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NATIONAL ARCHIVES AND RECORDS ADMINISTRATION
MICROFILM PUBLICATIONS

M1657

THE DISAPPEARANCE OF FLIGHT 19, NAVY AVENGER TORPEDO BOMBERS, OVER THE BERMUDA TRIANGLE, DECEMBER 5, 1945

Records compiled and Introduction written by
Kent Carter and Rodney Krajca

National Archives and Records Administration
Washington, DC
2001

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Authority NND 868189

INTRODUCTION

On this single roll of microfilm publication, M1657, are reproduced records of the Naval Air Advanced Training Command in Jacksonville, Florida. These records are located at the National Archives–Southwest Region in Fort Worth, Texas. They are part of the Records of Naval Districts and Shore Establishments, Record Group 181.

Background

The Air Operational Training Command was established on April 30, 1942, with headquarters at Jacksonville Naval Air Station to process naval aviators through an advanced course to prepare them for assignment to fleet units and to conduct advanced and specialized flight and ground training. An Air Intermediate Training Command was established on October 1, 1942, with headquarters at the Naval Air Station at Pensacola and operations at the Corpus Christi Naval Air Station. Both of these Commands became part of the Naval Air Training Command when it was established at the Pensacola NAS on December 20, 1943.

On November 1, 1945, the Air Intermediate Training Command was redesignated the Naval Air Basic Training Command, and the Air Operational Training Command became the Naval Air Advanced Training Command. Its headquarters were moved from Jacksonville NAS to Corpus Christi, Texas, on November 24, 1948.

At 2:10 p.m. on December 5, 1945, five Navy Avenger Torpedo Bombers disappeared while on a training mission over the Bermuda Triangle. The Bermuda Triangle is an area that covers 440,000 square miles between the Bermuda Islands, the coast of Southern Florida, and San Juan, Puerto Rico. The airplanes departed that fateful afternoon from the U.S. Naval Air Station in Fort Lauderdale, Florida, on what has become known as Flight 19. The airplanes were on a routine navigation exercise over the Atlantic Ocean. At about 4 p.m. a radio message was received from Flight 19. The message stated that they were lost and uncertain of the direction to the Florida coast. There was also some indication that the compasses on the airplanes were malfunctioning. Due to radio traffic, communication with Flight 19 was difficult. After several attempts to lead the ill-fated flight to safety, radio contact was lost and the flight was never heard from again.

A massive search was launched over the next 5 days for the lost squadron. Over 200 airplanes a day searched for the missing crew. Despite this enormous search effort, no trace of the airplanes or the crew was ever found. In fact, one of the PBM patrol planes involved in the search for Flight 19 also vanished on December 5, 1945. On December 10, 1945, the search was called off with a total of 27 men and six airplanes still missing. A Board of Investigation convened at the U.S. Naval Air Station on December 10, 1945, and subsequently released their Findings of Fact. Although the Findings of Fact point to factors that may have contributed to the loss of the airplanes, the disappearance of Flight 19 remains one of the greatest unsolved mysteries of the Bermuda Triangle.

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Records Description

The records that follow are related to this incident and include weather observations, the history of the aircraft and engine logs, a rough crash log, radio station logs, pre-flight forms, communication logs, incident reports, air/sea rescue plans, maps of the search area, and the Board of Investigation's Findings of Fact.

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Folder A17 (2). **Fort Lauderdale–5 TBM Crash–December 5, 1945**
Entry 16 (Box 94)

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Folder A17 (1). **Administrative Report–Fort Lauderdale–1946**
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NATIONAL ARCHIVES AND RECORDS ADMINISTRATION
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Target 1

Folder A17 (2)
Fort Lauderdale–5 TBM Crash–December 5, 1945
Entry 16 (Box 94)

Information on the disappearance of Flight 19.

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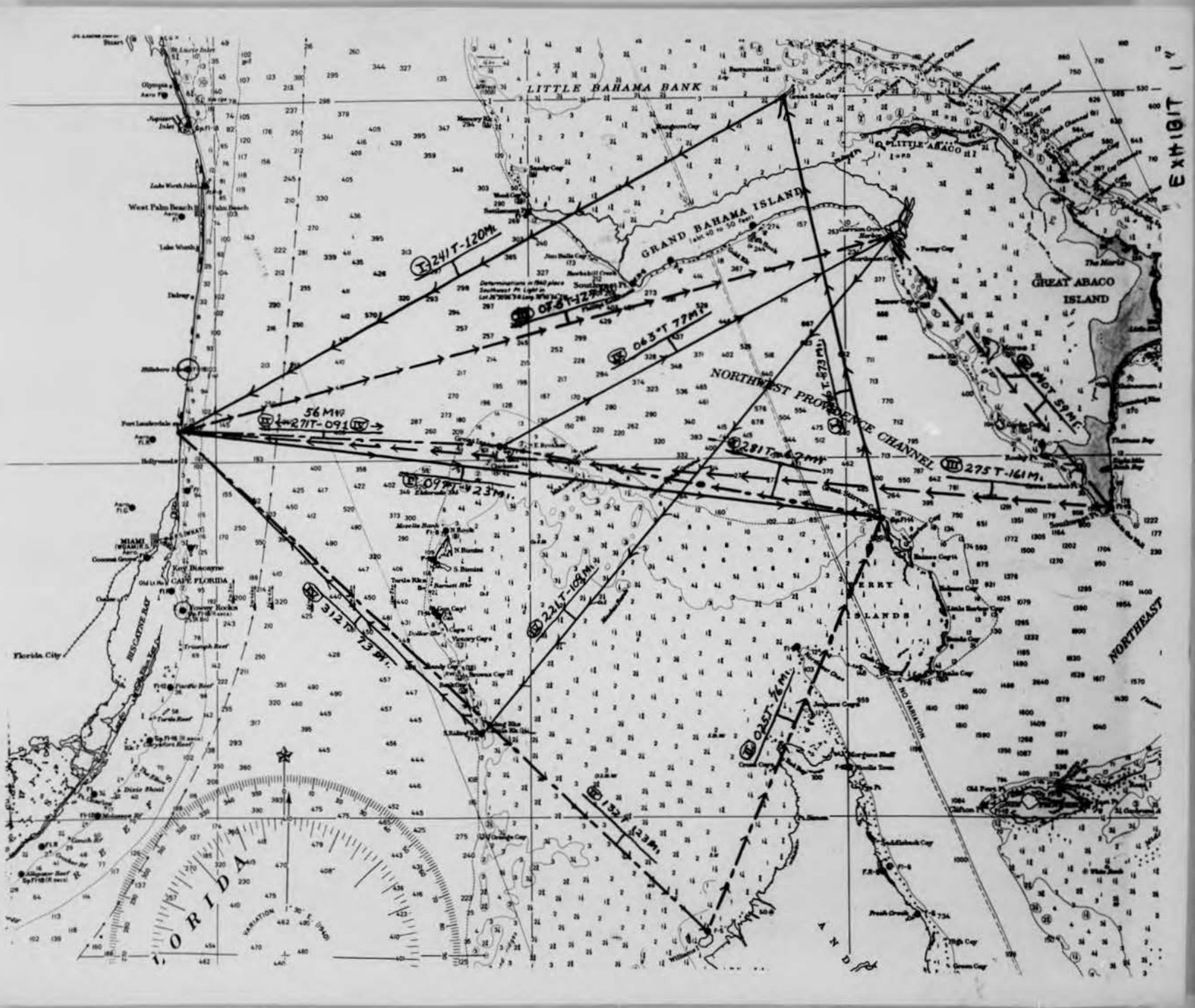
NARA 1



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Lt. Col. USA

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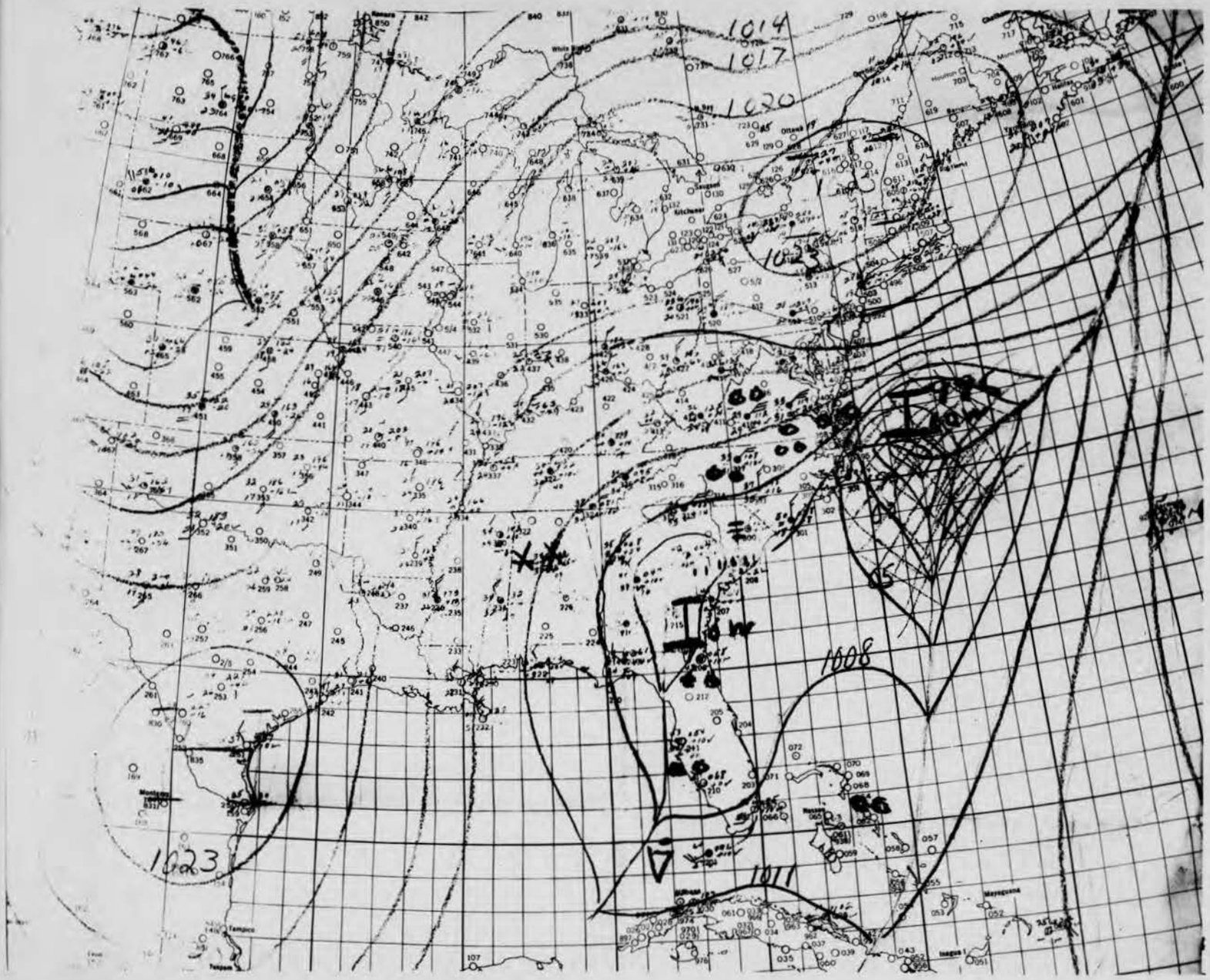

" EXHIBIT 2 "

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Certified to be a true copy of the surface weather map
of 5 Dec. 1945 at 0730E
N. A. S. Ft. Lauderdale, Florida
D. J. Beattenmuller, Lt. (jg) USNR
Aerological Officer

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NAVAER-448 A (12-44)

Time entries on this form are 75 th meridian time

To convert to G. C. T. {add / ~~subtract~~} 5 hours

Height of Barometer 30.6 Ft. (MSL)

NAVY DEPARTMENT

SURFACE WEATHER OBSERVATIONS

(LAND STATION)

WBAN—10 A

Security Classification RESTRICTED

Station U. S. NAVAL AIR STATION FORT LAUDERDALE, FLORIDA

Lat. 26°04'N Long. 80°09'W

TYPE (1)	TIME (2)	CLASSIFICATION (3)	CEILING (Hundreds of Feet) (4)	SKY (5)	VISIBILITY (Miles) (6)	WEATHER AND/OR OBSTRUCTIONS TO VISION (7)	SEA-LEVEL PRESSURE (Mbs.) (8)	TEMP. (°F) (9)	DEW PT. (°F) (10)	WIND DIRECTION (11)	WIND VELOCITY (N. P. H.) (12)	WIND CHARACTER AND SHIFTS (13)	ALTIMETER (Inches) (14)	REMARKS AND SUPPLEMENTAL CODED DATA (For Transmission) (15)	PRES. TEND. (16)	NET 3-HR. CHANGE (Inches) (17)	PRECIP. (Inches) (18)	CLOUDS LOW AMT., TYPE, DIRECTION (19)	CLOUDS LOW HEIGHT (Hnds. of Ft.) (20)	CLOUDS MIDDLE AMT., TYPE, DIRECTION (21)	CLOUDS MIDDLE HEIGHT (Hnds. of Ft.) (22)	CLOUDS HIGH AMT., TYPE, DIRECTION (23)	CLOUDS HIGH HEIGHT (Hnds. of Ft.) (24)	STATION PRESSURE (Inches) (25)	DRY BULB (°F) (26)	WET BULB (°F) (27)	WATER TEMP. (°F) (28)	(29)	OBS. INIT. (30)
S	0650			30 ⊕	5	GF-	1007.7	57	M	↗	5		975		3	+1.0		2 Cu c	E30	0	—	0	—	29.740	57.1	M			LAF
R	0750			40 ⊕	6	GF-	1007.9	59	M	↑↗	6		975					1 Cu c	E10	1 AC c	E60	0	—	29.745	58.0	M			LAF
S	0850			⊕/40 ⊕	8		1008.1	63	M	↑↗	5		976					2 Cu c	E40	1 AC c	E100	0	—	29.750	62.6	M			LAF
S	0925		E20	⊕/⊕	7	RW-	—	-		→↗	10		-					6 Cu →	E20	2 AC c	E100	6	—	—	-	M			KW
S	0950			⊕/30 ⊕	10		1009.0	63	M	↗	10		979		3	+1.2		2 Cu →	E30	2 AC c	E100	0	—	29.775	63.0	M			ARL
R	1050			⊕/20 ⊕	10		1007.7	66	M	↑↗	13		975					3 Cu →	E20	1 AC c	E100	6	—	29.740	66.0	M			LAF
R	1150			30 ⊕	12		1006.7	68	M	→↗	11		972	RW NW				2 Cu →	E30	0	-	0	—	29.710	67.6	M			KW
R	1250		E55	⊕/⊕	12		1006.7	67	M	→↗	18		972	30 ⊕	6	-2.4		6 SC →	E55	1 AC c	E100	0	—	29.715	66.8	M			ARL
S	1350		E55	⊕/⊕	12	RW-	1006.0	67	M	→	19		970	30 ⊕				6 SC →	E55	1 AC c	E100	0	—	29.680	67.2	M			AR
S	1420		E50	⊕/⊕	12		—	-	-	→	21	+	-	GSTS SW 31 K 30 ⊕				6 SC →	E50	1 AC c	E100	0	—	-	-	-			KW
R	1450			⊕/30 ⊕	12		1006.0	67	M	→	21	+	970	GSTS TO 31 K				4 SC →	E30	1 AC c	E100	0	—	29.696	67.1	M			AR
R	1550			⊕/35 ⊕	12		1005.9	65	49	→↗	20	+	969	GSTS TO 31 K	8	-0.8		3 CU →	E35	1 AC c	E100	0	-	29.685	65.1	56.0			AR
R	1650			⊕/25 ⊕	12		1005.8	65	60	→↗	15		969	DRK NW				3 CU →	E25	2 AC c	E100	0	—	29.680	65.0	60.0			AVS
R	1750			⊕/	12		1006.1	61	51	→↗	6		970	DRK NW FEW CU				1 CU →	E25	2 AC →	E100	0	—	29.690	61	55.5			AC
R	1850			⊕/25 ⊕	8		1006.1	60	52	→	6		971	BINOVC SCUD 15	2	+0.2		2 CU →	E25	1 DAC	E100	0 BKN CU		29.695	60.5	56.0			AC

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DJ Baltenmuller Sfg
Wea Off.

SUMMARY OF DAY (midnight to midnight)

Time of sunrise 0654 Time of sunset 1729

24-hr. Max. Temp. 71.0 °F. 24-hr. Min. Temp. 57.0 °F.

24-hr. Precip. (water equivalent) — in. 24-hr. Snowfall (unmelted) — in.

Total hours of fog: Light — Moderate — Heavy —

Max. wind (5 min.) — (m.p.h., knots) Direction — Time —

Extreme wind (fastest single mile) — (m. p. h., knots) Direction — Time —

Peak gust 38 (~~m. p. h.~~, knots) Direction WSW Time 1421

Thickness of ice on water — in.

Ground frozen from — in. to — in.

6-HOURLY OBSERVATIONS

Time of Obs.	0650	1250	1850	—	Midnight
Precip. (in.)	—	—	—	—	-
Snowfall (in.)	—	—	—	—	—
Snow Depth (in.)	—	—	—	—	—
Max. Temp.	71.0	68.4	68.5	—	—
Min. Temp.	57.5	57.0	60.5	—	—
5,000 ft. Pressure	—	—	—	—	XXX
Rel. Hum. %	M	M	M	—	XXX
Soil Temp.	—	—	—	—	XXX
State of Ground	1	1	0	—	XXX

Time of Obs.	0650	1250	1850	—
State of Sea and Dir.	—	—	—	—
Swell Ht. and Dir.	—	—	—	—
Swell Period	—	—	—	—
Surf (LsLsKsPsD)	—	—	—	—
Barograph Reading	1008	1007	1006	—
Attached Thermometer	71.0	75.0	75.0	—
Observed Reading	29.890	29.870	29.860	-
Total Correction	-0.150	-0.150	-0.165	—

Remarks, Notes, and Miscellaneous Phenomena

Types of air masses and frontal passages determined from synoptic maps, severe storms, miscellaneous hydrometeors, floods

Month DECEMBER Day 5 Year 45

EXHIBIT 3

16—42006-1 U. S. GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE

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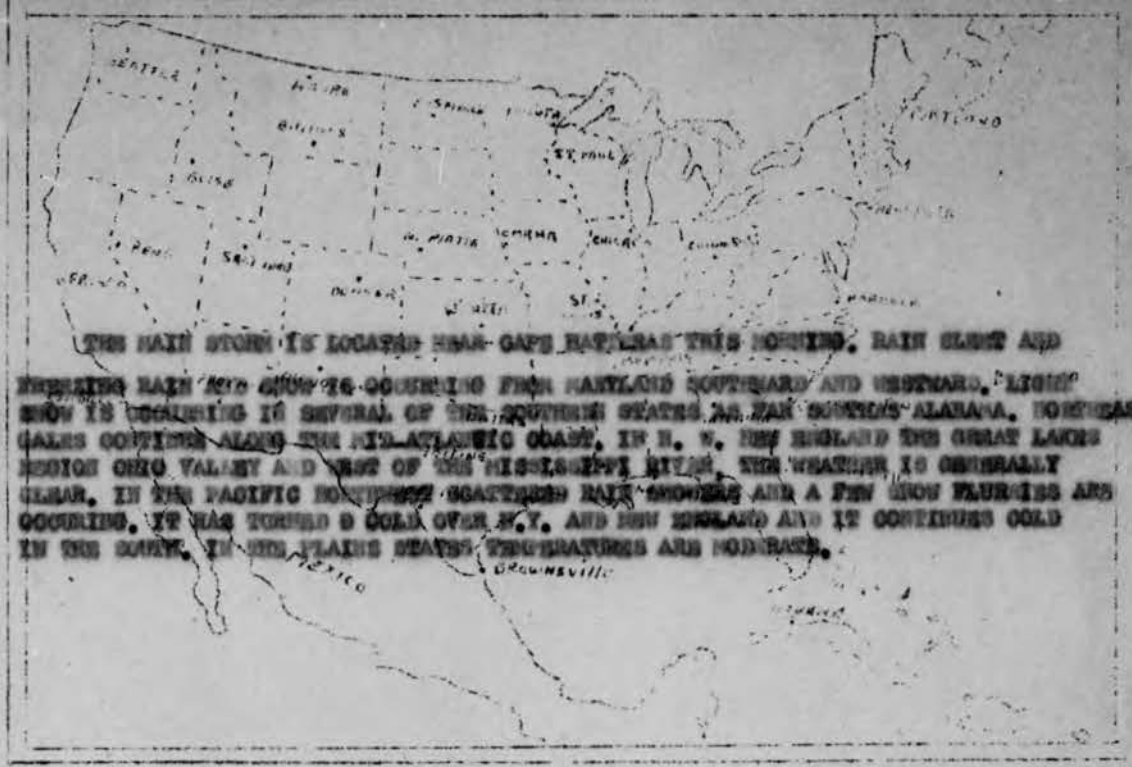
U.S. NAVAL AIR STATION
FORT LAUDERDALE, FLORIDA

DATE: 5 December 1945
TIME: 1100Z



THE MAIN STORM IS LOCATED NEAR CAPE HATTERAS THIS MORNING. RAIN SLEET AND FREEZING RAIN ARE NOW BEING REPORTED FROM MARYLAND SOUTHWARD AND WESTWARD. LIGHT SNOW IS OCCURRING IN SEVERAL OF THE SOUTHERN STATES AS FAR SOUTH AS ALABAMA. NORTHEAST GALES CONTINUE ALONG THE MID-ATLANTIC COAST. IN N. Y. NEW ENGLAND THE GREAT LAKES REGION OHIO VALLEY AND WEST OF THE MISSISSIPPI RIVER, THE WEATHER IS GENERALLY CLEAR. IN THE PACIFIC NORTHWEST SCATTERED RAIN SHOWERS ARE A FEW SNOW FLURRIES ARE OCCURRING. IT HAS TURNED D COLD OVER N.Y. AND NEW ENGLAND AND IT CONTINUES COLD IN THE SOUTH. IN THE PLAINS STATES TEMPERATURES ARE MODERATE.

(SEE ABOVE MAP) ""SYNOPSIS""

Widely scattered showers will precede the secondary cold frontal passage late this afternoon, giving much cooler temperatures tonight. State of sea tomrrow will be moderate to rought. T omorrow will be mostly clear with maximum around 65°.

TODAY UNTIL 1800

FLYING CONDITIONS	STATE OF WEATHER	SURFACE WINDS DIR.	VEL.a/h	high hr.	UPPER WINDS dir.	vel.	TEMP MAX.
AVERAGE TO UNDESIRABLE	SHOWERS	W	11	15	W	30	67

Scattered altocumulus clouds. Lower scattered stratocumulus and cumulus at 1500 to 2500 feet, becoming broken in moderate showers. Visibility 5 miles, lowering to 2 miles in showers. Surface winds southwesterly to westerly, 10 to 25 knots. Winds aloft 230° to 240°, 16 to 45 knots. Flying undesirable in showers in wind gusts to average between showers.

TONIGHT (1800 TO 0600)

FLYING CONDITIONS	STATE OF WEATHER	SURFACE WINDS DIR.	VEL.a/h	high hr.	UPPER WINDS dir.	vel.	TEMP MIN.
AVERAGE TO GOOD	MOSTLY CLEAR	NW	10	14	NW	25	43

Scattered altostratus, altocumulus clouds dissipating earl y in the period. B roken stratocumulus at 1500 feet, becoming scattered and then dissipating. S urface winds westerly, becoming northwesterly, 8 to 20 knots. Winds aloft northwesterly, 15 to 35 knots. Flying average to good.

TOMORROW (0600 TO 1800)

FLYING CONDITIONS	STATE OF WEATHER	SURFACE WINDS DIR.	VEL.	HIGH HR	UPPER WINDS dir.	vel.	TEMP. MAX.
GOOD	MOSTLY CLEAR	N	9	12	N	20	60

Few cumulus at 3000 feet. Visibility unrestricted and ceiling unlimited. Surface winds northwesterly to northerly, 6 to 17 knots. Winds aloft northerly, 15 to 30 knots. Flying generally good.

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D.J. Buttenmuller, Lt.(jg)

FURTHER OUTLOOK: D J Buttenmuller USNR AEROLOGICAL O-
FORECAST PREPARED BY:: [illegible]

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"EXHIBIT 4"

UNITED STATES NAVAL AIR STATION
FORT LAUDERDALE, FLORIDA

112
122

LATEST WINDS ALOFT DATA

TIME 1300 EWT DATE 5 Dec 1945

SURFACE	220	Degrees	20	Knots
1000 feet	241	Degrees	31	Knots
2000 feet	242	Degrees	32	Knots
3000 feet	240	Degrees	36	Knots
4000 feet	246	Degrees	33	Knots
5000 feet	245	Degrees	34	Knots
6000 feet	242	Degrees	52	Knots
7000 feet	235	Degrees	52	Knots
8000 feet	235	Degrees	45	Knots
9000 feet		Degrees		Knots
10,000 ft		Degrees		Knots

Reason for termination Entered cloud

REMARKS:-

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D J Buttenmuller Lt (jg) USNR
Aero Off.

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Extract of History of Aircraft and Engine Logs, TBM's.

AIRCRAFT

Tare Number and Type Aircraft	T-3 TBM-1C	T-23 TBM-3	T-36 TBM-1C	T-81 TBM-1C	T-117 TBM-1C
Bureau Number	45714	23307	46084	46325	73209
Total Time	725.7	320.2	1574.9	612.0	386.0
Total Time Since Overhaul	263.3	30.4	16.3	156.7	140.1
Number of Overhauls	One	One	One	One	One
Place and Date of Last Overhaul	Norfolk 3-2-45	San Diego 9-26-45	Miami 10-19-45	San Diego 7-11-45	Norfolk 6-27-45
Date of Acceptance	3-28-45	9-12-44	5-3-44	5-24-44	6-20-45
Type Last Check	120-hr.	Accept. Check	Accept. Check	120-hr.	120-hr.
Time Since Last Check	15.9	9.4	13.0	12.2	6.1

ENGINE

Bureau Number and Type Engine	34619 R2600-8	124575 R2600-8	66287 R2600-8	63027 R2600-8	34191 R2600-8
Manufacturer's Number	169292	- - -	Unknown	Unknown	168964
Total Time	1048.9	30.4	Unknown	Unknown	484.0
Total Time Since Overhaul	267.4	- - -	20.6	155.6	142.0
Number of Overhauls	Two	None	Unknown	Unknown	Two
Place and Date of Last Overhaul	Norfolk 2-20-45	- - -	San Deigo 12-12-45	- - -	Miami 6-24-45
Date of Acceptance	3-23-42	3-8-45	Unknown	Unknown	12-13-42
Type Last Check	120-hr.	Accept. Check	Accept. Check	120-hr.	120-hr.
Time Since Last Check	15.9	9.4	13.0	12.2	6.1

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1st Lt. Ord. USA

"EXHIBIT 5"

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WARMING UP

1. See that CHOCKS are under WHEELS. _____
2. Open ENGINE COWL FLAPS. _____

T - 8

Warm up engine in normal manner and make following checks:

3. Check ENGINE CONTROLS for proper functioning and lost motion. _____
4. FUEL PRESSURE. _____ 5. OIL PRESSURE. _____ 6. OIL TEMPERATURE. _____
7. MANIFOLD PRESSURE. _____ 8. GENERATOR OUTPUT. _____
9. R. P. M. drop at 70% rated R. P. M., R. H. MAGNETO. _____ L. H. MAGNETO. _____
10. VACUUM GAGE reading. _____ 11. Check operation of SUPERCHARGER CLUTCH. _____
12. Check ENGINE operation on each TANK. _____
13. Check INSTRUMENTS for excessive oscillation. _____
14. Check operation of PROPELLERS. _____
15. Check OIL PRESSURE WARNING SIGNAL. _____
16. Check for proper functioning, RADIO EQUIPMENT. _____ RADAR EQUIPMENT. _____

The operation of the internal geared supercharger has been checked in accordance with BuAer Technical Order No. 80-45 dated 7 September 1945 and has or has not (strike out one) been found satisfactory.

Flight No.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Gallons fuel										
Gallons oil										

Number of starter cartridges on board is _____

I certify that this airplane has this day been inspected under my supervision as above indicated and that the aircraft is (is not) ready for flight.

Date 5/12/45 Bu. No. _____ N. HARRIS

Plane Captain.

PILOT'S SIGNATURE

I accept this aircraft for flight:

1st Pilot [redacted]
2d Pilot J. T. BOSSI 79M
3d Pilot _____
4th Pilot _____
5th Pilot _____
6th Pilot _____
7th Pilot _____
8th Pilot _____
9th Pilot _____
10th Pilot _____

REPORT AFTER FLIGHT

Flight No.	Time Out	Time In	Purpose	Average R. P. M.	Average Manifold Pressure	Fuel Pressure	Oil Pressure	Oil Temp.	Fuel Consumed (gallons)	Oil Consumed (quarts)	Pilot's Initials	Passenger's Name
1	[redacted]										1 MJK 2	Barry Silverman
2	19 1345		L								1 JTB 2	Thelander Daluk
3											1 2	
4											1 2	
5											1 2	
6											1 2	
7											1 2	
8											1 2	
9											1 2	
10											1 2	

During flight I have noticed the following defects in this plane which should be remedied before the next flight:

No flight.

_____, 1st Pilot.
_____, 2d Pilot.
_____, 3d Pilot.
_____, 4th Pilot.
_____, 5th Pilot.
_____, 6th Pilot.
_____, 7th Pilot.
_____, 8th Pilot.
_____, 9th Pilot.
_____, 10th Pilot.

CERTIFIED TO BE A TRUE COPY
S. B. Smith

U. S. GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE 16—18936-2

T - 8

S. B. SMITH,
Lt., USN.

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34619

"EXHIBIT 6"

NAVAER-2119
(Rev. 9-43)

DAILY FLIGHT INSPECTION FORM

(For all types excepting VP, VPB, VJR, and amphibian type planes)

INSTRUCTIONS

The following form will be filled out and signed each day before any flights of the aircraft are made. This form is applicable to service type airplanes excepting VP, VPB, VJR, and amphibian types. However, ADDITIONAL SHEETS may be attached hereto as required by individual operating units.

The plane captain or person properly detailed to make inspection will check each item if satisfactory and will note remarks if items are unsatisfactory.

Each pilot will satisfy himself that a proper inspection is made of the aircraft and will state his acceptance before flight. Upon completion of each flight the pilot will record the defects noted which he considers should be remedied before the succeeding flight.

When an aircraft is remaining idle the propeller shall be turned over by hand at least two complete revolutions daily. Propeller blades will be wiped down with oil after each day's flying.

PLANE (Model)..... PLACE..... DATE.....

PROP.

1. Inspect BLADES and HUBS for pits, cracks, nicks, and proper oil film. .....
2. Inspect HUBS, BLADES, and ATTACHING PARTS for adequate tightness and proper safetying. .....
3. Check VARIABLE PITCH PROPELLERS for oil leaks (hub, barrel, governor base and head). .....

ENGINE

1. Inspect ENGINE COWLING, including RING COWL and FLAPS for cracks and security. .....
2. Inspect EXHAUST STACKS, COLLECTOR RING, and FLAME DAMPERS for cracks and security. .....
3. Inspect IGNITION HARNESS and SPARK PLUG TERMINALS for cleanliness, security of COUPLING NUTS, CONNECTIONS, and MOUNTINGS. .....
4. Drain and inspect small quantity of FUEL from FUEL LINE STRAINERS, and from LOWEST POINT IN FUEL SYSTEM, if STRAINER is not at lowest point (clean strainers if drainage shows presence of foreign matter). .....
5. Check ENGINE CONTROLS for ease and degree of movement, degree of slack and security. .....
6. Turn handle of disk type OIL STRAINER (if installed) at least one revolution to clean same. .....
7. Check FUEL and OIL SYSTEMS for leaks, security of tank caps, and ascertain that VENTS are not obstructed. .....
8. Check accessible GENERATOR TERMINALS and WIRING for condition and security. .....
9. Check FUEL PRESSURE WARNING SIGNAL with aid of auxiliary fuel pump. .....

LANDING GEAR

1. Inspect TIRES for defects and proper inflation. .....
2. Inspect WHEELS for cracks and distortion and HUB CAPS for security. .....
3. Inspect SHOCK ABSORBER UNITS and BRAKE LINKAGE GEAR. .....
4. Inspect STRUT RETAINING BOLTS and FITTINGS for security. .....
5. Inspect BRACE WIRES for tension and security. .....
6. Inspect RETRACTABLE LANDING GEAR mechanism and lubricate as necessary. .....
7. Inspect MAIN FLOAT(S) or HULL for leaks, presence of water, and security of handhole covers. .....
8. Inspect BEACHING-GEAR tires, wheels, locking pins, and attachment fittings. .....

WINGS

1. Inspect COVERING for damage, buckled ribs, and end bows. .....
2. Inspect ATTACHMENT FITTINGS for security. .....
3. Check STRUTS and FLYING WIRES for security of terminal connections. .....
4. Check AILERON HINGES, PINS, HORNS, and TABS for security of attachments, proper lubrication, and position. .....
5. Inspect and check operation of LANDING FLAPS or DIVING FLAPS (check for hydraulic leaks). .....
6. Inspect accessible CONTROL CABLE, TUBES, and PULLEYS for security and proper lubrication. .....
7. Check WING-TIP FLOATS for leaks, presence of water, and security of handhole covers. .....
8. Remove all SURFACE CONTROL LOCKS before flight. .....

TAIL

1. Inspect COVERING for damage, buckled ribs, and bruised edges. .....
2. Inspect ATTACHMENT FITTINGS for security. .....
3. Check STRUTS and BRACE WIRES for security of terminal connections. .....
4. Check CONTROL SURFACE HINGES, PINS, HORNS, and TABS for security of attachments, proper lubrication, and position. .....
5. Inspect CONTROL CABLE, TUBES, and PULLEYS for security and proper lubrication. .....
6. Check STABILIZER ADJUSTMENT assembly for cleanliness and proper lubrication. .....
7. Check TAIL SKID or WHEEL assembly for condition and lubrication, noting position of locking device. .....
8. Remove all SURFACE CONTROL LOCKS before flight. .....

FUSELAGE

1. Inspect all BAYS for loose articles. .....
2. Inspect CONTROL COLUMN assembly and accessible parts of control system for freedom of movement, lost motion, security of attachments, and proper lubrication. .....
3. Inspect RUDDER PEDAL assembly and CONTROL SYSTEM as above. .....
4. Check STABILIZER ADJUSTMENT mechanism for freedom of movement, returning it to neutral position. .....
5. Prior to carrier operation check operations of LANDING HOOK.—Inspect hook operating mechanism.
6. Test operation of NOSE SHUTTERS. .....
7. Inspect FLOTATION GEAR and FIRE EXTINGUISHER BOTTLE INDICATORS for fully charged condition.....
8. Inspect all removable COWLING, FAIRING, and INSPECTION PLATES for security. .....
9. Check proper functioning of LIGHTING SYSTEM. .....
10. Inspect for security of SAFETY BELTS.
11. Check proper functioning of COCKPIT ENCLOSURES and ADJUSTABLE SEAT mechanism. .....
12. Check position of GENERATOR BATTERY-CHARGING SWITCH. .....
13. Check HYDRAULIC SYSTEM RESERVOIR for proper quantity of fluid. .....
14. Clean windshield and cockpit enclosures. .....
15. Clean instrument cover glasses and check for rotation. .....

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Authority NND 868189

16—18936-2

NAVA 11

T - 28

WARMING UP

1. See that CHOCKS are under WHEELS. _____
2. Open ENGINE COWL FLAPS. _____

Warm up engine in normal manner and make following checks:

3. Check ENGINE CONTROLS for proper functioning and lost motion. _____
4. FUEL PRESSURE. _____ 5. OIL PRESSURE. _____ 6. OIL TEMPERATURE. _____
7. MANIFOLD PRESSURE. _____ 8. GENERATOR OUTPUT. _____
9. R. P. M. drop at 70% rated R. P. M., R. H. MAGNETO. _____ L. H. MAGNETO. _____
10. VACUUM GAGE reading. _____ 11. Check operation of SUPERCHARGER CLUTCH. _____
12. Check ENGINE operation on each TANK. _____
13. Check INSTRUMENTS for excessive oscillation. _____
14. Check operation of PROPELLERS. _____
15. Check OIL PRESSURE WARNING SIGNAL. _____
16. Check for proper functioning, RADIO EQUIPMENT. _____ RADAR EQUIPMENT. _____

The operation of the internal gears of supercharger has been checked in accordance with BuAer Technical Order No. 80-45 dated 7 September 1945, and has or has not (strike out one) been found satisfactory.

Flight No.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Gallons fuel										
Gallons oil										

Number of starter cartridges on board is _____

I certify that this airplane has this day been inspected under my supervision as above indicated and that the aircraft is (is not) ready for flight.

Date 12-6-45 Bu. No. _____ CONLEY

Plane Captain.

PILOT'S SIGNATURE

I accept this aircraft for flight:

1st Pilot	D. W. HARRIS	BSM	6th Pilot	
2d Pilot	J. NEIMAN	Instructor	7th Pilot	
3d Pilot	C.C.TAYLOR	Inst.	8th Pilot	
4th Pilot			9th Pilot	
5th Pilot			10th Pilot	

REPORT AFTER FLIGHT

Flight No.	Time Out	Time In	Purpose	Average R. P. M.	Average Manifold Pressure	Fuel Pressure	Oil Pressure	Oil Temp.	Fuel Consumed (gallons)	Oil Consumed (quarts)	Pilot's Initials	Passenger's Name
1.3 5 & 6			IBP	2000	37"	17"	90	60			1 DWH 2	Steger Wood
1.2 2 9	1000	1120	ND	2000	26	17	85	70			1 2 JH	No passengers
3 10	1345		L								1 2	Parpart Harmon
4											1 2	
5											1 2	
6											1 2	
7											1 2	
8											1 2	
9											1 2	
10											1 2	

During flight I have noticed the following defects in this plane which should be remedied before the next flight:

Radio coffee grinder inoperative.

D. W. HARRIS, *1st Pilot.*

O.K.

J. NEIMAN, Jr., *2d Pilot.*

_____, *3d Pilot.*

_____, *4th Pilot.*

_____, *5th Pilot.*

_____, *6th Pilot.*

_____, *7th Pilot.*

_____, *8th Pilot.*

_____, *9th Pilot.*

_____, *10th Pilot.*

CERTIFIED TO BE A TRUE COPY

S. B. Smith

S. B. SMITH
Lt., USN

U. S. GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE 16—18630-2

T - 28

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NAVAER 12

T - 35

WARMING UP

1. See that CHOCKS are under WHEELS. _____
2. Open ENGINE COWL FLAPS. _____

Warm up engine in normal manner and make following checks:

3. Check ENGINE CONTROLS for proper functioning and lost motion. _____
4. FUEL PRESSURE. _____ 5. OIL PRESSURE. _____ 6. OIL TEMPERATURE. _____
7. MANIFOLD PRESSURE. _____ 8. GENERATOR OUTPUT. _____
9. R. P. M. drop at 70% rated R. P. M., R. H. MAGNETO. _____ L. H. MAGNETO. _____
10. VACUUM GAGE reading. _____ 11. Check operation of SUPERCHARGER CLUTCH. _____
12. Check ENGINE operation on each TANK. _____
13. Check INSTRUMENTS for excessive oscillation. _____
14. Check operation of PROPELLERS. _____
15. Check OIL PRESSURE WARNING SIGNAL. _____
16. Check for proper functioning, RADIO EQUIPMENT. _____ RADAR EQUIPMENT. _____

The operation of the [illegible] supercharger has been c[illegible] accordance with BuAe[illegible] Order No. 80-45 dated [illegible] 1945, and has or has not (strike one) been found satisfactory.

Flight No.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Gallons fuel										
Gallons oil										

Number of starter cartridges on board is _____

I certify that this airplane has this day been inspected under my supervision as above indicated and that the aircraft is (is not) ready for flight.

Date 12/5/45 Bu. No. _____ ISBELL, B. P.

Plane Captain.

PILOT'S SIGNATURE

I accept this aircraft for flight:

1st Pilot E. J. POWERS, Jr. 79M
2d Pilot _____
3d Pilot _____
4th Pilot _____
5th Pilot _____
6th Pilot _____
7th Pilot _____
8th Pilot _____
9th Pilot _____
10th Pilot _____

REPORT AFTER FLIGHT

Flight No.	Time Out	Time In	Purpose	Average R. P. M.	Average Manifold Pressure	Fuel Pressure	Oil Pressure	Oil Temp.	Fuel Consumed (gallons)	Oil Consumed (quarts)	Pilot's Initials	Passenger's Name
1	19		L								1	Thompson, H.O.
											2	Peterson, O.R.
2											1	
											2	
3											1	
											2	
4											1	
											2	
5											1	
											2	
6											1	
											2	
7											1	
											2	
8											1	
											2	
9											1	
											2	
10											1	
											2	

During flight I have noticed the following defects in this plane which should be remedied before the next flight:

_____, *1st Pilot.*

_____, *2d Pilot.*

_____, *3d Pilot.*

_____, *4th Pilot.*

_____, *5th Pilot.*

_____, *6th Pilot.*

_____, *7th Pilot.*

_____, *8th Pilot.*

_____, *9th Pilot.*

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_____, *10th Pilot.*

S. B. SMITH, LCdr., USN

T - 35

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NATC 13

T - 81

WARMING UP

1. See that CHOCKS are under WHEELS. _____
2. Open ENGINE COWL FLAPS. _____

Warm up engine in normal manner and make following checks:

3. Check ENGINE CONTROLS for proper functioning and lost motion. _____
4. FUEL PRESSURE. _____ 5. OIL PRESSURE. _____ 6. OIL TEMPERATURE. _____
7. MANIFOLD PRESSURE. _____ 8. GENERATOR OUTPUT. _____
9. R. P. M. drop at 70% rated R. P. M., R. H. MAGNETO. _____ L. H. MAGNETO. _____
10. VACUUM GAGE reading. _____ 11. Check operation of SUPERCHARGER CLUTCH. _____
12. Check ENGINE operation on each TANK. _____
13. Check INSTRUMENTS for excessive oscillation. _____
14. Check operation of PROPELLERS. _____
15. Check OIL PRESSURE WARNING SIGNAL. _____
16. Check for proper functioning, RADIO EQUIPMENT. _____ RADAR EQUIPMENT. _____

The operation of the internal geared supercharger has been checked in accordance with BuAer Technical Order No. 80-45 dated 7 September 1945, and has or has not (strike out one) been found satisfactory.

Flight No.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Gallons fuel										
Gallons oil										

Number of starter cartridges on board is _____

I certify that this airplane has this day been inspected under my supervision as above indicated and that the aircraft is (is not) ready for flight.

Date 5/12/46 Bu. No. _____ W. HARRIS

Plane Captain.

PILOT'S SIGNATURE

I accept this aircraft for flight:

1st Pilot [redacted] 2d Pilot GERNER, F. J. 72M 3d Pilot _____ 4th Pilot _____ 5th Pilot _____

6th Pilot _____ 7th Pilot _____ 8th Pilot _____ 9th Pilot _____ 10th Pilot _____

REPORT AFTER FLIGHT

Flight No.	Time Out	Time In	Purpose	Average R. P. M.	Average Manifold Pressure	Fuel Pressure	Oil Pressure	Oil Temp.	Fuel Consumed (gallons)	Oil Consumed (quarts)	Pilot's Initials	Passenger's Name
1	[redacted]										1 AEF 2 FJG	BAKER, W. D. COX, D LIGHTFOOT
2	19 1345		L								1 2	
3											1 2	
4											1 2	
5											1 2	
6											1 2	
7											1 2	
8											1 2	
9											1 2	
10											1 2	

During flight I have noticed the following defects in this plane which should be remedied before the next flight:

No flights.

_____, *1st Pilot.*

_____, *2d Pilot.*

_____, *3d Pilot.*

_____, *4th Pilot.*

_____, *5th Pilot.*

_____, *6th Pilot.*

_____, *7th Pilot.*

_____, *8th Pilot.*

_____, *9th Pilot.*

_____, *10th Pilot.*

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S. B. SMITH Lt., USN

U. S. GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE 16—18006-8

T - 81

63027

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Authority NND 868189

MARK 14

T - 117

WARMING UP

1. See that CHOCKS are under WHEELS. _____
2. Open ENGINE COWL FLAPS. _____

Warm up engine in normal manner and make following checks:

3. Check ENGINE CONTROLS for proper functioning and lost motion. _____
4. FUEL PRESSURE. _____ 5. OIL PRESSURE. _____ 6. OIL TEMPERATURE. _____
7. MANIFOLD PRESSURE. _____ 8. GENERATOR OUTPUT. _____
9. R. P. M. drop at 70% rated R. P. M., R. H. MAGNETO. _____ L. H. MAGNETO. _____
10. VACUUM GAGE reading. _____ 11. Check operation of SUPERCHARGER CLUTCH. _____
12. Check ENGINE operation on each TANK. _____
13. Check INSTRUMENTS for excessive oscillation. _____
14. Check operation of PROPELLERS. _____
15. Check OIL PRESSURE WARNING SIGNAL. _____
16. Check for proper functioning, RADIO EQUIPMENT. _____ RADAR EQUIPMENT. _____

The operation of the internal geared supercharger has been checked in accordance with BuAer Technical Order No. 80-45 dated 7 September 1945, and has or has not (strike out one) been found satisfactory.

Flight No.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Gallons fuel										
Gallons oil										

Number of starter cartridges on board is _____

I certify that this airplane has this day been inspected under my supervision as above indicated and that the aircraft is (is not) ready for flight.

Date 5/12/45 Bu. No. _____ N. HARRIS

Plane Captain.

PILOT'S SIGNATURE

I accept this aircraft for flight:

1st Pilot SHOCKLEY, E. J. 983
2d Pilot STIVERS, G. M. 979M
3d Pilot _____
4th Pilot _____
5th Pilot _____
6th Pilot _____
7th Pilot _____
8th Pilot _____
9th Pilot _____
10th Pilot _____

REPORT AFTER FLIGHT

Flight No.	Time Out	Time In	Purpose	Average R. P. M.	Average Manifold Pressure	Fuel Pressure	Oil Pressure	Oil Temp.	Fuel Consumed (gallons)	Oil Consumed (quarts)	Pilot's Initials	Passenger's Name
1	8		L	1800	25	35	80	90			1 [illegible]	GRATTIN
											2	COLLEVIE
2	12	1345	L								1	CHENEL, R. F.
											2	GALLIVAN, R. F.
3											1	
											2	
4											1	
											2	
5											1	
											2	
6											1	
											2	
7											1	
											2	
8											1	
											2	
9											1	
											2	
10											1	
											2	

2.9

During flight I have noticed the following defects in this plane which should be remedied before the next flight:

O K
E. J. SHOCKLEY, 1st Pilot.
_____, 2d Pilot.
_____, 3d Pilot.
_____, 4th Pilot.
_____, 5th Pilot.
_____, 6th Pilot.
_____, 7th Pilot.
_____, 8th Pilot.
_____, 9th Pilot.
_____, 10th Pilot.

CERTIFIED TO BE A TRUE COPY

S. D. Smith

GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE 16—15930-2

T - 117 S. D. SMITH Lt., USN

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84191

RADIO STATION LOG

U. S. NAVAL AIR STATION, Ft. Lauderdale, Florida

OPR MUSTANG Frequency 4505 Position TURNS Date 5 DEC 1945

GCT	ZCT	TRANSMISSION
1605	NHAI V T 74	IT SEEMS TO BE A BUNCH OF PLANE LOST AND IS CALLING TOWER X SUGGEST YOU INFORM TOWER OF IT. K
1607	T74 V NHAI	WILCO. (INFORMED TOWER) TOWER ASKS IF THEY HAVE ANY RADIO. OR IDENTIFICATION
1608	T74 V NHAI	DO THEY HAVE ANY RADIO.
1608	NHAI V T74	NEG. NOT AS YET KNOWN.
1609	T74 V NHAI	WAS
1611	NHAI V T74	FLIGHT OF FIVE PLANES LEADER 10 FT 20. OUR POSITION IS ABOUT SOUTH OF LAUDERDALE DOWN BY THE RIVER. SMALL ISLANDS ON PORT SIDE X. SUN IS ON PORT SIDE X. HE HAS HIS RADIO. IFF EQUIPMENT ON X REQUESTS IF HE CAN BE PICKED UP ON FT. LAUDERDALE RADAR OKAY. XK
1620	T74 V NHAI	NEG. HE CAN NOT BE PICKED UP AT FT. LAUDERDALE RADAR OKAY. XK
1620	NHAI V T74	R. ROGER.
1625	NHAI V T74	HE IS NOW ON A NEW HEADING X ANGELS 4.5 AND CLIMBING K
1730	NHA3	a5
1730	FT 23 V NHA3	K
	NHA3 V FT23	I CAN HEAR YOU VERY FAINTLY MY TRANSMISSION IS GETTING WEAKER K
1730	FT23 V NHA3	RD CHANGE TO YELLOW BAND 3000KCS. AND GIVE US A CALL. K
1730	NHA3 V FT23	MY TRANSMISSION IS GETTING WEAKER K.
1730	NHA3 V FT23	
1733	FT23 V NHA3	COUNT X CHANGE TO YELLOW BAND 3000KCS. AND SAY AGAIN TWICE NEXT ANNOUNCED K
1734	FT23 V NHA3	DID YOU RECEIVE MY LAST TRANSMISSION K
1734	FT23 V NHA3	RD CHANGE TO 3000 KCS. K
1735	NHA3 V FT23	REPEAT ONCE AGAIN K
1735	FT23 V NHA3	CHANGE TO CHAN 1 3000 KCS. K
1802		WE MAY HAVE TO SWING
1803	FOWERS V TAYLOR	DO YOU READ K
1804	FOWERS V TAYLOR	DO YOU READ K
1804	FOWERS V TAYLOR	I HAVE BEEN TRYING TO REACH YOU K
1805	FOWERS V TAYLOR	THIS IS TAYLOR--WE ARE OVER---DON'T YOU THINK----------
1806	FOWERS V TAYLOR	TURN AROUND AND FLY BACK EAST UNTIL WE RUN OUT OF GAS X I THINK WE WOULD HAVE A BETTER CHANCE OF BEING PICKED UP X SHOULD BE ABLE TO SEE A LIGHT------
1806		
1807	FOWERS V TAYLOR	ARE YOU----TURN AROUND AND GO------
1807	FT23 V NHA3	DO YOU READ ME K
1809	FT23 V NHA3	DO YOU READ ME K (LOST CODE)K
1813	HELLO FOWERS V TAYLOR	
1817	FOWERS V TAYLOR	WHAT IS YOUR COURSE K RG ACK.
1843	FT23 V FT5	
1844	FT5 V NHA3	R 3 RGD COPY COME IN PLEASE K
1845	FT23 FT09	----------
1848	FT5 V NHA3	WE ARE READING YOU VERY WEAK COME IN PLEASE K
1848	NHA41 V NHA3	READING YOU VERY WEAK NOW DO YOU READ ME K
1850	NHA41 V NHA3	SAY AGAIN K
1852	NHA41 V NHA3	RG HAVE NO MESSG FOR YOU K
1853	NHA41 V NHA3	RT IF YOU PSE. SE YOU ARE G-6 ON 6705 RG MIAMI MORNING X TUNE YOU REC. TO THIS FREQ. K

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"EXHIBIT 7"

"EXHIBIT J"

RADIO STATION LOG
U. S. NAVAL AIR STATION FT. LAUDERDALE, FLORIDA

OPR KEIRVOLD Frequency 4005 Position TOWER Date 5 Dec. 1945

R TIME		TRANSMISSION
1956	NIA41 V NIA3	SET ADC-5 ON MIAMI BOMBING K
1957	NIA41 V NIA3	WE WILL GIVE YOU A CALL ON MIAMI BOMBING IN ONE (1) MIN. K
1904	T23 V T3	WD ACK V T23

RADIO STATION LOO

U. S. NAVAL AIR STATION, FT. LAUDERDALE, FLORIDA

MONTHLY

O/T [illegible] Frequency 3000 Position TWO Date 5 DEC 1945

E TIME	TRANSMISSION
1923	SKD UP WATCH
1926	MIAMI DUMBO V NAA1 — ET CONTINUE 045 DEGREES FOR 150 MILES THEN TURN SOUTH TO 29 DEGREES-14 MINUTES-TO THEREAFTER 3-00 MINUTES-REPT AND CALL FOR FU THER INSTRUCTIONS K
1933	NAA1 V MIA3 — MIAMI DUMBO ROGERS YOUR MESSG. K
1939	NAA3 V NAA1 — R AR.
1943	MIAMI DUMBO V NAA3 — MESSAGE FOR YOU K
2004	NAV V NAA3 — IF YOU HEAD ME GIVE MIAMI DUMBO A CALL K I HAVE A MESSG FOR HIM K
2006	NAV V NAA3 — RELAY THE FOLLOWING MESSG TO MIAMI DUMBO X AT END OF PRESENT COURSE PROCEED TO 29 DEGREES 15 MINUTES NORTH 079 DEGREES 00 WEST AND TIME LIMIT OF ENDURANCE K CONTACT HIMMER KEY CW FOX (D)ZK
2039	NPD V NAA3 — YOU ARE TO CALL MIAMI ON THIS TELE TYPE CIRCUIT NUMBER IS 7000 X MIAMI SAYS IT IS URGENT K
	(WE DID NOT HEAR THIS ACK)
2057	TRAINING 60 and 3C FROM COMM 7th NAVAL DISTRICT K V NPD — AIR SEA RESCUE IS CONTROLLING ALL PLANES ENGAGED IN HUNT OF 5 TBF'S K
	V TRAINING 60 — R AR
2014	TRAINING 3C K SARASOTA — DLING YOUR LIGHTS AGAIN FOR OUR BOATS K
	V B V NPD
	(DIDN'T HEAR 3C ACK)
2032	TRAINING 3C KN SARASOTA — BELIEVE EXPLOSION HEARD 23-50-00-00- IS THIS FROM NPD K
	V TRAINING 3C — R AR
2039	TRAINING 60 V NPD1 — CAN YOU GIVE US YOUR APPROX. POSITION
	(NO ACK)
6 DECEMBER 1945	
0005	TRAINING 60 V NPD1 — HAVE YOU BEEN DROPPING A NUMBER OF FLARES ?
000	UNABLE TO READ TRAINING 60 [illegible]
0009	TRAINING 60 V NPD — IS THIS CORRECT YOUR 2400 POSITION 29-30 NORTH 79-55 WEST ALT. BETWEEN 1500 and 1600 FTK
	NO ACK
0010	NAV V NAM — POSITION OF SEARCH IS 100 MI RADIUS 79 W 30-15 MIN N K
	V NAM — R AR
0031	VERO DUMBO — NOT QUITE SURE OF OUR POSITION HOWEVER WE ARE APPROACHING THE COAST LINE IN THE VICINITY OF DAYTONA BEACH K
	V NPD — IF YOU MAY RETURN TO BASE K YOU WILL RECEIV YOUR SEARCH PLANS IN THE MORNING FROM VERO
	V VERO DUMBO — R AR
0100	TRAINING 60 V VPB — IS THIS CORRECT YOUR POSITION IS 29-29 N 79-30 W K
	DIDN'T HEAR 60 ACK
0102	DIMMER KEY V NPD — AFFIRMATIVE VERO DUMBO IS RETURNING TO BAS DUE TO LACK OF FUEL K VERO DUMBO LANDED AT 0105 K
	DIDN'T HEAR ACK
0130	TRAINING 60 V VPB — REQUEST YOU TAKE A WEATHER REPORT EVERY HOUR ON THE HOUR AND A RADIO CHECK EVERY HOUR ON THE HALF HOUR K

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RADIO STATION LOG

U. S. NAVAL AIR STATION, FT. LAUDERDALE, FLORIDA
NOBALAY
OTC MINNOLD Frequency 3009 Position R Date 6/10/45

GCT	TRANSMISSION
0139	T. O L. S.
	UNABLE TO READ TR. 60
0141	TRAINING 60 V NPB — IS THIS CORRECT X SAW A FLASHING LIGHT ON THIS WATER INVESTIGATION PROVED NEGATIVE K
0142	TRAINING 60 V NPB — REQUEST YOU REPORT TIME AND POSITION YOU SIGHTED LIGHT K
	V NPB — IS THAT 0114 INSTEAD OF 0814 K
	STILL CAN'T READ TRAINING 60
0149	NPB V COAST GUARD MIAMI WHAT IS THEN CALL SIGN OF SHIP 3000 K
	C. G. MIAMI V NPB — CALL SIGNS FOR PBM'S ARE TRAINING 32 and 60 K
	V C. G. MIAMI — R AR
0206	TRAINING 60 V NPB — WILL YOU TURN ON YOUR IFF K
	(I STILL DON'T READ 60)
0225	TRAINING32 V NPB — ARE YOU IN CONTACT WITH TRAINING 60
	NO ACK RECEIVED
0231	TRAINING 32 V NPB — CONTACT TRAINING 60 BY CW ON 4385
	V TRAINING — R AR
0234	NPB IS CALLING TRAINING 60 (NO ACK)
0251	TRAINING 32 V NPB — COULD YOU GIVE ME YOUR PRESENT POSITION K
	V NPB — IS THIS CORRECT 28-30N 79-55W K
	I DID NOT RECEIVE ACK
0255	TRAINING 60 V NPB — HOW DO YOU READ (NO ACK)
0258	TRAINING 60 V C.G. — DIMMER NPB IF YOUR TRAINING NO NPB IS CALLING
0300	TRAINING 32 V NPB — YOU ARE TO MAKE A RADICAL TURN FOR A RADAR CHECK X DO YOU HAVE YOUR RADAR GEAR ON K (NO ACK)
0302	TRAINING 60 V NPB — NPB IS CALLING YOU AR
0305	NPB V TRAINING 32 — WEATHER X VIS. 10 CEILING..... WIND.....(SOMEONE CUT)
0304	TRAINING 32 — YOU ARE TO FLY A COURSE OF 20-30 X 70-30W K
	NO ACK
0308	TRAINING 60 V NPB — IS CORRECT X YOUR 30 MI. NE OF CAPE CANAVA K
	DID NOT RECEIVE ACK
0310	TRAINING 32 V NPB — DISREGARD MY LAST INSTRUCTION AND PROCEED ON YOUR REGULAR COURSE X WE ARE NOW IN CONTACT WITH TRAINING 60 AR
0317	TRAINING 60 V NPB — UP BAT AGAIN ALL AFTER BAHAMA RIVER K
0318	COULD NOT RECTRAINING 60's MSG30.
0327	TRAINING 32 V NPB — READING YOU FIVE BY FIVE NOW DO YOU READ ME K
0328	TRAINING 32 V NPB — MAY I HAVE YOUR PRESENT POSITION K
0329	COULD NOT REC. TRAINING 32
0329	TRAINING 32 V NPB — HOW LONG WILL YOUR FUEL HOLD OUT K
0330	COULD NOT REC. TRAINING 32.
0336	MIAMI V 10 — THERE GROUP WEATHER MSG30. FOR YOU X 06130 61750 22563K
0337	10 V MIAMI — R AR
0340	TRAINING 60 V NPB — IF YOU READ GIVE ME A SHORT COUNT K
0341	COULD NOT PICK UP TRAINING 60
0352	TRAINING 60 V NPB — BE TURN ON YOU IFF FOR RADAR CHECK K
0353	NPB V TRAINING 60 — R AR
0356	TRAINING 32 V NPB — BT IS THIS CORRECT X 2904 NORTH 7935 WEST K
	NO ACK FROM TRAINING 32
0407	TRAINING 32 V NPB — BT VIS. 10 MILES CEILING 600 ft. X HAVE YOU HAD CHANGE IN LAID K

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RADIO STATION 166

U. S. NAVAL AIR STATION, FT. LAUDERDALE, FLA.

NORMALLY

AIR [redacted] Frequency 3105 Position [redacted] Date 6 Dec. 1945

GMT	TRANSMISSION
0600	NO AOK FROM TRAINING 32
0609	NPB V TRAINING 32	MY POSITION IS 4000 NORTH 8010 WEST K
0609	TRAINING V NPB	RAR
0609	NPB V COAST GUARD MIAMI BT	YOU HAVE THE PRESENT POSITION OF TRAINING 60 AND TRAINING 32 K
0617	C.G. MIAMI V NPB	MY THE 0600 REPORT OF TRAINING 32 IS 4000 NORTH 8010 WEST X 0600 REPORT OF TRAINING 60 IS 3900 NORTH 7940 EASTERN WEST K
0619	NPB V COAST GUARD MIAMI K AR	
0629	MIAMI V WINDSOR	I AM UNABLE TO....(CUT OUT) INFORM (CUT OUT AGAIN)
0629	MIAMI V WINDSOR	I AM WAITING K
0640	WINDSOR V MIAMI	KEEP WAITING
0647	NPB V	I AM RETURNING TO BASE K
0647	V NPB	RAR
0648	TRAINING 60 V NPB	ARE YOU RETURNING TO BASE K
0651	NO AOK FROM 2 60	
0652	TRAINING 60 V NPB	WHAT IS YOUR POSITION K
0652	NPB V TRAINING 60	MY 0600 REPORT 2650 NORTH 8010 WEST
0653	TRAINING 60 V NPB	K MY NOW IS THE WEATHER K
0654	NPB V TRAINING 60	MY IT IS STARTING TO RAIN X CEILING LOW BROKEN 1500 FT 8000 UNLIMITED WIND 25 KNOTS NW VIS 5 MILES K
0656	TRAINING 60 V NPB	R AR
0658	NRAS V LAUDERDALE READY PLANE	HOW DO YOU READ ME UHF LOW AND K STANDBY VHF K
0659	LAUDERDALE READY PLANE V NRAS	READING YOU LOUD AND CLEAR K
0710	NRAS V LAUDERDALE READY PLANE	RAR
0711	NPB V COAST GUARD MIAMI BT	ARE TRAINING 32 AND 60 ASSIGNED AND WHAT IS NPA OF 32 AT BASE K
0711	COAST GUARD MIAMI V NPB	BT TRAINING 32 and 60 ARE ASSIGNED TO BANANA RIVER X NPA OF 32 0660 K
0712	NPB V COAST GUARD MIAMI R AR	
0712	NRAS V LAUDERDALE READY PLANE	HOW DO YOU READ ME VHF CHAN 4 K (140.04)
0713	LAUDERDALE READY PLANE V NRAS	LOUD AND CLEAR OUT
0714	COAST GUARD MIAMI V NPB BT	(CUT OUT) WISHES TO KNOW IF YOU HAVE ANY OTHER INFORMATION ON THE MISSING PLANES K
0715	NPB V COAST GUARD MIAMI	STANDBY
0718	NPB V COAST GUARD MIAMI	BT WILL YOU CHECK APPROX. POSITION
0720	COAST GUARD MIAMI V NPB	WILCO OUT.
0726	NRAS V NPB BT	RETAIN AT PRESENT POSITION UNTIL FURTHER NOTICE K
0726	NPB V NRAS	RAR
0727	NPB V COAST GUARD MIAMI BT	IS NRAS AT SCENE OF CRASH K AND WHAT IS ITS HOME BASE K
0728	COAST GUARD MIAMI V NRAS	INTERROGATED YOUR MESSAGE X NO WE ARE AT FORT LAUDERDALE K
0729	NRAS C.G.N.	AFFIRM X WE ARE DISPATCHING A BOAT AS SOON AS POSSIBLE X IT IS STANDING BY TO PICK UP SURVIVORS K
0741	NRAS V.C.G.N.	R AR
0742	NRAS V COAST GUARD MIAMI	BT WE S WISHES TO KNOW IF YOU ARE GOING TO WORK ON THE FIVE (5) PLANES THAT ARE MISSING OR WILL YOU B WORKING ON A SEPARATE CRASH K

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RADIO STATION LOG

U. S. NAVAL AIR STATION, FT. LAUDERDALE, FLORIDA

MCNALLY
OFF MCNICHOLS Frequency 8000 Position TWO Date 6 Dec. 1945

R TIME	TRANSMISSION	
0650	C. O. M. V NHAS	BT WE WILL BE WORKING ON 5 MISSING PLANES X WE WILL PARTLY WORK WITH FT LAUDERDALE PLANES X WE ALSO DISPATCHING A BOAT OUT K
0652	NHAS V COAST GUARD MIAMI	R AR
0714	T34	aS MAGNALLY TO BRUCHERT
0732	T8	aS
0745	NFB V DE DUMBO	WE AIRBORN AT 0750R PROCEEDING TO ASSIGNED SEARCH
	NOGY V NFB	SHORT COUNT 28A
	NHA 3 V NHASB	WE ARE TAKING DEPARTURE TO RELEAVE BOUY AS OF NOW
	NHASB V NHAS	R OUT
0804	T74 V T8	DID U FIND SOMETHING OR ARE U IN TROUBLE
	T8 V T74	NEG. EVERYTHING OKAY
0807	ALL PLANES V T8	MOVE ON OUT OF THE SQUALL THEN WE WILL GO BACK UP OUT
0820	NSL V NQGK	INT QSA K
0825	NHAK V NQGK	INT QSA K
	NQGK V NHAJ	QSA 5
	NHAK V NQGK	SAY UR CALL AGAIN QSA 4
	NHAJ V NQGK PT621)	QSA 5 R AR
0827	NQSO V NFB	ARE U AIDING IN SEARCH IF SO WHAT IS UR PRESENT POSITION
0828	V NFB	IF UR IN CONTACT WITH NQSO FIND OUT WHAT WHAT HIS PRESENT POSITION IS
0833	NHAS V NHAJ	INT QSA YELLOW K
	NHAJ V NHAS	aS INT QSA K
	NHAS V NHAJ	aS OUT
1456	CHANGED BACK TO GOT TIME FR COMM. OFFICER	
1600	BRUCHERT TO MOSKOWITZ	
1614	T21	SS
1636	NFB V NHAS	OVER
	NHASB NHAS	IF U HEAR ME GIVE ME A SHORT COUNT
1640	MOSKOWITZ TO BRUCHERT	
1648	NHASB V NHAS	IF U HEAR TELL NFB TO GIVE US A CALL OR ELSE GIVE US A CALL BY CW K
1753	NHASB V NHAS	IF U HEAR ME GIVE ME A LONG COUNT
1754	STATION CALLING NHAS	SAY AGAIN
1742	NHASB V NHAS	IF YOU HAVE A MESSAGE FOR ME SEND IT BY 1600R ACTION QUAY OR 26 POS 79 DEGREES 45 MIN. W RENDEZVOU 21 DEGREES 30 MIN. S. X WEATHER GOOD X 2 e X SWELLS 206215 K
	V NOK	R AR
2158	BRUCHERT TO MOSKOWITZ	
2200	NFB V NHAS	INFORM NHV THAT NLPZ IS CALLING HIM WITH A P MESSAGE
2207	BARAGOUDER V PONTAN	NOTIFY PONTAN WHEN ALL PLANES (REST OF MESSAGE INDISTINCT)
2310	DAY FLYING SECURED	

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RADIO STATION LOG

U. S. NAVAL AIR STATION, FT. LAUDERDALE, FLORIDA

OPR KYNVOLD FREQUENCY _____ Position THREE Date 7 Dec. 1945

GCT	TRANSMISSION
1100	SET WATCH
1123	NHA3 — 85
1144	NHA3 V NWSB — NR233. FOR YOU K
1145	NHA3 V NWSB — -T-A- NWSB 071145-QUAV GR 22 ET 0645 ESTIMATED POSITION 26 DEG. 24 MINUTES NORTH 78 DEG. 16 MINUTES WEST X WEATHER 65711364 ET 071145 K
1146	NWSB V NHA3 — R WILCO OUT.
1209	COAST GUARD DIRECTOR KEY V NOK DO WERE YOU CALLING NR THIS FREQ. K
1209	NOK V C.G.D.K. — AFFIRM A NHA3 IS CALLING YOU A MESSG. FOR YOU K
1210	C.G.D.K. V NOK — T U OUT
1211	C.G.D.K. V NDHQ — ET WILL YOU TRANSMIT A MESSG. TO NOK K
1212	NDHQ V C.G.D.K. — R SEND YOUR MESSG, K.
1213	COULD NOT REC NDHQ MESSG.
1214	C.G.D.K. V NOK — ET I INTERCEPTED NDHQ MESSG. K
1215	NOK C.G.D.K. — R AR
1221	NWSB V NHA 3 — MESSG. FOR YOU K
1222	NWSB V NHA3 — -A-QUAV 071209 NWSB GR 20 ET PROCEED TO 26 DEG. 00 MINUTES NORTH 78 DEG. 30 MINUTES WEST AND MAKE SQUARE SEARCH ET 071200 K
1223	COULD NOT REC. ACK FROM NWSB
1224	NWSB V NHA3 — ET CORRECTION X WAIT AFTER 30 IS MINUTES K
1224	COULD NOT REC. ACK FROM NWSB
1240	NHA3 NWSB — ONE MESSG. FOR U K
1240	NHA3 V NWSB — NOAA GRS SAYING TX. A-NWSB 071240 QUAV GR 22 ET 0740 R ESTIMATED POSITION 26 DEG 12 MINUTES NORTH 78 DEG 18 MINUTES WEST X WEATHER 65711464 ET 071240 NHA3 V NWSB K
1242	NHA3 V NDHQ — R WILCO OUT.
1240	KYNVOLD TO CALDWELL
1302	CALDWELL TO MCNALLY
1321	NOIX V NOK — K (NO ACK.)
	NOIX NRCL NTMN QA4 — RR OR LOGOUT FOR 20 FT LAUNCH BOAT DUNA-2-2 OVER SUB KEY WASTA WAITS WITH X 4 MEN ABOARD APROX POSITION 30 MI W KEY WEST
1325	NHA3 A NDHQ — 1ST QUAKE
1329	NTMN V NOK — AFFIRM. AR
1335	NHA3 V NDHQ — CRIQ. NDHQ-071315-GREK CHICA BASA RADIO -R-QUAV GR. 22 ET-0800 R POSIT. 24 DEG. 23'N. 79 DEG. .'W. X WEATHER CLOUDY WIND 16 KNOTS WSW. BBA -3 ET 071315
	V NHA3 — R AR
1405	NOK V NHA3 — (NEA TO NHA3 RELAY HAVE NDQ. TO NOK)
1415	NTMN V NOK — KXX ANS? 2670 FOR ONE MSG.

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RADIO STATION LOG

U.S. NAVAL AIR STATION, FORT LAUDERDALE, FLORIDA

OPR CALDWELL Frequency 3000 Position #3 Date 7 Dec. 1945

GCT		TRANSMISSION
1415	TOLR	
1417	NHA3 V NDNQ	WILL YOU RELAY MSG TO NOK FOR NHZ
	NDNQ V NHA3	R SEND YOU MSG
1418	NHA3 V NDNQ	UNABLE TO HEAR MSG. BUT HEARD NHA3 FOR IT AND THEN CALL NOK BUT WAS UNABLE TO RAISE NOK.
1441	NDNQ V NHA3	MSG FOR YOU K.
	NDNQ V NHA3	MSG FOR U K (NDNQ NO ANS.)
1446	NDNQ V NHA3	MSG FOR U K (NDNQ NO ANS.)
1447	NOK V NHA3	A NDNQ 071400 W-NRRK NAN QUAY AND OMICA BASE RADIO ON 21 MC. 0900 POSITION 24 DEG. 23 MINUTES NORTH 79 DEG. 36 MINUTES WEST X WEATHER OVER CAST WIND 18 KNOTS NORTH WEST X BRA S MC 071400 K
1448	DID NOT REC. ACK FROM NOK	
1452	NDNQ V NHA3	MESSG FOR YOU K BT NOK V NHA3 IT SHOULD READ THRK R
1453	NO ACK FROM NOK.	
1504	NHA3 V NHA 3	SEND YOUR MSG. K (DID NOT HEAR ANY OF MSG.)
1506	NHA3 V NHA3	R WILL RELAY AR
1514	CALDWELL TO BRUCHART	
1543	BRUCHART TO CALDWELL	
1613	AA V NHA3	PLEASE INSCRUTINGS SKIPPED WEATHER OR POSITION MESSAGES ON THIS FREQ. UNLESS ABSOLUTELY NECESSARY K AR(NO ANS. V.AA)
1618	T 23-118-28-28- T 28-4- V NHA3	MESSAGE FOR YOU, ANY PLANE IN THIS FLT. COME IN PLEASE K (NO ANSWER)
1618	T 23-118-28-28 T4 V NHA3	ANY PLANE IN THIS FLT IF YOU CAN HEAR ME PLEASE ANSWER K (NO ANSWER)
1619	T23-119-28-28- T4-V NHA3	ANY PLANE IN THIS FLT IF YOU CAN HEAR ME PLEASE ANSWER UP K (NO ANSWER)
1620	T23-119-28-28 T4 V NHA3	ANY PLANE IN THIS FLT. IF YOU CAN HEAR ME PLEASE ANSWER UP K (NO ANSWER)
1622	TO 1625	NHA3 REPEATED THE A BOVE MESSAGE AR
1627	T45 V NHA1	DO YOU HEAR K (NO ANSWER)
1635	FLT 3 V NHA3	ANY PLANE IN FLT 3 IF YOU HEAR ME COME IN PLEASE K (NO ANSWER)
1637	NOK V NHA3	MESSAGE FOR YOU (NO ANSWER)
1638	FLT 3 V NHA3	T23-20-45 ANY PLANE IN FLT 3 IF YOU HEAR ME COME IN PLEASE, ONE MESSAGE FOR YOU K (NO ANSWER)
1645	FLT3 V NHA3	ANY FLT PLANE IN FLT 3 IF YOU HEAR ME PLEASE COME IN K (NO ANSWER)
1646	NHA3 V NHA1	TOWER INFORMED US THAT T45 IS ON THE DECK AR (TRANSMITTED ON BLUE BAND)
1648	FLT3 V NHA3	ANY PLANE IN FLT 3 PLEASE ANSWER IF YOU READ K (NO ANS)
1657	NHA3 V NHA3	SEND YOUR MESSAGE (COULD NOT INTERCEPT MESSAGE)
1658	NHA3 V NHA3	WHO GAVE YOU IENT TO REPORT YOUR POSITION EVERY HOUR ON THIS FREQ. K
1659	V NHA3	R AR
1708	NDNQ V NHA3	SAY AGAIN THE WIND VELOCITY K
1711	NDNQ V NHA3	SAY ENTIRE MESSAGE AGAIN K
1713	NDNQ V NHA3	SAY AGAIN YOUR ENTIRE LAST TRANSMISSION K R WILCO

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RADIO STATION LOG

U.S. NAVAL AIR STATION, FORT LAUDERDALE, FLA.

OPR CARROZZA Frequency 5100 Position Three Date 7 Dec. 1945

GCT		TRANSMISSION
1713	T.O.L.R	C-FILES
1716	NOK V NHA3	XX QTC 1 X
1720	NHA3 V LAUDERDALE READY PLANE INT QSA K	
	L R F V NHA3	QSA 5 INT QSA
	NHA3 V L R F	QSA 5 R AR
1730	CORROZZA TO BE CORRT	
1810	NOK V NHA3	WEBS. FOR U K (NO ANS.)
1811	NOK V NHA3	WEBS. FOR U K (NOANSR.)
1812	NOK V NHA3	SHORT COUNT WEBS. FOR U K
1815	PROCEEDS TO CARROZZA	
1909	NIEG V NHA 3	SEND YOUR WEBS. K
1910	NIEG V NHA3	R YOUR WEBS. AR
1933	NHA3B V NHA3	REQUEST YOUR PRESENT POSITION K (NO ANS.)
1938	NHA3B V NHA3	WHAT IS YOUR PRESENT POS. WHERE ARE YOU K
1940	NHA3B V NHA3	R AR
1947	NB42 V NHA3	OVER TO YOU
1948	NB42 V NHA3	NO. 4 DO YOU HAVE ANYTHING FOR US K AIR SEA RESCUE NO. 4 HAVE YOU ANYTHING FOR US K (NO ANS.)
1952	NB42 V NHA3	FOLLOWED BY COURT IF YOU READ ME COME IN AIR SEA RESCUE K HAVE YOU A MESSAGE FOR ME K
1954	NB42 V NHA3	SAY AGAIN YOUR MESSAGE K
1957	NB42 V NHA3	WILL YOU REPEAT THE ENTIRE MESSAGE AIR SEA RESCUE K
1958	NB42 V NHA3	SAY YOUR WORDS TWICE YOU ARE BEING BLOCKED OUT BY A STRONG "CW" NOTE K
1959	NHA3B V NHA3	YES NHA3B STAY OFF THE AIR WE ARE GETTING YOUR MESSAGE K
2000	NHA3B V NHA3	NEGATIVE REFUSE TO PASS AR
2001	NB42 V NHA3	WILL YOU SEND YOUR MESSAGE OVER AGAIN K
2013	NHA3 V NB72	K
	V NHA3	COME IN K
	NHA3 V NB 72	GAVE POS. TO NHA3 --- UNABLE TO INTERCEPT BECAUSE OF FADING
	V NHA3	R AR
2016	NB72 V NHA3	MESSAGE FOR YOU K
2021	NHA3 V NB 72	K
	V NHA3	COME IN PLEASE K
	V NB72	SEND YOUR MESSAGE K
	V NHA3	DO YOU WISH US TO RELAY YOUR 1815 POS. TO ANYONE K
	V NB72	NEGATIVE WE WERE INFORMED FROM NIG TO G[redacted] OUR POS. TO AIR SEA RESCUE K
	V NHA3	R AR
2032	NHA3B V NHA3	PROCEED TO 7215 POS. 26 DEGREES 29 MIN. N. 79 DEGREES 46 MIN. W.K
	V NHA3	AFFIRMATIVE A PORTUGUESE SHIP HAS SIGHTED A LIFE JACKET AT THAT POS. K
2047	NOK V NHA3	-A-NOKO 072015 QRNK CORRECT DATE MAR -N-QUAV ON 18 1500 REPORTS 79 DEGREES 57 MIN W 24 DEGREES 56 N WEATHER CLOUDY WIND N W SEA2 DT 072015
	V NOK	R AR
2054	NHA 3B V NHA3	LAUDERDALE READY PLANE IS BEING DISPATCHED TO ASSIST YOU K
	V NHA3	IT HAS A LIFE JACKET BUT A LIFE RAFT FLOATING ABOUT 2 KNOTS. K
	V NHA3B	R AR
2056	NHA3 V 776	YOU DO YOU READ K
	V NHA3	55
	V 776	3434 AR

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2058	CARRO A TO MONROVIA	
2102	NHA38 V NHA3	THE CALL SIGN OF THE NORWEGIAN FREIGHTER IS LORN 26 DEGREES 37 MIN. N. 79 DEG. 44 MIN. W. AWAITING YOUR ARRIVAL X CONTACT ON 425 KCS.
2112	NHA3 V NOR	T-A-QTAV 071617 NOR OR 20 MT REQUEST YOU SEND ONLY DISTRESS TRAFFIC OVER 500 KC. DO NOT SEND POSIT. AND WATCH REPORTS THIS FREQUENCY QTO71617K
	V NHA3	R AR (MESSAGE DELAYED)
2115	NHA38 T76	INT. MESSAGE
	V NHA38	NHOAT OUT
2116	NHA3 V NHA38	ETA 1635
	V NHA3	R AR
2120	T76 V NHA3	NOR. FR. IS STANDING BY AT POSIT. 26 DEG 37' N. 79 DEG 44" W. AWAITING CRASH BOAT
	V T76	R AR
2125	T 76 V NHA3	MAKE A SQUARE SEARCH IN AREA GIVEN IN MY LAST MASSAGE FOR HALF HOUR, FOR MORE WRECKAGE.
2128	NHA38 V T76	AM CIRCLING WRECKAGE
	V NHA38	R WILL BE THERE SHORTLY
2135	T 76 V NHA 38	HAVE WRECKAGE IN SIGHT A IT IS A PAPER BASKET
	V T76	R AR
2140	NHA3 V NHA38	DO YOU HAVE ANY FURTHER INST. FOR US
	V NHA38	CONTINUE CIRCLING AREA FOR LIFE JACKET
	V NHA38	R AR
2143	MONROVIA TO CARRORA	
2147	NHA38 V NHA3	WILL TWO MORE PLANES BE OF ANY MORE ASSISTANCE IN SEARCH
	V NHA38	ASK T76
	T76 V NHA3	(AS ABOVE)
	V T76	NEGAT. I HAVE MADE A THOROUGH SEARCH OF FIVE MILES IN DIAMETER FOUR TIMES AND CANNOT LOCATE A THING K
	V NHA3	R AR
2148	T76 V NHA3	YOU MAY RETURN TO BASE AND SECURE K
	V T76	TO ANS.
2152	NHA3 V NHA38	MY ETA WILL BE AT THE PORT 1815 K
	V NHA3	R A R
2156	K113 V NFK	SEND YOUR MESSAGE K
	V NFK	YOU MAY SECURE AND IF YOU ARE NEEDED YOU WILL BE CONTACTED IN THE MORNING K
2201	K 113 V NFK	YOU MAY RETURN TO BASE K WHAT IS THE RESULTS OF YOUR SEARCH K
2214	NHA38 V NHA3	WHAT IS YOUR PRESENT POS. K STAND BY AT PRESENT POS. FOR FURTHER INST.
	V NHA38	R WILL GIVE YOU PRES. POS. SHORTLY K
	V NHA3	R AR
2216	NHA3 V NHA38	PRES. POS 10 DEGREES 80 MIN OF MILSBORO LIGHT K
	V NHA 38	R AR
2221	NFK4 V NHA3	IS IT A WEATHER OR POSITION YOU HAVE FOR ME. K
	V NHA3	R AR
2228	NHA 38 V NHA	PROCEED IMMEDIATELY AT LAST ATTEMPT TO 26 DEG. 37 MIN. N. 79 DEG. 44 MIN. W TANKER LORN STANDING BY LIFE JACKET X CAN YOU SIGHT HIM FROM THERE K
	V NHA38	S WAIT

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RADIO STATION LOG

U. S. NAVAL AIR STATION, FT. LAUDERDALE, FLORIDA

OPR CARBORTA FREQUENCY 3000 Position T.R88 DATE Dec., 7, 1945

GCT	TRANSMISSION
2228	
	T/O/L/I/ C-Files
2229	NHA3 V NHA38 ANY CHARACTERISTICS TO IDENTIFY THE SHIP K
	V NHA3 ALL WE KNOW THAT SHE IS A SOVIEGAN TANKER K IS SHE AT THE POS. GIVEN K
	V NHA3 NEGATIVE X IS IT AT THE POS WE FIRST GAVE YOU K
	V NHA3 IS THE SHIP IN THE DIRECTION WE GAVE YOU K
	V NHA3 NOT. TOO FAR EAST X SIGHTED TANKER NEAR LAND. READY PLANE WHEN IT HAS SEARCHING K
	V NHA3 YOU ARE TO GO ALONG SIDE AND INVESTIGATE K
	V NHA38 R AR
2245	NHA38 V NHA3 WILL YOU VARIFY YOUR LAST STA K
2249	NHA38 V NHA3 DO YOU HAVE THE TANKER IN SIGHT K
	V T 38 NEGAT.
	V NHA3 USE BLINKER LIGHT TO ATTRACT HIS ATTENTION IF NECESSARY K
	V NHA38 R X MY ETA 1840 ALONG SIDE NOW. TANKER K
	V NHA3 R AR
2320	NHA38 V NHA3 YOU ARE BEING CALLED BY "GW" BY AN UNKNOWN STAI - IC K
	V NHA38 THAT IS ALL VERY GOOD BUT THERE IS NO ONE ABOARD WHO CAN READ "GW" K
	V NHA3 WE WILL ACT AS A RELAYING STATION AND RELAY MESSAGE TO YOU K
	V NHA38 R AR
2225	CARRO A TO NORFOLK VA
2335	NHA3 V NHA38 AM NOW IN APPROX. POSITION GIVEN X SEE NO SHIP HAVE YOU TRIED VISCOMM.
	V NHA3 AFFIRM.
	V NHA38
2340	NHA3 V NHA38 IF TANKER IS WHERE WE SHOULD SEE HIM NOW UNLESS HAS ALL BLACKED OUT
	V NHA3 R AR
2345	CHICA BASE RADIO V NOE -A-NOJT 072215 MSGL CHICA BASE OR 4 DE REPORTING OF STATION 2 MSGS. (REMAINDER BLOCKED)
	V CHICA BASE R AR
2348	NHA38 V NHA3 AS-WILL HAVE A MESSAGE FOR YOU SHORTLEY
2400	SECURED

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ROUGH CRASH LOG

TIME	REPORT FROM	5 DECEMBER
1605	T-74	A ship or plane is calling - Seems to be lost
1610	---	NHA-3 is in contact with T-28 (the leader of the fleet of 5) - He believes he is south of Florida and west of Keys
1645	---	T-28 - Advises he is going to fly 030° for 30 minutes - then 270° until he hits land or runs out of gas -
1700	---	During the last 30 minutes following action was taken - Boat Facility alerted all crash boats - They are standing by until further advised - Ready plane alerted but held on ground by orders and flight officer - Air Sea Rescue Miami alerted - They are holding all search planes until further notice - Comdr. Randall, Operations, at NAS Miami notified - He will keep lights on UPN - Boca Ratân asked to try to get fix - Miami has gotten one fix
1715	---	T-28 and flight now flying 270°
1720	---	Morrison Army ACS asked to try to get DF fix
1720	---	Communications with T-28 - come in strong and fade - NHA-3 unable to get any messages through to T-28 - NHA-1 can hear planes talking to each other - apparently still flying 270°
1751		ASR Controller Miami requested to alert all fields from Miami to Banana River and have them turn on all lights
1800		Dinner Key and Bannana River Dumbo's out - radar equipped
1815		Dinner Key reports fix at 79W 29N
1845		T-3 and T-28 still talking
1904		Last transmissions from the flight (T-3 calling T-28) no answer
2005		Comdr. Baxter - operation officer ASR Miami - advised that we can have 36 planes ready for dawn take-off - Lauderdale is standing by for further instructions from Banana River - Banana River will direct the search from now on - Mayport dumbo out searching also
2030		Comdr. Newman advised he has talked with Banana River and all Dimbo's will stay out all night - 1 CVE and 2 DD's out all night - Comdr. Baxter in Miami will assign areas for tomorrows search
2210	B/F	Tanker saw 100 ft. burst of flame that laster for several minutes at 1950 - found oil slick - no survivors - no wreckage - 28° 58'N 80° 25W
2305	---	J.O.C. advises NHA search 25N to 27N between 78W and the beach - advise number of planes and time of
		6 DECEMBER
0659		First search plane off
0732		30th search plane off

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TIME	REPORT FROM	
0734		Comdr. Baxter advised of search planes department - also given design for search
0940		Major Wilkinson of Boca Raton offers 5 B-24 5 B-17 - 3 crash boats to aid in search - B/P is passing this information to J.O.C.
1017		30 planes returned - Results negative
1128		29 planes inborne - continuing search
1351		Miami controller advised that search had returned - negative results - Requested NHA to search 2400'N - 25°00'N between 80°30'W and 73°00'
1500		First search plane off the ground
1600		NHA-3 advises Miami desires same number of planes on 12/7 as on 12/6
1603		ATD (Comdr. Jenkins) advised - will have muster at 1270000
1605		Contacted J.O.C. They will advise at approximately 1623 areas to be assigned
1750	B.P.	Miami 7th Naval District Operations officer reports that No search is being contimplated to night (Comdr. Jenkins notified)
1802		ALL search planes on the deck - results negative
1900		Received phone call from Flight Officer Ferguson at ext. 302 Boca Ration stating they had picked up an SOS at 1113 this morning on about 3870 K.C. They asked for a steady signal to take fix and heard Following message, "Unknown station from (757 to 756)K This was repeated several times - Shortly after this they picked up a steady signal on about 3080 K.C. The preceding message was relayed to Comdr. Jenkins was also notified.
2000		Search area 28°N 26°30' between 77°30' and beach
		FRIDAY 7 DECEMBER 1945
0600		0645 Operations and tower manned Heavy ground fog prevents early search takeoff.
0751		1st plane off deck to search
0815		Last of 30 search planes off
1216		First of 15 search planes
1230		Last search plane landed - Negative results
1256		Last search plane off
1550		Reported by a Tanker that allife jacket and cylindrical object sighted 26294 7946W - approximately 16 miles off Delway Beach - 2 KT Northerly set. Tanker requested to stand by and investigate- Reported that they were 5 miles beyond that point

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TIME	REPORT FROM	
1559		Ready plane off deck to search above point - WHA 38 Also on way
1559		Comdr. Baxter (J.O.C.) advises that Captain Burch's plan for 12 WHA TBM's to use Solomons approved by Jax. by phone. WHA to contact Solomons through Jax. by teletype contemplated plan for Solomons on 12/8 is 7500 - 7600W and 30-3130W. We may change at our discretion
1635		Ready plane advised cylindrical object is a lard tub Area to be searched 12/8 as follows;
	NPB	8 PBM 28°30'N to 304H between 73°00 W and 74°00'W
	Jax.	6 or more PBY 2830 - 3000 between 75 and 76
	Army	B17's - 2830 - 29 between 74 and 74°30'
	Air Trans Co rescue	28°30' - 2900 between 7430 and 75
	Army	B17 and B24 - 27°00' - 28°30' between 74 and 75°W
	PB4Y	Also area not advised
1712		Ready plane returned
		Operations manned all night
		SATURDAY 8 DECEMBER 1945
0600		Weather up to north closed in with ground fog
0730		Contacted Comdr. Baxter on phone He has received report from Eastern airlines that one of their planes last night, observed a red flare, investigated and saw bobbing lights on the ground and saw a man on the ground. He radioed the position to Melborne as 240°-12 miles from Melborne Air Station, which immediately sent planes to investigate. Planes have been ordered to search ; Blimp is being arranged and also ground crews
0806		One T-35 plane took off to go work with NHA-35 on search Comdr. Neuman called and requests 2 planes to search area 26°38W to 27°10'N 79 30W to 7958W Also reports ready plane is returning to bar for unknown reason
0926		12 TBF took off to proceed to carrier for search
0928		T-35 landed with throttle trouble
0939		T-13 took off to work with NHA-35
0944		T-1 took off for search with T-13
Names of pilots lost on		flight with T-28 Lt. Charles Taylor Captain E.J. Powers Captain G.W. Stivers 2nd Lt. F.C. Gerber Ensign J.T. Bossi
1039	B/F	T-21 took off to join T-13 and T-1
1055	B/F	Reports Training Phone 21 (Mayport B/F) unwrapped life raft 30°58'N - 79°10' west. In axis of Gulf Stream East N.E. of Jax. Not yet picked up

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TIME	REPORT FROM
1200	Lieut. Comdr. Box of Miami operations relays a message from Comdr. Baxter, that Commodore Benson urgently desires Lauderdale to furnish as many planes possible to search area 28°15'N-27°30'N 80°40W -81°15'N Comdr. Jenkins has been notified
1240	Message was sent to Solomans requesting report on planes sent to them this morning
1245	Ft. Pierce B/F assumes control of three search planes
1330	FT-13 returned from search
1332	T-1 returned from search
1336	12 TBF took off for search of area below Melborne
1430	T-71 returned from search
1635	Airsearch for NHA on Sunday as forwarded from Miami B/F 26°00'N - 27°00' 77°30W - Coast
1733	All search planes from Melborne search on the Deck
	Report of Flight Leade 5 of Search (Lt. Comdr. Buchanan)
	Searched in scanting line on lower region of search area inland for 50 miles then East to within 10 miles of coast. Flew north about 6 miles and took up scanting line heading west. Located from parachute flares at 27° 48'N - 80'40'W. Informed NPB at 1515. They sent a coast Guard Antozino which land and investigated and reported information from native in area, that flares had been dropped night of crash by single engine aircraft after a twin engine aircraft had circled area-Search was discontinued at 1640
1915	The following messages were received by telephone to NHA From Solomons
	11 TBM on board Area from 28°07'N 31°12'N and 70 79°14'W T. 79°40'W Searched by plane at 1000' intervals 1 mile proceeding to 30°00'N 75°00'W to search area East of 75°00'W between 88°55'N-31°05'N starting 0700 tomarrow
This message concerning this sloop was cancelled by Boat Facility Time-121212 C. Mate	To NHA, From Miami 082301 Include in search Notify planes and vessels your command.Missing 35ft. sloop no. 4-C 484 ensonte Boston to Florida x Last heard from 29 Nov. in Delaware river x Forward cabin white, hull green, deck outboard rigged sudden x Travels from four to six knots x Advise if any information T. Solomons From Com Gulf InfoNHA
	Main search other units Sunday from 27°00'N to 30°00'N and 73°30'W 77°00'W Request your plans Comdr. Jenkins notified and received copies
1945	Informed Comdr. Baxter of Solomons intended search area. Baxters office had a dispatch of a plane from Morrison Field which observed a stationary light seemingly blinking an SOS (Position 26°20'N - 77°35'W)

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TIME	REPORT FROM	
		Plane kept on course and position of light did not change so continued on way Comdr. Baxter will notify us of action being taken tonight
		9 DECEMBER 1945
0345		Received messages from J.O.C. giving Eastern pilots report in further detail - 090902 Following reported by Capt. Morrison, Eastern pilot Reported sighted red flame at 0158R 08 December approximately 0200 R when plane 10-15 miles S to SW of Meloborne flying 3000' when sighted red rocket Rocket rose to about 300' and burst with streamers descending X Rocket was definitely shot from the ground and was definitely not anything dropped from the air X Next saw a light which appeared to be flashlight X Plane circled losing altitude and light followed the plane X Plane reached 300' and light was waved frantically while the person holding light moved around to better vantage point X Man was on small island of which there was hundreds and landing lights of the plane showed this island to be about 1acre in area X This location approximately bears 210° from Melbourne range station and almost due west 10-15 from the first beacon south of Melbourne X Lots of water on area Melbourne pass to Lauderdale to 0310 091126 In reference to our earlier messages regarding Capt. Morrison's report X I have just talked with and he is certain definitely of a few points which may have bearing X There definitely was no fire in the area that he circles after seeing the red flare X It was a marshy area X He did observe a large fire 30 miles or so further on while at 1000' X He made 3 circles counter-clockwise over the individual waving the flashlight and the person was endeavoring to pass a message of some kind as to a possible landing on the water in that area Please ask Lauderdale if they intend to use Capt. Morrison's services this morning
	La	Lauderdale replies - affirmative will pick up Capt. Morrison at any place he designates in Miami and fl him to spot where he saw flares Morrison and co-pilot motoring to Opa Locka We will pick them up there B/F has message asking if we wish Capt. Morrisons services this morning - NHA replies affirmative - we will pick him up at Opa Locka
0736	B/F	Suggest you search area carefully in Eastern Section of todays run X Check 26°20' and 77°35' to 40' where light was seen last night - there is a buoy in this area - Check to see if it is a lighted buoy
0758		24 TBM and 2 SNB off on search
0831		Capt. Burch departed for Opa Locka to pick up Capt Morrison of Eastern Airlines
0851		Capt. Burch departed Miami for Melbourne
1045		All TBMs on the deck - Negative

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TIME	REPORT FROM	
1113		Results of search reported to Miami - Standing for instructions
1200	Miami	Boca Raton planes reported 2 life rafts 50 miles apart (apparent dye marker) Position 76°00'W 28°05'N and 75°00'W 28°10'N. Cutter proceeding to east position. PBM to West position. USS Shenandoah proceeding to another 50 miles NW. Plane 1st 2. (No occupants)
1200	NHA	To Miami - dispatch - plane available for Monday 24 TBF, 16 SNJ, 48HB, 3 N2S
1220	Miami	To NHA - No additional search contemplated for today 12/9/45
1232		Comdr. Baxter advises a ship has picked up a life raft
1253 1330	B/F	Planes have sighted 2 men in a raft at 28°05'N DE. within 37 miles of 76°00'W (Life raft picked up off Jax at 30-08 80-44)
1433	Dispatch	Comgulfseafrom requests Solomons to reinform search around 28-05 - 76-00 Planes circling survivors are low on gas
1530	B/F	Tanker close to shore 80-40 30-08 picked up 2 survivors in Life raft - PBM ditching 30-30 78-30
1538	Dispatch	Solomons ETA 2210 Searching ahead until Darkness
1605	Dispatch	To Solomons giving probable position of survivors as 28-20N 76-27W
1610	ATC	B-17 out to drop Life-Boat at 28-20 76-37
1722	B/F	B-29 B-17 B-24 circling survivors
1922	Comdr. Baxter	Report by ship picking up two men was false Other reports doubtful.

10 DECEMBER 1945

0715	J.O.C.	No search plan for Lauderdale today - They believe the close to shore search has been conducted as thoroughly as possible and are now concentrating on large range search Eastward - Lauderdale is at Liberty to search anywhere they choose
1527		Comdr. Newman reports by phone, search is being abandoned at completion of searches this PM

SEARCH SECURED 10 DECEMBER 1945 AT NIGHT

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Lt [illegible]

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AIR SEA RESCUE TASK UNIT NO. 4 COMMUNICATION LOG FOR 5 DECEMBER 1945

DETAILED ACCOUNT OF MISSING FLIGHT OF FIVE (5) NAS FT. LAUDERDALE TBFs

1620 ASRTU#4 FT-74 VIA RADIO 4805 KC
FT-28 is calling you (Roger x Go ahead FT-28)

1621 INTERCEPTED FOLLOWING TRANSMISSION FROM FT-28 (leader of flight of 5 TBFs) TO FT-74 (leader of another flight of TBFs)
Am lost x At present time I am over small islands believed to be the Florida Keys x My compass is out.

1622 INTERCEPTED MESSAGE FROM FT-74 TO FT-28
Roger x Put the sun and the strip of islands on your port hand and you will be flying north x By doing this you should be able to reach the mainland x Continue flying north after you have passed over Miami as NAS Lauderdale is about twenty (20) miles North of Miami. (Roger from FT-28)

1624 FT-74 TO FT-28
I am continuing South down the coast and should be over Miami in about 5 minutes x I will continue south and try to pick you up.

1624 ASRTU#4 TO OPERATIONS OFFICER NAS LAUDERDALE VIA LAND LINE
Relayed above information as intercepted on 4805 KC.

1625 ASRTU#4 TO FT-28 VIA RADIO
Radio check, can you read us. (Affirmative - BT - We have just passed over small island x We have no other land in sight.)

1626 ASRTU#4 FROM FT-28 VIA RADIO
Am at angles 3.5 x Have an emergency IFF x Does anyone in the area have a radar screen that could pick us up. (Roger - Standby)

1627 ASRTU#4 TO OPERATIONS NAS LAUDERDALE VIA PHONE
Relayed FT-28's Message and was advised that they would notify NAS Miami and other stations to attempt to pick up FT-28 on radar or Direction Finder.

1628 ASRTU#4 TO FT-28 VIA RADIO
Suggest you have another plane in your flight with a good compass take over the lead and guide you back over the mainland. (Roger)
We were able to pick up particles of messages between Flight Leader (FT-28) and other planes in the flight concerning their estimated position and compasses, however as best we could tell, due to poor reception, no other plane ever assumed the lead.

1631 ASRTU#4 FROM FT-28 VIA RADIO
One of the planes in the flight thinks if we went 270° we could hit land.

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A. E. Thompson
Lt. USNR

"EXHIBIT B"

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1639 ASRTU#4 OPERATIONS OFFICER TO OPERATIONS OFFICER NAS LAUDERDALE VIA PHONE. In as much as FT-74 has run out of communication with FT-28 by proceeding South I think that this flight is lost somewhere over the Bahama Bank and suggest that the Lauderdale Ready Plane be dispatched guarding 4805 Kcs on a course of about 075° and try to establish communication with FT-28. And if the Ready Plane can pick up FT-28 better as he proceeds on this course we will be sure that the flight is lost over the Bahamas. Ready Plane could also act as relay on this frequency as it is becomming very difficult to pick up FT-28. NAS Operations Officer advised us that the Ready Plane would be dispatched to attempt to intercept FT-28. Operations also at this time requested that we ask FT-28 via radio if he had a standard YG disk aboard to home in on the Towers D.F.

1642 ASRTU#4 TO FT-28
Do you have YG disk for homing D.F. (Message never regered for)

1643 ASRTU#4 TO DINNER KEY VIA COMMAND LINE
Is there any way in which you can get a bearing on FT-28 which is lost with a flight of five (5) TBFs. Dinner Key advised us they would attempt it.

1645 ASRTU#4 FROM FT-28 VIA RADIO
We are heading 030° for 45 minutes, then we will fly north to make sure we are not over the Gulf of Mexico.

1645 ASRTU#4 TO DINNER KEY VIA COMMAND LINE
Are you able to get a bearing on FT-28. (Negative - Advise him to send continuously on 4805 KC, we can not pick up his IFF).

1646 ASRTU#4 TO FT-28 VIA RADIO
DF Station advises you broadcast continuously this frequency x Can not pick your IFF.

1649 ASRTU#4 TO DINNER KEY VIA COMMAND LINE
Have you been able to get a bearing on FT-28 yet. (Negative) We request you alert the DF Net up the coast and have them attempt to pick up this lost flight. Please let us know if you have any success. (Wilco).

1650 Three (3) 63' AVR have been warmed up and now standing by at dock.

1651 ASRTU#4 FROM NAS LAUDERDALE
If possible advise FT-28 to turn on his ZBX. (Attempted to relay FT-28 at 1652 with no success)

1656 ASRTU#4 TO ANY FOX TARE PLANE IN FLIGHT WITH FT-28
Turn on your ZBX. (No reply)

1707 FT-28 TO PLANES IN FLIGHT (Intercepted)
Change course to 090° for 10 minutes.

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1708 ASRTU#4 TO BOCA CHICA VIA PHONE
Request that through means of Radar and D.F. you search area around you for flight of 5 TBFs from NAS Lauderdale which have been lost since 1621R - Flight Leader FT-28 on 4805 KC.

1709 ASRTU#4 ADVISED BY NAS OPERATIONS LAUDERDALE VIA PHONE
That the Lauderdale Ready Plane was held on the ground and would not go out.

1715 ASRTU#4 FROM FT-28 VIA RADIO
I receive you very weak x We are now flying 270°. (Roger)

1716 ASRTU#4 FROM FT-28 VIA RADIO
We will fly 270° until we hit the beach or run out of gas.

1720 ASRTU#4 TO FT-28 VIA RADIO
If you can change to Yellow Band (3000 KC) please do so and give us a call. (No reply after 3 attempts).

1724 ASRTU#4 FROM FT-28 VIA RADIO
I receive you very weak x How is the weather over Lauderdale. (Weather over Lauderdale clear x Over Key West CAVU x Over the Bahamas cloudy rather low ceiling, poor visibility) No reply.

1730 FT-28 TO PLANE IN FLIGHT (Intercept) VIA RADIO
Is that a ship on the left x (Unable to read reply).

1733 ASRTU#4 FROM FT-28 VIA RADIO
Can you hear me x (Hear you strength three, modulation good x) (No reply).

1734 ASRTU#4 TO FT-28 VIA RADIO
Can you change to 3000 Kcs. (No reply after 3 attempts).

1738 ASRTU#4 TO BANANA RIVER (052238) VIA TWPL
A flight of five TBF's led by FT-28 from NAS Lauderdale have been lost since 1621R x We are able to contact FT-28 on 4805 Kcs very faintly x NAS Lauderdale unable to determine what area planes are in x We have three AVR's standing by x Can you set up on 4805 and contact that plane x Our teletype has been out of commission and we have been unable to send x BT x (No reply, message delivered via phone to Operations Banana River)

1740 ASRTU#4 FROM FT-28 VIA RADIO
How do you read x (Very weak x Change to 3000 Kcs.) (No reply).

1750 ASRTU#4 TO FT-28 VIA RADIO
Change to channel 1 3000 Kcs x (No reply).

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1752 ASRTU#4 FROM NAS LAUDERDALE VIA PHONE
At 1751 all stations along the coast were alerted to be on lookout for FT-28 and his flight.

1752 MIAMI TO ALL ASR STATIONS VIA TWPL
Following from District Coast Guard Officer, 7th ND, Miami: All stations Banana River South light up to greatest extent possible.

1754 ASRTU#4 TO DINNER KEY VIA COMMAND LINE
Request you send out Miami Dumbo to try and intercept FT-28 on 4805 Kc. We suggest that the Dumbo come North taking a departure from Ft. Lauderdale and steer course 045° for 150 miles attempting to establish communication with FT-28.

1804 FT-28 TO PLANES IN FLIGHT (Intercept) VIA RADIO
Holding course 270° - didn't go far enough east - turn around again - we may just as well turn around and go east again x

1807 ASRTU#4 TO FT-28 VIA RADIO
Test call. (No reply).

1813 ASRTU#4 TO NHA-41 VIA RADIO
Switch your TCE to Blue Band and see if you can hear FT-28 with a flight of five planes x Give him a call on 4805 Kcs and see if you can contact him x

1821 MIAMI TO BANANA RIVER VIA TWPL
Our DF give fix on flight as 29° N - 79° W, which puts them north of original presumed position x Will you alert fields north of you as far as Jacksonville x (This message not Rogered for).

1824 ASRTU#4 TO BANANA RIVER VIA PHONE
Relayed TWPL message from Miami. Also advised them to please have all stations in his area to attempt to contact FT-28 (Leader of Flight of 5 TBF's) on 4805 Kc and advise him to maintain course of 270°. This is serious as planes have been lost since 1621R and their gas should be out by 1930R. The TWPL System is out North of here. Also alert Dumbos in your area.

1830 ASRTU#4 TO MIAMI (052337) VIA TWPL
We called Banana River by telephone and had them alert all fields south of Jacksonville x (Roger)

1844 INTERCEPTED TRANSMISSION BETWEEN PLANES IN FT-28 FLIGHT
On 4805 Kcs x Conversation garbled x Could hear FT-3 giving his call.

1915 ASRTU#4 FROM DUTY OPERATIONS OFFICER NAS BANANA RIVER VIA PHONE
The following craft have been alerted: 3 PBMs from Banana River, Dumbos from Mayport - Daytona - and Vero Beach. All stations alerted including Boat Facility, New Smyrna and a carrier and 2 DD's in area.

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1922 ASRTU#4 FROM MIAMI VIA TWPL
Do you have any 104 ft. or 110 ft. AVR at sea this moment x (Negative x one at Cat Key).

1925 NHA-1 TO MIAMI DUMBO VIA RADIO
Proceed on course 045° for 150 miles and then turn North and proceed to 29°14' N - 79°00' W x Ask for further instructions at that time x

1928 ASRTU#4 FROM MIAMI DUMBO VIA RADIO
Can you contact C.G. Dinner Key and tell them we have no CW communications and tell them to switch to FR frequency for CW communications x (Roger - Wilco).

2007 ASRTU#4 TO NHV VIA RADIO
Relay to Miami Dumbo if possible x ET at end of present leg proceed to area 29°15' N - 79°00' W and investigate to limit of endurance x Contact Dinner Key on CW FO x (No response).

2013 ASRTU#4 FROM NHA-41 ON MIMINI PATROL VIA RADIO
We are still trying to contact FT-28 on 4805 Kcs x Negative results x (You may secure for tonight).

2105 BANANA RIVER TO MIAMI (060205) VIA TWPL
ATC has just informed Banana River that five unidentified aircraft were seen at 2050R 245° 32 miles from Brunswick, Ga., course 150° x ATC is alerting all stations x

2110 MIAMI TO BANANA RIVER VIA TWPL
Can you ascertain if this could be five missing planes off east coast of Florida x

2110 BANANA RIVER TO MIAMI VIA TWPL
We have been getting these reports from Jacksonville and Brunswick x They are planes that ATC has no record of x But if the fuel supply was correct how could the five missing planes be them x

2112 MIAMI TO BANANA RIVER (060212) VIA TWPL
Position 28°59' N - 80°25' W x Position just observed x Follow-whole message x At 1950R hundred foot burst of flame lasting several minutes seen by circling ship x Investigate x (Miami From Banana River: Where did you get the info)

2113 MIAMI TO BANANA RIVER VIA TWPL
Intercept on 500 Kcs x 85 Gaines Mills to WMH x.

2118 MAYPORT BOAT FACILITY TO BANANA RIVER VIA TWPL
Following message intercepted on CKT x
P A NMB/QUAS ET
From NMB x QPM AA Sta on 500 Kcs x
At 0208 QVN position 28°59' N - 80°25' W approached area under emergency QVM passing through big pool of oil at 0119 GMT

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2118 (Con't)
4 QVM stopped and circled area using QVM light QVM looking for survivors x Not QVM found BT Master SS Gaines Mills x Unquote x No action taken by NMB x

2203 MAYPORT BOAT FACILITY TO BANANA RIVER VIA TWPL
P A·NMB/QUAD BT
From NMB x Q PN KAJK on 500 Kcs at 0254 Quote
WAS DE KAJK BT Pass to COMEASTSEAFRON CK 28 BT
55 miles 74 degrees from QVM Cape Canaveral at 0135Z QVM
HOFFIC QVM reported sighting two parachutes QVM flares have searched five miles QVM am now resuming course BT Master 060205Z AR UNQUOTE
no action taken by NMB x

2235 MIAMI TO BANANA RIVER VIA TWPL
SS Thomas Payne 060225 x
To Banana River x
From KAJK x
Quote 55 miles 74° from Cape Canaveral x at 0135Z watch officer on lookout reported sighting two parachute flares x Have searched five mile area and am now resuming course x Master 06/0225 unquote x

2215 7th NAVDIS ASR OPERATIONS OFFICER FROM BANANA RIVER (060315) VIA TWPL. Request advise who is controlling search of five missing TBF's.

2225 7th NAVDIS ASR OPERATIONS OFFICER TO BANANA RIVER VIA TWPL
Reference your request x Miami has control x

2248 7th NAVDIS ASR OPERATIONS OFFICER FROM BANANA RIVER VIA TWPL
Following dispatch sent to three Banana River aircraft for action x and to Comdt 7th NavDis for information Quote Air Sea Rescue Officer 7th NavDis is controlling all aircraft engaged in search for five Tare Baker Fox aircraft x.

2300 7th NAVDIS ASR OPERATIONS OFFICER TO BANANA RIVER VIA TWPL
Request search at daylight by Daytona Dumbo from 79°00' W to beach between 28°00' and 29°00' North x Banana River planes to search area from 77°00' to 79°00' West and 27°00' to 28°00' North x Vero Beach Dumbo from 79°00' to beach and 27°00' to 28°00' N x

2305 7th NAVDIS ASR OPERATIONS OFFICER TO JACKSONVILLE VIA TWPL
Request search be made beginning daylight by Jax Planes from 79°00' West to beach between 29°00' and 30°30' North x Advise x Five TBM planes considered down x (Jax later advised to search area Lat. 29° 00' to 30°30' North from Long. 77°00' West to beach)

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2309 7th NAVDIS ASR OPERATIONS OFFICER TO MORRISON FIELD VIA TWPL
Can you search for five missing Navy planes considered down comma beginning daylight in area 76°00' to 77°00' West and 27°00' to 28000' North x (This was changed to Lat. 27°00' to 28°00' North from Long. 79°00' West to beach).

2322 BANANA RIVER TO COMDT 7th NAVDIS - INFO CNAATC - VIA TWPL
Three Peter Baker Mike aircraft sent on air sea rescue mission in connection five missing Tare Baker Fox aircraft x SS Gaines Mills report seeing explosion Latitude 28 dash 59 Longitude 80 dash 20 x This position at 1950 Roger coincides with established position of Peter Baker Mike number four nine and we are unable to communicate with Peter Baker Mike four nine x SS Gaines Mills and rescue boat from New Smyrna are searching area x

2337 ASRTU-4 TO MIAMI (060437) VIA TWPL
Have all Dumbos been secured for search of the five TBF's for tonight x (Negative).

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Current Incidents

File No. 2272
Action Time: Current
Subject: MV Berlanga - possible distress
Origin: WAX
Location: 50 miles north of Swan Island
Action Time:

05/1117 WAX advised following messages received through WOE from MV BERLANGA, HRCG "Northwest gale, Wind Northwest approximately 45 to 50 knots very rough sea approximate position 50 miles north of Swan Island." The BERLANGA reported on 2 December she had hit an object with one screw and had secured one engine due to excess vibration, but needed no assistance.

05/1157 WAX advised following heard on 500 kcs "SOS SOS SOS DE LKCG this followed by dashes. HF/DF not alerted.

05/1210 No further word has been heard from LKCG. This call not listed. Called chief Angle at WAX and inquired if LKCG sending SOS could have been HRCG. Angle states this is definite possibility, and he would try to raise HRCG and ascertain if she is in distress.

05/1215 Controller sent following C. P. Dispatch, for WAX to deliver to the BERLANGA by "R" method. "Are you in distress and require assistance. Received following message that WAX transmitted at 1201 to all ships and stations. "Request details of distress signals sent at 1653 GMT. Please report.

"EXHIBIT 10"
In substance this is a true copy of DKCO 7ND Operations office log, for period 0800R, 5, December, 1945 to 0800R, 14, December, 1945
S. G. Ferrell
Lt(JG) USCG.

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CG District Log, 7ND 0800 5 December - 0800 6 December 1945 Contd

Current Incidents (cont'd)

File No. 2272
Subject: MV BERLANGA - possible distress

Action: 05/1228 WAX advises "This station was in communication with HRCG at 1015 on 8 and 12 MC, but unreadable then. Last time asked him return at 1730 GMT, but no reply from him at that time.

05/1300 Called WAX who advised they have been unable to raise HRCG but are still trying.

05/1445 Check with WAX reveals HRCG still has not been raised.

05/1514 WNU Reports on HF/DF net "Heres following from HRCG just received. Quote Dec. 5 2000 GCT Gerace Tampa Fla. 2PM ship sprung leak. Stuffed rags in it, making for Swan Island 80 miles south east gale continued.

05/1517 WNU accepted from WAX for delivery to HRCG ComGulf's 051715"

05/1522 WNU delivered ComGulfs 051715 at 1520R.

05/1527 Following dispatch given to WAX for CO delivery "To all ships vicinity 50 miles north Swan Island Carribean Sea from DCGO 7NAVDIST Miami. Information Chief NavMission, Havana PanAmSea Batista Field, CGAS Miami, ComGulf SomSeven "SOS heard at 1657 EST believed to be Honduras MV BERLANGA call letters HRCG Advise if any vessels in locality.

05/1605 Following 05/2041 dispatch received from M. V. BERLANGA, via New Orleans Radio (WNU). "Following received from (HRCG) on 12420Kcs at 2041 GMT. Pass to ComGulfSeaFron ship leaking headed for Swan Island 77 miles SSE True appreciate assistance signed Master.

05/1610 Following OP 052027 dispatch sent by DCGO 7ND to all ships vicinity 50 miles North Swan Island, Carribean Sea, information Chief Naval Mission Havana Panama SeaFron Batista Field, Cuba, CGAS Miami, ComGulf, Com 7: "SOS heard at 1657 GMT believed to be Honduras MV BERLANGA call letters HRCG. Advise if any vessels in locality.

05/1650 Sent following 052143 OP dispatch to SS LA PLAYA (HPAM) information Chief Naval Mission Havana, Panama Sea Fron, Batista Field, Cuba, ComGulf. "M. V. BERLANGA(HRCG) in immediate need of assistance. Ship leaking. Headed for Swan Island 77 miles SSE True at 2100 GMT. Request your position and available aid.

05/1702 From WAX to DCGO 7ND. "We bearing 58 degrees from Swan Island at 2050 GMT at 1645 we heard XXX from KGGB but sigs. about QSA1 with poor fist unreadable could KGCR be in this area also worked WSG which is on Swan Island.
Checked with A-Board and KGC 8 is Francis Drake and not in area mentioned.

05/1703 From SS Rio Tunuyan via WAX to DCGO 7ND 052140 dispatch "Our position at 2100 GMT Lat 17.55 N. Long 82.34W Speed 10 miles Master.

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CG District Log, 7ND 0800 5 December - 0800 6 December, 1945 Cont'd

Current Incidents (Cont'd)

File No. 2272 (Cont'd)
Subject: MV BERLANGA - possible distress

Action: 05/1720 From S S CYRUS W. FIELD, via (WAX to DCGO, 7ND, 052130 dispatch Refer OP. My position at 052130 GMT 19-25.30N. 83-14.30 West. Course 308 degrees True Speed 4 knots.

05/1730 From ComForce GTmoSec to ComGulf information DCGO 7ND 052212 op dispatch: "Ur dispatch 052115. No vessels in vicinity."

05/1755 From DCGO 7ND to SS RIO TUIUYAN (LOIP) information Chief Naval Mission Havana PanamSeaFron ComGulf, ComCarib 052245 OP dispatch. "Ur dispatch 052140. MV BERLANGA (HRCG) in immediate need of assistance. Ship leaking. Headed for Swan Island 77 miles SSE True at 2100 GMT. Advise your ETA vessel in distress.

05/1800 From DCGO 7ND to SS CYRUS W. FIELDS (KHVL) information Chief Naval Mission Havana, Panama SeaFromComGulf ComCarib 052245 OP dispatch: "Ur dispatch 052130. M. V. BERLANGA(HRCG) in immediate need of assistance. Ship leaking. Headed for Swan Island 77 miles SSE True at 2100 GMT. Request your ETA vessel in distress.

05/1822 From Batista Field to DCGO 7ND 052251 OP dispatch "One crash boat on limited service here Swan Island, three eight zero miles from here.

05/1855 From ComPors GTMO, SLCTou, CaribSeaFron to DCGO 7ND 052212 OP dispatch 052115. No Vessels in vicinity

05/2005 From SS CYRUS W. FIELDS via WAX to DCGO 7ND 060030 dispatch. "Position of BERLANGA unclear to us. Master requests approximate position and course of vessel in distress. If vessel north of Swan Island, our distance from Vessel only 95 miles. Shall we proceed and to her assistance.

05/2030 From SS CYRUS W. FIELDS via (WAX) to DCGO 7ND 060118 dispatch. "Master says ship in ballast. Ready to assist. Distance now approximately 90 miles speed 10.7 to 11 knots."

05/2050 From DCGO 7ND to SS CYRUS W. FIELD information ComGulf 060135 OP dispatch "Ref ur 060100 dispatch. At 2100 GMT Swan Island was 77 miles SSE position MV BERLANGA. Vessel north of Swan Island heading for Swan Island. Request you proceed to assist.

05/2100 From SS La Playa via (WAX) to DCGO 7ND 052238 dispatch: "Position 2230Z 12.16 N. 81.05W. Think too far away to be any aid.

05/2211 From DCGO 7ND to SS LA PLAYA (HPAM) information ComGulf "Ur dispatch 052238. Agree with you. Many thanks.

06/0100 Received message from SS CYRUS W. FIELD, 05/2345 stating ETA vessel in distress N AM zone time Dic 7."

File No. 2273
Action Time: Current
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost
Origin: HF/DF (EVALUATOR)
Location: Unknown

Action: 05/1718 Evaluator advises that NAS Ft. Lauderdale had a flight of 5 TBM's who are lost and unable to determine their position. The flight leader's compass failed at 1552R when flight was over Hen and Chick Shoals(Bimini) Bahamas. One FF is also out. Flight leader unable

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Current Incidents (Cont'd)

File No. 8273 (Cont'd)
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost
Action: 05/1718 to contact wingman. Flight took off from NAS Ft. Lauderdale at 1408R on a Navigational Hop to the Bahamas.

05/1725 NAS Ft. Lauderdale advises planes have fuel for approximately 1 hr and 15 minutes from this time.

05/1750 Passed information to CAA and asked them to alert their setup this area

05/1800 1752R DCGO 7ND ordered all stations south of Banana River to light up to greatest possible extent.

05/1821 Evaluation gives fix as follows on flight of TBM's (FL-28* 25-15N 79 W.

05/1830 Alerted the CG Pandora and advised to be ready for sea at very short notice.

05/1835 Requested CGC Miami to dispatch CG-83504 to Coast Guard Island pending orders to sea.

05/1840 Alerted East Florida Coast South of Jacksonville ref. air fields etc

05/1855 From ComGulf to Wns. (all navies area East Coast Florida to 74 west 052355. "All ships area east Florida coast east to 74 west be on alert for five planes lost and short of fuel.

05/1900 Passed all details to Captain Mishar.

05/1901 Sent following OP 052341 to CG VIGILANT information ComGulf. "Five TBM's lost at sea possibly your area. Fuel about exhausted Have CG Vigilant ready to proceed on very short notice.

05/1902 Intercepted 052238 T.L from NAOTC Port Everglades to NAS Banana River: "A flight of five TBF led by FT-28 from NAS Ft. Lauderdale have been lost since 1621R. We are able to contact FT-28 on 4405 Kcs very faintly. NAS Lauderdale unable to determine what area planes are in. We have 3 AVR standing by. Can you set up on 4405 a contact that plane. Our teletype has been out of commission and we have been unable to send.

05/1921 Priority 052335 DCGO 7ND to Ponce De Leon LBS priority Five TBM's lost at sea possibly your area. Fuel about exhausted. Have CG-8345 ready to proceed on very short notice.

05/1930 From DCGO 7ND to CGC Ft. Pierce information ComGulf 060025 OP dispatch Dispatch CG-83457. Follow course due east and advise frequenc Orders follow.

05/1940 Sent OP dispatch 060031 to Ponce De Leon LBS information ComGulf. Dispatch CG-83497. Take course due east. Orders follow. Advise frequency.

05/1950 Received 06006 OP dispatch from (CVE-67) Salomons to NSO ComGulf. "4 to 6 planes No. 1FF at 1900 Lat. 2935, Long 8128 Course 170 Speed 120 estimated altitude 4000 feet.

05/2000 From DCGO 7ND OP Dispatch DCGO 35 to CG VIGILANT information ComGulf "Proceed to sea. Orders will follow.

05/2001 Intercept by NAX on 500from SS DELAWARE 06/0039 dispatch. We saw five planes at 2200 ft flying in formation going seaward from Hillsboro Light.

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CG District Log, 7ND 0800 5 December - 0800 6 December Cont'd

Current Incidents (Cont'd)

File No. 2273 (Cont'd)
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost

Action: 05/2037 Bans 05/2355 amended to read "All ships area east Florida Coast east to 74 West be on alert for five planes considered to be down."

05/2100 Following received from Mayport to NAS Banana River. "Try and organize search. Mayport Dumbo pilot considers VIS poor flying conditions unsafe. We are having him return to base. Above received on HF/DF machine.

05/2110 WAX intercepted on 474 Kcs 06/0215 dispatch from SS GAINES MILL to ComEast. "At 0050 GMT observed burst of flames apparently explosion leaping flames 100 ft. high burning 10 minutes position 28.59N 80.25W at present passing thru big pool oil at 0119 GMT stopped circled area using search lights looking for survivors none found.

05/2130 CGC Ft. Pierce advises: CG-83457 has been dispatched at 2030R for position of search.

05/2145 Sent 060235 OP dispatch to CVE-67 Salomons. "Flight Off. Five TBM planes overdue and considered missing; having departed Ft. Lauderdale at 1915 GMT. Can you make daylight search of area between 77-00 and 79-00 West and 29-00 to 30-30N.

05/2220 From CGC Fort Pierce to DCGO 7ND - 060240 dispatch "VIGILANT departed 2115R for scene. Guarding 2670 and 3000Kcs.

05/2221 CGC Ft. Pierce advises CG-83497 unable to send out till dawn. Due to weather and sea conditions also impossibility of crossing bar tonight. Above advised by Co, CGC Ft. Pierce.

05/2222 CGC Ft. Pierce to DCGO 7ND 060243 dispatch "CGC 83457 has been dispatched at 2030R for position of search.

05/2223 From DCGO 7ND TO SS GAINES MILLS (KUCL) via WAX information CGAS, Miami, NAS, Banana River, NAS Jacksonville, NAOTC Bt. Facilities Port Everglades, ComGulf, NAS Vero Beach via 060225 OP dispatch. "Request you standby position 28-59N 80-25W pending arrival air and surface rescue craft

05/2224 WAX intercepted following message from SS THOMAS PAYNE to ComEast "55 miles 740 from Cape Canaveral. At 0135Z watch officer on lookout reported sighting 2 parachute flares have searched 5 miles area and am now resuming course master.

05/2225 Sent following OP 060259 dispatch to SS THOMAS PAYNE information CGAS Miami, NAS Banana River, NAS Jacksonville, NAOTC Bt. Facilities, Ft. Everglades, ComGulf NAS, Vero Beach. "Request you standby position 55 miles. 74 degrees from Cape Canaveral pending arrival air and surface rescue craft.

05/2246 Following 060310 Urgent dispatch recd from RAF Nassau to ComGulf: "RAF request information on just what area to cover on search for missing planes and frequencies to use for relaying information PD RAF can send on search at dawn 06 December one Hudson and one Skytrain plus two sixty foot launches PD advise immediately.

05/2305 ComGulf to PCS 1378 OP 052335. "Be on alert for 5 TBM's. Lost at sea possibly your area. Fuel about exhausted.

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Current Incidents (cont'd)

File No. 2-75
Subject:
Section: 05/2307 Five VTI's (...5 Ft. Lauderdale) lost ... Takeoff to Southeast Priority ...5/5% "S, and 5 VT's from ... Ft. Lauderdale on ordinary flight out at 14... ... weather and ... Conducting search.

05/23... Takeoff to Melbourne (CV-47) at 05/2332 "Five VTI's lost in flight ... probably ... four ... engine; 4... kcs. possible position ... 7...

05/2315 From ...30 7... to Nassau Bahama, Gen Field ...4...3 GT dispatch "Hour ...0 ... could ... search of 2...-00 to 25-00 North 7...-00 to 7...-00 ... on 4250 will guard and 5... will be used on scene if located. No surface ... needed.

05/2355 Received message from ... stating: Your 060201. Regret no planes on board to conduct search. ... on return ferry trip."

05/0145 Vero ... down to refuel ... down.

05/0015 Received ... from ... Fort ... stating "at 1... ... in ... 30-1... long 78-... . Source 10... Observed four times ... ... last

05/0015 Received ... from ... stating dispatched ... 15 ... 5... 4155 and ... kcs.

06/0018 Received ... from ... stating, apparent aerial white flare bearing 160 T from position 29-30 N and 79-4... ... sighted 06/0430 GCT.

06/0022 Received message from ... 070516, stating at 0430 GCT sighted flare to inshore ... vicinity approximately position 28-50 ... and 79-40...

06/0035 Sent message to Panama River 06/0535, stating Request take off times of all aircraft participating in search for missing VT planes. No times here on Jayport, Pan. River, Daytona and Vero Beach planes.

06/0035 CG Radio Intercepted ... from Vero Turbo to Panama River. ... approaching coastline in vicinity of ... River. ... to base due to ... of fuel ... River told her to go ahead in.

06/0107 Morrison Field called Jacksonville on FM stating "Explosion ... 28-... N. and 2...-2... This position ... 1950Z coincides with established position of PBM 49 and we are unable to communicate with ... and rescue boat from ... are searching area.

06/0107 Morrison Field ... would have one C-47 off by daylight. Do you want more aircraft.

06/0129 Sent message to Morrison Field stating 1 plane be sufficient ... him search area of Vero ... told him Vero planes be searching area also.

06/0140 Rec'd. ... from ... 06/0632 stating ref. my last message ... area where flares sighted for one hour using searchlight ... sighted in vicinity and proceeding at 06/0830Z.

06/0150 ..., Fostus field ... they would have 5 privateers to search and would take off between 0900 to 1000Z of Dec. 6.

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CG District Log, ZHD 0800 5 December 0800 6 December 1945 (Contd)

Current Incidents (contd)

File No: 2273
Subject:
Action: 06/0155 Five TBM's NAS Ft. Lauderdale Lost
Received message on TTY from Banana River stating, Vero Dumbo off at 1856 R and on at 0105R, Daytona Dumbo off at 1921R on at 2400R. Training 32 off at 1902 R, and training 49 off at 1927, training 60 off at 22 35R Training 32 and 60 still out, and 49 is missing.

06/0230 Banana River requested we alert net on 4385 K for training 49 call sign C is 19825

06/0257 Banana River requested alert net for training 60, call 19845 on 3000 kcs.

06300 Received message from JOGO ZHD to [illegible] ZHD,060750 stating, Following received on 500 kc 0656 G.C.T. ACLT in position 27-30 N and 80-16-W observed flare. Has any distress been reported for the vicinity.

06/0301 Asked Banana River when TR 49 last hear from.Position."When was he to be on air."Then do want stations to listen.

06/0302 After requesting more information from Banana River on training 60 and 49, received message stating,"Ref training 60. Please disregard, We contacted him on 3000 kcs at 0305 R. He's positions at that that time was 30 miles NE of Cape Canaveral. Please secure alert on this plane

06/032 Banana River reported that training 49 was last heard from when he sent his report at 1927R. Again requested we listen for TR 49 as soon as possible

06/0354 Asked Banana River type of boats available and the number at that unit. Banana River said would check.

060360 Requested from Banana River how much fuel had aboard training no. 49. They replied about 12 hours. Banana River stated they had Gibson Girl aboard, Banana River requested we keep net alerted on 4385 Kcs stated training 49 is a PBM.

06/0415 Received message from CO Barnes, 06/0291Z stating: have only cargo aircraft. Will maintain surface lookout.

06/0513 Banana River stated voice call of Plane 49 was training 49.

06/0480 Pt. Everglades Boat Moc, said have 4 ARB's available, but suggested use boats up north as take 12 hours to get here up to scene of operations.

06/0410 Controller sent message to CTF 67 Solomons, 060926, stating Ref our 060003. Request any further information you may have on later position of planes.

06/0450 Cont message to ATLT via WAX. 060829 stating.Ref flares. We have no report of distress in that area. Request you search area and inform us of your operations.

06/0453 Called CG West and request that SC-663 proceed to 28-59N,80-25W and SC-1064 to 28-43N and 79-33W. Talked to Chief Modill.

06/0515 Sent search areas for 5 TBM planes to Jacksonville, Banana River, Daytona Beach.

06/45 Requested B. River to give last time training plane 49 was heard from. B.River replied 1904R. B.River said this was immediately after take off.

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Current Incidents (Contd)

File No. 2273
Subject:
Action: 06/0503

Five TBM's NAS(Ft. Lauderdale)Lost
Received message from Windsor Field RAF Field Nassau at 0237R, bearing 06/0606 GT, stating "Have you time and pt. of departure of plane missing GMS type of aircraft and hours of fuel aboard and possible course to be flown RAF will cover area Req. in your 05040 3.Forward any information relative to this area and progress of search.

06/0503 Sent following message to RAF Windsor Field, Nassau, 06/0923, stating; RE:M 06/0606 5 TBM's departed Ft. Lauderdale at 1408R on a local training flight, Planes were to fly in an easterly direction from Ft. Lauderdale. Duration for flight 1½ hours. Had 5 hours of fuel aboard. Merchant ship at 05/1950 R sighted explosion and flames at 28-59N and 80-25W. Search of area by ships negative. 05/2035 R Merchant Ship sighted 2 parachute flares 28-43 N and 79-53 W. Search in area negative. Surface craft proceeding to areas to conduct search. Planes will take off at daybreak to cover entire area. No reports of anything sighted your assigned area.

06/0512 GC-1308 departed Bayport, at 0549R. Guarding 3000Kcs. Radio Call sign NTIV

06/0550 Received message from Jacksonville to Comdt. 7ND. Information CNAAT, stating, Three PBJ aircraft sent onAR, rescue mission in connection five missing TBM aircraft. SS GAINES MILL reports seeing explosion 28-59 N. and 80-20W. This position at 1950R. Coincides with established position of PBM 49. SS GAINES MILL and rescue boat from U.S.S.YMCA are searching area.

06/068 Training plane No. 60 from Banana River, reported it was at 28-50 north and 80-10west. Remaining at scene of crash. Raining.Wind 35 knots. Visibility 3 miles.

06/0630 CGC VIGILANT reported position as 29-02N and 79-17W

06/0640 Miami Dumbo PBM 6695 took officer search

06/0715 Received TWX from HarrisonField stating. Our C-47 is preparing to take off. How soon I don't know.Do you have any further instructions for the crew of the plane as to what frequencies and etc. Told them to guard home station adn 3000 kcs.

06/0715 Received TWX from Port Everglades Boat Facility.stating ETD of our 104 ETA AR NHA 38-715R guarding 3000 kcs. This boat instructed to proceed at best possible speed to 28-43 N. and 79-33W. Who will direct NHA 36 upon arrival at that position.

06/0717 Sent message to Port Everglades Bt. Facility requesting ETA scene also that we would direct them thru that unit Also time departed

06/0200 Received message from CGC Solomons 06/1120 stating. High winds heavy seas make air search impossible. At 06/1145 GCT Solomons with one escort will conduct surface search Lat. 29-45N.Long 77-00W. to Westward at 12 knots. Proceeding to long 79-0W. then to Port.

06/0720 Sent priority message to CGC VIGILANT 06/1205, stating, "Request you proceed to 29-10N. and 79-30 W. working north on that track of 79-30W.

06/0730 Port Everglades Boat Facility replied that ETA of 104 Ft. AR at its assigned area was 1630R.

06/1740 Sent dispatch to Ponce De Leon Lifeboat Sta. for 83497,Proceed

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CG District Log, TTD 0200 5 December - 0800 6 December 1945 (Contd)

Current Incidents (Contd)

File No. 2273
Subject:
Action:- 06/0740 Five TBM's VC6 (t. Lauderdale) lost 29.3 and 79-40W. Proceed North. Give weather when on above position.

06/0740 Sent dispatch to CG Ft. Pierce stating "Tor 23457. Proceed to 28-45". and 79-45W. Report ETA scene alsoweather at station. Send hourly reports on operations.

06/0746 Received message from Mayport Boat Facilities stating refur 052210 Priority from Mayoroan Miami, Concerning PT's C14,C17,and C21, departing from Miami, sea buoy 0200D December 6 for N.Y. via Mayport ETA 0- n-C on PT C14 guarding 716 kcs. Suggest that if possible to divisk. PT's for search.

06/0755 Received message from Banana River stating. "Two additional PBM's conducting square. Pawino search at probable position where 131 was last 29.09N and 80-25W.

06/0757 Mayport Dumbo took off at 0725 for search area.

File No. 2274
Action Time: Current
Subject: SCOTTY BOY Disabled
Origin: Radio CG Miami
Location: 3 miles 135°
Action: 06/0620 NLPX reported intercept of HPB Banana River to CG Ft. Pierce "CGW 16 reported fishing boat SCOTTY BOY disabled at position 3 miles 135° from Cape Canaveral. Boat has enough food and water to last till morning. Home port St. Augustino.

Further Action - Previous Incidents

File No. 2260
Subject: SS JAMES T. GRIMES (KKHP)
Action: 05/1100 ComGulf 051605 to Chief Naval Mission Havana received "No further action required on SS JAMES T. GRIMES, no proceeding u.s. advise action taken on my 042142 and 042220.

05/1536 Following received from SS JAMES T GRIMES. "Ref your 051455 Patients condition remains slightly improved and able swallow jello for nourishment. Condition not considered Diptheria. Deem best proceed New Orleans account insufficient fuel oil for voyage via Key West. Four day ETA. Miss Delta if weather not moderate. Two days otherwise.

05/1420 WAX advises "Your 051253 SS JAMES T. GRIMES From CCCO TRavDist Miami delivered WUSF 174230CT."

05/1720 From SS JAMES T. GRIMES via (WAX to CCCO TTD 051985 dispatch. Ref. your 051455. Patients condition remain slightly improved and able to swallow jello for nourishment. Condition not considered diptheria. deem best proceed New Orleans account insufficient fuel oil for voyage via Key West. Four days ETA Miss delta if weather not moderate. Two days otherwise. Thank you.

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CG District Lor, 7HD 0300 5 December - 0300 6 December 1945 (contd)

Further Action -Previous Incidents (contd)

File No. 2209
Subject:
Action: 05/2150

BY JAMES W. [illegible] (RET'D)
From ComlO to Commors, Guantanamo Sector C ribseaFron
information [illegible] 7; via 052230 OP dispatch. "REfer
0300 7HD dispatch 052115 advise action taken."

Approved:

W.T. MURPHY, Lt. Comdr. USCG

Wm. Fisher, Captain, USCG

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CG District Log, 7th
0800 6 December - 0800 7 December 1945

06/0800-Lt. Covey on duty
06/1510-Lt. (jg) J.F. Koch reported for duty
06/1550-End of watch
06/1601-Commander Baxter, Lt. Condr. T.T. Murphy, Lt. Covey, Lt. (jg) Koch
Yeo Calhoun, Ross Seely and Chastid on duty pending action incidents
2252, 2270, 2272, 2273, 2274, 2275, 2276
06/1700-Lt. Covey departed
06/1701-Boca Chica (NAS, Key West) advises Flares and rockets exercises at
Barracuda Key 06 December from 1730Z to 2030Z by planes from Boca Chica
06/1700-Yeo Calhoun, Ross, Seely, Chastid departed.
06/1830-Lt. Condr. T.T. Murphy departed
06/2015-Condr. Baxter departed
06/2204-Ensign De Decree reported for duty
06/2350-End of watch
07/0001-Lt. (jg) Koch and Ens. J. DeGeorge on Watch
07/0027-Received following 070225 dispatch from CG Group Key West "20152 ASR
Boca Chica advised all of flying secured. Station boats two three and
four are returning to base.
07/0050-Lt. (jg) Koch departed
07/0110-Received following 070057 Dispatch from NAS Banana River Fla 0302 7th
"Rcvr 062250. Search has been completed with negative results. Civilian
residents in this area have not ing unusual to report. We are now firmly
convinced that this was the remains of the crash on 8 October involving
an F-6F and an SB2c. The sanford ready plane searched the area of re-
ported flares near Christmas, Florida, this afternoon with negative
results. The ready plane landed at 1430Z. this afternoon.
07/0145-Mr. Leslie Burch, 1460 SW 11th St. Miami, advised that he heard SOS being
sent on 590 broadcast band unable to read other than SOS.
07/0147-Alerted Gulf not on 590 but nothing heard.
07/0715-CG Group Miami advised that Mr. T. Hanson 2165 W 19th St. Miami, had
Parker 210 south of New Bridge. CG-38373 dispatched to assist.
07/0750-Lt. Sauer reported for duty
07/0759-End of watch.

Current Incidents

File No. 2276
Action To:
Subject:
Origin
Location:
Action: 06/0830

Current
CABIN CRUISER NEEDS ASSISTANCE
TAX
2 miles east of Tennessee Reef
Received from TAX message from A PT(Unable break) "Small
cabin cruiser named DEMER of Miami asked for help fromCoast
Guard, not leaking, believed to be engine trouble in position
two miles east of Tennessee Reef, time 1300 G.C.T. Master"

06/0849

Sent above to CG Key West with request they "Dispatch vessel
to assist and keep us advised."

06/0950

Received C G Key West 061400 to CG [illegible]"Small Cabin Cruiser

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CG District Loc, 7MD 0800 6 December - 0800 7 December 1945 (Contd)

Current Incidents - Contd

File No. 2275 (contd)
Subject:
Action: CG/0950 "[illegible] in need of assistance 2 mile east of Tennessee Reef. Proceed to assist."

CG/1153 Received copy of ARIADNE 061415 to Key West "Your 061400 proceeding [illegible] 1330R.

CG/1325 Received copy CG Group Key West CG-653 standing by distress vessel [illegible].1 ½ miles ENE of Tennessee Reef.

CG/1420 Received ARIAD[illegible] 061315 "Took tow over from CG-653 proceeding to Key West unless otherwise advised. ETA 0800R tomorrow.

CG/1440 Received CG Key West's 061035 "CG-653 steming by distressed boat [illegible] vicinity Tennessee Reef. ARIADNE took over at 1315R and proceeding Key West with Tow."

CG/2210 From CG ARIADNE to CG Key West information 0000 7MD 070100 dispatch "2000R position report 24 degrees 27 minutes north 81 degrees 27 minutes west. ETA 0100R.

07/0235 Received following 070522 message from CGC ARIADNE "Arrived Key West withTow 0020R.
Incident Closed.

File No. 2270
Action Time: Current
Subject: [illegible] FROM SS CHESTER HILLS
Origin WAX
Location: At sea, off Key West
Action: CG/0958 Received following message from WAX, from the SS CHESTER HILLS "Medical advise Patient Chief Mate temperature 102, respiration pulse 102 Tightening pain under the lungs, face blood streaked and rosy. Has formally had Indian Amoebic Dysentary. Suggest man being hospitalized. Due Key West 1215 EST. Please advise. Poulsen Master."

06/1015 Called [illegible] for information was advised by Dr. Padorr and forwarded following dispatch to SS CHESTER HILLS. "Diagnosis possible pneumonia or scarlet fever. Man should be hospitalized at earliest opportunity. Advise your ETA Key West. CoastGuard vessel will meet you at sea buoy."

06/1045 Received ETA of 1220 EST from SS CHESTER HILLS.

06/1050 Called C/G. Operations K.W. and informed them of vessels ETA. CG Vessel will meet ship at sea buoy.

06/1455 Received CG Key West's 061840 "Ref your telephone message 061050. 63063 removed chief mate George C. Peterson from SS CHESTER HILLS home port San Francisco California. Diagnosis Dysentary. Peterson taken to Naval Hospital Key West at 0613[illegible]R

06/2000 From CG Key West to [illegible] 7MD 062235 Dispatch "Reur 062023 63063 departed 1140R returned 1255R.
Incident closed

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CG District Log, 7th 0800 6 December - 0800 7 December, 1945 (Contd)

Current Incidents (contd)

File No. 2227
Action Time:
Subject:
Origin
Location
Action: 06/1705

Current
Overdue Sponge Boat - DOVA D-2
CG Key West 062045 dispatch
Dry Tortugas
From CG Key West to DCGO 7THD-062045 dispatch "DOVA D2,20 foot sponge boat painted white, 4 men on board, departed Key West 3rd December for sponge ground approximately 30 miles west of Key West. Overdue. CG-83506 on Dry Tortugas run to be on lookout for DOVA D2.

File No. 2279
Action: Time
Subject:
Origin:
Location
Action: 06/1730

Current
Canadian Aux. Schooner "La Mavie"
Telephone Call from Harriman Shipping Co.
Nova Scotia to Miami
Received telephone call from Mr. Harriman of Harriman Shipping Co., agents for Aux. Schooner La MAVIE. Mr. Harrimans office phone No. 3-4766 and home phone No. is 7-2957. He reports Canadian Aux. Schooner LA MAVIE overdue, and unheard from. ETA Miami was 29 November. Asked for aid in locating.

06/1815 Sent following 062251 dispatch to DCGO 1-3-4-5-6-information Com 1-3-4-5-6-ComEast and ComGulf "Harriman ShipoingCo., agents reported at 06173OR that Canadia Auxiliary Schooner LA MAVIE sailed from Liverpool Nova Scotia on 22 November bound direct for Miami. estimated time of voyage seven days now 7 days overdue. Schooner painted white. Two masted. Bald head. White deck house between fore and main. Request your advice if sighted or any information on same.

06/1830 06/1815 entry sent to CG Miami and CG Ft. Pierce CG Miami via 062341 dispatch CG Ft. Pierce 062327.dispatch.

06/2300 ComEast requested we include Canadian Aux. Schooner LA MAVIE in SAR search. Advised decision rested with Com.Baxter will advise.

07/0235 Received following 070241 dispatch from CAS Lant City ASR "Rcur 062251. Negative"

Further Action Previous Incidents

File No. 2269
Subject:
Action: 06/2210

SS JAMES W. ORIOUS (WTHF)
From Nav Sta Cuba to ComGulf- DCGO 10 San Juan PR 052205 dispatch. "Rcur dispatch 051605. No action taken your dispatch 042122 and 042220Z. BTO 52235 R.J.Wilkes USNR

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Further Action - Previous Incidents (Contd)

File No. 2272
Subject: SS PERLANGA - Possible Distress
Action: 06/0902 Received from NAX following message from MV PERLANGA "Geraco Tampa at Swan Island. Leak stopped with rags, weather moderated some. Awaiting Coast Guard Instructions.

06/0919 Sent following to CG Rio Tungan "PERLANGA arrived Swan Island and further assistance your vessels not needed. Many thanks.

06/0915 Sent following to SS PERLANGA "Can you effect repairs at Swan Island, and proceed your destination without further assistance.

06/09;7 Sent following to SS CYRUS T. FIELDS "Perlana arrived Swan Island, Further assistance your vessel not needed. Many thanks.

06/1018 Received from NAX following message from SS PERLANGA "Obtaining cement here to stop leak. will proceed and advise if further if help is needed thanks, master."

06/1219 USCG DP net advises following heard from the Arthur J. Tyrer (MSTD) "Have located (PERLANGA) PROG off Swan Island. He does not need assistance. Repairing his leaks and will continue on to Tampa this evening. I am proceeding to my destination."

06/2125 Received following from S.S. CYRUS T. FIELDS to DCGO 7TH of Swan Island and established contact with (CHTD) which searched Western area. CHTD then proceeded to Swan Island while we searched area between 18.10N and 17.40 North. Received message from CHTD at 0617352 saying MV PERLANGA had been located by her in lee of Great Swan Island. PERLANGA repairing leak, and in no further need of assistance. CHTD proceeding on her voyage. Still have not established radio contact with PERLANGA. We must proceed on our voyage.

06/2303 From DCGO 7TH to SS CYRUS T. FIELDS 070315 dispatch. Your dispatch 061745. Your services appreciated. Many thanks.

File No. 2274
Subject: SONNY BOY Disabled
Action: 06/1153 Received CGC Ft. Pierce 061430 "Motor Life Boat is being dispatched from Ponce DeLeon Life Boat Station to assist. Fishing boat SONNY BOY.

06/1710 Received 161920 Priority dispatch from CGC Ft. Pierce to DCGO 7TH: "For operations. Present position of Ponce De Leon Life boat 18 mile snorth Canaveral light. ETA at SONNY BOY is 1700R.

06/2135 Received 071420 dispatch from CGC Ft. Pierce to DCGO 7TH: "Reur 061405. My 061430. Motor lifeboat with fishing boat Sunny Boy in tow arrived New Smyrna at 2100 R 6 December." Incident closed.

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RESTRICTED

CG District 7ND, Log 0300 6 December - 0600 7 December 1945 (Contd)

Further Action-Previous Incidents (Contd)

File No.: 2273
Subject:
Action: 06/0905 Five TBM's (NAS, Ft. Lauderdale) Lost
Sent priority dispatch to Ponce De Leon Lifeboat station 06/1249 stating CG-83497. Report LTA scene. Also weather at station. Send hourly reports on operations.

06/0915 CGAS Dinner Key advises Miami Dumbo PBM 5596 airborne at 0745R on search.

06/0930 Comdr. Baxter advises that the following additional areas and units have been assigned search.
A. 3rd Airforce 82° - 83°
B. Boca Raton 29° - 31°
C. Miami ATC-317 South of 26° on north south lines beginning at Long. 80-15

06/1100 Capt. Hitchcock. Orlando (20701 ext. (345). advises his planes are now taking off consisting of 6 B-17's and 17 other aircraft. A-20's P51's and P47's

06/1115 Comdr. Baxter received call from a Pan American pilot sighted green flares between 2230 and 2300R on 5th around position 79-35 24-30.

06/1120 Called operations NAS Ft. Lauderdale who advised that each raft contained 6 flares, 150 ft. handfill projection, all red.

06/1126 Called CGAS Miami, who will dispatch plane to cover this position.

06/1132 Miami, C GAS Plane Airborne.

06/1145 Morrisson Field B-17 Airborne at 1617 Z.

06/1150 NAS Jacksonville advises that beginning at 0742, 70 planes from Jacksonville area have been dispatched to search assigned area.

06/1155 Ponce de Leon LBS advised CG-83497 arrived at scene at 0940R.

1200 SC-1064-advises "departed 0745 LTA 0600 7 December 15 knots making all speed possible. "WTC Miami advises "PT-613 send 619 on air sea rescue from Miami NAA Mayport 062400"

06/1220 Dinner Key advises JRF at scene of reported flares 061214 beginning square search.

06/1230 Mayport boat facilities reported to Banana River "overhead on 3000kcs that a unit found a raft at Matanzas inlet."

06/1233 Ft. Pierce reports "CG-83497 is at scene CG-83457 is refueling at New Smyrna and preparing to depart to scene.

06/1241 Banana River advises "Pilot of SNJ ready plane, believed that he saw a body with life jacket in position off Matanzas Inlet. Body was just below surface of water. Wing 10 is investigating assisted by blimp Y118".

06/1245 All interested units advised that orders have been sent to following vessels to proceed to following positions and commence square search. PANDORA to position 29.00N 77-00W. VIGILANT to 28.00N-79-00W,SC-1309 30.00N - 80.30W. SC-1064 to 24-30N 79-30W.SC-663 26-15N 78-30W.

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CG District Log, 7ND 0800 6 December - 0800 7 December 1945, Contd

Further Action - Previous Incidents (Contd)

File No. 2273
Subject:
Action: 06/1245 Five TBM's (NAS, Ft. Lauderdale) Lost CG-83497 30-00N. 79-30W. CG-83457 to 29-15N. 79-00W.

06/1306 NAS Jacksonville advises "Jacksonville airway traffic control reports Civilian Mrs. Sanderland, phone Orlando 4585 called Orlando tower and reported sighting flares blue and green 5 to 10 miles north of Christmas Florida. At about 0200R 6 December Christmas is about 65 miles SW of Titusville. We will dispatch Titusville ready plane." Banana River advises "Daytona Dumbo ETA at base 1230 for new crew. Vero Dumbo returned to base at 1250 for gas.

06/1322 Banana River advises Re 1306 entry Sanford ready pland dispatched to investigate

06/1323 Received copy of SC-653's 061534 "Departed 0650R. ETA 0630R Friday Sea 17. Present position 8 miles east Somerero Key.

06/1325 Received SC 1064's 061600 1000 position 81° 14 W. 24-30N weather overcast."

06/1350 Banana River advises NHA 38 now 6 miles at sea a little south of Ft. Pierce.

06/1350 Banana River advises "Sanford ready plane airborne at 1344" NAS Ft. Lauderdale advised assigned area searched with 38. to 40 planes with negative results. Comdr. Baxter assigned following area for their search this PM 24° to 25° N. 79° to 8030N.

06/1358 Sent following to Banana River "Have NHA 38 conduct square search based on center point 28-15 N. 79-45W.

06/1400 Received copy CG Ft. Pierce 061730 "Position of VIGILANT 1230R 29-31N 79-23W. Received following frm. PT 614 "Out 1130 position 27 degrees N 79-30 W. But heavy seas are farcing us to proceed to beach at slow speed course 306°T. Some damage sustained already."

06/1400 Received SC-653's 061654 "Present position Tennessee Reef Beacon."

06/1405 Received CVE 67 Solomon's 061627 our air search radar showed plane after take off from Banana River last night joining with another plane then separation and proceeding on course 045. At exactly time SS GAINES MILL sighted flames and in exact same spot the above plane disappeared from the radar screen and never reappeared.

06/1406 NHA 38 regered for instructions at 1405R

06/1413 Mayport Boat Facility advises (Ref 1241 entry) Area was searched by blimp, Mayport Dumbo 63ft. AVR with negative results. Report evaluated as false. We are securing in this area.

06/1420 Received PT 613's 061854 "We have also encountered heave seas and one man has broken his ankle. We are forced to return to base. Request doctor and tender to be at Pier 2 at 1430."

06/1430 Received copy ComGulf's 061911 "Plane referred to you 061627 believe to be PBM missing from Banana River.

06/1433 Dinner Key advised their PBM is leaving search area. A PBY will be in the air at 1500 to release it.

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CG District Log, 7ND 0800 6 December - 0800 7 December 1945 Contd

Further Action - Previous Incidents (contd)

File No. 2273
Subject: Five TBM'S (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost

Action: 06/1445 Received CGC Ft. Pierce's 061830 "CG-83457 ETA at scene 1900R."

06/1455 Army Operations 36th Street Airport advised receipt of following message addressed for action to QUAV "Designated area give 6 hour coverage by RAF Skytrain. Negative results. Advise if additional assistance needed."

06/1515 Received PANDORA's 061938 proceeding to designated search area ETA 0300 R december 7.

06/1520 Received SC-1064's 061700" 1400 position 80-21W. 24-41 N. weather clear. Wind 10 knots, sea 2". Banana River advised at 1425R that NHA 38 advises that there is a heavy sea and will have to put into Ft. Pierce for minor repairs and oil."

06/1525 Received CGC Key Wests 061835 which reads in part SC-653 complying with your telephone message of 060955 with all possible haste."

06/1537 CGAS Dinner Key advises Vero Bumbo landed at 1502. Dinner Key PBY airborne at 1535 to relieve PBY. JRF reports search negative, and will be back about 1550.

06/1550 Dinner Key advises JRF landed 1548R.

06/1552 Search area 07 December for Orlando AAF as follows" 29-00 N 31-00W from east coast to 82-30 W 23 planes. 6 B17's 17 miscellaneous including B-26, P-47 and P-51

06/1605 CGAS Miami reports Dinner Key PBM in at 1600R.

06/1606 6 December Search Plan Jacksonville NAOTC Coast along 30-30N to 29-00N to 78-30 W.
Daytona - Coast along 29-00N to 28-00N to 79-00W
Vero Beach - Coast along 28-00N to 27-00N to 79-00W
Solomons - (no flying weather)(CVE-67) and escorts conduct surface search 29-45 N westward to 77-00W to 78-00 to Port.
Banana River 79-00W along 27-00N to 29-00N to 77-00W
Ft. Lauderdale Coast along 27-00N to 25-00N to 78-00W.
Miami CCAS 78-00W along 27-00N to 25-00N to 77-00W
Master Field - 7700W along 28-00N to 25-00N to 75-00W
RAF NASSAU - 78-00N along 25-00N to 24-00N to 76-00W.
Following Surface Craft: CVE Solomons DE-666, DE 790, CGC VIGILANT CGC PANDORA, CG-83457, CG-83497, SC-1308, NHA 38, 1x 230 1x232 - 63' AVR from New Smyrna PTS (614-617-621) SC 653

06/1706 CGAS Miami, advises Vero Bumbo in at 1706R. Miami Dumbo in search sector at 1800R.

06/1707 Sent 062149 TWL to NAS Banana River: "Investigate wrecked plane at 8 miles out on WNW leg Banana River range just south lake Poinsett. Advise.

06/1712 From SC-653, to DCCO 7ND 062030 Priority dispatch. "Position 136 degrees 9 miles from curys Reef Light. Weather excellent sea, swell 2

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CG District Log, 7ND, 0800 6 December - 0800 7 December, 1945 (Contd)

Further Action - Previous Incidents

File No. 2273
Subject:
Action: 06/1715 Five TBM'S (Ft. Lauderdale, NAS)Lost
From SC-653 to DCGO 7ND 062125 dispatch "Position 1625R. Lat. 79 degrees 45 minutes west longitude 21 degrees 30 minutes north weather good. NR23

06/1715 From CGC Ft. Pierce to DCGO 7ND 062020 Priority dispatch. For operations. CG 83497 is returning to New Smyrna to refuel due to insufficient fuel for remainder of night. Will be dispatched to scene as soon as refueled.

06/1745 From NAS Banana River 062224 TWL to ASR Miami. "Request you advise if any search is contemplated for tonight. If so we have two PBM'S Available.

06/1745 From CGAS St. Petersburg 062240 TWL "PBMS 6519, and 6574 secured from search at 1730R. Results negative.

06/1747 From Morrison Field 062135 TWL "Search plane 4018 reports negative results.

06/1750 From ASR Miami TWL to NAS Jacksonville, NAS Banana River, Morrison Field, CGAS Dinner Key, CGAS St. Petersburg, NAS Ft. Lauderdale, NAS, Miami, "Search not contemplated for tonight."

06/1831 NAS Jacksonville advises via 061650 TWL that 70 planes were employed in today's search. from NAS Jacksonville and auxiliary fields.

06/1832 To NAS Jacksonville, Morrison Field ATC, CGAS Miami, CGAS St. Petersburg, NAS, Ft. Lauderdale, 3rd Army Air Force, Boca Army Air Field, Boca Raton, via 062051 TWL: Can you furnish approximately same number planes tomorrow as furnished today. Areas will vary slightly. Will advise shortly on changes to areas.

06/1833 From ASR Miami, to NAS Jacksonville 062111 TWL, "Pass to CNADVTRA ComD. Information CVE-67 Solomons. Refer Solomons dispatch 061521 As missing personnel have not been found request Solomons and three des. search area 30-00 to 30-30 North and 77-00 to 79-00W tomorrow.

06/1835 From NAS Banana River to ASR Miami 062129 TWL"Reur 062051 ATU will be able to provide three PBM with no replacement ABTU will furnish three PBY'5's

06/1837 From NAS Jacksonville to ASR Miami 062125 TWL "We will relay your 062111 to CNAADTRA by phone. Your 062111. NAS Jacksonville has 6 PBY's available for search tomorrow

06/1840 Have received affirmative replies to 06/1832 entry from NAS Jacksonville, Morrison Field ATC, CGAS Miami, CGAS, St. Petersburg, NAS Ft. Lauderdale, 3rd Army Air Force, Boca Army Air Field, Boca Raton

06/1843 Sent 062255 TWL to NAS Banana River "Can you search 29-30 to 31-30 76-to 77W with your PBY's tomorrow and from 30-00 to 31-30N. 79-00W to coast with other planes

06/1844 To NAS Banana River TWL 062254 "Remydispatch 062149. Advise action taken.

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CG District Log, 7ND, 0800 6 December - 0800 7 December 1945 Contd

Further Action - Previous Incidents (contd)

File No. 2273
Subject:
Action: 06/1845

Five TBM8s (Ft. Lauderdale, NAS) Lost From NAS Banana River to ASR TWL "We are reasonably certain that this is what remains of a midair collision of a F-67 and a SB2c on 8 OCTOBER. However we are investigating with a PBM and a surface crash truck. The midair was in almost this exact location.

06/1900 From SC-653 to DCGO 7ND 062315 dispatch "1815R position of NW of Gun Cay distance 8 miles. Weather good sea number two.

06/1901 From SC-653 to DCGO 7ND 062200 dispatch. "1720R position. Long 25 degrees 33 minutes. North Lat. 79 degrees. 41 minutes West. Number 2 sea. Weather good.

06/1902 From NAS Jacksonville to ASR miami, 062355 TWL "NAS Jacksonville planes searched this afternoon same areas as given in our 061650. All planes have returned from search. Results negative.

06/1935 From NAS Ft. Lauderdale to CNO information CNAADTRA Jacksonville Com7 Buner Comat VS USCoips, Bupers, 062060 dispatch. "TBM'S BUNO 23307 Squadron designation FT-28 pilot Lt. Charles Carrol Taylor 1A 1/ USNR file No. 114085. Passengers Walter Reed Parport Jr. ARM 3c USNR Service No. 7141916 and Robert Francis Harmon Sol' FT36 pilot Capt. Edward Joseph Powers Jr. USMC file No. 09789 Passengers Howell Orrin Thompson Staff Sergeant USMCR service No. 499181 and George Richard Paonessa Staff Sergeant USMC FT 117 pilot Capt George William Suvers, USMC, File No. 010959 Passengers Robert Peter Cruebil Private USMCR Service No. 563782 and Robert Francis Callivan Sgt. USMC service No. 359343. TBM 1c buno 46325 squadron designation FT-81 pilot 2nd Lt. Forrest James Gerber USMCR Nave file No. 047223, Passenger William Earl Lightfood Pt. 1st Class USMCR service No. 519803. TBM1c Buno 45714 squadron designation FT-3 pilot Ensign Joseph Tipton Bassi /A1/L USNR File No. 470677 passengers Herman Arthur Thelander S/1/C USNR Service No. 7584437 and Burt Edward Baluk Jr. S/1/C USNR service No. 7149150 missing on routine over water navigational training flight overdue since 1723R 5 December 1945. Injuries to personnel undetermined. Damage to material undetermined.

06/1940 07 December 1945 Search plan Comdr. Baxter advises:

Boca Raton: 29-00N to 30-00N
79-00W to Coast, advised by telephone

NAS Miami, OPA Locka PBY's 4 approx 8 to 12 planes
28-99 N to 30-00N
77-00W to 79 00W advised by telephone

U. S. S. SOLOMONS
30-00N to 30-30N
77-00N to 79-00W, TWL to Jacksonville

Miami, ATC
26-00N to 27-00N
76-00W to 77-00W, advised by telephone

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CG District Log, 7ND 0800 6 December - 0800 7 December, 1945 Contd

File No.: 2273
Subject:
Action: 06/1940

Further Action - Previous Incidents Contd

Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost
CGAS, Miami 27-00N to 28-00N
26-00N to 77-00W
PBM Search 28-00N to 29-30N
76-00W to 77-00W, advised by telephone
Jacksonville PBY's 29-30N to 31-30N
76-00W to 77-00W, advised by TWL
RAF Nassau 25-00N to 26-00N
76-00W to 78-00W, advised by 062315 dispatch
Daytona Beach, Dumbo 28-30N and 29-30N
77-00W to 78-30W, advised by TWL via B. R.
Vero Dumbo 27-00 N to 28-30N
77-00 W to 78-00W, advised by TWL via B. R.
NAS, Banana River 28-30 N to 31-30N
77-00W to 78-00W, advised by TWL
3rd Air Force 26-30N to 29-00N
82-00W to Coast(West) advised by TWL Via Morr. Field
CGAS St. Petersburg 26-00N to 28-00N
Off shore to 83-30W advised by TWL
ATC, Morrison Field 28-00N to 29-00N
78-30W to 80-00W, advised by TWL
NAS Ft. Lauderdale 26-30N to 28-00N
77-30 W to Coast, advised by telephone
NAS Jacksonville, Cecil Field 30-N 30-27N
15SB2c Coast to 79 W, advised by TWL
NAS Key West 24-30N to 26-00W
Coast to 83-30W, advised by telephone
25' F6F's available for search plus 2 SNB's
Orlando AAF 29-00N to 31-00N
Westward to 82-30W, advised by telephone
MAAS Mayport 10 planes 31-12N 31-30 Sunrise
Coast to 79-W
NAS Jacksonville 10F4us 30-27N 30-54N Coast to 79W
10 SNJS 30-54N 31-12N Coast to 79

06/1941 Ft. Lauderdale NAS advises "Boca Raton (1930) called Ft. Lauderdale and advised "At 1113R 6 december heard SOS on 3870Kcs and thought call was 756 or 757 shortly after heard steady note as if key tied down on 3060 Kcs" for check

06/1942 Checked with Evaluation center army 36 St. they know nothing about 06/1941 entry

06/1943 Checked with Army operations 36 St. Can supply on informal Army reports Requested Army check with Boca Raton

06/1944 From DCGO 7ND To Nassau Bahama - Oak Field 062315 OP dispatch "Request you search following area on seventh colon 25-00 to 26-00 North 76-00 to 78-00 West. Communication plan same as on sixth. Acknowledge

06/1945 From NAS Banana River to Sec NAV information CNAATC JPRL ComSeven CNATRA DNCLA 062015 dispatch "Three PBM aircraft departed this station evening of 5 december on air sea rescue mission in connection

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Further Action - Previous Incidents Contd

File No. 2273
Subject:
Action: 06/1945

Five USN's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) lost
with five overdue Tare Baker Fix aircraft from Ft. Lauderdale. American SS CAINES VIII reported observing explosion at 1950 near Lat 28-58N long 80-28W and subsequently reported seeing plane crash that vicinity. This position coincided with estimated position of FIVE aircraft Buno 59225 and radio contact with this plane was last established at 1927 immediately after plane had taken off. Search of area by Caines VIII and by boat from New Smyrna failed to located. Any survivors but CAINES VIII reported having sighted debris in area but due to sea conditions none recovered. boat from New Smyrna to area from 2250 until daylight when relieved by other boat and search air craft. have failed to find any evidence of crash. USN aircraft BUNO 59225 had five officers and 9 enlisted men on board. Surface and air search continued. All time used in this dispatch Zone.

06/1946 CGS Jacksonville advises 070040 TWL "Recr 06211 CNAAUTRA advises they have complied with your request and message has been answered by dispatch

06/1955 From NAS Banana River to NSR Miami, 0700 GC TWL "Recr 062254. TB 60 searched reported area with negative results. We has been secured at Banana River at 1945R. Ground units are still investigating.

06/2000 From CNAAUTRACOMD to ComGulf, DCGO 7ND NAAS at Mayport Fla. CUE 67 Solomons 06221 Priority dispatch "Following received ComGulf quote have Solomons and Des. search area thirty degrees to thirty minutes north. seventy seven degrees to seventy nine degrees west tomorrow morning unquote reply

06/2001 From CGC Ft. Pierce to DCGO 7ND information ComGulf 062350 Priority dispatch "Following received from CG-83457 quote Sea conditions no five wind eighteen knots and increasing. Request permission return to base due to weather conditions unquote. CG-83497 returned to Ponce De Leon 385ta. at 1820R for refueling. Struck bottom crossing bar and damaged screw resulting in considerable vibration. Consider it inadvisable dispatch CG-83497 back to scene Advise concerning these two vessels.

06/2002 From SC-554 to DCGO 7ND information CGC Key West 061830 dispatch "1515R position Abeam alligator. Reef light. Weather good sea 1 swell.

06/2003 From SC-955 to DCGO 7ND 061915 dispatch "1415R Position 1FC degrees 3 miles from Molasses Reef weather excellent sea 1 swell 2.

06/2004 From CNAAUTR ComD to ComGulf information CUE 67 Solomons, DCGO 7ND 062200 Priority dispatch. "Re USS Solomons 061521. Employ USS Solomons to fullest extent as your deem necessary

06/2005 From SC-353 to DCGO 7ND 062125 dispatch. Position 1625R position 79 degrees 45 minutes west latitude 21 degrees 30 min. North. Weather good. Number 2 sea. Swells 2

06/2054 VIGILANT advises on position at 2000R relayed by NAS BANANA River 070126 TWL

06/2058 SC-353 advises 2015R position 345 degrees 8 miles from Great Isaac Light. Number [illegible] Miles 5. Northwest wind. Weather clear. Barometer

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CG District Log, 7ND 0800 6 December, 1945 - 0800 7 December 1945 Contd

Further Action - Previous Incidents (Contd)

File No. 2273
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost
Action: 06/2100 From Mayport to ComGulf 070200 TWL "Following received from NTHV (SC-1308). Have reached position am commencing box search. Sea condition slight swells. Rader inoperative.

06/2235 From Mayport to ComGulf 070302 TWL "Following received from (NTHV)(SC-1308) have completed search of area. Wind has freshened. Sea rough. Request permission to secure. Request instructions.

06/2300 ComEast requested we include Canadian Aux. Schooner "LA Havie" in TBM Search advised decision rested with Comdr. Baxter will advise.

06/2301 From DCGO 7ND To CGC Ft. Pierce information ComGulf 070205 Priority dispatch. "Ur dispatch 062350. Recall CG-83457.to base. Hold CG-83497 pending further orders. Have both vessels ready for sea on short notice.

06/2302 From SC 653 to DCGO 7ND 070230 dispatch "2115 position 010 degrees 9 miles from Great Isaac Light. Number 1 sea number 2 swells wind northwest 15 knots barometer 29R93.

06/2303 06 December search as follows
ATC, Miami 5.3 hours
Third AAF 5.6 hours 10 planes from Sarasota 6 planes from McDill ATC, Morrison Field 2 planes unknown time.

07/0010 Received following 070430 message from SC-653 via Boat Facilities Ft. Everglades Your 061737. On station carrying out search instr.

07/0027 Received following 062328 from CVE 69 Solomons to DCGO 7ND Refur 062111. Will comply.

07/0030 Received following 062015 dispatch from NAS Banana River to Secnav Information Com7 "3PBM aircraft departed this station evening of 5 December on air sea rescue mission in connection 4 overdue TBF Aircraft from Ft. Lauderdale. American SS GAINES MILLS reported observing explosion at 1950 near lat. 28-50N Long 80-25W and subsequently reported seeing plane crash that vicinity. The position coincided with estimated position of PBM Aircraft Buno 59225 and radio contact with this plane was last established at 1927 immediately after plane had taken off. Search of area by GAINES MILL and by boat from New Smyrna failed to locate any survivors but GAINES MILL reported having sighted debris in area but due to sea conditions none recovered. Boat from New Smyrna in area from 2250 until daylight when relieved by other boat and search aircraft have failed to find any evidence of crash. Have failed to find any evidence of crash. PBM Aircraft Buno 59225 had 5 Officers and 8 enlisted men on board. Surface and air search continues. All times used in this dispatch are Roger.

07/0050 Received following 070540 message from NAS Jacksonville NAS Jacksonville Search planes for 7 December are as follows all planes scheduled to depart at sunrise. Six PBYS will search area 29-30 to 31-30 N.to 77W. Cecil Field will have 15 SB2CS 30-27N Coast to 79W. Mayport will have 10 planes 31-12 to 31-30 coast to 79W. NAS Jacksonville will have fifteen F4US 30-27N 30-54N Coast to 79 and TOSNJS 30-54N 31-12 N Coast to 79"

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CG District Log, 7ND 0800 6 December - 0800 7 December 1945 Contd

Further Action - Previous Incidents Contd

File No. 2273
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS, Ft. Lauderdale) Lost
Action: 07/0103 Received following 070538 dispatch from SC 653 0015 DR position 26-11 north 76-34 west weather follows 43801376

07/0235 Received following message 070726 from SC-653 0215R position 26-11 north 78-34 west. Have searched five miles square. Results negative. Am extending search. Weather 448111365

07/0235 Received following 062320 dispatch from Com 7 to ComGulf "Your 061434. Am searching area fifteen miles wide from 28-06 North 76-46 west at 061130 Roger to Charleston Whistle buoy.

07/0257 Received following 070555 message from SC-1064 "0100 position 24 degrees 39 min. North 79 degrees 22 min west weather cloudy wind 16 knots NE Sea 3

07/0415 Received following message from the USAT Ernest HINDS at 0805 GMT 4 miles off our stbd quarter. Two dim lights separated about one half mile apart were sighted one blinker the word Call unable to distinguish any more signals our position at time was 30.08 North 79-33 west speed 15 knots course 003

07/0420 Passed 07-0415 entry to NAS Jacksonville and NAS Mayport via 070918 message TWL

07/0420 Received following 070730 dispatch from SC-1064 "0200 position 79 degrees 20 minutes west 24 degrees 18 min north weather clear wind 16 knots NE SEA 3

07/0500 Received following 070924 dispatch from SC-653 "0450R estimated position 26-23 north 78-30 west. Weather 47816135

07/0514 Sent following 071014 TWL message to all ASR "Advise time upon departure of all units to participate in TBM search this date.

07/0549 Received 070845 dispatch from CGC PANDORA Reference your 061736. PANDORA on position.

07/0554 Received 071045 dispatch from SC-653 0545 R estimated position 26-18N 78-38 W. weather 45811363

07/0559 Received following TWL message from CGAS Dinner Key, "Miami Dumbo PBM 6596 over the side 0515 R Airbourne 0541R.

07/0612 Received following TWL message from CGAS St. Pete. Reference ur 071014 two PBM on search at approximately 0800R.

07/0700 Received following 071145 message from SC-653 "0645Rest position 26-24 North 76-16 West. Weather 6511364

07/0703 Sent following 071201 message to NAS Banana River "Do you have any additional planes that could search in area 30-00 to 31-30 and 74-00 to 76-00.

07/074 Sent following 071204 to SC-1308 via Boat Facilities Mayport. "Proceed for SC-1308. Proceed to 31-00 north and 80-00 west and make square search. Advise departure.

07/0705 Received following 070855 dispatch from SC-1064 "0400 position 79 degrees 43 minutes west. 24 degrees 21 minutes north weather clear wind 16 knots NE Sea 3

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Further Action - Previous Incidents (Contd)

File No. 2273
Subject:
Action: 07/0735

Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost
Sent following 071221 dispatch to all ASR on TAL
"Include in search notify planes and vessels your command. Missing schooner named LA HAVRE. Painted white, two masted white deck house between masts. Also note that following rescue vessels are making searches at positions indicated. PANDORA Call NRCO guarding 2670 and 3000 position 2900 North 77-00 west. VIGILANT call NRWC Guarding 26-70 and 3000 position 28-00 north 78-00 West. SC-1038 from Mayport in position 31-00 north and 80-00 West SC-653 from Key West in position 26-00 north and 76-30 west. Solomons CVE 67 and escorts from Mayport position approximately 30-00 to 30-30 North and 77-00 to 79-00 west.
Above message also sent via dispatch to NAS OPA Locka, NAS FT. Lauderdale, CG Group, Key West, Orlando Army Air Base, Boca Raton Army, CVE 67 Solomons RAF Nassua.
Received following 061230 from Morrison Field "Army 3270 PBY Departed Morrison 1220Z destination area 28 to 29 degrees north 78 30 to 80 degrees west on search.
Received following 071234 message from CGAS Dinner Key Miami dumbo on area Commencing search to east. Vero Dumbo airbourne at 1220Z.

07/0755 Received following 071242 message from SC-653 "0740R estimated position 26-12 north 78-12 north 78-18 west. Weather 65711464"

W. T. MURPHY, Lt.Comdr USCG

Approved:

Wm. Wisher, Captain, USCG

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CG District Log 7ND 0800 7 December 0800 8 December 1945

07/0801 Lt. R.F. Sauer on duty.
07/0815 Yeo. Calhoun and Ross reported
07/0825 Lt. (jg) S.G. Perret reported
07/0826 Sea. Neely reported
07/0830 Lt. Comdr. W.T. Murphy reported
07/0900 CG-38473 arrived at base with ANNE in tow
07/1220 Following 071600 received from CGC, Key West, Recur 062045, DONA D returned safe to Key West at 1015"
07/1555 Lt. (jg) G.F. Koch reported
07/1559 End of watch
07/1601 Comdr. R. Baxter, Lt. Comdr. W.T. Murphy, Lt. Sauer, Lt. (jg) G.F. Koch Lt.(jg) S.G. Perret, Yeo, Neely, Ross, Calhoun on duty pending action on incidents file "2256,2260,2269,2272,2273,2277,2278,2279
07/1700 Lt. (jg) S.G. Perret, Yeo, Neely, Ross, Calhoun departed
07/1706 Received 072003 Pr. dispatch from CGC, Ft. Pierce to DCSO 7ND; "CG-83457 hit submerged object in channel. Port screw bent badly. R called to base. Advise.
07/1730 Lt. R.F. Sauer departed
07/1800 Lt. Comdr. W.T. Murphy departed
07/1829 Comdr. Baxter departed
07/1830 From DCGO 7ND to CGC Ft. Pierce 072205 Priority dispatch Recur 072003 Have CG-83457 remain at base until further orders.
07/2100 CGC Miami advised CG-38505 stand by in assisting retrieve of corpse found at Royal Palms by John Corly, Gibson Hotel, Miami, while fishing. Miami Police took action body identified as John A. Force (negro age 55)
07/2400 Ens. C.V. DeGeorge reported for duty.
08/001 Lt. (jg) G.F. Koch and Ens. C.V. DeGeorge on duty pending action on incidents.
08/0025 Lt. (jg) Koch departed
08/0025 On advise of Gulfron dispatch 071545 and Lt. Demerrit, Ais to Nav. Officer sent following 080825 to CG Radio Hialeah and Egmont Key and CG Group, Key West "For special and next two regular broadcasts. USCG notice to Mariners. 2420 ton steel TCI barges lost by tug FRANK T. SPENCER 1955 Roger 22-20N 84-50W. Another lost 1015R 5th 23-11N 84-27W Menance to Navig.
08/0755 Lt. R.F.Sauer reported
08/0759 End of Watch.

Current Incidents

File No. 2281
Action: Current
Subject: Flares sighted 10 miles SW Melbourne
Origin: CAA Miami
Location: 10 miles SW of Melbourne

Action: 08/0205 CAA Miami advised that the Eastern Airlines trip 56 in position 10 miles southwest of Melbourne had red flare shot at him and had observed a flashing light on lands. Planes is now circling area.

08/0207 Sent following 080707 message to NAS, Banana River "CAA Miami advised Eastern Air Lines trip 56 position 10 miles southwest Melbourne at 0158R had red flare shot at him and observed flashing light. Is circling area which is swamp. Investigate and advise.

08/0203 In answer to NAS Banana River and on advise of CAA Miami sent following to NAS B.R. He is now transmitting to Melbourne on 3117.5 call Eastern 56.

08/0213 Sent following 080113 to NAS Banana River on advise of CAA Miami Eastern 56 in proceeding on way. Advises he believes he saw man at scene but no sign of wreckage.

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Current Incidents (cont'd)

File No. 2281
Subject:

Flares sighted 10 miles SW Melbourne
is standiat by at scene and is still hindered by heavy ground
fog. JRM to take off at 0630R to aid on land search. NPM is
working land crash on 4730 as much as possible. Jeep weasel
and amphibious craft left vero beach. Pilot of Eastern Air Lines
No. 56 reports via ATC he saw one or men around fire.

08/0631 Sent following 081131 message to NAS Banana River "Do you wish to have Dumbo from N. Pete aid in search at scene of flare.

08/0648 Rec'd 081141. Not just now. Ground fog covering area hampering search. JRM Numo 66-16 off at 0630R to search area of reported fire midway between Melbourne and Orlando.

08/0726 Sent following 081220 message to MacDill Field "Red flare, flashing lights seen near 28-00 north and 80-50 west. Can you search area making expanding square search that point.

08/0735 MacDill Field advised via TWL "The only aircraft we have is AT-11 and L-5S, is that okay, if so we will locate area you mentioned in your 122933.

08/0230 Rec'd from NAS Banana River 081227 message. Fog still thick do not advise more than one aircraft in the area. Navy 66410 is conducting search in that area with ground lits.last night.

08/0743 Sent 081238 message to MacDill Field "Be advised that heavy ground fog exists at present . Suggest caution due to other plane in area Sent 081233 message to NAS to NAS Jacksonville, Suggest blimp to sea- area west of Melbourne. Acknowledge
Rec'd 081239 message from NAS Banana River Aerology Banana River advise that fog will lift at 0900R. Daytona dumbo on position of reported fire has 300 feet of fog standing by over position.

08/0749 From NAS Jacksonville, "We have no blimp."

08/0743 Rec'd following 081201 dispatch from CVE 67 Solomons "Request information of reported fire Mac- who is coordinating search No instructions received.

08/0750 C Condr. Baxter advised to disregard 080743 entry.
Rec'd following 081252 message from Mayport to Banana River, "There is a blimp coming down from Charleston today. Operations officer suggests it should be used in this area due to location of its home base.

08/0755 Received following 081255 message from NAS Banana River "Suggest Banana River task unit handle flare search with land planes. Vero to proceed on previously assigned offshore search. Daytona dumbo and one land plane are handling flare search.

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Current Incidents (cont'd)

Folio 0. 2211
Subject:

Flares sighted 10 miles SE Melbourne

08/0214 Rec'd follow[illegible] 080714 from NAS Banana River "Vero Bumbo alerted at 0211R.

08/0234 On advice of [illegible] sent following 080227 Dispatch to NAS Banana River "Eastern 56 advises large fire observed half way between Melbourne and Orlando approx. 20 miles from position of flare.
Rec'd following 080730 dispatch from NAS Banana River Vero reports that Vero Bumbo out of commission will be 1 to 2 hours. Navy 70435 circling position now. Reports another red flare 15 miles inland bearing 240 from Melbourne NAS.

08/0243 Rec'd 080 730 from NAS Banana River "Refer ur 080727. Daytona Bumbo alerted at 0237R."

08/0256 Rec'd 080820 from NAS Banana River, "Received from NAS Daytona, 0812, Daytona Bumbo airbourne we will have to relay instructions to him through NAS Daytona.

08/0327 From NAS Banana River 080825 dispatch, Disregard my 080820.

08/0353 Sent following 080827 dispatch to NAS Banana River, Refer my 080707 have any land units been dispatched to assist in search.
Rec'd 080830 from NAS Banana River "Refer ur 080827. Negative. Banana River land units preparing to go weasel out of commission. NAS Melbourne on caretaker status.

08/0359 Rec'd 080837 from NAS Banana River VP-1 off at 0350R. He is vero ready plane guarding 3000 Kcs. voice. CPS is in contact with him.

08/0402 Rec'd following 080857 from NAS Banana River Daytona Bumbo airbourne at 0350R.

08/0437 Rec'd following 080935 message from NAS Banana River. Is the F/DF not able to take bearings over land about 15 miles inland. Answered affirmative.

08/0938 Rec'd following 080933 message from NAS Banana River. Will alert you when we want act. The freq. will be 4200 Kcs C/W. The position will be bearing 240 degrees 12 miles from NAS Melbourne. Received following 080947 from NAS Banana River two jeeps and one ambulance departed Banana River for scene at 0440R. One weasel and two amphibious craft preparing to depart Vero Beach.

08/0550 NAS Banana River advised by 08120 message; "Pilot of VP-1 is here and has reported that he definitely saw silohette of a man at reported crash.
Sent following 081020 message to NAS Banana River: What have you learned about the reported fire. Is there any connections between this and the flares.
Rec(d 081027 message from NAS Banana River. Had to divert Daytona Bumbo from the fire to position of flares to relieve VP-1. VP-1 was low on fuel and had to return to Banana River. We have plane ready to gas soon from here.

08/0618 NAS Banana River advised by 081114 message, Daytona Bumbo

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CG District Log 7ND 7 December to 0800 8 December, 1945 cont'd

Current Incidents (cont'd)

File No. 2282
Action: Current
Subject: 3 Barges lost by tug FRANK W. SPENCER
Origin: Gulfcon Havana
Location: NW of Cape San Antonia Cuba
Action: 08/0205 Received following 071545 dispatch from Gulfcon to DCGO 7ND "2-420 ton steel TCI barges lost by Tug FRANK W. SPENCER 1955 Roger 4th 22-20N 84-50W, another lost 1015 Roger 5th 23-11N 84-27W. Menace to navigation.
08/0300 Passed above info to Lt. DeMerritt, Aide to Nav. Officer.
08/0315 Controller requested tug from Supsol, New York upon request of Eastseafron for ComGulf to take action.
No action taken for aid search pending permission to use tug and advise of Comdr. Baxter.
08/0515 CGAS Miami advises a JRF would be available for this search.

File No. 2280
Action: Current
Subject: 18-T-308 Swan Overdue
Origin: CG Group, Key West, 072015 dispatch
Location: Key West to Harbor Key
Action: 07/1630 Rec'd following 072015 dis from CGG Key West to DCGO 7ND: "Aux sail boat Swan 18-T-308 overdue at Key West from Harbor Key area. Departed Key West 5 Dec. for 3 days fishing. CG-38398 departed at 1430R to search area. Key West Dumbo will search area approx. 1600R.
07/2050 From CGG Key West to DCGO 7ND-07235 dis: "Re our 072015 Vessel arrived Key West approximately 1800. No assistance required or rendered.
07/2059 CGAS Miami advises Key West Dumbo out at 1527R - in 1805R. Incident closed.

File No. 2279
Action: Current
Subject: YTL-168, Aground
Origin: Navy Operations Office, 7ND
Location: Shell Bank, ICW, near Tavernier
Action: 07/1400 Lt. Comdr. Nann, 7ND Oper. Office reports the Navy tug YTL-168 with barge in tow is aground and Navy requests CG assistance. Tug aground shortly after midnight. Attempt was made at next high tide, unsuccessful.
07/1401 Passed all above info to Lt. Comdr. Stellinger, CGG, Miami. He reports he will send alert CG-83504 to assist.
07/1402 Advised Lt. Comdr. Schmidt, 7ND, Operations, assistance would be sent.
07/1403 Passes information to Controller.
07/1430 CGG, OOD, Miami reports CG-83594 departed to assist YTL-168.
07/2100 CGG Miami advises: "CG-83504 on scene at 072000-YTL-168 in ICW - will await favorable tide in morning.

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Further Action on Previous Incidents

File No. 2256
Subject: Two (2) F6F Crashes
Action: 08/0150 Rec'd following 080305 dis from CG Group Key West, "This is routing report covering plane crash Key West harbor. Action already completed.
A-F6F 94120 Boca Chica Naotu
B-Pilot was apparently blinded when caught in glare of search lights and crashed while attempting to maneuver clear.
C-1926R 27 Nov. Thought to have been approximately 1500 yds. 315 degrees from true from entrance to Basin NOB
D-1927R advised ASR Controller Boca Chica by phone.
E-Advise by Military duty officer NOB via telephone.
F-ASR Controller Boca Chica. Who had previously ordered crash boats CG-63063 and 63083 to secure to scene of plane crash near Boca Chica Grande deverted 63083 to scene of second crash at approximately 1930R. CG-38796 dispatched to assist at 1955R. CG-63083 arrived area approximately 1950. CG-38796 arrived area approx. 1950. CG-38796 arrived area 1945
G-Ens. Cecil Yound Dingler Jr. USNR killed.
H-CG-63083. CG-38796 and numerous launches and small craft from NOB
I-Unknown
J-Crashed plane and body of pilot unrecovered after exhaustive search northwest channel and inner harbor by aircraft dragging and sound equipment search abandoned this date. Incident closed.

File No. 2275
Subject: Cabin Cruiser Needs Assistance
Action: 07/1040 Received CG Group, Key West 071450 "ARIADNE arrived Key West with cabin cruiser New Eraat 0020R. Crew members were Frank J. Williams, Larvo M. Williams, of 1320 SW, 13th St. Miami and William Moore, NW 54th St. Miami. Vessel disabled due to loss of both rudders. Towed to Thompsons Railway, Key West at 0930R.
Incident closed.

File No. 2277
Subject: Overdue Sponge Boat-DONA D 2
Action: 07/1235 Received ASR Controller Key West 071536- "Dona D 2 returned to Key West under own power. Went fishing longer than expected."
Incident closed.

File No. 2278
Subject: Canadian Aux. Schooner "La Havre"
Action: 07/0830 All planes from all field and surface craft were alerted to be on lookout for La Havre.
07/1300 Mr. Harriman called and notified of above.

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Further Action on Previous Incidents cont'd

File No. 2273
Subject: Five TBM's (USS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost
Action: 07/0300 Rec'd following 071250 message from MacDill Field, "Are there any additional instructions or new area for us to search today."
Sent following 061253 msg. to USS Jacksonville, Advise when and how you received info on missing TBM and what action did you take. Also advise same on TBM from Nat. River.
Sent following 071257 disp. to USS Banana River, Advise time of receipt of first info on missing TBM's and how received. Also advise departure of return times of search planes first night.
07/0302 Sent msg to MacDill Field Tampa asking: "Do you have any four engine search planes. How many"
MacDill Field replied: Do not have any for search. May have some later.
07/0310 Sent msg to MacDill stating: No further requests at present. If large planes become available please advise.
07/0323 Sent msg to CG Ft. Pierce, 071317, stating: "Request you have CG-83497 make square search in following area 29N and 79-45W. CG-83457 to make similar search in 27-45N and 79-30W. Advise ETD and ETA, give hourly reports on position.
07/0310 Ops Duty Officer Opa Locka advised that a man had reported three TBM fly west over South Miami at 1045R 5 Dec. Comdr. Baxter evaluated this info as of no value.
07/0325 Dinner Key reported that Lower search area would be unable to cover until got plane in operation again. Would notify us. At noon would send 2 out to relieve 2 conducting search in upper area assigned.
07/0325 Rec'd copy of dispatch sent by Navy Controller to CTG 67.7 (Marenhalt CO 491 and Lillian J. Patterson AOT 104), 071240 stating: Five TBM's down from Ft. Lauderdale departed 051015. Approx. radio fix 29-30N and 7900W. Banana River, 1 missing since 060027. Last reported position 29-59N and 80-25W. Request you alert and search as wide area as possible to your destination. Action to CTG 67.7.
07/0330 Ft. Laud. Operations reported that at 0815R they had 30 planes out on their assigned search. Ground fog had closed field in until 0715R.
07/0330 Asked Morrison Field (AACS) 071301 if they could deliver msg. to Orlando Army Air Base and Boca Raton Army Air Base. Morrison Field said would, and requested they pass to them to have their planes alerted for missing schooner La Havre. Also relayed info on the various surface vessels conducting search for missing planes.
07/0340 Rec'd message from Boca Raton 071534 giving take off times of their land planes for 7 Dec:

Number	Take off
1 OL 32	0649
41	0700

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CG District Lor, 7th 0300 7 December; 1145 to 0300 8 December, 1945 cont'd

Further Actions Previous Incidents cont'd

File No. 2273
Subject: Five TBM's (VT-28 Ft. Lauderdale) Lost
Action: 07/0840(cont'd)

	Number	Take off
	30	0849
	23	0058
	13	0054
	7	0702
	53	0730
	57	0726
aker	60	0800
Baker	73	0757

The last two planes are TBY 5 airplanes

07/0845 Rec'd message from Mt. Over. Comt Facility 071339, stating: SC-1064 reports her position at 0800Z as 24-23 and 79-33. Weather cloudy, winds 18 knots, Sea 3.

07/0846 Rec'd msg from . Wilfer, 071341, stating: Refer 071257 Upon inquiry to NOC Miami at 1652Z this unit was advised at 1700Z that flight of planes were lost near Fla Keys, and that U.S. Guard Dinner Key was standing by. At 1810Z received from [illegible] Comt Facilities Mt. Over. by telephone the info that 5 TBM's were missing from training flight approx. 180 miles E of Bahama Banks."

07/0855 Rec'd message from USAF General George Stronds, 071220, stating: Referring broadcast 5 planes lost my position 12306 GCT, 20-40 74-49. Course 300° speed 15 knots."

07/0900 Rec'd msg from Morrison Field, 061349, stating Army 4313 PBY departed Morrison Field 13452. Destination area 28-29 to 78-30 degrees west. On search.

07/0912 Sent dispatch to CUB 07 USS SOLOMONS, 071403, stating: "Advise if planes may be used today. If so suggest planes to search present area and to 31-30. Six radar operators on afternoon 5 Dec over follow a flight of 5 planes in area 27-00 to 28 North and 76 to Coast. Info very important.

07/0915 Rec'd copy of dispatch from ComEast to all U.S. Nav Ships, info ComGulf, 070523 stating: "Request Naval ships in Atlantic Coastal Area keep sharp lookout for auxiliary schooner [illegible] NAVAL enroute Liverpool N. Scotia to Miami overdue Miami since 29 Nov. Left Liverpool 22 Nov. app, speed 3.5. White hull, 2 mast, Gold head, white deck-house between fore and main."

07/0917 Sent msg to N. River, 071359, stating: "Do you have any additional search planes for area 28-30 to 28-00 and 75-00 to 76-00 rather than 30-00 to 31-30. Same longitude. Urgent.

07/0917 Rec'd ans from . River, to above, 071403, stating: We have 3 PBM's and one PBY available.
Sent msg to N. River, 071405, "Search that area 28-30 to 30-00n and 75-00 to 76 .
Banana River said: Willco, will advise you time of take off.

07/0920 Sent msg to MacDill Field Tampa, 071409, stating: If any B-29's are avilable would appreciate a search out in

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CG District Log, 7ND 0800 December 7 to 8 December, 1945 Cont'd

Further Action on Previous Incidents Cont'd

File No. 2275
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost
Action: Atlantic, Advise, Area planned considered vital 28 to 30 N and 74 to 75 W.
McDill Field, in 071409, states "At the present time that would be almost impossible as per directive Continental Air Forces that all aircraft are having check for some type of tech. order compliance there maybe some available this afternoon. Will let you know as soon as they are checked.

07/0925 Rec'd msg from Jax, 071416, stating: "Rec'd report at 0906R this date from Civilian J. E. Coles Address 27 Tr. St. Jacksonville, Phone 5-2279 that at 0550R Dec., while driving bus between Barberville and De Leon Springs, Fla. saw a very bright solid blue flame that lasted about 30 seconds and lighted entire area. No explosion heard but believed one occurred." Request NAS Delant investigate. Banana River sent msg. to Jax, 071420, stating: "This is ASR duty officer. I saw that blue white flame on the morning of 5 Dec. It couldn't have been anything that a meterorite, traveling at a tremendous speed."

07/0940 Rec'd msg from B. R. 071359, stating: Training land 29 PBM's and Baker 56 PBY are the only planes available here. Third PBM grounded. They will take off immediately. Is this soon enough or do you want us to pull planes from the previously already assigned areas.

07/0940 Rec'd message from Pt. Myer. Boat Facility, NDKQ stating his position at 0900R as 24-23N and 79-36W. Weather overcast wind 18 knots. NW Sea 3.

07/0940 Rec'd msg from SS SINCLAIR HC, 0713203, stating: One Navy 2 engine plane appearance PBM 3 typemarked with letters RP near bow of fuselage seen flying approx, SE course at about 500 ft. from position 28-10N and 79-56 W. 061430 GMT wind westerly force 8.

07/0947 Rec'd msg from ASR Controller B. Chica, Key West, 071356, stating: Key West Dumbo and assisting planes from B. Chica will cover area from 24-30N and 25N and from coast to 83-30W. PBY5A 48294 Pilot guild Co. Pilot Lockwood crew Jones AMM1/c Keller AMM3/c, Wyman AMM3/c departed 0820 search for five TBM.

07/0947 Rec'd msg from USAT Ernest Hinds, 071400, stating: Please cancel my info concerning two dim lights sighted at 0705 GCT. Radarmen aboard report they were ships on one starboard quarter at time. Ref was 0805 GCT- which stated: "4 miles off our stbd quarter 2 dim lights separated about one half mile apart were sighted one clinked the word call". Unable to distinguish.

07/1007 Rec(d message from B. River, 071503, stating: We are asking AHEU to have two PBY standby here. They will reply if they can get two in readiness.

07/1007 Rec'd copy of message from B. River to Jax, 071446, stating: Reur 071416 we have dispatched Sanford and Deland ready planes to investigate reported flames seen between Barberville and De Leon Springs on 5 Dec.

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CO District Ltr, Y-3 0800 7 December to 0800 8 December, 1945 cont'd

Vilo C. 2275
Subject:
Action: 07/1007

Further Action on revious Incidents
Five T's (Lt. Underdale) Lost
Rec'd msg from Jax, 071450, stating: Refur 071257, [illegible]
Jax intercepted first msg at 1937Z. 6 Dec. between Pan.
River and Apport con Pacilition, regarding T's being
overdue and requesting that Apport Control be sent. ost
msgs were garbled and none were addresses to this station.
At 0242Z this station rec'd a long distance call from Condr.
Dexter from Jax informing us of planes overdue and giving last
reported position. At 1034Z Jax alerted all aux
fields requesting a check and had all lighting equipment
turned on. The same action was taken by NAS Jax. ATC Jax
was alerted to check fields in area for planes overdue. No
definite action was requested for NAS Jax to take until 2300
6 Dec when search area for following morning discussed.
At 2222Z 6 Dec, msg 080022 from Jax River rec'd following
info on reported explosion and failure to communicate with
searching [illegible]. No action was required by NAS Jax. Is
this report complete enough or can we furnish further info.

07/1007 Sent msg to Jax River, 071502, Refur 071430. Do not take
off on planes reviously assigned. Take off of planes
is soon enough.

07/1008 Rec'd dispatch from SC-853, 071350 stating: 0345Z MST.
Position 26-00 and 78-02 . Weather 66711004.

07/1015 Rec'd dispatch from SC-853, via Ft. Ever Boat Facility,
071300, 0245Z Posit. 350-00 miles from Great Stirrup Light.
Weather 0671 1504. Is all this traffic from SC's necessary
as it is jamming freq. for the many planes operating in
search area on this frequency.

07/1013 Rec'd msg from [illegible] 071505 stating: Ref my 071430,
training 1 is grounded and we have other . that has only
13 hrs on it since major overhaul. Is this urgent enough
to send out this plane.

07/10 20 Chas. "S" officer reported by phone that SC's 310 and 313
were searching until 1600Z in area 29-30 and 78-. Passed
to him the info regarding search for 07 Dec.

0 7/1025 Sent msg to Ft. River stating we would call their operations
officer by phone regarding search , and in regards to search
for blue flame sighted over land.

07/1033 Rec msg from Jax 071525 stating; Refur 070623, requesting
total flight hours and no. of planes used in FBM search 6
Dec. Total flying time for NAS Jax planes 203.4, Mayport
48.8, Cecil Field 97, 203.4, Mayport 48.8, Cecil Field 97,
total 349 hours 12 mins. Total No. planes used in 6 Dec.
search 124, 70 planes were used in morning search and 54
in afternoon. This includes NAS Jax Mayport and Cecil Field.

07/1033 Sent message to Ft. River. oat Facility; asking what freq.
are SC's using in sending position reports and other info.
SC 853 is on search for TB's also. Ft. Ever. Boat Facility
SC-853 is using 3000 Kcs.

07/1045 Rec'd message from [illegible]. stating: Refur 071430, Ltr 071551.
One PBM in dir. Do you wish him to proceed without other
PBM.

33 07/1050 Condr. Dexter called Ft. River Oper. Officer, and he stated
they had 8 planes left on assigned search, and 2 now searching

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Further action of Previous Incidents

File No. 2273
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost
Action: on the crash of their PBM. PBY's and possibly four would search new area of 29-30 to 28 30N and 74 to 75-00W.

07/1053 Sent msg. to PT-601, 602, 603, 604, 07/1504 stating: While enroute Mayport request you alert your boats for possible survivors of 5 TBM's and 1 PBM missing since evening of 5 December. Have men keep sharp lookout along coast and seaward particularly in area north of 28N. Pick up and report to Com 7 ASR officer any wreckage which seems pertinent.

07/1100 SC-1064 sends her 0900 posit. 07/1400 as 24-23N and 79-36W. Weather overcast wind 18 knots NW Sea 3.

07/1105 B. River reported to Jax. 071645, that: Have searched area of reported flame seen by bus driver. DeLand and Sanford ready planes report negative this search

07/1118 Recd message from B. River 071615, stating: Refur 071359 Training 29 in air already proceeded at 1100R. PBY off at 1051R. Another PBY getting ready. NHA requests to return getting ready. NHA request to return to base. Told them to secure NHA 38.

07/1105 SC-663 reports position as 25-52 N, and 77-35W. Weather 6571 16 64.

07/1125 Sent msg to SC-655, 071617, stating: Request you send only distress traffic over 3000 Kcs. Do not send position and weather reports on this frequency.

07/1130 Rec'd msg. from CUE 67 SOLOMONS, 071520, stating: Air search radar SC red afternoon of 5th. Can use planes today. Am complying your 071403.

07/1130 Rec'd message from CGG Ft. Pierce, 07/1340, stating 83457 arrived this unit 0745R. Is on alert status.

07/1133 Rec'd msg. from Jax, 071623, stating: "Planes on search this date. Cecil Field had 15SB2 CS depart 0705R. Mayport had four SNJS and two J2FS depart between 0830R and 1030R. Three SNJ's will depart shortly. NAS Jax had 15F4U's between 0820 and 0850R. One PBY returned due to engine trouble. One of the PBY's in the NEXO sector will cover both sectors NAS Jax. land planes returned at 1050R, negative results. Will conduct same search this afternoon. Can you estimate duration os search.

07/1135 Ponce de Leon Lifeboat Station; 07/1329: CG-83497; in repairs Boca Raton sent message to Jax stating; "We have reached this area with negative results. This office saw a meteor on morning of 5 December at 0550R. Believe this to be the blue white flame in question. Any further instructions?"

07/1200 Told Jax that we were unable to estimate duration of search at present. Contemplate another four days. At 07/1640 Miami CGAS reported Vero Dumbo returning to base.

07/1205 Sent message to Banana River allowing them to secure search on blue flame.

07/1215 MacDill Field, Tampa stated "reference my 1647 message. Further check revealed that Mr. Sloan heard this explosion on Monday and not Wednesday night."

07/1215 SC-653 reports via Port Everglades Boat Facility that 1145

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Further action of Previous Incidents (cont'd)

File No. 2273 (cont'd)
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost
Action: 07/1215 Position was 245° 10 miles from Hole in Wall Light on Great Abaco Island. Weather 4580 15VR 64.
07/1225 SC 1064 sent via Port Everglades Boat Facilities, her position for 1200 as 79-25W and 24-35N
07/1235 Received copy of message sent to CG Group, Fort Pierce 07/1651, stating "Ref my 07/1317 Dis 83457 depart on assigned search. Request answer immediately."
07/1307 Banana River stated: "Vero Dumbo at 1254R. reported that he is just off Sebastian Inlet and is changeing to beer tower frequency and he departed scene of search at 1134R."
07/1307 Banana River told Port Everglade Boat Facilities that NHA is returning to base, Presume that is Port Everglades. in answer to Port Everglade request.
07/1310 Vero Beach Dumbo down.
07/1317 Dinner Key Dumbo Down
07/1330 Received message from MacDill Field, Tampa stating: "Here is some information just given me by a reporter of Tampa Tribune and might be worth investigating. Night before last a Mr. E.O. Sloan was hunting on Kissimee River and he heard and explosion which to him seemed to be 8 or 10 miles south by east from Kissimee River bridge on Vero Beach to Tampa Highway the exact time is not known."
07/1324 PBM 6524 took off Dinner Key.
07/1330 Asked Banana River if Melbourne had any planes available for checking this area. Could this information be handled by these planes if so send them all above information on the explosion before made this request."
07/1335 Banana River replied: "Melbourne has the SNJ's and one JRB but only one pilot. Request instructions." Sent message for Banana River to call Comdr. Lawrence at that station.
07/1345 MacDill Field, at 07/1838 stated "Four planes have returned from search. Negative results. Two planes are still searching."
07/1345 Banana River stated "Army 3724 (36th S.S. Miami Plane) has completed his search. Requests further instructions."
07/1347 Told Banana River were no further instructions for Army 3724. Search being planned for tomorrow. Told him Roger. Banana River then asked if we wished him to return to base. Sent affirmative.
07/1400 Banana River stated they were sending one SNB to investigate explosion at Kissimme River.
07/1400 Lt. Comdr. Doyle reported by phone that an MB-42 from his file sighted an oil slick at 29-13N and 78-43W.
07/1445 SC 1064 sent her position report via Port Everglades at 1400R position 79-37W 24-23N. Weather cloudy, wind NW 10 knots, sea 2.
07/1416 Banana River stated Daytona Dumbo landed at 1319R for new plane. Airbourne again at 1354R. to resume search.

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Further action on Previous Incidents (Contd)

File No. 2273 (Contd)
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost
Action:

07/1427 Sent message to Port Everglades Boat Facility 071927, Request present position of NHA 38. Send answer as soon as possible.

07/1439 B. River states NHA is 5 miles south of Jupiter Inlet.

07/1445 Port River. asked if we had any instructions for NHA. 38.

07/1449 Sent msg to CGC, Ft. Pierce, 071943, stating: "Remy 071651 expedite reply.

07/1449 Told Port River. no instructions for NHA 38. Have her proceed to base.

07/1453 Sent message to Canadtr Comd, 071939 stating: "NAS Ft. Laud. offers 12 TBF planes and experienced crews for duty, on SOLOMANS IF OF VALUE TO SEARCH. Request message to Lauderdale info this unit.

07/1455 Sent msg to CGC VIGILANT AND PANDORA, 071649, stating: Send present posit. Request you give hourly posit. reports on hour.

07/1457 Msg sent from ComGulf to SS 477 (Comgu), 071929, "Proceed best possible speed to 29-13N 78-42W to investigate oil slick reported by Navy PB4Y. Request ETA.

07/1500 ComGulf sent msg to AGP 18 (Chiron) 071851 stating: "Request you keep sharp lookout for survivors or debris 5 TBM's 1 PBM missing 5 Dec. Area North 29N thru 32N. Report any wreckage ASR officer.

07/1505 Sent msg to SC-653 071957 stating: Request your posit. Please send these hourly reports as before but do not send over 3000 Kcs.

07/1505 Rec'd message from CGC Ft. Pierce, 071780, stating: Reur 071317 and 071651. Your 071317 not rec'd until 1200R. CG-83497 has been screw or shaft is unable to comply. CG-83457 departs base at 1300R. Speed 8 knots. ETA search posit. 1800R. Guarding 3000 Kcs. continuously. Unable to deliver your 071604.

07/1505 Rec'd message from Banana River 072000, stating: enter-cepted following: Sighted oil slick 29-13N and 78-42W. Proceeded with box search out 25 miles. Sighted other slicks seemed much older. Advise, Intercepted at 1455R.

07/1507 Key West Dumbo returning to base. Negative results.

07/1510 Rec'd message from Norwegian Ship Christian Thomas Boe, 071954, stating: Silver clyindrical object afloat 2 yds long half yard in diameter. Observed at 143R in post. 26.28N and 29-45 West 20 miles E. Del Ray Beach. Hialeah receipted for message and ship instructed by HFDF to keep sharp lookout.

07/1515 B. River asked if her 072000 msg was passed to us.

07/1513 Rec'd msg from Norwegian ship 072015 stating: "Sighted object resembling life jacket in posit. 26-29N and 79-46 W at 1950 GGT.

07/1522 Rec'd msg from Morrison Field (AACS) 072022, stating: 3270 returned results negative. Can furnish 1 PBY Sat. if needed.

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CG District Log 7ND 0800 7 December to 0800 8 December 1945 cont'd

Further action on previous incidents

File No. 2273 Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost

07/1524 Sent msg to Port Ever. Boat Facility 072026, stating sighting of life jacket and cylindrical object. Requested they send WHA 38 to that scene with best speed. Stated also that we have notified ship that boat will be enroute.

07/1548 ComGulf sent msg to USS Congu SS477,072013, stating: Proceed best speed to 29-13N and 78-42W to investigate oil slick reported by Navy PBY. Request ETA.

07/1525 Comdr. Baxter talked to Operations at Ft. Lauderdale and they stated they were sending boats and planes to the scene of sighted objects.

07/1542 Norwegian Ship reported at 072035 that "We are already 5 miles past last reported position. Object drifting with about 2 miles speed and now out of sight."

07/1543 Sent the above message to Port Everglades Boat Facility.

07/1544 Norwegian ship stated would wait at present position 26-37N and 79-44W. Then can boat arrive here.
Told ship that boat due arrive in 20 mins. Planes should be overheard.
Corrected position as 79-44.05N and 26-37N.

07/1556 Sent message to Port Ever. B. Fac. that Norwegian Ship awaiting arrival crash boats.

07/1557 Sent msg 072044 to Morrison Field ATC. Can you search tomorrow area 28-30N 22-00W and 74-30W to 75-00W.

07/1600 Search plan 07 Dec. as follows:
NAS Mayport 31-21N to 21-30N; Coast to 79-00W
Jax NAATC 30-27N to 21-12N: Coast to 79-00W
Cecil Field 30-00N to 20-27N: Coast to 83-30W
Jax PBY-293ON to 31-30N: 76-00 to 78-00W.
Daytona-28-30N to 29-30N;77-00W to 78-0W
3rd AAF-26-30N to 29-00N:82-00W to Coast.
SOLOMANS(CVE 67) 30-00N to 30-30N:77-00W to 79-00W.
Banana River 29-30N to 31-30N:77-00W to 79-00W.
Ft. Lauderdale 26-30N to 28-00N: 77-30W to Coast
Miami ATC 26-00N to 27-00N:76-00W to 77-00W.
St. Pete CGAS 26-00N to 28-00N;Offshore to 83-30W.
RAF Nassau 25-00 to 26-00N:76-00W to 78-00W.
NAS KW 24-30N to 26-00N; Coast to 83-30W.
Orlando AAF 29-00N to 31-00N; West to 82-30W.
Boca Raton 29-00N to 30-00N; 79-00W to Coast
NAS Opa Locka 28-00N to 30-00N; 77-00W to 79-00W.
ATC Morrison 28-00 to 29-00N:78-30W to 80-00W.
Miami PBM 28-00N to 29-30N;76-00W to 77-00W.
CGAS Miami 27-00 to 28-00N: 76-00W to 77-00W
Vero Beach Dumbo 27-00N to 28-30N; 77-00W to 78-00W
plus following surface craft:

1) Solomons and DE666 and DE799
2) CG Pandora
3) CG Vogilant
4) IX-230
5) IX-232
6) MHA-38
7) SC-1064
8) SC-653

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CG District Log 7ND 0800 7 December to 0800 8 December, 1945 cont'd

Further Action on Previous Incidents cont'd

File No. 2273
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost
Action:

07/1601 Sent following 072157 TWL to NAS Jax: "Request Saturday search by 6 or more PBY's 28-30 to 20-00n 75-00 to 76-00 W acknowledge.

07/1621 CGAS Miami advises Miami Dumbo No. 1 (G596) landed at 1630R.

07/1629 Comdr. Lawrence informed by phone concerning NAS Banana River's search area 08 December as follows:
28-30 to 30-00 N
73-00 to 74-00 W

07/1641 From CG Pandora to DCGO7ND Priority 072055 dis: CG Pandora 1600R Position 29-00N-77-09W.

07/1700 Comdr. Baxter advises: "Ft. Lauderdalehas been approved to work directly with carrier and use its own planes and crews and search where it deems best. (above okayed by Jax and Lauderdale)

07/1701 From CNAO/TRACOMD to NAS Ft. Lauderdale info ComGulf, DCGO 7ND CVR 67 Solomons 072101 OP dis: "Re DCGO 071939. Comply if requested by DCGO to base, TBM aircraft on Solomons. Ref. 071701 entry Comdr. Baxter advises personal conversation between Capt. Burch and Comdr. BAxter indicates former taking care of all details thru Jax.

07/1702 Comdr. Baxter advises all ASR Controllers as follows: "The following are the commands to be notified if search is secured at any time or changes made.
1) Jax NAS- via teletype
2) NAS Banana River - Via phone
3) CGAS Dinner Key - Via phone
4) ATC Morrison Field - via teletype
5) ATC Miami- Via phone 3-0411 EXt 480 or 512.
6) Third air Force Tampa- Via teletype
7) USS Solomons (CVE 67) via Jax
8) Boca Raton Army air base - via telephone OOperations
9) NAS Ft. Lauderdale - NAS Ext 302
10)Orlando Army Air Base, Col. Simons - day 20761 Ext 1303
Night Winter Park 738J
Captain Hitchcock - day 20761 Ext. 1345
Night Winter Park-112 Also Ext-1052
in Air Force Center.

07/1703 From SS-477 Conger to ComGulf 072055 Op dis: "Will cover square twelve miles per side by dark."

07/1704 From ASR Controller Boca Chica to CGAS Miami info JOC Miami 072100 dis: "Designated search area 24 degrees 30 min to 26 degrees 00 min N and 83 degrees 30 min W to Coast had been thoroughly combed. Results negative. Pilot and crew ref. 071356 Total time 6.9, 0820 to 1514.

07/1706 From CGC Ft. Pierce to DCGO 7ND info ComGulf 072003 Priority dis: "CG-83457 hit submerged object in channel. Port screw bent badly. Recalled to base, advise"

07/1710 Sent 072205 TWL to NAS Jacksonville: "Hand planes 28-30N to 31-00N 79-00W to Coast. PBY's 28-30 to 30-00N 75-00 to 76-00W. (Above is NAS Jax's search area 08 Dec.)

07/1712 From CG VIGILANT TO DCTO 7ND 072020 Priority dis: "Present DR Position 28-52N 79-35W.

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CG District Log cont'd

Subject: Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost

Action:

07/1715 From (LDNN) Chr Th Boe 072184 dis: "ComGulfseafron are not in position but can not see any boat or planes. Master

07/1716 Sent 06/1715 entry to Boat Facilities (Navt-C) Pt. Ever.

07/1717 From NAVTC Boat Facilities Pt. Everglades to ASR Miami 072209 dis; "Our 104 footer NHA 38 and Lauderdale ready plane searched area in vicinity of 26-29N 79-46 West reported previously as position of life jacket and cylindrical object. Only floating object revealed was a lard bucket. NHA 38 and ready plane have been secured.

07/1718 Sent following 072205 Priority dis to CGG Ft. Pierce: "Reur 072003 have CG-83457 remainat base until further orders.

07/1720 From (LDNN) via (WZX) 500 Kcs at 1954: "Silver cylindrical object afloat about 2 yds. long half yard in diameter, observed at 1935 GMT in posn 26.28 N 79-45W Master.

07/1727 From LDNN via (WAX) on 435 Kcs Priority to Comgulf: "Are now in posn but can not see any boat or plane. Master

07/1721 From NAOTC Bt. Fac. Pt. Ever. to ASR Miami 072226 TWL: "We have dispatched our NHA-38 to pick up life jacket.

07/1732 From Morrison Field ATC to ASR Miami-072215 TWL: "If possible request search area be cut down, Have only one PBY to cover that area and at present distance fuel supply will exhaust before area can be covered.

07/1733 From CG VIGILANT to DCGO 7ND Priority 072200 dis: "1700 R Posit 2830N 79-25W.

07/1738 From (NAOTC Bt. Fac.) Pt. Ever. 072232 TWL: "will you advise Steamer (LDNN) that our NHA-38 is proceeding towards her.

07/1742 From ASR Miami,to NAVTC (Bt. Fac.) Pt. Ever 072235 TWL: "What position is NHA-38 proceeding to. Ref (LDNN) Merchant ship.

07/1743 From (NAVTC Bt. Fac.) Pt. Ever. 072237 TWL: "NHA-38 is proceeding to 26-37 N 79-44W.

07/1755 From CG PANDORA to DCGO 7ND-072155 Priority dis: "Pandora 1700R position 29-04N 77-07W.

07/1756 From CNAADTRA JKNL, Fla. to NAS Miami info NAAS Whiting Field LMSPC, ComGulf DCGO 7ND-072014 dis:"Re my 032040 Dec. If privateers needed Com Gulf to conduct search operations for Port Lauderdale TBM's past 10 Dec, delay execution transfer required planes and personnel Whiting and advise.

07/1800 OPr. 072235 from SS Conger (477) to Comgulf "Search completed. Nothing here, proceeding as before."

08/1801 From DCGO 7ND to Nassa Bahamas Oak Field 072255 OP dis;" Would appreciate any search you might make Saturday of 25-30 to 26-00N and 75-30 to 76-00 W. Communication plans same as before. Acknowledge.

07/1805 Sent to CGAS, St. Petersburg 082257 TWL: "Cpi;d upi searcj area tomorrow from 27-00 to 27-15 N and from 79-00W in an easterly repeat easterly direction as far as conditions permit.

07/1806 Ref 061805 entry from CGAS S. Pete via 072300 TWL: "Affirmative can assign one PBM.

07/1820 From DCGO 7ND to (LDNN) Chr. Th Boe info NAOTC (Bt. Facil.)Pt. Ever. AVR call NHA-38 is now proceeding to position 26-37N 79-44W

07/1823 From DCGO 7ND to CGC Pandora info ComGulf-072313 Priority dis: "Proceed to 28-30N and 75-30W and make square search. Advise ETA scene.

07/1823 To Mayport from CGAS St. Pete 072323 TWL: "Please advise present

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Action: position SC-1308. Also advise time vessel returned to base when secured 06 Dec.

07/1830 From DCGO 7ND to CGC Ft. Pierce 072205 Priority dis; "Reur 072003 have CG-83457 remain at base until further orders.

07/1836 From DCGO 7ND to CGC VIGILANT info ComGulf 072319 Priority dis: "Proceed to 77-30 W and 28-30N and make squard search. Advise ETA scene.

07/1841 From Mayport 072320 T.L: "SC-1308 damaged in yesterday's search has been replaced by SC-1321 present posit. 31-03N 79-46.[illegible] will advise when vessel arrived Mayport.

07/1842 From NAOTC Pt. Ever to ASR Miami 072338 T.L: "Will you contact tanker (LDNN) and ask if they are still standing by. NHA-38 is in that area and unable to locate them.

07/1847 Sent following to NOOTC Pt. Ever. 072343 T.L: "Following rec's from (LDNN) via (NAK) quote to NAOTC (Bt. Facil) Pt. Ever. AVR remained in posit. until dark but as no boat or plane appeared proceeded course. Master

07/1900 From NAS Banana River to ComGulf 072353 T.L: "Refer ur 070807. Plane 3NB Buno 39755 reports. Searched area south Kissimee completed thorough search of area assigned and also surrounding it. There was no sign of wreckage in this area."

07/1905 Sent 072359 T.L to Mayport "For SC-1321/ Proceed to 29-00N 79-00W and make square search. Advise ETA scene.

07/1925 From Mayport to ASR Miami 0800 20 T.L: "Have services of blimp tomorrow. Do you have any particular sector you want searched."

07/1930 From ComGulf to SC-1000 PC-780 info DCGO 7ND op dis 072310: "Request you keep sharp lookout for survivors or debris five TBM's and one PBM missing since five December.

07/1931 From Solomons (CVE-67) to DCGO 7ND info (No break) 072217 dis: "Completed search of area within 31-30N and 30-00N and 77-00 W and 79-00W. Negative results. My present position 31-25N 78-09W. Request instructions.

07/1940 From NAS Jacksonville to ASR Miami, ComGulf, NAS Banana River 080025 T.L: "The following is a report of NAS Jax and aux fields search for 7 Dec. for missing planes. All planes searched areas assigned and reported negative results. Mayport had nine planes including 4 SNBs two J2Fs and three SNJ's in the morning search and the same no. in the afternoon. Their last plane returned at 1647R. Total flying time for the day 49.1. Cecil Field had fifteen SB2Cs both in the morning and the afternoon. Their last plane retd at 1616R. Total flying time 88 hrs. NAS Jax had 5 PBYs in the morning and the same number in the afternoon. The last plane returned at 1644R. Total flying time 42.5. Fifteen F4U in the morning and the same in the afternoon. Total flying time 75.9. Ten SNJs in the morning and the same in afternoon search. The last plane retd at 1520. Total flying time 54.1. The last F4U retd at 1650R. Total number of planes from NAS Jax and aux fields fifty four in the morning and fifty four in the afternoon. Total flying time 309 hrs and 35 minutes.

07/1943 From NAVTC Port Everglades to ComGulf 0800 39 T.L: "We have recalled NHA-38 and are securing him since the tanker proceeded on course after dark.

07/1944 From Mayport to ASR Miami 080041 T.L: "SC 1321 is returning to base due to engine trouble.

07/1944 Sent following to Mayport 080030 T.L: "Ur 080020. Search area

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Action: for blimp left to your descretion. Where blimp can best be employed.

07/1950 Sent 080046 TWL to NAOTC B. Fac.,Ft. Ever."Ur 080039, it is necessary that NHA-38 proceed to scene and make search for objects reported.

07/1950 CGAS Miami advises PBM(Dumbo 2) 6524 in at 1928R.

07/2005 From CG VIGILANT to DCGO 7ND 072300 Priority: "1800R position 28-50N 79-13W.

07/2000 From CG Pandora to DCGO 7ND info ComGulf 080002 Priority dis: "Pandora ETA scene 0100R 8 Dec.

07/2007 From CG Pandora to DCGO 7ND 072301 dis: "Pandora 1800R Posit 29-05N 77-01W.

07/2009 ComGulf to Bams (area 28) any or all Merchant Ships 072336 ids. "All Ships area East Florida Coast East to 72 W keep sharp lookout for survivors or debris six planes lost at sea five December.

07/2001 From NAS Jax. to ASR Miami 080053 TWL: "NAS Jax and Aux fields search planes will depart at sunrise or as soon thereafter as possible 6 PBM's from NAS Jax will search 28-30N to 30-00N 75-00 to 76-00W. Cecil Field 15 SB2os 28-30N to 29-15N Coast East to 79-00W. Mayport 9 planes including 4 SNBs 2 J2Fs and 3 SNJs 30-30N to 31-00N coast east to 79-00W and 10 SNJs 30-00 to 30-30 N Coast East to 79-00W. Total number of planes to search in the morning 54 and the same number in the afternoon unless otherwise instructed.

07/2021 From SS 477 Conger to ComGulf 072235 dis: "Search complied. Nothing here. Proceeding as before.

07/2039 Sent following Priority 080035 dis to NAS Ft. Lauderdale info NAS Jacksonville: "Following 072217 dispatch rec'd from USS Solomons (CUE-67) to DCGO 7ND quote. Completed search of area within 3130 N and 3000 W and 7900W. Negative results. My present posit on 3125N 78 09W. Request further instructions.

07/2040 Sent 080043 Priority dis to USS SOLOMONS (CVE-67) info NAS Ft. Lauderdale NAS Jacksonville: "Ur dis 072217. Doubleheaded to NAS Ft. Lauderdale for action info NAS Jacksonville.

07/2055 From Ft. Everglades to ComGulf 080151 TWL: "NHA-38 has electrical trouble and is being relieved by NHA-35.

07/2056 Sent 072359 Priority dis to SC-1321 info ComGulf: Proceed to 29-00N 2900W and make square search. Advise ETA scene.

07/2115 From SC-1064 to CGC Key West Boca Chica Base Radio, Radio Key West, Fla. info DCGO 7ND - 072015 Pr dis: "1400 Posit. report 79 degrees 37 minutes West 24 degrees 36 minutes north weather cloudy wind northwest sea 2.

07/2116 As above from SC-1064 - 972210 dis: "1700 Position report 79 degrees 20 minutes west 24 degrees 40 minutes west 24 degrees 40 minutes north weather clear wind northwest 10 knots sea 2.

07/2123 From Army Air Base Nassau to DCGO 7ND op 080100 dis:"RAF will cover area designated in your 072255Z PD advise any info relative to this area and progress of search.

07/2124 From NAS Miami to ComGulf info NAS Whiting Field, DCGO 7ND advises that privateers not needed after scheduled search tomorrow 8 Dec.

07/2125 Rec'd from CTG 67.7 to ComGulf 072251 dis: "Completed search along track with 30 miles front thru following points. 27-40 76-50 28-32 77-17. 29-03 77-47. 29-28 78-20. Results negative. Continuing during the night with 6 mile front on course 340 to destination.

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Action:

07/2130 From CG Pandora to DCGO 7ND 080100 dis: "Pandora 2000R Posit 2901N 7636W.

07/2131 From NAS Ft. Lauderdale to CNE Solomons info Com 7 072250 or dis; "at Ft. Lauderdale, 12TBF and experienced pilots ready at 0700 Dec 8 for search, will use 3345 Kcs and 172.74 VHF, Advise rendezvous point less than 300 miles from Banana River if agreeable. Planes will refuel at Banana River enroute.

07/2135 080230 TwL from NAS Banana River to ComGulf and ASR Miami "Conducted search as directed, all planes have returned to base, results negative except for one unidentified object posit. of which is accurately determined. Will investigate further on morning search. Comdr. Laurence originator.

07/2145 From CG Pandora to DCGO 7ND 080210 dis: "Pandora 2100R Posit 2855N 7622W.

07/2150 From CGAS St. Pete 080300 TwL: "2 flights, 14,8 hrs. PBM 6574 out 0948 in 1640. PBM 6519 out 0842 in 1630,

07/2151 080301 TwL to Mayport "Ur 080041. What vessel is replacing SC-1321.

07/2152 From McDill Field 080302 TwL: "Time of search this morning was 18 hrs and 5 mins. Negative results.

07/2155 From Mayport 080329 T.L: "Ur 080301. No vessel won't know til morning, (above in reference to SC-1321).

07/2200 From NAS Banana River 080333 TwL: "Following is report of planes, all times Roger, ATU Planes are PBMs and ABTU planes are PBYs, Dumbos are PBYs.

ATU TR	off	on
32	0649	1445
41	0700	1713
39	0649	1510
23	0658	1433
18	0654	1916
7	0702	1912
57	0726	1918
17	0914	1926
29	0950	2030
ABTU		
B-60	0800	1652
B-44	1317	2018
B-57	1335	2047

Daytona Dumbo 0830 1319 (1st Hop)
1354 1847 (2nd Hop)

07/2245 ComGulf to Ap-21 Wakefield info DCGO 7ND 080221 dis: "En-route destination request you keep sharp lookout from 32-00 N to 27-00 N for survivors or debris six planes lost at sea 5 December.

07/2246 From SC 1064 to CGC Key West, Radio, Key West Chica Base. Info DCGO 7ND 080000 dis: "1900 Posit report. 79-20W 24-20N weather clear wind southeast 10 knots sea 2.

07/2250 From ATC Morrison Field 080325 TwL: "We have one PBY

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Subject: Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost

Action: 07/2250(cont'd) participating in search today with total sum of 9½ hrs. dep. 1344Z and returned for end of day search at 2307Z.

07/2315 From DCGO 7ND to Nassau Bahama- Oak Field info Comgulf 080405 Pr. dis: "Results of search to date negative."

07/2330 From SC-653 via Layport 080400 TWL: "2245 Position 2558N 7625W, weather 6270 1773.

08/0020 Rec'd 072235 dispatch from SC-653 1735 posit 25 degrees 54 min north 76-35 min west, weather 37811476.

08/0020 Rec'd 080301 dispatch from CGC VIGILANT 2200R position 28-44N 78-24W.

Rec'd 080312 dispatch from CGC Pandora "Pandora 2200R position 2849 north 7610 west.

08/0032 Rec'd 080500 disp from CGC Vigilant via EL "2400R position 28-39N 78-03W

Recd foll. 080419 msg from Pt. Everglades UT Reur 08-247, following is report of planes from NAS Ft. Lauderdale. All times roger, all planes are TBF's.

Flight #	No. of planes	off	on
1	6	0810	1228
2	6	0754	1145
3	6	0751	1157
4	6	0803	1201
5	6	0757	1126
6	6	1216	1516
7	6	1231	1545
8	3	1256	1536
FT 76	1	1559	1712

Total time 164 hours 58 minutes. 46 planes participated.

08/0057 Sent following 080557 msg to NAS Ban Riv."Advise number of 63 foot boats on search from New Smyrana"

08/0100 Rec'd foll 080600 msg from NAS Ban. Riv. Refer us 080557, All new Smyrna boats now at cok at New Smyrna

08/0129 Ref 080600 msg from CGC Vigilant 0100R Position 2835N 7752W Sent 080613 msg to NAS Ban Riv "Advise departure return time of New Smyrna boats.

Recd 080617 msg from NAS Ban. River Ref. ur 080613, New Smyrna 5 departed at 0848R and returned at 2055 R.

08/0130 Rec'd 080401 msg from CGC Vigilant "2300R position 28-42N 78-14W Rec'd 080418 msg from CGC Pandora "Pandora 2300R position 28-38N 76-03-W

08/0150 Recd 080417 msg from Comgulf to CGC 67.12 (Frazier DD-607, Meade (DD-602) CTC 67.1 (Maroman DE 249) info DCGO 7ND "Enroute destination requet you keep sharp lookout from 2700N to 3200N for survivors or debris six plane lost at sea 5 Dec.

08/0156 Recd from 080654 from NAS Ban Riv Hull No. of New Smyrna 5 is C-26623

08/0224 Recd 080717 disp from Boat Fac Pt. Everglades "While returning to base from search of last night NHA 38 was dispatched to posit where norwegian tanker sighted life jacket at 071533R. He returned to t[illegible]1505 R. NHA 35 departed to relieve NHA 38 at 2041R.

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RESTRICTED

Subject: Five PBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost

Action:		
	*08/0216	Recd from CGC VIGILANT 080700 0200R position 28-33N 77-40W.
	08/0224	Rec'd 080653 dispatch from SC-653 0145R position 2610 north 76-31 West, weather 9081664.
	08/0234	Rec'd 080500 dispatch from CGC Pandora, Pandora 2400R position 28-35N 75-49W.
	08/0234	Rec'd 080600 dispatch from CGC Pandora "Pandora 0100R position 28-32N 75-36W.
	08/0236	Rec'd 080600 dispatch from SC-1064 0100R position report. 79 degrees 20 minutes west 24 degrees 18 min north. Weather clear wind 15 knots west sea 2.
	08/0308	Recd 080745 dispatch from SC-653 "0245R est. position 7624 west 2604 North.
	08/0318	Recd 080800 msg from CGC Vigilant 0800R position 2830N 7730W
	08/0348	Recd 080805 msg from SC-1064 "0300 position report 79 degrees 38 min west 24 degrees 19 min north. Weather clear, wind NW 16 knots sea 2.
	08/0411	Recd 080849 msg from SC-653 0345R position 2601 North 7623 west.
		Rec'd 080600 msg from SC-1064 "0100 position 79 degrees 20 min west 24 deg 18 min north, weather clear wind 15 knots sea 2.
		Rec'd 080800 msg from CGC Pandora "PANDORA 0100R position 28-27N 75-23W.
	08/0418	Rec'd 080900 msg from CGC Vigilant 0400 R position 28-46N 77-36W.
	08/0504	Rec'd 080948 msg from SC-653 0446R position 2553 North 76-24W.
	08/0530	NAS Ban. River advised by 081020 msg "6 PBM's departed at 0520 to search in assigned area. Lead plane training 20.
	08/0530	Rec'd 081000 dispatch from CGC Vigilant "0500R position 28-30N 77-37W.
		Rec'd 080300 dispatch from CGC Pandora "Pandora 0100R position 28-27 North 75-23W.
	08/0558	CGAS Miami advises PBM 6598 off at 0529 PBM 6559 0545R.
	08/0555	Rec'd 080900 dispatch from CGC Pandora "Pandora 0400 position 28-26 north 75-18W"
		Rec'd 081000 dispatch from Pandora "Pandora 0600 position 28-26 N 75-24 W."
	08/0600	Sent following 081103 message to NAS Jax, Following received from the SS Chancellorsville on 500 Kcs MAX de Kucg nr 1. Lookout reported seeing one white rocket proceeded towards position indicated but no further signals seen. Position 29-24N 77-53W at 0900Z BT Have your planes on lookout enroute to search area assigned for this morning.
	08/0618	NAS Banana River advised by 081114 message Flight of two PBM's off at 0610R. Searching in an expanding square starting at position 30-57N and 78-58W. Lead plane is training 13.
	08/0620	0600R Position of CG Vigilant 28-37N 77-37W.
	08/0624	Rec'd from NAS Banana River 081121 dispatch. We have two PBM standing by, at daybreak.
	08/0640	Rec'd 081132 dispatch from CGAS St. Pete PBM 65-74 airborn 0632R for assigned search lat 27 to 2715N and from 2900W in an easterly direction as far as conditions permit.
	08/0655	Rec'd 081149 from NAS Banana River NAS Banana River field is closed fog.
	08/0720	Rec'd 081156 dispatch from CG Pandora "Pandora 0600R posit,

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File No. 2273
Subject:
Action: 08/0721

Five PBY's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) lost
28-28 N 76-34W.
Received 081155 dispatch from SC-653 0645R position 26-56N 76-36 W.
Sent to NAS Jax and Boat Facility, Port Everglades 081205 message "Advise time of departure of all units on todays search upon departure."
Comdr. Baster advised that on yesterdays search Masters Field used 8-PB4Y's time unknown, Miami ATC used one B-17 6.9 hrs. RAF Nassua used one skytrain time unknown.

W. T. MURPHY, Lt. Comdr. USCG

Approved:

Wm. Nishar, Captain, USCG

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CG District Log, 7TD
0800 8 December - 0800 9 December 1945

0801 - Lt. Bauer, Ens. C. V. DeGeorge on duty, Pending Incidents 2256, 2260, 2269, 2272, 2278, 2279
0830 - Lt. (jg) S. G. Perret, Seaman Neely, reported
0835 - Lt. Comdr. Murphy reported
0900 - Ens. C. V. DeGeorge departed
1530 - Lt. R. S. Covey reported
1550 - Lt. R. F. Bauer departed
1559 - End of watch
1601 - Lt. R. S. Covey on duty. Pending Incidents file No. 2256, 2272, 2278, 2279, 2282, 2283, 2285
1800 - Lt. Comdr. Murphy, Lt. (jg) Perret departed
2230 - CGC Miami reports 38505 dispatched to Bayfront Park to search for body reported floating by soldier.
2345 - Lt. (jg) G. F. Koch reported
2359 - End of watch
0001 - Lt. Covey and Lt. (jg) G. F. Koch on duty pending incidents File No. 2260, 2269, 2272, 2281, 2282, 2284, 2286
0759 - End of watch

Further Action Previous Incidents

File No. 2278
Subject: Canadial Aux Schooner "LA HAVIE"
Action: 09/0230 From CGC Ft. Pierce Fla., to DCGO 7TD 090400 Priority dispatch: "Rcur 082301. Yacht MALBU reported that a sloop answering the description of the missing vessel was passed approximately 15 miles of Mosquito Lagoon on ICW. Sloop was traveling south 4 to 6 knots at approximately 0915R 08 December. Aux KATCH MAYFARA No. 161938 reported seeing sloop answering missing vessels description in area between Winter Beach and Vero Beach. 1430 R 08 December. Reported seeing a man and woman aboard her.
09/0300 Called Mr. Harriman to give information 09/0230 entry and was advised LA HAVIE arrived Miami 09/0945R.
09/0310 Sent following 09/0825 dispatch to DCGO 1 3 4 5 6 Com 1 3 4 5 6 ComEast ComGulf, information CGC Ft. Pierce, CGC Miami, Ref my dispatch 062251. Canadian Auxiliary Schooner LA HAVIE arrived Miami 080945R. Cancel alort.
09/0310 Sent Text 09/0310 entry to All ASR stations on T.L machine 09/0841 T.L message.
Incident closed.

File No. 2279
Subject: YTL-168, aground
Action: 09/0200 Requested status of incident from CGC Miami, CGC Miami advises "CG-83504 floated YTL-168 at 1135R and returned to base at 2200R. Incident closed.

File No. 2282
Subject: 3 Barges lost by tug FRANK W. SPENCER
Action: 09/0515 From GulfCon Havana to ComGulf, information NAP, Key West Com East 09/0355 OP Dispatch. "Ur dispatch 082256. Cuban subchaser located barge lat 22-24-05N long 84-23-15W in good condition.

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CG District Log, 7ND, 0800 8 December - 0800 9 December 1945 Contd

Further Action - Previous Incidents Contd

File No. 2282 Contd
Subject: 3 Barges lost by tug JOHN W. SPENCER
Action: 09/0515 Tow cable in perfect condition, information as to desposition of barges unknown.

CURRENT INCIDENTS

File No. 2283
Action Time: Current
Subject: Cuban Schooner in distress
Origin: WAX
Location: 40 miles south of Sand Key
Action: 08/1155 Received following from WAX. "Cuban motor schooner C 21A in distress 40 miles south of Sand Key. Request immediate assist.
08/1202 Passed above to CGC Key West with request they take action ARIADNE and 1 83 footer will be dispatched
08/1219 Confirmed above telephone message by dispatch.
08/1234 Key West advises 83396 departed at 1210, ARIADNE at 1220 to assist.
08/1255 DCGO 8ND advises "Following received on 500 from KFRX SS T. J. JACKSON "at 1738 the position of the schooner is Lat. 23-49N 81-53W. Schooner apparently in no immediate danger. Am proceeding
08/1505 Received ARIADNE'S 081370 "Proceeding to assist Cuban motor ship C21 A at 1215R ETA 1600
08/1820 Received ARIADNE'S 082150 "Position (600R 23-33N 81-39W. Took disabled vessel in tow 1630. Same position as before. Proceeding to Key West ETA 2300R.
08/1900 Received CGC Key Wests "ARIADNE took disabled vessel C-21A in tow 1630R. Proceeding to Key West. ETA 2300R. Machinery disabled. Ship and crew apparently in good condition. Customs and immigration officials at Key West notified.
08/2330 Received ARIADNE'S 090230 "Arrived Key West with tow at 2110R
09/0230 From CGC Key West to DCGO 7ND 090500 Priority dispatch. "Ref your 081719 ARIDANE arrive Key West with tow 2210R. C21-A LA MACHINA 103 Gross tons. Homeport Havana. 2 days out of Havana bound Miami. Cargo fruit. 2 automobiles. Owner Oscar Santa Maria Laino Muelle Orsenal Havana. Capt. Avelina Santiago. Crew of 9. Casually broken crankshaft. Moored Craig dock Key West. Other vessels assisting FAUNCE and 83396 returned to base 2020R.
Incident closed.

File No. 2284
Action Time: Current
Subject: Man Lost near Appalachicola (Mr. Joe Thompson)
Origin: ?
Location: Marshes Appalachicola area
Action: 09/0021 Received 090500 priority dispatch from DCGO 8ND to CGAS St. Pete information DCGO 7ND, CGAS, Biloxi, Com 8. Refur 082307 Beloxi

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Current Incidents (Contd)

File No. 2284
Subject: Man Lost near Appalachicola (Mr. Joe Thompson)
Action: 09/0021 J4F will proceed Tybdall Field at daybreak to assist. Have JRF pilot leave complete inf.rmation on case with Tyndall Field operations for J4F pilot.

09/0345 From CGAS St. Pete, to CGAS Biloxi, information DCGO 7ND, DCGO 8ND Com' - 090715 dispatch "Re DCGO 8ND 090500. JRF Buno 84792 Lt. Comdr. Goodwin now at Apalachicola. Can be contacted by telephone by calling Apalachicola i. Helicopter will depart St. Pete, at daylight, for Apalachicola. Following information regarding Case has been received. Joe Thompson, departed Apalachicola 0830 Tuesday to hunt ducks in marshes east of Apalachicola in small duck hunting boat with outboard motor and carried one twelve guage shotgun. Was last ween on 1200 Tuesday. Search was started on Wednesday morning. Winds was fresh west north west weather cold. Boat was located on St. George Island 18 miles from where Thompson was last seen. Gun case, gas can, hat and 3 decoys were found in boat which was half full of water. Will depart on search at daylight.

File No. 2285
Action Time: Current
Subject: 36 Ft. Sloop, unheard from
Origin: DCGO 6ND
Location: Between Maryland and Florida
Action: 08/1600 Received following dispatch from DCGO 6ND "New York ASR advised that a 35 ft. sloop Roughin enroute to Boston from to Florida, hasn't been heard from since 29 November in the Delaware River. Mrs. Sarah Stile rpported it that the occupants were Mac Stile and man named Lowe. Description of sloop are as follows: Forward cabin outboard rig rudder white green base. Number 4G484 traveling 4 to 6 knots. Please advise if any information.

08/1801 Above information sent to all units DCGO 7 with request they advise.

08/2210 ASR Charleston advised by phone that sloop was located south of Elizabeth City in no trouble.

09/0110 From DCGO 7ND to NAS Jacksonville, NAS Banana River, NAS Miami SC-1064, CVE 67, CG ARIDNE CG PANDORA, CG VIGILANT, SC653 CGAS Miami, CGAS, St. Pete, CGG Ft. Pierce, CGG Miami, CGG Key West, NAS Ft. Lauderdale, Boca Raton AA Base, RAF Nassau, AAF Morrison and MacDill Field 090449 dispatch. "Cancel my 082301. Sloop located.
Incident Closed.

File No. 2286
Action Time: Current
Subject: Green Flares
Origin: 0020 R Telephone call from CAA
Location: 50 miles from Tampa
Action: 09/0020 Received following at 09/0020R from CAA quote "Eastern Air Line Trip 25 reports 4 green flares at 2355R 50 miles out of Tampa bearing 345 degrees from Ft. Myers. This observed by flight

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CG District Log, 7ND 0800 8 December - 0800 9 December, 1945 Contd

Current Incidents Contd.

File No. 2286
Subject: Green Flares
Action: 09/0020 Attendant. Guarding 4122Kcs unquote.
09/0024 Sent 09/0020 entry to CGAS St. Pete, and MacDill Field Requested MacDill to check other fields their area by 090535 T.L.

FURTHER ACTION - Previous Incidents Contd.

File No. 2273
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) lost
Action: 08/0823 Sent message to St. Pete 08/1320, stating, If you have standby PBY of JRF consider that it should be amply supplied with message clocks. Will possibly be dispatched to area 10 to 15 miles S. W. Of Melbourne to drop messages to men on ground at that point.
St.Pete said Roger. We have one JRF in flying condition.
08/0825 Dinner Key Dumbo reports on station.
08/0831 Mayport asked Banana River if wanted blimp to search swamp area today.
08/0831 VIGILANT reported position at 0800R as 28-34N and 77-22W.
SC-653 - 0800 R position is 26-06N and 76-35W.
08/0855 Received message from NOB Key West, originator Chancellosville 08/1110Z., stating, Lookout reported seeing one white rocket proceeded towards position 29-24N and 77-53W at 0900Z. No further signals seen. Ships in vicinity keep lookout for same.
08/0900 SC-1064 position at 0800R 24-36N and 79-37W.
08/0900 PANDORA'S 0700R position 28-30N and 75-37W.
PANDORA'S 0800R position 28-25N and 75-13W.
08/0922 Received message from Morrison Field 08/1416, Pilot of C-54 No. 2460 arrived this station 0915R at 0750Z he saw a green flare at approximately 27-55N and 76-40W. Flying at 0800 Ft.
08/0926 Ft. Lauderdale reported 12 TBM's took off for Solomons.
08/0927 Sent message to St. Pete and MacDill Field, 08/1427. Do you have helicopters available if desirable in area west of Melbourne.
08/0927 St. Pete stated had 2 helicopters and 2 pilots ready.
08/0927 MacDill Field stated had 3 helicopters but none are in commission. St. Pete stated our helicopters can't land on water. Flight from here to Melbourne would require 2 hours. Request early notification if these craft can be of use.
08/0929 Advised B. R. that NAS Miami, has ready vessels for search up in Melbourne area. They are alerted. Ready to go. Advise.
08/0930 Message sent to PBY 4 via Masters Field to search area 27-55N and 77-40W. and to advise ETA.
08/0934 Informed St. Pete would give necessary notification in advance to use helicopters.
08/0935 SC-653 - 0845R position 26.04N and 76-35W.
08/0940 B. River requested St. Pete to send one helicopter.

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CG District Log, 7ND - 0800 8 December - 0800 9 December, 1945 Cont'd.

Further Action - Previous Incidents Cont'd

File No. 2273
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost
Action: 08/0940 Weather here at present is thick with fog. Airology feels it will be off by the time it arrives.

08/0940 Ft. Everglades Boat Facilities stated 12 planes enroute carrier will be on UHF 142.74 until they reach vicinity of carrier and they will change to 3345 HFDF advised of frequencies being guarded.

08/0947 B. River advised that vessels other amphib. gear from NAS standing by awaiting lifting of fog. B. River directed to control search up near Melbourne. B. R. is having St. Pete send helicopter over to aid in Melbourne area. Information relayed by Comdr. Baxter.

08/0950 VIGILANT - 0900R. position as 28-30N and 77-21W.

08/0958 ComGulf sent message to CUE 67 Solomons 08/1431, stating Ref ur 08/1201. Cmabdvtr directed C. O. Ft. Lauderdale to direct Solomons search today. Hdqs. controlling all other searches from Army, Navy, and C. Guard flights. Area of their main search today covers 27. to 30N and 73 to 76 W.

08/0958 Solomons, in 08/1400 requested. Do you desire us to continue search. If so where present position 29-45N and 79-40W. Course 150 speed to 10 knots.

08/0959 Ft. Everglades informed that FT48 is leader of flight of 12 planes going out to Solomons. Leader 2nd. Sec. Flight 90 Leader 3rd section ft. 24 Leader 4th Section FT4

08/1000 St. Pete advised B. River helicopter would depart in 10 minutes. Do you have and ceiling at all. 50 ft. is sufficient. B. River stated negative. It is right on the deck. But expect to break up in about 45 minutes.

08/1015 Comdr. Baxter ordered mobile equipment 1 alligator and 1 weasel to proceed aboard trucks to NAS Vero Beach with crews. Expected arrival about 2 hours word passed to NAS Vero Beach, and Banana River.

08/1015 Port Everglades informed B. R. We have been searching area 26-38 N. and 79-30 W. to 79-50 W. for floating life jacket and cylindrical object reported in position 26-38N. and 79-44 W. at 1607R, 6 December utilizing crash boat and two TBF planes. Results there for negative. Suggest Ft. Pierce be instructed to institute search N. of Lat. 27-10. Advise

08/1015 B. River informed us in 08/1506, that. Believe we can get planes for the area you suggest. However it is impractical to search at present. Entire area in this vicinity is closed in with heavy ground fog. Visibility about 220 yds. Will act as soon as fog lifts.

08/1021 Morrison Field states have 2 planes searching assigned area. PBY and B 17 3715 with rescue boat attached.

08/1028 PANDORAS 1000R position 28-35N and 75-36W.

08/1030 Ready plane 21 from B. River gave position 1515GCT at 30.53N and 79-10W. ComGulf.

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CG District Log, 7ND 0800 8 December - 0800 9 December 1945 Cont'd

Further Action - Previous Incidents

File No. 2273
Subject: FIVE TMI'S (Ft. Lauderdale NAS) Lost
Action: 08/1030 Sent message to PC-780, 08/1558 stating. Proceed position 31 N. and 79-10W. Where unfolded life raft sighted. Make square search. Plane standing by. Advise. ETA above position.
08/1030 Received message from St. Pete, 08/1536 stating. Helicopter 1390 44 departed St. Pete enroute to B. River at 1025R.
08/1039 Mayport Dumbo reported be on scene at 1122R.
08/1043 SC-1064 stated 1000 position as 79-25W. and 24-35N.
08/1045 Received message from Mayport, 08/1545, stating Believe carrier group closing to that position. Are trying to contact them to have DE dispatched. Will send SC to that position. If we are closer than DE's.
08/1045 Received message from B. River, 08/1537, telling about training 21 sighting unfolded life raft at 30-58N and 79-10 Blimp K113 is proceeding to scene. Request surface craft be dispatched to pick up raft.
08/1045 Sent message to Jacksonville 08/1542, Direct 110SC(garbled) from Mayport proceed to position of life raft sighted 31-10N. and 79-10W. Conduct square search. Acknowledge.
08/1050 Received message from B. River, 08/1547, request four planes be dispatched to search area 28-15N. to 27-30N and 80-40W to 81-15W B. River planes now grounded due to fog.
08/1050 Sent message to Banana River Refur 08/1528, Have Ft. Pierce Navy AUR's take up search with Ft. Lauderdale planes from that point.
08/1112 Received message from Mayport 08/1603 stating. "We are dispatching 104ft. AUR, NFK 3 to a position reported. We have also sent two DE's to that position from carrier group.
08/1113 Sent message to MacDill Field., 08/1606, search area 27-30N to 28-15N and 80-40 to 81-15W. With available aircraft. B. River fogbound. Advise names calls and freq's of planes operating.
08/1115 Sent message to Jacksonville Refur 08/1537. What vessels will be sent from your unit. When will they depart. ETA Scene. Mess. refurs to search for folded life raft. Jacksonville replied she had no vessels but would check with Mayport B. Facility.
08/1115 Sent message to B. R. ref 08/1557, four men and weasel and Caterpiller proceeding Vero NAS un at deserition.
08/1115 B. R. in 081554, asked how far North do you want Ft. Pierce to search from 27-80. Also what Long boundries.
Told them to consult Pt. Everglades Boat Fac. who was handling.
08/1115 08/1115 Jacksonville 081602 stated Mayport was taking action on above and would give information requested in your 08/1537. Jacksonville has no vessels.
08/1125 Jacksonville 08/1613, sent message of 08/1205 regarding departure time of planes on search. NAS Jacksonville and Aux. Fields planes departed as follows. 6 PBY's departed between 0742 and 0921R. 15 F4U's between 0813 and 0954, 9 SNJ's between 0900 and 0910R Cecil Field had 15 SB2C's departed between 0840 and 0900R. One J2F and 0935R and 6 SNB's at 1010R. Nine SNJ's from NAS Jackson. Returned at 1105R with no results.

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CG District Log, 7TH 0800 8 December - 0800 9 December 1945 Cont'd

Further Action - Previous Incidents Cont'd

File No. 2273
Subject:
Action: 08/1131 Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost
PANDORA, 081528 sands her 100R position as 28.35N and 75.36W. Proceeding to new scene ETA 1330R.

08/1131 ComGulf sent message to PT 606, 081556. Enroute Mayport search area in position 31 N and 79-10W. for unfolded life raft. Plane standing by at position.

08/1140 Com Gulf sent message to SC-1290 and 1291, 08/1612, When ready for sea. SC 1290 proceed position 28N. and 79-15W. 1291 proceed to position 26.15N and 78-40 Both vessels conduct square search. Advise ETD and ETA. Acknowledge.

08/1140 08/1617, Sent message to DCGO 6TH, informing of unfolded life raft. Also told them that PC boat and AUR 104 fooler and DE from Solomons escort sent and blimp K113 proceeding. Suggest Dumbo search from your area to North of that position.

08/1140 09/1140 08 1638 requested B. River instruct DD 886 to proceed to area 31-10N. and 79-08W. B. River said would do. B. River sent original information that destroyer had offered to help. DD enroute Charlestown.

08/1158 08/1650. Port Everglades sent message to B. River stating. "Suggest area from 27-10N. northward between 79-30W and 79-50W. allowing 2.5 knot northerly drift from position 26-30, 26-30N and 79-44W at 1640R 07 Dec. We guess position of life jacket and cylindrical object as approx. 27-27N and 79-42W at 1200R 8 December.

08/1158 08/1654 Banana R. informed that Army 3724 would be in assigned area to 1205R.

08/1200 08/1657 Banana River informed that NG 6 and 7 dispatched to investigate life jacket rept. Dec. y. they have been sent to search exact area suggested by Pt. Ever. ETA station is 1220R. They will move northward thru area.

08/1205 08/1205 Masters Field called Comdr. Baxter and gave information that pilot sighted what appears to be large splotch of what appeared to be blood about 10 yds. square. Many sharks in water area. Position given as 27-45 N and 75-45W. PB4Y pilot from Masters Field sighted same. PANDORA was dispatched to scene in dispatch of 08/1711 received at 1729.

08/1217 SC-663, 08/1455, gave 0945 position as 26.05N. and 76.24W.

08/1225 VIGILANT 08/1601 gave 1100 position as 28.23N. and 77.32W.

08/1233 Com Gulf sent message to Pc780, 08,1858, Proceed to position 31N and 79-10W. Here unfolded life raft sighted. Make square search. Plane standing by. Advise ETA above position.

08/1233 PANDORA 08/1600 sent position as of 1100 R as 28-23N and 75-38W.

08/1243 PANDORA's 1200 position 28-19N and 75-38W.
VIGILANT's 1200 position 28-28N and 77-43W.

08/1246 Pilot from PBY4 sent an amplyfying report on 1st message. Stick reddish brown in color 500 ft. from brown stick very clearly. (CCVERLY-garbled) light oil stick which appeared since my last message. No debris visible. Sea calm wind 280. 12 knots fuel aboard for 6 hours.

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CG District Log, 7ND 0800 8 December - 0800 9 December, 1945 Cont'd

Further Action - Previous Incidents Cont'd

File No. 2273
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost
Action: 08/1249 Sent message 081749 to all parties on ASR TWL also for relay to CNAAUDTC, Boca Raton, ATC Miami, and Orlando, Plan to continue search tomorrow Sunday if not successful today. Search plans will be promulgated when information received of no. and type planes available. Please advise at each unit.

08/1255 Received message from DCGO GND, 08/1725, Chas. dumbo off at 1105R to search area bounded by following coordinates 79W and 32N. 78-30W and 32N 79-30W and 30-30N. 80-W and 30-30-N CGC Travis departing shortly to search area bounded by following coordinates 78-30W and 32N and 78W and 32N. 79-30W and 30-30-N 80-W and 30-30-N.

08/1255 Mayport, 081742 reported ETA of DE's Bown and Jinks on scene of reported lifecraft be 1430R. ETA HFK3 on scene 1800R. Request permission to recall HFK3. In order to have him here in case of another emergency. Gave permission to recall HFK3 at discretion.

08/1255 Received message from Jacksonville 08/1755, Reur 0817491 NAS Jacksonville will have about 55 planes available for search 9 December, including NAS Jacksonville land planes. PBY's Mayport planes and Cecil Field planes would appreciate notification of areas assigned as soon as possible.

08/1305 B. River stated in 08/1805 No. of planes available from here for 9 December 6PBM's 2PBY's 6SNB, SNB will not be available for over water hops.

08/1307 Port Everglades in 08/1807 stated planes available for search 9 December from NAS Ft. Lauderdale 24TBF's, 4 SNB's 11 SNJ's 2 N2's total planes 41.

08/1210 Told B. River Ft. Lauderdale sending 12 TBM's to shore search area by Melbourne. OPA Locks has other standing by ready.

08/1335 Mayport stated Training 13 and 21 have ended search. No results. Request permission secure. Granted.

08/1335 St. Pete 081835 stated one PBM available for long range search Sunday.

08/1345 PANDORA 081745 stated ETA new scene 1400R.

08/1359 Jacksonville sent message from Dumbo 2DE's will be in area to carry further search. Do you think area should be searched by surface craft. Dumbo says have searched area if liferaft was sighted suggest further search.

08/1400 Mayport stated 081855 ETA of DE's Bown and Jinks on 1st reported scene of life raft 1430R. Mayport Dumbo to assist them in surface search.

08/1406 Plane Masters Field reports oil stick fading fast, brown colored water fading fast. Will be in position for 30 minutes.

08/1420 B. River 08/1946, Ref my 081547. We have sent 4SNB's lead

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OC District Log, 7TH 0800 3 December - 0800 9 December 1945 Cont'd

Further Action - Previous Incidents

File No. 2273
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost
Action: 08/1420 by Vero Beady plane to search area 27-30 to 28-15N and 80-40 to 81-0. All planes off by 1344 Weather here has cleared.
08/1423 Sent message to SC-653 SC-106 4, 08/1913 Request information on time, you can remain at sea on present assignment.
08/1423 SC-653 081748 1245 R position 25-48N and 78-31W. We have searched 22 miles square. Results negative.
08/1426 Asked B. River if her planes were still in area of unfolded life raft. B. River answer affirmative. Training 13 and 21 are in that area.
08/1430 Permission given SC-1064 to transmit on 2670Kcs because unable to send on 3000Kcs.
08/1435 Jacksonville 081929, said Lt. Robins Marine pilot from NAS Jacksonville reports sighting at 1330 R white flag attached norral logs at position 080° 40 miles from Daytona. Pilot went down to 100 ft. but couldn't see any personnel. He had to return to Jacksonville due to engine trouble.
08/1435 Requested long range plane from Morrison Field Area to be assigned if available.
08/1440 Sent message Jacksonville 08/1940, refer message from Mayport Dumbo regarding search for unfolded life raft. B. R. states that training 13 and 21 are still in that area. Pass to DD's searching at scene. Jacksonville said Willco.
08/1448 Morrison Field, 08/1946, answered would have 1 long range search plane for search, probably two.
08/1453 B. River 08/1947, stated Navy Smyrna 6 and Daytona Dumbo have been dispatched reported position.
08/1455 Sent message to B. River 081950. Do not confuse info. read from plane asking to secure and stating search negative with Melbourne search above was only plane searching off coast for debris.
08/1500 ComGulf sent message to SC-1290 081857, Cancel my 081612. Proceed to position 27N and 76W. and conduct square search. Advise ETD and ETA send position reports every 2 hours.
08/1500 VIGILANT 1300 R position 28-23N and 77-51W.
08/1506 B. River 082002, Remy 081657, NGWY has covered area from 27-37 and 27-10N and 79-30 and 79-50W with no results. Request instructions.
08/1455 Mayport advises from SC-653 1454 R Fix 26-22N 76-58W.
08/1505 Sent following to Morrison Field "Would appreciate search in area 26-30 to 27-00N and 74 00 to 74-30
SC-1064 advises (081755 1200 position repart (79-25W 24-35N. Pandora advises 081900 1400R position 27-45N 76-45W VIGILANT advises 081900 1400R position 28-28N 75-55W.
08/1506 MacDill Field advises AT 8 AT-11 629 back from search results negative. Searched area 27-30, 28-30N 80-30 81-15W

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CG District Log, 7TH 0800 8 December - 0800 9 December, 1945 Cont'd

Further Action - Previous Incidents Cont'd

File No. 2273
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost

Action:
08/1506 Low fog obscured visibility in southern part of Jack.
08/1529 Answered B. Rivers request for direction. for army 3724 (ATC Miami plane) Return to base.
08/1530 B. River reports FT-34 has sighted four parachutes at 27-48N. and 80-40W. He is circling. With other planes in his flight. They seem to be small chutes possibly from targets or flares. Request instructions.
08/1537 Asked B. River (Can one of your planes check them.
08/1539 B. River advises. We have sent a helicopter to that position
08/1540 Received SC 1064's 081855 "1400 position repeat 79-37 24-23
08/1540 Recal SC-1064's 081805 "1300 position repert 79-25W 24-23N Received VIGILANTS 08200 1500R position 28-34N 77-55W. Recd. PATHFORS 1530R position 27-43N 75-46W.
08/1547 Asked Jax. 08/2047, for 6 or more PBY's to search area 29-00 to 30-00N and 74- to 75W Sunday Acknowledge Jax said O.K. Request position for land planes as soon as possible.
08/1548 B. River advises "Helicopter call sign is Coast Guar 044.
08/1550 Sent following to Morrison Field Will a long range plane be available tomorrow. Area will be assigned shortly if plane is available.
08/1553 Morrison advises "Will have no long range plane available for search tomorrow and probably two.
08/1555 MacDill advised Our Plane AT-11 178 has returned to base. They picked up message on 3000Kcs that all MacDill planes were to return to base. Have you any information.
08/1556 B. River advises. Message was sent by Banana River to secure all MacDill planes. Mayport advises "SC-653 1545R posit. 26-26 76-45W.
08/1601 Mayport advises "Navy Blimp K113 will be available again tomorrow weather permitting.
08/1608 Banana River reports Daytona and Vero Dumbos will be available tomorrow.
08/1610 Sent following to Jax. Land plane search for Sunday. Share to 80-00W and 30-00N. to 32-00N.
08/1617 Sent following to B. River "Search area Sunday 28-30 to 30-00N and 75-00 to 75-00W. Acknowledge. Six, or so planes.
08/1621 Sent following to Ft. Everglades B. Facility. "Pass to NAS Ft. Lauderdale. Land plane search for Sunday 26-00 to 27-00N 77-30W to Coast.
08/1625 B. River advises "Request further instructions for planes FT35 and MCW-6.
08/1626 Sent following to St. Pete. Search Sunday between 27-45 and 28-00N. and 76-00 to 76-30
08/1627 Mayport advises. Mayport Dumbo is returning to base at 1645R. due to low fuel supply
08/1635 B. River advises. Four planes from B. River that searched area 27-30 to 28-15, 80-40 to 81-15 landed. Results negative.

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CG District Log, 7ND, 0800 8 December - 0800 9 December 1945 Cont'd

Further Action - Previous Incidents Cont'd

File No. 2273
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost

Action: 08/1640 Sent following to B. River "Your082125. No further instructions. Use your own discretion.

08/1647 Dinner Key advises Dumbo 1 and 2 on water at 1646

08/1648 B. River advises. Eight PBM planes all landed by 1600 R all search results negative except sighted life raft. As previously reported. Received SC-653's 082044 "1545 R position 26-26N 76-45W.

08/1735 Sent following to Banana River. "Suggest you search area with local landplanes tomorrow. 27-30 to 28-15N and 80-40 to 81-15W. Daytona to search 29-30 to 29-45N and 77-30 to 78-30W. Vero to search 29-00 to 29-15N and 78-30 to 78-30W.

08/1750 Received following (062255) from SC-1064. "1700 position repart 79-20W 24-20N.

08/1755 Received SC-1064's 082055 "Can remain at sea on present assignment until 1200 9 December.

08/1742 Sent following to Jax. B. River, and Ft. Ever., Please advise ZE when search planes have returned to base so that ZE may secure DF stations who are readio guarding them Acknowledge.

08/1744 Sent following to all stations on ASR TWL and CUE67, ComSeven ComGulf, Boca Raton Army Airbase and NAS Ft. Laud. "During search hours one B-29 boatcarrying Dumbo call 1671 and one boat carrying B17 call 3724 are assisting search and are available in an emergency. Both planes guard 4220 Kcs CW and 3000 Kcs voice.

08/1749 NAS Jax. advises "All search planes have returned. Detached.

08/1700 Banana River advises "Reference is made to fires reported near Melbourne last night. Helicopter searching from B. R. landed at 1706R. Results of search as follows. Helicopter landed on scene and indentified flares which one arbiting plane had dropped on the scene last night. The pilot conversed with a civilian Mr. L. C. Smith of Grant Florida, who stated that it was he who had the fire at that place last night and described how planes circled above him and tried to see the area more clearly by use of the planes lights and flares. Another civilian unidentified reported to a member of B. River crash crew, that he was engaged in running cattle in that area last night and also had a fire burning from 2200R to 0600R.

08/1800 Ft. Everglades advises that 12 TBM's from NAS Ft. Laude. landed on the solomb at 1136R and will remain aboard overnight.

08/1818 B. River advises All search planes in but Vero Dumbo. His ETA 1900R.

08/1820 Received VIGILANTS 082200 Position 1700R. 28-52N. 77-51W. Received copy ComGulfs 082215 to CUE 67 Main search other units Sunday from 27-00 to 30-00 and 73-30 to 77-00. Request your plans. Received VIGILANTS 082100 "1600R position

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Further Action - Previous Incidents Contd.

File No. 2273
Subject: Five TBM's(NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost.

Action:
08/1820 28-74N 77-55W. Received PANDORA'S 082100 PANDORA 1600R position 27-55W. Search for blood and sharks so far negative.

08/1845 Received following from Morrison Field. "Aircraft NDR 3987 sighted stationary light at 23052. Not near any body of land Seemed be be flashing SOS position 26-20N 77-35W. Aircraft continuing on course. Position of light did not change as aircraft departed.

08/1900 Received RDo Miami's 082229 "SC-1290 departed Miami 1700R December 8. ETA on station 1700R. December 9. Guarding 2760 Kcs. SC-1290 sends. Received SC-663's 082320 Urdia. 081913, Fortyeight hours maximum.

08/1920 Received Cue C7's 082205 Eleven TBMs on board. Area from Lat. 28-57 to 31-12 Long. 79-14 to 79-40 searched by planes 1,000 ft. altitude one mile interval. Results negative. Proceed into Lat. 30-00 Long. 75-00 to search area east of Long. 75-00 between Lat. 28-55 and 31-05 starting 090700R

08/1921 Received following from B. River NBIG(DD886 Orleck) on 3,000 Kcs. Position is 30-40N 79-10W. Proceeding north on course 000° to cover area that planes searched this afternoon enroute to Charleston will remain on course 000 until morning.

08/1928 SC-1064's 082355 received "1800 position report 79-40W.24-20N.

08/1939 Sent following to CG VIGILANT "Proceed to position 29-00N 77-00W and commence square search.

08/1953 Sent following to CG PANDORA "Secure from present search. Proceed position 28-30N.75-00W. and commence square search.

08/1955 Sent following to CGC Key West. Dispatch one SC if available to proceed to position 25-00N. 79-30W and commence square search. This SC to relieve SC-1064.

08/1959 Mayport advises following from SC-663. 1845R position 28-13N 76-25W.

08/2003 Sent following to SC 1064 "At expiration your endurance return to base.

08/2015 Received PANDORA'S 082312 "Cancel my 082300/ PANDORA 1800R position 27-37N 75-29W. Due to darkness search for blood and sharks impossible. Advise. Received VIGILANTS 082301 "1800R position 28-55N 77-35W.

08/2045 Jax. advises that all planes searched areas assigned and reported negative results.
10 planes from Mayport off at 0932 back 1742
15 planes from Cecil Field off 0840 back 1645
6 planes PBY's from NAS Jax. off 0742 back 1600R
16 planes from NAS Jacksonville off 0913 back 1800R
9 SNJ's from NAS Jax. off 0900 and back 1505

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CG District Log, 7ND 0800 8 December - 0800 9 December 1945 Cont'd

Further Action - Previous Incidents Cont'd

File No. 2273
Subject:
Action: 08/2112 Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost
Jacksonville advises NAS Jax. and Aux. fields search planes will depart as soon after sunrise as possible and will search following areas 6 PBY's 26-00 to 30-00N. 74-00 to 75-00W. Cecil Field 15 SBCC's 31-24N. to 32-00N coast east to 80-00 Mayport 10 planes 30-24N to 30-48N Coast to 80-00W NAS Jax 15 P4U's 30-48 to 31-24 Coast east to 80-00 NAS Jax 10 SNJ's 30-00N to 30-24N Coast east to 80-00W.

08/2115 Flashing light reported by army is evaluated as lighted whistle buoy located within 5 miles of reported position; No action to be taker on this information.

08/235 Received CG Group, St. Pierces 082005 "CGC 83479 arrived this unit 1745 this date." Received VIGILANTS 090101 " 2000R position 28-52N 77-22W.

08/2145 Received SC-653's 082148 "1645R position 26-26-N 76-36W."

08/2155 Received SC-653's 082359 "1845R position 26-13N 76-25W."

08/2222 Banana River advises 9 planes searched assigned areas off 0457 back 1600. Vero Dumbo off 1215 back 1847. Daytona Dumbo off 0350 back 1755. Land search, 8 planes off 1044 back 1855."

08/2231 Mayport advises (SC-653 2145 position 25-55N 76-55W."

08/2300 Received SC-1064's 090200, "2100 position 79-37W 24-23N."

08/2330 Received PANDORS's 090300 "PANDORA 2200R position 27-48N 75-75-34W. Received VIGILANT's 090201 "2100R position 28-61N 77-13W. Received 1290's 090114 "My position at 2100 R 25-58N 79-41W."

08/2345 Received ComGulf 090417 alerting 3 merchant ships to lookout for debris or survivors of crash.

08/2345 Received ASR Controller Boca Chica's 082206 "Temporary Dubmo JRB 66415 departed 1425 returned 1630." Received VIGILANT's 090401 "2300R position 29-09N 77-09W."

09/0111 From DCGO 7ND to SC 653 information Com 7 ComGulf 090535. Priority dispatch? "Return to base when endurance reached.

09/0150 NAS, Fort Lauderdale advises search TBM's 8 December via 090645 TWL via NAOTC, Port Everglades;

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CG District Log, 7ND 0800 8 December - 0800 9 December 1945 Cont'd.

Further Action - Previous Incidents

File No. 2273
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost
Action: 09/0150 "12 TBFs departed Ft. Lauderdale 1336 returned 1733.
09/0151 From Morrison Field Via T/L "2 planes from this base a B-17 and an OA 19 total time searching 17 hours 41 minutes.
09/0152 From MacDill Field via T/L Two planes from this base both were at AP118 total search times were 5 and 1/2 hours.
09/0205 From SC-653 via Mayport on T/L "0145R position 26.31N. 76.29W. weather 23341964
09/0206 Received following from controller quote Capt. J. D. Morrison phone 7-0791 called to report on flare sighted 0158R 8 December. At approximately 0200R Capt. Morrison and Co. Pilot Genther when plane 10 to 15 miles S to SW of Melbourne flying at 3,000 ft. saw red rocket fired. Rocket rose to about 300 ft. and burst with streamers descending. They then saw a light which appeared to be strong searchlight. The plane circled losing altitude and light followed plane. Plane reached altitude at 300 ft. and light was waved frantically while the person holding light moved around to better vantage point. Man was on small island of which there were hundreds in area and landing lights of plane showed to be about one acre in area. This location approximately bears 210 degrees from Melbourne. Range station and almost due west 10 to 15 miles from first beacon south of Melbourne. Lots of water in area Capt. Morrison volunteers to accompany search in locating. Capt. Morrison an Eastern Air Line Pilot.
09/0220 From CG PANDORA to DCGO 7ND 090301 Priority dispatch 2200R position 2900N 7712W
09/0228 From CG PANDORA to DCGO 7ND 090410 Priority dispatch. PANDORA 2300R position 27-56N 75-28W.
09/0229 Fr CG PANDORA to DCGO 7ND 090500 dispatch. PANDORA 2400R position 28 03 N 75 20W.
09/0230 Fr SC-1064 to CGC Key West Chica Base Radio Key West 090515 Priority dispatch. "2400 Position report 79-25W 24-23N weather clear wind
09/0231 From CG PANDORA to DCGO 7ND 090600 dispatch PANDORA 0150 R position 28 11N 75-15W.
09/1232 From SC-1290 to ComGulf 090400 dispatch. My position 2300R 26 08 N 78 57W.
09/0310 From SC-653 via Mayport on T/L 090750 T/L 0245 position 26.29N 76.18W. Have searched 31 square miles. Results negative weather 23341964
09/0330 Passed 09/0206 entry to all ASR stations 090902 T/L and by phone to Lt. Hines duty officer NAS Ft. Lauderdale.
09/0331 From CG PANDORA to DCGO 7ND 090800 dispatch "Pandora 0300 Position 28 26N 75-02W.
09/0332 CG VIGILANT to DCGO 7ND 090700 dispatch "0200R position 29 00N 76 49 W
09/0334 CG VIGILANT to DCGO 7ND 090800 dispatch "0300R position 28-50N 76-49W.

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CG District Log, 7TH [redacted]00 8 December - 0800 9 December [redacted] Cont'd

Further Action - Previous Incidents Cont'd

File No. 2273
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost
Action: 09/0340 From SC-1290 via Mayport T/L 090820: 0300 R Position 25-53N 78-06W.

09/0430 From NAS Banana River to ASR Miami 090930 T/L "Civilian L. C. Smith with whom the pilot of the HHS helicopter conversed on the afternoon of December 8th, described how a twin engine aircraft came low and turned on his landing lights to look at the surroundings. Smith said he had built a fire there and he did not understand why the plane was circling hi . Smith may be contacted by telephone at Couch Manufacturing Co. Grant Fla.

09/0505 From CG PANDORA to DCGO 7ND 090900 dispatch. "0500 Position 28 32N 74 55W.

09/0516 From CG VIGILANT to DCGO 7ND 090900 Priority "0400R position 28-52N 77 00W.

09/0517 To NAS Banana River T/L "We evaluate Smits position at the the ti e as being 20 miles north of reported flare by Capt. Morrison. Well still check further. Advise.

09/518 From NAS Banana River T/L. "That area is included in our search plans for today.

09/0520 From SC-653 via Mayport on T/L 091003 "0445 Position 26 05N 76 18W and weather 23341934

09/0528 From SC-1290 via Mayport on T/L 091005 "0500 R Position 25-49N 77-34W.

09/0600 From NAS Banana River 091050 T/L "6 PBMs departed at 0541 R to search assigned area. Two PBMs departed at 0450R to conduct search beginning at Lat. 31-10N and Long 79-10W.

09/0626 091126 T/L to NAS Banana River from ASR Miami: In reference to our earlier messages regarding Capt. Morrisons report. I have just talked with him and he is certain definitely of a few points which may have bearing. There definitely was no fire in the area that he circled after seeing the red flare. It was a marshy area. He did observe a large fire 30 miles or so further on while at 1000 ft. He made three circles counterclockwise over the individual waving the flashlight and the person was endeavoring to pass a message of some kind as to a possible landing on the water in that area.

09/0627 Requested Port Everglades to pass my 091126 to Banana River to NAS Ft. Lauderdale.

09/0629 From NAS Banana River 091137 T/L "Re ur 091126. We request you get from Capt. Morrison an accurate position. Either as a bearing and distance from a known object or in coordinates of latitude and longitude.

09/0630 Sent to NAS Banana River 091139 T/L "Are you cognizant of information in my first message.

09/0635 091145 T/L from U S Banana River. "We are cognizant of all messages received thus far on this situation. However the position thus far does not seem to be definitely established by Capt. Morrison.

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CG District Log, 7ND 0800 8 December - 0800 9 December 1945, Cont'd

Further Action - Previous Incidents Cont'd

File No. 2273
Subject:
Action: 09/0640 Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost Sent 091151 TWL to NAS Banana River "Position 210 degrees 15 miles."

09/0650 Arrangements made for Ft. Lauderdale to send plane to OPA Locka to pick up Capt. Morrison and Co. Pilot Genther and fly to vicinity where Capt. Morrison spotted red rocket flare.

09/0700 From CG PANDORA to DCGO 7ND 091000 dispatch "0500R position 28 32N 75-05W.

09/0701 From CG PANDORA to DCGO 7ND 091100 dispatch 0600R position 28 23N 75 05W

09/0702 From CG VIGILANT to DCGO 7ND 091000 dispatch "0500R position 28 55N 77 18W

09/0703 From CG VIGILANT to DCGO 7ND 091101 dispatch "0600R position 28 55N 77 26W

09/0730 Sent following 091225 TWL to NAS Ft. Lauderdale via Pt. Everglades. "Suggest you search area carefully in the eastern section of your todays run. Check area around 26-20 and 73 35 to 77 40 where light was seen last night. A buoy is in that area. Check to see if it is a lighted buoy.

09/0745 Received following 1235 G message from SS HAROLD JORDAN position at 1200Z 25 58N 79 43 W sighted large oil slick with debris and white flag investigated but saw nothing else.

/s/ W. T. Murphy
W. T. MURPHY, Lt. Comdr. USCG

approved:

/s/ Wm. Wishar
Wm. Wishar, Captain, USCG

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0801-Ens. De George reported for duty
0830-Lt.(jg)Koch departed Lt. Comdr. Murphy and Seaman Neely reported for duty
Lt.(jg) Perret reported
1130-Seaman Shastid reported for duty
1245-Yeoman Ross reported for duty
1500-Lt. Covey reported for duty
1530-CG Group Miami advised that a body was reported floating in bay last night near Royal Palm Night Club. Bicket boat was unable to locate during darkness. CG-38473 and CG-38506 resumed search at 0915R and secured at 1505R with negative results. CGAS Dinner Key assisted in search with a JRF which was airbourne at 1105R and secured at 1134R with negative results.
1559-End of watch
1601-Lt. Covey, Ens. De. George Lt. (jg) Perret, Lt. Comdr, Murphy, Comdr. Baxter on duty pending incidents file No. 2282,2284,2287.
1705-CGC Miami advised 38473 dispatched to assist boat ZX "HELEN RUTH broken down near Marer 2 in Bay
1715-CGC Miami advises 83504 dispatched to assist small boat reported in distress near Fowey Rock
1846-Yeoman Ross, and Seaman Shastid departed
1930-CGC Miami advises CG-38473 returned base 1910R with HELEN RUTH in tow.
1930-Seaman Neely departed
2122-CGC Miami advised 83504 returned to base at 2118 after towing 14 Ft. skiff to Coconut Grove. Outboard motor on skiff had conked out.
2345-Lt. (jg) Koch reported
2356-Lt. Covey departed
0001-Lt. (jg) G.F. Koch on duty pending action on incidents File 2273,2282,2284,2286 2287
0747-Ensign De George reported
0750-Lt.(jg) Koch departed
0759-End of watch

Current Incidents

File No. 2287

Action Time:		Current
Subject:		Piper Cub NC-26011 crashed
Origin:		Brown Airport
Location:		1/4 Mile east Chapman Field
Action:	09/1310	CGAS Dinner Key advised that Brown Airport reported a Piper Cub NC-26011 Crashed in water 1/4 mile east Chapman Field.JRF was airbourne at 1310R to assist.
	09/1318	Request CGAS Dinner Key to dispatch crash boat. CGAS advised that a civilian boat was already alongside crashed plane to assist.
	09/1320	CGAS Dinner Key advised that Crash boat C-7610 was dispatched to scene.
	09/1325	CGAS Dinner Key advised that one body that of a sailor USN had been recovered from wreckage by civilian boat who was bringing him ashore and doctor was working on survivor. Body of a Chief Air Pilot known to be in wreckage.
	09/1429	CGAS Dinner Key advised JRF landed at 142 7R. Also advised both occupants of Piper Cub NC-26011 had been brought to Chapman Field. Also advised that C-7610 was attempting to tow piper cub into the beach.

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Current Incidents Cont'd

File No. 2287
Subject: Piper Cub NC-26011 crashed
Action 09/1630 CGAS Dinner Key advised that crash boat C-7610 had towed wrecked Piper Cub to CGAS Dinner Key. Both occupants of plane were killed, and bodies returned to Chapman Field. Occupants Jack Yancey, Sgt. of Civilian Air Patrol and Bill Hoffman a USCG Seaman.
09/1720 Dinner Key advised Serial number of Sea. Hoffman taken from his hat is 641 384.
09/1820 Lt. Comdr. Bailey notified and will handle disposition and notification.
Incident Closed.

File No. 2288
Action Time: Current
Subject: Sloop 18G266 Unreported
Origin: CGC Key West
Location: Between Key West and Tortugas
Action: 09/1927 Received copy CGC Key West 092235 "Advised 30 foot double ended auxilary sloop 18G266 gray hull no name departed Key West for Tortugas fishing grounds 1 December unreported to date. Dumbo to search at dawn. Tortugas requested to investigate.

Further Action - Previous Incidents

File No. 2260
Subject: Small vessel in need of assistance
Action: 08/1200 No further information.
Incident Closed.

File No. 2281
Subject: Flares sighted 19 miles SW Melbourne
Action: 09/1340 See File NR 2273 Five TBM's missing for further information.
Incident Closed.

File No. 2282
Subject: 3 Barges lost by tug FRANK W. SPENCER
Action: 09/1340 Received 091516 dispatch to ComGulf from GulFcon Havana. "USA Havana requests barges towed Key West. Await arrival Tug. Navinia Havana has by hand for information. ComGulf pass to interested adees.
09/1400 CGAS Dinner Key, advised that Key West Dumbo would be on standby to assist if necessary.
09/2300 Received SS Crusaders 100300"Two barges hard aground on Cazo Buenavista in Lat. 22-24-30N Long 84-23-15W. Crusader unable to get within four miles of barges.
09/2320 Controller advised Merritt Chapman Scoot is in touch with CRUSADER and attempt would be made in morning to get barges off.
10/0007 From S.S. CRUSADER (KXWD) to ComGulf 100358 OP dispatch: Attempted it will require the services of derrick barge and small tug with not more than six foot draft. These would be used in laying and heaving on beach gear.

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Further Action - Previous Incidents Cont.

File No. 2284
Subject:
Action: 09/0930 Man lost near Appalachicola Mr. Joe Thompson
Received from CGAS St. Pete, "Recur 091348 not in communication with JRF at Appalachicola, Helicoptor departed St.Pete enroute Appalachicola via Ocala Lake City and Tallahassee at 0755. Will advise further when information available.

09/0917 Sent following 091417 to Hon Robert Sikes HC via Western Union Wash DC information to ComGulf ComSeven. CGAS St.Pete. Biloxie DCGO 8HD ComEight, "Your 8 December telegram regarding planes and one helicoptor have been dispatched at dawn this date to conduct search for missing man.

09/2210 St.Pete advises HHS 1 39052 arrived Appalachicola 1538R. Ron. Will conduct search in conjunction with JRF 5 64792, which arrived 8 December 1945.

File No. 2285
Subject:
Action: 09/2220 Green Flares.
Sent following to CGAS St.Pete "Recur 090635.Advise if any information obtained by MacDill re green flares sighted 50 miles west of Tampa.

09/2229 MacDill advises "No information on green flares Search reports negative results.

09/2236 Sent following to MacDill Request that search was made and details.

09/2242 MacDill advises "Search on report from Eastern Air Lines about flares 50 miles from Tampa. We sent two at 11 out. Report was negative.

09/2307 Sent following to MacDill "If information available active types planes sent and times off and back.

09/2310 MacDill advises airplanes were at 11 Take off at 0840 and landed at 1300.

File No. 2273
Subject:
Action: 09/0800 Five TBM's (NAS Ft.Lauderdale) Lost
Received 091210 message from SC1290 0700 R position 26 53 North 77 08 West.
Received 091254 message from NAS Banana River Ref ur 091241 Vero Dumbo will investigate area.
Sent 091257 message to SS HAROLD JORDAN "Request you remain on scene pending arrival vero dumbo now enroute to reported position.
Sent 091256 message to Banana River We are advising SS HAROLD JORDAN accordingly.
Received 091256 message from NAS Banana River What frequency is SS HAROLD JORDAN on.
Received 091258 message from NAS Banana River. Vero Dumbo departed to search assigned area at 07030. Daytona departed 0735 to sea assigned area.

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File No. 2273
Subject: Five [illegible]'s (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost
Action: 09/0809 Sent following 091300 message to NAS Banana River Ship working 454 Kcs. Ship now working WAX Radio Hialeah. Can Planes work WAX on 482 Kcs.
Sent following 091302 message to NAS Banana River. "Following mes. sent action to HAROLD A. JORDAN quote request you remain on scene pending arrival search plane now enroute to reported position.
Received 091245 message from SC-653 0745R position 26-26 worth 76-16 west.
Received 091305 message from NAS Banana River what is voice call for SS JORDAN. We are setting up here on 454 kcs.

09/0810 Received following 091306 message from Boat Facilities Mayport. Request use of Navy Blimp King 113 in our search area toda.

09/0813 Sent following 091310 message to Boat Facilities Mayport Refur 091306 use it if available.

09/0813 Sent 091312 message to NAS Banana River Ref 091305, Voice call same as CW call ANFG

09/0814 Received 091201 message from VIGILANT CG 0700R position 29 02N 77 27 West.

09/0815 Received 091200 message from CG PANDORA 0800R position 28 23N 74 56 West.

09/0825 Received 1313C message from SS HAROLD A. JORDAN "Expect to arrive position at 1327 zebra.

09/0841 Received from NAS Banana River 091337 dispatch ANFG is sending MO(s on 454 kcs for vero dumbo to home in on.
Received from NAS Banana River 091354 dispatch "At 0826 R training 32 reported at position 28-29N and 76-37W sighted an oil slick. Also pilot Chutke possible Kater the navigator identified the pilot chute. I mean bu pilot chute the little chute that is on top of a parachute.

09/0855 Received 091301 message from CG PANDORA 0800R position 29 10N 77 27 West

09/0900 Received 091356 message from NAS Banana River Vero Dumbo arrived on scene of ship SS JORDAN. Sighted oil slick but did not see white flag. Could you have ship pick the flag. Dumbo is not in contact with ANFG.

09/0903 Received 091400 message from NAS Banana River. Ref my 091334. Do you know if any ships in that area.

09/0905 Sent 091403 message to NAS BananaRiver Training 32 is standing by at position plane advise.

09/0907 Received 091339 message from CG PANDORA PANDORA 08005 position 28-74N 74-45W

09/0911 Received 1405 G message from SSHAROLD JORDAN "About 100 Foot area of debris. Several crates and cans. Three lifejackets. White flag attached to stick.

09/0911 Sent 091407 message to NAS Banana River. Ref. 091403. Ship has been asked to go that position and aid plane.

09/0914 Sent 0914111 message to NAS Banana River Your 091405. Why not send New Smyrna speed boat.

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CG District Log. 7ND 0800 9 December to 0800 10 December 1945 Cont'd

File No. 2273
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost
Action: 09/0918 Received 091515 message from NAS Jacksonville advising search planes delayed due to weather.
09/0925 Received 091421 message from NAS Banana River stating How Smyrna boat can get to ship to three hours. We advised by 0914.
09/0930 Controller sent 091413 message to USS SHENANDOAH (AD-26) "Request 1600 GCT position. Oil slick debris and possible parachute sighted position 28-29-N 76-31W plane at position standing by Can you proceed to above position if so advise.
09/0937 Received 090937 message from NAS Banana River advising Vero Dumbo is in area searching for debris and SS HAROLD JOHNSON
09/0940 Received 091437 message from Morrison Field "Army 3715 boat carrying B-17 departed noon 1419Z search.
09/0944 Received SC-1290 message 091415 "0900R position 26 00N 76 48W
Received SC-663 message 091400 "0945 position 26-11N 76-27W
09/0947 Received 091444 message from NAS Banana River "Refur 091407 What ship is proceeding Advised by 091448 message. Refur 091444 ship is USS SHENANDOAH (AD-26)
09/0952 Received 091344 message from WINDSOR Field Nassau "RAF sky train 5 hours in area 25/2026OON, CMA 75/3076OOW on Saturday negative results. Advise if further assistance needed.
09/1000 NAS Banana River advised by 091430 message "Vero Dumbo is trying to find SS JOHNSON advised them of SS HAROLD JOHNSON message stating we are now waiting for plane.
09/1503 From NAS Ban. Riv. Refur 091448 1885 A is training 32 CW call sigh. Can USS SHENANDOAH sit up 4386 kcs. and contact 1885A.
09/1002 CG VIGILANT 0900R position 29 19N 77 27W
09/1005 Sent 091415 (Message from ComGulf to USS SHENANDOAH) to VIGILANT for information
09/1010 PANDORA 0900R position 28 34 N 74 42W
Received 14520 message from SS HAROLD JORDAN "We are now waiting for plane.
09/1011 091508 message from NAS BANANA RIVER Four SNB's departed at 0859 to search assigned area over land.
09/1012 Controller sent following 091447 dispatch from ComGulf to USS PETERSON (DE-152) "Enroute destination request you keep sharp lookout from 27-00N to 32-00N for survivor or debris six planes lost at sea 5 December. Pass to Pool (DE-151)
09/1014 NAS Banana River advised by 091511 message Vero Dumbo is now circling ship(SS JORDAN Has put small boat over the side to investigate.
09/1025 SC-663 0945R position 26-28N 76-56W est.
09/1030 NAS Banana River advised by 091519 dispatch regard to debris around ship. There is no indication of aircraft disaster. It is apparently from aboard ship. From Vero Dumbo.
09/1038 SC 1064 0900 position report 79 degrees 40 minutes West 29-40 North Weather clear wind 8 knots NE Sea2
09/1039 SC-663 0945R position 26 28N 76 48W.
09/1044 From SS HAROLD JORDAN 15 24G Plane circling overhead we have boat picking up debris.

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File No. 2272
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS, Ft. Lauderdale) Lost.

Action:
09/1046 PANDORA 1000R position 28 34N 74 51W
09/1048 VIGILANT 1000R position 29 28N 77 27W.
09/1049 From SS HAROLD JORDAN 1543E message "Captain advises we can't do anymore. Does plane guard 500 kcs."We are shoving off
09/1050 Sent following 091551 to SS HAROLD JORDAN "Does lifejackets or debris you picked up appear to be from ship or aircraft."
09/1059 From NAS Banana River 091555 message Vero dumbo is trying to get on 500 kcs.
09/1100 From Boat Facilities Mayport 091603 message We have blimp assigned from Charleston participating in search here. Can we use for search over swamp lands.
09/1100 Passed above entry to BananaRiver via 091603 message and 091630 message Pass all instruct for Blimp to EL Mayport
09/1100 From NAS Ban River 091555 message Vero dumbo cannot use 500 and 3000 at the samb time. He will remain on 3000 kcs.
09/1100 Received from SS HAROLD JORDAN 1555 E. No lifejackets white flag was fishing marker debris seemed to be old. Don't know if ship or aircraft what is call sign of aircraft and what flag
09/1123 Send 091609 OP message to CG PANDORA proceed to 28 10N 75 08W liferaft sighed. Plane standing by and on 3000 kcs.
09/1130 From NAS Banana River 091611 message Army 3724 will be in assigned area at 1145.
09/1130 Sent 091615 message to SS HAROLD JORDAN "Plane is on 3000 kcs. Call vero dumbo Many thanks for your assistance.
Sent 091611 message to CGAS St.Pete order your airbourne Dumbo to 28 05 and 76 00, Raft sighted.
Condr. Baxter advised that Boca Raton planes had reported two rafts in position 28 05N 76 00N no occupants.
From CGAS St. Pete Refur 1091611 sent to Dumbo
Sent 091621 message to CGAS St.Pete Boca Radon Army planes on 3000 kcs is standby to scene. Another raft has been sighted at 28 10 and 75 08 and PANDORA is proceeding to plane circling area. No occupants seen in either raft. Advise time of receipt this information by your dumbo from St. Pete message delivered at 1606Z.
09/1130 Sent to CGAS St. Pete 091626 message Boca Raton planes on 3000 voice and 3870 CW
09/1135 NAS Banana River advised they intercepted above information asked if any action from Banana River was needed answered by 091637 Negative.
09/1136 Sent 091630 to NAS Banana River. Pass all instructions for blimp to (EL) Banana River.
09/1140 To NAS Banana River 091639 message Refur 091628. Recall 63 footer and have vero dumbo proceed on previous search.
09/1137 From NAS Jacksonville 091654 message advised NAS Jacksonville flights plane had sighted oil slick in 30-35N 80-35W.
09/1145 Sent 091627 message to CG PANDORA Boca Raton planes on 3000 voice and 28 70 CW.
09/1152 Sent 091629 message to NAS Jacksonville Banana River, Miami, Ft. Lauderdale, AACS Morrison Field, AACS MacDill Field.

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File No. 2273
Subject:
Action: 09/1152 Five PBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost Boca Raton, RAF Nassua, CGAS Miami, St. Pete " If unsuccessful today search will be continued tomorrow. Advise as soon as possible number and type of planes available for Monday search. Received 091531 message from USS SHENANDOAH AD-26 "Irdia 091415 GMT position 27-21-5N 76-25-5W. Am standing toward 28-29N 76-37W at best speed. ETA 1920 GMT if search frequencies other than normal advise.

09/1157 From NAS Banana River 091652 message Refer my 091334. Training 32 reports that he has revised position to 29 03N 76 15W Additional objects sighted.

09/1158 From NAS Jacksonville 091655 message. Refer 091640. Blimp K113 evaluation negative.

From NAS Banana River 091655 message NYBW wants to know what plane is circling him in 27-30W. Is it army 3724.

09/1210 From Morrison Field 091709 message. General Hancell and Secretary of Navy here. Request all information of life rafts sighted.

09/1215 To NAS Banana River 091712 message Rear 091655 yes if boat is attached underneath B-17.

ComEast N Y advised "HMS BASUTA departed Bermuda 5 December Navigation Officer on watch challenged by plane with letters CN answered challenge and plane replied with IMI then flew on 060120. lookout reported flares and possible explosion positions 33-48N 66-10W. Searched area with search light for some time,,but results were negative.

09/1205 SNJ 886 from Jacksonville reported sighting parachute at position 36 miles seaward bearing 090 from Jacksonville beach Mayport dumbo enroute.

09/1230 From OTU 111 Raf NAssua 091623 message X222 9/12/45 boat landing 09124 06108 14500 01852 10230

09/1220 CG VIGILANT 1100R position 29 28N 77 12W.

09/1220 Sent 091701 message from ComGulf to USS SHENANDOAH (AD-26) Ref your 091531. Search frequencies are 3000 kcs voice. Planes sighted life rafts one at position 28-05N 76-00W. one at 28 10N 75-08W without occupants. Above is for your info.

09/1220 CGC PANDORA 1100R position 28 34 N 75 02W.

09/1230 SC-653 091705 dispatch. "Have readied limit of endurance Advise

09/1235 From DCGO 7ND to SC 653 091731 dispatch Proceed to Nassau fuel stores then return to present station.

09/1245 091629 message to NAS Jax, Morrison Field, CGAS Dinner Key NAS Banana River, MacDill Field, Morrison Field to pass to Boca Raton. "If unsuccessful today search will be continued tomorrow. Advise as soon as possible number and types of planes available for Monday search.

09/1245 From NAS Banana River 091741 message. Refer your 091629 Eight PBM's and four SNB's. The SNB's for land search.

09/1245 Boca Raton advised Comdr. Baxter other planes sighted two men in life raft position 28 05N 76 00W.

09/1253 From Morrison Field 091744 message refer 091629. One PBY and a B-17 for daylight takeoff.

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File No. 2273
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS, Ft. Lauderdale) Lost
Action:

09/1253 Sent 091748 message to all ASR Two men on raft sighted. 28 04N 76 00 West
Sent 091760 message to CGAS St. Pete Remy 091748. Direct St.Pete Dumbo to position given.

09/1253 Sent 091751 message to NAS Banana River. Remy 081300. Banana River task unit take complete charge of land search.

09/1300 Controller sent 091719 message from ComGulf to USS SHENANDOAH. Received information navy vessel 26 picked up raft. Is that you. If so describe raft.

09/1300 Controller sent 091717 from ComGulf to USS SOLOMONS. Following for your information. Boca Raton planes sighted rafts at 28 10N and 75-08W and 28 05 N and 76-00West no occupants. Possible dye marker near one. Seaplane dumbo and cutter PANDORA proceeding. They are near those positions. USS SHENANDOAH proceeding to position 28 29N 76 37 W. eta 1420R where other plane spotted debris and possibl chute canopy.

09/1310 SC 753 1045R position 26 17N 86 48W.

09/1311 From St. Pete; Dumbo request to know if there are any planes circling two men.
091810 message to St. Pete, Roger planes circling inform dumbo other rafts have been sighted without occupants in General area.

09/1320 From St. Pete 091815 message Information just received by another source indicates that green flare seen this AM was about 1/2 mile to east of highway, between Bonita Springs and esters near double S curve in main highway. This is just south of Ft. Myers.

09/1320 PANDORA 1200R position 28 56 N 75 11 W.
PANDORA proceeding to liferaft, ETA 1400R(PANDORA 091700 dis)

09/1320 Controller sent 091759 message from ComGulf to USS SOLOMONS. Two men on life raft sighted position 28 05N 76 00W. Proceed to scene.
VIGILANT 1200 R position 29 27N 76 58 W.

09/1223 NAS Banana River 091877 advised Shenandoah proceeding to position of reported life raft conaining two men. Present position 28 02N 7636W

09/1330 SC 653 1145R position 26 08N 76-50W.
Orlando AAF Advised they will send super dumbo to 28 05 76 00 to cover rafts with men and other rafts.

09/1335 Comdr. Baxter advised Boca Raton to tell her planes that ship 26 which picked up raft had not picked up plane liferaft. Position was 27 39N 76 32W. and that 3 planes circling him if belonging to Boca Raton should continue to search on raft. area as that is considered more vital.

09/1349 SC-653 1245 R position 2600N 8651 West

09/1352 NAS Banana River 091850 message advised. "From Army 3724. I have completed searching area assigned. Have found one balsa raft. are there any further instructions.

09/1356 From NAS Banana River 091853 position. "Training 32 advises that he has fuel to remain on station for 4 hours. Do you anticipate sending any surface units to this position. Shenandoah to go there before he altered course to liferaft.

09/1400 CGC VIGILANT 1300R position 2927N 7644W.

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File No. 2272
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS, Ft. Lauderdale) Lost

Action:
09/1410 NAS Banana River 091855 message Vero Dumbo has completed search. Results negative. Returning to base, ETA 1515

09/1410 Sent 091957 to NAS Banana River Refer ur 091850. Request rendezvous plane circling two survivors. That Plane on 375 Kcs. How much longer can you remain out there.

09/1410 Sent 091959 to CGAS St. Pete. Have Dumbo home on plane circuling survivors on 375 Kcs.
Sent to Morrison Field 091930 message. Will you contact Boca Raton and find out what frequency they plan circling survivors, is working them on. This is urgent as plane will have to leave scene shortly and we are to alert DF's on that frequency.
Sent 091906 message to NAS Banana River CG VIGILANT proceeding to position of training 32.

09/1410 Received 081404 message from Boat Fac. Pt. Everglades concerning life jackets and cylindrical object reported by tanker LYNN yesterday east of Delray Beach. We are at present searching area from 2638N to 2710N and to 7930W. Utilizing two TBF's and 83 ft. crash boat.

09/1412 Sent 091905 message to CGC VIGILANT Proceed to position 2829N. 7637 W. where oil slick debris and parachute canop were sighted, by plane. Advise ETA.

09/1412 Sent 091901 message to CG PANDORA "Home on plane circling survivors on 375.

09/1415 ASR Charleston "Requested information on call and frequency of plane circling survivors, Call 635 Frequency 3370 advised ETA of SHENANDOAH at position CUE 67 enroute.

09/1421 Sent following message to Morrison Field will get plane call from Boca Raton.

09/1422 NAS Banana River 091917 message advised "Msg. from Army 3724. Am Changing course to position for liferaft with two men aboard. ETA at life raft on hour. CAS Available to circle raft for 4 hours.
Received from SC 1064 091715 dispatch. "Securing" from search area returning to base.
Received from NAS Ft. Lauderdale 091745 dispatch. "Refur 091629 plane available for Monday search December 10, 1945. 24TBF and 4 SNB. 16 SNJ and 3 N2S
Intercept from merchant vessel KYJD to WNV Radio Jacksonville. Plane dipping wing. Have you any report to of distress in this vicinity at present 21 miles 120 degrees from St. John light vessel.

09/1425 SC 1290 1300R. Position 26-31 north 76-17 West.

09/1427 Received 091715 message from USS SHENANDOAH picked up water soaked ship type balsa raft in position 2739N. 7632 W. Dye marked by search plane 22X. Resuming Course for 28 29N 76 37W

09/1427 Received 091821 dispatch from USS SHENANDOAH "Urdis 091751 ETA 2805N 7600W. 2010 GMT. Mayport 1800 GMT 2803N 76387.

09/1431 Received from NAS Banana River 091929 message Daytona dumbo has completed search with negative results. Will now search from 29-30N south in same longitude.

09/1434 Controller sent 091915 message from ComGulf to USS SOLOMONS. If within your range reinforce search centered on 28 05N 7600W.

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File No. 2272
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS, Ft. Lauderdale) Lost

Action: 09/1434 Advise us ETA Plane circling survivors low on gas.
Received from NAS Banana River 091931 message "We have two PBM's standing by on the water here. Acknowledge by 091931, message
Received from Morrison Field 091934 message "A-3715 proceeding to 28 05N 7600W to continue search.

09/1437 Alerted DF net (army) on plane Call 0635, frequency 3870, Transmitting steady signal.

09/1439 Received 091936 message from NAS Jacksonville "NAS. has six PBY's appr. 70 to 100 miles north of position given two men in life raft. We are trying to establish CW Contact with planes. If contact can be established shall we send them to position.
Sent to NAS JAX 091940 message UR 091936 affirmative Advise.

09/1447 Received from Morrison Field 091943 message. Boca Raton says that plane call is 0635 frequency 3870 it is a B-24.

09/1458 Received 1950 G message from KYJD SS MARTIN RUSSEL. Now picking up survivors in liferaft.

09/1458 Received from NAS Banana River, "The 6 PBM's from here are proceeding to position. They have completed their search "091955 message "We are trying to contact our PBY's now to go to position. They have completed their search.

09/1448 From NAS Jacksonville 091948 message to all ASR, NAS Jax unable to raise PBY's on CW, Request other stations trying to contact them and send them to position of men in life rafts. PBY's on 4265 kcs. CW call signs. 1721 "1721 T 1721W 173Y 17230 and 1721z. Planes are guarding 3000 voice.
Sent following 091953 message to NAS Banana River and Jacksonville "Corrected fix is now 27 55 N 77 15 W. Investigate PANDORA Being diverted to new position.
Sent following 091946 message to CGAS St.Pete HF.DF Net bearings of plane circling 2 men in raft 27-55 north 7720 west. Deliver to your dumbo.

09/1505 Received Jacksons 1455 NAS Jax tower intercepted message that Tanker Irving Russel is lowering life boat picking up survivors Mayport Dumbo reports position survivors being picked up 30 08N 80-40W

09/1507 Received following from WAX "Message from KTHE on 500 Kcs. KTHE preparing to pick up survivors.

09/1506 Received from Banana River "Alert KKMU PBM dunking.

09/1513 Sent to WAX for delivery to SS Pan Florida. "Proceed to vicinity 27 58N 75 00W. 2 survivors in life raft. Banana River advises call sign of PBM is 1884P. HF, DF net alerted. Position 79 39 30 30

09/1515 Sent to WAX for delivery to SS ELLS HILLS. "Give position where survivors picked up.

09/1520 NAS Ft. Lauderdale, requests by phone, names of any survivors when known.

09/1520 Received following Jacksonville advises PBY C. call QUVQ V has been contacted and is proceeding to 28 05 N 76 00 W to investigate life raft with two men. PBY has emergency IFF on

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Subject: Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost
Action:

09/1520 Advised ASR TWL Cancel previous position at life raft New Proper position 28 20N 76 27W. Move all ships planes that point.

09/1520 Received RAF Nassau's 091920 "Will have one plane for search Monday if required. A 29 NR AM751 call VPXC pilot Latta.
ComGulf advises AD 26 Proper position 27-55,77 15W of survivor
VIGILANT advises 1400R position 29-23N 7631W.
VIGILANT 091927 received "ETA 1800R" Pandora's
091927 received PANDORA 1400R position 28 11N 75 08W

09/1524 Copy of message to PANDORA received "Proper position of survivors 27-55N 77-15W proceed immediately.

09/1522 Advised Mayport HF/DF Six on PBM dunking at 2016Z is 29 25N 79 58 W. radius 40 miles
Banana Rivera advises, "Daytona Dumbo has him in sight.

09/1527 Received USS SOLOMONS 091942 "ETA 2110 AM searching ahead until dark in triangle 29-38N, 73-50W and 28-30N. 7405W and 28-36N. 74-48?W with 8 planes.
Receive PANDORAS 091943 PANDORA 1330 R position 28-08N 7509 unable to home in survivors, Requests their position.

09/1532 UNU Reports intercept from SS Pan Florida, "My position now 28-16N, 76-21W. Received copy our message to SS Irvin Russell "Did you pbk up any survivors. What are characteristics of raft color material identifing number and names. Urgent.

09/1537 Banana River reports training 17 has dunked between two DE's position 60 miles from base.

09/1538 WAX received following from SS ELY Hills who reports ship not in vicinity. ETHE reports call apparently KYDG this is the IRVIN R.

09/1541 WAX received following from SS Pan Florida "We will be in a position in about 2⅓ hours am proceeding so ordered.

09/1544 Banana River reports "Last from 47 is he is 40 miles from Daytona heading from Daytona Beach.

09/1545 Advised Banana River "Fix on 9635 28-40N 79-2W at 2040Z Radius 50 miles. Banana River advises Training 17 is being towed to New Smyrna by the DE

09/1555 Mayport advises "Training 47 CW call 1884P is at St. Augustine
PANDORA advises "1500R position 29-09N 75 13W. ETA 2300R position of survivors." Received NAS Miami 091915 Eight PBY4's aircraft available or search Monday (2) advise section to be searched.

09/1559 Received VIGILANTS 092005 We are proceeding to following corrected position of parachute canopy. 2933N 76 15W. ETA 1600R.
Received SC-1064's 091600 1100 position reports 78-25W 24-23N

09/1609 Banana River reports first reported dunking did not go down no miles off Daytona. That was his position at one time. As far as we can figure out he headed from there for St. Aug. to CVE 87.
New Probable position of survivors 28 20 27 W.
Above all sent to AD 26 above also passed to ASR TWL

09/1624 Dinner Key advises Vero Dumbo landed at 1545
NAS Jacksonville advises "Planes available for search 10 Dec.
Mayport 10 planes including 6 SNB's 1 J2F 3 SNJ's
NAS Jax. 24 PBY's provided 12 requested from Pensacola arrive.
4 SNB's 8 SB2C's 21SNJ's 55 F4U's and 11 FGF8s Total no. of

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File No. 2273
Subject:
Action:

Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost.

09/1624 Planes available NAS Jax., Cecil Field and Mayport 193. Would appreciate assignment of areas to be searched as soon as possible.

09/1630 Comdr. Baxter received following report from St. Falk, Boca Raton pilot of B-24 # 0635 at 1115R he saw one life raft. While circling he discovered 2 more tied together, covered or overturned at 28-05N 76-00W. Then saw two men possible tired, not seen after first sighting at 500 ft. altitude. Following more in area and aware of rafts. B-29 #1671, B-17 the B-24 a freightly and a small Navy vessel A dye sea marker was dropped at scene of rafts tied together. Plane departed at 1515R. Search area for tomorrow 28-45 27-45 78-00 77-00 W.

09/1637 Received PANDORA'S 092100 PANDORA 1600R position 28 06N 75-29W.

09/1645 Received VIGILANT's 092100 1600R position 29-05N 76-20W

09/1647 Received Mayports 092953 From SC-655 1545 position 25-37N 7713W ETA Nassau 1720R. Morrison Field request Do you still want a boat dropped to the two men in the life raft if so I can contact my B-17 NR 3715. He is carrying a boat.

09/1650 Banana River advises. Training 32 is securing due to lack of fuel

09/1652 Morrison advises. "Planes in area of life raft one both carrying boats B-29 is from Orlando and the other is from here.

09/1655 WAX advises following received from KYJD (IRWIN RUSSEL) 33 ½ mile bearing 114° from St. Johns Light Ship boat just returned with what is believed to be target used by palnes for firing practice. Wait for more details.

09/1710 Morrison advises "3715 is now working CTO 5015 kcs. We will tell him QTN.

09/1715 Received VIGILANTS 092150 Plane that reported corrected position of parachute has departed We are conducting search in area. Shall we continue search advise.

09/1727 Advised Morrison Ref ur request for Latest Position of raft. Latest information here puts it radius 30 miles 28-20N. 76-27 W. Morrison says plane now has position and is proceeding to it.

09/1830 #1671 B-24 Pilot Capt HOTCHKISS, pilot of Super Dumbo reports they sighted No. life rafts at D.R. position 28-20N 76-15W. Atthat position Navy Aux. 1 mo[illegible], 1 B-24, 1 B18, in sight. Only plane contacted was B-29 #2112, sister plane of Eglin Field no boat on #2112, but has 3 droppable rafts. Saw 2 B-24 1 B17, and 1 PBY no rafts seen, and we departed on different course. At 28 20 76-15 (maybe 10-15 miles off) saw all those vessels and planes but no rafts. A B-17 near may have had a boat, but not close. We are carrying an experimental boat at present.

09/1745 Capt. de Witt, Miami, ATC, reports saw gray life raft, at 26-32N 74-34 West. Sent message to Banana River via NWBW, Shenandoah, Balsa raft Battleship gray. No marks. Shenandoah picked up one, but not this.
Saw another life raft in midst of seaweed near 26-32N. 74-34 West, dropped yellow sea marks on it, at was empty, no gear adrift at all around it, probably off freighter or tanker.

09/1810 Called Army B-29 Pilot of #2112 sister of the B-29 Super Dumbo he reports dropping a dye sea marker and light at raft.

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File No. 2273
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost
Action: 09/1810 Two or 3 men in plane could see marker between 1300 1400. A B-17 tried to direct ships to life raft. He talked with a B-24 #0891 saw a B-17, Two B-29 and two vessels. We let up a small Navy vessel. #26 (The SHENANDOAH) a dye sea marker on raft, the Navy #26 (SHENENDOAH) picked raft up. Pilot says he couldn't see it but his crew said a B-24 crossed it twice no one reported aboard. This raft was smaller, dark orange in color. Zoomed to all rait attention at 1540 to 1400F at Position, 28-22N. 76-05W. Remained until ship picked up raft.

09/1717 Received PANDORAS 092200 1700R position 2830W 7638W.

09/1716 Morrison advises Do you want 3715 to QTN

09/1718 Advised Morrison If he is over the life raft by all means.

09/1720 St. Pete advises "Buno 519 5492 requests permission to return to base due to lack of fuel.

09/1721 Advised St. Pete. Permission granted.

09/1725 Morrison advises Negative on your last message to AS as 3715 is not over life raft., have him QTN upon arrival over life raft.

09/1737 Morrison advises "AC 3715 has only 500 gals gas left. He is returning to base. Any further instructions.

09/1742 Advised Morrison Negative.

09/1802 Jax, reports all NAS Jax and Aux. plane returned from search. Detailed report will follow

09/1820 Morrison advises "Air Craft 3715 has landed this station air sea rescue officer this station wants to know if you want to continue search with aircraft.

09/1844 Banana River Advises, Second SNB search over assigned island area results negative except for tail of FG' N 203 at position 27 46N 80-46W. Ban. River plane to secure search that area this date unless otherwise advise. Received SC-1290's 092210 1700R position 26-55N 75-55W. Received ComGulfs 0922226 to SC-1291 "Correcting my 081612. SC-1291 proceed position 2815N 7630W and conduct square search. USS SC-1291 has by hand for action. Received CVE 67's 092215 area between Lat. 28-56 and 31-04 from Logn. 75-12 to 73-30 covered by air search planes 1,000 feet two mile intervals. Sector originating Lat. 29-38 Logn. 73-50 from 190° to 220° true distance 90 miles covered by 8 plane search. Results negative. Proceeding to Lat. 2820 Long. 76-26 ETA 092345R. Intend to search adjacent area tomorrow unless otherwise directed.

09/1858 Received VIGILANTS 092301 "2310 F position 2902N 76-20W.

09/1900 Received SC-653's 092312 Arrived Nassau 1735R unable to obtain fuel or supplies until tomorrow. Will get them through U.S. Army.

09/1923 Sent following to Banana River "4 PBYBs to search 2900 to 29-30 and 7500 to 7600 12 PBM's search 27-30 and 2900 and 7400 to 7500 Vero and Daytona to standby.

09/1930 Received from WAX following message from SS PAN FLORIDA. "am in vicinity 27-58N 76-00W. Have been searching contacted naval vessel W 193. (PANDORA) by blinker. Nothing sighted as yet shall we maintain search.

09/1937 Sent following to SS. PAN FLORIDA "Request you continue search"

09/1945 Banana River requests "Could you give me dope that you have on

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File No. 2275
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS, Ft. Lauderdale) Lost
Action:

09/1945 The Two survivors in a raft picked up by a freighter.

09/1950 Comdr. Baxter interviewed Major Estes pilot of B-29 from Orlando not the super dumbo, who took over from Boca Raton B-24. The B-29 buzzed everything in area. He sighted one cardboard box and two packing boxes close together. No one in or on them. Nothing else sighted in area.

09/1955 Received PANDORA's 0923002 PANDORA 1800R position 28-03N 75-52W. Received VIGILANTS 10001 "1900R position 2853N 7625W.

09/1958 Sent following to Banana River SS IRWIN RUSSEL first reported taking survivors aboard. Laters stated had raft, no occupants. Raft appeared to be target raft.

09/2009 Sent following to CVE 67 "We are concentrating search tomorrow between 74-00 and 2800 andbetwebn 2730 and 2930. Reports of picking up any survivors on rafts today was unfounded. One army plane reports sighting one raft but no occupants and two rafts together with two occupants at 1115R. in position 2805 and 76-00W. All other planes and vessels there at the time indicate they were packing cases and other debris and not rafts. Personnel conversation between air sea rescue controller and pilots of the planes indicate no aircraft life rafts have been sighted. Request your plans for Monday.

09/2015 Sent following to all ASR units on TWL "Status of search to date. Evaluation on all repeat all sighting of aircraft type life rafts and survivors is negative. Search negative.

09/2015 Received PANDORAS 100005 1900R position 2802N 7601W.

09/2016 AD 26 reports (092317) have searched area in civinity of 28-05. 7600W and in company with 5 army planes and one merchant ship, area in vicinity 2820N. 7627W. Result negative. Will proceed on duty assigned unless otherwise directed.
Mayport advises Operations misinformed as to life raft mentioned Object picked up was target sleeve. rpt. target sleeve by freighter ERWIN RUSSEL.

09/2021 Advised NAS Jax. Search area with available PBY's

09/2024 Banana River advises 6PBM's returned to base. One at St. Augustine and one in tow enroute New Smyrna. Results of search. Possible parachute at 29-30N 7500W. and a shiny metal object 6 feet by 3 feet by 3 feet one quarter mile west of parachute. Another parachute type at 28 29N. 76 37 W. particularly above water object attached. Two boxes orange in color one to three miles north of second parachute. Other object in area not identified.

09/2025 Sent following to SS PAN FLORIDA "your assistance appreciated. Proceed on your voyage.

09/2043 NAS Jax. Advises. "e are waiting for assignment of area you wish ourPBY's to search tomorrow.

09/2058 Advised Jax. Appreciate if you will search area 27-30N 29-30N 7700W 7800 W.

09/2105 Capt. Hitchcock Orlando Army Air Base called, and was advised of evaluation on sighting to date. He will search area assigned with 2 B29's, 2 B-17's and 1 or more B-25's. Received VIGILANTS 100101 "2 00R position 28-48N 76-27W. Received copy ComGulfs 10013 to AD 26 Your assistance appreciated. Proceed on duty assigned.

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File No. 2275

Subject: Five TWI's(NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost

Action:

09/2125 Received PANDORA's 100100 PANDORA 200R position 2800N 7615W.

09/2138 NAS Jack. advises "Is assignment of areas for PBY's only"

09/2140 Jack. asks Do you have areas for our land planes to search tomorro

09/2141 Mayport advises Training 57 landed at 1601R.

09/2143 Advised Jack. Ur 100238 affirmative.

09/2146 Advised Jack search by land planes will not be required tomorrow.

09/2200 St. Pete asked, Advise if PBM Flight will be required from this unit tomorrow.

09/2205 Advised St. Pete. Your status for tomorrow is standby.

09/2207 Received VIGILANT 00201 "2100R position 2842 N7626W.

09/2210 Received PANDORA 00215 PANDORA 2100R position 2800N 7631W. Request further information available on correct position of survivors.

09/2242 Received Jack. report of search. Planes were delayed in departing due to weather. All planes searched sectors assigned with 100% coverage. All objects sighted were investigated. Results negative. Total number of planes flown in morning search 46, in afternoon 51

09/2253 Sent following, dispatch to CTC PANDORA ERDIS 100215 search today negative. Further report on sighting of survivors in life raft indicate they were packing boxes. Evaluation of all sightings negative.Proceed to position 28-45N. 77-30W and commence square search at daylight. NAS Jack. planes will be in area tomorrow.

09/2301 Mayport advises 2200R position 28-37N 76-26W of VIGILANT

09/2305 Received CNE 67's 1 0253 Your 100109 Proceeding to Lat 30-00 Long 7335 to search to eastward of 7335 between ~~XX~~ lat 2855 and 3105 starting 100700R. Proceeding Mayport with leak in main steam Boriem proceeding Mayport in morning to provision and refuel. Jenks remains with us for plane guard.

09/2323 Received PANDORAS 100310 PANDORA 2200R position 2759N 7645W.

09/2335 Received Banana River 100412 Report of search. Search included 6 PBY's vero Dumbo, DaytonaDumbo SNB searched assigned inland Melbourne area.

09/2350 From NAS Banana River 100448 TWL. Training 17 moored behind Navy Smyrna 7 at N. Smyrna Secured at 2325 Roger time. Will be passed in the morning. 100 octane available will advise tomorrow further developments.

10/0015 Boca Raton advises via CAA Miami that one of their planes at 092340 spotted an SOS flashed to him by a red signal light in area location approx. 30 miles NW of Boca Raton 10,0015 Boca Raton dispatch plane to investigate

10/0019 CG VIGILANT 2400R posn. 2827N 7626W from VIGILANT Via Mayport 100600ZWL.

10/0025 From CG PANDORA to DCGO 7ND 100400 dispatch 2300 R position 2757N 7659W

10/0026 From DE 666 (Durik) to CVE 67 Solomons, ComG information ComEast CMAOPTRACOMD,ComNasector Navairoptracomdt. ComGulf,CinClant Comairlant NAAF, at Mayport, 100305 dispatch DURID reports 092200R 2850N 7546W. Course 285 speed 17. ETA Mayport 101615R.

10/0045 From CG PANDORA to DCGO 7ND 100500 dispatch 2400R position 2758N 7653W.

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CG District Log, 7ND 0800 9 December - 0800 10 December 1945 Contd.

File No. 2273
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS), Ft. Lauderdale Lost
Action:
10/0115 From SC-1290 via Mayport 100612 TWL 0100R position 27.10N. 75.49W.
10/0120 From CGC VIGILANT Via Mayport 100600 TWL 0100R position. 2827N 7621W.
10/0155 From USS Wakefield (Ap-21) to ComGulf 100345 Dispatch "Your 080221 search along track from 3600N 7500N to 2405N 7415W. was negative.
10/0156 From CG PANDORA to DCGO 7ND 100600 dispatch "0100R position 2804N 7658W.
10/0250 From CG Pandora to DCGO 7ND 100700 dispatch "0200R position 2810N 7703W.
10/0315 Capt. Thomas from Boca Raton Army Air Field called and reported an Army AT11 just before 2400R 09 December while flying over the Everglades in approx. posn. 2633N. 8031W. (Within 5 mile range spotted white light and when plane made pass over posn. SOS was flashed in code with a red light. Area is desolate and uninhabited. Boca Raton dispatched B17 at 10/0015 to investigate, and while they found position were unable to get more than SOS on red light from person on the ground.
10/0330 From CG VIGILANT to DCGO 7ND 100700 dispatch. "0200 Posn. 2827N 7615W.
10/0331 Sent following 100825 TWL to ATC Morrison Field. "We have someone at position 2633N. 8031W. within five mile radius who is showing a white light and flashing SOS in code with a red light. This is up in your area close the Hollsboro Canal. Request if you could dispatch something of earliest opportunity to investigate.
10/0332 From SC-1290 0300R position 2713N 7608W. 100801 TWL
10/0335 From CG VIGILANT to DCGO 7ND 100800 dis. "0300R. position 2820N 7616W.
10/0340 From CG PANDORA to DCGO 7ND 100800 dispatch "0300R position 2818N 7709W.
10/0420 From CG VIGILANT to DCGO 7ND 100900 dis. "0400R. position 2817N. 7615W.
10/0431 From SC-1290 to ComGulf 100801 dis. 0300R. Position 2713N.7608W.
10/0432 From ComGulf to Irex (SS-482) Clamagore (SS-343) Lt.391 Lat.56 information DCGO 7ND "Enroute destination request you keep sharp lookout from 2700N to 3200N for survivors or debris of six planes east of sea five December.
10/0710 From CG VIGILANT 10100dis. 0500R position 2812 N 7615W.
10/0711 From SC 1290 via Mayport 101015 TWL 0500R posn. 2653N 7610W
10/0712 From CG VIGILANT to DCGO 7ND 101100 dis. 0600 Posn. 2812N.7626W.

Approved:

Wm. Wishar, Captain, USCG W. T. MURPHY, Lt. Comdr. USCG

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CG District Log, 7ND

0800 10 December - 0800 11 December 1945

0801-Ens. C. V. De George on duty
0830-Lt. Comdr. Murphy, reported for duty. Yeoman Ross, and Shastid reported. and Miami Army Air Field "Naval Operating Base Guantanamo advised Air Sea Rescue Station at south Caroos discontinued.
1015-CGAS Dinner Key advised that JRF 224 departed to search for a green 4 door sedan near route 26, Hialeah towards the glades.
1142-CGAS Dinner Key advised that JRF 224 secured from search at 1142, State highway patrol was continuing search
1548-Lt. R. F. Sauer reported for duty
1559-End of watch
1601-Lt.Comdr. Murphy, Ensign De George and Lt. R.F. Sauer on duty, Lt. (jg) Perret Yeoman Ross, and Shastid on duty Pending Incidents No. 2273, 2282, 2284, 2286, 2289, 2290, 2291, 2292.
1603-Ens. C. V. DeGeorge departed
1700-Yeoman Ross and Shastid departed
1715-Lt.Comdr. Murphy and Lt.(jg) S.G.Perrit departed
1730-Received message from DCGO 8ND, 10/2212, stating, "Tanker bulkfuel aground Bolivar Rds. vicinity buoy NR9. Channel partially blocked to traffic. Agents dispatching tugs to assist in floating. Pilots notified. Will advise further developments.
1800-Received message from DCG) 8ND, 10/2240, stating "Ref my 10/2204(2212) Ship refloated 1630 proceeding to sea.
1805-Received message from DCGO 8ND 10/2250 stating Tortugus D. F. station out of time present signal is a growl. No sigh. Called Lt. Comdr. Reilly, and said to send above message to CGG Key West which was done at 2027R.
1920-Received message from lxl37 Cetter, stating: What is reason for requesting re-check of position. Do not understand your message. Is any emergency indicated. Of 20 make request for HDF bearings thru regular channels. Duty officer NFDF advised this message be sent.
2230-Called CG Duty Officer, Miami, and reported that Lt. Comdr. Dane had stated there was a part of a dock 12 x 12 ft. tied to dock at 5325 Pine Tree Drive on Indian Creek, requesting boat be sent after it in morning.
2340-Lt. R.S.Covey reported for duty
2355-Lt. Sauer departed
2359-End of watch
0001-Lt. R.S.Covey on duty, pending incidents File No. 2282, 2284, 2286, 2288, 2273, 2289, 2290, 2291, 2292, 2293
0745-Ens. C.V.DeGeorge reported for duty
0757-Lt. Covey departed
0759-End of watch

Current Incidents

File No. 2289

Action:	Current
Subject:	Possible Fighter down
Origin:	Lt. Cook, Ft. Lauderdale #240
Location:	Over water
Action: 10/1018	HF/DF Received phone call from Mr. Cook Navy Ext. 240 Ft. Lauderdale of Navy fighter on 142.74 emergency 1FF saying plane was over water Canova Beach originated the emergency 1FF report.

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CG District Log. 7ND 0800 10 December 0000 11 December 1945 Contd.

File No. 2289
Subject: Possible Fighter Down
Action: 10/1030 Passed all information to ASR circuit. Passed information to CG Air Station, who have JRF up, Dumbo will go up.
10/1030 Called Mr. Cook, Ft. Lauderdale 7240, who said they had no more information, but intercept indicated all fighters have been recalled.
10/1035 Checked operations Location, all fighters in test 7125 on a test flight , no plan of flight.
10/1037 DF, CGA Station reports Dumbo 703955 I, up 10300. Dumbo #2 JRF 707722, out to east Miami, and CG-63043, AMR alerted Clyt. Cut enroute Miami Sea Hoy.
10/1048 To reports Canova Beach, Code was bearing 270°.
10/1050 Lt. Cook, Ft. Lauderdale reports Ft. Lauderdale, ready planes diverted 1050 to assist possible crash.
10/1054 ASR net. Canova beach reported that IFF picked up was not emergency IFF
10/1057 Opa Locka reports 7125 landed O.K. No. Fighter missing. Forman Field reports 152 had broadcast on Emergency landing. He landed O.K. checking to see if IFF emergency used.
10/1105 7152 landed safely at Forman Field, did not use emergency IFF.
10/1140 Called Forman Field, Hollywood 7755 Plane landed, engine smoking, did not say he was over water.
10/1142 Dumbo #2 down, at Miami CGAS
10/1153 Informed CGAS and Ft. Everglades Opa Locka reports plane No. 152 landed at Forman Field. Had short broad cast saying emergency landing and then safely landed. He used no repeat no emergency IF
10/1221 Comdr. Baxter evaluated Miami alert as tied in with S82c down off Vero Beach, to secure present alert this area.
10/1221 Sent out 101721 on ASR Circuit " resent alert Miami area fighter cancel evaluated as intercepted from S82c down off Vero Beach. Fighter planes this area accounted for.
10/1224 CGAS reports Dumbo 2 down, and 63043 securing at Causeway Island.
10/1230 Received Ft. Everglades 101730 reporting they are securing. Information to Banana River.
Incident closed.

File No. 2290
Action Time: Current
Subject: Medico SS WILLIAM L. WATSON
Origin DCGO 10ND
Location: 6 miles south of Martinique
Action: 10/1252 Received following 101410 message from SS WILLIAM L. WATSON passed by DCGO 10ND message 101650 message to USS MARINE HOSPITAL, Key West by DCGO 10ND message 101650 message to USS MARINE HOSPITAL, Key West CGSF and ComTen. "Man aboard very ill shows following symptoms. Fever at noon 103 point 8 7ND 102 point at 0800 AM respiration 25 Pulse 120 face flushed and skin hot. After several hours profuse perspiring fever graually subsides. Sever headache Muscular aches arms and legs pains in back. Vertigo. Tongue heavily coated yellow brown. Has just recovered from bronchites. Deported Takoradi West Africa Nov 27. Malaria evident. Please advise Positio given as 6 miles south of Martinique at 1640Z.

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CG District log, 7ND 0800 10 December 0800 11 December 1945 Contd.

Current Incidents Contd.

File No. 2290 Contd.
Subject: Medico SS WILLIAM L. WATSON
Action: 10/1302 Passed above information to USPS Dr. Love, Miami, who advised following message be sent from DCGO 7ND to DCGO 10ND, information CGSF, ComTen/101815 message. "Refer medico aboard SS WILLIAM L. WATSON, USPHS Miami, advised following treatment. Asperin grains 15 every four hours until temp. normal then as often as necessary. Force fluids. Bed rest. Keep bowels open. Keep us advised of future course of fever.
A-Board advised that ship was bound for Mobile ETA 17 Dec.
10/1630 Passed to MIO Lt. Comdr. Studley.

File No. 2291
Action Time: Current
Subject: MEDICO, SS EDWARD KAVANAGH
Origin: CG Radio Hialeah
Location: departed New Orleans 9 December for France
Action: 10/1404 Received following 101844 message from SS EDWARD KAVANAGH to USPHS Miami "Have patient with object imbedded in iris of eye request treatment or hospitalization.
10/1407 A-Board advised ship departed New Orleans 9 Dec. bound for Marsaillos France.
10/1410 Passed above information to USPHS, Doctor Love, who advised medical treatment and removal to hospital as per following message. from DCGO 7ND to SS EDWARD KAVANAGH information DCGO 8ND "Advise position and ETA at Key West seabouy where patient can be removed, for hospitalization. USPHS Miami, advises following treatment. Use Cocaine four percent drops or pontacaine one per cent drops as often as necessary to control pain in eye. Keep eye closed with bandage.
10/1550 Received from SS EDWARD KAVANAGH LC2003 message. "ETA Key West sea bouy 0330 GMT Dec. 11: Abeam tortugas now.
10/1620 Passed to MIC, Lt. Comdr. Studley
10/1655 Sent message to CGG Key West 102143, stating SS EDward KAVANAGH enroute France from New Orleans, has man aboard with object imbedded in iris of eye. USPHS doctor advised use cocaine 4% drops or pontocaine 1% drops as often as necessary to control pain in eye. Keep eye closed with bandage. Ships ETA Key West 03306 Mt have boat meet her. Pass to MIO
11/0810 Sent message to CG Group Key West from DCGO 7ND #111209. Advise action SS EDWARD KAVANAGH Medico."

File No. 2292
Action Time: Current
Subject: MEDICO SS PAN YORK
Origin: CG Radio Hialeah
Location: At sea destination Cristobal
Action: 10/1430 Received following 101830 message from SS Pan York "Negro male cook 27 years of age taken sick suddenly with pains in joints and left side fever first day 101 degrees 2nd day 102 degrees pulse 82 per minute breathing 25 per minute stop breathing 25 per minute. Treatment given stop put to bed given epsom salts 2 aspirin tablet every four hours after taking epsom salts bowels moved and patient

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CG District Log 7ND 0800 10 December - 0800 11 December 1945 Contd.

Current Incidents Contd

File No. 2292
Subject: MEDICO SS PAN YORK
Action: 10/1430 vomited stop gave pineapple and orange juices raw egg and milk stop patient vomited raw egg and milk but was able to hold fruit juices on stomach stop giving fruit juices now only and two aspirin every 4 hours also rubbing patients chest and neck with vicks vaporub stop Patient suffered from double pneumonia 2 years ago stop was treated US Naval Hospital at Pearl Harbor for Hernia one year ago stop Expect to arrive Cristobol Canal Zone December 12th 6PM
10/1455 A-Board advised SS PAN YORK departed Mobile 8 December
10/1440 Passed all information to USPHS Miami, Dr. Love, who advised the following message to be sent from DCGO 7ND to SS PAN YORK
Ref your medico negro cook, USPHS Miami advises following treatment. Sulphadizine or sulphathiazole 2 grams first dose then 1 gram every four hours. Force fluids. No solid food, Aspirin to control pain. Keep us advised.
10/1620 Passed to MIO Lt. Comdr. Studley

File No. 2293
Action Time: Current
Subject: MEDICO SS SWIFTLIGHT
Origin: CG Radio Hialeah
Location: 160 miles NE Miami
Action: 10/2325 Received message from SS SWIFTLIGHT, LL/O8552, stating, "Man deckhand age 18, restless last nite, worse this AM. 5PM temp 103° 6PM Pulse is 108 at 1015PM respiration pulse 18 min. Appearance normal. Slight muscular contraction all over. Good bowel movement. Orange juice only today. 9:30 PM fever 104.1°. Treatment 2 grams sulphathiazole at 6PM 1 gram at 10 PM please advise. Ship enroute Houston, ETA December 15 Called Dr. Love USPHS.
10/2330 Ships position given as 160 miles NE of Miami
10/2337 Sent following dispatch to WAX for delivery. "Continue treatment stated. Doctor requests more information as to what man complains of other than fever. Are there any other symptoms you can give us. Keep us advised of any developments.
11/0148 Received from WAX following from SWIFTLIGHT "Man feels no localized pain, sleeping. We will keep you informed."

Further Action - Previous Incidents

File No. 2288
Subject: Sloop 18G266 Unreported
Action: 10/0930 Received CG Group, Key West 101410 dispatch Recur 092255. 30 foot sloop 18G266 arrive Key West 0915R. No assistance required or rendered.
Incident closed.

File No. 2282
Subject: 3 barges lost by tug FRANK W. SPENCER
Action: 10/1653 Received message from NAF at San Julian, 10/1910 Ref my 091645 Second search result negative. Tug CRUSADER advised Cuban sub chaser it also unable to locate launch. Have discontinued search efforts.

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CG District Log, 7ND 0800 10 December - 0800 11 December 1945 Contd.

Further Action - Previous Incidents

File 2273
Subject:
Action:

Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) left

10/0713 From CGC PANDORA TO DCGO 7ND 101100 dispatch "0600R position 28-41N 77-27W.

10/0714 From ComGulf to USS WAKEFIELD (AP-21) 100859 dispatch "Your 100345. assistance appreciated.

10/0715 Sent following 101215 TWL to ATC Morrison Field. "Ref my 100825. Advise your action.

10/0[illegible] From CG PANDORA to DCGO 7ND 100900 dispatch "0400R position 2825N 7715W.

10/0717 From ATC Morrison Field 101219 TWL "Operations advises us here that a plane will be at that area a few min. before 0800R.

10/0718 From CG PANDORA YO DCGO 7ND 101000 dispatch 0500R position 2834N 7720W.

10/0719 From CG VIGILANT TO DCGO 7ND 101200 dispatch 0700R position 2811N 7629W.

10/0735 From CGC PANDORA TO DCGO 7ND 101200 dispatch 0700R position 2846N 7738W.

10/0750 Received SC 1290 101230 dispatch to ComGulf 0700R position 2635N 7549W.

10/0800 Received CG Group 101220 to DCGO 7ND SC-985 requests information on what area to search advise.

10/0802 Received Morrison Field message as follows: "Has the search beea discontinued we have had a report that it has been discontinued. Our Air sea planes are s tanding by. "Answered this message. "The search continues today.

10/0824 Received NAS Banana River 101321 message. "Request instructions as to what you want done with the weasel and alligator at Vero Beach. They are standing by Comdr. Lawrence says there use no longer required.

10/0830 Comdr. Harding duty officer advised to send following message to SC-985 from DCGO 7ND to CG Group Key West 10000 dispatch. Refur 101220 SC-985 services no longer required. Return to base.

10/0840 Received CGC VIGILANT 101312 message to DCGO 7ND 0800 position 2811N 7636W.
Received CGC PANDORA 101300 message to DCGO 7ND PANDORA 0800 position 2842N 7741W.

10/0853 Received NAS Banana River 101341 message. "Search planes, areas AK search and plane take off ti es today are as follows. Four PBY 5AS searching 2900 to 2930N and 7500 to 7600 W.

Number	Took off
B-71	0700
B-56	0701
B-45	0702
B-50	0702
B-74	0734

B-74 replaced B-56 two PBM's searching square search 3000 to expanding square search starting at 3000N and 8000W.

Number	Took off
Training 50	0629
" 40	0618

Eight PBM's searching area 27-30 to 2900N and 7400 to 7500W.

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CG District Log 7ND 0800 10 December 0800 11 December 1945 Contd.

File No. 2275
Subject:
Action:

Five TBM's (NAS, Ft. Lauderdale) Lost

Number	Took Off	Number	Took Off
20	0647	30	0627
27	0702	39	PWR
28	0649	YP	0641
29	0649	47	0747

All times Roger

10/0853
10/0900 Received CGC VIGILANT 101301 dispatch to DCGO 7ND 0800R position 2811N 7636W.
10/0909 Received Morrison Field 101406 message Ex17 departed Morrison 1319Z PBY Dep MORRISON 1320Z.
10/0913 Received SC-1290 10140 message via Mayport "0900R position 26 north 7635 west.
10/0915 Received NAS Banana River 062351 dispatch to SecNav information ComSeven. "Remy 062015, Missing Crew PBM aircraft Buno 59225 Pilot Lt. (jg) W.G. Jeffrey USN 329291. Co Pilot Lt. Jr. H. G. Cone Al USNR 378634. Ens. RM Allen Al USNR 466015, Ens. L. A. Eliason, Al USNR 466964, Ens. C. D. Arceneau X L-T, USNR 409770, De Peterson AMM1/c USN 3828899, W. D. Cargill S1/c USNR 9759012, R. C. Cameron AMM 3/c, USNR 5740417, J. F. Jordan ARM 3/c, USNR 8877608, P. B. Neeman S1/c, USNR 2471121, J. T. Menendez, AOM 3/c 2688498, J. F. Osterfield AOM 3/c USNR 3789575 A.S. Zwiddo S1/c USNR 7276979. Surface and air search continues. Next of kin notified.
10/0935 Received SC-1290 101400 message to DCGO 7ND 0900R position 2659 north 753 west.
Received CG VIGILANT 101481 message via Mayport 0900R position 2811N 7643W.
10/0943 Sent 101444 message to NAS Banana River "Direct weasel and Alligator return home base. Advise.
10/0950 Received PANDORA 101400 dispatch to DCGO 7ND PANDORA 0900R position 2844N 7732W.
10/0954 Returned NAS Banana River 101450 message, "Banana River PBX sighted long narrow oil slick at 2853N and 7608W. Investigated with negative results. Continuing with search. Also Ban. River PBM 60 sighted possible parachute at 2756N and 7728W. his flight still circling this position.
10/1003 Sent following 101503 message to CGC VIGILANT via Mayport Boat Facilities (El) Proceed 2756 north 7728 west contact Banana River PBM 60 which is now circling possible parachute in this area. Passed 10/1003 entry to NAS Banana River for information
Sent 101520 message to all ASR "Navy fighter 14274 Mcs and using emergency IFF calling Miami, Over water and motor cutting out. Take bearing and other action necessary Ft. Lauderdale reported immediately as well as radar bearings. Urgent expedite.
From boat Facilities Port Everglades AVR standing by at sea.
10/1023 Received CG PANDORA 10/1500 dispatch PANDORA 1500R position 2852 N 7725W.
10/1033 Received NAS Banana River 101529 message. "Refur 101520.

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File No. 2273
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS, Ft. Lauderdale) Lost
Action:

10/1033 Canova Beach reports that radar is off for few minutes. On as soon as possible.

10/1036 Received NAS Banana River 101553 message. Called Stuart and gave necessary information. They are going to take bearings.

10/1045 Evaluation Center advised that CGAS Dinner Key Miami, Dumbo airbourne 1030 to search for fighter plane. JFR 224 alerted CG-63063 underway to Miami Sea Buoy.

10/1050 Received CG VIGILANT 101601 dispatch 100R position 2805N 7648W.

10/1100 Ban. River 101607 message. Vero Beach advise that they have two planes overdue and are believed to be down 200 miles east of Ft. Pierce. We are sending three PBY Vero Dumbo is in air now.

10/1145 Received CGC VIGILANT 101601 dispatch 1100R position 2805N 7648W.

10/1155 Received NAS Banana River 101647 message. Frontal passage expected between 1600R and 1700R. All Banana River aircraft will be directed to return to base at 1500R, unless otherwise directed, Advise.
Received NAS Banana River 101556 dispatch "Refer my 191460 tran 60 reports that investigation result. White object on patch of seaweed. Piece of white material possible inflated chute. One wooden object nearty small box with painted yellow ASR Charleston requested information on search. Also requested courses of TBR flight when last heard from, last known position. Advised them this information unknown.
Passed all information to Comdr. Baxter.

10/1223 Comdr. Baxter advised ASR Charleston all information they requested.
Sent 101705 message to NAS Banana River "Refur 101647 acknowledged and satisfactory.

10/1232 Received SC-1290 101600 message 1100R position 2709 north 7545 west.
Received NAS Jax 101713 message. NAS Jax, has twenty PBY's searching this morning in areas assigned by you. The first plane was off at 0740R and the last one dept 0934R. The same number will be searching this afternoon.
Sent 101706 message to NAS Banana River "Reur 101607. What type planes down. Any AVRS dispatched from Ft. Pierce. Advise status planes.
Received NAS Banana River 101713 message Reur 101706. The Vero Beach plane was an SNO. The pilot came ashore off Palm Beach. Vero reports this at 1200R. The plane was an SB2c. Vero Dumbo is circling what he reports a crash 30 mile east of Ft. Pierce. He is that position are investigating.

10/1240 Received NAS Banana River 101732 message Vero Dumbo is circling oil slick 30 miles from Ft. Pierce with NEM-6. Do you have any alerts there. We have no planes missing or in distress here. Vero Dumbo is circling oil slick 30 miles at sea east of Ft. Pierce NOW 6 is ALSZ this position. Do you know of any other distresses or alerts.

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CG District Log, 7ND 0800 10 December - 0800 11 December 1945 Contd.

Filo No. 2273
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS, Ft. Lauderdale) Lost

Action: 10/1246 Sent to NAS Jacksonville 101739 message "Do you have any information on poor weather coming.
Received from Morrision Field 101741 message. When you get the information from Jax.advise us about calling in our planes
Sent 101744 message to NAS Banana River, Does vero have two down. Have any been located. Advise complete information on vero planes reported down.

10/1248 Received CG VIGILANT 1010700 message "1200 position 2802N 7647.
Received CG PANDOR 01610 message PANDORA 1100R position 2858N 7723 W.
Received CG PANDORA 101700 message PANDORA 1200R position 2805N 7727W.

10/1314 Received SC 1290 101600 message.1100R position 2709N 7545W.

10/1315 Received NAS Banana River 101804 message "Army 3715 completed a 40 mile expanding search from coordinate 2830N and 7600W. Request further induration.
Received NAS Jacksonville 101812 message, Reur 10173 NAS Jax. Local weather,Expect Intermittant rain thru afternoons instrument condition after 1500R.Cold front passing 1700R with rapid clearing behind front.

10/1325 Sent following message to NAS Banana River Reur 101818.No other distress recorded.
Passed NAS Jax message 101812 to Morrison field and following 101823.Have your planes return in time to avoid weather.
Received SC-653 dispatch 101743 "Departed Nassau 1234R.Returning to station at 17 knots.

10/1329 Received SC-1290 101806 message 1300R position 2722 north 7604W.
Received NAS Banana River 101751 message, "Reur 101744.Vero Beach reports that they have no planes missing. The SB2c that went down 3 miles off West Palm Beach was from there. Pilot Meilmoil J.H. Lt., has been recovered and is all right. A false life jacket was picked up but was later found to be a cushion from a pleasure liner NGW 6 just reported that he was picked up a dye marked off a life jacket vero dunbo and NGW are investigating.

10/1335 Received CG VIGILANT 101800 message "1300R position 2800N 7702W

10/1341 Received CG PANDORA 101800 message PANDORA 1300R position 2848N 7738W

10/1350 Sent following message 101835 to NAS Banana River Reur 101450. PBM reported atposition 2756N 7728W. VIGILANT enroute. Have army 3715 assist.
Sent 101847 message to NAS Banana River Advise your plane that ETA of VIGILANT Position 2756 North 7728W is 1500R.

10/1355 Received SC-655 101833 message 1300R position 2515 north 7717W.

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File 2275
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS, Ft. Lauderdale) Lost

Action: 10/1410 Received following message from MacDill Field, "We have one B-17 searching assigned area.

10/1420 Received following 101915 message from MacDill Field, What area do you want us to search tomorrow, think that if possible that there will be one 17 available.

10/1430 Received CG VIGILANT 101900 message 1400R position 2758N 7717W

10/1459 Received CG PANDORA 101900 message PANDORA 1400R position 2845N 7747W.

10/1500 PANDORA's 1500 R position 10/2000, 2842N 774W.

10/1501 SC 1290 position 1500R 2705N 7621W.

10/1527 Sent message to all parties on AST TWL 10/2027 stating Search for 5 missing planes of 5 December 1945 will be secured on completion of return of all planes on this mission today. No further special search is contemplated. All planes and vessels in area keep bright lookout and report any pertinent information. Acknowledge. All parties acknowledged except Morrison Field.

10/1530 Comdr. Baxter stated search secured. Units being notified.

10/1541 Requested Morrison Field to relay above message to Boca Raton and Orlando.

10/1545 10/2045 ComGulf advised SC-1290 01291 to secure at 1800R

10/1558 Message of 1557 sent to ComE and ComS both acknowledged.

10/1559 Message resent to Morrison Fieldh He said he would send to Boca Raton and Orlando.

10/1559 VIGILANT Position as of 1550R27-50N and 7730W 10/2000

10/1600 SC 655 10/2031 1530 position 1830 8 miles from Hole in Wall light SC 1290 10/2001 1500 position 27-05N and 7621W.

10/1610 Received message from VIGILANT 10/2028 stating Rcur 10/1503 Arrived position 1500 R and began search. Plane departed this area 1310R.

10/1615 At 1525 Col. Barnett, Orlando AAF was advised to text of DCGO 10/2027 about search being secured.
At. 1526 Lt. Comdr. Doyle, Master Field advised of 102027 dispatch about search being secured.

10/1635 Sent message to Solomons, CHAATR, 102135 advising of 102027

10/1637 At 102137, RAF Nassau was advised of text of 102027, regarding search being secured.

10/1639 10/2139 CGC Key West advised of 1027 Search secured.

10/1647 Message sent to PANDORA SC 985, 653, 10/2147 stating. Secure search return to base at 1800R. Keep bright lookout on return and report any pertinent information. Acknowledge.

10/1703 10/2205 CGC Ft. Pierce advised also that orders sent VIGILANT SEARCH secured.

10/1705 Received message from Ponce de Leon Lifeboat Station 102001, stating 83497 enroute Ft. Lauderdale. Repair Base and is alerted for missing planes.

10/1707 1700R Position of SC 1290 is 2649N and 7610W.

10/1713 B. River stated that all planes from Banana River on seaward search have returned to base. Doesn't include PBM at St. Aug. or PBM at New Smyrna.

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File No. 2273
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost

Action:
10/1723 VIGILANTS 1600R position 2803N and 7723W. 10/2100
10/1725 PANDORA is 10/2100 position at 1600R is 2840N and 7736W.
10/1725 Mayport adgised that Army P 41 abeam St. Johns Lightship and proceeding in to Mayport.
10/1725 SC-653 R Position is 2602N and 7658W.
10/1730 SC-653 1730R position is 26-19N and 7658W.
10/1739 Banana River in 10/2239 informed that NGW 16 and NHS have picked up 2 men in a raft off Bahama Beach Club near here. Men are in a survival course detail from Melbourne and accidently drifted away from rest of group. NGW 6 picked the men up in good condition and put them ashore. The LNS CG-044 also participated.
10/1740 At 10/2240 Jax. reported search for 10 December NAS Jax. had 20 PBY searching areas designated by you in morning and same no. in afternoon. Results negative. First plane departed 0748R and last one returned 1551R. Total flying time for day 124 hours 40 minutes. NAS Jax secured from special search per TWL 10/2027 from DCGO 7ND All Squadrons and outflying fields notified to have all planes on lookout for any signes of wreckage.
10/1745 Notified CGC Miami of text of TWL 10/2027 regarding search being secured.
10/1750 Notified CGAS Miami of text of TWL 10/2027 regarding search being secured.
10/1800 Notified ATC Miami, " - " " " " " " " " " "
10/1820 Notified NAS Ft. Lauderdale of text of TWL 10/2027 regarding search being secured. Copy of dispatch being sent over TWL to Pt. Everglades to relay to them.
10/1938 SC-653 at 10-2330, give 1930R position as 30N and 76-45W.
10/1940 Received message from SC-1291 10/2045, "Am now on station 2825N and 7600W and commencing square search.
10/1940 VIGILANT in 10/2201 gives 1700R position as 2805N and7728W.
10/1940 Received copy of dispatch from Solomons 10/2146, stating Area between Lat. 2856 and 3104 from 7334 to 7125 covered by air search Planes 1000 ft. 2 miles interval. Results negative recommend discontinuing search.
10/1940 Solomons in 10/2135 acknowledged receipt of message telling about search being secured.
10/1940 PANDORA in 10/2200 position for 1700R as 2834N and 7703W.
10/1940 PANDORA in 10/2147 stated proceeding to Miami ETA 1600R Dec 11.
10/1940 Congulf in 11/0005, sent message to Solomons, Refur 10/2145, Discontinue search, Secure.
10/2000 SC-1290 in 10/2207 1700R position as 26-49N and 7610W.
10/2000 Received message from CGAS Miami, 10/2228, stating Summary days activities Dinner Key.JRF 87722 search for Ford Sedan off 1020 on at 1205R PBY 02955 search off 1030 on 1228. JRF 224 search off 1034 on 1112. Vero Beach Dumbo search times off not available here, time on 1400, Key West PBY 34004. Train off 1515 on 1625 PBY 6596 to take off 1004 back at Dinner Key 1620. CG-63043 out on training 1500 back at Causeway Island 1630.
10/2003 Banana River sent message 110056, stating following is report of planes from B. River on seaward search for 10 Dec. 4 PBY's from ABTU, First 1 took off at 0700. Last one returned at 1538. Total flying time 33 hrs. 16 minutes.

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File No. 2273
Subject:
Action: 10/2003 Five TBM's (NAS, Ft. Lauderdale,) Lost
8 PBM's from ATU Participated on seaward search. The first took off at 0620R, and last one landed at 1654. Total flying time 66 hours.
2 PBM's and Vero Dumbo were dispatched in connection with alert of SB2c detaching off W. Palm Beach, PBM's off at 1145 and 1148 and landed at 1410. Dumbo off at 1041 and on at 1402. Total flying time 8 hours and 10 minutes.
Two PBM's conducted quare search at 30N and 80W off at 0618 and 0629. On at 1516 and two. Total flying time 17 hours and 50 minutes. Results of searches were negative except as previously reported. All times report are R. Planes ASR units notified of secured of special search and advised to keep sharp lookout and to report any pertinent information.

10/2033 Received message from CGC Ft. Pierce 102340 stating you 102203 acknowledged CGC VIGILANT acknowledges your 102207

10/2033 Received message from NAS Ft. Lauderdale 102356 stating Refur 10/2331(Regarding securing of search) Willco.

10/2033 Received message from NAS Ft. Lauderdale to Solomons 110005 Search discontinued Request you return Lauderdale planes [illegible]

10/2033 ComGulg in 110050, sent message to DE 790(Borum) search discontinued as of 10/1800R. Contact Solomons for securing instructions.

10/2035 Search plan for DCGO 10 was as follows:
NAS Mayport, Cecil Field, Jax., PBY, Jac, NAATc 2730 to 2930, 77 to 78W, Daytona Standby, 3rd AF, Solomons 2855 to 3105 east of 7335. Banana River 2730 to 29 7400 to 7500 to 2900 to 2830 7500 to 7600.,Ft. Lauderdale, Miami,ATC,St, Pete, CGAS,Standby RAF Nassau, Orlando AAF 2845, to 2930,76 to 7700, Boca Raton 2745 to 2845 76 to 7700, NAS/G/1 2730 to 2900 75 to 7600 ATC Morrison 2830, 7600 search vicinity CGAS Miami, Standby UB Dumbo, Standby

10/2125 Received message from CNAADTRA JKUL, 10 2030, stating.Formal search missing TBM aircraft being discontinued brief all flight operating seaward to continue keeping alert lookout.

10/2125 Received message from CGG Ft. Pierce 10/2345 stating Reur 1020 45 Radio Jax has relayed message to SC 1290. But is unable to contact SC 1291. Jax. will continue endeavor contact SC-1291

10/2130 Sent message to Morrison Field, 110209 stating.Request resume of days activities of planes involved in search for 6 missing planes.Please give no of hours on and off times.Type of planes and their numbers. Morrison said Roger.

10/2130 Sent message to Banana River 11/0222, Request resume of activities involved in search for men sighted in swamp wouth of Melbourne.Please give no. of planes involved.Type and No. of hrs. on and off times. Also whether any craft.Surface or air were involved.B.River acknowledged for same.

10/2140 Morrison Field 11/0235, resame is Planes taking part todays search B-17 3715,9hrs. 0820Z to 1600Z)"-10 3270,9hrs. 0825Z to 1649Z

10/2150 Banana River in anser to message about search S. of Melbourne,

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File No. 2373
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS, Ft. Lauderdale,) Lost
Action: 10/2150 stated in 110236 One SNB 88 searched area today. Off at 1240R on at 1617R, Flying time 3 hrs. 37 mins. Results negative.

10/2150 SC-653 in 11/0010, acknowledged receipt of our 10/214 telling them to secure from search

10/2225 Called Capt. Hitchcock off Orlando Army Air Base, and he informed that they had 2B-29's and 2B-17 in search today, each flying about 5 hours each. Did not know exact times as no one at Field who could give information tonight. Asked for a final report on no., type of planes, total no. hours flown.

10/2240 Sent message to Solomons 11/0339, stating Request resume of No. and type of places involved in todays search. Please give take off and landing times. Buno No. Total no. of hours flown by all planes.

10/2247 Called Boca Raton Army Airfield and duty officer reported they had a 2 B-24's and 5B-17's in todays search each flying on an average of 7 to 8 hours each. Unable to give definite hrs., to cause Army ASR officer not there. Requested he notify ASR to give us a final resume of no. of planes involved in entire search, type, and total no. of hours flown.

10/2300 Controller stated 1291 had acknowledged for message titling it to secure.

10/2230 Called NAS Miami, and operations officer informed that Masters Field had 8 PBY4-2 involved in today search.

Squad 59 off at	0934R	on 1550	6 hrs.	16 mins.
49"	1018R	1624	6	06
71	0907	1721	7	14
48	1037	1814	7	37
44	1256	1736	4	40
50	1031	1923	9	12
41	0941	1734	7	53
51	0918	1655	7	17

Total of 55 hrs. 16 minutes

10/2330 Received message from CGC Key West, 11/0250, stating, Reur 11/0155. DCG) 10/1333 states quote refur 10/1200. SC-985 services no longer required. Return to base unquote. Our 101432 instructed vessel to return to base. SC-985 returned to base 1310R and placed in repair status. SC-653 acknowledged.

11/0130 Received CTE 07's 110008 "Eleven TBM's flew sixteen flights. First flight six planes off 0605 beam searches landing at 0943 Second flight four planes off 0932 beam searches landing 1205 Third flight six planes off 1208 beam searches landing 1526. All times roger. Total 48.3 hours flown today.

Approved:

Wm. Nisbet, Captain, USCG

W.T. MURPHY, Lt. Comdr. USCG

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RESTRICTED

CG District Log, 7ND
0800 11 December - 0800 12 December 1945

0801-Ens. C.V. DeGeorge on duty, pending action incidents 2282,2284,2286,2288, 2273,2289,2290,2292,2293,
0830-Lt. Co,dr. Murphy, Lt. (jg) Perret, Yeo Ross and Shastid reported for duty
1550-Lt. R.P. Sauer reported for duty
1559-End of watch
1601-Lt. Comdr. Murphy,Lt. Sauer, Lt.(jg) Perret, Ens. De George, Yeo Ross and Shastid, on duty, Pending incidents 2273,2282,2284,2286,2288,2289,2290,2292,2293
1610 Ens. De George Departed
2006-CGC Ft. Pierce in 11/2015 stated following received from Telephone system office, New Smyrna quote Beacon Light south of Banlover Canal out. Oiled Lt. Comdr. Demerritt, and he advised following message be sent.
2030-12/0121, Refer 11/2015, Contact CO of 40319 D and have him contact telephone system office New Smyrna to find out which beacon is out. Instruct him to 43 light as soon as possible.
2340-Lt. R.S. Covey reported for duty
2355-Lt. A. Sauer departed
2359-End of watch
0001-Lt. Covey on duty. Pending Incidents file No. 2273,2284,2290,2292,2293,2294.
0210-Received NAS Key West sts 120536 from ASR Controller "Is all fields around Homestead and Hollywood for Fairchild M62A No. NC 507622 Pilot Gene Scarlet. Woman 21 years old departed Meacham Field at 1515, Dec. 11, for Homestead, Operation wired Homestead AAV answer negative. Hollywood home of plane and pilot, advise as soon as possible."
0220-Cassed ASR Controller Boca Chica who advised information came from O.D. Meachan Field. Plane arrived without flight plane as advance knowledge on 10 Dec. Pilot was requested to file arrival report on reaching Homestead. None received. Pilot planned to fly up highway, refuel at Homestead, name of Airport not know, then continue to Hollywood.
0300-Attempts to call Municipal Airport Homestead McArthur, Airport Hollywood. Mr. George Powel, owner of McArthur Airport of Miss Gene Scarlet negative. No planes listed for any of above.
0325-Sent following to NAS Key West "For ASR controller, urdis. 120536, unable check civilian airports vicinity Hollywood, Homestead as no telephones listed.
0400-Called Hollywood police and requested they send on to McArthur Airport to check on plane and call back any information obtained. The advise airports Tel. No. is Hollywood 9127 (no one answers)
0800-Lt. Covey departed, Ens. C.V. De George on duty.
0845-Called Hollywood Airport tell 466, and spoke to Miss Gene Scarlet who advised she arrived Hollywood airport 1630R 11 December. Incident closed.

Current Incidents

File No. 2294
Action Time: Current
Subject: MARLOCK 38 foot Cabin Cruiser
Origin Phone Call from Mrs. M.E. Tullock, Ft. Lauderdale
Location: Boat enroute Chesapeake City, Md. To: Ft. Lauderdale and stated that 38 ft. cabin cruiser MARLOCK, had departed Chesapeake City, Md. 22 Nov. enrout Ft. Lauderdale. She was

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CG District Log, 7ND 11 December 1945 - 0800 12 December Contd.

(Current Incidents Contd.)

File No. 2294
Subject: MARLOCK 38 Foot Cabin Cruiser
Action: 11/1945 unable to give any no. for boat and husband couldn't be contacted as he is enroute Ft. Laud. Boat has white hull with squamarine trim on cabin. Name MARLOCK is on stern. Charley Card and one other man aboard. Boat traveling ICW. Owners consider boat long overdue. Owmder lives at 800 S.E. 4th St., Ft. Lauderdale. Phone Lauderdale 800. Advised Mrs. Tullock to notify this unit if she heard anything on boat.

11/2015 Sent message, 12/0105, to DCGO 6ND, information ComEast, DCGO 5ND and CGG Ft. Pierce, stating. "Request any information on 38 ft. cabin Cruiser MARLOCK which departed Chesapeake City Md. on 22 November enroute Ft. Lauderdale, Owner is M.E. Tulloch, of Ft. Lauderdale. Unable to give no. of boat. Boat has white hull aquamarine trim on cabin. Name MARLOCK on stern. Charley Card, and one other man aboard. Considers long overdue. Traveling ICW. Please advise.

11/2020 12/0120, sent above message to Ft. Everglades Boat Facility Banana River, Jax, and Mayport. Added at end of message." Please alert your boats or planes. All acknowledged."

11/2200 12/0200 Banana River asked "Where and when was this boat last seen or heard from."

11/2204 12/0230, sent message to Banana River. No word heard of boat since its departure on 22 Nov. Have notified DCGO 6ND, 5ND also ComEast CG Ft. Pierce, Boat may be anywhere between Chesapeake City, Md, and Ft. Lauderdale.

11/2230 12/0230 Banana River reported New Smyrna and Ft. Pierce Boat Facilities report that they haven't seen or heard anything about missing boat. Do you request a search sent from this unit and if so please advise.

11/2235 At 12/0235 sent message to Banana River, Do not request any search at present. Alert any boats that might be traveling ICW Will notify later if we want search conducted.

12/0100 Received CGG Ft. Pierce 120500, "Refur 120105, MARLOCK passed through Ft. Pierce at 1030R, 11 December headed south.

12/0143 Sent following dispatch to DCGO 5, information ComEast DCGO 5 Cancel my 120105. Vessel located.

12/0149 Sent following to Ft. Everglades, Mayport, Boat Facilities NAS Jax, Banana River, "Cancel my 120120. Cabin Cruiser MARLOCK passed thru Ft. Pierce 1030R. 11 December.

12/0715 Notified Mrs. Tullock of above.
Indidents closed.

Further Action - Previous Incidents

File No. 2282
Subject: 3 Barges lost by tug FRANK W. SPENCER
Action: 11/1200 Controller advised that Crusader was returning to Key West. Supt. Salvage, CESF had advised to discontinue efforts. If further salvage operations desired, Supt. Salvage will notify ComGulf.

11/1530 Comdr. Schmidt, advised that Lt. Davis of Merritt Chapman estimates cost of salvage barges at $25,000 and Supt. Salvage Incident Closed.

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Further Action, Previous Incidents Con'd.

File No. 2285
Subject: Man Lost Near Appalachicola Mr. Joe Thompson
Action: 11/1303 Sent following 111803 message to CGAS St. Pete, and MacDill Field. "Advise status and yesterday search for man in Appalachicola area.
CGAS St. Pete advised. "We are waiting a phone call from up there now.
MacDill Field advised "We haven't any information on the Appalachicola search.
Incident closed.

File No. 2291
Subject: Medico SS EDWARD KAVANAGH
Action: 11/1650 Received message from CCG Key West 11/1430 stating CG 63063 departed base 2138 R. Rendezvous with SS KAVANAGH at sea buoy. Took sick man off name Wilbur Beggerstaff. AB Seaman Returned to base 2310R. and Beggerstaff taken to Naval Hospital Key West Florida
Incident closed.

File No. 2292
Subject: Medico SS PANYORK
Action: 110950 Received SS PAN YORK Medico 11 Dec. 1945, 1415GM "Reference Negro male cook stop temperature 100 degrees pulse 72 breathing 54 stop complain intense pains lower right side stop when lying left side has coughing and spitting spells stop after vomiting spits small amount light pink blood stop claims to be in intense pain stop. have morphine syrettes aboard stop aspirin seems to give no relief stop continuing sulphathiazole P.Ys as prescribed.
11/1010 Passed all 0950 entry to Dr. Love. USPHS who advised following be sent
11/1033 DCGO 7ND Prior Dis 111533 to SS PAN YORK Rcur 11 December 1945 1415GMT Medico. USPHS Miami advises. Do not give morphine. Continue aspirin and sulphadiazine or sulphathiazole. Force fluids keep patient quiet. Probable pneumonia. Patient should be hospitalized. Cristabol being advised.
11/1031 Received following message from CG Radio Hialeah "Your 11533 SS PAN YORK delivered W1C1 1613 GMT. Pan York said he was one day out of Balboa and to relay any more traffic to him thru NBA (Summit C.Z. balboa Control radio)

File No. 2293
Subject: Medico S. S. SWIFTLIGHT
Action: 11/0920 Received 111314 message from SS SWIFTLIGHT "G15AM Condition of patient pulse 82respiration 21 temperature 100 Patient feeling much better this morning.
11/0925 A-Board advised that SS SWIFTLIGHT enroute to New York ETA 12/16
11/1230 Passed information on 11/0148 and 11/0920 entries to USPHS Dr. Ciccocci

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CG District Log, 7ND 0800 11 December - 0800 12 December 1945 Contd

Further Action - Previous Incidents Contd.

File No. 2273
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS, Ft. Lauderdale) Lost

Action: 11/0937 Sent following 111437 message to CGC VIGILANT "Report search results December 10.

11/120 Sent following 111710 message to NAS Banana River "Reur 101450 sighting at 2756N 7728W, by PBM 60. Please advise immediately any information you have on this sighting. Advise time PBM 60 departed from scene and arrival. Departure times of Army 3715. Did either plane contact CG VIGILANT which arrived at scene at 1500R.

11/1239 Received following message from NAS Banana River Reur 111710. PBM 60 arrived on scene 0814R and searched area with 4 PBM's until 0845R. Army 3715 was not seen on scene. Object reported was white object approximately 4 square yards in area floating on red seaweed. PBM 60 did not contact CG VIGILANT. Position of object corrected to 2750N 7700W.

11/1251 Sent following 111751 message to CGC VIGILANT and CGC PANDORA Proceed to position 2750N 7700W search for white object possibly a parachute floating on red seaweed reports by PBM at 0950R dec. 10. Report present position and also number of days you can remain out.

11/1330 Sent following message to 111830 message to NAS, Banana River "Reur 101450 and 111710. Do you have a plane available search area vicinity 2750N and 7700W to relocate possible parachute. VIGILANT and PANDORA expect arrive area late tonight or tomorrow morning. Advise.

11/1333 Received following message from NAS Banana River "Reur 111830 Do you request this today or tomorrow.

11/1338 Sent 111838 message to NAS Banana River would appreciate plane today to verify position.

11/1340 Received message from NAS Banana River Roger Wilco, for our info. That position is 200 miles distance from Banana River. Estimated it will take about one hald to one hour to get PBM Airbourne. Estimate one and one half hours flight time to the scene. Possibility for about one hour of daylight search. After arriving on station.

11/1350 Sent message 111350 message to Banana River "If planes possible parachute request HF/DF not be alerted on Guebo via Banana River. If not sighted request plane at daytlight tomorrow.

11/1359 Received 111515 message from CGC VIGILANT Ref on 111437 search results negative.

11/1400 Received following message from Morrison field "Do you want any information about the total no. of hours of search for the 6 missing planes. I mean on the planes from this station I have it here now" answered affirmative."

Received 111520 message from CG Group. Key West, "Reur 102139 receipt acknowledged. SC 985 returned to base. SC-653 returned at 2300R.

Received 111635 message from NAS Ft.Lauderdale to SecNav Remydis 062125. Search has been discontinued as results negative. Next of kin are being notified.

11/1426 Received from CGC PANDORA 111830 message "Present position

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File No. 2273
Subject:
Action: 11/1426 Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost 6 miles SE of Hillsboro light. Fuel and supplies very low. Can remain out two more days.

11/1432S Sent following 111926 message to OTC PANDORA "Rear 111830 proceed Ft. Pierce. Fuel and provisions all possible haste then proceed on assigned mission. Advise 37 Group Ft. Pierce via dispatch fuel and stores needed.
Received from 37 Group, Ft. Pierce 111801 message "For operations. CGC VIGILANT arrived this unit 1240R this date.

11/1435 Sent following 111935 message to CG Group Ft. Pierce. Direct VIGILANT Fuel and provision all possible haste then proceed accordance my 111751. PANDORA directed proceed Ft. Pierce for fuel and provision. Expedite his departure to comply my 111751.

11/1436 Received 111922 message from NAS Banana River Rear 111830 PBM 21 departed Banana River at 1418 R for scene of reported possible parachute. ETA about 1545R. Operating on 3000Kcs. anotherPBM preparing to depart.
Training 21 just advised he will be on scene in time to search about three hours until fuel supply demands that he return to base. This plane was already Airbourne when you requested a plane be dispatched. We diverted him from a training hop to this mission.
Received following message from NAS Banana River Training sending on 4385 Kcs.

11/1445 Received 111945 message from NAS Banana River Alert net for T-21 on 3000 Kcs. Sending MO's 30 miles east of Banana River.

11/1446 Alerted net on 3000 Kcs.

11/1458 Sent to NAS Banana River "Can you confirm emission on T-21 on 3000 Kcs. Is he up now and is he still sending MO's
From NAS Banana River "No he is sending on 4385 Kcs not on 3000 kcs and still sending MO's.
To NAS Banana River, "Know nature of call or if emergency.
From NAS Banana River "Call sigh is 1882N. The emergency is returning to base with caulty port engine.
Paaed above information to HF.DF net and alerted net on 4385 Kcs.

11/1457 Sent to NAS Banana River"Tell plane to keep sending MO's on 4385. Unheard so far.
Received 112000 message from NAS Banana River Training 21 landed safely. Secure alert.

11/1606 Sent 112005 message to NAS Banana River "Any information on 1882N alert still on here. Is T21 also 1882N. NAS Banana River answered "That is correct"

11/1507 Cancelled HF/DF Alert

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Further Action - Previous Incidents Contd.

File No. 2273
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Contd.Lost

Action: 11/1517 Received telephone call from Commanding Officer of CGC VIGILANT who advised that VIGILANT arrived in assigned area at 1510R. 10 December, Lat. 2756N Long 7728W, Searched area for approximately 3 hours. Results negative. At. time sea was very rough. heavy swells plenty of white caps. At 1310R talked with PBM #20. PBM in sight at time, PBM advised of sighting possible parachute at approximately 1000R but had not seen since. PBM departed at this time. Sighted a 4 motored plane in area at 1730R believed to be B-29 101845R, VIGILANT departed from scene.

11/1526 Received following 112025 message from NAS Banana River. "Training 13 and 21 have returned to base. Vero dumbo and Daytona dumbos have been dispatched. Instructions for dumbos are as follows. If object sighted give MO's of 4385 kcs CW. Also turn on emergency 1FF.

11/1534 Sent 112034 message from NAS Banana River "Reur 112025 if object sighted can you have dumbos make moson 8770 kcs.

11/1535 CCAS Dinner Key Cognizant by NAS Banana River message to them.
Received 112029 message from NAS Banana River "Can you tell us what frequency the VIGILANT and PANDORA will be guarding.
Request above information from Radio Room.

11/1539 Received 112039 message from NAS Banana River, Reur 112034 Both dumbos can set up on 8770 kcs.

11/1540 SC 653 in 111957 reports ETA 1910R Key West

11/1540 11/2040 Asked Banana River what call signs 2 planes would use. Banana River stated Daytona Dumbo call CW is 349A. Vero call CW is 548 Y. Asked if this implied they are to set up immediately on 8770

11/1541 11/2051 told Banana River that PANDORA AND VIGILANT guard 2670 and 3000 Kcs. continuously. Will advise any other frequencies.
Call signs are VIGILANT NRMG and PANDORA NRGO

11/1605 Morrison Field 11/1900, gave resume of flights for 7,8,9,10,Dec.

6 Dec. C-47 No.3836-9 hrs. off 0730R on 1230 off 1330R on 1730R
PBY No. 4018-7 hrs. off 1115 on 1830 and 15 minutes.
7 Dec. PBY No. 4018- 9 hrs. 30 min. off 0840 on 1810
PBY No. 3270-7 hrs. 45 min. off 0715 on 1500
8 Dec. PBY No. 4018-10 hrs. off 0915 on 1915
B-17 N. 3715 -8hrs. off 1035 on 1835.
9 Dec. B-17 No. 3715-8 hrs.40 min. off 0920 on 1800
10 Dec. B-17 No. 3715 - 7 hrs. 40min. pff 0820 on 1600
PBY No. 3270 - 8 hrs. 31 mins. off 0820 on 1650
Total hours 76 and 20 minutes.

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Further Action - Previous Incidents Contd.

File No. 2273
Subject:
Five TBM's (NAS; Ft. Lauderdale) Lost Contd.

Action: 11/1633 11/2133 Sent message to CGAS Miami, stating Lt. Comdr. Orr Supt. Aviation training Ops Locks called and passed following information Mrs. J. Caruthers 1632 NW 59th St., husband went hunting Sat. morning 0330R 8 Decemberout on Tamiami Trail between Arch on Tamiami Trail and Turner River to North side of road. They saw 4 flares. No description flares given. Request report be investigated in reference to missing TBM's. CGAS Miami asked Do you wish to send a JRF in search. Sent back affirmative.

11/1652 11/2152 Banana River reported that Daytona Dumbo would reach scene at 1658R.

11/1652 Dinner Key, JRF 87722 airbourne on search

11/1702 11/2208 Banana River reported that Daytona Dumbo starting square search on position at 1751. Both Dumbos instructed to leave scene at 1715R.

11/1730 SC-1290 in 11/1958, gave 1500R position as 2607N 7845W.

11/1749 11/2249 Banana River reports Daytona Dumbo left scene at 1730R. Reported nothing sighted.

11/1750 Dinner Key reports JRF 877 down. Search negative.

11/1755 11/2255 Mayport reports Vero Dumbo securing search. Results negative. Returning to base. ETA 1915R.

11/1755 Lt. Comdr. Murphy called Exec. of CGC Ft. Pierce, who stated that ETA PANDORA at Ft. Pierce was 2215R. and ETA of VIGILANT Ft. Pierce was 1900R.

11/1820 11/2125 SC-1290 gave 1700R position as 2606N and 7906W.

11/2005 Vero Dumbo landed 12/0118 from Banana River

11/2105 11/2355 SC-1290 1900R position is 2559N and 7927W.

11/2105 11/2345, SC-653 sends it arrival Key West 1905R.

11/2125 12/0100 VIGILANTS 2000R position is 2730N and 8003W.

11/2150 12/0444 Banana River search plan for Daytona and Vero Beach Dumbo for 12 Dec. Depart stations at 0630R and proceed to position 2750N and 7700W at that point Vero Beach Dumbo conduct expanding square search extending legs 4 miles. Daytona Dumbo conduct expanding square search extending legs 2 miles. PANDORA and VIGILANT are expected to be in or near area assigned for search in or near the area assigned for search. Upon sighting possible wreckage or debris of five missing TBF or missing PBM plane sighting object is to orbit and keep it in sight turn on IFF and send MO on 8770 kcs. The other plane is to direct surface craft to scene if any are in area. If not this plane is to climb to 8000 ft. or as high as weather permits and orbit above the plane circling the object making a square pattern with 3 mile legs and 10° turns and also turn on IFF and transmit MO on 8770 Kcs. Communications between planes and on scene crept 3000Kcs voice position reports on 46HR on 8770Kcs "Q" signal or the half hr. on 8770 kcs. Dumbo are to return to base with at least one hr. fuel remaining in tanks, all objects sighted that possibly may be wreckage or debris

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CG District Log, 7ND 0800 11 December - 0800 12 December, 1945 Contd.

Further Action - Previous Incidents

File No. 2273
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS, Ft. Lauderdale) Lost Contd.

Action:	11/2150	of missing aircraft are to be reported immediately to NOB on 8000KC voice or 8770 kc CW
	11/2200	VIGILANT in 12/0200 gave 2100R position as 2713N 7949W.
	11/2200	SC 1290 in 12/0200, gave 2100R position as 2642N 7939W.
	12/0035	Received VIGILANT 120500 0000R position 2734N 7910W. Received PANDORAS 120340 arrived Ft. Pierce 2235Q.
	12/0120	Received VIGILANTS 120600 "0100R position 2737N 7859W.
	12/0505	Received VIGILANTS 120800 0300R position 2740N 7835W.
	12/0640	Rodeived VIGILANTS 121100 0600R position 2733N 7759W.
	12/0740	Received VIGILANTS 121200 0700R position 2745N 7748W.
	12/0808	Sent 121308 message to NAS Banana River "Advise times Vero and Daytona Dumbos airbourne.
	12/0809	Received 121309 message to NAS, Banana River, Vero Dumbo took off at 0715. Daytona Dumbo took off at 0757.

Approved:

W.T. MURPHY, Lt. Comdr, USCG

Wm. Wishar, Captain, USCG

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CG District Log, 7ND
0800 12 December - 0800 13 December 1945

0801 - Ens. C. V. De George on duty.
0830 - Lt.Comdr. Murphy,Lt.(jg) Rerret, Yeo Ross,Neely, and Shastid reported for duty.
0845 - Ens. Burr reported for duty.
1100 - IAMIER, Jorry Slc, dischargod from sickbay,reported for duty on A-Board.
1110 - Received 12606 message from ASR Banana River "4385 Kcs. 1862U CW 1 hours, overdue on position report enroute San Juan from Banana River expect him to be in vicinity of San Juan.
1111 - Alerted HF/DF net and passed above information
1115 - Received 121611 message from NAS Banana River "118820 landed atSan Juan"
1116 - Cancelled HF/DF alert
Sent 121355 dispatch to NAS Key West "For ASR Controller. Reur 120536 nC 507622 arrived Hollywood airport 1830 Roger 11 December. Spoke to pilot Gene Scarlet personally.
1350 - Lt.)jg) G. F. Koch reported for duty.
1559 - End of watch
1601 - Lt. Comdr. W. T. Murphy, (lt.(jg) G. F. Koch, Lt.(jg) S.G. Perret,Ens.Burr on duty, pending action on incidents file #2290, 2292, 2293, 2273
1620 - Ens. De George departed.
1622 - Ens. Burr departed
1700 - Lt.Comdr., W. T. Murphy,Lt.(jg) S. G. Perret, Yeomen Ross,Neely, and Shastid doparted.
2350 - Lt. R. F. Sauer reported
2355 - Lt. (jg) G. F. Koch departed
2359 - End of watch.
0001 - Lt. R. T. Sauer on duty,pending incidents #2273, 2284, 2290, 2292, 2293, 2294.
0740 - Lt. R. S. Covey reported for duty.
0755 - Lt. Sauer departed
0759 - End of watch

Current Incidents

File No. 2299
Action Time: Current
Subject: Americal Eagle (2 masted schooner)
Origin: 121935 Priority dispatch from CGC Tampa to CG ACTIVE
Location: Near Tampa Bay Channel Mun Buoy 2B
Action: 12/1545 Received 121935 priority dispatch from CGC Tampa to CG ACTIVE information DCGO 7ND "2 Masted Schooner American EAGLE reported in need of assistance. Position near Tampa Bay Channel mun buoy 2B. Investigate and advise.
12/1930 From CGC Tampa to DCGO 7ND 122225 dispatch "Refer my 121935 vessel being towed to Tampa. Engine trouble.

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CG District Log, 7MD
0800 12 December - 0800 13 December 1945

(Current Incidents Contd.)

File No. 2295
Action Time: Current
Subject: Possible plane distress
Origin: NAS Banana River 122037 TWL
Location: Due West 40 miles of Canova Beach
Action: 12/1537 Received 122037 TWL from NAS Banana River to ASR Miami; "Canova Beach reports an emergency (IFF) bearing 100 degrees 40 miles from Canova Beach. Canova Beach is 15 miles south of Banana River.

12/1541 From NAS Banana River 122045 TWL to ASR Miami "Request you alert SAR net on above IFF bearing 100 degrees 40 miles from Canova Beach. We are not sure of the type plane. Suggest you alert [illegible] single engine type plane and 4385 kcs should it be a PBY.

12/1552 SAR/DF net alerted

12/1553 From ASR Miami to NAS Banana River 122052 TWL "Net is alerted. do you know whether this is a plane or identity of origin of IFF

12/1554 From NAS Banana River to ASR Miami "We were notified of this emergency by the radar station at Canova Beach. The last position is bearing 090 degrees 35 miles from 13 and PBM also several others are investigating.

12/1632 From NAS Banana River to ASR Miami 122132 TWL "Ref my 122045 message. Cancel alert on plane off. Melbourne. Plane from Incident Closed.

File No. 2295
Action Time: Current
Subject: 2 planes overdue at NAS Jacksonville
Origin: NAS Jacksonville 122121 TWL
Location: NAS Memphis to NAS Jacksonville (out of our Frontier)
Action: 12/1631 Received 122121 TWL from NAS Jacksonville to ASR Miami "2-planes overdue. F4U Buno 07990 pilot Page departed NAS Memphis 1325R VIA NAS Jacksonville 1645R. Fuel aboard 3 hrs. 030 minutes. F4U Buno 0823 pilot Stafford departed NAS Memphis 1324R VIA 1624R Two hours enroute. NAS Jacksonville and outlying fields have been checked. ATC has also checked stations enroute. Request alert on northern circuit. No radio frequency was given. Request any information frequency 3105 kcs.
Evaluation advises "We are now monitoring on 3105 kcs.
From NAS Jacksonville to ASR Miami 122218 TWL F4U Buno 80790 landed Maynort 1715R. Secure alert.
Incident Closed.

File No. 2297
Action Time: Current
Subject: Unidentified white flares
Origin: LSM 521 CTF 130015 dispatch
Location 24-26N 81-51W South Key West
Action: 12/2020 Received copy of 130015 CP dispatch from LSM 521 to Com 7

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CG DISTRICT LCC, 7TH, 0800 12 December - 0800 13 December, 1945

Current Incidents (cont'd)

File No. 2297
Subject:
Action: 12/2020 Unidentified white flares
12/2030 Unidentified white flares sighted Lat 2426N Long 8151
Called Boca Chica and requested information on any flare or rocket exercises this date. Informed none but they will check further and call us back.
12/2055 Sent following 130135 Priority dispatch to CCG Key West information Comdr[illegible], CCGS [illegible], YAG Key West as follows: "IX [illegible]621, reports unidentified white flares sighted at 24-26N 8151 at approximately 122014. Request you investigate and advise.
12/2216 Received 130232 Priority dispatch from CCG Key West to NCRC 7TH as follows: "Ref 130135. Investigation now being conducted by Fred Lee."
12/2310 From CCG Key West to NCRC 7TH 130318 Priority dispatch. "Reour 130232. Investigation negative. Incident closed.

File No. [illegible]
Subject: Man Lost near Apalachicola Mr. Joe Thompson
Action: 12/0930 Sent following 121330 message to CCAS ST. Petersburg "Is there any information on Apalachicola search. Please keep us advised of action this search. Departure return times of aircraft.
Received from CCAS St. Petersburg, following message in answer to 121330 message.
Information on Apalachicola search. Number of planes in search is three HNS -1, JRF-5 J4F. The J4F is from CCAS Biloxie. Hours flown each day is as follows. Sunday JRF 3 hrs. HNS 1 5 hrs. J4f non
Monday JRF 6 hrs, HNS 1 4 hrs, J4F 5 hours.
Tuesday JRF 6 hrs. HNS 1 4 hours J4F 5 hours.
Original Times off and landing are as follows:
Sunday notimes available
Monday JRF off 0820R landed 1820R

	J4F	0820R	1820R
	HNS	0920	1730
Tuesday	JRF	0800	1755
	J4F	0800	1755
	HNS-1	0848R	1720R

Progress of search is as follows from officer in charge Quote we have thoroughly searched the swamp area with the helicicopter J4F and JRF has extensively searched the entire area of coastline from Carravelle to Cape St. George light several times each day with negative results. The search today will be the last extensive search unless advised otherwise. It is impossible for the man to be alive in my opinion in the seamn. An occasional check should be made along the coast line since the man must have drowned and may come to the surface. Swamp has been entirely and thoroughly searched. Man could not be seen from the air. If drowned might come to surface but not too probable due to fact that he was wearing heavy boots and would tend to hold him under. Will continue search along coast line today. There is a private aronca plane here which is conducting search also periodically. Will contact Coast Guard Petersburg via radio today for further orders. Pilot does

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CC District Log, 72C 0800 12 December - 0800 13 December, 1945 Contd.)

Further Action - Previous Incidents Contd.

File 2284
Subject: Man lost near Appalachicola Mr. Joe Thompson
Action: 12/0850 not think further search necessary. Advise.
12/0850 Passed all information of 12/0830 entry to Capt. Fisher who advised that following message be sent.
12/0910 Sent to CGAS St. Petersburg 121410 message "If results negative today negate search.
12/0124 13/0621 Requested information from St. Pete, CGAS, as to results of search for man in sharp. Please give resume of days activities. St. Pete replied helicopter has returned negative results. JRF has not returned. All search results negative.

File No. 2273
Subject: Five planes (NAS, Ft. Lauderdale Lost
Action: 0810 Passed information to Evaluation Center who assigned two stations to Position 8470 Fox. for call signs 548 Y 548 A
12/0828 Received 121500 message from CGC VIGILANT 0800 R position 2749N 7743W.
12/0858 Requested NAS Banana River check with CG Group, Ft. Pierce, regarding departure of CGC PANDORA
12/0904 Received from NAS Banana River 121403 message. PANDORA gave 0809 Position 2730N 8005W ETA 0900R at search area
12/0923 Received CG VIGILANT 121400 message via Banana River 0900R position 2751N-7730W.
12/1018 Received from Anana River message "Vero Dumbo on scene of search at 0904R. Daytona Dumbo ETA Scene of search 1018R. Both dumbos in Radio contact with Vigilant.
12/1035 Received from Banana River 10904 position VIGILANT 2753N 7719W.
12/1100 Received from CG Group, Ft. Pierce 121220 message PANDORA departed Ft. Pierce 0700R.
12/1100 Received from ComGulf sea Fron 121357 to Brinkley Bass Msg. Enroute destination request you keep sharp lookout from 2700N to 3200N for survivors or debris of six planes lost at sea 5 December. Possible parachute reported at 275N 7700W. CGC VIGILANT and plane investigating. Advise present position.
12/1130 Received from PANDORA 121500 message PANDORA 1000R position 2727N 7945W.
12/1145 Sent to Banana River 121638 message "intercept from mistook vessel the VIGILANT CG to Lake North Lifeboat Station. RT passed through several objects floating. Metal case with following position on it TNT head foil 15 grams 10 pound gun case one pound 12 miles due east of Palm Beach.
Received from Banana River message Will check with ATC. Can Morrison Field investigate
12/1152 Called officer in charge Lake North Inlet, LifeBoat station. Passed all information 15 knt boat will go out and take gear found aboard and search
Dinner Key Dumbo going and boat from Ft. Pierce requested
12/1152 Sent to Banana River 12/1652 message A Crash boat from Ft. Pierce to Position 12 miles east of W. Palm Beach NACTC has several there.
12/1154 Banana River to Morrison Field 121654 message. "Can you investigate objects in water 12 miles due east of West Palm Beach.

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CG District Lor, 7ND 0800 12 December, - 0800 13 December, 1945
Further Action - Previous Incidents

File No, 2273
Subject:
Action: 12/1155 Five TB'S (VAS, Ft. Lauderdale) Lost
Called Dinner Key and advised them of above. They will dispense dumbo.
12/1204 Received from Banana River 121704 message Ft. Pierce has been notified [illegible] boat to 12 miles off Palm Beach. He will notify you [illegible] know the boat number.
12/1208 Dinner Key dispatch Dumbo airbourne at 1208 PBYsa 46628
12/1225 Received from Banana River to Fort Everglades 121718 message. "Can you dispatch a boat to investigate object in water. 12 miles due east Palm Beach.
12/1225 Received from Banana River 121722 message. Do you wish us to dispatch a boat from Fort Everglades to investigate objects off Palm Beach.
12/1231 Received 121729 from VAS Banana River Ft. Pierce boat PC , 7 departed 1225R.
12/1231 Sent following 121731 message to VAS Banana River Small boat from Lake Worth Inlet LFS enroute to scene also. Do not deem it necessary to send one from Ft. Everglades.
12/1238 Received 121735 message from Morrison Field to VAS Banana River "Getting a plane ready now to investigate objects reported 12 miles east of Palm Beach. Have you had any contact with Army PBY call 3270." Passed to DCGO 7ND for information by Banana River.
12/12/45 Received 121757 from VAS Banana River Morrison Field has a plane ready to aid in search due east of Palm Beach.
Received 121530 message from DD 887 "Refer 121357 Position 2610N 72450 at 1030R.
12/1250 Received 121752 message from NAS Banana River PCS 7 is on 4790Kcs boat from Ft. Pierce.
12/1300 Received from Morrison Field 121758 message C-47 Call 975 Airbourne at 1756Z object search.
12/1319 Received 121819 Evaluation Center from D" message VIGILANCE was just on sec said he was entering straights. We took one brg. on him. Transmission to short for alert.
12/1329 Received 121529 position 1300R Vero Dumbo 77004W 2735N
Daytona Dumbo 7710W 2735R.
12/1340 Sent to Fort Everglades, Banana River 121835 message. JRP D/F Brg on VICILANCE 168° VICILANCE said "He was entering straights" 2670Kcs. Request Fort Everglades have crash boat rendezvous and obtain debris found on investigation.
12/1350 Received from VICILANT AND PANDORA 1600 message VICILANT 1100R position 2754N 7708 . PANDORA 1100R position 2727N 7832W.
PANDORA 1200R position 2727N 7918W.
Received from Lake Worth 121715 message "For CG Operations Mia CG-30302 departs at 1205 to scene of reported floating object will advise.
12/1350 Called NLPV, CGC Miami, Radio to get ETA abreast Ft. Everglades for information regarding message from Ft. Everglades wanting to know at what position can or boat rendezvous with the VICILANCE.
12/1358 Received Daysort from DCGO 8ND, 121658 message. "Request names ranks and serial numbers of personnel involved in 5 TB'S and 1PBY Type aircrafts. Wish them for completion of records this station.

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CC District Log, 7ND 0800 12 December - 0800 13 December, 1945 RESTRICTED

Further Action - revious Incidents

File No. 2273
Subject: Five TBM's (NAS, Ft. Lauderdale) Lost
Action: 12/1358 Sent to Airport 121858 refer 121658 from DCCO 8TD. "Information being sent via deferred dispatch."

12/1400 CAP CGS C-In-C called "VIGILANCE picked 3"50 shell case. Dozen floating in water. Picked up by CG Boat will also search for hours [illegible] CG & T LHS and secure.

12/1405 121858 sent to Fort Everglades message VIGILANCE RTA abreast Ft. Everglades believed approximately 1530R this date. Having MCPX call VIGILANCE on 2670Kcs now and get RTA. Will advise you.

12/1410 Called Dinner Key to secure dumbo.

12/1413 121918 Sent to Banana River, Fort Everglades "orrison Field, message LTT LHS Debris picked up by VIGILANCE was 31 inch 50 shell case. CG Boat also picked up 3x50 shell case and reports a dozen or more floating. Secure from this search position 12 miles east of [illegible] F.

12/1414 Received from "orrison Field message "Do you want me to call crash boat C47 Back to base"
Answered "Secure"

12/1420 121919 Received from "orrison message "Crash Boat reports picking up two of the cylinders and is now picking up more. The objects are about 6 inches in dia. and 3 foot long. Will know till both crash boat and plane to secure. That's what you want Right

12/1435 121930 Sent to Ft. Everglades, "orrison and Banana River message. "Reply 121913 secure all units planes boats. No possibility debris can be from plane was wilcoed.

12/1455 Dinner Key Dumbo on water

12/1505 121800, Received from PANDORA AND VIGILANT 1300R porition PANDORA 2724N 7909W. VIGILANT 2750N 7656W.

12/1457 Sent 06/1935 entry to DCCO 8ND (Charleston So. C.) information Hunter Field, Georgia 121957 deferred dispatch.

12/1615 From CG VIGILANT TO DCCO 7ND 121900 dispatch "1400R position 2744N 7703W.

12/1616 From CG PANDORA TO DCCO 7ND 121900 dispatch PANDORA 0400R position 2726N 7854W.

12/1328 From CG VIGILANT TO DCCO 7ND 122000 dispatch 1600R position 2751N 7706W.

12/1[illegible] From CG PANDORA TO DCCO 7ND 122000 dispatch 1500R position 2728N 7843W.

12/1645 From NAS Banana River to ASR Miami 122144 TWL "Request search plans for TBM Thursday December 13.

12/1700 Sent following 122200 TWL to NAS Banana River. "Advise when Vero and Daytona Dumbos return from search for possible parachute.

12/1755 Sent following to NAS Banana River 122247 TWL Ref. ur request for search plan 13 December for TBM search. Request you dispatch planes to search area 2750N 7700W. which is in the approximate area where parachute was sighted today. We intend to keep this PANDORA and VIGILANT in that area in order to coordinate on the search. Advise.

12/1812 VIGILANT 1700R position 2806N 7658W.

12/1830 PANDORA 1800R position 2733N 7806W.

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CG District No., 7th 0800 12 December - 0800 13 December, 1945 Contd.

File No. 2273

Subject: Five TBM's (NAS, Ft. Lauderdale,) Lost

Action: 12/1831 Sent following 122317 T/L to NAS Banana River "Request arrival time and results planes dispatched to search for reported parachute.

12/1832 Daytona Dumbo in 1811R.

12/1833 122329 T/L from NAS Banana River to ASR Miami "Daytona Dumbo search from point assigned to 46 miles on all four sides of it in square search. Negative results. Do you wish the same number of planes to go out tomorrow.

12/1835 Sent 122335 T/L to NAS Banana River. "We leave the number of planes to your discretion."

12/1855 Sent 122323 Priority dispatch to CG PANDORA AND CG VIGILANT information ComGulf, NAS Banana River "Commence Square and expanding search 13 December in area 2750N 7700W. Coordinate your search with NAS Banana River planes who will also be searching in that area.

12/1857 VIGILANT 1600R position 2754N 7658W.

12/1858 PANDORA 1600 position 2732N 7829W.

12/1859 PANDORA 1700R position 2730N 7820W.

12/1905 VIGILANT 1800R position 2803N 7656W.

12/1907 From Lake Worth Inlet PBS to CCGC 7th information CGC Miami 121901 dispatch "30302 on search for reported floating object.

12/1920 From NAS Banana river to ASR Miami 130015 T/L Refer 122323. Notified VIGILANT AND PANDORA OF YOUR instruction will notify COMGULF

12/2010 From NAS Banana River to ASR Miami as follows; "Planes going on search tomorrow 13 December will be Vero and Daytona Dumbo they were instructed to take off at 0630R.

12/2011 From ASR Miami to NAS Banana River 130037 T/L "Pas Vero Dumbo returned to base"

12/2012 From NAS Banana River "Affirmative. Vero Dumbo landed at 1710R. results were negative.

12/2035 CG VIGILANT 1900R position 2804N 7650W.

12/2100 CG VIGILANT 2000R position 2804N 7643W.

12/2216 CG VIGILANT 2100R position 2803N 7637W.

12/2320 CG VIGILANT 2200R position 2803N 7631W.

12/2326 CG VIGILANT 2300R position 2803N 7625W.

12/2330 13/0430 PANDORA reported 2330R position as 27-50 N and 7700W Searching in assigned area. Will work with planes in morning as directed.

13/0000 13/0500 VIGILANTS 0000R position 2803N and 7613W.

13/0100 13/0600 VIGILANTS 0100R position 2802N 7642W.

13/0200 13/1700 VIGILANTS 0200R position 28N and 7632W.

13/0300 VIGILANTS 13/0800 0300R position 2758N and 7638W.

13/0400 13/0900 VIGILANTS 0400R position 27-56N 76-44W.

13/0500 13/1000 VIGILANTS 0500R position 2755N 7648W.

13/0600 13/1100 VIGILANTS 0600R position 2754N 7653W.

13/0720 13/1230 Banana River reports Vero Dumbo off at 0745R ETA at position 0845R Daytona Dumbo off at 0723R ETA 0955R.

Approved:

Wm. Fisher, Captain, USCG

W. T. MURPHY, Lt. Comdr. USCG

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0801 - Lt. R. S. Covey on duty. Pending Incidents File No. 2273, 2284, 2298
0845 - Lt. Comdr. Murphy reported duty.
0830 - Yeomen Ross, Neely, and Shastid reported for duty.
1234 - Dinner Key advises Boca Chica Dumbo up on search at 1225R. No details on what search as yet.
1245 - Dinner Key advises Boca Chica Dumbo out on search for SNJ reported overdue at Tampa from Key West. Just heard St. Pete say SNJ has been located.
1261 - Sent following to St. Pete "Request full information on SNJ overdue from Key West to Tampa and action you have taken."
1320 - St. Pete advises "SNJ has landed at army airfield"
1350 - Dinner Key advises SNJ landed at Buckingham AAF, Ft. Myers at 1145" Dumbo will land at 1410R.
1430 - Boca Chica controller advises Dumbo landed 1415 K 93 was dispatched to search at 1206 and landed at 1345
1452 - St. Pete advises N' 6574 was diverted from routine flight at 1225 and secured at 1240.
1557 - Lt. (jg) C. F. Koch reported for duty
1559 - End of watch
1601 - Lt. Comdr. M. T. Murphy, Lt. Covey, Lt. (jg) C. F. Koch, Yeoman Ross, Neely and Shastid on duty, pending action on Incidents File #2273 2284, 2298 2299 2300.
1610 - Lt. Covey departed
2015 - ASN teletype out of order. Messages coming thru garbled. Requested CO communications to call Telephone company, and request immediate repairs.
2030 - ASN teletype not repaired we are getting some messages thru.
2150 - From NAS Banana River to CSR Miami 140245 TAL: Between 2010 and 2015 Roger Training 63 made an emergency landing a proximately 8 miles north of Titusville in the Indian River. Boat facilities at Navy Titusville were dispatched and handled the case. Plane is in 3 ft of water. Crew is unhurt. This will cause a delay in our report to you.
2158 - ASN Teletype now operating properly
2300 - Lt. Comdr. M. T. Murphy departed - (2315- Lt.(jg) S. G. Ferret reported.)
2345 - Lt. Sauer reported for duty
2359 - End of watch
0001 - Lt. (jg) C. F. KOCH, Lt. R. F. Sauer on duty. Pending incidents 2298, 2299, 2300 2273, 2284
0010 - Lt. (jg) C. F. Koch departed 0600- Lt. (jg) S. G. Ferrett departed.
0745 - Lt. R. S. Covey reported
0759 - End of watch.

Current Incidents

File No. 2299

Action Time	Current
Subject:	Medico from SS CONASTOGA
Origin:	Was -
Location:	300 miles south of S. W. Pass
Action: 13/1105	Received from NAK following "SS CONASTOGA 300 miles from S. W. Pass. Speed 16 knots bound Beaumont. Have Messman age 23 complains pain in stomach Temperature 100.1 Pulse 77 has been vomiting three times have gave dose of pareagaric and oly liquid food. Has no pain in lower right side. Please advise. Master."
13/1115	Called Dr. Federr, USPHS, who gave medical advise as continued.

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CG District Log, 7ND 0800 13 December 1945, Contd

Current Incidents (Contd)

File No. 2299
Subject: Medico from SS CONASTOGA
Action: 13/1119 Following sent to MAX for delivery to SS CONASTOGA "Reur 131537. Apply ice bag to abdomen. Give no cathartics and liquid food only if tolerated. Hospitalized man in arrival meanwhile keep us advised."
13/1212 MAX advised above message delivered at 1135R.

File No. 2300
Action Time: Current
Subject: Unknown station calling NHA-1
Origin: Capt. Birsh, NAS, Ft. Lauderdale
Location: Unknown
Action: 13/1134 Lt. Comdr. Murphy received all from Capt. Birsh, NAS, Ft. Lauderdale that an unknown station was heard on 3000 kcs. trying to call NHA-1 (Pt. Everglades Boat facility). He was advised of same by Banana River. Signal strength very weak. HF/DF not alerted.
13/1148 Asked Pt. Everglades and Banana River if they had any additional information on above. They report negative.
13/1412 Sent following to Banana River and Pt. Everglades "HF/DF net secured monitoring 1900F. Results negative. Nothing more has been heard. Incident closed.

Further Action - Previous Incidents

File No. 2284
Subject: Man Lost near Appalachicola, Mr. Joe Thompson
Action: 13/1215 St. Pete advised JRF, FAF, HNS have searched area Lat. 2957N to 2950N and Log. 84-42 to 8515W with negative results. A civilian plane hired by townspeople at Appalachicola also participated in search. Townspeople feel that man has drowned but desire search be continued until body recovered. This command believes area has been carefully and completely covered by searching aircraft. Suggest discontinuing search unless it so desired to continue for sake of morale of townspeople in which case recommend assigning one aircraft from St. Pete until not later than 16 December. Lt. Comdr. Goodwin is senior officer present. If search is continued, request Biloxi aircraft remain at scene request instructions.
13/1327 Sent following to St. Pete. "Refer our 120910 which ordered search secured.
13/1546 St. Pete advised. "Body found at Appalachicola today. JRF Buno 84792 departed Appalachicola 1500 for St. Pete. Will give complete information when plane returns.
13/1754 From CGAS St. Petersburg 132252 TWL "JRF (84792) landed Drew Field from Appalachicola due to fog at St. Pete. Report will be delayed until pilot arrives by land transportation.
13/2146 From CGAS St. Pete 140236 TWL "Data on Appalachicola search 8-13 December, will be submitted as soon as pilot is available with information. Plane was forced to land at Drew Field due to fog at this field.

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CG District Log 7MD - 0800 13 December - 0800 14 December, 1945, Cont'd

Further Action - Previous Incidents

File No. 2284
Subject:
Action: 14/0230 Man lost near Appalachicola, Mr. Joe Thompson
Received message from DCGO 8ND, 140656, stating 0830R JRF 210 departed Tyndall Field to resume search for Joe Thompson reported lost in marshes east of Appalachicola, Florida 6 Dec. 1945. 1005 JRF 210 landed Appalachicola 1400 JRF 210 enroute to Tyndall Field reported that body of Joe Thompson was found by a Coast and Geoditic Servy vessel at approximately 1215. JRF 210 to Ran Tyndall Field due to weather. Case closed.

14/0530 14/0530 Sent message to DCGO 8ND 141025, stating where did Geoditic Survey boat pick up body supposed Joe Thompson. Lat and Long. Is it definitely his body. Request any other information you have regarding this.

14/0630 Received message from DCGO 8ND stating Information radioed to Beloxi by JRF 210 now ROW Tyndall Field. Further clarification impossible at present. Unable contact JRF 210.

File No. 2273
Subject: Five TBM's (Lost, HAS Ft. Laudardale) Lost.
Action: 13/0845 Received VIGILANTS 131500 0800 position 2755N 7705W.
13/0850 Received PANDORA'S 131500 0800R position 2748N 7703W.
13/0852 Received Banana Rivers 131341 to Mayport. "Have Mayport Dumbo conduct ladder search of area from shore line to 80-00W. And from 28-20N to 30-00N distance between legs 8 miles, commence search at 3000N and 8118W. Search for possible wreckage and debris of missing PBM's. Advise time of take off Mayport Dumbo.

13/0907 Banana River advises their PBY will make above search as Mayport Dumbo is out of commission.

13/0933 Banana River advises "Vero Dumbo and Daytona Dumbo near the area assigned for search. Report ceiling 400 feet. Visibility zero. Weather moving north. Have instructed them to search as closely as possible to the area assigned but avoid instrument conditions and remain on contact.

13/1003 Banana River advises "Do you concur with the orders issued to the Dumbo's. They conflict with those issued by ASR, Miami, which designates search area for this date.

13/1008 Sent following to Banana River "Reur 131503. Affirmative. Use your own judgment. If results negative today search will be secured on return of planes to Base."

13/1056 Banana River advises "Baker 66 was off at 1020 to conduct this search."

13/1130 Banana River advises "B-68 landed and is being replaced by B-56

13/1140 Received PANDORAS 131600 PANDORA 1100R posit. 2751N 7655W.

13/1143 Asked Banana River "Request time back for B-68.
Banana River advises "Back at 1126?

13/1315 Received PANDORAS 131700 PANDORAS 1200R posit. 2750N 7706W.

13/1330 Received VIGILANTS 131705 1200R posit. 2745N 7733W.

13/1405 Received copy PANDORAS 131800 "PANDORA also has white bale of rubber aboard that looked like folded parachute until rescued.

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CG District Log 7ND 0800 13 December, 1945 - 0800 14 December Contd

Further Action - Previous Incidents (Contd)

File No. 2273
Subject:
Action :13/1405 Five TBM'S (NAS Ft. Lauderdale) Lost
1300R position PANDORA 2747N 7719W
VIGILANTS 131800 1300R position 2753N 7740W

13/1436 Banana River advised B-56 off at 1230R on search

13/1630 PANDORA 1500R Position 2747N 7722W

13/1715 PANDORA 1600R position 2747N 7710W

13/1741 VIGILANT 1500R Position 2758N 7728W

13/1742 From NAS Banana River 132231 TWL Daytona and Vero Beach Dumbo have returned to base after searching area assigned 2830N to 3000N Banana River SNB searched area from 2920N to 2940N and from 8100W to 8150W results of all searches negative. Request instructions for Friday 14 December

13/1748 To all ASR stations 132316 TWL TBM search secured this date at 1700 Roger

13/1755 From NAS Banana River to ASR Miami, 132356 TWL How about the PBM Search.

13/1756 From ASR Miami to NAS Banana River. "Affirmative on that too."

14/1757 132242 TWL to all Air Sea Rescue Stations. 3rd Army airforce, Boca Raton Army Air Field. "Will you be able to furnish the following information on how many planes from your NAS participated each day in the search and the types area searched and total hours flown on search

13/1950 Sent 114033 Priority dispatch to RAF Nassau Bahamas. Please advise immediately report on day by day bases of planes used on search TBMS. Hours flown and area searched.

13/1930 CG VIGILANT 1700R position 2800N 7716W.

13/2310 Sent following 140359 Priority dispatch to CGC PANDORA to recapitulation on day by day basis of your search from 5 Dec. to date for five TBMS.

13/2325 NAS, Ft. Lauderdale advises via 140422 TWL via Pt.Everglades as follows "NAS Lauderdale advises that they will be unable to get that information til morning as their log books are all locked up.

13/2339 From CG Pandora to DCGO 7ND 14002 dispatch "Ref 132019. Results of search negative. Returning to ETA Miami 1430R. 14 December.

13/2340 From CG VIGILANT to DCGO 7ND information CGG Ft. Pierce 132315 dispatch. "Ref ur 132019. Results of todays search negative returning to station ETA 1100R. 14 December.

File No.F2298 No. 2298
Subject:
Action: 13/1109 American Eagle (2 masted schooner)
Sent following to CGG St.Pete. Advise where schooner American EAGLE towed to and time arrival CG Active.
Received 131900 dispatch from CGG Tampa to DCGO 7ND. "Reuf 131609. Schooner American EAGLE towed to Tampa by passing Army crash boat. CG ACTIVE investigated at 1608R. Situation was such that a commercial tug should have been utilized as vessel was in safe anchorage and not in distress. Incident closed.

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/s/ W. T. MURPHY, Lt. Cdmdr. USCG

Approved:

Wm. Wishar, Captain, USCG

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MARK 1946

GULF SEA FRONTIER HF/DF NET

5 December 1945

GLOSSARY

AG	District Coast Guard Office, Eighth Naval District
GF	U. S. Naval Air Station, Corpus Christi, Texas
LN	Jupiter, Florida
LN	U. S. Coast Guard, Key West, Florida
LO	U. S. Naval Air Station, Pensacola, Florida
LP	Houma, Louisiana
LQ	Houston, Texas
IR	Port Isabel, Texas
OF	U. S. Coast Guard, St. Petersburg, Florida
OM	U. S. Coast Guard Air Station, Dinner Key, Florida
OX	U. S. Coast Guard, Biloxi, Mississippi
AX	Tropical Radio, WAX, Hialeah, Florida
NU	NO Radio NNU

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LM LO LP V ZE MONITOR 4805 KCS FOR PLANE FT28 A5 PLANE LOST ON EAST COAST FLA 2145

LP R 2144 K
LO R 2144 K
LM R 2144 K
V ZE IF U HR HIM OR FT74 ALERT THE NET 2145

4805 FT 28 A5 LP7 2147 K
V LP DFH NW

ZE V LP CUD SUB BE USING CALL QUOTE TAYLOR UNQUOTE K
V ZE DONT KNO
DFG V LP
DFH
LM UH 53 (;UHZVMOI IS FT 28
LR UH K
LP V ZE TAYOXXX TAYLOR IS THE WING MAN AND IS BEING CALLED BY SQDRN LEADER K

V LP R ALSO HR FT28 CANT MAKE OUT WHO HE WORKING K
LO 163 B3 55 K
LP 113 C5 50 ON TAYLOR
LM V ZE T NFF THIS ALERT K
V LM R 57 K
LO 163 B2 57 DISTORTED SUB UNCERTAIN K
TAYLOR UP NW V LP

ZE V LP IS WHOLE SQDRN LOST OR JUST TWO ALERTED IMI K
V ZE THE LEAD PILOT COMPASS IS OUT AND FT28 IS LOST FROM TH SQDRN THREE ARE/5 PLANES UP K
LP R

Q5G V ZE FT 28 IS LEADER OF 5 PLANES AND THE WHOLE SQDRN IS LOST OF THA T GROUP X FT74 IS OK ADN JUT PICKED UP MSG AND RELAYED FOR FT28 2211

LO 216 . B3 11 NO SENSE K
H
FT28 5
HELLO NA NHA3 TI FT28 V LP
LP 115 0 2 15 FT28 K
LO 270 B13 15 K
LO CCCCCCC LAST BRNG 068 W2 15 K
ZE V LM ET FROM NFF Q5K UH 5AT 2213 K
LO 068 W2 16 K
ZE V LM ACK ABOVE PLEASE K
V ZE R

KV
LP 090 B2 QSB ON SUBJECT SAYING WL HAVE TO LAND ON WATER UNLESS LANDFALL C MY BRNG AT 15 BELIEVE TT WAS ON 11 NHA3 K
LQ UH 18 K
V LO BT FT28 FLYING 270 DEG AT QT 15 PLANES WERE TOLD TO LA D IN THE WATER WHEN THE FIRST PLANE DROPPED TO TEN GALLONS OF GAS K
ZE V O LO BT DOES PLANES WORK ANY OTER FREQ QRK HEAVY HERE K
V ZE THATS THE ONLY FREQ

LR UH K
LP 092 C 2 22 K
LP 085 /NIL G2 25 K
LM UH HR K
V LO PLANES WERE TOLD THE WEATHER WAS CLEZR AT LAUN XXXX LAUDERADALE K

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V LP NHA3 TOLD FT28 I BELIEVE TO SHIFT TO EFR 3000 KC CAN
U CONFIRM THIS IMI K
LO 127 A3 26 / ?? SUB UNCERTAIN K
V ZE R
ALL STAS GET ALL BRNGS POSSIBLE K
LP 095 SB 30 K
LP STRONG CARRIER UP OFTEN IT FREQ QRM NO VIOICE VOICE 303 BRNG K
V ZE R

V ZE TAKE BRGNS ON CARRIER MAYBE HIM K
V LR X IS ABVE CARIER ON 3000 IMI OR ;3K
WPT
V ZE PLANES ON RIPT 4805 KCS

LO 294 A3 32 CARRIER K
LP 305 A4 42 CCC 32 CARRIER K
LR NB X HEAR ONLY BROAD CAST STA HERE AR
LQ 295 C5 33 K
LO 296 A3 35 CARRIER DFH NOW K
LP 305 B4 35 1-4 CARRIER K
LO 296 A3 36 CARRIER UP NOW K
LM UH 35 K

V ZE DISREGARD BRGNS ON CARRIER LOOK FR FT28
2238

LP 094 / NIL B3 40 K
LO 120 A //// C2 41 K

LA
ZAM
Q5C V ZE PLANES HAVE BEEN TOLD TO GO TO 3000 KCS X NOT KNOWN WHETHER
THEY RECD MSG BUT STAS GUARD 39CCC 3000 AS WELL AS 4805 KCS 2243 K

LQ 085 W2 41 ON 4805 KCS K
LM LR V ZE EITHER HAVE BRNGS ON)O CC LP7 K
V LM UH LP 7 K
LR UH HERE AR
LQ 090 C2 45 K
LP 095 C2 46 QRM FM NHA3 K
LQ 088 C2 QRM 46 K
LP 090 K NIL A 4 FT28 AT 47 K
LO 105 C3 46 XX FT 28 AI K
V LO BT BRNG TAKEN ON FT28 AI K
LP NIL/089 C 4 FT28 48 K
LO 106 B3 49 X FT28 A1 (K
V LP TT AE IS NHA3 RITE K
LQ 085 C2 QRM 49 K
HELLO NHA3 THIS IS FT28 OVR
LP 092 K NIL A4 51 K
V ZE WHAT FREQ WAS FT ON THEN K
V LP STILL 4805 K
LP 099 A4
L

LP 089 A4 52 FT28 K
LQ 084 B3 50-51
LQ 082 A3-PN FT3 K
LP 090/NIL A4 53 K
LQ ABV BRNG P CCC OF 082 UAS AT 2251 K
ZE V LM BT SHALL I INFORN NFF TO GUARD 3000 KCS IN ADDITION TO 4803
K
LP 093 / NIL B3 55 QUOTE F N FT 28 I CANNOT CHANGE FREQ
I MUST KEEP MY PLANES INTACK K
V ZE R
LM V ZE IN VIEW OF LAST XMISSION NFF ONLY GUARD 4805
Q5C V ZE GUARD 4805 KCS ONLY AND NOT 3000 KCS K
2255

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LQ 060 B5 54 K
NU V AX QUM
ZE V AX K
V ZE K

ZE V AX CAN U TELL US IF 500 IS CLR HW
V ZE THINK IT IS QRT IN GULF ND QUM ON EAST COST K

V AX WELL WAS WONDERING IF NOT CLR BECAUSE NU HAS BEEN USING 500 KCS HW

NU V ZE

AS

V NU NO K
V ZE R
AX V ZE SEE ABOVE FM NU

V LP QUOTE WE MAY HVE TO DITCH ANI MINUTE K

V ZE BT PLANE SAY MAY HVE TO DITCH ANI MINUTE 2302

VQ
1
Q50 V ZE SUBT ALL BRGNS ON HIM 239XXX 2302

LR IQXXXX UH 02K
LO NB QRM 04
LP 097 SB 04
LP 087 SB 05
LP 097/087 04 06K
LQ 085 B3 2304 K
LP 092/ NIL B5 07 ON TAYLOR K
LQ 082 B3 05 K
LP 092 B3 08 ON TAYLOR K
LO 034 WW E /// 3 07 K
LQ 085 B5 06-07 K

M

ZE V AX BT HAVE RQ FROM KTOB FOR NAVIGATIONAL BEARING QTE? X HE IS ON
IF X DO NOT RECOMMEND X PLS ADVISE 2310 AR

AX V ZE IFNOT EMERGENY HAVE HIM SAID XX QRX TILL DISTRESS OVE 2310

ZE V AX R NO EMERGENCY AR

Z

E V LO
U WANT ANY INFO TT TAYLOR SAID TO TOWER UNABLE
TO HR WHAT TOWER SAID TOSHIM K
V ZE R AS

V ZE IMI TO TWR K

LO V ZE K

LO V ZE K

V LO TAYLOR SAID NEGATIVE WHAT COURSE ARE WE ON
AFFIRMATIVE I PRETTY SURE WE ARE OVER GULF WE DIDNT GO FAR ENOUGH EAST
HOW LONG WE BEEN ON THIS COURSE I SUGGEST WE FLY DUE EAST
UNTIL WE RUN OUT OF GAS WE HADXXXX HAVE BETTER CHANCE OF BEING PICKED
UP CLOSE TO SHORE D THIS IS ALL I HRD SO FAR MAYBE
LP CAN AMPLIFY THIS HW K
A

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ZE V NU RDQ PERMISSION GA WID AX K
V ZE K

AX V NU 500 ALL CLEAR OVER HR SO FAR AS I KNW QUM WAS SENT ABT
AN HOUR OR SO AGO DIDNT KNW WHEN U ASKED BEFORE AS 500 WAS BUSY ES
CUDNT LUK UP WHOLE LOG HW

LO V ZE K

V LO WHAT U WANT PSE K

LO V ZE WHAT STATION WAS TAYLOR WORKING
LO HE JUST CALLED TOWER TT ALL I CUD MAKE OUT HE NEVER USE
ANY CALL EXCEPT TOWER K
V ZE R AS

LO V ZE THE WING MANS NAME IS POWER AND THE LEADER IS TAYLOR SO
THE WORKING BACK AND FORTH

V LO I NEVER HRD POWER AT ALL K
S
V LO SORRI GUESS IT CUD OF BEEN RTE IMI RITE WE HAVE HVY QRM
FROM FOREIGN AS STATIN HR K
V ZE R AR 2323

AX V ZE SEE ABOVESFM NU
ZE V LP BT WE TOOK BRNGS ON BOTH TAYLOR AND POWER BUT THOT POWER WAS
A SHORE STA X HIS BRNG WAS 97 AT TIME OF LAST TRANSMSN K
V ZE R

ZE V LO MAY I ASK LP WHO JUST SAID YOUR CLEAR ACROSS RNXXX RUNWAY DO
IMI RUNWAY DOC K
V ZE C

LP V ZE SEE ABOVE K
LO V ZE BT HRD TRANS BUT CUDNT READ IT K
V ZE R

LP V ZE SEE ABOVE K
ZE V LP SRI BT USED YOUR SINE ABOVE IS LOV LP K
LO V LP DID NOT GET LAST TRANS OF PLANES K

ZE V LO CAN U TELL WHAT FIEDL THESE PLANES ARE FROM IMI WA WHAT FIEDL
LO V ZE THEY OUT OF FT LAUDERDALER ON NAVIGATION FLIGT R
V LO R 35 K
QSO V ZE HR APPROX FIX 2914 N 7900 W AT 2250 RADIUS 100 .8)MILES 2336

ZE V LM BT SO U WISH MLM TO RELAY THIS FIX TO MFF FOR THEIR INFO K

V ZE S AS

LM V ZE SEND TO MFF

OM V EZE K

ZE V LM BT HERE HEADING WILL USE ---A- CAZE/MFF BT IMI CC K
UBV ZE C

OM V ZE K
ZE V LM BT R UR FIX TO MFF 2342 AR

OM V ZE K

T
OM V ZE K K

V OM K

OM V ZE U GET FIX ON LOST PLANS ABOVE IMI K

V OM AS AS

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ON V ZE HR FIX 2915N 7900 W AT 2250 RADIUS 100MILES 2345 K

V ON R AR
ON V ZE PLS STAY KN THIS NET DURING THESE CASES AR

K
ZE V LM BT NFF ROGERED FIX AT 2349 K

V ZE R AR 2350

ZE V LM BT INT SECURE LP7 K
LM V ZE NEGATIVE KEEP ALERT WATCH ON 4805 KCS AS THEY READY TO DITCH K
V LM BT R R X NFF MAY ASK FOR SECURE X WILL TELL THEN QQZ AR

GMMV LO BT HRD HA4l V HA3 WE WILL GIVE U A CALL ON MIAMI ? IN ONE MIN OVER X DOES THIS MAKE SENSE K
V ZE MAY MEAN THAT MIAMI NSO IS GOING TO CALL HIM I HW
V LO WORD AFTER MIAMI SOUNDED LIKE BONNIE K
V ZSUBR ZE R AR 2400

;)
V LP WA MIAMI WAS BOMBING K
V ZE R

END OF DA

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NARA 134

EASTERN SEA FRONTIER RP/DF NET

5 December 1945

GLOSSARY

LC	Jamesport, Maine
QC	Winter Harbor, Maine
LD	Brunswick, Maine
LE	Assaganset, Long Island
LI	Cape May, New Jersey
LJ	Poyners Hill, North Carolina
LT	Duponte, South Carolina
LL	Glen Cove, Georgia
LM	Jupiter, Florida
LK	Bermuda
FB,	Banana River, Florida

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IR V AV INT K
V IR K
IR V AV PLANES /5/ ARE LOST OUT OF FT LAUDERDALE X REQUESTING QTF
ON 4805 KCS A3 X WUD LIKE TO HAVE HT AND LL MONITOR AND REPT IF
ANYTHING HRD X 2144 K CALL OF PLANE FT28 FLIGHT OF 5 TBF'S K
LL HT V R NOTE ABOVE AND CMXXXXX COMPLY K 2144

HT R AR
LL R AR
V HT IS ANI CALL GIVEN ON THAT ASSIGNMENT HW K
V AV CALL OF PLANE IS FT28

4805 FT 28 A3 LP7 2147K

V MN QRA KFZV (USMS VENA) AR 2147
V IR R 2147

V LJ FT28 70 UP HW
V AV IS 70 UR BNG INT K
V LJ NEG BT 194 C3 46 K

MN V IR WHAT IS STATUS NOW OF KFZV X IS HE FINISHED
TRANSITING X DOES HE WANT MORE BEARINGS X IS HE IN NEED OF ASSISTANCE
IN WAY OF VESSEL COMING OUT AFTER HIM K IR V MN HE IS THROUGH
XMITTING X DOES NOT NEED MORE BRNGS X DO YOU KNOW OF ANY ACTION
TAKEN ON HIM K V IR
V MN ASI PSE K
V IR R 2154 AR

HT RE CSE) LP7 WW BNG K
K IR V LI BT DO U WANT BNGS ON LP7 K

LI V IR K BRGS
LI 193 84 49 K
TOVLINT ALERT NR LP7 HW K

LOIR V SL INT K
K
IR V WSL X WSL IS WORKING AN MEDICO IN 8320 (KCS
V IR R PRINT TEXT WHEN OBTAINED K

IR V SL R
2157 AR
IV SL X COPY OF MEDICO X SS JOHN EVANS/ KXUQ CK82 2115 X
MEDICO MARINE HOSPITAL NEWYORK MAN TWENTY EIGHT ILL TPR 102 84
20 FEVER ONSET TDAY LARGE RED PUSTULE WITH WHITE CENTER ON FOREHEAD
SWELLING AND TIGHTNESS OF SKIN FOREHEAD AND AROUND AND BETWEEN EYES
EYES TIRED AND SR/ SENSITIVE TO LIGHT SINUS HEADACHE TENDERNESS
FOREHEAD AND RIGHT SIDE OF FACE ALONG CHEEKBONES TO EARLOBE AND BEHIND
EAR NO APPETITE SLIGHT NAUSEA REDDENING OF THROAT BUT NO PAIN TO
// TONGUE O
SL V IR HOLD REST OF THAT MEDICO TILL CALLED FOR X HAS IT
BEEN PASSED ALREADY BY OTHER MACHINE K
IR V SL X NO X THIS IS DIRECT COPY K
SL V IR R CONTINUE WITH MEDICO IMI AA TONGUE K
T

M
IR V AV FT28 UP HW X CALLING QUOTE TAYLOR IMI TAYLOR 2285 K

SL V IR AS AS AR
Q5H V IR LP7 UO XXXX UP NOW K WITH BRGS SOON AS RECD K

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2206
V QC IS FT28 UP NOW IMI K
V IR AV REPORTS UP NOW AR 2207
CCCCC 2206
IR V LI BT KKMR IS CALLING NKC ON 375 X CAN THEY GO AHEAD K

NKC V IR HAS KC CONTACTED KKMR YET K
V LI BT NEG

MN V IR CONTACT KKMR ON 375 AS AS
MN V IR CONTACT KKMR
DISREGARD ABOVE

CONTACT KKMR AND ASK HIM IF HE CZXXXX CAN WAIT
FEW MINUTES
ABOVE FOR KC V IR
VLI R
KC V IR INRXXX INT R ABOVE K
V LI BT I HANDLE ALL TPC FOR KC K
V IR R TU AR 2211

Q5H V IR SUBMIT BEARINGS OBTAINED ON LP7 K

V QC UH HR AR
LD UH HR AR
LE UH K
LT UH K
L 194 C4 CCCCC
LI 194 C4 57 K
LJ UH HR
HT UH K
LL 135 SB 2150
LL 133 C3 2152
LL 128 C3 C4
LL120 C3 10-11 K
LM NB SI 09 K
LK UH K
LC UH (WAS BUSY) K
LL C3 15 K
CCCC
LL 120 C3 15 K
IR V LI BT KC ATEMPTED TO CONTACT KKMR BUT HE DID NOT ANSWER K
V IR R 2217

Q5H V IR SUBMIT ON XXXXX ONLY BRGS OBYAINED ON LP7 K
V IR V M INT K
V IR K
V MV QPP QPM FT28 WHEN FIRST MAN GETS DOWN TO 10 GALLONS OF GAS
WE WILL ALL LAND IN THE WATER TOGETHER DOES EVERYONE UNDERSTAND
THAT UNQUOTE FT28 IS IN RDO CONTACT WITH NHA3 V MV K
V AV R TU 2222 CCC 2219

V LI HERE BNG ON LP 7
L 1190 C4 2217 K
IR V LM BT HAS MN10 BEEN SECURED K
V IR MN 10 NOT YET SECURED X PSE GIVE LM BRG ON
LP7 K
V LM UH HR K

I
MN V IR ANY MORE INFO ON MN10 ~~####~~ K
V MN NEG K
MN V IR ANY ACTION TAKEN ON MN10 SUBJ K

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OSHSNDO C
Q5
...
Q5H RDO V IR SECURE MS10 2224 X CLASIFY USMS AR

IR V AV INT K
K
V AV FT28 IS SQDRN LEADER OF 5 PLANES AND THEY AEE ALL LOST OFF
THE COAST NEAR MAIMI OR THIS VICINITY ONLY VOICE K

V IR R
2225

V LL HR BRN ON LP7
LL 118 C3 22 K
LI 195 C4 25 K

SL V IR IMI AA TONGUE K 2227
IR V SL R
IR V SL TONGUE NORMAL HAD CHILL PR MATE ABOARD GIVING PENICILLIN
Q4H STOP REQUEST ADVICE
HARRY J KAMINSKY MASTER 052115
TOD 2226 8320 (:
SL V IR R IF Q4H K
Q4H
V IR R 2229 AR TU
IR V LD DID U NOTE BRGNS FM LL LI ABVE HW

IR V LD INT AK ARK HW
V IR NOT NECESSARY AR 2231 AR
IR V LD INT QRK HW
QRJ5.
QRK 5 AR AR 2232 AR
T IR V AV ANY BRNGS FRM IR NET VRY IMPORTANT X ANY VORE K

Q5H RDXXX
Q5;;
Q5H V IR K BEARININGS ON LP7 NO UH REPORTS K

LI V IR ANY MORE BRGS K
V LI NEG
LL V IR K
IR V LL NO M RE BRNGS K
R TU
IR V MV INT K
K
V MV QPM FT////////
V MV QPM NHA3 TO FT28 QUOTE CAN U SHIFT TO 30000 KCS OVER UNQUOTE V MV
NO ANSWER HRD HERE FM FT28
V IR R 2235.///// 2235 AT
M
T
IR VMF BT X XXXXX DE NMN XXXX QJZ HW
X ON 599 /////
IMIV;; ?5 TT
MGCB V IR IMI ALL ABOVE QVP K
VV MF BT ON 500 KCS XXXX DE NMN XXX QRT QJZ
V IR R 2237
MN V IR INT ABVE X CAN U AMPLIFYK
IR V MN AS PSE
R 2238

V MN BT WE SENT NOTHING X WE HAVE ORDERS FM ASR NORFOLK TO
CONTACT KFZV AND HAVE KFZV SEND MO'S AGN FOR QTE'S X MSG AS FOLLOWSFROM
KFZV BT WANT ASSISTANCE POSITION NORTH 65 E FROM CAPE HENRY TRUE AT GCT
2225 BT 052228 ------- WE ARE TRYING TO CONTACT KFZV --- KFZV FADED OUT
ON HIS SIGNAL AND WE GOT NO QSL FOR OUR MSG ---YOU ARE 27 MILES BEARING
115 FROM CAPE HENRY BT 2241

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MN V IR R X IF SUBJ HEARD ALERT NET FOR MORE BRGS K
V MN AS YET NO QSO BUT WILL ALERT NET AGN AS MN10 HW
V U
FIVALLD HAE HRD / SEV ART ON 500 KCS HW

MN V IR MN10 WAS SECURED REALERT ON NEXT CONSECUTIVE NUMBER K
V MN RA R

LD V IR IMI K
IR V LD BT HAVE HRD SEV QRT ON 500 KCS K
LD V IR WHO SENT THEM AND WHAT WZS SENT GIVE DC K
IKKB I
BV LD QRT DISTRESS TKHN HRD SEVERAL OTHER STA SAY SAME NO SINE HW
IR V SL CONFIRM ABOVE 2243 SEVERAL QRTS DISTRESS ON 500 NO
DETAILS YET

V IR ANY CALLS HEARD K
NO
V D VNMXO M MIM
V IR R TU2245
V LI BT HER BNG LN LP7
LI 198 C4 40 K

V LI BT SUBJ WAS HRD ASKING WHA3 SIG STRENGHT K
V IR R
IR V A
AV V IR NOTE AR 2246
IR V AV R NOTED
IR V LD QPM 500 QRT XXX QRT
V IR R 2250

IR V LI BT KC IS BEING CALLED ON 375 X PERMISSION TO K WHT HIM K
V IR KKKK
V LI BNG ON LP7
LI 200 B4 50 K
LE V LD QPM 500 KCS CQ DE VCS FOLLOWING PM VCG
CANCEL XXX QUM HW
V IR R 2254

IR V LJ INT K BNG ON LP7 K
V IR KLJ Q196 59XXXXX B3 50 K
BNG ON LP7
LT 206 SB QRM 53 K

LL V AV INT MORE BRNGS ONLP7 K 2258
AV V LL HAD BRNG ON SIG BUT WAS NOT SUR E SUBJ OF ALRT K

XR V AV RE LP7 SUBJ SAYS HE CANNOT CHANGE TO 3000 SO
WILL STAY ON 4805 KCS X NEED ALL BRNGS POSSIBLE K 2259
V IR R 2300
SSS EUT
375 KCS KYUH A1 NO HF GEAR AND IN HVY FOG LIII WEPP CCC2300 AR
LI V IR IS SHIP QTN'ING K
V LI NEG X WILL INSTRUCT SHIP TO QTN T

V ZE BT PLANE SAY MAY HVE TO DITCH ANI MINUTE 2302

VQ
1
Q50 V ZE SUBT ALL BRGNS ON HIM 239XXX 2302

LR IQXXXX UH 02K
LC NB QRM 04
LP 097 SB 04
LP 087 SB 05
LP 097/087 C4 06K
LQ 085 B3 2304 K
V IR SUBMIT BRNGS ON LIII KK
V QC 220 B5 05 K
LJ 033,2 C 3 06 K P

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HT 039.9 P5 12
K
V HT CC TIME 07 K

KS 099 B 2209 K
LJ 039 C3 10-11 K

NLF V IR K BRNG
LE 199 B4 10 K
V LF 923//// // 0230 I F K
LF V IR CHECK SENSE X APPARENTLY RECIPROCAL K

NAB V IR INT BRNG K
V NAB NOB K
LI V IR RELEASE FOLLOWING RXXXX BRNGS
NKC 099 B 2209
NLJ 039 C3 2211
LE 199 B4 2210
K 2317

T IR V LIT BT SHALL WE UEXXXX WE USE NLJ AND LE OR THE OLD CALLS
BT K
LI V IR USE NEW CALLS AND IF HE ASKS FOR POSN TELL HIM OF CHANGE K
V LI R WILCO
LI V IR NOTIFY IR OF TOD AND IF FURTHER BRNGS REQUIRED K
V LI R AR
QSH RDO V IR SECURE LIII X CLASSIFY COMMERCIAL X NEXT ALERT NUMBER
WILL BE 12 AR 2319
IR V MF K INT K
V IR K
IR V MF BT QPM 500 ART ICE BERG TTT AT 2320 BT K
V IR R 2321 AR

MF V IR INT WB I CE BERG K
V MF WB IE CCC ICE BERG QRT X DO U WANT ME TO ALERT NET K
MF V IR WAS ANY POSN RECEIVED K
IR V MF BT THAT WAS ALL THAT WAS SENT K
V R IR R AR 2324

EE
EMKMI
5

L$.
IR V HT INT K
K
V IR CUD YOU GIVE US DOPE WE MISSED IF ANY WHILE SECURED FROM CKT K
V IR AS

IR V LI BT NKC BEING CALLED ON 375 BY KKMR X PERMISSION TO GO AHEAD WITH
HIM K
V IR GO AHEAD K
2330

375 KCS KKMR AI LII2 2332 AR

V IR SUBMIT BRNGS AS RECEIVED AR 2332

LEXXXXX LI V IR FIND OUT NATURE OF EMERGENCY AND INSTRUCT QTN K
), AS CCCC ON CALL SINE SHD BE ((CCCC KKMR KKMR AR
V IR R

V IR CHANGE CALL SIGN OF ALERT TO BE KKMR AR 2333
HT V IR LP7 STILL ON K
IR V AV ANY MORE BRNGS FRM LJ LL HT ON LP7 IN T K 2335
V IR ABV STATIONS TAKE NOTE AND REPLY K
V

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V
AV V LL NEG K
B
V HT QQZ AR
LJ QQZ AR

V AV R
2335

Q5Q.V ZE HR APPROX FIX 2914 N 7900 W AT 2250 RADIUS 100 .8)MILES 2336

K
IR V AV ABOVE FYI X PLANES ABOUT READY TO DITCH SO ONLY GIVEN AS APPROX POSN 22CC 2337 K
V IR R TU 2338 AR

IR V AV STILL KEEPING ALERT IN EFFECT X ANYTHING PICKED UP WUD BE APPRECIATED K2338
V IR R 2338 AR

LI V IR INT INFO ON L112 K
IR V LI AS I
LJ O15 C4 39-40 K
V IR R 233///2341

IR V LI BT KKMR CALIMS TRYING TO MAKE LIGHTSHIP X WINDS AND RAIN ARE STRØ/
CCC STRONG AND PROGRESS IS ØLOW K

V IR R K WITH BRNGS K
2344

V QC 230

QC 230 P3 35 K
V HT SUBJ ON MO NW JK
V IR K BRNGS K K

L J O15 C4 44K
KCT)VH
HMVMV

KC 175 A 43 44 K
LF 239.6 (
LE 229 B4 4Ø K
NAB 227.2 Ø2 K

LF V IR IMI BRNG RPT K
V LF 239.6 K
V IR IMI TIME AND CLASS K
LF V IR INT TIME AND CLASS OF BEARING SUBMITTED K
V LF WRXXXXXXX2344 :5?/.9/ CKASF K
LF V IR IMI K

VVLFBFU IMI I I IMI I I IMI IMI
UO
V IR IR ONLY INTERESTED IN ABV X IR WILL ONLY ASK FOR IMIS AR

LF V IR YOUR MACHINE APPERENTLY OUT OF ORDER X NOTIFY TELCO AND REPORT WHEN IN CONDITION X SEND YOUR BEARINGS BY OHTHR R MEANS IF POSSIBLE K 2350
V2B996 & T

TBORO
LI V IR IS KKMR STILL UP K 2351

IR V LI BT NEG X BUT WE CAN STILL CONTACT HUN K
V IR R X HAVE HIM QTN AGN K X 2352

V LI R

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IR V AY INT K
K
V AY HAVE REPLY TO MEDICO FOR JOHN ESBBBO EVANS DO U WANTIT K
K
V AY HERE THE CCCCC TEXT ONLY SENT TO WSL
ADVICE X INCREASE PENCILLIN TO 30,000 UNITS EVERY TWO HOURS X
IF NECESSARY COMMUNICATE WITH DE MUIR WHICH IS IN YOUR VICINITY
WITH DOCACCCC DOCTOR ABOARD SIGNED DR WEIL K

V IR R TU WETT 2355 AR

IR V HT INT K WITH BNGS K
K
V HT 024.3 04 42-43-44 K
KC 175 A 2355 K
LJ K BRNGS K 2356

IR V AY CCC SIGNATURE ON THAT MEDICO TO REED DR MEE NOT WEIL K
V IR R 2357 AR

LJ 015 04 55
LE V IR K BRNG K

IR V LE NB K
V IR R 2359

LI V IR RELEASE FOLLOWING BRNGS TO KKWR LE 229 B 2345
KC 175 A 2355 NLJ 015 C 2355 K 2400

V IR END OF DAY AR 2400

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AAAA 162

AIR SEA RESCUE/GULF SEA FRONTIER ENT

5 December 1945

GLOSSARY

ZH	Gulf Sea Frontier, Joint Operations Center, Miami, Florida
AV	District Coast Guard Office, Seventh Naval District, Joint Operations Center, Miami, Florida
TO	U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida
VT	Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4, Port Everglades, Florida
EL	Boat Facility, Mayport, Florida
TA	U. S. Naval Air Station, Jacksonville, Florida
RP	Army Air Force, Morrison Field, Florida
WS	U. S. Coast Guard Air Station, Dinner Key, Florida
SA	U. S. Coast Guard, St. Petersburg, Florida
MT	U. S. Army Air Force, MacDill Field, Tampa, Florida

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TO V WS BT 052200

PORT EVERGLADES INFORMS US FLIGHT OF PLANES LOST NEAR FLA KEYS X CG DINNER KEY STANDING BY BT 052200

WS V TO

OGE

AR

V WS 2201 AR

V

TEST NOW IS THE TIME FR ALL GOOD MEN TO COME TO THE AID ETC
END OF ESTTEST

TO V UT

DOU READ DO U READ INT KKKKK

TA V ZE 052222 BT

CAN YOU GIVE FLIGHT ROUTE OF FLIGHT FT28 LEAT

V
TO V UT INT K

MTA V ZE ARE U GETTING MY TRAFFIC K AA FT 28

ERDS
S
M

THIS IS ZE PLS DO NOT BUST INTO TRANSMISSIONS THAT WAY UNLESS YOU HAVE URGENT TRFC ZE CONTROLS THIS CIRCUIT

TA V ZE 052222 BT

CAN YOU GIVE FLIGHT ROUTE OF FLIGHT FT 28 LEADER OF K

ZE V UT INT DU DO U READ WE HAVE UN URGENT TRAFFIC R K

ZE V UT R AS AS ONE MINN

WILCO

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NARA 164

ASR V ZE

V MV QPP QPM PT28 WHEN FIRST MAN GETS DOWN TO 10 GALS OF GAS WE WILL ALL LAND IN THE WATER TOGETHER DOES EREYONE IMI EVERYONE UNDERSTAND THAT UNQUOTE PT28 IS IN RDO CONTACT WITH NHA3 V MV K

ASR K

ASR V UT KKKKKK

ASR V UT K

V WS K

ASRV UT DO YOU READ THIS KKKK

PV ZE R

ASR V ZE 052230 BT

ADDITIONAL INFO ON ABOVE ASR MSG PT 28 IS FLIGHT LEADER AND THEY ARE WORJ IMI WORKING ON 2805 KCS K

V UT THAT IS 4805 KCS K

V WK R CCCC V WS R UNDR STND

TA V ZE DID U GET MY 052222 K

TA TA TA TA TA V ZE ZE K

TO V UT 052238 BT

A FLIGHT OF FIVE TBF LED BY FT-28 FROM NAS LAUDERDALE HAVE BEEN LOST SINCE 1621R X WE ARE ABLE TO CONTACT PT28 ON 4805 KCS VERY FAINTLY X NAS LAUDERDALE AEEEE UNABLE TO DETERMINE WHAT AREA PLANES ARE IN X WE HAVE 3 AVR STANDING BY X CAN YOU SET UP ON 4805 AND CONTACT THAT PLANE X OUR TELETYPE HAS BEE N OUT OF COMMISSION AND WE HAVE BEEN UNABLE TO SEND BT KKK

TO V UT INT R MY 052238 KKK

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ASR V UT INT KKK

V ZE R 2242 GCT

AS ASR V UT CAN U READ ME KKK

TV

TO V UT CAN U READ ME KKKK
UT V ZE WE GET U OK
TO UT IS CALLING U K K K

ZE V UT DID U READ MY 052238 TO BANANARIVE KK

R WE GOT IT OK TU
CAN U CONTACT -TO- KK
WILL C AS

UT V ZE WE WILL SEND UR MSG TO BANNANA RIVER ON OTHER TT K

ZE V UT ROGER TUVM AR

UT V ZE CANT GET BANANA RIVER ON OTHER MACHINE SORRI

TO TO TO TO TO V ZE ZE ZE K

ASR V ZE 052252 BT

FOLLOWING FROM DCGO SEVEN NAVDIST MIAMI X ALL STATIONS BANANA RIVER SOUTH

LIGHT [illegible] UP TO GREATEST EXTENT POSSIBEL

K

V UT WLCO WILCO

TA TO EL RP WS FA NT ASR INCLUDES YOU DID U GET MSG PLS R FER IT K

Z
ZE V WS WILL PLSE REPEAT ALL AFTER BANANA RIVER K

Z
ASR V ZE 052252 BT

FOLLOWING FROM DCGO SEVEN NAVDIST MIAMI X ALL STATIONS BANANA RIVER SOUTH

LIGHT UP TO GREATEST EXTENT POSSIBLE K

ZE V WS WORDS PILED UP AFTER BANANA RIVER IS THAT WORD SOUTH LIGHT K
R SOUTH LIGHT UP TO GREATEST EXTENT POSSIBLE K

ZE V WS ROGER 2300 AR
TA K
EL
K
TO
RP
FA
NT
ALL THE ABOVE PLSE R R FER MSG K

TO C UT TO V UT INT K INT M

ZE V UT DO U STILL READ

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TO V AV BT OUR HF DF GIVES FIX ON FLIGHT AS WO NORTH EE 29 NORTH 79 WSRT WHICH PUTS THEM NORTH OF ORIGINAL PRESUMED AREA X WILL YOU AE ALERT FIELDS NORTH OF YOU AS FAR AS JAX KK

ZE V UT WE ARE STILL READING OK

TO V AV KKKK
33488 RP
V

TO V AV KKK ZE V UT WE WILL RELAY UR LAST

EEEEE

AV V UT WE WILL RELAY UR MSG OT T TO BANRIV LAND LIND LINE

V AV R AR

ZW V TA QTC INUV K
XXXXXX

ZE V TA QTC INT K
ZE V TA BT HAVE MSG INT KUV
2 V ZE GA

ZE V TA BT 052330 BT
WILL LAUNCH N2S CALL 50A AT DAYLIGHT TO SEARCH AREA 7900 WEST
[illegible]
TO BEACM AND BETWEEN 29 DEGREES AND 30-2XXXX IMI 30-30 MINS X
WILL LAUNCH ALL AVAILABLE AIRCRAFT AS SOON AS PRACTICABLE TO SUMARCH SAME AREA BT K

V ZE R AR

ASR V ZE 052335 BT

FROM DCGO SEVEN MIAMI X ALL STATIONS FROM BANANA RIVER SOUTH

ALERT FOR MISSING AIRCRAFT K

15
28 V UT R AR

WS R AR

ZE V UT 052337 BT
WE HV HAVE CALLED BAN RIV BY TELEPHONE AND HAD THEM ALERT ALL FIELD SOUTH OF JAX K
V ZE R THAT IS RITE

CORRECT MY 052335 TO READ ALERT ALL FIELDS AND STATIONS SOUTH OF JACKSONVILLE K

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V UT R TKS AR

WS
V WS K
DID U GET CORRECTION TO MX LAST MSG K
ALERR ALL FIELD SOUTH OF JAX INT K E

YES ALL FIELDS AND STATIONS K

V WS R AR

V 3984 K R U RECEIVING US

EM T V M

UT V ZE NIP IS RELAYING TO TO "TO" NW ON CKT 7000 X WE
TRYING GET INFO ON 5 MISSING PLANES OFF E CIAST OF FLA VE K
ZE V UT IMI AA MISSING PLANES KK

V ZE PLANES OFF EAST COAST OF FLA VE K

ZE V TO 060206 BT

CAN U RSCZD MUODACOK

TO V ZE U R GARBLING BUT K K WILL TRY TO READ U K K

ZE V TO 060205 BT
ATC HAS JUST INFORMED BANANA RIVER THAT 5 UNIDENTIFIED

IRCRAFT WERE SEEN AT 2050 R 245 DEGREES 32 MILES
FROM BRUNSWICK GA. COURSE 150 X ATC IS ALERTING ALL
STATIONS KK

TO V ZE R TU X CAN YOU ASCR// ASCERTAIN IF THIS COULD
BE 5 MISSING PLANES OFF EAST FLA COAST KKK

V TO WE HAVE NEEEEEEN BEEN GETTING THESE REPORTS FROM JAX

AND BRUNSWICK X THEY ARE PLANES THAT ATC HAS NO RECORD OF

X BUT IF THE FUEL SUPPLY WAKE COR
ECT HOW COULD THE 5 MISSING

PLANUOS BE THEM KK

TO V ZE P 060212

POSITION 2859N 8025W EXPLOSION JUST OBSERVED X FOLLOWING IS WHL////
WHOLE MESSGAE X AT 1950 ROGER HUNDRED FOOT BURST OD/// OF FLAME
LASTING SEVERAL MINUTES SEEN BY CIRCLING SHIP INVESTIGATE KKKK

V TO R TU

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NARA 168

ZE V TOGTHER DID U GET THATINFO KKKK
V ZE INTERCEPT ON 500 KCS SS GAINES MILLS TO WMR KK

V TO
OGER AR

V ZE ADVISE ANY INFO U MAY BE ABLE TO FURNISH KK X URGENT KK

V TO AS AR

OO V EL BT
FOLLOWING MSG INTERCEPTED ON CKT

V A NMB/QUAB BT

FROM NMB X QPM AA STA ON 500 KCS AT 0208 QVM POSITION 2859. NORTH 3025

WEST APPROACHED AREA UNDER EMERG QVM PASSING THROUGH BIG

POOL OF OIL AT 0119 GMT 4 QVM STOPPED AND CIRCLED AREA USING QVM LIGHT
QVM LOOK OXXX LOOKING FOR SURVIVORS X NOT QVM FOUND BT MASTER SS GAINES

MILL UNQUOTE NO ACTION TAKEN BY NMB

KKK

V TO R TU AR

ØMVHTO BT NONEW INFOGERE F

E
R XXX LAST MSG IS LATE T EOVE WE
HAVE KKKK

V ZE R TU

UT V ZE WHAT IS UR GEOGRAPHICAL CALL SIGN PLS
V UT NHA 3 K
NOT UR RADIO CALL UR GEOGRAPHICAL CALL SIGN
V UT AS
ZE V UT PLS CLARIFY GEOGRAPHICAL K
V ZE BUST ØRI NW NIL

OO V EL PYPWGR BT

BUST

TO V EL 060224 BT

REF NMB TO QUAB X IF WE CAN CONTACT CARRIER AND EXCORTS X DO YOU WANT
US TO RELAY POSITION TO THEM BT K KK K

ELTVVE ANKI

V EL ROGER

ZE V UT GEOGRAPHICAL CALL SIGN FOR FT LAUDERDALE IS JATA K

V TO CAN YOU ADVISE US THE PAST KNOWN POSITION OF THE CARIER K

EL V TO WHAT

V EL R W AS WE ARE RELAYING AN OTHER MSG TO CARRIER AND KKK

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WS V ZE PLS ANS
V WS K

WS V ZE ARE YOU GETTING BRGNS OB KTOB USE ZE CIRCUIT K

V WX XXXXXX

V WS AFFIRMATIVE R AR
WX V ZE SUB MIT BRGNS URGETLY NEEDED ON OTHER ZE CIRT

BE V WS WE HAVE BRNGS AND R GV IVER ON DF CIRCUIT NW

V ZE AS MIN
V ZE OK NOW AR

TO V EL BT

P A NMB / QUAB BT

ROM NMB X QPM KAJK ON 500 KCS AT 0254 QUOTE WAX DE KAJK BT PASS TO
CONEASTSEAFRON CK 28
BT 55 MILES 74 DEGREES FROM QVM CAPE CANAVERAL
AT 0135Z QVM HOPPIC QVM REPORTED SIGHTING TWO PARACHUTES QVM FLARES
HAVE SEARCHED FIVE MILE QVM AM NOW RESUMING COURSE BT MASTER
0603////// PYPWPTX/////// 060205Z AR UNQUOTE NO ACOLON TAKEN BY NMB KKK

TO VEL

SSSSS

TO V EL PLS ROGER

TO V

V TO ROGER
TO V EL BT
P A NMB / QUAB BT

FROM NMB X QPM AA STA ON 2670 KCS AT 0242 QUOTE PROCEED TO 2859
8025 IF POSSIBLE AND INVESTIGATE EXPLOSION REPORTED BY SURFACE CRAFT
UNQUOTE NO ACTION TAKEN BY NMB BT KKKKKK

AV VTOREQUEST AD ICE WHO ISCONTROLLING SEACH OF 5 MISSING
TEFS KK

AV V TO PLEADEANSWER

V AV AS

TO VAV BT ADVISE WHETHER U HAVE MOVED UP AIR AND SURFACT CRAFT TO SCENE
OF REPORTED EXPLOSION KKK
V TO AFFIRMARIVE

EP V WS

NOM QRKG PLAPEION 2670 IKKS MAYBE U OR RATHER NMB HRDP

NOM SENDING THE AOBS INFO AXT PROCEEDING TO PSN OF EXPLSN

AV V TO 97991

3
-S V TO 070315 REQUEST ADVISE WHO IS CONTROTLING SEARCHOF 5
MISEING TBF. KKKKS

3
-S V TO PLEASEANSWEE

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TO V EL PLS R MY LAST TRANS

EL V TOMESAGE RECIEVED AND BOATS AND PLANES DISPATCHED XX

TO V EL 060320 BT

RECEIVED FOLLOSING FROM CARRIER X 062145R POSIT 2927 NORTH 7944 WEST
COURSE 120 SPEED 17 K K KK K K

EL V TO ROGER

TO V EL 060321 BT

WE HAVE TWO COASTAL SWEEPERS HEADED SOUTH ALONG COAST AND HAVE BEEN
INSTRUCTED TO BE ON LOOKOUT FOR SURVIVORS OR DEBRIS X THESE TWO
VESSELS ARE GUARDING 2716 VOICE X CARRIER MAY BE CONTACTED ON
2716 KCS CW X CALL SIGN OF SWEEPERS NDVM X CALL SIGN OF CARRIER
NKWC BT K K K

TO V AV BT REF UR REQUEST X MIAMI HAS CONTROL KK
AV V TO ROGER
TO V EL INT R MY LAST TRANS

EL VTO OGER YOUR LAST MESSAGE

IS TO ON

EL V TO ROGER AR

TO V ZE PLS GIVE GA

"3 V TO

ZE V TO EO U HAVE A MESGFOR ME K

YES
SS THOMAS PAYNE 06225
TO BANANA RIVER

FROM KAJK

QUOTE 55 MILES 74 DEGREES FROM CAPE CANAVERAL X AT 0135Z WATCH OFFICER
ON LOOKOUT REPORTED SIGHTING 2 PARACHUTS FLARES HAVE SEARCHED
5 MILE AREA AND AM NOWR RESUMING COURSE
MASTER 06/0225

UNQUOTE

QUESTION-DID ANY OF YOUR XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX PLANES DROP PARACHUTE
FLARES

TO KAJK
FROM

AP F
OM TO FOLLOWING DISPATCHSENT TOTH
HE BANANA RIVER AIRCRAFT

RO
ACTION AND TO COMDT SEVENTHNAVAL DISTRICT FOR INFORMATIONQUOTE
AIR SEARESCUE IEEEEEEEEEE OFFICE
ELEVENTH NAVAL DISTRICTIS CINTROLLING
ALL
K

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V ZE TO T O DID U REC MSG IF SO ROGER,

V TONEGATIVE XX PLS RESEND KKK

OK

S S THOMAS PAYNE 060225
TO BANANA RIVER
FROM KAJK

QUOTE Z55 MILES 74 DEGREES FROM XXXXX CAPE CANAVERAL X AT 0135Z WATCH OFFICE ON LOOKOUT REPORTED SIGHTING 2 PARACHUT FLAR
Y
IC E SEARCHEN 5 MILE AREA AND AM NOW RESUMING COURSE
MASTER 06/0225
UNQUOTEQUESTION- DID ANY OF YOUR KK PLANES DROP PARACHUTE FLARES

V TO WILL CHECK AS

TA V RP QJC IMI QJC AR

V TA R AR

ZE V RP CAN I GO AHEAD TO TA INT KKK
V ZE ROGER GA
TA V RP R U RADY KKK
V TA QPZ K
TA V RP AA EXPLOSION BT EXPLOSION LAT 28 DASH 59
LONGWTEEERRE IMI LONGITUDE 80 DASH 20 X THIS POSITION
W
V TA SXXX X STILL WVN UPPER BRACKED X TYPE IT SLOW
XXXX AONXXX AND
KZ
DVV RP I WILL SPEEL THEM OUT
ALL AFTER EXPLOSION BT EXPLOSION LAT TWENTYEIGHT DASH FIFTYNINE
LONGITUDE EIGHTY DASH TWENTY X THIS POSITION AT ONE NINE FIVE ZERO
ROGER COINCIDES WITH ESTABLISHED POSITION OF PETER BAKER MIKE NUMBER
FOUR NINE AND WE ARE UNABLE TO COMMUNICATE WITH PETER BAKER MIKE FOUR NIN
NINE X S S GAINES MILLS AND RESCUE BOAT FROM NEW SMYRNA ARE
SEARCHING AREA BT END OF MSGE INT RUVGER KKK
V TA R AR TU
UR WELCOME

AV V TO BT REMZ 060422 XX DID YOU RECEIVE IT OK INT KK
ASS WAITV AV R
V TO R AR
TO V AV WAX THAT THE MSG THAT WAS INFO TO CWAAT AND TO COMDS 7TH ND

IMI
AV V TO AS SECOND

XX V RP O HEH H

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VKKK 3
TA V RP HEADING OF MSGE 060422 IS AS FOLLOWS
TO COMDS 7 TH NAVAL DISTRICT
INFO CNATT
BTA I FORGOT TO GIVE IT TO U BEFORE V AR
INT R
TA V RP INT R

ZE V RV FYPYFUZ BT
WILL HAVE ONE C-47 OFF BY DAYLIGHT X DO YOU WANT MORE AIR CRAFT
FOR SEARCH INT KKK
V ZE RAFNGL AS

AS
V TO 06042 BT

INFO CNAAT TO COMDS 7TH NAVAL DISTRICT

XXXXX XXXXXR BAKER MIKEE AIRCRAFT SENT ON AIR EEA
SION IN CONNECTION FIVE MISSING TARE BAKER FOX AIRCRAFT SS
GAINES MILLS REPORTS SEEING EXPLOSION LAT 28 DAST 59
LONGITUDE 80 EA
WITH ESTABLISHED POSITION OF PETER BAKER MIQE NUMBER FOURNINE
AND WE ARE UBEEEEEKEEEK UNABLE TO COMMUNICATE WITH PETER BAKER MIKE
FOUR NINE X S S GAINES MITIS AND RESCUE BOAT FHOM NEW SMYRNA
ARE SEARCHING AREA KKKK

V EL R AR
MIQS R AR
V
V UT R AR
V FA R AR

V TO LINE AFTER FOUR NINE X AND WE AREUNABLE TO COMM-
UNICATE WITH PETER BAKER MIKE FORTY NINE X SS GAINES MILLS
AND
ESCUE BOAT FROM NEW SMYRNA ARE SEARCHING AREA KKK

V UT R AR

V RP ROGER ON BOTH AR
V QS R UR CORCEKTION
V ZE R AR

V ELR AR

ZW V TA QTC INT K

ZE V UT FYEEE 060437 BT
HAVE ALL DOZBOES BEEN SECURED FOR THE SEACHEEEE SEARCH OF THE 5
TEF FOR TONIHEEEE TONIGHT K
VA AZE TO UT AS

IMI V TA DTG GARBLED

AV TA V TO BT
DID YOU RECEIVE MY SERO EIX ZE
O FOUR TWO TWO INTKK
V AV MIN

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NARA 173

90 V TA
IMI AA LONGITUDE LINE 4
K
TAV TO R AR

3
TA V TO 860510 BT
TO WHICH MESSAGE ARE U REFERRING KKK
3
TO V TA X MEG REFERING TO IS UR 860422 K
TA V TO AS

9

090 V ZE 060517 BT
DE KUIJ AT 0430 GCT SIGHTED FLARE INSHORE SEARCHING VICINITY APPROX POSN
26.50 NORTH 79.40 WEST X WAX HANDLING THIS CASE BUT WAX WAS QRL WHEN
THIS BDCAST AR KKK
V EL PLS REAPEAT THE FIRST TWO WORDS I RECD THEM AS DE KUIJ RPT DE
KUIL KKKK
AS FROM SS JOHN E WARD

AS 090 HAVE TWO
MSGS

090 V ZE 060520 BT
RECD FROM KDLB/SS WASHINNGTON/ AT 0511 GMT ON 500 KCS QUOTE APPARENT
AERIAL WHITE FLARE BEARING 100 TURE FROM POSITION 2930 NORTH 7940 WEST
060430
GMT BT MASTER UNQUOTE AR KKK

R FOR 2 MSGS
V EL PLS REPEAT FIRST TWO WDS OF FIRST MSG I REC THEM AS DE KUIJ IS
THAT CORRECT INT
DE KUIJ MEANS FROM SS JOHN E WARD
OK TU
VEL R 060517 AND 060520
3 ARAR
V TA IMI 860520 WA APPARENT K

AERIAL WA 100 TRUE

ZE V TO BT WAS THAT MSG ALSO MEANTFOR US INT KK
FOR EVERYBODY ON CKT

ZE V TO ROGER FOR BOTH UR MESSAGES AR
OA R 060617 MMM AND 060520 AR
V RP ROGER ON QEEE BOTH OF UR MSGES AR
ZE V UT ROGER ON BOTH ABOVE MESG AR

TA V TO 06 EEE 069526 BT
REMY 060422 T
V TA
V TA IMI K

TA V TO 060526 BT
ROPY 060422 XXX IMI WA LONGITUDE TTIS POKIT

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V TA IMI QVP K
V TA IMI MMMM U ARE TRNSMITTING UN UPPER CASW K
TA V RP DO U WANT ME TO IMI THE MSGE INT
RV V TA PZZZZ QPZ K
TA V RP SAASAS
TA V RP MSGE 060422 IS AS FOLLOWS BT
THREE PETER BAKER MIKES AIRCRAFT SENT ON AIR SEA RESCUE MISSION
IN CONNECTION FIVE MISSING TARE BAKKKLEEEE BAKER FOX AIRCRAFT S S
GAINES MILLS REPREKIMI PEPORTS SEEING EXPLOSION LAT 28 DASH 59
LONGIRUDE 80 DASH 20 X THIS POSITION AT 1950 ROGER COINCIDES
WITH ESTABLISHED
V TA
V TA U ARE TRANSIMMITTING UN U PER CASW K
ZZ T TA V RP R SHALL I TRY AGAIN INT KKK
V TA IMI AA EXPLOSION K
V RP ROGER BT EXPLOSION LAT28 DASH 59
LONGITUDE 80 DASH 20 X THIS POSITION AT OTP ROGER COINCIDES
WITH ESTABLISHED PT
V
XV TA X SIME THING IT MAY BE OUR MACHINE BOUT XXXX BOUT XXX
BUT WHEN U CHANGE VXX FROM LETTERS TO NUMBERS WILL U HIT
THE KEY TW OR THREE TIMES K
V V RP SHO NUFFF
T
TO V ZE 060535 BT
REQUEST TAKE OFF TIMES OF ALL AIRCRAFT PARTICIPATING IN SEARCH FOR
MISSING TBM PLANES X NO TIMES HERE ON MAYPORT BANANA RIVER DAYTIEEEEEEEEE
DAYTONA AND VERO BEACH PLANES KKK
ZE V TO WILCO XXX GET RLTO GIVE THE INFO ON THEIR EUMBO KK
TO V ZE R AR

TO V ZE ANSWER ON TWPL 7000 URGENT K K

TO V ZE K K K K K

UT V ZE CAN U WORK TO PSE K THIS IS URGENT TRY TO GET TO "TO"

TO V UT DO U READ ME URGENT K
ZE V UT WE WILL TRY ON EEEE BY RADIO K
ZE V UT BT BELIEVE THAT TO IS ON UR TELETYPE NOW KK

V ZE R AR

RP V TA X GARBLED X WILL U RERUN K
TA V RP MSGE WAS ADDRESSED TO ZE ZEBRA EASY AR
EEEEEEEEE DID U RECEIVE MSGE 0604222 HEADING KKK
V TA IMI U ARE IN U PER BACKXX BRACKET K
TA V RP DID U RECEIVE HEADING OF MSGE I RELAYED TO U
EARLIER INT KKK
V TA DO U MENXX MEAN 060422 K

V RP QPZ

V AS 2
V

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RP V TA WILL U REPAT XX REAZXX REPEAT 060422 AB INFO CNAAT K

TA V RV QPZ BT
TO COMDS SEVENTH NAVAL DISTRICT
INFO CNAAT BT DID U R KKK
V TA R 06042W AR X DID U MUST SEND US ONE MORE A FEW MINUTE
AGO K
TA V RP QQZ IMI QQZ AR
V TA R AR TU
UR WLCOME
IKT

R RP V ZE 060629 BT
XXXXXXXX ONE PLANE WILL BE SUFFICIENT AT PRESENT X REQUEST
HE SEARCH AREA BOUNDED BY COAST EAST ALONG 27 DEGREES NORTH AND EASTWARD
ALONG 28 DEGREES NORTH TO COAST X VERO BEACH PLANES BE SEARCHING
AREA ALSO KK2a

ZE V RP R AR
ZEIV WS BT WE WERA RUNNING OPEN HERE FOR ABOUT ZEN MINS IS EVERXTHING
OK NO KNTZ4
WS V ZE ALSO RUNNING OPEN HERE DONT THINK ANYTHING WAS SENT TO U
BE V WS R TU

5
V MIN PLSUCO IS ME S IS MC DILL ON HERE NOS
HELLO MC DILL FIELD

HELLO MC DGL MC DILL
HELLO MC DILL SSSSSSSSSSSSSSSSSSSSSSS HELLO MC DILL

MAC DILL FLD OVER
WELL ARE YOU MCDILL OR NOT
YES OK FINE WE BEEN WORKING ON THIS CIRCUIT AND
11 WANTED TO T O KNOW IF U WERE STILL OK ON HERE

OK IT IS ALL YOURS AND CIRCIT CIRCUIT E WILL BE OK
THANK YOUKK
ZE AV V TO 860644 BT
REFMSG FROM ZE 060535 XX VERP DUMDO OFF AI1856 ON AT 0105 ROGERX
DAYTON A DUMBO OFF AT 1921 ON AT 2400 ROGER XX TRAINING 32 OFFFOKO
1982 ROGER XX TRAINING 60 OY4 AT 2135 ROGER XX TRAINING 49 OFF AT OWU RZ
32 AND 60 ARE STIBL OUT XX 49 IS MISKING KKK
TO V TA KIM MSG K

TA V TO BT LAST MSG WAS FOR ZE AND AV XX DO WANT THE INFO ALSO INTKK
V TA AFF KK
T
IMI FROM TO

ZE AV TA V TO 060644 BT
REFEREEE REFE
MSG FROM ZE 060535 XX VERO DUMBO
FIVE SIX OE AT ZERO ONE ZEROFIVEXX EAYTONA DUMBOOFF AT ONE NINE
TWO ONE ON ATTWO FOURZERO ZEROXX TRANING THREE TWO OFF AT ONE NINE
ZERO TWO XX TRANING FOUR NINE OFF AT ONE NINE TWO SEVEN XX TRANING
SUKEE SIX ZERO OFF AT TWO ONE TTREE FIVE XX TWEEEE TH
EE TWO AND
SIX ZERP ASEEE ARE STILL OUT XX FOUR NINE IS MISSING KKK
V TA R AR
ZE AND AV V TO BT PLS ANSWER MY LAST MSG KK
XXXXXXX V ZE AV PART OF IT GARBLED HERE GOT MOST OF IT BUT AM AFRAID
YOU WILL HAVE TO SEND OVER SORI LKKK
VTOROGER XX ARE U ZE OR AV KK

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AM ZE AND AV BOTH

ZE AV FROM TO 060644 BT

REFR MSG FROMZE 0605371 XXX VERO DUMBO OFF AT 1856 R ONAT 8105 R
DATEE DAYTONA DUMBO OFF AT 193
1902 R XX TRAINING 1927 R T
49 OFFAT 2135 RXX 32 AND 60 A

ETILL OUTXX 49 IS MISSING KKKK
TO V AV ZE R AR

P

T E VTO 050730 BT
EQUEST YOU ALERTTFNET ON
385 KLCS FOR TNG 9 8-44 SION1883 T
IS ABOVE MSG FOR ZE IMI
V TO AFFIRMATIVE X REQEST YOU AEEEEEALERT NETON 385248 FOR TRNG
4982 CALL SIGN IS 1883 T KKKKKKK

V ZE YOU ARE GARBLED HERE
V

TO V ZE PLS IMI UR 050730 IMI PLS
ZE V TO BT IMI X
EQUEST YOU ALET TF NET ON 4385248 FOR KMRNG
9 CALL SIG
TO V ZE IMI AA 438 KCS IMI KKK
ZEV TO AA 438528 IMI FOR TRAINING 49 CALL SIGN CW IS1883 TAREKK
TO V ZE R AR

S

7WS V ZE OTHER UNITS ARE ANSWERING US EITHER
NO OTHER UNITS
R TU
3
860135 ZE V UT BT

DO U HAVE ANTEKEEEE ANY CONTROL OVER NLFX RADIO STZTION NOW XMITTIN
ON 30000 KCS TO P748 INT K
R AFFIRMATIVE
R AS

PLS ADVISE THEM TO STATEEEE SA STAY OF THE AIR AS MUCH AS
POSSIBLE ON THIS FREQ AS THEY ARE JAMMING THE CIRCUIT FOR DUMBO
PLANES OPERATING NORTH OF HERE K

V ZE R AR

V ZE TO UT HAVE ANS FOR U

V UT GA
V ZE TO UT NEGATIVE
V UT R TKS AR

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V ZE TO TO CAN I MAE MAKE CORRECTION ON OSG I SENT U

V TO GA
OK IT SHOULD READ ILL REP WHOLE MSG

REQUEST SEARCH AT DAYLIGHT BY DAYTONA DUMBO FROM 79-00 WEST TO BEACH BETWEEN 28-00 AND 29-00 NORTH X BANANA RIVER PLANES TO SEARCH AREA FROM 77-00 TO 79-00 WEST AND 27-00 TO 29-00 NORTH X VERO BEACM DUMBO FROM 79-00 TO BEACH AND 27-00 TO 28-00 NORTH X
V TO ROGER A

EL V TO 060748 BT

REQUEST THAT YOU TRY TO CONTACT TRAINING60 FOT US XX TEIS WORKING 3000 KCS VOICE KKK
3
TO V EL IMI TRAINING TO HE
EL V TO BT IMI XX TRAINING 60 SIX ZERP BEEEE ZERO FOR US X HE IS WORKING 3000 KCS VOICE KK
DO U USE THAT CALL TRAINING 60
EL V TOQPZ KK
TO V EL R 060748

ZE V TO 06083333 060757 BT
REQUEST THAT YOU HAVETHENETT
Y TO RAISE TRAINING 60 CALL 1884 EUGAR XX
V ZE CAN RV PLS RELAY TO MSG TO US THEY ARE GARBLED HERE UNABLE TO READ KKK

// V TPBTREPE
LASTMSG TO ZE XXX PLS RELA Y
XX ALSOAED TO TRY
TO
CONTACT TRAINING60 ON 385 KCS CW ALSO KKK

11
223

TO V ZE 060801 BT

REP TRAINING PLANE 49 X WHEN WAS HE LAST HEARD FROM X WHAT POSITION X WHEN WAS HE SUPPOSED TO BE ON AIR X WHEN DO YOU WANT STATIONS TO LISTEN FOR HIM KKKK
3
ZE V TO860802 BT
TRAINING 9 LAST HEARD FROM WHEN HE SENT HIS OUT REPORTAT 1927 ROGERXX POSITION WOULD BE HIS TAKE OFF FROMHE R XX PLS DIS REGARD ALE T ON /0 XX WEHAVE JUST CONTACTED HIM XX REQ STATIONS TO LISTEN FOR 49 AS SOONAS POSSIBLE KKK
V ZE WILL HE BE UP IMMEDIATELY K K
ZE V TO ROGE TU AR

EL UP V ZE 060823 BT
REQUEST INFO IN REGARD TO USING OF YOUR AVR S IN SEARCH PLAN FOR MISSING TBMS X XXXXXXX IMMEDATE REPLY REQUESTED KKK
XXXX XLUX 06082ARAR
Z

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ZEBL UT ONE MIN ON YOUR LAST MESG X IM HAVING THE OD TO CHECK UP NOW AR K
V ZE R AR

TO V ZE WHAT IS VOICE CALL OF 1883T PLEASE K K

ZE V TO DID YOU WANT THE OW OR VOICE CATLLLL INT KKKKK
TO V ZE WE WANT VOICE CALL IN CASE HE SHUD GO TO 500 KCS KKK

V TO HIS VOICECALL TRAININKV 49 KKKKV

TO V ZE R X TUVM AR

E
TO V EL 060832 BT
MAYPORT DUMBO WILL BE ON SEARCH TOMORROW X AXXXXX DUE TO DISTANCE
AVRS WILL NOT BE AVAILABLE TOMORROW BT K

EL V TO R TU AR
ZE V EL THIS TO U ALSO
ZE V EL INT R
EL V ZE R AR

TO V ZE DO U HAVE FURTHER INFO ON 1883T X DF NET IS ALERTED BUT NO ONE
HEARS HIM X IS HE SUPPOSED TO SEND IN A POSITION REPORT AT ANY SPECIAL
TIME OR WHAT KKK

ZEV TO BT TRAINING 49 ISTHE LOST PB M X WE ARE TAKING STAB ATTIM
SENDING OR T YING TOZENE KKKKKK
TO V ZE IMI AA TAKING X GARBLED KKKK
ZE V TO BT IMI AA TAKING X TAKING A STAB ATHIM SENDING OR TRYING
TOGET TRU TO A STATION KKKKK
V ZE R X TU AR

GA
TO V ZE DISREGARD
TO V ZE REFER MY 060823 TO UT AND EL REQUEST ANY INFO YOU MAY HAVE ALSO
KK

ZD
ZE V UT BT I AM SET UP ON 4385 KCS LISTEBING IN FOR ANYTHING THAT M
MAY COME VER AH KKK
2
KE V TO BT EL REPO TS THAT MAYPORT DUMBO WILL BE ON SEARCH THIS MORN
ING X DUE TO DKBETANCEAVR S WILL NOT BE ABEEJM AVAILABTE KKKBB/

TTO V ZE WILL YOU HAVE ANY BOATS AVAILABLE IN THE MORNING TO AID IN
SEARCH IF NECESSARY KKK
ZE V TO AS

ZE V UT 060845 BT
OUR AVRS ARE AVAILABLE HOWEVER IF 5 TBMS ARE IN SUSPECTED AREA AROUND
29 DEGREQOS 00 NORTH 79 DEGREES 00 WEST IT WOULD BE MUVH MORE PRAC-
TICAL TO USE THE AVAILAVEEB AVAILABLE BOATS NOTEE NORTH OF
HERE X IT WILL TAKE MORE THAN 12 HOURS FOR US TO GET BOATS TO THAT
AREA AR KKKK

ZE V TO BT HOW MANYBOATS EO YOU REQUIRE KKKK
TO V ZE AS

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TO V ZE PLS CONFIRM CALL SINE OF PLANE TO BE LISTENED FOR X STATIONS
HEAR 1883A R OW X WHAT IS CALL PLEASE K K K
ZE V TO BT CALL FOR TRAINING 49 IS 1883 TAREKK
TO V ZE ROGER TU AR
TO V ZE 060813 BT
REF TRAINING PLANE 60 X WHERE ISHE FROM X POSITION LAST HEARD
FROM X WHEN HX SHOULD STATIONS LISTEN FOR HIS X TIME OF HIS
TRANSMISSIONX X PLEASE BE MORE CAREFUL IN YOUR TRANSMISSIONKTX
MUCH OF IT UNREADABLE KKK

ZE V TO 060816 BT
REF TRAINING 60 XX PLS DISREGARDALERT ONHIMXX WE CONTACTED HIM ON
3000 KCS AT 9395 ROGER XX HIS POSN AT THAT TIME WAS 30 MILES
NORTHEAST OF CAPE CANAVERAL XX PLE SECURETHE ALERT ON THIS PLANE KK

ZE V TO BT C RRECTION ON THE TIME IN MY LAST MSGXXSTOULD REAE 0305 R KK
TO V ZE R AR

TO V ZE PLEASE REPEAT LAST TIME TRINING PLANE 49 WAS HRDUMF HRD
FROM X KKKK

ZE V TO AS

ZE V TO BT LAST WORE FROM 492- HIS OUT REPORTAT 1804 R KKKK

O TO V ZE IS THA HIS DEPAARTURE TIME KKK
BE VTO THAT WAS IMMIDIATLY AFTER TAKE OFFFKKKK
TO V ZE R AR
TO V ZE 060854 BT
WHAT TYPE OF BOATS ARE AVAILABLE X ARE THEY 104 FOOTERS OR 83 FOOTER
X ADVISE NUMBER OF EACH KKK
BE V TO AM TRYING TO CHECK FOR YOU WILL LET YOU KNOW
KXK

TO V ZE RAPMY
ZE V UT DID YOU REC MY ABOVE MESG KKKK

BT V ZE AFFIRMATIVE WILL ADVISE IF ANY INSTRUCTIONS AR

TO V ZE REFERENCE 1883T CASE X HOW MUCH FUEL DID HE HAVE AND HOW
LONG CUD HE STAY UP PLEASE KKK

ZE V TO BT TE AT LEASTTENHOURS FUEL ABOARD X WE WOULE SUGGEST YOU
LET EL BUST THIS KKKKKKK

TO V ZE WHAT DO U MEAN BUST THIS X DO U MEAN CANCEL THE ALERT KKKKK
ZE V TO AS WE ARE CHECKING FURTHER NOW KKK

TO V ZE IS THAT RITE THAT PLANE HAS FUEL FOR 10 HOURS KKK
ZE V TO THAT WAS GIVEN AS APPROXAMOUNT WILL GIKE YOU CORECT
IN A MINUTE X TRNG 49 HAD TWELVE HRS OF FUEL ABOARD KKKK
UMTO V ZE BELIEVE IT IS USELESS THEN FOR DF STATIONS TO LISTEN
FOR 49 UNLESS HE HAS A GIBSON GIRL OR SOMETHING X THE REASON IM SO
CONCERNED IS THAT ALL OF GULF AND EASTERN SEA FRONTIER STATIONS ARE
ALERTED ON THIS CASE AND WOULDACMIK LIKE ALL INQBO INFO
AVAILABLE X DO U ADVISE KEEPING ALERT IN EFFECT KKKK

ZE V TO AS PLSE

TO V EL 060904 BT AX

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" EXHIBIT 9 "

HEADQUARTERS GULF SEA FRONTIER
DUPONT BUILDING
MIAMI, FLORIDA

NG2(16)
S94
(WSA:HHJB:JHH:js)

RESTRICTED

23 December 1944

From: Commander, Gulf Sea Frontier.
To: Distribution List.

Subj: Gulf Sea Frontier Air/Sea Rescue Plan No. 1-45, dated 1 January 1945.

Ref: (a) CNO Serial 243434 of 31 Aug. 1944.

1. Enclosure 1 is forwarded for compliance by Gulf Sea Frontier Forces and for information of other interested parties. Subject plan is effective 0400 Z, 1 January 1945.

2. This plan has been prepared with the aim of making rescue operations as nearly automatic as possible. The principal obstacles to efficient rescue operations are usually a lack of correct information and a lack of coordinated effort. It is hoped to overcome these by filtering all pertinent information through the Joint Operations Centers at Miami and New Orleans. The controllers at these centers will then be in a position to effect the necessary coordination and will be charged with disseminating pertinent information to responsible commands and initiating such action as is necessary.

/s/ W. S. ANDERSON

Encl.
1. Subject Plan.

AUTHENTICATED:

J. H. STIBBS
Flag Secretary

CERTIFIED TO BE A TRUE COPY.
Lt. Cdr. USN

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DISTRIBUTION LIST - (SPECIAL FOR GULF SEA FRONTIER AIR/SEA RESCUE PLAN NO. 1-45, DATED 1 JANUARY 1945)

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Com8
Com10
Com15
CG First Air Foce, Mitchell Field, L.I.
CG Third Air Force, McDill Field, Tampa
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CG Caribbean Division, ATC (2)
CG Southeastern Sector, Raleigh, N. C.
Comdr. Task Unit 03.1.1
Comdr. T.U. 03.1.2
Comdr. T.U. 03.1.3
Comdr. T.U. 03.1.4
Comdr. T.U. 03.1.5
Comdr. T.U. 03.1.6
Comdr. T.U. 03.1.7
Comdr. T.U. 03.1.8
Liaison Officer, Southeastern Sector, EDC
ComFairWing 12 (3)
ComFairShip Wing 2 (3)
CO, Fleet Sonar School
CO, Naval Training Center
CO, Convoy Control Center
Comdr. NOB Key West (2)
Comdt. NAS Pensacola (2)
Comdr, NAS Corpus Christi (2)
CO, NAS Key West (2)
CO, NAS Miami (2)
CO, NAS Ft. Lauderdale (2)

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C.O. NAS Melbourne (2)
C.O. NAS Banana River (2)
C.O. NAS Vero Beach (2)
C.O. NAS Sanford (2)
C.O. NAS Deland (2)
C.O. NAS Lake City (2)
C.O. NAS Daytona Beach (2)
C.O. NAS Richmond (2)
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C.O. NAAS Boca Chica (2)
C.O. CGAB St. Petersburg (2)
C.O. CGAB Miami (2)
C.O. CGAB Biloxi (2)
C.O. NATS VR-6, Dinner Key (2)
C.O. NATS VR-7, Miami
C.O. USS CHRISTIANA
C.O. YHB-13
C.O. YHB-16
U.S. Naval Liaison Officer, Nassau
U.S. Naval Attache, Havana
Chief Naval Mission, Cuba
DCGO, 7ND
DCGO, 8ND
C.O. Gulf Sector, SDC
ComNavAirBases, 7ND
ComNavAirBases, 8ND
C.O. Homestead, Fla. AAF
C.O. Page Field, Ft. Myers, Fla. AAF
C.O. Buckingham AAF, Ft. Myers, Fla.
C.O. Venice, Fla. AAF
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C.O. Bronson NAAS, Pensacola, Fla.
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C.O. Chevalier NAS, Pensacola, Fla.

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C.O. NAAS Corry, Pensacola, Fla.
C,O. De Ridder, La., AAB
C.O. NAAS Ellyson, Pensacola, Fla.
C.O. Esler AAF, Alexandria, La.
C.O. Gulfport, Miss., AAF
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HEADQUARTERS GULF SEA FRONTIER
MIAMI, FLORIDA
1 JANUARY 1945

GULF SEA FRONTIER
AIR/SEA RESCUE PLAN 1-45

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PART I

GENERAL

1-1. DEFINITION. Air/Sea Rescue is a term which includes the broad field of assistance and distress operations, distress communication procedures and emergency flight control, survival methods and equipment, and the indoctrination of personnel in these matters.

1-2. MISSION. The mission of the Gulf Sea Frontier Air/Sea Rescue Service shall be to render emergency assistance to aircraft and surface vessels in distress and to rescue the survivors thereof.

1-3. JURISDICTION. The Gulf Sea Frontier Air/Sea Rescue Service is concerned primarily with the phases of rescue on and over the sea and in costal areas. However, this does not preclude the use of Frontier facilities for land rescue work when the need for such is indicated.

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PART II

ORGANIZATION

2-1. The Gulf Sea Frontier Air/Sea Rescue Service shall be based upon the organization of:

(a) The Gulf Sea Frontier.

(b) The Naval Districts within the Frontier.

(c) The Rescue Task Units within the Naval Districts.

(d) The stations and organizations within the Naval Districts.

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PART III

GEOGRAPHICAL DIVISION

3-1. FRONTIER. The limits of the Gulf Sea Frontier Are as set forth in the Gulf Sea Frontier Organization Manual.

3-2. NAVAL DISTRICTS. The limits of the Seventh and Eighth Naval Districts are as set forth in U.S. Navy Regulations, 1920.

3-3. 7ND WATERS. For purposes of Air/Sea Rescue, the waters of the Seventh Naval District shall be those Frontier waters east of a line joining the following points:

(a) The mouth of the Apalachicola River.
(b) Latitude 25-20 N., Longitude 86-00 W.
(c) Latitude 25-20 N., Longitude 88-15 W.
(d) Latitude 21-10 N., Longitude 90-00 W.

3-4. 8ND WATERS. For purposes of Air/Sea Rescue, the waters of the Eighth Naval District shall be those Frontier waters west of the 7ND waters.

3-5. SECTOR DIVISION. The sector division as outlined below is to be used as a general guide in defining the operating areas of Rescue Task Units. It is not intended to impose any restrictions upon responsible commanders in their use of any available rescue facilities.

3-6. NAOTC SECTOR. The NAOTC Sector shall be that area off the east coast of Florida bounded on the north and east by the Gulf Sea Frontier boundary and on the south by latitude 25-50 N.

3-7. MIAMI SECTOR. The Miami Sector shall comprise those waters of the 7ND bounded on the north as follows:

(a) Off the east coast of Florida by the NAOTC Sector.
(b) Off the west coast of Florida by latitude 25-20 N.

3-8. ST. PETERSBURG SECTOR. The St. Petersburg Sector shall comprise those waters of the 7ND bounded on the south by the Miami Sector and on the north and east by the coast of Florida.

3-9. PENSACOLA SECTOR. The Pensacola Sector shall comprise those 8ND waters east of longitude 88-15 W.

3-10. NEW ORLEANS SECTOR. The New Orleans Sector shall comprise those 8ND waters bounded on the east by the Pensacola and Miami Sectors and on the west by a line joining the following points:

(a) Latitude 21-10 N., longitude 90-00 W.
(b) Latitude 28-51 N., longitude 95-28 W.

3-11. CORPUS CHRISTI SECTOR. The Corpus Christi Sector shall comprise those 8ND waters west of the New Orleans Sector.

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PART IV

DUTIES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

4-1. FRONTIER COMMANDER. The Commander, Gulf Sea Frontier, shall:

(a) Establish, maintain, and operate an adequate and efficient Air/Sea Rescue Service within the area under his jurisdiction, utilizing to the maximum existing Gulf Sea Frontier Facilities.

(b) In consultation with the Commandant, U. S. Coast Guard, formulate policy, prepare plans, and effect coordination and standardization of all matters pertaining to Air/Sea Rescue.

(c) Maintain liaison with adjacent Sea Frontier Commanders, appropriate fleet and area commanders, and other civil and government agencies as necessary.

(d) Provide operations centers appropriate to the requirements of the Air/Sea Rescue Service.

4-2. DISTRICT COMMANDANT. The Commandants of the Seventh and Eighth Naval Districts, under Commander, Gulf Sea Frontier, shall be responsible for the Air/Sea Rescue Service within their respective Naval Districts. They shall:

(a) Establish a Rescue Task Unit in each sector of their respective Naval Districts.

(b) Establish and maintain positive and rapid communication with all Air/Sea Rescue Service facilities within their Naval Districts.

(c) Receive, evaluate, and promptly disseminate all distress information and initiate rescue action when indicated.

(d) Analyze the general handling of each distress incident and publish the results thereof.

(e) Be cognizant of the operating status of all radio and radar navigational aids within their Naval Districts.

(f) Keep a status board indicating primary rescue facilities and current weather conditions.

(g) Promptly provide emergency assistance in the form of D/F fixes, bearings, advice on safe altitudes to fly, weather conditions, and any other possible assistance when so required.

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(h) Assume emergency flight control of any aircraft when necessary, identify such aircraft if possible, and inform the responsible aircraft unit commander of the situation.

(i) Maintain liaison with all operating units within the Naval District to insure thorough indoctrination of personnel in the use of safety equipment and in Air/Sea Rescue Service procedures.

4-3. RESCUE TASK UNIT COMMANDER. The Rescue Task Unit Commander, Under the District Commandant, shall:

(a) Maintain his planes, boats, and equipment in a state of constant readiness and high operational efficiency.

(b) Initiate immediate rescue action with equipment available when informed of any crash or casualty and notify the District Commandant of the action taken.

(c) Maintain a program of training which will assure his personnel of being highly efficient in all phases of search and rescue operations.

(d) Cooperate with others in the interest of achieving the utmost efficiency in rescue operations.

(e) Make constant studies of communication and operational procedures and make appropriate recommendations to the District Commandant.

4-4. OTHER COMMANDS. Local commands charged with the operation of surface craft or aircraft shall have the following duties and responsibilities within the Air/Sea Rescue Service:

(a) To dispatch, when indicated or when directed, local rescue facilities to the assistance of aircraft or surface vessels and to notify the District Commandant immediately of the situation and of the action taken.

(b) To maintain liaison with the District Commandant in Air/Sea Rescue Service matters and to formulate their operations and communications procedures so that they shall be consistent with the Frontier Air/Sea Rescue Plan.

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(c) To standardize the indoctrination and training of all air crews under their command in emergency drills, use of emergency equipment, and in distress procedures.

(d) To initiate request for assistance from the District Commandant at the first indication that an aircraft under their command is in distress or is overdue.

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PART V

SERVICES AND FACILITIES

5-1. SERVICES. Services available to the Gulf Sea Frontier Air/Sea Rescue Service are as follows:

(a) Navy and Coast Guard communication networks.

(b) Coast Guard Safety & Distress Organization.

(c) Direction Finder nets.

(d) Radar stations.

(e) Plotting centers, surface and air.

(f) Weather services.

(g) Navigational aids, air and surface.

(h) Army and CAA services as may be made available by agreement.

5-2. PRIMARY FACILITIES. Primary facilities are established, maintained, and operated, for the primary purpose of engaging in rescue operations. They are as follows:

(a) Rescue Task Units. These are basic elements of the Air/Sea Rescue Service. They consist of specially equipped air and surface craft manned by crews trained in rescue operations. These task units shall be maintained and operated primarily by the Coast Guard.

(b) Local crash and rescue facilities.

(c) Lifesaving stations.

(d) Other facilities such as blimps, helicopters, other air and surface craft designated primarily for rescue purposes but not organized into task units.

5-3. SECONDARY FACILITIES. Secondary facilities are those whose mission includes, but not as primary duty, Air/Sea Rescue, and who are integrated into the Air/Sea Rescue organization as regards indoctrination, equipment, and readiness to perform Air/Sea Rescue duties when so directed. These facilities will include Blimps, patrol boats, patrol aircraft, and any Army rescue facilities which may be available.

5-4. MISCELLANEOUS FACILITIES. Miscellaneous facilities include merchant vessels, fleet units, civil aircraft, yachts, and fishing vessels.

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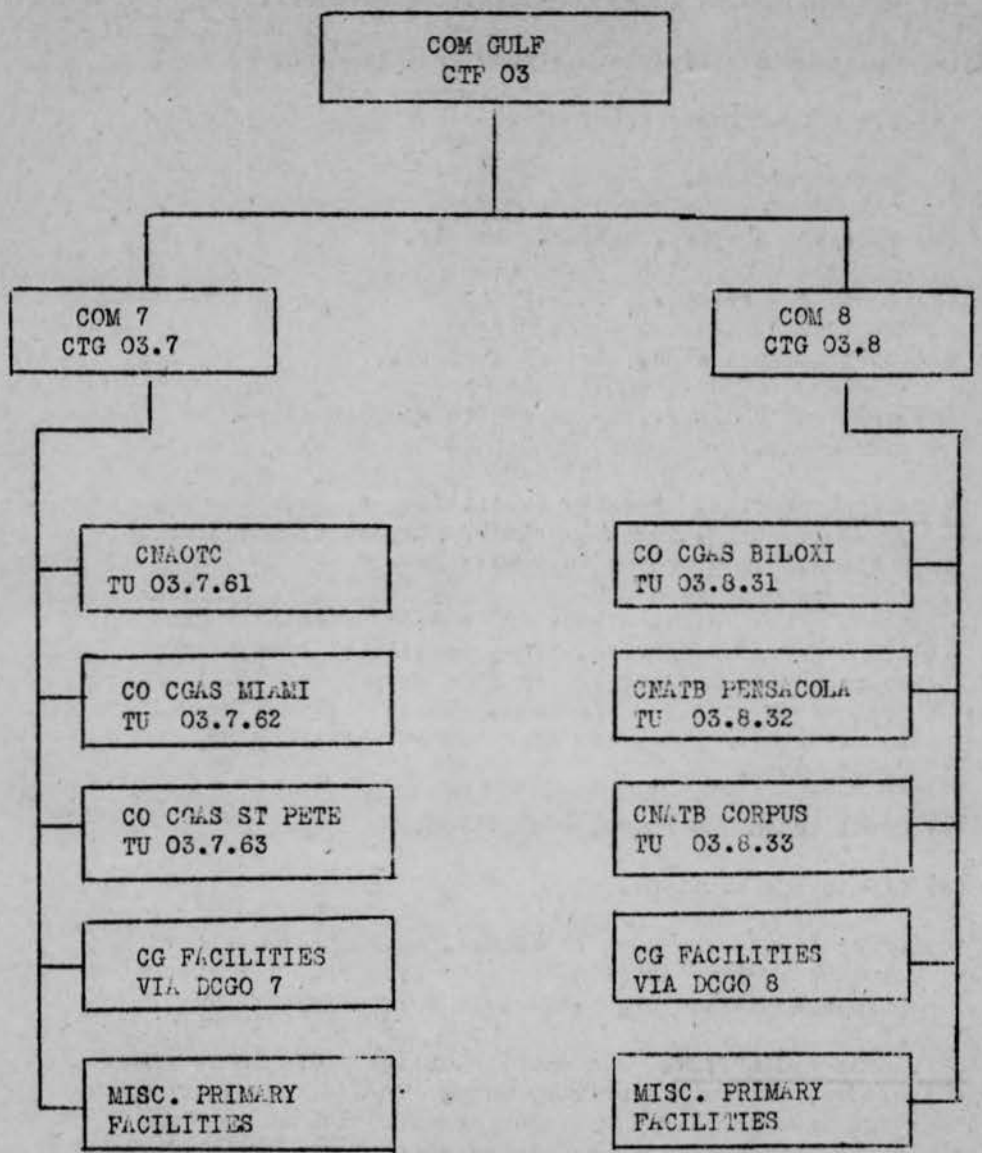

ORGANIZATION

AIR/SEA RESCUE SERVICE

GULF SEA FRONTIER

PRIMARY FACILITIES

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PART VI (REVISED)

PROCEDURES

6.1 General Reporting Procedures.

Whenever information is received by any Army, Navy, Marine, Coast Guard, or civil station that an aircraft has crashed, made a forced landing, or is overdue, or that any surface craft requires assistance, such information shall be passed at once by the most expeditious means of communication to the Joint Operations Center (JOC) of the appropriate Naval District.

JOC., 7ND - Tel. Miami, 9-3711, Extension 395.
JOC., 8ND - Tel. New Orleans, Magnolia 6651, Extension 337.

6.2 Broadcast of Distress Information.

(a) The controller at the Joint Operations Center shall, when the situation warrants, have distress information broadcast by suitable radio stations on 8280 and 500 kc.

(b) The controller at the Joint Operations Center shall take such action as is necessary to satisfy interested parties of the termination of each distress incident.

6.3 Aircraft Distress Procedure.

When an aircraft is threatened by serious and imminent danger and requires immediate assistance, the pilot will -

(a) Turn on IFF emergency.

(b) Transmit "SOS" on CW and/or "Mayday" on voice followed by aircraft identification and a 20 second dash.

(1) When HF or VHF (Voice) is used, transmit "Mayday" (three times) followed by call sign of aircraft (three times). For HF Voice keep microphone button depressed (listen and repeat) for 20 seconds after above transmission and then transmit call sign again (listen and repeat).

(c) The first transmission by the aircraft will be on the assigned air ground frequency. If the aircraft is unable to establish communication on the assigned air ground frequency, one or more of the following will be used.

(1) The international distress frequency, 500 Kc.
(2) U. S. Emergency and Safety Frequency, 8280 Kc.
(3) Any other available frequency in an effort to establish contact with a ground station.

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(d) If time permits, the following information should be transmitted:

(1) Best estimated position and time thereof.

(2) Course and speed.

(3) Altitude of the aircraft.

(4) Intention of aircraft commander as to ditching, bailing out, or crash landing.

(e) Immediately prior to ditching, bailing out, or crash landing, the pilot or radio operator will tie down the CW key. If the aircraft is equipped with VHF, the pilot will break the safety wire on the VHF control switch and throw the switch to transmit position, or use any other means available to obtain continuous transmission.

(f) If the aircraft no longer is in distress, a message cancelling the state of distress must be transmitted on the same frequency.

(g) If the aircraft has crashed or ditched and the controlling ground station (or controlling authority) determines that a state of distress no longer exists, a message cancelling the state of distress will be transmitted by the controlling ground station on the same frequency.

(h) Special care must be taken to authenticate cancellation messages in those areas when authentication systems are in effect.

6.4 Aircraft Emergency Procedure.

When an aircraft is in trouble and requires immediate navigation aid, the pilot will -

(a) Turn on IFF emergency.

(b) Call the ground station employing normal calling procedure, using the precedence prosign "O" for radiotelegraph (CW) and/or "Emergency" for radiotelephone (Voice). If not in contact with a ground station use XXX by CW or PAN on R/T. Request fix (bearing or course), followed by -

(1) For radiotelegraph (CW): A 20 second dash and call sign.

(2) For radiotelephone (Voice) VHF: Count one to five and back.

(3) For radiotelephone (Voice) HF: A 20 second period during which no voice transmission is made, but the microphone button remains depressed, and call sign.

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(c) Obtain receipt and acknowledgment from ground station to transmit emergency message.

(d) Transmit emergency message, containing the following information:

(1) Best estimated position and time thereof.

(2) Course and speed.

(3) Altitude of the aircraft.

(4) Available flight time.

(5) Intention of the airplane commander as to ditching, bailing out, or crash landing.

(e) Obtain from ground station receipt for emergency message with fix, bearing, or course and special instructions.

(f) Frequencies same as used in Aircraft Distress Procedure.

(g) Cancellation procedure same as in Aircraft Distress Procedure.

6.5 Aircraft Safety Procedure.

When the pilot of an aircraft is uncertain of his position or is expecting a state of emergency, but with the aid of ground station can proceed on a course or land at a suitable air field, he will call the ground station using normal procedure.

(a) If the pilot is unable to contact the ground station or does not know what station to call, he will use the international safety signal "TTT" on radiotelegraph (CW) and/or "Security" on radiotelephone (Voice) followed by aircraft identification, and request a fix or bearing.

(b) Upon receipt of request for fix, bearing, or course, ground station will after alerting the DF net direct the aircraft to transmit.

(1) For CW QTN6, for HF/VHF Voice "Transmit for Fix (bearing or course)."

(c) The desired fix, bearing, or course will be released by HF/DF Net Control to be furnished to requesting aircraft by the ground station.

6.6 Action by Aircrew Afloat in Dinghy or Lifeboat.

Aircrew in dinghy or airborne lifeboat should use some or all of the following methods to attract attention:

(a) When no aircraft or surface craft are seen or heard in the vicinity -

(1) "Gibson Girl" transmitter (SCR-578A or An/CRT-3). This transmitter should be operated approximately 5 minutes of each 15 minutes, coinciding with the international silence periods at X:15 and X:45 o'clock, if possible.

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(2) "Walter" (MX-137/A or MX-138/A). This equipment should be erected.

(b) When aircraft or surface craft are seen or heard in the vicinity -

(1) The "Gibson Girl" transmitter should be operated continuously.

(2) The "Walter" equipment should be operated continuously.

(3) "Corner". This equipment should be erected.

(4) Use pyrotechnics.

(5) Use paulin for flag signalling.

(6) Use mirror for flash signalling.

(7) Blow whistles in fog or darkness.

(8) Lay a colored trail on the sea by use of fluorescein.

(9) Use any other method of signalling to attract attention.

6.7 Action by Search Aircraft.

When a search aircraft is dispatched on an emergency rescue mission -

(a) The following frequencies, if possible, shall be guarded continuously:

(1) 3000 Kc. "On scene" frequency.

(2) 500 Kc. (by means of automatic direction finder).

(3) The base frequency.

(4) 140.58 MCS VHF command, ASR and emergency.

(b) Search equipment should be operated to detect presence of "Walter" and corner reflector ("Emily").

(c) Communication between all search craft should be on 3000 Kc. frequency.

(d) To establish communications -

(1) With any Coast Guard base or boat, call and listen on 2670 Kc.

(2) With a Navy base or boat call and listen on 2716 Kc.

(3) With an Army Air Forces air ground station, on frequencies as specified in AAF radio facility charts and similar documents provided by the dispatching authority.

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(4) With towers or range stations, call by voice using 4495 or 6210 Kc., and listen for reply on the proper tower or range frequency.

(e) Search aircraft having sighted distressed aircrew, while circling the position, will -

(1) When installed; turn on emergency IFF. (When leaving the immediate scene of distress, emergency IFF should be turned off).

(2) Notify the base station, indicating the location and whether assistance is needed.

(3) When assistance is needed to complete the rescue, transmission can be made on 500 or 8280 Kc so that shore stations can obtain a fix and surface, and aircraft can "home" on the scene.

(f) When the rescue is effected and the rescue craft is proceeding to the base, the base station will be notified.

(g) When unable, because of the imposition of radio silence or otherwise, to establish communication by radio an aircraft sighting a surface vessel may indicate the location of the distress as follows:

(1) The aircraft will establish identification if necessary. It will then circle the ship at least once, fly across the bow of the ship at low altitude, opening and closing the throttle, and will head in the direction of the distress scene, rocking the wings. This procedure will be repeated until the ship has acknowledged by following the aircraft. If possible, the aircraft will maintain visual contact with the ship until the latter sights the aircraft or ship in distress or the survivors thereof.

6.8 Action by Search Surface Craft.

When a search surface craft is dispatched on an emergency rescue mission -

(a) The following frequencies if possible shall be guarded continuously:

(1) 3000 Kc.

(2) 500 Kc. (by means of automatic direction finder).

(3) The base frequency.

(4) 140.58 MCS VHF command emergency air sea rescue.

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(b) To establish communication -

(1) With any Coast Guard base or boat, call and listen on 2670 Kc.

(2) With a Navy base or boat, call and listen on 2716 Kc.

(3) With an Army Air Forces ground station on frequencies as specified in AAF radio facility charts and similar documents provided by the dispatching authority.

(4) With towers or range stations, call by voice using 4495 Kc or 6210 Kc, and listen for reply on the proper tower or range frequency.

(c) Search surface craft, having sighted distress aircrew, will notify the base station, indicating the location and whether assistance is needed.

(d) When rescue is effected, the base station will be notified.

6.9 Action by Aircraft Witnessing a Forced Landing or Sighting Distressed Personnel.

Aircraft observing an incident should -

(a) Keep aircraft or distressed personnel in sight.

(b) Turn on IFF emergency.

(c) Notify the ground station of the pertinent facts, giving the following information or applicable parts thereof;

(1) Type of aircraft or surface craft.

(2) Location - by geographic point or bearing or distance from some fixed point, or latitude and longitude.

(3) Time of crash or forced landing.

(4) Personnel:

(A) Number.

(B) Whether seen to bail out.

(C) Whether known to be afloat.

(d) Remain on scene as long as endurance permits, or until directed otherwise.

(e) Transmit, if possible, the appropriate signals on 500 Kc. to alert Navy (Coast Guard) bases or units which maintain watch on

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this frequency, and to aid rescue aircraft or surface craft to home on the location of the distress personnel.

(f) Transmit, if possible, the appropriate signals for HF/DF fix on the control frequency or on 8280 Kc. A constant HF/DF watch is maintained by all AAF and Navy (Coast Guard) HF/DF stations on 8280 Kc.

(g) Transmit, if possible, appropriate signals for VHF/DF fixes.

(h) Turn off emergency IFF when departing from the immediate scene of the incident.

(i) When unable, because of the imposition of radio silence or otherwise, to establish communication by radio, an aircraft sighting a surface vessel may indicate the location of the distress as follows:

(1) The aircraft will establish identification, if necessary. It will then circle the ship at least once, fly across the bow of the ship at a low altitude, opening and closing the throttle, and will head in the direction of the distress scene, rocking the wings.

(2) This procedure will be repeated until the ship has acknowledged by following the aircraft. If possible, the aircraft will maintain visual contact with the ship until the latter sights the aircraft or ship in distress or the survivors thereof.

6.10 Action by Surface Craft Witnessing a Forced Landing or Sighting Distressed Personnel.

Surface craft witnessing a forced aircraft landing or distress personnel should -

(a) Render immediate assistance.

(b) Notify shore stations of the situation and action taken and advise whether further assistance is necessary.

6.11 The Gulf Coast HF/DF Network.

(a) The Coast Guard Gulf Coast HF/DF network, under the operational control of the Commander, Gulf Sea Frontier consists of the following HF/DF stations:

(1) Jupiter, Fla.
(2) Key West, Fla.
(3) Pensacola, Fla.
(4) Houma, La.
(5) Houston, Tex.
(6) Port Isabel, Tex.

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(b) All network stations, including the control and evaluator stations, are connected by a leased teletype circuit.

(c) The mission of the net is to obtain bearings on aircraft and vessels in distress or in potential distress, survival transmitting equipment, and upon request, track aircraft.

(d) The net covers a frequency range of 2000 to 18000 Kcs. and may be alerted at any time by anyone requiring assistance. Radio contact with the net can be made by calling own base radio station on base frequency, or by calling Coast Guard Radio Stations, NMV Jacksonville, Fla., WAX Hialeah, Fla., and WNU New Orleans, La. on the U. S. Emergency and Safety Frequency, 8280 Kc. The proper degree of urgency may be indicated by SOS, XXX, TTT, or by QTF(see Article 6-3, 6-4, 6-5, or JANP-107). Bearings observed by the network HF/DF stations are forwarded by teletype to Net Controller, Room 903, duPont Building, Miami, Fla., where they are plotted and evaluated. Fixes, bearings, or courses are then given to all stations on the net, thus permitting any station on the net to utilize them as may be required.

(e) To acquaint pilots and radiomen with the capabilities and limitations of the HF/DF network as a navigational aid, training bearings or fixes may be obtained by calling own base on base frequency, and requesting training fix, bearing or course. Training alerts are immediately terminated upon the alerting of the net for safety, emergency or distress. Upon the receipt of fix, bearing, or course, it is requested that the plane furnish its own DR position at time indicated in fix, bearing, or course for information of net evaluator section.

(f) The U. S. Emergency and Safety Frequency, 8280 Kc. This frequency is available for ships and aircraft to transmit distress, emergency, and safety messages and for survival transmitting equipment. This frequency is guarded for emergency requests for bearings by the Army and Navy (Coast Guard) HF/DF stations for emergency bearings and fixes and by the Coast Guard Primary Radio Stations and Leased Radio Stations.

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TELEPHONE NUMBERS BY WHICH THE GULF COAST HF/DF NET MAY BE ALERTED

JOINT OPERATIONS CENTER	COMMERCIAL	EXTENSIONS
JOC Miami, Fla. (CGSF)	Miami 9-3711	395
JOC New Orleans, La. (Com-8)	MAgnolia 6651	337, 398, 263
NET CONTROL, MIAMI		
HF/DF Evaluation Center	Miami 9-3711	517
SUB-NET CONTROL		
DCGO 7ND Miami, Fla.	Miami 9-3711	320, 329
DCGO 8ND New Orleans, La.	MAgnolia 4451	272
INTER-NET RADIO STATION		
C. G. Leased Radio "WAX"	Miami 8-2689	
C. G. Leased Radio "WNU"	Cedar 1455	
NET SERVICE DROPS		
Jacksonville, Fla.	Jacksonville 2-7711	8231, 8659
Banana River, Fla.	Banana River 1	418
DIRECTION FINDER STATIONS		
Jupiter, Fla.	West Palm Beach 2-1464	
Key West, Fla.	Key West 790	NAS 224
		NAS 211
		NAS 328
Pensacola, Fla.	Pensacola 8-2840	
Houma, La.	Houma 2020	- - -
	Houma 2100	29
Houston, Texas	LaPorte 4071	- - -
Port Isabel, Texas	Pt. Isabel 9003	- - -

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6-7. AIRCRAFT WITNESSING FORCED LANDING OR SIGHTING DISTRESSED PERSONNEL. Aircraft observing a forced landing of another aircraft or sighting distressed personnel should:

(a) Keep aircraft or personnel in sight.

(b) Turn on IFF "Emergency" switch.

(c) Notify appropriate ground station of pertinent facts.

(d) Be prepared to transmit for D/F fix and to home rescue craft to the scene.

(e) Remain on station as long as fuel permits or until relieved.

(f) Render any other assistance as may be practicable.

(g) Turn off emergency IFF when leaving scene.

6-8. SURFACE CRAFT WITNESSING FORCED LANDING OR SIGHTING DISTRESSED PERSONNEL. Surface craft witnessing a forced landing of an aircraft or sighting distressed personnel should:

(a) Render immediate assistance.

(b) Notify appropriate shore station of the situation and action taken, and advise if further assistance is required.

6-9. COMMUNICATIONS.

(a) Air/Sea Rescue communications shall always be in plain language.

(b) Voice transmission (R/T) shall be used wherever possible.

(c) The first transmission by an aircraft will be on the normally assigned air-ground frequency. If unable to establish communication on that frequency, one or more of the following should be used:

(1) International Distress, 500 kc.

(2) U.S. Emergency & Safety, 8280 kc.

(3) Scene-of-Action, 3000 kc.

(4) U.S. VHF Common, 126.18 mc.

(5) Any other available frequency.

Cancelled - Revised

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PART VII

SEVENTH NAVAL DISTRICT RESCUE PLAN 1-45

TASK ORGANIZATION

(a) LOCAL DEFENSE FORCES - DCGO 7ND

CG Striking Groups
Captains of the Port

(b) DISTRICT SERVICE FORCES - COM. SERVICE FORCES, 7ND

Miscellaneous District Craft
Rescue and Salvage Force

(c) N.O.B., KEY WEST

Vessels assigned

(d) AIR/SEA RESCUE GROUP - OPERATIONS OFFICER, 7ND

Rescue Task Unit, N.A.O.T.C.
Rescue Task Unit, CGAS, Miami
Rescue Task Unit, CGAS, St. Petersburg

(e) NAVAL AIR BASES, 7ND - COMNAVAIRBASES, 7ND

NAS Key West
NAS Richmond
NAAS Boca Chica
CGAS Miami
CGAS St. Petersburg
NAF Dinner Key
NAF San Julian

(f) MISCELLANEOUS 7ND ACTIVITIES

District Medical Department
District Supply Department
District Industrial Manager

(g) MISCELLANEOUS

Third Air Force
Caribbean Div., Air Transport Command
Miscellaneous Transient Vessels

7-1. (a) The Frontier Commander has delegated the responsibility for Air/Sea Rescue within the Seventh Naval District to the Commandant, 7ND. By definition (Part I, GSF Air/Sea Rescue Plan) Air/Sea Rescue includes all phases of distress operations. Such operations as are carried out by Com 7 will be closely coordinated with Gulf Sea Frontier Operations.

(b) All reports of distress in the 7th Naval District should be forwarded by the most expeditious means to the Controller, Joint Operations Center, Miami, Fla. (Telephone Miami 9-3711 and ask for "Controller").

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The Joint Operations Center has leased line telephone service to various strategic points throughout the district and also is the focal point for all other methods of communication. A visual air and surface plot is maintained, giving the controller a complete picture of current operations throughout the entire Frontier.

(c) Vessels of the Navy Rescue Tug Service will be specifically requested from Commander Eastern Sea Frontier by Commandant, 7th ND. The disposition of the regularly assigned commercial station tugs (none are assigned at present to the 7th ND) of the Navy Rescue Tug Service is controlled by Commander Eastern Sea Frontier. In addition to these vessels Commander Eastern Sea Frontier has knowledge of the movement and locality of commercial seagoing tugs operating in the Eastern, Gulf and Caribbean Sea Frontiers and capable of rendering rescue service. He is authorized to procure such tugs for rescue missions when the station tugs are not available.

7-2. COM 7 will carry out duties listed in Part IV, Section 4-2 of GSF Air/Sea Rescue Plan 1-45.

7-3. (a) LOCAL DEFENSE FORCES

Through the DCGO, forces available will be ordered to conduct operations for the rescue of personnel, aircraft and vessels within the waters of the 7th ND.

Captains of the Port furnish assistance as may be directed by the District Coast Guard Officer.

The local SCGO-COTP on being informed of vessels or aircraft in distress within his vicinity shall render immediate assistance. He shall then notify the Gulf Sea Frontier Controller concerning the action taken, and all other information pertaining to the rescue operation.

Coast Guard Stations be on the lookout for persons, aircraft and vessels in distress. Provide lifesaving equipment, and beach patrols for assisting mariners, as necessary and practicable.

(b) DISTRICT SERVICE FORCES

(1) Miscellaneous District Craft. These forces available through COM Service Forces, 7ND and include tugs, barges, YAG's YO's, YHB's, and other craft. They shall be used as expedient and as their capabilities permit.

(2) Rescue and Salvage Force, 7ND. This unit, under the Commanding Officer, ATR 29, and composed of that vessel and any others which may be assigned, is especially equipped for off shore rescue, firefighting, towing, and salvage. Communications in accordance with current GSF communications plan.

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(c) N.O.B. KEY WEST

Forces available through Commander, NOB, Key West, include harbor tugs, small boats, motor vehicles, and personnel. The Industrial Department is capable of performing emergency repairs to vessels and the Supply Department can issue equipment and supplies for rescue operations. Reached by direct leased telephone through Joint Operations Center, Miami, Fla.

(d) AIR/SEA RESCUE GROUP

This group is composed of three Rescue Task Units with air and surface craft deployed throughout the 7th ND. These task units are primary rescue facilities as defined in basic Air/Sea Rescue Plan and are quickly activated through the Joint Operations Center, Miami, or any Navy or Coast Guard activity.

(1) Rescue Task Unit, N.A.O.T.C. This unit maintains rescue aircraft and surface vessels strategically located throughout the NAOTC sector. Surface craft are especially equipped 63' and 104' aircraft rescue boats. Planes are of various types, including stripped down PBY-5A's, especially equipped for rescue work and manned by trained rescue crews. Planes and boats are equipped with radar and radio and transmit and receive on 3,000 kc. R/T. Detailed operations plan for this task unit is distributed to appropriate activities within the NAOTC and adjoining sectors.

(2) Rescue Task Unit, CG Air Station, Miami. This unit maintains rescue aircraft and surface craft at Miami and Key West, surface vessels at La Fe, Cuba, and aircraft at San Julian, Cuba. Surface craft are 63' AVR's and aircraft are stripped down PBY-5A's and PBM's especially equipped for rescue work and manned by trained rescue crews. Planes and boats are equipped with radar and radio, transmit and receive on 3,000 kc. R/T. Detailed operations plan is distributed to appropriate activities

(3) Rescue Task Unit, CG Air Station, St. Petersburg. Rescue aircraft at CG Air Station, St. Petersburg. Rescue surface craft at St. Marks, Cedar Keys, Egmont Key, St. Petersburg, and Boca Grande. Equipment and personnel same as (2) above. Planes and boats transmit and receive on 3,000 kc. R/T. Detailed operations plan distributed appropriately.

(e) NAVAL AIR BASES, 7ND

Provide facilities as requested by COM 7 ND for search or other missions in connection with Air/Sea Rescue.

Promptly pass to Controller, Joint Operations Center, Miami, information of vessels and/or aircraft in distress.

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(f) MISCELLANEOUS SEVENTH NAVAL DISTRICT FUNCTIONS.

(1) District Medical Department. Provide medical personnel and supplies for rescue parties. Provide emergency first aid at point of debarkation, and transport to nearest naval or civil hospital rescued persons in need of medical attention. Arrange with civilian hospitals at coastal points throughout the 7th ND for the reception and emergency treatment of injured personnel.

(2) District Supply Department. Issue emergency supplies as required for rescue operations.

(3) Industrial Manager. Furnish mechanics, tools and equipment to vessels in distress to permit them to continue under their own power wherever possible, or to assist them in keeping afloat until they can reach port.

(g) MISCELLANEOUS

(1) Third Air Force. This activity operates an Air/Sea Rescue Service off the west coast of Florida. Equipment includes aircraft rescue boats and airplanes equipped to drop survival gear to persons in the water. Detailed operations plan is published as Third Air Force Manual 62-1. This service is activated through Air/Sea Rescue Control, McDill Field, Tampa, Fla., Telephone Tampa, H-8811, Ext. 725.

(2) Caribbean Division, Air Transport Command. This activity maintains and operates an Air/Sea Rescue Service along the ATC route from Miami and West Palm Beach to Puerto Rico. Equipment consists of rescue aircraft and surface vessels which transmit and receive on 3,000 kc. R/T. Communications are handled by Army Airways Communication Service (AACS). Detailed Air/Sea Rescue Plan is published and distributed. This unit activated via AACS or telephone West Palm Beach, 3371, Ext. 57.

(3) Miscellaneous Transient Vessels. All transient vessels, naval or commercial, are to be considered available to responsible commanders for emergency rescue work. Communication with these vessels can be handled through the Joint Operations Center but will be more expedient if direct communication can be established.

(x) (1) Subordinate commanders are directed to initiate prompt and effective action in the case of nearby vessels requiring assistance.

(2) The responsible commander nearest the scene of distress is charged with the duty to initiate appropriate rescue operations and will advise his next superior of the action taken.

(3) In a rescue operation, if it becomes evident that further assistance is required, advise the Commandant immediately through the Joint Operations Center and state specifically what further assistance is required.

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(4) Combatant forces may be used for rescue operations providing such duty does not interfere with their primary mission to seek the enemy forces and destroy them.

(5) Comply with pertinent instructions as set forth in Commander-in-Chief, U.S. Fleet and Chief of Naval Operations serial 344 of 28 February 1942. (Annex "Able")

7-4. (a) All vessels and aircraft refuel at nearest base as necessary. Maintain at least a two (2) hour state of readiness unless specifically exempted by competent authority, as when undergoing authorized overhaul or upkeep.

(b) As a general rule, Salvage Vessels will not be employed in rescue operations, if rescue vessels are available. When salvage vessels are required for rescue service, permission for their use must be first obtained from the Supervisor of Salvage, 17 Battery Place, New York City. He may be reached directly by telephone Whitehall 4-9152 or via the command line to Commander Eastern Sea Frontier.

7-5. Communications in accordance with current Gulf Sea Frontier Communication Plan. Use Eastern War Time (Queen) Zone Plus Four, and so state in body of dispatches.

Commandant, SEVENTH Naval District, at Headquarters, Alfred I. duPont Building, Miami, Florida.

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PART VIII

EIGHTH NAVAL DISTRICT RESCUE PLAN - 1-45

TASK ORGANIZATION

3.8.3 RESCUE GROUP - 8ND - COMMANDANT, EIGHTH NAVAL DISTRICT (Operations 8ND)

(a) Inshore Patrol Vessels and Frontier Bases - ComInsPat and ComFron-Bases.

Vessels currently assigned to ComInsPat.
Frontier Bases, Burnwood.
Frontier Bases, Galveston.

(b) Coast Guard Activities - 8ND - DCGC 8ND

Vessels and boats operating under DCGO
Captain of the Port
Coast Guard Stations and Lifeboat Stations

(c) 3.8.31 - Air/Sea Rescue Group - ASR Officer, 8ND

Corpus Christi Task Unit
New Orleans Task Unit
Pensacola Task Unit

(d) Naval Air Bases - 8ND - ComNavAirBases, 8ND

NAS, Clinton, Oklahoma (Headquarters)
NAS, Houma, Louisiana
MCAS, Eagle Mountain Lake, Texas

(e) Miscellaneous 8ND Activities

District Medical Department
District Supply Department
Industrial Manager, 8ND
District Communications 8ND

(f) Miscellaneous

Miscellaneous transient vessels.

8-1. (a) The Commander, Gulf Sea Frontier has delegated the responsibility for Air/Sea Rescue within the Eighth Naval District to the Commandant, 8ND. By definition (Part I, GSF Air/Sea Rescue Plan), Air/Sea Rescue includes all phases of distress operations. Operations conducted by ComEight in this category will be coordinated with Gulf Sea Frontier operations through Joint Operations Center, 8ND.

(b) All reports of distress should be forwarded by the most expeditious means to Controller, Joint Operations Center, New Orleans (Telephone MAgnolia 6651 - Extension 337).

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(c) Requests for tug service will be forwarded to ComEight (Operations) who will take the necessary action thereon.

(d) Special Task Units, equipped and trained for fast service in connection with Air/Sea Rescue Service, have been established in the various sectors of the Gulf Sea Frontier under Gulf Sea Frontier Air/Sea Rescue Plan. For local operations, the Pensacola and Corpus Christi units are directly available to the Air Training Bases Commands under the Pensacola and Corpus Christi Sector Plans. Where coordination between 8ND and adjacent sectors is required, this coordination will be effected by Com Eight Joint Operations Center.

8-2. ComEight will carry out the duties listed in Part IV, Section 4 - 2 of Gulf Sea Frontier Air/Sea Rescue Plan 1-44.

8-3. (a) Inshore Patrol Vessels and Frontier Bases

Vessels and boats available will be ordered by ComEight to conduct operations in connection with the rescue of personnel, aircraft, and vessels within the waters of 8ND.

On receipt of information of vessels or aircraft in distress in the vicinity, ComInsPat and ComFronBases shall render immediate assistance with the means available, informing ComEight of the circumstances and the action being taken.

Frontier Bases will be utilized for the receipt, treatment, and transfer of survivors in accordance with ComEight Serial 01597, dated 1 December 1942 and for necessary services to vessels engaged in Air/Sea Rescue operations.

(b) Coast Guard Activities - 8ND - DCGO 8ND

Coordinate action initiated by the DCGO in connection with Air/Sea Rescue with action taken by Naval Activities, via Joint Operations Center, 8ND.

Keep ComEight informed of circumstances and action being taken in matters involving Air/Sea Rescue which come originally to the attention of the DCGO.

(c) Air/Sea Rescue Group - 8ND

Carry out the provisions of the Pensacola, Corpus Christi and New Orleans Sector Plans as provided for in 1 (d) above.

(d) Naval Air Bases - 8ND - ComNavAirBases, 8ND

Provide aircraft, crash boats and facilities as requested by Com Eight for search or other missions in connection with Air/Sea Rescue.

Pass to ComEight prompt information of vessels and/or aircraft

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requiring assistance of Air/Sea Rescue Task Group which come originally to the attention of ComNavAirBases, 8ND.

(e) Miscellaneous 8ND Activities

Provide service as required by Operations, 8ND for the completion of Air/Sea Rescue and related tasks.

(1) District Medical Department. Provide medical personnel and supplies for rescue parties. Provide emergency first aid at point of debarkation, and transport to nearest naval or civil hospital rescued persons in need of medical attention. Arrange with civilian hospitals at coastal points throughout the 8ND for the reception and emergency treatment of injured personnel.

(2) District Supply Department. Issue emergency supplies as required for rescue operations.

(3) Industrial Manager 8ND. Furnish mechanics, tools and equipment to vessels in distress to permit them to continue under their own power wherever possible, or to assist them in keeping afloat until they can reach port.

(4) Communications, 8ND. Provide communication services as required. (See Sector Air/Sea Rescue Group Plan.)

(f) Miscellaneous

(1) Miscellaneous Transient Vessels. All transient vessels whether naval or commercial capable of rescue operations at sea are to be considered available to responsible commanders in an emergency, for use in rescue work. Provide for quick communication with these rescue vessels through the facilities of the Port Director organization, or otherwise as may be most effective.

(x) (1) Subordinate commanders are directed to initiate prompt and effective action in the case of nearby vessels requiring assistance.

(2) The responsible commander nearest the scene of distress is charged with the duty to initiate appropriate rescue operations and will advise his next superior of the action taken.

(3) In a rescue operation, if it becomes evident that further assistance is required, advise the Commandant 8ND immediately through his Operations Officer and state specifically what further assistance is required.

(4) Combatant forces may be used for rescue operations providing such duty does not interfere with their primary mission to seek and destroy enemy forces.

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(5) Comply with pertinent instructions as set forth in Commander-in-Chief, U.S. Fleet and Chief of Naval Operations Serial 344 of 28 February 1944. (Annex "Able")

8-4. All vessels and aircraft refuel at nearest base as necessary. Maintain at least a two (2) hour state of readiness unless specifically exempted by competent authority, as when undergoing authorized overhaul or upkeep.

8-5. Communications in accordance with current Gulf Sea Frontier Communications Plan. Use Eastern War Time (Roger) Zone Plus Five, and so state in body of despatches.

Commandant, EIGHTH Naval District, as Headquarters, Federal Building, New Orleans, Louisiana.

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

HEADQUARTERS OF THE COMMANDER IN CHIEF (C O P Y)
Navy Department, Washington

FF1/
S94/A3-1/A4-3/F1
Serial: 344
RESTRICTED

23 February 1942.

From: The Chief of Naval Operations, and
The Commander in Chief, United States Fleet.

To: Commander in Chief, U. S. Atlantic Fleet.
Commander in Chief, U. S. Pacific Fleet.
Commanders of Sea Frontiers.
Commandants of Naval Districts, less 16th Naval District.
All Bureaus and Offices of Navy Department.
The War Department.
The Maritime Commission.

Subject: Organization and operation of rescue and salvage services.

1. Rescue operations are undertaken to assist persons and ships in distress at sea. The rescue of personnel can be performed by any suitable vessel. The rescue of ships involves a high degree of seamanship, and requires the employment of seagoing vessels, preferably tugs, fitted for towing. The rescue of ships includes:

(a) Towing disabled vessels into port for docking and repair, or, when the vessel is too badly damaged to permit such a voyage, towing it to a beach where it can be stranded, or to a sheltered area where it can be anchored in shallow water.

(b) Fighting fire on burning vessels.

(c) Minor repairs to vessels in distress to permit them to continue under their own power, or to assist them in keeping afloat until they reach port.

2. Salvage operations are those involved in refloating stranded or sunken vessels, and delivering them to repair yards. Salvage operations require the services of highly specialized technical personnel; the availability of a considerable amount and variety of special salvage gear; and the employment of specially equipped salvage vessels, both self-propelled and non-self-propelled. Salvage may also involve the recovery and lightering of cargo. The assistance of tugs is usually required.

3. Rescue operations are a responsibility of the seagoing operating forces, and are under the Commander in Chief, United States Fleet.

4. Salvage operations are the responsibility of the Shore Establishment, under instructions issued by the Bureau of Ships

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Subject: Organization and operation of rescue and salvage services.
RESTRICTED:

5. The Commander in Chief, United States Fleet, hereby delegates responsibility for rescue operations to the Commanders in Chiefs of Fleets, and to the Commanders of the Sea Frontiers. As a broad general rule, Commanders in Chief will initiate rescue work in the case of vessels more than 500 miles from the land of the sea frontiers, and Commanders of Sea Frontiers will initiate rescue operations in the case of vessels less than that distance from the land of the sea frontiers. Border line cases will be settled through cooperation, but responsible commanders and their subordinates will promptly take action in the case of nearby vessels, without waiting for formal instructions. The commander responsible for initiating rescue operations will inform other commanders who may be involved, and will request their assistance if unable to provide it himself.

6. The Navy Department is executing contracts with private towing companies for the services of their vessels for rescue work, when required, on a per diem basis. Lists of these companies and information as to their tugs will be furnished as soon as possible.

7. As a general rule, salvage vessels, personnel, and equipment should not be employed in rescue operations, when rescue vessels are available.

8. All seagoing tugs and other vessels capable of towing operations at sea, whether naval or commercial, and to whatever organization assigned, are to be considered available to the responsible commanders for use in rescue operations. When not engaged in rescue, vessels, will continue normal operations at their various stations, but the requirements of rescue will be taken into account in the assignment of towing vessels to naval districts or to the various operating forces. The naval districts and naval operating forces having cognizance or command of vessels suitable for rescue operations will:

(a) Keep the appropriate superior constantly advised as to the locations and availability of such vessels.

(b) Keep as large a proportion of them as possible immediately available for rescue assignment.

(c) Advise the appropriate superior, in advance, whenever possible, before laying up one of these vessels for repairs, or assigning it tasks that will prevent its use for rescue.

9. The commanders responsible for rescue operations will:

(a) Keep informed as to the relative capability and availability of rescue vessels, naval or commercial. Decide which rescue vessels will be

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employed in particular cases, and direct their operation.

(b) Keep informed of enemy operations which may foreshadow rescue requirements, and shift the stations of rescue vessels as necessary to meet probable calls.

(c) So far as possible, keep informed as to naval, military, and commercial shipments in order to determine the relative value and importance of vessels which may require rescue.

(d) Advise with officials of the Shore Establishment as to the ports to which damaged vessels are to be towed.

(e) Distribute lists of suitable beaches or shallow water anchorages where vessels may be taken when it is apparent they will sink before reaching repair yards.

(f) Promptly inform the Bureau of Ships when salvage services are required for vessels stranded or sunk in shallow water.

(g) Arrange for protection of vessels being rescued.

10. The Salvage Service will:

(a) Undertake the salvage of stranded or sunken vessels along the coast.

(b) Undertake the salvage of cargo from coastwise wrecks too badly damaged to be salvaged as a whole.

(c) Undertake the salvage of large vessels sunk in ports or harbors when salvage operations are justified, or when the vessels involved are naval ships.

(d) Undertake emergency salvage repair on vessels afloat that may be necessary to permit such vessels to continue to port, or to lighten their draft to permit them to enter drydock.

(e) Cooperate with Army engineers in the removal of wrecks blocking harbors or other navigable waters.

(f) Assist local salvage companies engaged in minor salvage operations in harbors and in other inland waters by loaning, at reasonable rates and without delay,

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such salvage gear, equipment or personnel as they may require to facilitate their local operations.

(g) Arrange to recondition damaged cargo on ships brought in by either the Rescue Service or by the Salvage Service.

(h) Prepare claims for salvage awards on behalf of the Navy for ships and cargo rescued or salvaged, when not owned by the United States.

(i) Support the Rescue Service with technical and legal advice, with salvage equipment, and with the use of salvage vessels as may be required.

H. R. STARK

E. J. KING

Copy to: B.A.D.

/s/ G. L. RUSSELL,
Flag Secretary.

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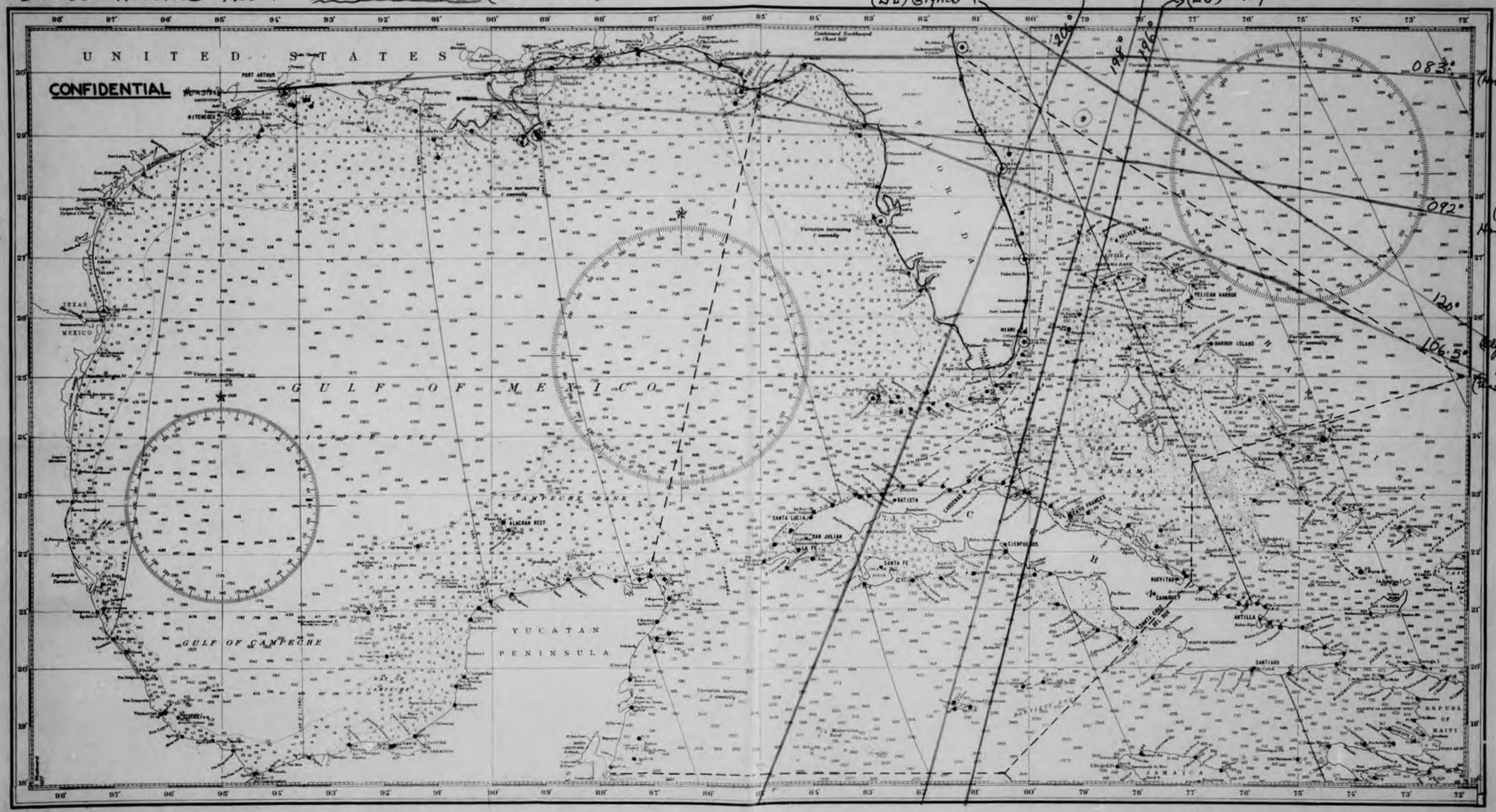
ALERT "LP5" - 5 December 1945
5 missing TBM's.

BRNGS. RECEIVED FROM 2215-2308Z (AVERAGES)



Approx. fix: 29-15 N, 79-00 W.
Radius 100 miles.
@ 2250Z

Certified to be a correct copy
Ellen M. Sorensen Lt.(jg)
EXHIBIT 11

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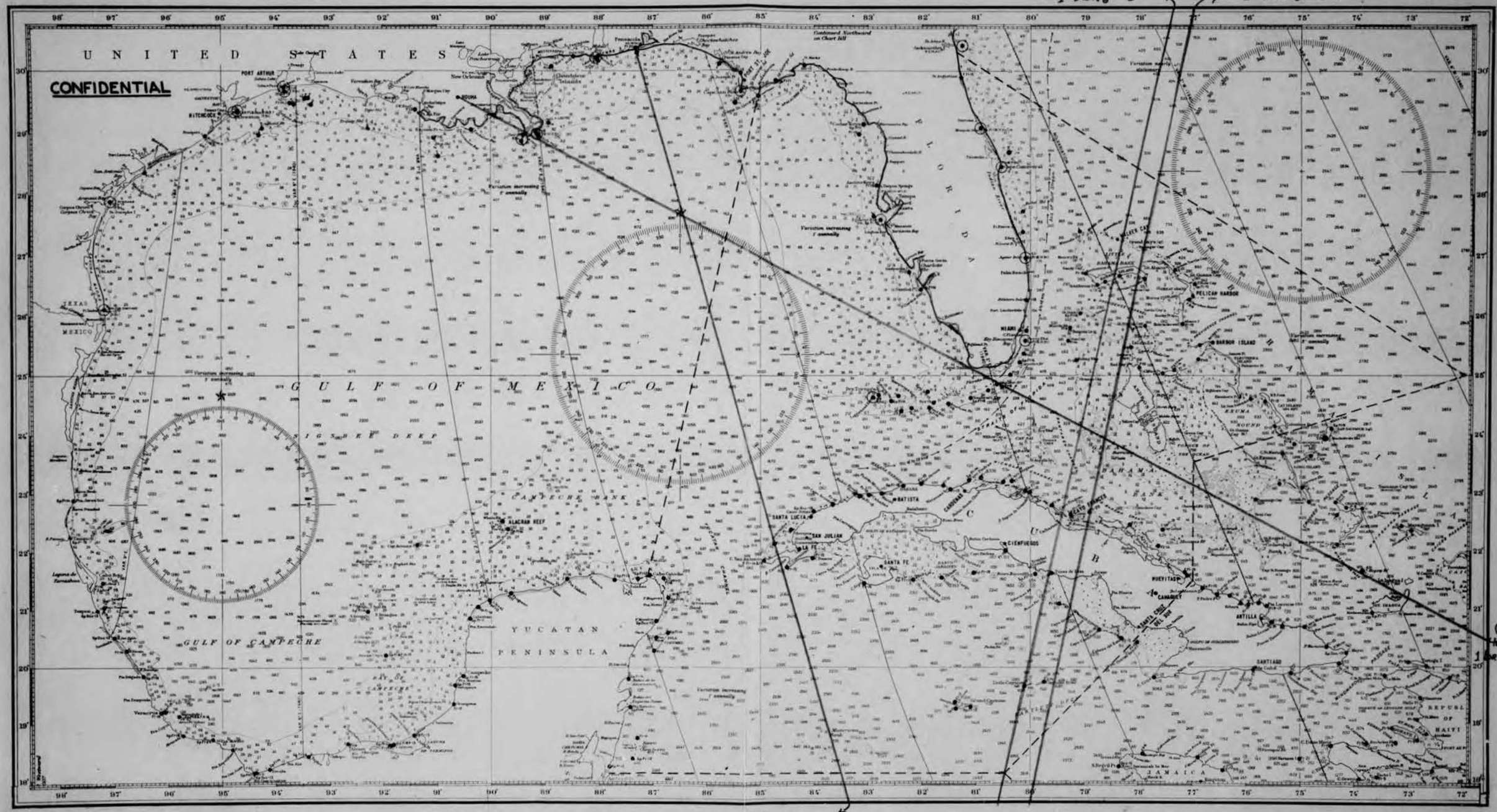
Alert "LP5" 5 December 1945
5 missing TBM's.

BRNGS. Received 2147-2213Z.

Poyners Hill (LI)
1 BRNG "C"

CAPE MAY (LI)
1 BRNG "B"



(LP) Homestead
1 BRNG "E"

(LO) Pensacola
2 BRNGS. "B"

Certified to be correct copy
E. M. Sorensen Lt (jg)

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ALL HF/DF BEARINGS ON ALERT LP7
(5 Missing Navy Planes.)

5 December 1945

LO - Pensacola

Brng.	Time	Class.
163	2155	B3
163	2157	B2
216	2211	B3
068	2215	W2
068	2216	W2
127	2226	A3
120	2241	C2
105	2246	C3
108	2249	B3
034	2307	WW

LP - Houma

Brng.	Time	Class.
113	2150	C5
115	2215	D2
090	2217	B2
092	2222	C2
085/Nil	2223	C2
095	2230	SB
094	2240	B3
095	2246	C2
090/Nil	2247	A4
Nil/089	2248	C4
092/Nil	2251	A4
089	2252	A4
090	2253	A4
093/Nil	2255	B3
097	2304	SB
087	2305	SB
097/087	2306	C4
092/Nil	2307	B3
092	2308	B3

LQ - Houston

Brng.	Time	Class.
085	2241	W2
090	2245	C2
088	2246	C2
085	2249	C2
084	2250	B3
084	2251	B3
082	2251	A3
080	2254	B3
085	2306	B3
082	2305	B3
085	2306	B3
085	2307	B3

LI - Cape May

Brng.	Time	Class.
193	2149	B4
194	2157	C4
190	2217	C4
195	2223	C4
198	2240	C4
200	2250	B4

LJ - Poyner's Hill

Brng.	Time	Class
194	2147	C3
196	2250	B3

LT - Brigantine

206	2253	SB

LL - Glynco

Brng.	Time	Class.
135	2150	SB
133	2152	C3
128	2204	C3
120	2210	C3
120	2211	C3
120	2215	C3
118	2222	C3

Approx. location given to Operations at 2300Z as 29N, 79W. Rad. 100 M
Approx. fix given as 29-15N, 79-00W. Rad. 100 Mi. Av. time 2250.

(Classification)

"A" - Within 2°
"B" - Within 5°
"C" - Within 10°
"D" - Within 20°

"1" - Scarcely Perceptible
"2" - Weak
"3" - Fairly Good
"4" - Good
"5" - Very Good
WW - Wandering
SB - Snap Bearing

Certified to be correct copy
E. M. Stevens
Lt (jg)

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NARA 229

RADIO STATION LOG
NAVAL AIR STATION BANANA RIVER FLORIDA

OPR [redacted] FREQ 4385 POSIT 8 DATE [redacted]

TIME(GCT)	TRNSMISSION
[redacted]	NEW LOG FOR NEW DAY
[redacted]	T.O.I.R. ON PRECEDING LOG [redacted] DEC. 45
	NPB V 1883Z QSV K
	1883Z V NPB SEXT VEES K
	NPB V 1883Z INT QSV K
	NPB V 1883Z INT QSA K
	1883Z V NPB QSA5 K
[redacted]	NPB V 1883Z R AR
	NPB V 1883A INT K
	1883A V NPB K
	NPB V 1883A -R-[redacted] GR1 BT OUT BT [redacted] K
[redacted]	1883A V NPB R AR
[redacted]	NO SIGNALS [redacted] NO SIGNALS [redacted] NO SIGNALS
	NPB V 1883Z K
	1883Z V NPB K
	NPB V 1883Z -R-A-1883Z AR - [redacted] GR1 BT OUT BT [redacted] K
[redacted]	1883Z V NPB R AR
[redacted]	NO SIGNALS [redacted] NO SIGNALS [redacted] NO SIGNALS
[redacted]	NO SIGNALS [redacted] NO SIGNALS [redacted] NO SIGNALS
	1883A V NPB INT QSA K
	NPB V 1883A K
	1883A V NPB K
	NPB V 1883A -R-[redacted] GR5 BT ONE ABLE 198 79 282 BT [redacted] K
[redacted]	1883A V NPB R AR
[redacted]	NO SIGNALS [redacted] NO SIGNALS [redacted] NO SIGNALS
[redacted]	NO SIGNALS [redacted] NO SIGNALS
[redacted]	1883Z V NPB INT QSU K
	1883Z V NPB K
[redacted]	1883Z V NPB K
	1883A V NPB INT QSA K
	NPB V 1883A QSA5 K
[redacted]	1883A V NPB R AR
	1883Z V NPB K
[redacted]	1883Z V NPB K
	1883Z V NPB K
[redacted]	1883Z V NPB K
[redacted]	1883Z V NPB K
	NPB V 1883A INT K
	1883A V NPB K
	NPB V 1883A -R-[redacted] GR5 BT TWO ABLE 897 [redacted] BT [redacted] K
[redacted]	1883A V NPB R AR
[redacted]	1883Z V NPB K
[redacted]	1883Z V NPB K
[redacted]	1883Z V NPB K
[redacted]	1883Z V NPB K
[redacted]	1883Z V NPB K
[redacted]	1883Z V NPB K
[redacted]	1883Z V NPB K
[redacted]	1883Z V NPB K
[redacted]	NO SIGNALS [redacted] NO SIGNALS
[redacted]	1883Z V NPB QSV K
	1883Z V NPB QSV K

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J. C. Parker Lt. USN

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"EXHIBIT 12"

RADIO STATION LOG
NAVAL AIR STATION BANANA RIVER FLORIDA

OPR GREENBERG FREQ 4385 POSIT 8 DATE 06 DECEMBER 1945

TIME(GCT)	TRNSMISSION
0235	T.O.L.E. ON PRECEDING LOG
0237	1883T V NPB QSV K
0240	1883T V NPB QSV K
	1883T V NPB K
	1883T V NPB K
	1883T V NPB K
0245	NO SIGNALS 0250 NO SIGNALS
	1883T V NPB K
	1883T V NPB K
	1883T V NPB K
0255	NO SIGNALS 0300 NO SIGNALS
	1883T V NPB K
	1883T V NPB K
0305	1883T V NPB K
	1883T V NPB K
	1883A V NPB K
0310	NPB V 1883A AS AR
	NPB V 1883A INT K
	1883A V NPB K
	NPB V 1883A -P-060304 GR5 BT
	THREE ABLE 275 60 270 BT 060304 K
0314	1883A V NPB R AR
	1883T V NPB K
0316	1883T V NPB K
	1883T V NPB K
	NPB V 1883L INT QSA K
	1883L V NPB QSA 5 K
	V 1883L AS
	NPB V 1882L INT QSA K
	1882L V NPB QSA5 K
0320	V 1882L R AR
	1883T V NPB K
0325	1883T V NPB K
	1883T V NPB K
	1883T V NPB K
0330	NO SIGNALS 0335 NO SIGNALS
	1883T V NPB K
	1883T V NPB K
	1883T V NPB K
0340	NO SIGNALS
	NPB V 1882L INT K
	1882L V NPB K
	NPB V 1882L -P-060335 GR1 BT OUT BT 060335 K
0345	1882L V NPB R AR
	NPB V 1883A K
	1883A V NPB K
0350	NPB V 1883A AS
	1883A V NPB BT ARE U IN COMMUNICATION WITH 1883T K
	1883T V 1883A K (SENT BY CAPT SLATTERY)
	1883A V NPB TRY AND CONTACT HIM BY PHONE AR
	NPB V 1883A R AR
	1883T V NPB K
0356	1883T V NPB K

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NARA 222

RADIO STATION LOG
NAVAL AIR STATION BANANA RIVER FLORIDA

OPR GREENBERG BLAKLEY FREQ 4385 POSIT 8 DATE 06 DECEMBER 1945

TIME(GCT)	TRNSMISSION
	NPB V 1883A K
	1883A V NPB K
	NPB V 1883A -UNABLE TO CONTACT 1883T VOICE K
0405	1883A V NPB R AR
	1882U V NPB K
	NPB V 1882U -P-T-A-1882U 060400 NAW-W-NPB GR1 BT OUT BT 060400 K
0410	1882U V NPB R AR
	1883T V NPB K
	1883T V NPB K
	1883T V NPB K
	NPB V 1883A K
	1883A V NPB K
	NPB V 1883A -P-060311 GR5 BT ONE ABLE 270 130 BT 060311 K
0413	1883A V NPB R AR
	1883A V NPT INT GR4 K
	NPB V 1883A C C K
0415	1883A V NPB R AR
0420	NO SIGNALS
0425	1883T V NPB K
	1883T V NPB K
0430	1883T V NPB K
	1883T V NPB K
0435	NO SIGNALS 0440 NO SIGNALS 0445 NO SIGNALS
	GREENBERG OFF TO BLAKLEY
0450	1883T V NPT QSV K
0453	1882L V NPB INT QRU K
	NPB V 1882L -P-060500 GR5 BT ONE 117 ABLE 79 155 BT 060500 K
0455	V NPT R AR
0457	1883T V NPT QSV K
0500	NPB V 1882U -P-T-A-1882U 060500 NAW NPB GR5 BT [illegible] 191 ABLE 33 090 BT 060500 K
0503	V NPT R AR
	NPB V 1883A -P-060505 GR5 BT ONE BAKER 270 90 245 BT 060505 K
	V NPB QRT 0505 K
	V 1883A -P-060505 K
0505	V NPB R AR
0510	NO SIGNALS
	1883T V NPB QSV K
0515	NO SIGNALS
0520	1883T V NPB QSV K
	1883T V NPB QSV K
0525	NO SIGNALS
0530	1883T V NPB QSV K
0535	NO SIGNALS
0540	1883T V NPB QSV K
0545	1883T V NPB QSV K
0550	1883T V NPB QSV K
0555	NO SIGNALS 0600 NO SIGNALS
	NPB V 1882L -P-060600 GR5 BT TWO 292 BAKER 45 155 BT 060600 K
	V NPB IMI AA BT QRM 5 K
	V 1882L AA BT K
0605	V NPB R AR

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NARA 223

RADIO STATION LOG
NAVAL AIR STATION BANANA RIVER FLORIDA

OPR BLAKELY FREQ 4385 POSIT 8 DATE 06 DECEMBER 1941

TIME (GCT)	TRNSMISSION
	NPB V 1882U -P-XXXXX T-A- Ø6Ø6ØØ NAW NPB GR5 BT
	TWO 341 BAKER 1Ø4 1ØØ BT Ø6Ø6ØØ K
Ø61Ø	V NPB R AR
Ø615	NPB V 1883A K
	V NPB K
Ø62Ø	V NPB K
	NPB V 1883A K
Ø625	V NPB K
	V NPB K
Ø63Ø	NPB V 1883A AS
	NPB V 1883A -P-Ø6Ø632 GR5 BT
	ONE ABLE XXX 259 132 Ø54Ø BT Ø6Ø632 K
	V NPB INT C GR5-ØØØ K
	V 1883A AS
	V 1883A C GR5-Ø54Ø C- Ø54Ø K
Ø635	V NPB R AR
Ø638	1883T V NPB QSV K
Ø64Ø	1883T V NPB QSV K
	NPB V 1882L INT QSA K
	1882L V NPB QSA3 K
Ø645	1882L V NPB QSA3 K
Ø65Ø	1883T V NPB QSV K
Ø655	1883T V NPB QSV K
Ø7ØØ	NPB V 1882U -P-T-A-1882U Ø6Ø7ØØ NAW NPB GR5 BT
	THREE Ø45 BAKER 38 18Ø BT Ø6Ø7ØØ K
Ø7Ø3	V NPB R AR
	NPB V 1882L -P-Ø6Ø7ØØ GR BT
	THREE 165 BAKER 47 14Ø BT Ø6Ø7ØØ K
Ø7Ø5	V NPB R AR
Ø7Ø7	1883T V NPB QSV K
	NPB V 1883A -P-Ø6Ø712 GR5 BT
	ONE ABLE 273 114 Ø9Ø BT Ø6Ø712 K
Ø71Ø	V NPB R AR
Ø715	1884S V NPB K
Ø72Ø	1884S V NPB QSV K
Ø725	1884S V NPB QSV K
Ø73Ø	1884S V NPB QSV K
XX	6Ø V 1883A INT K
	1883A V NPB INT QZC 6Ø K
	NPB V 1883A QQZ QZC 6Ø K
Ø733	1884S V NPB QSV K
Ø738	1884S V NPB QSV K
Ø745	NO SIGNALS Ø75Ø NO SIGNALS
Ø755	1884S V NPB QSV K
	NPB V 1882L -P-Ø6Ø8ØØ GR5 BT
	FOUR 2Ø2 CHARLIE 26 175 BT Ø6Ø8ØØ K
Ø8ØØ	V NPB R AR
	NPB V 1882U -P-T-A-1882U Ø6Ø8ØØ NAW NPB GR5 BT
	FOUR 162 BAKER 89 18Ø BT Ø6Ø8ØØ K
Ø8Ø5	V NPB R AR
	NPB V 1883A -P-Ø6Ø8Ø5 GR5 BT
	ONE ABLE 26Ø 11Ø ØØØ BT Ø6Ø8Ø5 K
Ø8Ø7	V NPB R AR
Ø81Ø	1883T V NPB QSV K
Ø815	1883T V NPB QSV K
Ø82Ø	NO SIGNALS

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RADIO STATION LOG
NAVAL AIR STATION BANANA RIVER FLORIDA

OPR [redacted] FREQ [redacted] POSIT [redacted] DATE [redacted]

TIME(GCT)	TRNSMISSION	
	NPB V 16825	-P-060830 GR12 NT FIVE 297 CHARLIE 62 134 CHANGING PLAN TWO ACCOUNT WEATHER AND FUEL NT 060830 K
0825	V NPB	R AR
0830	NO SIGNALS	
0835	16825 V NPB	QSV K
0840	NO SIGNALS	
0845	BLANKEN OFF TO OLSON	
0848	NPB V 16825	INT K
	16825 V NPB	K
	NPB V NOP	K
	NOP V NPB	INT QRU QSA1 K
	NPB V NOP	QRU QSA5 AR
	16825 V NPB	K
	NPB V 16825	-P-R-A-16825 060900 NAN NPB GR 5 NT FIVE 202 CHARLIE 40 212 NT 060900 K
0856	V NPB	R AR
	NPB V 16825	INT K
0857	V NPB	K
	NPB V 16825	INT 060900 K
	V NPB	R 060900 R AR
	NPB V 16825A	K
	V NPB	K
	NPB V 16825A	-P-060904 GR 5 NT EIGHT ABLE 270 35 170 NT 060904 K
0902	V NPB	R AR

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NAVAER-443 A (12-44)

Time entries on this form are 75 th meridian time

To convert { add / ~~subtract~~ } 5 hours

Height of Barometer 35.0 Ft. (MSL)

Certified to be a true copy:
Robert D. Dinegar, Lt

NAVY DEPARTMENT

SURFACE WEATHER OBSERVATIONS

(LAND STATION)

WBAN—10 A

Security Classification

Station NAS Banana River, Fla.

Lat. 28°15'N Long. 80°36'W

TYPE (1)	TIME (2)	CLASSIFICATION (3)	CEILING (Hundreds of Feet) (4)	SKY (5)	VISIBILITY (Miles) (6)	WEATHER AND/OR OBSTRUCTIONS TO VISION (7)	SEA-LEVEL PRESSURE (Mbs.) (8)	TEMP. AND DEW PT. (°F) (9)	(10)	WIND DIRECTION (11)	WIND VELOCITY (M.P.H.) (12)	WIND CHARACTER AND SHIFTS (13)	ALTIMETER (Inches) (14)	REMARKS AND SUPPLEMENTAL CODED DATA (For Transmission) (15)	PRES. TEND. (16)	NET 3-HR. CHANGE (Inches) (17)	PRECIP. (Inches) (18)	CLOUDS LOW AMT., TYPE, DIRECTION (19)	LOW HEIGHT (Hnds. of Ft.) (20)	MIDDLE AMT., TYPE, DIRECTION (21)	MIDDLE HEIGHT (Hnds. of Ft.) (22)	HIGH AMT., TYPE, DIRECTION (23)	HIGH HEIGHT (Hnds. of Ft.) (24)	STATION PRESSURE (Inches) (25)	DRY BULB (°F) (26)	WET BULB (°F) (27)	WATER TEMP. (°F) (28)	(29)	OBS. INIT. (30)
S	0045		E45	⊘	7		1007.2	56	52	↑↗	11		973		0	+0.0		8Sc↗		0		0		1005.9	56.5	54.0			CS
S	0145		E45	⊘	7	RW-	1006.9	57	52	↑↑	11		972	SHWRY CNDS N				9Sc↗		0		0		1005.6	57.0	54.0			CS
S	0200		E45	⊘	7		1006.9	57	52	↑↑	11		972	SHWRY CNDS				9Sc↗		0		0		1005.6	57.0	54.0			CS
S	0220		E45	⊘	7	RW-	1006.9	57	52	↑↑	11		972	SHWRY CNDS				9Sc↗		0		0		1005.6	57.0	54.0			CS
S	0245		E45	⊘	8		1006.2	56	54	↑↗	9		970					6Sc↗		0		0		1004.9	56.5	55.0			CS
R	0345		E45	⊘	8		1006.0	56	54	↑↗	11		970		8	-1.2		6Sc↗		0		0		1004.7	55.5	56.0			CS
S	0445			4S ⊘	8		1005.7	56	54	↑↗	11		969					5Sc↗		0		0		1004.4	55.5	54.5			CS
R	0545			4S ⊘	8		1005.7	55	53	↑↗	13		969					5Sc↗		0		0		1004.4	56.0	54.0			FVT
S	0645		E35	⊘	8		1006.2	54	53	↑↗	15		970		4	+0.2		6Sc↗		0		0		1004.9	55.2	54.2			FVT
S	0738		E35	⊘	8	R-	1006.3	55	53	↑↗	15		971					9Sc↗		0		0		1005.0	55.0	54.0			PN
S	0745		E35	⊘	8		1006.3	55	53	↑↗	15		971					8Sc↗		0		0		1005.0	55.0	54.0			PN
R	0845		E35	⊘	8		1007.0	56	53	↗	15		973					7Sc↗		0		0		1005.7	56.0	54.5			WMC
R	0945		E30	⊘	8		1006.9	60	52	↗	10		972		1	+0.8		6Cu↗		0		0		1005.6	59.5	55.5			WMC
R	1045		E30	⊘	10		1006.8	58	49	→↗	10		972					6Cu↗		0		0		1005.5	58.0	53.0			FW
R	1145		E30	⊘	10		1006.3	60	49	→↗	14		971					8Cu↗		0		0		1005.0	60.0	54.0			FW
S	1200		E30	⊘	10	RW-	1006.3	60	49	↗	13		971					8Cu↗		0		0		1005.0	60.0	54.0			MP
S	1215		E30	⊘	10		1006.3	60	49	↗	12		971					8Cu↗		0		0		1005.0	60.0	54.0			MP
R	1245		E25	⊘	10		1005.6	60	51	↗	13		964		8	-1.2		8Cu↗		0		0		1004.3	60.0	56.0			REH
S	1250		E20	⊘	8	RW-	1005.6	60	51	↗	16		969					8Cu↗		0		0		1004.3	60.0	55.0			REH
S	1345		E25	⊘	10		1005.1	58	51	→	11		967					8Cu↗		0		0		1003.8	58.0	54.0			MP
R	1445		E30	⊘	10		1005.0	56	48	→	17		967					8Cu↗		0		0		1003.7	56.5	52.0			MP
S	1545		E70	⊘ 15 ⊘	10		1006.3	55	48	→	12		968		8	-0.4		2St→		10Ac↑		OBSCD		1003.4	55.0	51.0			FRP
S	1568		E70	⊘ 15 ⊘	10	RW-	1006.3	55	48	→	12		968					2St→		10Ac↑		OBSCD		1003.4	55.0	51.0			MP
S	1645		B20	⊘ 15 ⊘	8		1006.8	54	48	→	11		972	SCUD 15 HND				10Sc→		OBSCD		OBSCD		1005.5	54.5	51.0			HB
S	1745		E20	⊘ 15 ⊘	8	RW-	1006.9	54	48	→	12		973	SCUD 15 HND				10Sc→		OBSCD		OBSCD		1005.6	54.5	51.0			HB
S	1810		E25	⊘ 15 ⊘	8		1007.3	54	48	→	12		974	SCUD 15 HND				10Sc→		OBSCD		OBSCD		1006.0	54.5	51.0			FB
S	1845		E15	⊘ ⊘	8	RW-	1007.8	52	50	→↗	8		975	E70 ⊘	2	+2.6		7St→		3Ac←		OBSCD		1006.5	52.0	51.0			FB
S	1900		E15	⊘ ⊘	8		1007.8	52	50	→↗	8		975	E70 ⊘				7St→		3Ac←		OBSCD		1006.5	52.0	51.0			FB
R	1945		E15	⊘ ⊘	8		1008.5	52	47	→	8		977	E70 ⊘				7St→		3Ac←		OBSCD		1007.2	51.5	49.0			JWP
S	2045			15 ⊘	10		1008.5	51	46	→	8		977					7St→		0		0		1007.2	51.0	48.5			JWP

SUMMARY OF DAY (midnight to midnight)

Time of sunrise 0700 Time of sunset 1726

24-hr. Max. Temp. 62 °F. 24-hr. Min. Temp. 52 °F.

24-hr. Precip. (water equivalent) 0.05 in. 24-hr. Snowfall (unmelted) 0.00 in.

Total hours of fog: Light 0 Moderate 0 Heavy 0

Max. wind (5 min.) ___ (m.p.h., knots) Direction ___ Time ___

Extreme wind (fastest single mile) 16 (~~m.p.h.~~, knots) Direction W Time 1305

Peak gust 24 (~~m.p.h.~~, knots) Direction WSW Time 1248

Thickness of ice on water ___ in.

Ground frozen from ___ in. to ___ in.

6-HOURLY OBSERVATIONS

Time of Obs.	0045	0645	1245	1845	Midnight
Precip. (in.)	-	0.01	0.02	0.02	
Snowfall (in.)	-	-	-	-	
Snow Depth (in.)	-	-	-	-	
Max. Temp.	59.5	57.0	62.0	69.0	
Min. Temp.	56.5	54.0	52.0	52.0	
5,000 ft. Pressure					
Rel. Hum. %	85	94	73	75	
Soil Temp.					
State of Ground	0	1	1	1	

Time of Obs.	0045	0645	1245	1845
State of Sea and Dir.				
Swell Ht. and Dir.				
Swell Period				
Surf ($L_b L_w K_s P_s D$)				
Barograph Reading	1007.3	1004.3	1005.6	1006.5
Attached Thermometer	70.0	66.5	74.0	70.5
Observed Reading	1011.2	1009.0	1010.0	1011.9
Total Correction	-5.3	-6.0	-5.7	-6.4

Remarks, Notes, and Miscellaneous Phenomena

Types of air masses and frontal passages determined from synoptic maps, severe storms, miscellaneous hydrometeors, floods

CPK AIR MASS

RW- B 0145 E 0200 RW- B 1745 E 1810

RW- B 0220 E 0245 RW- B 1845 E 1900

R- B 0738 E 0745

RW- B 1200 E 1215

RW- B 1250 E 1345

RW- B 1668 E 1645

Month DECEMBER Day 5 Year 1945

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EXHIBIT 18

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

NAVAER—443-A1 (12-44)

Time entries on this form are 71 th meridian time

To convert { add / subtract } 5 hours

Height of Barometer 35.0 Ft. (MSL)

Certified to be a true copy.
Robert W. Pinegar, Lt

NAVY DEPARTMENT
SURFACE WEATHER OBSERVATIONS
(LAND STATION)
WBAN—10B

Security Classification

Station NAS BANANA RIVER, FLA

Lat. 28° 15' Long. 80° 36'

TYPE (1)	TIME (2)	CLASSIFICATION (3)	CEILING (Hundreds of Feet) (4)	SKY (5)	VISIBILITY (Miles) (6)	WEATHER AND/OR OBSTRUCTIONS TO VISION (7)	SEA-LEVEL PRESSURE (Mbs.) (8)	TEMP. AND DEW PT. (°F) (9)	(10)	WIND DIRECTION (11)	WIND VELOCITY (M. P. H.) (12)	WIND CHARACTER AND SHIFTS (13)	ALTIMETER (Inches) (14)	REMARKS AND SUPPLEMENTAL CODED DATA (For Transmission) (15)	PRES. TEND. (16)	NET 3-HR. CHANGE (Inches) (17)	PRECIP. (Inches) (18)	CLOUDS LOW AMT., TYPE, DIRECTION (19)	LOW HEIGHT (Hnds. of Ft.) (20)	MIDDLE AMT., TYPE, DIRECTION (21)	MIDDLE HEIGHT (Hnds. of Ft.) (22)	HIGH AMT., TYPE, DIRECTION (23)	HIGH HEIGHT (Hnds. of Ft.) (24)	STATION PRESSURE (Inches) (25)	DRY BULB (°F) (26)	WET BULB (°F) (27)	WATER TEMP. (°F) (28)	(29)	OBS. INIT. (30)
5	2145		E30	⊖	8		1009.2	52	46	→	10		979		2	4.4		10 5		OBSCD		OBSCD		1002.9	52.0	49.0			JWP
L	2241		E25	⊖	8		1009.3	51	46	→	12		980					6 5		0		0		1008.0	51.0	48.5			JWP
5	2345			35⊖	8		1009.5	44	43	—	15		980					4 5		0		0		1008.2	49.0	46.0			JWP

U. S. GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE 16—42335-1

Month DECEMBER Day 5 Year 1945

MARK 227

OPERATIONAL TRAINING UNIT

SOUADRON No. 49 BUREAU No. 59225

PBM-3

PRE FLIGHT FORM

The following form will be filled out each day before flight. The plane captain will check each item and will note remarks if items are unsatisfactory. The pilot will satisfy himself that a proper inspection has been made and will sign his acceptance before flight. After each flight the pilot will note all defects observed on discrepancy list.

EXTERIOR

1. Make visual inspection of entire airplane looking for damage, loose parts, security of cowling and unstowed lines and sea anchors.
2. Remove pilot head covers.
3. Clean windows.

INTERIOR

1. Inspect all compartments for loose articles.
2. Check bombing window shutters in closed and locked position.
3. Lock gun turrets and waist guns in " SECURE " position.
4. See that tunnel and tail gun hatches are in place and dogged tightly.
5. Check water supply.

FUEL AND OIL

1. Drain all fuel strainers and purge hull tanks.
2. Check fuel and oil filler caps for security.
3. Check fuel and oil quantities and indicate below.

FUEL (gals.)

Tank	On Board
R. Wing	220
L. Wing	200
FWD	---
Center	270
Aft	1165
R. Bomb Bay	---
L. Bomb Bay	---
	1855

Total

OIL (gals.)

Tank	On Board
Left	63
Right	63
A.P.P.	OK
Servo Oil	---

RUN UP

1. See that chocks are under wheels and brakes locked.
2. Turn auxiliary power unit two revolutions by hand, start and warm up.
3. Operate engine cowl flaps through full travel.
4. Check lighting system, interphone, and radio.
5. Turn both engines over slowly by manual engagement of the starters.
6. Start engines and warm up, leaving cowl flaps open (not over 1000 R.P.M.).
7. With propellers in low pitch (take off position) test both magnetos, on each engine at 1600 R.P.M.
8. Check propellers in manual and automatic.
9. Check oil pressure 80—100lb.
10. Check fuel pressure 6—7lb (15-18 lbs PBM3/D-16½ desired.)
11. Check vacuum pump 3—5" Hg.
12. Check operation of fuel transfer pumps.
13. Unlock all controls.
14. Check controls for full throw and freedom of movement.
15. Bleed gyro pilot system of air by putting controls in full throw positions and holding for one minute (each position).
16. Operate bomb bay doors and check bomb loading.
17. Check flap operation.

(Over)

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 969189

EXHIBIT 14

I certify that this airplane has been inspected under my supervision as above indicated and that the above airplane is ready for flight.

/s/
E. PETERSON
Plane Captain

Lt(jg) PILOTS Jeffrey	CREW AND PASSENGERS	
1. Lt.(jg) H. G. Cone	1. Peterson D.E., AMM1c	1. ZYWICKI, A.J., S1c
2. Ens. R. M. Allen	2. Cargill W.D., S1c	2.
3. Ens. L. A. Eliason	3. Cameron R.C., ARM3c	3.
4. Ens. C. D. Areeneaux	4. Jordan J.F., ARM3c	4.
5.	5. Zappolo V.J., ARM3c	5.
6.	6. Neeman P.B. S1c	6.
7.	7. Menendez J.T., AOM3c	7.
8.	8. Osterheld J.F., AOM3c	8.

I accept this aircraft for flight with the above listed passengers.

~~88 G~~
D-6

/s/
Lt (jg) Jeffrey
Pilot

Time out _____ Time in _____ Total time _____

Bu. No. 59225 Sqdn. No. 49 Date 12-5-45

CERTIFIED TO BE TRUE COPY
Robert A. Lee
Lieut. USN

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

UNITED STATES NAVAL AIR STATION
BANANA RIVER, FLORIDA
VPB2 #3

1 February 1945

MAINTENANCE DEPARTMENT ORDER NO. 6-45.

Subj: Smoking in Aircraft.

Ref: (a) Maint. Dept. Order No. 1-45 dated 4 Jan. 1945.
(b) Aviation Circular Letter No. 4-45 dated 19 January 1945.

1. This order supercedes and cancels reference (a); reference (b) is quoted in part for compliance by personnel in this unit.

2. Smoking in naval aircraft is forbidden under the following conditions:

(a) During fueling operations, including transfer and jettisoning.
(b) During and immediately after take-off.
(c) Immediately before and during landing.
(d) Whenever any gas fumes are detected in the aircraft.
(e) During all ground and water operations and within fifty (50) feet of any aircraft on the ramp.
(f) In the bomb bay, fuselage or hull compartments which contain gasoline tanks.
(g) In any compartment where cargo of an inflamable or explosive nature is aboard.
(h) During inspection of plane compartments wherein gas fumes may have collected.
(i) Whenever oxygen equipment is in use.

3. In aircraft where fuselage or hull tanks are installed, smoking shall be permitted in compartments adjacent to the fuel tank compartments only when all doors and ports of such compartments are secured.

4. Compliance with the above shall be the responsibility of the pilot in command of the aircraft, who is empowered to prohibit smoking at anytime or in any part of the aircraft when he deems such action necessary.

5. Plane Captains will be responsible tosee that the following notice is posted in a conspicuous place on a bulkhead in each aircraft of this unit and that all personnel aboard are cognizant of these regulations:

NO SMOKING

EXCEPT BY PERMISSION OF PILOT IN COMMAND, AND THEN ONLY WHEN AIRCRAFT IS IN FLIGHT, AND THEN ONLY ON FLIGHT DECK AND IN FORWARD COMPARTMENT WITH HATCHES SECURED.

Submitted:

W. WEEKS
Lt. Comdr. U.S.N.
Maintenance Officer.

Approved:

L. B. NICHOLSON
Lt. Comdr. U.S.N.
Executive Officer.

CERTIFIED TO BE A TRUE COPY.
Lt. Col. USA

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

"EXHIBIT 15"

CERTIFIED TO BE A TRUE COPY.

A. S. Roberts
Lt. Cdr. USN

" EXHIBIT 16 "

EXHIBIT 16
BOARD OF INVESTIGATION
U. S. NAVAL AIR STATION
MIAMI, FLORIDA
10 DECEMBER 1945

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

RAAM 231

84° 82° 80° 78° 76°

CHARLESTON

5 DECEMBER 1945

JACKSONVILLE

2180 R. MAYPORT
DUMBO UP ABOUT 9TH

ST. AUGUSTINE

HEADED FOR NEW SMYRNA

DAYTONA DUMBO UP 1827
ON 24.29.7.1 HOURLY

1821 R. LAST NP/OP FIX
79°00 - 29°15'

TR. 32 SA. SCH.
DAYTONA DUMBO

TR. 60

TR. 32.7.1 HRS.

TR. 32 @ 1820
TR. 43 @ 1927
TR. 60 @ 2135

4 BAND-PLANES
SEARCHED 28.1 HRS

INVESTIGATE FLARES

150 M. NORTH

1 PLANE UP 1845

VERO BEACH

VERO DUMBO 6.1 HRS.

150 M. EAST

CT 4805 KCS

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 963189

78° 76° 74° 72° 70°

33°

32°

5 DECEMBER 1945

30°

CVE [illegible] LEADER AREA
FOR 6 PARA/FIGS

221 R. LAST NP/OF PIX
9°00 -23°15'

ESTIGATE FLARES

150 M. NORTH

150 M. EAST

T. 480 S KCS

28°

CHART 233

TR. 32 SA. SCH. DAYTONA DUMBO

TR. 32 F 1920
TR. 49 F 1927
TR. 60 F 2235

TR. 32. 7.1 HRS.

TR. 60

CAPE CANAVERAL

4 BAN. R PLANES SEARCHED 28.1 HRS.

INVESTIGATE FLARES

150 M. NORTH

TAMPA

1 PLANE UP 1845

VERO BEACH

VERO DUMBO 6.1 HRS.

150 M. EAST

NOTES ON 5 TBM'S
LOST 5 DECEMBER 1945
SWEET 1, 5, DECEMBER 1945

1820 D.R. PLANE TO EST. R.D.O CONTACT 4405 KCS.
150 MILES 045 T

JUPITER

WEST PALM BEACH

FT. LAUDERDALE

1845 C.G.A.S. O.K.
ALERTED 2 PLANES
11.6 HRS.

MIAMI

BOCA CHICA

DECLASSIFIED

NARA 234

TIGATE FLARES

150 M. NORTH

150 M. EAST

4805 KCS

28°

26°

24°

5-DECEMBER-1945.

"EXHIBIT 16"

DECLASSIFIED

CERTIFIED TO BE A TRUE COPY.

S. G. Perrell
LT(JG) USCG.

"EXHIBIT 17"

EXHIBIT 17
BOARD OF INVESTIGATION
U. S. NAVAL AIR STATION
MIAMI, FLORIDA
10 DECEMBER 1945

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

NARA 296

84° 82° 80° 78°

CHARLESTON

6 DECEMBER 1945

31°00'N

3RD AAF & ORLANDO S. TO 27:00 N.

3RD AAF SEARCH

JACKSONVILLE

N.A.S. JAX
26 PLANES OUT 349.7 HRS. total

N.A.S. JAX PBY'S
+ AUX 70 PLANES IN AREA
MORNING AND AFTERNOON.

EXTENSION SOLOMON'S AREA
For 7TH

3RD AAF SEARCH
10 PLANES SARASOTA
& MEDILL S.S. HRS AV.

ST. AUGUSTINE

JAX
3 SNJ'S 4 SNB'S
CECIL FLD.
20.05 DEC'S.

MAYPORT
DUMBO

N.A.S. JAX
8 SNJ'S

N.A.S. JAX.
20 F4U'S
5 SNJ'S

SOLOMONS
+ ESCORTS
40 PLANES

MEDILL H. L 5'S
2 MTH 25.3 HRS.

DAYTONA BEACH

PONCE DE LEON INLET

C.G.A.S. ST. PETE
2 PBM - 10 HRS.

7.8 HRS
DAYTONA DUMBO
MORRISON FIELD
2 PLANES
CAT-PBY - 16.3 HRS

CAPE CANAVERAL

BANANA RIVER
11 PLANES 86.3 HRS.

TAMPA

VERO BEACH

VERO
DUMBO
2 PLANE 8.1 HRS

56.6 HRS.
3D AAF + ORLANDO
N TO 31°00 N 60 PLANES
B17'S, A26'S, A-31'S, P47'S

MORRISON
A.T.G.
1 C47 1 - PBY
16 HRS - 15 MINS.

DECLASSIFIED

78°

76°

74°

72°

70°

33°

32°

30°

28°

6 DECEMBER 1945

SOLOMON'S AREA
7TH

SOLOMONS
+ ESCORTS
NO PLANES

ANA RIVER
ES 86.3 HRS.

MERRILL
A.T.G.

1 C47 1 PBY
16 HRS 15 MINS

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

RIVER
86.3 HRS.

MORRISON
A.T.C.

1 C-47 1 PBY
16 HRS. 15 MINS.

28°

26°

24°

OAK FIELD R.A.F.
6 HRS. 30 MINS. BY SKY TRAIN.

6 DECEMBER 1945 L.D.M.

EXHIBIT "A"

CERTIFIED TO BE A TRUE COPY.

S. G. Ferrell
18(16) USCG

EXHIBIT 16

EXHIBIT 16
BOARD OF INVESTIGATION
U. S. NAVAL AIR STATION
MIAMI, FLORIDA
10 DECEMBER 1945

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

AARA 241

84° 82° 80° 78° 76°

CHARLESTON S.C.

N.A.S. JAX. + AUX FIELDS
TOT. 54 PLANES A.M. & P.M.
309.75 HRS.

N.A.S. MAYPORT 9 PLANES TOT. 49.1 HRS

N.A.S. JAX — UP0755 54.1 HRS.
10 S.N.J. 6

N.A.S. JAX 15 F4U¹ UP 0755 R 75.9 HRS.

CECIL FLD. 35 SB2 C's UP0705 92 HRS

BANANA RIVER
9 PBM - 3 PBY 114.6 HR.

CVE SOLOMONS PLANES
9 FLIGHTS 18.1 HRS.

SOLOMONS + ESCORTS
8 M. INTERVAL

NAS
JAX PBY
5 PBY 42.5 HRS.

JACKSONVILLE

St Augustine

ORLANDO AAF

BOCA RATON B 17's
3 PLANES 36.7 HOURS

N.A.S. MIAMI
8 PBY's USED 50 HRS.

DAYTONA
DUMBO
9 HRS 32 Min

NAS
MIAMI
PBM

Daytona Beach

Ponce de Leon Inlet

A.T.C. MORRISON
2 PBY
19.5 HOURS

CAPE CANAVERAL

3rd AAF

BANANA RIVER
14 PLANES
130.1 HOURS

TAMPA

Vero Beach

McD. Fl. AAF
16 PLANES
SEARCHING 18 HRS.

N.A.S. FT. LAUD. Total
46 PLANES 164 HRS 58 MINS.

VERO BEACH
DUMBO
1 PLANE 6.5 HRS.

C.G.A.S. MIAMI
2 PLANES 17.4 HRS.

Jupiter

C.G.A.S. ST PETE

NARA 242

78° 76° 74° 73°

33°

32°

30°

28°

7 DECEMBER 1945

...NANA RIVER
- 3 PBY 11¼ HR.

...LOMONS PLANES
-LIGHTS 18.1 HRS.

...MONS 4 ESCORTS
...M. INTERVAL

...S. MIAMI
...SED. 50 HRS.

DAYTONA
DUMBO
9 HRS 32 MIN

NAS
JAX PBY
3 PBY 42.5 HRS.

NAS
MIAMI
PBM

BAN. R.
3 PBM
1 PBY

BAN R.
3 to 4 PBY's

VERO BEACH
DUMBO
1 PLANE 6.5 HRS.

C.G.A.S. MIAMI
2 PLANES 17.4 HRS.

NARA 243

3rd AAF

TAMPA

BANANA RIVER
14 PLANES
130.1 HOURS

CAPE CANAVERAL

A.T.C. MORRISON
2 PBY
19.5 HOURS

NAS
MIAMI
PBM

Vero Beach

McD. FLD. AAF
6 PLANES
SEARCHING 18 HRS.

N.A.S. FT. LAUD, Total
46 PLANES 164 HRS 58 MINS.

VERO BEACH
DUMBO
1 PLANE 6.5 HRS.

C.G.A.S. MIAMI
2 PLANES 17.4 HRS.

Jupiter

West Palm Beach

C.G.A.S. ST. PETE
2 P.B.M. 14.8 HRS.

BAHAMA ISLAND

MIAMI A.T.C.
B-17
6 HRS.

McDILL CENTERED SEARCH
4 L-5s 2 AT-11s 1 B-17
25.1 HRS.

Ft Lauderdale

Miami

N.A.S. KEY WEST
2 F6F, 2 SNB'S

BOCA CHICA DUMBO
6.9 HRS.

R.A.F. NASAU 7.5 HRS. BY
SKYTRAIN.

BOCA CHICA 15 TBM's (7.2 HRS. EA.)
KEY WEST DUMBO

ANDROS ISLAND

DECLASSIFIED

NARA 24

MIAMI
PBM

28°

VERO BEACH
DUMBO
1 PLANE 6.5 HRS.

C.G.A.S. MIAMI
2 PLANES 17.4 HRS.

MIAMI AIC
B 17
6 HRS.

26°

R.A.F. NASAU 7.5 HRS BY
SKYTRAIN.

24°

7 DECEMBER 1945 C.C.C.

"EXHIBIT 18"

DECLASSIFIED

CERTIFIED TO BE A TRUE COPY.

S. G. Ford

Lt(JG) USCG.

"EXHIBIT 19"

EXHIBIT 19
BOARD OF INVESTIGATION
U. S. NAVAL AIR STATION
MIAMI, FLORIDA
10 DECEMBER 1945

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

84° 83° 82° 81° 80° 79° 78° 77° 76

33

32°

CHARLESTON

CHARLESTON
DUMBO

8 DECEMBER 1945

MAYPORT 12 SNB'S
2 JRF'S 6 SNJ'S.
52 NAS.

0618 DIR 7 PBM
SQ. SCH. 10 HRS.

JACKSONVILLE
NAS-JAX 104 PLANES
293.8 HOURS. TOTAL

18 SNJ'S

SOLOMONS
PLANES
8 FLIGHTS
39 HRS.

30°

ST AUGUSTINE

NAS JAX LAND PLANES
30 PLANES F4U'S 177.6 HRS.

DAYTONA BEACH

PONCE DE LEON INLET

DAYTONA DUMBO
14.1 HRS

BANANA RIVER
15 PLANES
118 HRS.

CECIL FIELD
30 SNB 2 C'S
64 HOURS

CAPE CANAVERAL

BANANA R.
4 SNB'S
9 HR 20 M.

C.G.A.S. ST PETE
3 PLANES 24.8 HRS.

BANANA
RIVER
4 JRS
2 HR 48 M.

28°

TAMPA

TAMPA 2 PLANES
5.5 HOURS.

VERO JUMBO 6.5 HRS.

AAF
MORRISON
PBY- B17
18. HRS.

VERO BEACH
2 PLANES 14.5 HRS.

78° 77° 76 75 74 73 72 71 70

33 33

32° 32

8 DECEMBER 1945

C^VE SOLOMONS
(2 PBMs)

4 PBM

JAX NAS
6 PBY'S
APPROX. 60 HRS.

C.G.A.S.
DINNER KEY
2 PBM.
23.1 HOURS

BANANA R.
6 PBMs
63.6 HRS.

ATC
MORRISTOWN
2 C-7
BOAT CARRYING
2 PLANES
177 HRS

NAS Miami
OPA-LAKA
3 PLANES
30 HRS.

30° 30

28° 28

AAF
MORRISON
PBY- B-17
18. HRS.

AAF
BOCA RATON
5 - B-17's
2 - B-24's
46 HRS. 15 MIN.

AAF
ORLANDO
3 - B-29's
2 - B-17's
31.9 HOURS

NARA 248

DAYTONA BEACH

PONCE DE LEON INLET

DAYTONA DUMBO
14.1 HRS

BANANA RIVER
15 PLANES
118 HRS.

CECIL FIELD
30 SB2 C's
64 HOURS

CAPE CANAVERAL

BANANA RIVER
4 SNB's
9 HR 20 M.

C.G.A.S. ST. PETE
3 PLANES 24.8 HRS

BANANA RIVER
2 JRS
2 HR 48 M.

28°

TAMPA

TAMPA 2 PLANES
5.5 HOURS.

VERO DUMBO 6.5 HRS.

AAF
MORRISON
PBY- B17
18. HRS.

VERO BEACH
2 PLANES 14.5 HRS.

C.G.A.S. ST. PETE
2 PLANES 16.9 HRS.

JUPITER

NAVAL AIR STA.

NAS
FT. LAUDERDALE

LOCAL AREA SEARCH
15 PLANES 59.8 HRS

26°

MIAMI

KEY WEST

BOCA CHICA

24°

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NARA 249

23.1 HOURS

63.6 HRS.

180

ATC
MORRISTOWN
B-17
BOAT CARRYING
2 PLANES
17.7 HRS

NAS Miami
OPA-LAKA
3 PLANES
5.0 HRS.

28°

28

AAF
MORRISON
PBY- B-17
18. HRS.

AAF
BOCA RATON
5 - B-17's
2 - B-24's
4 G HRS. 16 MIN.

AAF
ORLANDO
3 - B 29's
2 - B 17's
31.9 HOURS

PETE
16.9 HRS.

26°

26

R.A.F.
SKYTRAIN
13 HRS.
IN
AREA

24°

24

"EXHIBIT 19"
8th of December '45

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CERTIFIED TO BE A TRUE COPY.

1st Lt USA

"EXHIBIT 20"

EXHIBIT 20
BOARD OF INVESTIGATION
US NAVAL AIR STATION
MIAMI, FLORIDA
10 DECEMBER 1945

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

NARA 231

84° 83° 82° 81° 80° 79° 78° 77° 76°

CHARLESTON

NAS CECIL FD. 30 - SB 2C's 60 HRS.

NAS JAX 30 FAU-S

NAS JAX 30 PLANES 178.1 HRS.

NAS MAYPORT 12 SNB'S 33.2 HRS

NAS JAX & AUX 90 PLANES 2 HRS 15 MIN. TOTALS

JACKSONVILLE

ST. AUGUSTINE

DAYTONA BEACH

PONCE DE LEON INLET

BANANA R. TOTALS 17 PLANES 143 HRS. 25 MINS.

CAPE CANAVERAL

MC DILL AAF 11 PLANES 94 HOURS

TAMPA

BANANA R. PLANES & HRS 3.6 HR

SNO's 26.8 HRS.

FT. LAUD 2 - SNB's

VERO BEACH

MC DILL AAF

BANANA R. NAS 2 PB M's SQ. SCH. 22.1 HRS.

DAYTONA DUMBO 4 PLANE 10.1 HRS

VERO DUMBO 8.6 HRS.

C.G.A.S. ST. PETE 1 PLANE 12. 5 HRS

9 DECEMBER 1945

DECLASSIFIED

78° 77° 76° 75° 74° 73° 72° 71° 70°

33

32

9 DECEMBER 1945

CVE SOLOMONS
8 PLANES, 20 FLIGHTS
46.3 HOURS*

N.A.S. JAX 6 PLANES.

TONA DUMBO
LANE 10.1 HRS

NAS
BANANA RIVER
9 PLANES
120.9 HRS.

NAS MIAMI
OPA - LOCKA
8 PLANES - PBAY'S
80 HRS.

30

28

C. G. A. S.
ST. PETE
1 PLANE
13 E HRS

AAF
BOCA RATON
5 PLANES B17'S
55 HOURS

AAF
ORLANDO SUPERDUMBO
2 B 17'S & 2 B 29'S
41 HRS 10 MIN

DAYTONA BEACH

PONCE DE LEON INLET

BANANA R. TOTALS
17 PLANES
143 HRS. 25 MINS.

CAPE CANAVERAL

MS DILL AAF
11 PLANES
44 HOURS

TAMPA

BANANA R.
PLANES 7
HRS 3.6 HR

SNO'S
26.8
HRS.

FT. LAUD
2 - SNBS

VERO BEACH

VERO DUMBO
8.6 HRS.

C. G. A. S.
ST. PETE
1 PLANE
13 HRS

MS DILL AAF
2 AT-11
6.6 HRS.

JUPITER

FT. LAUD. NAS 24 PLANES 64 HRS.

FT. LAUDERDALE

MIAMI

KEY WEST

BOCA CHICA

DECLASSIFIED

NARA 254

NAS
BANANA RIVER
9 PLANES
120.9 HRS.

NAS Miami
CPA - LOCKA
8 PLANES - PBAY'S
80 HRS.

C. G. A. S.
ST. PETE
1 PLANE
13.5 HRS.

AAF
BOCA RATON
5 PLANES B17's
5.5 HOURS

AAF
ORLANDO SUPERDUMBO
2 - B 17's & 2 B 29's
41 HRS. 10 MIN

MIAMI
ATC
7.8 HRS.

MORRISON
ATC
1 PLANE
8.4 HRS.

4 HRS.

23

26

24

9 DECEMBER 1 "EXHIBIT "20"

CERTIFIED TO BE A TRUE COPY.

S. G. Pruett

~~Lt~~ (JG) USCG.

" EXHIBIT 21 "

EXHIBIT 21
BOARD OF INVESTIGATION
US NAVAL AIR STATION
MIAMI, FLORIDA
10 DECEMBER 1945

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

NARA 236

84° 82° 80° 78° 76°

CHARLESTON

10 DECEMBER 1945

JACKSONVILLE

NAS.
BAN. R. 2 PBM'S SEARCHED
EXPANDING SR. 17 HRS. 50 MIN.

ST AUGUSTINE

DAYTON BEACH

PONCE DE LEON

CAPE CANAVERAL

NAS. BAN. R. DAYS
TOTAL 16 PLANES
121 HRS. 47 MINS.
BAN. R. SND. HNS. 4.5 HRS.

TAMPA

VERA BEACH

N.A.S. JAX.
20 PLANES
124 HRS. 40 MIN

2829's
2817's
1025
ORLANDO AAF
20 HRS. 35 MINS.

BOCA RATON AAF
2 B-24's
6 B-17's
52 HRS. 15 MINS.

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NARA 257

78°
76°
74°
72°
70°
33°
32°
31°
30°
28°

CVE Salamons + ESCORTS
16 TBM'S SEARCHED
48.5 HOURS.

NAS
BAN. R. 4 PBY'S
33 HRS. 16 MINS.

ZB29'S
2017'S
1025
ORLANDO AAF
20 HRS. 35 MINS.

N.A.S. JAX.
20 PLANES
124 HRS. 40 MIN

BOCA RATON AAF
2 B-24S
6 B-17S
52 HRS. 15 MINS.

MASTER FIELD
NAS Miami
8 PBY'S
55 HRS. 15 MINS.

NAS
BAN. R. 8 PBM'S
66 HRS. 11 MINS.

NARA 258

20 PLANES
124 HRS. 40 MIN

BOCA RATON AAF
2 B-24S
6 B-17S
52 HRS. 15 MINS.

CAPE CANAVERAL

NAS. BAN. R. DAYS
TOTAL 16 PLANES
121 HRS. 47 MINS.
BAN. R. SNB. HNS. 4.8 HRS.

TAMPA

VERA BEACH

JUPITER

WEST PALM BEACH

FT. LAUDERDALE

MIAMI

KEY WEST

BOCA CHICA

DECLASSIFIED

124 HRS. 40 MINS

DOCA RATON AAF
2 B-24's
6 B-17's
52 HRS. 15 MINS

MASTER FIELD
NAS Miami
8 PB4Y's
55 HRS. 15 MINS.

NAS
BAN. R. 8 PBM's
66 HRS. 11 MINS.

28°

26°

24°

10 DECEMBER 1945

WTP
EXHIBIT 21

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Hdqtrs, District Coast Guard Officer
SEVENTH Naval District
duPont Building, Miami, Florida

RESCUE PLAN, DCGO-7, NO. 1-45

TASK ORGANIZATION

(a) 03.3.1 Rescue Task Group - DISTRICT COAST GUARD OFFICER

03.3.11 Air Sea Rescue Task Unit at CGAS Miami

Sub-unit - Deputy Air Sea Rescue Task Unit, Boca Chica

03.3.13 Air Sea Rescue Task Unit at CGAS St. Petersburg

03.3.14 Air Sea Rescue Task Unit at Banana River

(b) 03.3.50 Group Commanders - DISTRICT COAST GUARD OFFICER

03.3.51 Commander Fort Pierce Group

03.3.52 Commander Port Everglades Group

03.3.53 Commander Miami Group

03.3.54 Commander Key West Group

03.3.55 Commander Tampa Group

1. STATUS AND ASSUMPTIONS

(a) Responsibility for rescue and salvage operations within the waters of the Gulf Sea Frontier is vested in the Commander, Gulf Sea Frontier. This responsibility has been delegated to the Commandants of the Seventh and Eighth Naval Districts, which districts comprise the Gulf Sea Frontier. The Commandant, Seventh Naval District, by 7ND Operation Plan 1-45, dated 26 September 1945, has directed the District Coast Guard Officer, 7ND, to direct the operations of the Seventh Naval District rescue organization insofar as is practicable.

(b) Aircraft, surface craft, and the crews and passengers thereof will, from time to time, require emergency assistance.

2. COMMAND MISSION

(a) This force will:

(1) Maintain positive and rapid communications with all rescue facilities within the Seventh Naval District.

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EXHIBIT 22"

(2) Receive, evaluate, and promptly disseminate distress information, initiating such rescue action as is indicated.

(3) Be cognizant of the operating status of all radio and radar navigational aids within the Seventh Naval District.

(4) Promptly provide emergency navigational assistance when so requested.

(5) Maintain liaison with all operating units within the Seventh Naval District to ensure thorough indoctrination of personnel in the use of survival equipment and in proper air-sea rescue procedures.

(6) Ensure that subordinate commands maintain their rescue craft in a state of constant readiness insofar as is practicable.

(7) Notify nearby merchant marine vessels and direct them to scene of action to assist insofar as practicable.

3. TASK UNIT MISSIONS

(a) AIR-SEA RESCUE TASK UNIT AT CGAS MIAMI

Sub-unit - Deputy Air-Sea Rescue Task Unit, Boca Chica

(1) Initiate immediate rescue action with equipment available when informed of any crash or casualty and notify the District Coast Guard Officer of action taken.

(2) Maintain assigned boats, planes, and equipment in a state of constant readiness.

(3) Maintain a program of training which will ensure that assigned personnel are highly efficient in all phases of search and rescue operations.

(4) Cooperate with others in the interest of achieving the utmost efficiency in rescue operations.

(b) AIR-SEA RESCUE TASK UNIT AT CGAS ST. PETERSBURG

Provisions of 3(a) above apply.

(c) AIR SEA RESCUE TASK UNIT AT BANANA RIVER

Provisions of 3(a) above apply.

(d) COMMANDER FORT PIERCE GROUP

Provisions of 3(a) above apply.

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(e) COMMANDER PORT EVERGLADES GROUP

Provisions of 3(a) above apply.

(f) COMMANDER MIAMI GROUP

Provisions of 3(a) above apply.

(g) COMMANDER KEY WEST GROUP

Provisions of 3(a) above apply.

(h) COMMANDER TAMPA GROUP

Provisions of 3(a) above apply.

(X) (1) This plan effective on receipt.

(2) The senior officer present on the scene shall be the officer in tactical command unless another officer is designated by the District Coast Guard Officer.

(3) All subordinate commands are directed to initiate prompt and effective action in the case of nearby vessels, aircraft, or persons requiring assistance and to advise their next superior of the incident and the action taken.

4. LOGISTICS

(a) All vessels and aircraft refuel and provision at nearest base as necessary. Maintain state of readiness as prescribed by unit command.

5. GENERAL PROVISIONS

(a) Communications in accordance with current Gulf Sea Frontier communications plan.

(b) Time Zone: Use Eastern Standard Time (ROGER), Zone Plus Five, and so state in body of dispatches.

(c) "Command" for operations is District Coast Guard Officer, 7ND, under Commander Gulf Sea Frontier and Commandant, 7ND.

(d) Command Headquarters: The District Coast Guard Office, SEVENTH Naval District, maintains Headquarters in the Alfred I. duPont Building, Miami, Florida.

J. E. WHITBECK
Commodore, U. S. Coast Guard
District Coast Guard Officer
SEVENTH Naval District

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DISTRIBUTION
CNO (5)
CINCLANT (5)
COMAIRLANT (5)
COMFAIRSHIPS LANT (5)
COMDT USCG (10)
COMGULFSEAFRON (5)
COMEASTSEAFRON (5)
COMCARIBSEAFRON (5)
COMPASEAFRON (5)
COMWESTSEAFRON (5)
COM SIX (2)
COM SEVEN (2)
COM EIGHT (2)
COM TEN (2)
COM FIFTEEN (2)
CG, THIRD AIR FORCE (5)
CNAOTC, Jacksonville (5)
DCGO 6 (2)
DCGO 8 (2)
DCGO 10 (2)
NAS Miami (5)
NAS Richmond (5)
NAS Banana River (5)
NAS Key West (5)
CGAS Miami (5)
DASRTU, Boca Chica (5)
ASRTU, Banana River (5)
CGAS, St. Petersburg (5)
CGG, Ft. Pierce (6)
CGG, Pt. Everglades (4)
CGG, Miami (6)
CGG Key West (15)
CGG Tampa (6)

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NAVCG 2614 A
U. S. COAST GUARD

RADIO LOG HOUMA, LA RADIO D/F STATION NLP Date 5 DECEMBER, 1945

TIME	JONES, CRM ON WATCH ENTRIES 500 AND 8280 KC	FREQ
2105	LAST ENTRY	
10	WLO WLO DE HRCO HRCO QTC	500
13	PCH PCH DE PCPJ	8280
14	WLO CLOSED K HR CL W 468	500
17	BUSY ALERT LR1	
22	BSI WID LR1 ALERT	
28	DE NOY NOY K / KDUK WAX 425 K	500
30	KDUK WAX QRK K	500
32	WNU DE ANPV ANPV BT QTC K	500
35	WANA/ DE JQTC QSW 468	500
36	WNU VN PV ANPV ANPV QTC	500
36	WNU DE ANUB ANUB QTC AR K	500
38	NOQ NOQ QSW 425 ANS 425	500
40	WNU DE ANPV BT QTC K	500
45	FROM ZE ALERT - MONITOR 4805 FOR FT 28	
47	ALERTED NET FT28 HRD ON 4805	4805
52	BUSY WID DAB OP	
57	TI TAYLOR BUSY WID DAB OP	
2202	MONITORING	4805
07	MONITORING VARIOUS A3	4805
12	FT 28 UP7	4805
17	JONES CRM RELEIVED BY GLEASON RM3C LP7 IN EFFECT ON FT28 AND FT74	
	E JONES	
18	WL HAVE TO LAND ON WATER UNLESS LANDFALL	4805
22	NHA3 TI FT28	4805
25	TI NHA3 SHIFT TO 3000	4805
29	STRONG CARRIER NO MODULATION	4805
34	BUSY WITH DAB OP	
39	BUSY WITH DAB OP	
46	NHA3 CALLING FT28 WHILE FT28 IS WORKING	4805
49	FT28 V NHA3 K	4805
51	BUSY TWPL	
55	NHA3 TI FT28 I CANNOT CHANGE MY FREQUENCY I MUST KEEP MY PLANES INTACT/	4805
2300	MONITORING 4805 NIL HRD	4805
02	WE MAY HAVE TO DITCH AN I MINUTE	
07	BUSY WITH DAB OP	
13	BUSY WITH DAB OP	
17	WHAT CBURSE ARE WE ON - AFFIRMATIVE IM PRETTY SURE WE OVER GULF WE DIDNT GO FAR ENUF EAST - SUGGEST WE FLY DUE EAST UNTIL WE RUN OUT OF GAS WE HAVE BTR CANCE OF BEING PICKED UP (EOM)	4805
22	NOTHING HRD	
27	BUSY WITH DAB OP	
32	VUSY WITH DAB OP	

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(OVER)

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EXHIBIT "23"

TIME	ENTRIES	
2332		
37	WHAT COURSE ARE WE ON NOW	48#5
42	MONITORING NIL HEARD	48#5
47	MONITORING NIL HEARD	48#5
52	DITTO	
57	A3 HRD NO CONNECTION LP7	48#5
2400	END OF DAY	

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NAVCG 2614 A
U. S. COAST GUARD

RADIO LOG CG HF/DF STA. HOUMAN LA. Date 6 DECEMBER, 1945

TIME	ENTRIES
0000	GLEASON, KM3C ON WATCH GUARDING 8280 & 4805
05	BRI ON 4805
10	BSI ON 4805
15	BSI ON 4805
20	EAV EAV EAV DE EAAP EAAP EAAP EAAP EAAP EAV EAV EAV DE EAAP EAAP
	EAAP ---- QRM 8280
25	LP LPD LPD LPD LPD DE LOIC LOIC LOIC LOIC QTC K/ 8280
30	NO RDBLE SIGS
35	NO SIGS
40	VVVVV P --- STDY PPR PPR
42	WSL WSL DE KFEN KFEN KFEN K/
44	WSL DE KFEN KFEN KFEN QTC AR/
49	PPR NP HOOE MRU TOI PPR QRU IMI K/
53	EAV EAV KEIL AR/ EAV EAV LICK/
55	STDY 85 NOTE UP
58	KXKC DE NBA NBA QSY --- BLOCKED QRM
0103	CQ CQ CQ DE LLRL -- HEAVY QRM UNR SIGS
04	BGVA BGVA -- QRM --
06	NBA NBA NBA -- QRM
08	NBA NBA NBA DE WQUU WQUU WQUU BT QTC 2 QTC 2 QSW 8300 AR K
09	WSL WSL WSL DE KOZI KOZI Z --
14	WVP DE ANSE AS/
18	WSL DE KWOH K/
23	NO RDBLE SIGS (QRM5)
25	WSL WSL --- BLOCKED QRM
26	KFS KFS DE ----- KFS KFS KFS KFS KFS KFS V V V V (TESTER)
30	WSL WSL WSL WSL DE KHNH KHNH KHNV WSL WSL KHNV WSL KHNV KHNV KHNV
34	WSL WSL KVEN KVEN QTC AR K/
40	MONITORING 500 KCS FOR POSSIBLE SOS
45	NO RDBLE SIGS (QRM5)
50	KFS KFS KFS KFS KFS KFS DE KWTD KWTD BT QTC AR/
52	XXX XXX FROM WAX ON 500 KCS REGARDING LOST PLANES (LP7)
	EXPL LEGING FLAMES 100 FEET HEIH UNERNG MINUTES
	IMI POSITIO KUCL SENDING MSG
0225	BUSY ON 500 TAKING BRNGS ON KUCL
32	NBA NBA NBA DE WQGM WQGM WQGM QRU IMI QRU NIL QSA IMI AR K/
36	STDY 85 NOTE UP/ WCC DE ANSA K/
38	WCC WCC DE ANSA ANSA K/
40	KFS KFS DE --- BLOCKED QRM
	HR NR 1 03 IMI 03 IS LZ LESGH VICTORY G ----- QRM --- MMT 6 BT LYKES
	BROS IMI LYKES MASTER 1 VICTORY LLACE NEW YORK BT AESIGH VI IMI
45	LESIGH VICTORY ----- DECEMBER 7 IMI 7 BREPM BT QST AR --- (QRM4)
46	WCC DE ANSA K/
50	BQ BAN BAN DE PND AND URGENT QTC K/
51	NBA NBA NBA NBA NBA DE ANND AND QTC AR K/
52	WSL WSL V WQIV WQIV QRU IMI /
53	FTL --- WSV WVO WVO DE VOO DE KORH KORH KORH KORH KOR QTC QTC ANS
	8280 K/ WVO WVO WVO WVO DE KORH KORH KORH QTC ANS 8280 KCS K/
58	AN DE BAOK K/ (QTR QTR DE NBA TO ANND

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(OVER)

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TIME	ENTRIES
	GLEASON, RM3C ON WATCH GUARDING 8280 4895 KCS
0258	LAST ENTRY
0300	G MO MO MO (NO SINE)
05	WTN WT WO WO WO MO TWO (NO SIGN)
10	NO RIBBLE SIGS
15	NO RIBBLE SIGS
19	STEADY S5 NOTE UP/
22	EAV EAV EAV EAV DE EAAL EAAL EAAL ETC /
27	STDY SIGS STILL UP
32	SAME AS ABOVE
37	EAV2 EAV2 EAV2 DE EAFA EAFA AR K /
38	WVP WVP WVP WVP DE ANRU ANRU ANRU
39	NBA DE VGVG VG BT QSW 7470 KCS K/
40	WVP WVP WVP WVP DE ANRU ANRU ANRU GS 4255 4255 AR/
45	KEIL KEIL KEIL KEIL EAVA EAVA EALK EALK DE EAFA EAFA QRK IMI AR K/
50	NBA NBA NBA DE ANNV ANNV ANNV ANNV FNBA V NBA QRK IMI 36
55	NO RIBBLE SIGS
0400	WSL VVVVVVV WSL WSL WSL DE SKBA SKBA WSL WSL WSL AR K/
03	WSL DE SKBA WSL WSL WSL WSL DE SKBA WKBA
05	ANNV DE NBA WA MAN K /
WVP WVP	WVP DE ANRU ANRU ANRU 4255AR/
WVP WVP	WVP DE ANRU ANRU QRK QRK QRK/
13	WVP WVP WVP DE ANVF ANVF QTC AR K/
15	EAV2 EAV2 EAV2 EAV2 ---- FADED
19	WVP WVP DE ANRU ANRU --- BEPEEN -- QRM BLOCKING/
22	IF 7396 BASH F COMMA CAN CDENR 1 R R K/
23	WSL DE KK - GM QRK IMI
25	WCC WCC DE ANNU ANNU ANNU QRK IMI K
26	WCC DE ANNU HVC LISTEN 8320 AS
30	KFS KFS KFS KFS KFS ETC / (TESTER)
35	WCC WCC DE KVIY KVIY QRU IMI K /
37	WCC DE KVIY KVIY QRU IMI K /
40	WCC DE KVIY KVIY KVIY QRU IMI K /
43	DE KVIY QRU IMI K /
48	NO SIGS RELEIVED BY ZANNELLA RM3C /SGLEASON RM3C
52	LANNELLA RM3C ON WATCH
54	WSL WSL WSL DE KOIK KOIK KOIK K
55	IMI DE WSL WSL WSL // WSL WSL WSL DE KKDG KKDG KKDG // QRM
57	WSL WSL DE KKDO KKDO KKDO //
	WSL WSL DE KKDO KKDO KKDO BT WAT WAT WAS POSN IN UR BAMS2A
0500	060238Z -- K
02	WSL WSL DE KKDO KKDO 37N 72 W K
07	WEAK SIGS -- HEAVY QRM
10	WSL WSL WSL --- UNR
14	NBA NBA NBA DE // WSL WSL WSL DE // QRM BLOCKED OUR XM TUNING
19	WEAK SIGS UNR
21	WVP WVP WVP DE ANRU NRU ANRU QTC QTC K
22	WSL WSL WSL DE KONH KONM KONH BT TFC QRM IMI K
24	WSL WSL WSL DE KONH KONM KONH PSE QSV QSV ON 8290 K

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NAVCG 2614 A
U. S. Coast Guard

RADIO LOG USCG HF/DF STA HOUMA LA Date 06 DECEMBER, 1945

TIME	ENTRIES
0524	ZANNELLA RM3C CONT WATCH LAST ENTRY
27	DE ANLA BT B HOW ABOUT 8300 IMI K
28	WVP WVP WVP DE ANRU ANRU ANRU QTC K
33	LPD LPD LPD
38	WVP WVP WVP DE ANRU ANRU QTC K
43	WVP WVP WVP DE ANRU ANRU ANRU QTC AR K
48	PROSEGUIRE FINO BUENOS AIRES DOVE SARENO -- QRM
52	WVP WVP WVP DE ANRU ANRU ANRU QTC AR K
	RELEIVED BY WALLACE RM1C
	ZANNELLA RM3C LP7 STILL UP
0600	V V VVVVV TEST VVV VA
05	WVP WVP WVP DE ANRU ANUU ANRU QTC AR K
10	WVP WVP WVP DE ANRU ANRU ANRU QTC K
12	WVP WVP WVP DE ANRU ANRU ANRU QTC K
15	WVP WVP WVP DE ANRU ANRU ANRU QTC K K
19	PLD PDL PDL // QRM DE LOIC LOIC LOIC QRK IMI QRK IMI K
23	LPD LPD LPD DE LOIC LOIC LOIC QRK IMI K K
27	NBP NBP NBP DE KYCP KYCP KYCP K K
	LPD LPD LPD LPD DE LOIC LOIC LOIC // QRM // QRM IMI QRK IMI K
32	CQ CQ CQ DE NNU // LOIC LOIC LOIC QRK IMI QRK IMI QTC K
357	NBA NBA DE NMR NMR AR K
39	IMI K // QRM
44	UNIDENTIFIED TESTER HRD AGN
45	WSL WSL WSL DE ANEP // QRM // K K
47	WSL WSL WSL DE ANXR ANXR ANXR BT QTC 3 QTC 3 QRK IMI K K 8280 K K
50	WSL WSL WSL DE LKIK LKIK LKIK MSG
51	WSL WSL DE ANXR ANXR ANXR BT QRK IMI K K
52	KUIZ KUIZ DE NBA NBA QRK IMI K
	KUIZ DE NBA BT
	NORTH // VVVVV // NORTHWEST SWAN ISLAND HEADED FOR BT ARE U IN
	E AREA IMI K // VVV // QRM HVY NW
55	WSL WSL WSL DE KHIE KHIE KHIE QRU IMI K
57	NDT NDT NDT DE KUTN KUTN KUTN QRK IMI K
0702	KUTN KUTN KUTN QSV QSV IMI K
03	WSL WSL WSL DE ANXR ANXR ANXR BT QRK IMI K K
08	LPD LPD LPD LPD DE LOIC LOIC LOIC QTC QTC QRK QRK IMI K
11	WSL WSL WSL DE KHIE KHIE KHIE BT PSE CFM MY NR2 052 // QRM
13	WSL WSL WSL DE KHIE KHIE BT QRK IMI K K
13	ALERT AX4 ON NW
	HPHI DE ANUV ANUV BT TO TO SHORE SHORE AUTHORITIES AUTHORITIES
16	BOA THE TU GIVING DIRECT COPY ON TWPL NW
29	POSSIBLE W// QRM UNREDBLE (LSNG FOR AOUV)
30	XXX FROM HRPI OK R R QRR QSL QRX AR K
32	AX4 CANCELLED NW
35	WSL WSL WSL WSL
36	WSL WSL WSL DE KFAX KFAX KFAX QTC K
38	NDT NDT DE NPN NPN QTC QRK IMI K
41	NDT NDT DE NPN NPN // CQ DE NBA QRT QRT QRT QRT QRT
42	KUIZ DE NBA QRM QRM BT QIZ QSZ QSZ K K

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TIME	ENTRIES
0742	WALLACE, RM1C ON WATCH CONTINUED FM LAST ENTRY 8280 KCS
44	WVP WVP WVP DE ANRU ANRU ANRU QTC K
46	GOING TO HRCC I TINCE ISSISTANCE GE QRM
48	KSF K // DEB NBA BT SIFD GOING TO UERCG ASSISTANCE BT HW K
	BY BT ESTOY BIEN BESOS BT ANGEL AR NR8 P12 CARMEN DELAROUA
51	SPANISH STA NO CPY
52	WCC WCC WCC DE KKHL KKHL KKHL QRU IMI AR
53	WCC DE KKHL K
55	ALERT ZE5 ON NW CONTINUATION OF LP7 ON TRAINING PLANE
0800	BUSY WITH ZE5 UNITL FURTHER ENTRY
30	NSS CAUSING QRM4/5 ON 4385 KCS FOR ALERT ZE5 NW
35	BUSY WITH ZE5
40	BUSY WITH ZE5
45	BUSY WITH ZE5
50	BUSY WITH ZE5
55	BUSY WITH ZE5
0900	BUSY WITH ZE5
05	WNUW WNU DE C KAN U LISTEN KISTEN 4140 4140 KCS IMI K
10	WSL WSL WSL DE KHAG KHAP KHAP QRG IMI QRG IMI PSE K K H 500
12	WNU LISTEN 4140 LISTEN 4140 AR
13	ANWT ANWT ANWT QRK IMI K
15	WCC WCC WCC DE KHJI KHJI KHJI // KFS KFS // QRM
18	WCC WCC // R GM
22	NDT NDT NDT DE NPN NPN NPN Q4C AR K
25	WVP WVP WVP DE KGHG KGHG KGHG QTC QRK IMI AR K K
27	WSL WSL WSL DE KFWP KFWP KFWP QTC ANS 8390 AS 8 ANS 8390 AR K
29	WSL WSL WSL DE KFWP KFWP KFWP QTC QTC ANS 8390 K
	KEK KEK KEK KEK KEK KEK DE ANWT ANWT ANWT QRK IMI QRK IMI ANS
32	UP K K
35	KFS KFS KFS DE KVLA KVLA GM QRU IMI QRU IMI ANS 8380 AR K
37	KFS KFS KFS DE KVLA KVLA KVLA QRU IMI QRU IMI AR K
40	KFS KFS KFS DE KVLA KVLA KVLA QRU IMI QRU IMI AR K
	KEK KEK KEK DE ANWT ANWT ANWT // WL WSL WSL DE ANXR ANXR QTC
45	QTC // QRM
47	DE ANWT ANWT QSZ QSZ QRM QRM K
50	WSL WSL WSL DE KOZ0 KOZI KOZI K K
55	NO RDBL SIGS QRM
1000	WVP WVP // NVIZ // QRT QRT QRT
02	WSL WSL WSL DE AOGC AOG // KOGI KOGI KOZI K K
05	WVO WVO WVO LPKF QTC IMI 26 AR K
	WCC WCC WCC DE KHJI KHJI KHJI // WCC WCC WCC DE KHJI KHJI KHJI
07	AR K
12	KOZI KOZI KOZI K K // CA LING WSL
17	NO RDBLE SIGS QRM
20	WVO WVO WVO WVO WVO WVO
21	WVO WVO WVO DE KKNP KKNP KKNP QRU IMI RU IMI ANS 8510 KCS K
26	WSL WSL WSL DE AOGC AOGC AOGC QTC QTC QRK IMI QRK IMI AR K
28	WSL WSL WSL DE KHMD KHMD KHMD QTC AR K
30	WSL WSL WSL DE KHMD KHMD KHMD QTC QRK IMI K
36	AUM QRM 40 AIQS AIQS AIQS CAV // K K

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NAVCG 2614 A
U. S. COAST GUARD

RADIO LOG HOUMA HF/DF RDO STATION (NLP) Date 06 DECEMBER, 1945

TIME	ENTRIES
1040	WALLACE,RM1C ON WATCH CONTINUED FM LAST ENTRY 8280 KCS
1042	WSL WSL WSL WSL DE KMHD KMHD QRK IMI AR K
47	KFS KFS // WSL WS// QRM
49	KFS DE KVUV QSW 8380 HW
52	WVP WVP WVP WVP WVP DE KCKH KCKH BT QRK IMI K
57	IT IS CNSIGRECIM ORTANN GARBLED SIGS UNRBLE
1100	NMO NMO NMO DE // KOWH KOWH AR K
01	ALERT AX6 ON NW
06	BUSY WITH AX6
11	BUSY WITH AX6
12	AX6 CANCELLED NW
17	WSL WSL // QRU IMI K
22	WSL WSL WSL VVVVVV // CW NOTE HRD ON 8280 KCS NW
24	WSL WSL WSL DE KMHD KMHD KMHD AR
29	K KFS KFS DE KV GM QRU IMI QRU IMI ANS 8380 AR K
	KFS KFS KFS KFS DE KVLA KVLA KVLA GM QRU IMI QRU IMI ANS
30	8380 AR K
31	WSL WSL WSL DE KMHD KMHD KMHD HW
32	CQ CQ CQ DE // QRM // QRZ A ZA WAZA AR
35	WSL WSL WSL DE KMHD KMHD KMHD HW
	NUMBER FIVE FIVE HATCH STOP NO MAIAE MAIL BT QSTER USESR VICTORY
37	BT CORRECT PREFIX TOREAD GOVT BT D HW
39	CQ CQ CQ DE VDST VDST VDST AR K K
41	KWOQ KWOQ KWOQ BT QTC QRK IMI K
43	WSL WSL WSL DE KWOQ KWOQ KWOQ BT QTC MSG QTC MSG HW K
45	YOU GER K // WK SIG
49	WSL DE KWOQ KWOQ BT 1140Z USSR VICTORY SS USSR VICTORY HW K
52	GNYC GNYC DE WOON WOON QTC AR
57	WSL WSL WSL DE ANWT ANWT AR
1200	GRAND MANAN MANT IMI MANAN AR K
02	NPO V NPN BT UR MSG FM I A INT INT AR K
1134	LP7 FINALLY CANCELLED
1207	NO RDBLE SIGS QRM
10	NMO NMO DE KIEK KIEK KIEK // BRKN BY QRM
15	NO RDBLE SIGS QRM
17	NMN NMN NMN NMN // QRM AGN
23	NO RDBLE SIGS QRM
27	UNIDENTIFIED TESTER HRD NW
32	WSL WSL WSL DE KORY KORY KORY BT QTC1 QTC2 QRK IMI QRK IMI AR K
36	WSL WSL WSL DE KKMHD KMHD KMHD QTC QRK IMI K
38	WSL WSL WSL DE KMHK KMHD KMHD QTC QRK IMI K
43	NO RDBLE SIGS
47	BT TO ZERO SIX DEGREES K // CW NOTE BLKNG SIGS NW
50	KCG CC CGN7 CGN7 // CGX7 CGX7 CGX7
55	QQZ QQZ AR
1300	CW NOTE WITH S5 SIG BLOCKING SIGS ON 8280 KCS
05	QRZ IMI QRZ IMI DE VIP VIP IMI K
10	WCC WCC WCC WCC WCC
15/6	WAX WAX WAX DE HRCG HRCG HRCG QTC2 PSE 36 AR
20	WSL WSL WSL
21	WSL WSL WSL DE KORY KORY BT QTC1 AR

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TIME	ENTRIES
1321	WALLACE,RM1C ON WATCH CONTINUED FM LAST ENTRY 8280 KCS
26	CW NOTE STILL CAUSING QRM
31	CW NOTE STILL ON
35	CLD CLD CLD CLD KK
40	CQ CQ CQ CQ CQ CQ CQ DE ACL CLD // QRU IMI ARK
42	ALERT NR MY5 ON NW
49	MY5 CANCELLED NW
54	HOY LAS TZRV IMI 8R451 BT AMPDA MOVGIMI // GARBLED SIGS
58	8 MILES EIGHT MILES FROM YOU NOW AR K HRD ON 500 KCS
1401	KJQF // KH KGO QRU IMI NIL
06	RELIEVED BY LUCIANO,RM3C ZE5 ALERT STILL ON
	W.T.WALLACE,RM1C
10	WSL WSL WSL DE KCUN KKUD KKUD BT QTC 2 QRK IMI K
12	NPO NPO NPO DE NDT NDT NDT BT INT QRL INT QIL WPOO AR K
13	QRZ DE NPO NPO IMI K
14	NPO NPO NPO DE NDT NDT NDT INT QIL WPOO AR K
18	ZE5 CANCELLED
23	DE NPN NPN NPN BT QRK 4 QRK 4 QSA 3 QSA 3 AR K
27	NPN NPN NPN DE ANWS ANWS ANWS BT QSW QSW 8320 KCS K
27	MONITORING ASSIGNMENT FROM ZE....4385 KCS ....
30	WAX WAX WAX V ZGZO ZGZ0 .... UNRDBLE...
35	DE VDVZ VDVG VDVG IMI
36	TWPL OPEN
41	TWPL BACK TO NORMAL AGAIN...
46	NO RDBLE SIGS
48	V V V V V V V TEST V V V V V V V AE.....
49	WSL WSL / NBA NBA NBA DE KXVP KXVP K
50	WSL WSL DE KKBH KKBH KKBH K
55	WAX WAX DE ANAX ANAX ANAX AR K (TWPL RUNNING OPEN)
59	NMR NMR DE KMVN KMVN QTC QRK IMI K
1500	WAX WAX DE ANAX ANAX ANAX AR K (CALLED TELCO MAN) UNABLE TO GET
04	KOKOKOK DE ANAQ QTC K LINES
05	NMR NMR DE KMVN KMVN QTC QRK IMI K
07	KOK KOK KOK DE ANAQ ANKQ ANKQ QTC K
09	NMR NMR NMR DE KKMN KMVN QTC QRK IMI
09	CALLED TELCO MAN.. NEW ORLEANS... TWPL STILL RUNNING OPEN.. .
13	WAX WAX WAX DE AOIO AOIO BT QTC QRK IMI K
14	NMR NMR NMR DE KMVN KMVN KMVN QRK IMI K
14	WAX DE AOIO BT QSP IMI SS .. QRM..IMI...
15	KOK KOK DE ANAQ ANKQ K
16	KOK KOK DE ANKQ ANKQ QTC K
20	XDAC XDAC DE X4BGV X4BGV AR K
22	NBA NBA NBA DE KULI KVLI KVLI KVLI QTC 1 K
23	WAITING FOR NO TELCO CALL ON TWX OPEN-CALLED LOCAL PHONE CO THEY SAY LINES OUT ALL OVER STATE WILL CALL BACK.
27	PUT 4385 ON OTR POSN ACCOUNT TWX BEING OPEN GUARDING 8280 AND 500 THIS POSN
32	WPA WPA DE KDUQ QTC K K

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RADIO LOG HOUMA RDF STATION Date 06 DECEMBER, 1945

TIME	ENTRIES	
1532	LUCIANO RM3C ON 4385 OTHER POSN SPENCER CRM ON 500 8280	
33	WNU DE KJQF (154 A B)	500
36	WPA DE KDUQ - KJQF WNU LSN 448	500
40	CQ DE LOKB QRU IMI PSE QRK IMI K	500
41	TWX STILL OPEN	
42	CLA CLK K	8280
42	KJQF DE 550D (QRM) IR CLIMG YOU K	500
43	KOK DE ANKQ QTC K	8280
44	NBA DE KVLI QTC	8280
49	TELETYPE WORKING	
54	WMR - 500 OK AR - WMR DE AOEN BT QTC 1AR	500
57	NMV DE KSVK QTC K	500
1602	WNU DE KJQF K - KJQF WNU K - WNU DE KJQF (154 A 3) THE HOKED UP AND THAT HTEY ARE TO RETURN TO MOBILE	500
07	BUSY TWX	
12	KOK DE AOGL QTC QTC QRK IMI K	8280
17	CTORY AR HW - VVV CQ DE XBRU	8280
23	WLO ANFG QTC	500
24	NMR DE KMVN QTC QRK IMI K	8280
25	TELL KORU TO GO BACK TO MOBILE (KJQF)	500
27	WAX OIPZ KI MSG K	8280
28	WAX LOSP LOIP QRV VE 6 K	8280
32	WAX LOIP R 3 QSZ MY - 7054 OVR -	8280
37	BUSY TWX	
41	CQ DE XBRF1 QRV VE 6 K	8280
42	NBA DE KSFDQTC K	8280
43	V V V HRCG VA	8280
46	CALLING NBA ON 8280 IMI (QRM) CGX CGK7 AR	8280
49	HRCG DE VPRJ	8280
50	HRCG DE VPRJ QRK IMI PSE 36 K	8280
55	HRCG DE KSFD BT OK K	8280
57	NMN NMN NMN (QRM) PSE (QRM)	8280
58	QRZ IMI NMN PSE K KK	8280
1700	BUSY TWX	
05	NBA KSFD QTC K	8280
10	NBA DE KSFD R AS	8280
14	WPA DE KKMV QRU IMI QSA AR K	500
19	WNU DE KVTW QRK K	500
24	WNU ANGF QRU IMI K	500
28	WNU DE KESK QRU IMI K	500
29	WNU DE KESK (129 A 5)	500
31	WSL DE AN QRK IMI PSE ANS 500 KCS K	8280
32	WSL DE ANAK QTC PSE ANS 500	8280
37	NMR DE W QSW 8240 K	8280
40	WNU DE AOIO BT QTC 1 QRK IMI K	8280
42	NOQ DE WICI (078 A4)	500
46	STEADY NOTE (286 A4)	500
49	WSL DE ANCK MSG QSW 8300	8280
50	WCC DE KFEN QTC	8280
51	GRAND VDST VDST GMT BT RUWANNE (FADED OUT)	8280

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TIME	ENTRIES	FREQ
1751	WCC DE KFEN QTC	828Ø
54	SPENCER CRM RELEIVED BY LUCIANO	
	C E SPENCER	
55	NOW GUARDING 828Ø AND 4385	
56	WSL WSL DE AOIU AOIU AOIU K	828Ø
57	WSL WSL DE AOIU AOIU AOIU K	828Ø
57	TEST TEST DE KUVZ QRA IMI	828Ø
58	WNU WNU / WSL DE ANCK ANCK BT QTC IMI QTC2 QRK IMI	
	LISTENT 83ØØ KCS K	828Ø
58	WCC DE KFENT	828Ø
59	TEST TEST DE KSUZ KSUZ K QRK IMI K	828Ø
18ØØ	WSL WSL DE ANCK ANCK 832Ø 822Ø K	828Ø
18ØØ	WSL WSL 83ØØ K K	828Ø
Ø1	WSL WSL DE KSUZ KSUZ QRK IMI K	828Ø
Ø2	WSL WSL DE KSUZ KSUZ KSUZ QRK IMI K	828Ø
Ø5	BUT U SAID THIS SETTING WAS CKOSER LAN THE SETTING	
	ON CARD- ALSO HAVE 84 IMI 847Ø AND 829Ø SHALL TRI IMI	828Ø
Ø6	24 AND 2/NPB V 1883R K	4385
Ø8	NPB V 1883R K/ NPB V 1883R INT QSA K	4385
12	WAX 6 K / WAX 6 K	828Ø
13	WAX DE ANKQ ANKQ QTC K	828Ø
13	WSL DE / WAX DE ANKQ 36 K	828Ø
14	QRZ IMI DE NBA NBA QRU IMI K	828Ø
14	NBA NBA DE NQU IMI BT QRK/QSA 5 AR K	828Ø
15	NBA DE WQUN WQUN R TU QRU VA	828Ø
18	WSL WSL DE KKBH KKBH BT MSG QRK ON 832Ø AR K	828Ø
19	WSL / WCC DE KENR R R	828Ø
2Ø	WSL WSL DE KETH KETH HR QTC HW K	828Ø
23	WSL WSL DE KKBH KKBH BT MARK IMI QRK IMI AR K	828Ø
26	WSL WSL DE KETH KETH QTC QTC HW K	828Ø
27	WSL WSL DE AOIU AOIU	828Ø
28	WSL WSL DE AOIU AOIU	828Ø
29	WSL WSL DE AOIU AOIU	828Ø
3Ø	NPB V 1882D K/ 1882D V NPB K	4385
3Ø	NPB V 1882D -A-1882D -A- 1883U QAZ / K	4385
3Ø	WSL WSL DE KETH KETH QTC HW K	828Ø
31	1882D V NPB R R AR	4385
32	NPB V 1883R K/ 1883R V NPB K	4385
33	NPB V 1883R INT QRU K/ 1883R V NPB QRU QSA 5 AR	4385
34	NPB V 1882D INT QWT / K	4385
35	1882D V NPB QWT 183ØZ . . . . . LONG DASH K	4385
36	NPB V 1882D R AR	4385
37	NPB V 1882W QUZ K/ 1882W V NPB R AR	4385
4Ø	NPB V 1882W K/ 1882W V NPB	4385
41	NPB V 1882W -P-A- 1882W Ø61845 NPB GR 5 BT POSIT 29-ØØ N	
	LAT 7 IMI LAT 79-32 W LONG BT Ø61845 K	4385
42	1882W V NPB R R AR	4385
44	NBA NBA NBA DE KHUL KHVL BT QSY QSY 1242Ø	828Ø
45	WSL WSL WSL DE KORK KORK BT QTC 1 QRK IMI ARK	828Ø

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RADIO LOG [redacted] Date [redacted], 194[redacted]

TIME	ENTRIES
	LUKIAND, WN. NM 3/C ON WATCH [redacted]
1945	TOLE....
47	[redacted]
50	TEST ...LONG DASH.... TEST ....VA..NO SINE..
55	[redacted]
56	[redacted]
1900	[redacted]
02	[redacted]
03	[redacted]
03	[redacted]
04	[redacted]
05	[redacted]
06	[redacted]
07	[redacted]
08	[redacted]
08	[redacted]
12	TESTER HRD..SHORT DASHES...
13	[redacted]
16	[redacted]
17	[redacted]
20	[redacted]
25	NO SIGNALS HRD
30	NK SIGNALS HRD
31	[redacted]
32	[redacted]
33	[redacted]
34	[redacted]
35	[redacted]
36	[redacted]
37	[redacted]
40	[redacted]
42	[redacted]
45	[redacted]
	BT POSIT 27-19 N LAT 80-20 W LONG BT [redacted]
46	[redacted]
50	[redacted]
53	[redacted]
54	[redacted]
56	[redacted]
57	[redacted]
58	[redacted]
59	[redacted]
2001	[redacted]
06	[redacted]
08	[redacted]
09	[redacted]
09	[redacted]
	CK 16 BT PROCEED KINGSTON JAMICA X ARRIVING KEING INI
	C/ COMPILOT AND HQ ... QRM INI ...
13	[redacted]
13	TESTER UP NR.....US...

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TIME	LUCIANO, W. RM 3/C ON WATCH ENTRIES GUARDING 8280 AND 4385 KCS.	
2013	TOLE....	
17	WSL WSL DE KVMB KVMB QTC ANS 84 IMI..CEASED..	8280
24	NO SIGNALS	BOTH
27	BUSY TWX AX7 XXX ON 8280	
33	BUSY TWX DO	
38	BUSY TWX DO	
42	V V V DE KWAL TEST AR	8280
48	WAX DE ANMD BT QTC QSR 8320	8280
51	WAX DE ANMD QTC QSR 8320 MC AR K	8280
53	WAX DE AOFY BT HR NIL CRU IMI QRG	8280
56	WCC DE AOFY QRK IMI QRG K	8280
57	WCC DE KVMB QTC K	8280
57	WAX DE ANMD BT QSD	8280
2103	V 1883R INT - 1883 R R QSA5 K - V 1883R INT QSA K	4385
04	1883R V 1885N INT VICC CALL (QSB) - 1883R V 1885N	
	INT VOICE CALL OR PLANE K K -	4385
10	WAX DE AOFY QRU IMI QRK IMI K	8280
14	ALL EQUIPMENT FOR COMPLETE TREATMENT NOT WHOOD BT MASTER 8280	
	AR	
16	BND ICB - LOB LOB LOB LOAV LOAV LOAV LOB LOB LOB LOB	
	LOB LOB LOB LOB LOB DE LOAV LOAV LOAV GE QTC QTC AR AR K 8280	
17	BERD SENDER EN KASSE MSBAAL - MDDL DE NBLF V V V V V	
	PCH1 PCH 1 - DE NBLF -VPR VPR - V V V V V - CYCC AR -	
	QRK IMI LR QRK K - QRM 5 IF LAT 1750 17.50 SOUTH	
	RPT LONG QSZ K -	
23	CQ DE XFM CQ DE XFM 3% -	8280
25	DE LIDG R R TU YOU QSA NOW 4 K	8280
26	WSL WSL DE LIMA QRK IMI	8280
27	WSL WSL DE KORY KORY	8280
28	V 1882D R/ 1882D V NPB K	4385
29	NPB V 1882D -1882D QAC BASE - 1883U S IMI - 1883U QAC BASE	
	IMI 1882D QAC BASE - 1883U QAC BASE K K	4385
31	1882D V NPB R AR	4385
32	NPB V 1885N / 1885N V NPB R AR	4385
34	WSL WSL DE WINF WINF - XXX MSG ANRP BLEN CAIAR D IMI ANS	
	8320 AR	8280
35	WCC WCC DE KUMB KVMB QTC QRK IMI	8280
36	WSL WSL DE LIZS LIZS AR	8280
37	WSL WSL DE WVLF WVLF QRM..IMI..	8280
41	WSL WSL DE KNZJ KNZJ KNZJ QRK IMI K	8280
43	TEST HRD...V V V V V TEST V V V V VA...NO SIME..	8280
44	WSL WSL DE WINF WOVB WOVB QRU IMI	8280
45	WSL WSL DE KVIB KVIB QRU IMI K	8280
45	NPB NPB V 1882N 1882N R/ 1882N V NPB K	4385
46	NPB V 1882N -P- 062242 - QPZ 21422	4385
51	WAX WAX DE LOIP LOIP K K K	8280
53	LUCIANO, W. RM 3/C OFF TO PERRY, M.J. RM 3/C	
	W. S. LUCIANO	
2205	PERRY, M.J. (LONG CONTINUOS DASH ON 8280 KCS.)	

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U. S. COAST GUARD

RADIO LOG LP- UNITED STATES COAST GUARD *Date* 6, DECEMBER, 1945

TIME	ENTRIES
	PERRY, M.J. QSX 8280 KCS.
2205	LAST ENTRY
20	BUSY 8280 ZEB (LONG CONTINUOUS NOTE), WNU WNU WNU DE KORY KORY KORY QTC IMI QTC IMI QRK IMI K.
30	LONG CONTINUOS NOTE STILL UP(BLOCKING OUT ALL MSG.) ALERT ZEB
36	NO READABLE SIGNALS HRD. QRN 5
45	RECNH WUD GDEVERHEIDSTR BR(QR K 1 QSA 1 QRM QVM
47	NR 2 R (OK)-RASPY A2 SIGNALS UNIDENTIFIED
48	DITDIT JAAR AR K (GY,) --
51	WCC WCC WCC WCC WCC WCC WCC DE
56	QSU --AFAST GARBBLED SIGS UNREADABLE-WAX WAX WAX WAX (STOPPED) A30 FONE SIGS) MOLW AOLW AOLW QRK IMI TEST IMI K
2300	A3 UNREADABLE FOREIGN FONE SIGS.
03	WSL WSL DE KKZJ QTC IMI K
08	WAX WAX WAX DE ? STOPPED)
11	QRN QSN (---IMI) HIGH SPEED BUG. Z
15	NBA NBA NBA DE ANTB ANTB ANTB HR QTC 1 ARK IMI K K
18	WSL WSL WSL DE KWTH KWTH KWTH K WTH
23	ANRG ANRG QRK IMI QRU IMI --ANRG ANRG IMI K
24	WSL WSL WSL WSL WSLD ANRP QRK IMI K
30	V ANCQ ANCQ ANCQ 4V (UNREADABLE QRM QRN 5.
34	VVVVVVVVVVVVVVVVVVV DE ANCQ ANCQ ANCQ TEST VVVVV DE ANCQ DE ANCQ V V V V V V V V V V V TEST AR
35	WSL WSL DE ANNP WSL WSL WSL WSL WSL ANNP QRK IMI K
38	KFS KFS KFS KFS KFS KFS DE ANKQ ANKQ ANKQ ANKQ ANKQ ANKQ QTC K
39	WAX WAX WAX WAX WAX DE KSFD KSFD KSFD KSFD QRU IMI QRK IMI K
42	LONG CONTINOUS DASHES TEST NO CAL SINE.
43	WAX WAX WAX WAX DE KSFD KSFD KSFD KSFD QRU IMI QRU K
48	WSC WSC WSC WSC WSC WSC WSC WSC WSC DE KYVU KYVU KYVU BT QRU IMI K
51	TEST TEST AR VA NO CALL SINE. VVVVVVV
57	WSLW SL WSL WSL WSL WSL WSL WSL DE KKZJ KKZJ KKZJ KKZJ KKZJ KKZJ QTC QTC K.
0000	END OF DAY.

CERTIFIED TO BE A TRUE COPY OF THE RADIO LOG FOR THE PERIOD 2105Z 5 DECEMBER 1945 TO 2400Z 6 DECEMBER 1945

C. E. SPENCER

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RADIO LOG RADIO HF/DF STA. PENSACOLA, FLA (NLO) Date 5 DECEMBER 1945 194_

ENTRIES	1242Ø KCS FREQ.	TIME
SHEETS E.L. RM1/C ON WATCH GUARDING 828Ø &		
MONITOR ASSIGNMENT ON 48Ø5 KCS FOR FT28 A3 PLANE		2143
NET ALERTED ON 48Ø5 KCS ON FT28 LP7 UNHRD HR	48Ø5	47
WATCH RELIEVED BY HALL, O.C. RM3/C		
SHEETS E.L. RM3/C OFF -- ALERT LP7 UP		5Ø
WCC WCC WCC / BLOCKED BY TESTER	828Ø	52
WEAK DISTORTED FONE SIGS - UNRDBLE	48Ø5	54
THREE STATIONS SENDING SAME TIME - UNRDBLE	828Ø	59
ALL PLANES IN THIS FLIGHT JOIN UP IN CLOSE FORMATION	48Ø5	22Ø4
HOW LONG HAVE WE GONE NOW LETS TURN AND FLY EAST 2 DEGREES WE ARE GOING TO DAMN FAR NORTH INSTEAD OF EAST		
IF THERE IS ANYTHING WE WOULDN'T SEE IT	48Ø5	Ø9
YOU DIDN'T GET FAR ENOUGH EAST HOW LONG HAVE WE BEEN GOING EAST	48Ø5	11
HELLO NHA3 THIS IS FT28 DO YOU READ OVER	48Ø5	14
THIS IS FT28 I AM FLYING 27Ø DEGREES UNTIL I REACH FIELD OR RUN OUT OF GAS	48Ø5	19
PLANES FLY CLOSE FROMATION WHEN ONE PLANE DROPS TO TEN GALLONS OF GAS ALL PLANES WILL LAND TOGETHER	48Ø5	24
QRL ALERT		29
QRL ALERT		34
QRL ALERT		39
QRL ALERT		44
QRL ALERT		49
QRL ALERT		54
RELEIVED BY GAERTNER, R.H. RM1/C LP7 STILL UP		
O. C. HALL, RM3/C OFF		59
WAX WAX DE NMR NMR POSN OF DISTRESS DISTRESS IMI K	828Ø	23Ø1
WAX WAX WAX DE ANXR ANXR QTC 2 QRK IMI K	828Ø	Ø2
WAX DE NMR IMI K	828Ø	Ø2
WAX WAX DE NMR NMR QSY PSE 849Ø KCS K	828Ø	Ø3
HELLO TOWER THIS TAYLOR	48Ø5	Ø4
TAYLOR CARRYING ON CONVERSATION WITH TOWER -- NEGATIVE -- WHAT COURSE ARE WE ON ---- WE ARE OVER THE GULF WE DIDN'T GO FAR ENOUGH EAST ---- HOW LONG WE BEEN ON COURSE ---- I SUGGEST WE FLY DUE EAST UNTIL WE RUN OUT OF GAS WE HAVE BETTER CHANCE OF BEING PICKED UP CLOSE TO SHORE ---- (UNABLE TO HR TOWER)	48Ø5	13
QRL ALERT		2Ø
QRL ALERT		25
QRL ALERT		3Ø
RELIEVED BY HALL, O.C. RM3/C		
R.H. GAERTNER RM1/C OFF ALERT STILL UP		33
FORIEGN SIGS - BLOCKING WEAK FONE SIGS	48Ø5	38
FORIEGN COMMERCIAL STATION BLOCKING SIGS	48Ø5	43
WSL WSL DE KOOA KOOA KOOA KOOA QRK IMI K K	828Ø	48
FT3 THIS IS NHA3 OVER	48Ø5	5Ø
WAX WAX WAX WAX DE AOAG AOAG AOAG K K	828Ø	51
HA33 MSG FOR U OVER	48Ø5	53
THIS IS HA33 PUT UR R5 ON MIAMI LINE OVER	48Ø5	56
THIS HA 3 WE WILL GIVE U A CALL ON MIAMI BONNIE ? IN ONE MIN. OVER	48Ø5	59

EXHIBIT "24"

(OVER)

* (NOTE- HALL, O.C. RM3/C UNABLE TO SIGN LOGS-ON LEAVE AT PRESENT)

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ENTRIES		TIME
HALL, O.C. RM3/C ON WATCH GUARDING 8280, 12420 & 4805 KCS		
END OF RADIO DAY LP7 ALERT STILL UP		
(DECEMBER 6, 1945) O.C. HALL RM3/C ON WATCH		2400
BEGINNING NEW RADIO DAY -- LP7 ALERT UP ON 4805 KCS		0000
WNU WNU WNU DE NBA NBA QBM KVXV - D - WNU R QSL K	8280	05
STEADY NOTE S5 - NO SINE	4805	08
WNU WNU WNU DE NBA NBA NBA K K	8280	13
STEADY NOTE S5 - NO SINE	4805	18
FORIEGN STATION BLOCKING SIGS	4805	23
WSL WSL WSL WSL WSL WSL DE KYNM KYNM QTC K	8280	28
STEADY NOTE S3 - NO SINE	4805	32
LPD LPD LPD LPD DE LOIC LOIC LOIC LOIC QTC K	8280	37
LPD LPD LPD LPD DE LOIC LOIC LOIC QTC K	8280	42
FT28 FT28 THIS IS NSO NSONSO HOW DO YOU HEAR ME OVER	4805	46
FT28 FT28 THIS IS NSO NSO NSO HOW DO YOU HEAR ME OVER	4805	49
WSL WSL WSL WSL DE KFWP KFWP KFWP QTC K K	8280	51
FT28 FT28 THIS IS NSO NSO NSO HOW DO YOU HEAR ME OVER	4805	54
FT28 FT28 THIS IS NSO NSO NSO HOW DO YOU HEAR ME OVER	4805	59
VVV VVV VVV TEST VVV AR VA	8280	0102
NBA NBA NBA DE WQUU WQUU WQUU BT QTC 2 QSW 8300 K	8280	07
WEAK SIGS - FONE UNRDBLE - QRM HEAVY	4805	11
WEAK SIGS - FONE UNRDBLE QRM HEAVY	4805	16
WSL WSL WSL WSL DE KHNV KHNV KHNV KHNV QTC K	8280	21
WSL WSL WSL DE KHNV KHNV KHNV QTC K	8280	26
WCC WCC WCC DE KVLX KVLX KVLX QTC K	8280	30
WCC WCC WCC DE KVLX KVLX KVLX QTC K K	8280	35
WEAK SIGS - FONE - QRM HEAVY - UNRDBLE	4805	40
STEADY NOTE S2 - NO SINE	4805	45
COMMERCIAL STATION BLOCKING SIGS - HEAVY QRM	4805	50
STEADY NOTE S3 - NO SINE	4805	55
COMMERCIAL STATION BLOCKING SIGS - QRM	4805	0200
KWFU KWFU KWFU AR K K	8280	05
THREE STATIONS XMITTING SAME TIME - UNRDBLE	8280	08
STEADY NOTE S5 - NO SINE	8280	12
WVP WVP WVP WVP DE ANSA ANSA ANSA QTC K K	8280	15
WSL WSL WSL DE KHJQ KHJQ KHJQ QRU IMI K K	8280	20
WSL WSL WSL DE KHJQ KHJQ KHJQ QRU IMI K K	8280	25
THREE STATIONS XMITTING SAME TIME - UNRDBLE	8280	30
STEADY NOTE S4 - NO SINE	8280	35
WCC WCC WCC DE ANSE ANSE ANBE K K	8280	40
NET ALERTED ON 454 KCS ON KTOB AX1	INFO	39
WBL NBA NBA NBA DE ANND ANND ANND QTC K K	8280	44
NET ALERTED ON 8280 KCS ON ANND AX2	INFO	48
KFS KFS KY ////	8280	
FT28 FT28 THIS ?? HOW DO U HEAR ME OVER (QRM HVY)	4805	52
FT28 FT28 THIS IS ?? HOW DO U HEAR ME OVER (QRM HVY)	4805	56
PND PND // RPT SCONG STRONG K K (GARBLED)	8280	0300
DE ANND R R QSL 0602302 AR	8280	04
NBA NBA // ANND ANND DE NBA NBA AS AS	8280	05
CANCELLED AX2 ON 8280 KCS	INFO	05
COMMERCIAL STATION BLOCKING SIGS	4805	10

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Form 2614 A
U. S. Coast Guard

RADIO LOG RADIO HF/DF STA. PENSACOLA, FLA (NLO) *Date* 6 DECEMBER , 194 5

HALL, O.C. RM3/C ON WATCH ENTRIES GUARDING 8280, 12420 & 4805 KCS		TIME
LAST ENTRY -- LP7 AND AX1 ALERTS STILL UP		0310
NBA NBA NBA DE VGVG VGVG VGVG QTC 2 QTC 2 K K	8280	12
WSL WSL WSL DE KKZJ KKZJ KKZJ BT QRK IMI K K	8280	16
NBA NBA NBA NBA DE VGVG VGVG VGVG BT QTC K K	8280	19
WSL WSL WSL DE KKZJ KKZJ KKZJ BT QRK IMI K K	8280	20
ANND DE NBA NBA OK OK K	8280	22
WSL WSL WSL DE KKLO KKLO KKLO BT QRU IMI QRU IMI K	8280	27
WSL WSL WSL DE KKLO KKLO KKLO BT QRU IMI K	8280	29
WVP WVP WVP WVOP DE KKLO KKLO KKLO BT QRU IMI K	8280	31
WVP WVP WVP DE KKLO KKLO KKLO BT QRU IMI K	8280	35
CANCELLED AX1 ON 454 KCS	INFO	37
WVP WVP WVP DE KKLO KKLO QRU IMI K	8280	42
WEAK SIGS S2 -- RUNRDBLE	8280	47
TESTER ON S3 -- NO SINE	8280	52
STEADY NOTE S3 - NO SINE	8280	56
WEAK DISTORTED SIGS - UNRDBLE	4805	0401
TESTER ON -S3 - NO SINE	8280	06
DISTORTED SIGS - UNRDBLE - JERKY	4805	11
WSL WSL WSL DE KWOQ KWOQ KWOQ QRU IMI K K	8280	16
WCC WCC WCC DE ANNU ANNU ANNU QRK IMI K K	8280	21
WCC WCC WCC DE ANNU ANNU ANNU QRK IMI K K	8280	26
WEAK SIGS S2 - UNRDBLE	8280	30
WCC WCC WCC DE ANNU ANNU QRK IMI K K	8280	35
WSL WSL WSL DE KKDO KKDO KKDO AR K K	8280	40
WSL WSL WSL DE KKDO KKDO KKDO AR K K	8280	45
WSL WSL WSL DE KKDO KKDO KKDO AR K K	8280	50
WSL WSL WSL DE KKDO KKDO KKDO BT QRK IMI K	8280	0500
WEAK SIGS S2 UNRDBLE	8280	05
TESTER ON S3 - NO SINE	8280	10
VVV VVV VVV TEST VVV VVV AR VA	8280	15
WEAK TESTER -OR CARRIER ON- PROBABLY CAUSED BY COMMERCIAL STATION - FOREIGH	4805	20
WEAK SIGS S2 - UNREADABLE	8280	25
WCC WCC WCC WCC DE / (WEAK SIGS FADED OUT)	8280	30
TESTER ON S3- NO SINE	8280	35
WVP WVP WVP WVP DE ANRU ANRU ANRU ANRU QTC AR K	8280	40
WVP WVP WVP WVP DE ANRU ANRU ANRU ANRU QTC AR K	8280	45
KYBH KYBH KYBH QTC QTC K K	8280	48
WVP WVP WVP WVP DE ANRU ANRU ANRU QTC IMI AR K	8280	52
TESTER ON / ON / S2 NO SINE	8280	57
RELIEVED BY GAERTNER, R.H. RM1/C ALERT LP7 UP O.C. HALL, RM3/C OFF		58
NO READABLE SIGS - NET ALERTED 500 N QTE -- AX3		0603
WVP WVP WVP DE ANRU ANRU ANRU QTC K	8280	08
WCC WCC WCC DE FOK /// WSL WSL WSL DE KFWP KFWP KFWP BT QTC		
QTC ANS 8390 K	8280	13
AX3 CANCELLED AT		15
WEDL WEDL WEDL WEDL LPD LPD LPD LPD	8280	19
NET ALERTED ON 500 KCS N XXX KC2		19
LPD LPD LPD LPD DE WEDL WEDL WEDL	8280	23

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GAERTNER RH RM1C ON WATCH ENTRIES GUARDING 8280 &12420 KCS

		TIME
TOLE PAGE 2		Ø623
KOK KOK KOK DE KVLI KVLI KVLI QRU IMI K	8280	28
NBA NBA NBA DE NMR NMR AR K	8280	33
NBA NBA DE NMR NMR AR K	8280	34
NMO NMO NMO DE KKIE KKK KIEK QRK IMI K	8280	34
NBA NBA NBA DE NMR NMR NMR K	8280	35
KIEK KIEK DE NMO NMO BT QRM5 QSW IMI AR K	8280	39
KCS ALERT CANCELLED		39
WSL WSL WSL DE KFWP KFWP KFWP BT QTC	8280	42
WSL WSL WSL DE ANXR ANXR QTC3	8280	45
KIEK KIEK DE NMO NMO QRK 4 NW K	8280	49
WSL WSL WSL DE ANXR ANXR ANXR BT QRK IMI K	8280	50
CQ CQ CQ DE NBA NBA QRT DE NBA	8280	53
BT QRZ //// KHIE DE NBA QRT QRT DE NBA SAN K //	8280	55
CALL ME FUQSO HR CGHW // NBA NDT NDT NDT DE KUTN KUTN QRK IMI K	8280	56
WSL WSL WSL KDIK KDIK LDIK QRK IMI	8280	58
WSL DE LDIK R NR ABRAHAM LINCOLN NR1 CK 75 1500 GMT BT FREDOLSEN FRED OLSEN NEWYORK BT CANAL 17 0705 IFFORM FERAFRB FERAGEN BT OLSEN AR K (QRM HEAVY)	8280	0701
WSL WSL WSL DE ANXR ANXR BT QRK IMI K	8280	02
NDT NDT DE KUTN KUTN KUTN BT QDID U -- TESTER UP -- S5	8280	02
KIEK KIEK DE NMO NMO PSE RPT 36 K	8280	03
ANLL ANLL ANLL ANLL ANLL DE LPD LPD LPD	8280	06
WSL WSL WSL DE KHIE KHIE KHIE BT PSE CFM MY NR2 05205Z	8280	09
WSL WSL WSL DE KHIE KHIE KHIE BT QRU IMI	8280	10
WSL WSL WSL DE KHIE KHIE HIE BT	8280	12
NET ALERTED 500 KCS XXX N AX4 CALL ANUV	8280	13
WSL WSL WSL DE ANXR ANXR ANXR BT QTC3	8280	14
WSL WSL WSL DE ANXR ANXR ANXR BT QRK IMI	8280	17
CQ CQ CQ CQ DE NMO NMO HR QRC -- QRM HVY -- BROKEN UP	8280	21
NO READABLE SIGS		26
WEAK SIGS UP		31
ALERT AX4 CANCELLED		32
WSL WSL WSL DE KFAX KFAX KFAX QTC K		34
SEVERAL STATIONS SENDING V TESTING	8280	39
CQ CQ CQ DE NBA NBA QRT QRT QRT QRT	8280	40
DE NBA NBA NBA QRT QRM BT QSZ K	8280	41
KUIQKJUIQ DE NBA NBA QRM BT TRI 468 HW K	8280	42
KUIQ DESNBA OK QSZ K	8280	43
KUIQ KUIQ DE NBA NBAD BT JUIF KUID IS GOING TO HRCG HRCG AR ASSISTANCE BT HW K GE	8280	45
KUIQ KUIQ DE NBA BT KSFD IS GOING TO ASSISTANCE CE	8280	47
WCC WCC DE KKHL KKHL KKHL QRU IMI AR K	8280	51
NET ALERTED 4835 KCS 1883T A1 ZE5		55
KFS KFS KFS KFS DE KWSZ KWSZ KWSZ QRU IMI K	8280	57
KFS KFS KFS DE KWSZ KWSZ QRU IMI K	8280	0800
NMA O DE KRMP KRMP BT QSV AR K	8280	02
WSL WSL WSL DE WPEJ WPEJ WPEJ BT K	8280	05
WSL WSL WSL DE KHIE KHIE KHIE BT QRU IMI	8280	10
WCC WCC WCC WCC DE DE ANYZ ANYZ ANYZ QTC 1 K	8280	15
QRL ALERT		20

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Authority NND 868189

Form 2614 A
U. S. Coast Guard

RADIO LOG HF DF RADIO STATION PENSACOLA FLA Date 6 DECEMBER, 194 5

GAERTNER RH RM1/C ON WATCH ENTRIES GUARDING 828Ø & 48Ø5 & 1242Ø		TIME
TOLE PAGE 3		Ø82Ø
WSL WSL WSL DE ANBR ANBR	828Ø	24
QRL ALERT UP		29
NMO NMO NMO DE ANWS ANWS BT QTC 1 QRK IMI AR K	828Ø	34
NMWS DE NMO NMO AS AS	828Ø	35
ANWS ANWS DE NMO NMO NMO BT QRV QSY QSW 425 KCS	828Ø	37
WAX WAX DE NBA NBA QRT 5ØØ QRT 5ØØ	828Ø	38
TESTER UP SNEIND LONG DASHES		42
WNU WNU DE KWZF KWZF (FADED OUT)	828Ø	43
KFS KFS KFS DE ANLY ANLY ANLY ON DE (QRM HVY)	828Ø	47
WSL WSL WSL WSL DE KFWP KFWP KFWP KFWP BT QTC ANS 839Ø	828Ø	52
TESTER S5 SENDING V'S AND LONG DASHES	828Ø	56
WSL WSL WSL / WAX WAX DE KKDR KKDR KKDR QTC QRK IMI AR HW	828Ø	57
WSL WSL WSL DE KHAP KHAP KHAP KHAP QRG2 QRG IMI PSE ANS 5ØØ		Ø9Ø2
TESTER UP // WSL WSL WSL DE KHAP KHAP KHAP GM QRG IMI ANS 5ØØ		Ø6
WSL WSL DE KWPJ KWPJ QTC IMI QTC ANS 839Ø	828Ø	Ø9
WCC WCC WCC WCC DE KHJØ KHJØ KHJI	828Ø	11
NO READABLE SIGS -- ALERT STILL UP	BOTH	16
TESTER UP V V V V V LONG DASH V V V V V	828Ø	21
NMR NMR NMR DE KKCM KKCM QTC K	828Ø	23
WSL WSL WSL WSL DE KFWP KFWP KFWP QTC ANS 839Ø K	828Ø	26
KEK KEK KEKKEK -- STATION UP CALLING BUT MISSING DITS BADLY, NO READABLE ---	828Ø	3Ø
KFS KFS KFS KFS DE KVLA KVAL KVLA KVLA GM QRU IMI ANS 838Ø		33
NO SIGS	828Ø	38
WSL WSL WSL DE ANXR ANXR ANXR QTC2 QSY IMI K	828Ø	42
WSL WSL WSL DE KOZI KOZI KOZI K K	828Ø	47
NO READABLE SIGS		52
WCC WCC ///// TESTER UP // NPN NPN QRZ NBT -	828Ø	56
WSL WSL DE KOGI KOGI KOGI K	828Ø	1ØØØ
WCC WCC WCC /// WVO WVO WVO DE KHLP	828Ø	Ø5
SEVERAL STATIONS SENDING SAME TIME		1Ø
NO READABLE SIGS		15
TESTER UP	828Ø	18
NO READABLE SIGS	828Ø	23
WSL WSL WSL DE KMSD KMSD KMSD KMSD QTC	828Ø	25
WSL WSL WSL DE KMSDKMSDKMSDKMSD QTC	828Ø	27
WVO WVO WVO WVO DE KKNP KKNP KKNP	828Ø	31
V V V V V V V V (LONG SERIES)	828Ø	32
WSL WSL WSL KHNT KHNT	828Ø	34
WSL WSL WSL DE KMSD KMSD KMSD QRK IMI K	828Ø	39
NO READABLE SIGS		44
WAX WAX WAX WAX DE KOKS KGKS KGKS KGKS	828Ø	49
TESTER UP S5	828Ø	53
CQ CQ CQ (ABT 4 STATIONS SENDING)	828Ø	54
WSL WSL WSL WSL DE KMSD KMSD HW K	828Ø	57
KFS KFS KFS KFS DE KOWI KOWI KOWI	828Ø	59
NBA NBA // NET ALERTED 828Ø A1 N MO'S		11Ø1
HRD MO'S VERY WEAK IN BACKGROUND-- ALSO STATION CALLING NMO CUD BE THE SAME DUE TO THE QRM -- S1/2 SIGS	828Ø	Ø5

16—20663-2

(OVER)

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ENTRIES		TIME
GAERTNER RH RM1/C ON WATCH GUARDING 8280 & 12420 & 4805		
TOLE PAGE 4		1105
NPO NPO NPO DE WOGN WOGN QTC	8280	08
WSL WSL DE ANRT ANRT ANRT	8280	08
WSL WSL DE NBA NBA UP		
NBA DE WSL HW	8280	11
WSL DE NBA PSE QSZ K	8280	12
ALERT CANCELLED AT	XXXX	12
WSL WSL DE NMR NMR K	8280	13
WSL WSL DE NMR NMR K	8280	14
WSL WSL DE NMR NMR HW K	8280	14
NMR NBA -- AS FAR AS WE CAN K	8280	15
WSL WSL WSL WSL DE KMSD KMSD QTC	8280	20
WSL WSL WSL WSL DE KMSD KMSD KMSD QRK IMI K	8280	24
KFS KFS KFSKFS DE KVLA KVLA KVLA GM QRU IMI ANS 8380 AR	8280	26
WAX WAX WAX DE KMSD KMSD QRG IMI K	8280	28
KFS KFS KFS DE KVLA KVLA KVLA GM QRU IMI ANS 8380	8280	30
ZE GARBLING ON TWPL --	TWPL	35
TWPL STILL GARBLING -- UNABLE TO CONTACT TELCO--		40
WSL WSL WSL WSL DE KWOQ KWOQ KWOQ BT MSG QTC K	8280	45
WSL DE KWOQ BT R R GM AR K	8280	50
NO SIGS		55
ZE NOTIVIED US THAT LP7 CANCELLED AS OF 1134 - SECURING		1200
4805 KCS-- ZE5 STILL IN EFFECT	TWPL	1204

CERTIFIED COPY OF INTERCEPTED SIGNALS FROM ORIGINAL LOG --

J. R. HAMPTON CH. RDO. ELEC.
COMMANDING OFFICER

U. S. GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE 16—80663-1

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A17C2) Ft. Lauderdale 5 TBM crash SDAC 1945

old 109871
FRC 191353

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NARA 284

Green File Copy

NAVAL AIR ADVANCED TRAINING COMMAND
NMEO-11/AT-3/~~A17-2~~ HEADQUARTERS
UNITED STATES NAVAL AIR STATION
JACKSONVILLE, FLORIDA.

A17(2)

Serial No. 1748

24 JAN 1946

The convening authority notes in Opinion 41 of the board of investigation that the factors contributing to the ineffectiveness of efforts to locate and recover the aircraft of Flight 19 while still airborne were due to excessive interference on the training frequency in use by the flight; failure of the flight to shift to the Air Sea Rescue frequency; failure of the Air Sea Rescue teletype during the critical period; the inability of the HF/DF nets to obtain early and reliable bearings due to interference on the frequency in use by the flight; and lack of complete coordination, understanding, indoctrination, and training in Air Sea Rescue procedures on the part of principal participating units, both within themselves and in combined effort. However, it is considered that the primary reasons for the disappearance of Flight 19 were the confusion of the flight leader as to his location; his failure to take into account the strong winds which apparently carried him farther East than he realized; and his failure to utilize radio aids which were available to him.

It is considered that the coordinated search operations conducted were thorough, adequate and well-organized.

The convening authority is, by separate correspondence, recommending to the Commander Eastern Sea Frontier that he conduct frequent Air Sea Rescue drills utilizing such facilities of this Command as he deems desirable in order to promote complete understanding among all units which might become involved.

Subject to the foregoing remarks, the proceedings, findings and opinion of the board of investigation in the attached case are approved.

RALPH DAVISON,
Rear Admiral, U. S. Navy,
Chief of Naval Air Advanced Training.

CC: CO, NAS, Banana River, Fla.
CO, NAS, Ft. Lauderdale, Fla.
ComSeven (with copy of record of proceedings)
CNO (with copy of record of proceedings)
Commander Eastern Sea Frontier

Record forwarded:
To: SecNav (JAG)
Via: CNATra

(For the purpose of inquiring into and reporting upon the circumstances attending the disappearance of five TBM type aircraft, Bureau Numbers 23307, 46094, 73209, 46325, and 45714, and one PBM aircraft, Bureau Number 59225, which occurred at approximately 1900, 5 December 1945, resulting in the missing status of Naval personnel).

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21 January 1946

MEMORANDUM:

To: Admiral

Via: (1) Training Roper R
(2) Chief of Staff w/

Subj: Attached board of investigation.

1. To attempt to substantiate every Finding of Fact and every Opinion submitted by the board would entail days of careful analytical reading, which obviously we have not attempted to do because of the urgency in forwarding the record. It is evident from a scanned but complete reading that the members of the board did a highly intelligent and thorough job.

2. The only possible technical error that has come to light is related to the "intent, fault, negligence or inefficiency" clause. There is no question that this has been properly done in connection with the PBM (Opinions 47, 48 and 55). However, it appears that the members of the board, after due consideration, were not prepared to express such an opinion on the TBM's because they felt the flight leader, Lt. Charles C. Taylor, had exercised poor judgment. An opinion that the missing status of Taylor and all hands occurred in line of duty and not as a result of misconduct is expressed in Opinion 7. Opinion 45 is to the effect that " No offenses are known to have been committed, nor serious blame incurred by any known person or persons other than that which may be assigned to Lieutenant Charles C. Taylor******for his faulty judgment that contributed to the disappearance ******.

3. I believe it evident that an opinion of no "intent, fault, negligence or inefficiency" must be taken as intended, and therefore, recommend the attached endorsement.

4. With this one exception, subject to our above comments as to the nature of the examination of the record, it is otherwise in good form and meets all the requirements of the JAG?

Respl.
Ryan
LEGAL

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NARA 288

J.NAS 69208 J-4323 3-45 200M

NAVAL AIR OPERATIONAL TRAINING COMMAND
HEADQUARTERS
UNITED STATES NAVAL AIR STATION
JACKSONVILLE, FLORIDA

Date.....

Memo For: Cof S.

I think it would add a great deal to follow your suggestion. Please amend our endorsement accordingly.

Dawson

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J.NAS 69208 J-4323 3-45 200M

NAVAL AIR OPERATIONAL TRAINING COMMAND
HEADQUARTERS
UNITED STATES NAVAL AIR STATION
JACKSONVILLE, FLORIDA

Date.....

Memo For: Admiral

While the record contains the essential information, I wonder if it would add anything to comment on the opinion of the board regarding communication troubles on the 5th, adequacy of searches, and to recommend drills to completely familiarize all hands with procedures.

Respy
W

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RECORD OF PROCEEDINGS

OF A

BOARD OF INVESTIGATION

CONVENED AT THE

U. S. NAVAL AIR STATION, MIAMI, FLORIDA

by order of the

CHIEF OF NAVAL AIR ADVANCED TRAINING

For the purpose of inquiring into and reporting upon the circumstances attending the disappearance of five TBM-type aircraft, Bureau Numbers 23307, 46094, 73209, 46325, and 45714, and one PBM aircraft, Bureau Number 59225, which occurred at approximately 1900, 5 December 1945, resulting in the missing status of Naval personnel.

December 10, 1945

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FINDING OF FACTS

1. That TBM-3, BuNo. 23307, Squadron No. FT-28, Engine No. 124575; TBM-1E, BuNo. 46094, Squadron No. FT-36, Engine No. 66287; TBM-1C, BuNo. 73209, Squadron No. FT-117, Engine No. 34191; TBM-1C, BuNo. 46325, Squadron No. FT-81, Engine No. 63027; and TBM-1C, BuNo. 45714, Squadron No. FT-3, Engine No. 34619, departed at approximately 1410R, 5 December 1945, as Flight 19 on an authorized overwater navigation training flight from U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida.

2. That the authorized overwater navigation training flight assigned to Flight 19 on 5 December 1945 was Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, navigation problem No. 1 which is as follows: (1) depart 26 degrees 03 minutes north and 80 degrees 07 minutes west and fly 091 degrees (T) distance 56 miles to Hen and Chickens Shoals to conduct low level bombing, after bombing continue on course 091 degrees (T) for 67 miles, (2) fly course 346 degrees (T) distance 73 miles and (3) fly course 241 degrees (T) distance 120 miles, then returning to U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida.

3. That Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685, was the authorized pilot who signed for and accepted for flight TBM-3, BuNo. 23307, for Flight 19 on the afternoon of 5 December 1945.

4. That Edward Joseph Powers, Jr., Captain, U.S. Marine Corps, File No. 09789, was the authorized pilot who signed for and accepted for flight TBM-1E, BuNo. 46094, for Flight 19 on the afternoon of 5 December 1945.

5. That George William Stivers, Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 010959, was the authorized pilot who signed for and accepted for flight TBM-1E, BuNo. 73209, for Flight 19 on the afternoon of 5 December 1945.

6. That Forrest James Gerber, Second Lieutenant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, File No. 047223, was the authorized pilot who signed for and accepted for flight TBM-1C, BuNo. 46325, for Flight 19 on the afternoon of 5 December 1945.

7. That Joseph Tipton Bossi, Ensign (A1)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 470677, was the authorized pilot who signed for and accepted for flight TBM-1C, BuNo. 45714, for Flight 19 on the afternoon of 5 December 1945.

8. That Walter Reed Parpart, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 19 16, and Robert Francis Harmon, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 711 02 11, were the authorized aircrew passengers on TBM-3, BuNo. 23307 (pilot Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685) on 5 December 1945.

9. That Howell Orrin Thompson, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 499181, and George Richard Paonessa, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 805639, were the authorized aircrew passengers on TBM-1E, BuNo. 46094 (pilot Edward Joseph Powers, Jr., Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 09789) on 5 December 1945.

10. That Robert Peter Gruebel, private, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 563782, and Robert Francis Gallivan, sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 359343, were the authorized aircrew passengers on TBM-1C, BuNo. 73209 (pilot George William Stivers, Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 010959) on 5 December 1945.

11. That William Earl Lightfoot, private first class, U. S. Marine Corps,

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Reserve, Service No. 519803, was the authorized aircrew passenger on TBM-1C, BuNo. 46325 (pilot Forrest James Gerber, Second Lieutenant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, File No. 047223) on 5 December 1945.

12. That Herman Arthur Thelander, seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 758 44 37, and Burt Edward Baluk, Jr., seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 91 50, were the authorized aircrew passengers on TBM-1C, BuNo. 45714 (pilot Joseph Tipton Bossi, Ensign (A1)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 470677) on 5 December 1945.

13. That TBM-3, BuNo. 23307, Squadron No. FT-28; TBM-1E, BuNo. 46094, Squadron No. FT-36; TBM-1C, BuNo. 73209, Squadron No. FT-117; TBM-1C, BuNo. 46325, Squadron No. FT-81; and TBM-1C, BuNo. 45714, Squadron No. FT-3, and the personnel assigned to these aircraft for Flight 19 that departed from U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, at 1410R, 5 December 1945, are unaccounted for since about 1900R, 5 December 1945.

14. That Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685; Edward Joseph Powers, Jr., Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 09789; George William Stivers, Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 010959; Forrest James Gerber, Second Lieutenant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, File No. 047223; and Joseph Tipton Bossi, Ensign (A1)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 470677, were qualified naval aviators on 5 December 1945.

15. That Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685; Edward Joseph Powers, Jr., Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 09789; George William Stivers, Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 010959; Forrest James Gerber, Second Lieutenant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, File No. 047223; Joseph Tipton B ossi, Ensign (A1)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 470677; Walter Reed Parpart, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 19 16; Robert Francis Harmon, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 711 02 11; Howell Orrin Thompson, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 499181; George Richard Paonessa, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 805639; Robert Peter Gruebel, private, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 563782; Robert Francis Gallivan, sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 359343; William Earl Lightfoot, private first class, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 519803; Herman Arthur Thelander, seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 758 44 37; and Burt Edward Baluk, Jr., seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 91 50, were attached to and serving on active duty in flight status at the U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, on 5 December 1945.

16. That Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685, was the authorized and assigned instructor in charge of Flight 19 which departed from the U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, at 1410R on 5 December 1945.

17. That Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685, was a naval aviator whose flight log indicates a total of 2509.3 hours flying time, and his officer's qualification jacket indicates that he served approximately one year with VS-62 as a scout pilot based at Key West, Florida, and had completed a recent combat tour as a carrier-based torpedo plane pilot attached to the USS HANCOCK.

18. That George William Stivers, Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 010959; Edward Joseph Powers, Jr., Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No.

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09789; Forrest James Gerber, Second Lieutenant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, File No. 047223; and Joseph Tipton Bossi, Ensign (A1)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 470677, were naval aviators undergoing instruction in VTB Type Advanced Training at U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, on 5 December 1945.

19. That Walter Reed Parpart, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 19 16; Howell Orrin Thompson, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 499181; George Richard Paonessa, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 805639; Robert Peter Gruebel, private, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 563782; Robert Francis Gallivan, sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 359343; William Earl Lightfoot, private first class, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 519803; Herman Arthur Thelander, seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 758 44 37; and Burt Edward Baluk, Jr., seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 91 50, were undergoing Advanced Combat Aircrew Training in VTB type aircraft on 5 December 1945.

20. That Robert Francis Harmon, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 711 02 11, was in a flight duty status, assigned to the Gunnery Department at the U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, on 5 December 1945.

21. That Edward Joseph Powers, Jr., Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 09789; George William Stivers, Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 010959; Forrest James Gerber, Second Lieutenant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, File No. 047223; and Joseph Tipton Bossi, Ensign (A1)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 470677, completed, prior to 5 December 1945, the required ground training syllabus for VTB Type Advanced Training.

22. That Walter Reed Parpart, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 19 16; Howell Orrin Thompson, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 499181; George Richard Paonessa, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 805639; Robert Peter Gruebel, private, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 563782; Robert Francis Gallivan, sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 359343; William Earl Lightfoot, private first class, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 519803; Herman Arthur Thelander, seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 758 44 37; and Burt Edward Baluk, Jr., seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 91 50, completed the ground training syllabus for aircrewmen in VTB Type Aircraft Advanced Training prior to 5 December 1945.

23. That Lieutenant Robert F. Cox, U. S. Navy, at approximately 1600R, on 5 December 1945, while piloting FT-74 in the vicinity of the U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, established communication with FT-28 leading Flight 19 and he, while flying toward the reported position of FT-28 which was the Florida Keys, experienced a fading radio signal from FT-28.

24. That U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, learned at 1611R, 5 December 1945, that FT-28 was uncertain as to his position.

25. That Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 at Port Everglades, Florida, was aware of the difficulty of FT-28 at approximately 1620R, on 5 December 1945.

26. That the Joint Operations Center of the Gulf Sea Frontier Air Sea Rescue organization was aware of the difficulty of FT-28 at approximately 1630R on 5 December 1945.

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27. That at 1647R, 5 December 1945, the Gulf Sea Frontier and Eastern Sea Frontier HF/DF nets were alerted to obtain all possible bearings on transmissions from FT-28, who was transmitting on 4805 kilocycles.

28. That at approximately 1800R, 5 December 1945, an approximate HF/DF fix was obtained on FT-28 placing FT-28 within a one hundred mile radius of 29 degrees, 15 minutes north, 79 degrees, 00 minutes west, at 1750R.

29. That the 1750R HF/DF evaluated position was telephoned to the tower at U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, at about 1810R, 5 December 1945.

30. That the 1750R HF/DF evaluated position was transmitted on the Gulf Sea Frontier and Eastern Sea Frontier HF/DF teletype nets and Air Sea Rescue teletype net of the Gulf Sea Frontier at approximately 1836R, 5 December 1945.

31. That at 1820R an Air Sea Rescue dumbo was airborne from Coast Guard Air Station, Dinner Key, Florida, to attempt to regain communications with the planes of Flight 19 on 4805 kilocycles.

32. That the Air Sea Rescue dumbo from Dinner Key Coast Guard Air Station was unsuccessful in its endeavors to contact Flight 19.

33. That the YG homing device at U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, was functioning properly at approximately 1625R on 5 December 1945.

34. That extensive search operations by surface craft and aircraft from 6 December to 10 December, inclusive, conducted over land and sea areas adjacent to the Florida peninsula failed to discover any wreckage or locate any survivors of the five TBM's comprising Flight 19 on 5 December 1945.

35. That PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, Squadron Training No. 49, Engines No. P-54213 and 52187, departed at approximately 1927R, 5 December 1945, on an authorized Air Sea Rescue search mission from U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida.

36. That an "out" report sent by radio was received by the U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida, from PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, Squadron Training No. 49, at about 1930R, 5 December 1945, and no further communications were received from said airplane after that time.

37. That the authorized Air Sea Rescue mission assigned to PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, on 5 December 1945, was as follows: Depart U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, and proceed to 29 degrees north and the east coast of Florida, thence fly east to 29 degrees north, 79 degrees west, there to conduct an expanding square search.

38. That Walter G. Jeffrey, Lieutenant (junior grade), U. S. Navy, File No. 329291, was the authorized patrol plane commander who signed for and accepted for flight PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, on 5 December 1945.

39. That Harry G. Cone, Lieutenant (junior grade)(Al), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 378634; Roger M. Allen, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 466015; and Lloyd A. Eliason, Ensign, (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 465964, were the authorized and assigned co-pilots of PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, Squadron No. 49, for the search mission launched from U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida, at 1927R on 5 December 1945.

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40. That Charles D. Arceneaux, Ensign (Al)T, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 409770, was the authorized and assigned radar officer of PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, for the search mission launched from U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida, at 1927R on 5 December 1945.

41. That Alfred J. Zywicki, seaman first class (aviation ordnanceman), U.S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 727 69 79; James F. Osterheld, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 378 95 75; John T. Menendez, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 268 84 98; Philip B. Neeman, seaman first class (aviation radioman), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 247 11 21; James F. Jordon, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 887 76 08; Robert C. Cameron, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 574 04 17; Wiley D. Cargill, seaman first class (aviation machinist's mate), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 975 90 12; and Donald E. Peterson, aviation machinist's mate first class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 382 88 99, were the authorised and assigned crew members of PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, Squadron No. 49, for the search mission launched from U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, at 1927R on 5 December 1945.

42. That Walter G. Jeffrey, Lieutenant (junior grade), U. S. Navy, File No. 329291; Harry G. Cone, Lieutenant (junior grade)(Al), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 378634; Roger M. Allen, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 466015; and Lloyd A. Eliason, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 465964, were qualified naval aviators on 5 December 1945.

43. That Walter G. Jeffrey, Lieutenant (junior grade), U. S. Navy, File No. 329291; Harry G. Cone, Lieutenant (junior grade)(Al), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 378634; Roger M. Allen, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 466015; Lloyd A. Eliason, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 465964; Charles D. Arceneaux, Ensign (Al)T, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 409770; Alfred J. Zywicki, seaman first class (aviation ordnanceman), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 727 69 79; James F. Osterheld, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 378 95 75; John T. Menendez, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 268 84 98; Philip B. Neeman, seaman first class (aviation radioman), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 247 11 21; Robert C. Cameron, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 574 04 17; James F. Jordon, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 887 76 08; Wiley D. Cargill, seaman first class (aviation machinist's mate), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 975 90 12; Donald E. Peterson, aviation machinist's mate first class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 382 88 99, were attached to and serving on active duty in a flight status at the U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida, on 5 December 1945.

44. That Walter G. Jeffrey, Lieutenant (junior grade), U. S. Navy, File No. 329291, was an ATU, U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida, instructor and patrol plane commander whose flight log indicates a total of 1917.8 hours flying time.

45. That Harry G. Cone, Lieutenant (junior grade)(Al), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 378634; Roger M. Allen, Ensign (Al), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 466015; and Lloyd A. Eliason, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 465964, were naval aviators undergoing instruction in VPB type Advanced Training at U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida, and were members of Combat Airerew 88Q on 5 December 1945.

46. That Charles D. Arceneaux, Ensign (Al)T, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No.

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409770, was a student radar officer on temporary duty involving flying under instruction at the U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida, on 5 December 1945.

47. That Donald E. Peterson, aviation machinist's mate first class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 382 88 99; Wiley D. Cargill, seaman first class (aviation machinist's mate), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 975 90 12; Robert C. Cameron, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 574 04 17; James F. Jordon, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 887 76 08; Philip B. Neeman, seaman first class (aviation radioman), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 247 11 21; John T. Menendez, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 268 84 98; James F. Osterheld, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 378 95 75; and Alfred J. Zywicki, seaman first class (aviation ordnanceman), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 727 69 79, were undergoing Advanced Combat Aircrew Training in VPB type aircraft and were members of Combat Aircrew 88G at U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida, on 5 December 1945.

48. That the officers and men comprising Combat Aircrew 88G were undergoing training at the U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida, and had obtained approximately 160.1 hours flight time as an operating crew in PBM type aircraft.

49. That Harry G. Cone, Lieutenant (junior grade) (Al), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 378634; Roger M. Allen, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 466015; Lloyd A. Eliason, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 465964, completed, prior to 5 December 1945, the required ground training syllabus for Advanced Training in VPB type aircraft.

50. That Donald E. Peterson, aviation machinist's mate first class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 382 88 99; Wiley D. Cargill, seaman first class (Aviation machinist's mate), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 975 90 12; Robert C. Cameron, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 574 04 17; James F. Jordon, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 887 76 08; Philip B. Neeman, seaman first class (Aviation radioman), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 247 11 21; John T. Menendez, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 268 84 98; James F. Osterheld, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 378 95 75; and Alfred J. Zywicki, seaman first class (aviation ordnanceman), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 727 69 79, completed, prior to 5 December 1945, the ground training syllabus for aircrewmen in Advanced Training in VPB type aircraft.

51. That Donald E. Peterson, aviation machinist's mate first class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 382 88 99, was the authorized and assigned plane captain of Combat Aircrew 88G, who was checked and certified as qualified to solo as plane captain in PBM type aircraft on 22 October 1945.

52. That PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, Squadron No. 49, and the assigned personnal aboard are unaccounted for since about 1930R, 5 December 1945.

53. That the hourly position report due at 2030R from PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, was not received at U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida, on 5 December 1945.

54. That at 2115R on 5 December 1945 the SS GAINES MILLS reported as fol-

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lows: "At 0050 G.M.T. observed burst of flames, apparently explosion, leaping flames 100 feet high burning ten minutes. Position 28 degrees, 59 minutes north, 80 degrees 25 minutes west. At present, passing through big pool oil at 0119 G.M.T. Stopped, circled area using search lights, looking for survivors. None found."

55. That USS SOLOMONS CVE67 dispatch 06127 reported as follows: "Our air search radar showed plane after takeoff from Banana River last night joining with another plane, then separation and proceeding on course 045 degrees at exact time SS GAINES MILLS sighted flames and in exact spot the above plane disappeared from the radar screen and never reappeared".

56. That concentrated search operations from 6 December to 10 December 1945, inclusive, by surface and aircraft in the area of the reported explosion failed to reveal any debris of the missing PBM or evidence of its crew.

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OPINION

The board, from all evidence before it, is of the opinion:

1. That Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685; Walter Reed Parpart, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 19 16, and Robert Francis Harmon, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 711 02 11, are missing as a result of the disappearance of TBM-3, BuNo. 23307, Squadron No. FT-28, on 5 December 1945.

2. That Robert Francis Harmon, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 711 02 11, who is missing as a result of the disappearance of TBM-3, BuNo. 23307, Squadron No. FT-28, enlisted fraudulently under this assumed name and that his legal name is George Francis Devlin.

3. That George William Stivers, Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 010959; Robert Peter Gruebel, private, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 563782; and Robert Francis Gallivan, sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 359343, are missing as a result of the disappearance of TBM-1C, BuNo. 73209, Squadron No. FT-117, on 5 December 1945.

4. That Edward Joseph Powers, Jr., Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 09789; Howell Orrin Thompson, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 499181; and George Richard Paonessa, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 805639, are missing as a result of the disappearance of TBM-1E, BuNo. 46094, Squadron No. FT-36, on 5 December 1945.

5. That Forrest James Gerber, Second Lieutenant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, File No. 047223; and William Earl Lightfoot, private first class, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 519803, are missing as a result of the disappearance of TBM-1E, BuNo. 46325, Squadron No. FT-81, on 5 December 1945.

6. That Joseph Tipton Bossi, Ensign (A1)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 470677; Herman Arthur Thelander, seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 758 44 37; and Burt Edward Baluk, Jr., seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 91 50, are missing as a result of the disappearance of TBM-1C, BuNo. 45714, Squadron No. FT-3, on 5 December 1945.

7. That Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685; Walter Reed Parpart, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 19 16; Robert Francis Harmon, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 711 02 11; Edward Joseph Powers, Jr., Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 09789; Howell Orrin Thompson, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 499181; George Richard Paonessa, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 805639; George William Stivers, Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 010959; Robert Peter Gruebel, private, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 563782; Robert Francis Gallivan, sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 359343; Forrest James Gerber, Second Lieutenant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, File No. 047223; William Earl Lightfoot, private first class, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 519803; Joseph Tipton Bossi, Ensign (A1)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 470677; Herman Arthur Thelander, seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 758 44 37; and Burt Edward Baluk, Jr., seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 91 50, are missing in line of duty and not as a result of their own misconduct.

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8. That Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685, instructor in charge of Flight 19 and pilot of FT-28, had sufficient experience, training, and aviation background to be a qualified VTB senior instructor capable of leading an overwater navigation training flight such as was assigned to Flight 19 on the afternoon of 5 December 1945.

9. That all personnel of Flight 19 had received ample instruction for proper and safe conduct of flight in TBM aircraft engaged in overwater navigational training.

10. That Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685; Edward Joseph Powers, Jr., Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 09789; George William Stivers, Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 010959; Forrest James Gerber, Second Lieutenant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, File No. 047223; and Joseph Tipton Bossi, Ensign (A1)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 470677, were physically qualified and temperamentally adapted for actual control of aircraft on 5 December 1945.

11. That Walter Reed Parpart, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 19 16; Robert Francis Harmon, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 711 02 11; Howell Orrin Thompson, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 499181; George Richard Paonessa, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 805639; Robert Peter Gruebel, private, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 563782; Robert Francis Gallivan, sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 359343; William Earl Lightfoot, private first class, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 519803; Herman Arthur Thelander, seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 758 44 37; and Burt Edward Baluk, Jr., seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 91 50, were physically qualified and temperamentally adapted for flight in aircraft on 5 December 1945.

12. That the weather over the area covered by the track of the navigation problem assigned to Flight 19 on 5 December 1945 was average, to below average, for a training flight of this nature.

13. That TBM-3, BuNo. 23307, Squadron No. FT-28; TBM-1Z, BuNo. 46094, Squadron No. FT-36; TBM-1C, BuNo. 75209, Squadron No. FT-117; TBM-1C, BuNo. 46325, Squadron No. FT-81; TBM-1C, BuNo. 45714, Squadron No. FT-3, were in satisfactory operating condition and properly equipped for an overwater navigation training flight on 5 December 1945.

14. That an intercepted radio transmission between the pilots of Flight 19 at approximately 1545R, 5 December 1945, was the first indication that the instructor of Flight 19 in FT-28 was uncertain of his position.

15. That intermittent and unsatisfactory radio communications on 4805 kilocycles was carried out between Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 at Port Everglades, Florida, and FT-28, leader of Flight 19, from 1620R to 1755R, 5 December 1945.

16. That unsatisfactory radio communication on 4805 kilocycles was due to interference from Cuban broadcasting stations, static, the presence of a steady carrier note, and atmospheric conditions during this time.

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17. That the leader of Flight 19 in FT-28 was uncertain as to in what direction lay the peninsula of Florida and this uncertainty influenced his later decisions.

18. That the Air Sea Rescue frequency of 3000 kilocycles was not utilized in accordance with existing instructions by any of the aircraft of Flight 19 on 5 December 1945.

19. That shore-based radars provided no effective assistance in locating any of the aircraft of Flight 19 on 5 December 1945.

20. That difficulty was experienced in obtaining the HF/DF bearings on the aircraft of Flight 19 after the Gulf Sea Frontier/Eastern Sea Frontier nets were alerted because of interference on 4805 kilocycles.

21. That the Air Sea Rescue Gulf Sea Frontier teletype was out of commission south of Banana River during the critical period on the evening of 5 December 1945.

22. That no Air Sea Rescue activities engaged in assisting Flight 19 were in successful communication with the flight after the receipt of the evaluated fix.

23. That no activity associated with assiting Flight 19 made blind transmissions or radio broadcasts of the 1750R evaluated position to any aircraft of that flight.

24. That the YG homing device at the U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, was functioning properly on the evening of 5 December 1945.

25. That the 1750R, 5 December 1945, evaluated position obtained by HF/DF bearings represents a highly probable location of Flight 19 at that time.

26. That the nature of the navigation problem assigned to Flight 19 on 5 December 1945 and the force and direction of the surface wind and winds aloft would preclude the probability of Flight 19 at any time reaching a position south or west of the peninsula of Florida.

27. That Flight 19 departed on the first leg of its assigned navigation training flight on 5 December 1945 led by an unknown student member of that flight.

28. That Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685, the instructor in charge of Flight 19, flew in a tracking position for an undetermined period after the start of the navigation flight to a point somewhere along the second leg.

29. That Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685, instructor in charge of the flight, believed that Flight 19 was not on the prescribed track of the assigned navigational problem at some time prior to 1545R and, therefore, assumed the lead of the flight with the intention of correcting its position.

30. That Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685, after assuming lead of Flight 19 in FT-28, concluded that

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his compasses were not working and at approximately 1545R was undecided as to his position.

31. That Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685, in FT-28, at approximately 1545R was over broken land which he believed to be in the Florida Keys.

32. That Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685, led Flight 19 on undetermined courses for undetermined lengths of time when, at some time prior to 1645R, he turned to 030 degrees intending to fly for a period of forty-five minutes, thence to fly north in order to assure himself that he was not in the Gulf of Mexico.

33. That prior to 1715R Flight 19 assumed a course of 270 degrees with the intention expressed by Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685, of flying until he reached mainland or exhausted his fuel supply.

34. That at some undetermined time prior to 1850R Edward Joseph Powers, Jr., Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 09789, in TBM-1E, BuNo. 46094, Squadron No. FT-36, assumed the lead of Flight 19 and maintained a course of 270 degrees.

35. That at 1806R Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685, suggested to Edward Joseph Powers, Jr., Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 09789, to change course to the east again, assuming that the flight was still over the Gulf of Mexico.

36. That the courses flown by Flight 19 subsequent to 1807R are undetermined.

37. That the aircraft of Flight 19 made forced landings in darkness at sea east of the peninsula of Florida sometime after 1904R on 5 December 1945.

38. That the state of the sea in the area in which Flight 19 was presumed to have landed was rough and unfavorable for a water landing.

39. That the fuel supply of the aircraft in Flight 19 on 5 December 1945 should have permitted them to remain airborne until approximately 2000R.

40. That the Air Sea Rescue efforts to assist the return of Flight 19 on the evening of 5 December 1945 were ineffective.

41. That the following factors contributed to the ineffectiveness of the over-all Air Sea Rescue effort in the attempt to locate and recover the aircraft of Flight 19 before they were presumed to have been forced down by fuel exhaustion:

(a) Excessive interference on the training frequency, 4805 kilocycles, in use by Flight 19.

(b) Failure of the aircraft concerned to shift to the Air Sea Rescue frequency of 3000 kilocycles which was guarded by all the Air Sea Rescue activities.

(c) The failure of Air Sea Rescue Gulf Sea Frontier teletype during the critical period.

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(d) The inability of the HF/DF nets to obtain early and reliable bearings on 4805 kilocycles due to interference.

(e) Lack of complete coordination, understanding, indoctrination, and training in Air Sea Rescue procedures on the part of principal participating units, both within themselves and in combined effort.

42. That the principal participating units in the Air Sea Rescue efforts on the evening of 5 December 1945 were:

(a) U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida.

(b) U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida, and attached Air Sea Rescue activity.

(c) Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4, Port Everglades, Florida.

(d) Joint Operations Center, Gulf Sea Frontier, Miami, Florida.

43. That the coordinated search operations conducted under the direction of Joint Operations Center, Gulf Sea Frontier, Miami, Florida, from 6 December to 10 December 1945, inclusive, utilized sufficiently large numbers of surface vessels and aircraft in those areas in which survivors of Flight 19 were presumed to have been located to satisfactorily cover those areas.

44. That the disappearance of TBM-3, BuNo. 23307, Squadron No. FT-28; TBM-1E, BuNo. 46094, Squadron No. FT-36; TBM-1C, BuNo. 73209, Squadron No. FT-117; TBM-1C, BuNo. 46325, Squadron No. FT-81; and TBM-1C, BuNo. 45714, Squadron No. FT-3, resulting in the missing status of Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685; Walter Reed Parpart, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 19 16; Robert Francis Harmon, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 711 02 11; Edward Joseph Powers, Jr., Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 09789; Howell Orrin Thompson, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 499181; George Richard Paonessa, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 805639; George William Stivers, Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 010959; Robert Peter Gruebel, private, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 563782; Robert Francis Gallivan, sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 359343; Forrest James Gerber, Second Lieutenant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, File No. 047223; William Earl Lightfoot, private first class, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 519803; Joseph Tipton Bossi, Ensign (A1)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 470677; Herman Arthur Thelander, seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 758 44 37; and Burt Edward Baluk, Jr., seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 91 50, was caused by a temporary mental confusion resulting in faulty judgment on the part of the flight leader and instructor of Flight 19, Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685, permitting himself to lose knowledge of his general position relative to the peninsula of Florida, and failure on his part to utilize the facilities available to him in his flight for orientating himself.

45. That no offenses are known to have been committed, nor serious blame incurred by any known person or persons other than that which may be assigned to Lieutenant Charles Carroll Taylor, (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685, the flight instructor in charge of Flight 19 for his faulty judgment that contributed to the disappearance of TBM-3, BuNo. 23307, Squadron No. FT-28; TBM-1E, BuNo. 46094, Squadron No. FT-36; TBM-1C, BuNo. 73209, Squadron No. FT-117; TBM-1C, BuNo. 46325, Squadron No. FT-81; and TBM-1C, BuNo. 45714, Squadron No. FT-3, resulting in the missing status of Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685; Walter Reed Parpart, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 19 16; Robert Francis Harmon, aviation ordnanceman third class, Service No. 711 02 11; Edward Joseph Powers, Jr., Captain

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U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 09789; Howell Orrin Thompson, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 499181; George Richard Pacnessa, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 805639; George William Stivers, Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 010959; Robert Peter Grusbel, private, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 563782; Robert Francis Sullivan, sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 359343; Forrest James Gerber, Second Lieutenant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, File No. 047223; William Earl Lightfoot, private first class, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 519805; Joseph Tipton Bossi, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 470677; Herman Arthur Thelander, seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 756 44 37; and Burt Edward Saluk, Jr., seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 91 60.

46. That Walter G. Jeffrey, Lieutenant (junior grade), U. S. Navy, File No. 329291; Harry G. Cone, Lieutenant (junior grade) (Al), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 378634; Roger M. Allen, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 466015; Lloyd A. Eliason, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 465964; Charles D. Arceneaux, Ensign (Al)T, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 409770; Alfred J. Zywicki, seaman first class (aviation ordnanceman), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 727 69 79; James F. Osterheld, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 378 95 75; John T. Menendez, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 268 84 98; Philip B. Neeman, seaman first class (aviation radioman), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 247 11 21; James F. Jordon, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 887 76 08; Robert C. Cameron, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 574 04 17; Wiley D. Cargill, seaman first class (aviation machinist's mate), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 975 90 12; and Donald E. Peterson, aviation machinist's mate first class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 382 88 99, are missing as the result of the disappearance of PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, Squadron No. 49.

47. That Walter G. Jeffrey, Lieutenant (junior grade), U. S. Navy, File No. 329291; Harry G. Cone, Lieutenant (junior grade) (Al), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 378634; Roger M. Allen, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 466015; Lloyd A. Eliason, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 465964; Charles D. Arceneaux, Ensign (Al)T, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 409770; Alfred J. Zywicki, seaman first class (aviation ordnanceman), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 727 69 79; James F. Osterheld, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 378 95 75; John T. Menendez, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 268 84 98; Philip B. Neeman, seaman first class (aviation radioman), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 247 11 21; James F. Jordon, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 887 76 08; Robert C. Cameron, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 574 04 17; Wiley D. Cargill, seaman first class (aviation machinist's mate), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 975 90 12; and Donald E. Peterson, aviation machinist's mate first class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 382 88 99, are missing in the line of duty and not as the result of their own misconduct.

48. That the disappearance of PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, Squadron Training No. 49, resulting in the missing status of Walter G. Jeffrey, Lieutenant (junior grade), U. S. Navy, File No. 329291; Harry G. Cone, Lieutenant (junior grade) (Al), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 378634; Roger M. Allen, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 466015; Lloyd A. Eliason, Ensign (Al)L, U. S.

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Naval Reserve, File No. 465964; Charles C. Arceneaux, Ensign (Al)T, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 409770; Alfred J. Zywicki, seaman first class, (aviation ordnanceman), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 727 69 79; James F. Osterheld, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 378 95 75; John T. Menendez, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 268 84 98; Philip B. Neeman, seaman first class (aviation radioman), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 247 11 21; James F. Jordon, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 887 76 08; Robert C. Cameron, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 574 04 17; Wiley D. Cargill, seaman first class (aviation machinist's mate), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 975 90 12; and Donald E. Peterson, aviation machinist's mate first class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 382 38 99, was not caused in any manner by the intent, fault, negligence, or inefficiency of any known person or persons in the naval service or connected therewith.

49. That PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, Squadron Training No. 49, was in satisfactory operating condition and properly equipped for a search mission at the time it was launched at 1927R on 5 December 1945.

50. That the crew assigned to PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, Squadron Training No. 49, on the evening of 5 December 1945, was competent and fully qualified to perform the duties essential to the mission assigned.

51. That Walter G. Jeffrey, Lieutenant (junior grade), U. S. Navy, File No. 329291, volunteered to act as patrol plane commander of PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, Squadron Training No. 49, for the night search mission on 5 December 1945, and in doing so displayed a keen sense of duty and commendable spirit.

52. That the weather conditions over the area assigned to PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, Squadron Training No. 49, on the night of 5 December 1945 were undesirable, but not unduly hazardous for the mission assigned.

53. That PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, exploded in the sea for reason or reasons unknown in the approximate position of 28 degrees, 59 minutes north, 80 degrees, 25 minutes west.

54. That thorough and extensive searches of the sea areas in and adjacent to 28 degrees, 59 minutes north, 80 degrees, 25 minutes west, were conducted during the period 5-10 December 1945, inclusive, for possible survivors of PBM-5, BuNo. 59225.

55. That no offenses are known to have been committed or serious blame incurred by any known person in connection with the disappearance of PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, resulting in the missing status of Walter G. Jeffrey, Lieutenant (junior grade), U. S. Navy, File No. 329291; Harry G. Cone, Lieutenant (junior grade) (Al), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 378634; Roger M. Allen, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 466015; Lloyd A. Eliason, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 465964; Charles D. Arceneaux, Ensign (Al)T, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 409770; Alfred J. Zywicki, seaman first class (aviation ordnanceman), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 727 69 79; James F. Osterheld, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 378 95 75; John T. Menendez, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 268 84 98; Philip B. Neeman, seaman first class (aviation radioman), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 247 11 21; James F. Jordon, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 887 76 08; Robert C.

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Cameron, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 574 04 17, Wiley D. Cargill, seaman first class, (aviation machinist's mate), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 975 90 12; Donald E. Peterson, aviation machinist's mate first class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 382 88 99.

56. That the various logs and records as submitted in evidence by all the participating activities are incomplete, compiled from direct logged communications, memory, notes, and memoranda, and are difficult to reconcile one with the other and with the testimony in some cases, but do represent the best records available.

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RECORD OF PROCEEDINGS

OF AN INVESTIGATION

CONDUCTED AT

THE U. S. NAVAL AIR STATION, MIAMI, FLORIDA

For the purpose of inquiring into and reporting upon the circumstances attending the disappearance of five TBM-type aircraft, Bureau Numbers 23307, 46094, 73209, 46325, and 45714, and one PBM aircraft, Bureau Number 59225, which occurred at approximately 1900, 5 December 1945, resulting in the missing status of naval personnel.

December 10, 1945.

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John Harding, Commander, U. S. Coast Guard, Assistant Operations Officer, Gulf Sea Frontier, Miami	109, 110, 111
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GLOSSARY

Term	Meaning of Term
FT-28	Lieutenant Charles C. Taylor's plane call
FT-74	Lieutenant Robert F. Cox's plane call
LM	HF/DF Station, Jupiter, Florida
LO	HF/DF Station, Pensacola, Florida
LP	HF/DF Station, Houma, Florida
NFF	HF/DF Station, San Juan, Puerto Rico
NHA-1 (NAN HOW ABLE ONE)	Operations Radio, U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida
NHA-3 (NAN HOW ABLE THREE)	Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 (Radio), Port Everglades, Florida
NHA-8 (NAN HOW ABLE EIGHT)	Ambulance, U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida
NHA-41 (NAN HOW ABLE FORTY-ONE)	Air Sea Rescue Crash Boat, U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida
NPB (NAN PETER BAKER)	Operations Radio, U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida
NSO	Miami Radio, Miami, Florida
NV	Coast Guard Leased Radio Station, New Orleans, Louisiana
WAX	Coast Guard Leased Radio Station, Miami, Florida
ZE	Joint Operations Center, Seventh Naval District, Miami, Florida

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MM29-11/OT-3/A17(2)

NAVAL AIR ADVANCED TRAINING COMMAND
HEADQUARTERS
UNITED STATES NAVAL AIR STATION
JACKSONVILLE, FLORIDA

Serial No. 33436 — 7 December 1945.

From: Chief of Naval Air Advanced Training.
To: Captain Albert K. Morehouse, U. S. Navy, U. S. Naval Air Station, Miami, Florida.

Subj: Board of investigation to inquire into and report upon the circumstances attending the disappearance of five TBM type aircraft, bureau numbers 23307, 46094, 73209, 46325, and 45714, and one PBM aircraft, bureau number 59225, which occurred at approximately 1900, 5 December 1945, resulting in the missing status of naval personnel.

Ref: (a) CNAAdTra dispatch 061615 dtd. 6 Dec. 1945.

1. A board of investigation consisting of yourself as senior member and of Commander Joseph T. Yaveraky, U. S. Navy, and Commander Howard S. Roberts, U. S. Navy, as additional members, and of Lieutenant Commander Richard S. Roberts, U. S. Navy, as recorder, will convene at the earliest opportunity at the U. S. Naval Air Station, Miami, Florida, for the purpose of inquiring into and reporting upon the circumstances attending the disappearance of five TBM type aircraft, bureau numbers 23307, 46094, 73209, 46325, 45714, and one PBM aircraft bureau number 59225, which occurred at approximately 1900, 5 December 1945, resulting in the missing status of naval personnel.

2. The board will make a thorough investigation into the matter hereby submitted to it, and will include in its findings a full statement of the facts it may deem to be established. The board will further give its opinion as to whether any offenses have been committed or serious blame incurred.

3. The board is hereby empowered and directed to administer an oath to each witness attending to testify or depose during the course of the proceedings of the board of investigation. Hearings may be held at such places as the board may deem appropriate.

4. The proceedings of the board will be conducted in accordance with the provisions of chapter X, Naval Courts and Boards, and the board will give the opinions called for by section 723.

5. The attention of the board is particularly invited to section 734, Naval Courts and Boards.

6. The Commanding Officer, U. S. Naval Air Station, Miami, Florida, is hereby directed to furnish the necessary clerical assistance. In addition to the record of proceedings and copies required by Naval Courts and Boards, you are directed to make four copies for the convening authority.

RALPH DAVISON,
Rear Admiral, U. S. Navy,
Chief of Naval Air Advanced Training.

CC: CO, NAS, Banana River, Fla; CO, NAS, Ft. Lauderdale, Fla.;
CO, NAS, Miami, Fla.; CNATra; COM7.

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FIRST DAY

U. S. Naval Air Station
Miami, Florida
Monday, December 10, 1945

The board met at 9:30 a.m.

Present:
Captain Albert K. Morehouse, U. S. Navy, senior member;
Commander Joseph T. Yavorsky, U. S. Navy, member;
Commander Howard S. Roberts, U. S. Navy, member; and
Lieutenant Commander Richard S. Roberts, U. S. Navy, recorder.

The recorder introduced Elvera M. Erquist, yeoman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, and Margaret L. Anderson, yeoman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, as reporters, who were duly sworn.

The convening order, hereto prefixed, was read, and the board determined its procedure and decided to sit with open doors.

No witnesses not otherwise connected with the investigation were present.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Thomas H. Jenkins, Commander, U. S. Naval Reserve, attached to U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida.

2. Q. What are your particular duties?
A. Aviation Training Officer.

3. Q. State to the board what you know concerning the loss of the five TBM aircraft at U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, and the disappearance of naval personnel on 5 December 1945.
A. Referring to my records as Aviation Training Officer, the five TBM aircraft that were lost on 5 December 1945 were attached to the U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida. They were on a regularly scheduled navigation hop to seaward. Their scheduled takeoff time was for 1345, but the hop was delayed and they actually departed at 1410. We and the Port Everglades Boat Facility had some radio communication with them, but this eventually faded out and the aircraft were declared missing and have never been heard from since. The leader of the flight was Lieutenant Charles Carroll Taylor, (Al), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685, pilot of TBM-3, aircraft BuNo. 23307, Squadron No. FT-28, who was then attached to the U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, as a senior qualified VTB flight instructor. Lieutenant Taylor's passengers were Walter Reed Parpart, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 19 16, who was temporarily attached to the U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, undergoing training as a combat aircrewman, and Robert Francis Harmon, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 711 02 11, who was permanently attached to the U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida. He was a permanent flight order man assigned to duty in the gunnery department. The students in Lieutenant Taylor's flight were Captain Edward Joseph Powers, Jr., U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 09789, pilot of TBM-1E, aircraft BuNo. 46094, Squadron No. FT-36. Captain Powers was temporarily attached to the

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U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, undergoing flight training in VTB ATU No. 1. His passengers were Howell Orrin Thompson, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 499181, who was temporarily attached to the U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, undergoing training as a combat aircrewman and George Richard Paonessa, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 308639, who was temporarily attached to the U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, undergoing training as a combat aircrewman. TBM-1C, aircraft BuNo. 73209, Squadron No. FT-117, was piloted by Captain George William Stivers, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 010959, who was temporarily attached to the U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, undergoing flight training in VTB ATU No. 1. His passengers were Robert Peter Gruebel, private, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 563782, who was temporarily attached to the U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, undergoing training as a combat aircrewman, and Robert Francis Gallivan, sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 389343, who was temporarily attached to U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, undergoing training as a combat aircrewman. The pilot of TBM-1C, aircraft BuNo. 46325, Squadron No. FT-81, was Second Lieutenant Forrest James Gerber, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, File No. 047223, who was temporarily attached to U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, undergoing flight training in VTB ATU No. 1. He had one passenger, William Earl Lightfoot, private first class, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 519303, who was temporarily attached to U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, undergoing training as a combat aircrewman. TBM-1C, aircraft BuNo. 45714, Squadron No. FT-3, was piloted by Ensign Joseph Tipton Bossi, (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 470677. Ensign Bossi was temporarily attached to U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, undergoing flight training in VTB ATU No. 1. His passengers were Herman Arthur Thelander, seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 756 44 37, who was temporarily attached to U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, undergoing training as a combat aircrewman, and Burt Edward Baluk, Jr., seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 91 50, who was temporarily attached to U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, undergoing training as a combat aircrewman. The five aircraft involved comprised Flight No. 19 and took off from the main station field of U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, at 1410, on 5 December 1945. Flight No. 19 was due to return at 1723, 5 December 1945. It was a regularly authorized and scheduled advanced training, over-water, day navigation flight. The destination of the flight was our navigation problem No. 1 which is; depart 26 degrees, 03 minutes north and 80 degrees, 07 minutes west, and fly 091 degrees true distance 56 miles to Hen and Chickens Islands to conduct low level bombing. After bombing, continue on course 091 degrees true for 67 miles. The second leg was course 346 degrees true for a distance of 73 miles. The third, and final, leg was to fly course 241 degrees true for 120 miles, which would return them to U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida. I give you herewith a chart of the navigational flights as flown from U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida. The flight marked No. 1 is the one involved in this investigation.

The chart produced by the witness was submitted to the board and offered in evidence. There being no objection, it was so received and marked "Exhibit 1."

The witness continued:

Lieutenant Taylor had a total flight time of 2609.3 hours. He served at U.S. Naval Air Station, Miami, Florida, as a VTB type instructor for a period of

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approximately six months and, prior to that, was in a combat squadron in this particular type of plane. Ensign Bossi had a total flight time of 373.4 hours, 65.9 of which was in VTB. Second Lieutenant Gerber had a total flight time of 360.6 hours, 61.8 hours of which was in VTB. Captain Powers had a total flight time of 344.9 hours, 62.2 hours of which was in VTB, and Captain Stivers had a total flight time of 374.7 hours, 57.9 hours of which was in VTB. Prior to the flight, the yellow sheets indicated no deficiencies in any of the aircraft involved. All required safety equipment was in the planes.

4. Q. Commander Jenkins, state to the board the procedure of briefing pilots covering their navigational problem.

A. The students receive all of their instructions for flights through the ground training course. They are given their navigation and communication lectures prior to their navigational flights. They are then briefed by their instructor immediately before the flight. It is the instructor's responsibility to obtain winds and other pertinent weather data from our operations department. When he has given this information to the students, he is ready to man his planes for the flight. The problem itself is worked out under the supervision of the instructor and each student's navigation is checked by other students and the instructor prior to departing on the flight.

5. Q. Would you explain to the board when the pilots were checked out in lost plane procedure?

A. The pilots are checked out in lost plane procedure by the Operations Officer. It is one of the first lectures they receive in their training.

6. Q. In what manner are these navigational training flights authorized and who clears them?

A. All training flights are planned according to the approved syllabus. The flight schedule is made out on the preceeding day and the flights are supervised by the Aviation Training Duty Officer who is the direct representative of the Flight Officer and the Training Officer.

7. Q. When did you first learn that the flight was in difficulty?

A. The Operations Officer informed me in my office at approximately 1830 on 5 December 1945. The Operations Officer learned of it through intercepted radio messages from the flight to other planes in the air.

8. Q. At what time did you activate Air Sea Rescue facilities?

A. We did not actually activate the Air Sea Rescue facilities inasmuch as they intercepted the messages attempting to contact the flight and they also tried to contact the flight, commencing at 1620. Air Sea Rescue attempted to contact them until 1627, at which time the Boat Facility notified NAS, Miami, and other stations to attempt to pick them up on radar or direction finder. At this time, it was considered that Air Sea Rescue was definitely informed and was participating in the attempted return of the aircraft.

Examined by the board:

9. Q. When you first were advised of the flight's difficulty, what remaining time in the air did their fuel supply give them?

A. I estimated they would be out of gas in about three to three and a half hours, or that they could not remain in the air after 2000.

Examined by the recorder:

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10. Q. From your record where did the aircrewmen of the five missing TBM aircraft receive their ground training?

A. With the exception of Parpart and Harmon, who were riding with Lieutenant Taylor, all aircrewmen received their ground training at NAS, Miami. These aircrewmen had been transferred to NAS, Fort Lauderdale in the latter part of November. Both Parpart and Harmon had received their ground training at NAS, Fort Lauderdale.

11. Q. From your records where did the pilots of the five TBM aircraft receive their ground training?

A. All of the pilots had received their ground training at NAS, Miami prior to being transferred to NAS, Fort Lauderdale the latter part of November.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.

A. Charles M. Kenyon, Lieutenant Commander, U. S. Naval Reserve, U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida.

2. Q. What are your specific duties at NAS, Fort Lauderdale, Florida?

A. Stations Operations Officer.

3. Q. Were you on duty on the afternoon of 5 December 1945?

A. Yes, I was.

4. Q. What is the procedure followed at U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, when a plane reports that it is in distress?

A. When the crash bell from Operations Radio is sounded in the Operations Office, the Operations Duty Officer immediately reports to Operations Radio and determines the nature of the difficulty. If it is a lost aircraft, Operations at NAS, Fort Lauderdale, telephones Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 at Port Everglades, giving all the particulars available. Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 and NAS, Fort Lauderdale, maintain constant communications with one another and, through the facts available, attempt to determine the position or bearing of the lost aircraft, and, through combining their facilities, endeavor to get the lost aircraft back to base. When it is determined that additional help is needed and the scope of operations is going beyond our designated area, Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 notifies Air Sea Rescue Operations in Banana River.

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5. Q. Was this procedure carried out on 5 December 1945 when you were advised that Flight No. 19 was in difficulty?
A. The normal procedure was carried out by NAS, Fort Lauderdale.

6. Q. Tell the board what action you took after being advised that the five TBM's were in difficulty on the afternoon of 5 December 1945.
A. The first action I took was to send the Duty Officer to Operations Radio. When I was first advised that these planes were lost, about 1610, I assumed that it would be almost impossible for them to get into any serious difficulty and did not go to Operations Radio myself at that time. At about 1630 I went to Operations Radio. After reporting there, I determined that the YG was on, the 3000 kilocycles was guarded, that the working frequency 4805 kilocycles of this flight was on and being monitored. At 1655 I disseminated the information over the crash phone that the flight was lost. The crash phone circuit is connected with the Aviation Training Duty Officer, the Flight Officer, the Executive Officer, the Commanding Officer, the Fire Department, the Dispensary, the Operations Office, the Safety Office, the Engineering Officer, A&R, and the OOD. I called Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 at Port Everglades and discussed the advisability of sending out a ready plane on an east, north-east course in an attempt to at least relay messages to the flight. I advised the Operations Officer of Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 that I would send the ready plane out. The ready plane was not sent out as planned since the Flight Officer thought it better to hold the ready plane in view of the fact that Commander Baxter, Assistant Controller of the Seventh Naval District, had advised that they had a fix on the lost planes. This was at 1700. Since this fix did not materialize, the ready plane was never sent out that night.

Examined by the board:

7. Q. Is the YG in operation during off-shore navigational flights from U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale?
A. Yes, the YG is in operation the entire time flying is being conducted.

8. Q. Has the YG been functioning successfully for off-shore flying?
A. To the best of my knowledge, it has been.

9. Q. You have stated that when you first learned of the difficulty of the missing TBM's, you assumed no serious consequences would result. Please explain your basis for this assumption.
A. The basis for my assumption is because I give a lecture to all incoming pilots and I had recently given one to the instructors, discussing course rules and regulations and making a definite point of the fact that if they are lost over water in our normal operating areas and under normal weather conditions, they should fly west until they hit the coastline. On the other hand, if they were over land in our normal operating areas, they could fly east and hit the coastline. I also point out to them that if they are in any difficulty at all or sight anyone in any difficulty, they should immediately switch to crash frequency channel 1, MHF frequency 3000 kilocycles. I checked to find out what time the flight was due back and it was 1723. This transmission of planes being lost was picked up at 1605 according to our radio log, so there was another good hour before they were actually due back which indicated that on problem 1 navigational hop they couldn't be too far off since a 20 minute bombing period is conducted at Hen and Chickens Islands. I figured they were temporarily confused and, with all the instructions we had given them and with another plane in the air that had happened to pick up the transmission, they would come back right on time.

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10. Q. On what frequency do aircraft conduct their bombing exercises?
A. On 4805 kilocycles.

11. Q. Is there any evidence that the planes of the missing flight switched to 3000 kilocycles, the crash frequency?
A. No. We attempted through Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 to instruct FT-28 to switch to 3000 kilocycles, but these instructions apparently were not received and there is no evidence that the aircraft switched to 3000 kilocycles.

12. Q. What were the weather conditions over the area in which this flight was scheduled to proceed?
A. According to weather information I had received, I considered the weather in the operating area to be satisfactory for that training and that it would continue that way until our flying was secured.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

The board then, at 12:00 noon, recessed until 1:30 p.m., at which time it reconvened.

Present: All members, and the reporter.

No witness not otherwise connected with the investigation were present.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Donald J. Beuttenmuller, Lieutenant (junior grade), U. S. Naval Reserve, Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, temporarily assigned.

2. Q. State your particular duties at U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida.
A. I have charge of issuing all aerological forecasts and warnings. I also have charge of the Aerological Office and personnel in that office. I'm responsible to the Operations Officer. I also teach aerology in ground school.

3. Q. Were you on duty on the afternoon of 5 December 1945?
A. Yes, I was on duty.

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4. Q. Are you the legal custodian of the official weather surface map from the records of the U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, for 0730 Eastern Standard Time, 5 December 1945, the surface weather observations, and the weather forecasts? If so, produce them.
A. I am; here they are.

The weather surface map, the surface weather observations, and the weather forecasts were submitted to the board by the recorder and offered in evidence, extracts to be read as pertinent weather information. There being no objections, they were so received and marked "Exhibits 2, 3, and 4".

5. Q. Refer to these charts and read such facts as pertain to this case.
A. The weather conditions at 1600 were average to undesirable. We had unlimited ceiling, clouds at 3000 feet, visibility was 10-12 miles, surface winds were 20 knots with gusts to 31 knots, making landings undesirable on the field.

6. Q. What were the weather conditions in the area the navigational flight was to cover on 5 December 1945?
A. There were scattered rain showers with ceiling of 2500 feet in showers and visibility range for 6-8 miles. Conditions were average to undesirable in the showers. Flight conditions outside the showers were average.

7. Q. From what source of information and from what stations do you receive off-shore weather?
A. Only from aircraft in flight do we receive off-shore weather. The rest of the weather is forecast from the weather map synoptic situation. We do receive hourly reports from Nassau and 6-hourly reports from the Bahamas and the West Indies.

8. Q. What was the state of the sea?
A. The sea was moderate to rough.

9. Q. What was the specific information that was given to the pilots going on this flight?
A. They were given the winds aloft up to 8000 feet.

10. Q. Will you state the winds that were given to this flight in their briefings?
A. At 1000 feet they were 241 degrees, 31 knots; at 2000 feet, 242 degrees, 32 knots; at 3000 feet, 240 degrees, 36 knots; at 4000 feet 246 degrees, 33 knots; at 5000 feet, 245 degrees, 34 knots; at 6000 feet, 242 degrees, 52 knots; at 7000 feet, 235 degrees, 52 knots; at 8000 feet, 235 degrees, 45 knots.

11. Q. What weather information, other than winds aloft, are given to pilots in pre-flight briefing?
A. Aerology does not brief the pilots, but delivers a morning forecast and then gives other information in response to specific requests. This information is made available to pilots concerned by the Training Office.

12. Q. Did you, at any time, consider the weather to be adverse for such a navigational flight?
A. I did not.

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13. Q. During the time the subject flight was out, at any time did you have any information of a weather change that might have affected the flight?
A. We didn't have any weather information that would have affected the flight in the operating area.

Examined by the board:

14. Q. Do you have any further information, at the present time, of any unusual conditions such as violent local weather or storms that might have affected this flight adversely?
A. A secondary cold front was passing across the Florida Peninsula during the period from noon until 2000, 5 December 1945. This front was a weak front accompanied by showers which were light and intermittent, but which were accompanied by strong and gusty surface winds. There is no reason to believe that any freak storm was in the operating area during the period 5 December 1945. Also, on the teletype sequence for the Florida Peninsula there was no indication of any violent or freak storm. Since the weather was moving from west to east and no stations along the Florida coast were experiencing any violent weather, we had every reason to believe that there was nothing unusual in the weather at sea.

15. Q. Referring to the weather map and any other information available to you, were there any signs of wind shifts between Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, and the extremities of the tracks to be flown by the planes?
A. There was no indication as to any shift of winds from west southwest.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. William F. Krantz, Lieutenant Commander, U. S. Navy, U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, permanently assigned.

2. Q. What are your particular duties at the U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida?
A. I am the aircraft maintenance officer and am responsible for the maintenance and repair of all aircraft on the station and see that they are maintained in a state of commission.

3. Q. Were you on duty on the afternoon of 5 December 1945 at the Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida?
A. Yes sir, I was.

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4. Q. Are you the legal custodian of the engine and aircraft log books for TBM-1C, BuNo. 45714; TBM-3, BuNo. 23307; TBM-1E, BuNo. 46094; TBM-1C, BuNo. 46325; and TBM-1C, BuNo. 73209? If so, produce them.
A. I am. Here they are.

The aircraft and engine logs were produced for the purpose of obtaining extracts therefrom pertaining to the material condition of subject aircraft and engines. There being no objection, the logs were so received and examined by the board.

5. Q. Have you an extract of the history of the aircraft and engines as taken from the aircraft and engine logs?
A. Yes, I have.

The extract was submitted to the board and by the recorder offered as evidence, a copy being appended to the record marked as "Exhibit 5". There being no objection, it was so received and examined by the board.

6. Q. Referring to the aircraft and engine log books, are there any recorded entries concerning mechanical discrepancies that should be called to the attention of the board?
A. There are no major discrepancies.

7. Q. Are you the legal custodian of the Daily Flight Inspection Forms, NavAer Forms 3119, for the five missing TBM's? If so, produce them.
A. I am. Here they are.

The daily flight inspection forms were submitted to the board for examination and by the recorder offered in evidence and appended marked as "Exhibit 6". There being no objections, they were so received.

8. Q. Referring to the Daily Flight Inspection Forms, are they signed by the respective pilots?
A. Yes sir.

9. Q. Do the Daily Flight Inspection Forms for 5 December 1945 indicate that the aircraft were properly inspected prior to flight?
A. Yes, they do. The yellow sheets at Fort Lauderdale are signed by a leading petty officer who has charge of six aircraft and in this way he certified that they are ready for flight, including gas and oil.

Examined by the recorder:

10. Q. Do the Daily Flight Inspection Forms show the quantity of gasoline and oil in each aircraft?
A. No, they don't.

Examined by the board:

11. Q. An examination of the Daily Flight Inspection Forms reveals no check marks to indicate the prescribed daily inspection. On what do you base your statement that the prescribed checks of the aircraft have been made?
A. Due to the shortage of qualified plane captains, the following system is used at Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale. For every six aircraft, a

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line petty officer supervises six inexperienced plane captains in the inspection of the aircraft. The policy has always been at Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, that the leading petty officer sign the sheet without including the check mark in the proper places that the aircraft is ready for flight.

12. Q. Who is responsible for supervising the filling out of the Daily Flight Inspection Forms for training planes at Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale?
A. Lieutenant Stephen B. Smith of Air Plot.

13. Q. Can you explain why the Daily Flight Inspection Forms you have submitted to the board are not properly and correctly filled out?
A. No sir.

Examined by the recorder:

14. Q. Are all the instruments for an overwater navigational flight installed in each of these aircraft?
A. They are.

Examined by the board:

15. Q. Referring to the aircraft logs and records of the subject aircraft, enumerate the flight instruments that were installed.
A. All of the five aircraft were equipped with the following flight instruments: airspeed indicator, rate of climb indicator, turn and bank indicator, directional gyro, artificial horizon, manifold pressure gauge, remote indicating compass, magnetic compass. None of the planes had civil time clocks.

Examined by the recorder:

16. Q. Can you state when the remote and magnetic compasses on these planes were checked or compensated?
A. I do not know when they were compensated, but they were all checked as in working order within the last fourteen days.

Examined by the board:

17. Q. What does your statement, "checked and in working order" imply?
A. My statement means that they are functioning mechanically and electrically.

18. Q. In what way do you determine this?
A. The remote compass is checked by setting the plane on a known course, and power is supplied so that the gyro can operate and, if the movement of the hand on the dials swings to the known bearing and settles down, we consider the compass as operating. The magnetic compasses are checked to see if they have the proper liquid level, are mounted securely, and checked on a known bearing. If they settle down on that bearing, they are operating correctly.

19. Q. Do you consider the proper functioning of magnetic and mechanical compasses in training aircraft at Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, your responsibility?

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A. I feel responsible only for the installation, maintenance, and mechanical operation of the compasses.

20. Q. Whose responsibility is it at Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, for compensating compasses in training planes?
A. Lieutenant Jackson, an ATD navigator.

Examined by the recorder:

21. Q. Have any discrepancies been noted on any of the compasses on the missing aircraft since the last aircraft check?
A. No sir.

22. Q. From your knowledge, what was the air worthiness and mechanical condition of the five missing TBM aircraft?
A. The missing aircraft were in the best possible air worthiness and mechanical condition due to the fact that no discrepancies were noted on these airplanes prior to the flight and my personal observation of the men who worked on them during the recent checks which were completed during the past two weeks.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

The board then, at 4:20 p.m., adjourned until 9:30 a.m., Tuesday.

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SECOND DAY

U. S. Naval Air Station
Miami, Florida
Tuesday, December 11, 1945

The board met at 9:30 a.m.

Present:
Captain Albert K. Morehouse, U. S. Navy, senior member;
Commander Joseph T. Yaveraky, U. S. Navy, member;
Commander Howard S. Roberts, U. S. Navy, member; and
Lieutenant Commander Richard S. Roberts, U. S. Navy, recorder.
Elvera M. Erquist, yeoman third class, U.S. Naval Reserve, reporter.

The record of proceedings of the first day of the investigation was read and approved.

No witnesses not otherwise connected with the investigation were present.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Richard W. Kohlmeier, Lieutenant (junior grade), U.S. Naval Reserve, attached to the U.S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida.

2. Q. What are your specific duties?
A. I am the radio-radar maintenance officer.

3. Q. Were you on duty on the afternoon of 5 December 1945?
A. Yes, I was.

4. Q. State the exact types of radio equipment that you had installed in each of the missing TBM aircraft and the frequencies of each set.
A. All five aircraft missing on this flight were equipped with radio equipment ATC transmitters on the following frequencies set up at that time on nine channels: 3000 kilocycles, channel 1; 3471 kilocycles, channel 2; 3105 kilocycles, channel 3; 4805 kilocycles, channel 4; 3345 kilocycles, channel 5; 6620 kilocycles, channel 6; 3385 kilocycles, channel 7; 6540 kilocycles, channel 8; blank, channel 9; 5225 kilocycles, channel 10. All five aircraft were equipped with ARB receivers which will receive from 195 kilocycles to 9.05 megacycles and covers that whole band. Manual tuning is necessary in this type of set. All five planes were equipped with ZBX homing equipment. T-3, Bureau Number 45714, and T-28, Bureau Number 23307 were equipped with AN/ARC-5 receivers. T-36, Bureau Number 46330, T-81, Bureau Number 46325, and T-117, Bureau Number 73209 were equipped with ARA type receivers. ARC-5 and ARA receivers were set on 4805 kilocycles. Type ARA is tunable from the front cockpit. Type ARC-5 is not tunable from the front cockpit. All planes were equipped with 233-A VHF receiver and transmitter units calibrated on the following frequency channels: channel 1, 140.58 megacycles; channel 2, 142.22 megacycles; channel 3, 140.22 megacycles; channel 4, 143.64 megacycles. T-3, Bureau Number 45714, T-28, Bureau Number 23307, T-81, Bureau Number 46325, and T-117, Bureau Number 73209, aircraft were equipped with AL-7 type inter-phone. T-36, Bureau Number 46330, aircraft was equipped with AL-5 type inter-phone. T-28 had installed, in addition, an ARC-1 receiver-transmitter unit.

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5. Q. Was the ARB receiver calibrated for accurate manual tuning from the front cockpit?
A. As far as I can tell from the last check, it was.

6. Q. Explain your last answer, "As far as I can tell".
A. When a plane is brought in for check the manual tuning apparatus is calibrated at that time. However, over a period of time, the screw handle disc can become loose, thereby causing the disc to become out of alignment with receiver condensers. This calibration is never exact. We have a long control cable, I believe in the TBM it is approximately twelve feet long, and there will be a slight play sometimes.

Examined by the board:

7. Q. On the aircraft concerned, were any discrepancies reported concerning the misalignment of the tuning dial away from the set frequencies?
A. No sir.

8. Q. Which of these installed receivers and transmitters would be used for communication with the base or Air Sea Rescue during an off-shore navigation training flight?
A. The ATC transmitter and the ARB receiver would be used for navigation and communication with Air Sea Rescue. However, if the pilot were receiving and transmitting on the navigation frequency which is 4805 kilocycles, it would necessitate changing the frequency to 3000 kilocycles to communicate with Air Sea Rescue. He could have also used the 233-A transmitter receiver. We have no frequency for this unit assigned for navigation. Channel 1 of this set, 140.58 megacycles, is the Air Sea Rescue frequency.

Examined by the recorder:

9. Q. When was it that you last ground checked this radio equipment?
A. T-3, Bureau Number 45714, was given a 120-hour check on 21 November 1945. T-36, Bureau Number 46330, was given an acceptance check on 8 November 1945. T-28, Bureau Number 23307, received an acceptance check on 20 November 1945. T-81, Bureau Number 46325, was given a 120-hour check on 27 November 1945. T-117, Bureau Number 73209, was given a 120-hour check on 26 November 1945.

Examined by the board:

10. Q. Do these refer to radio checks in particular?
A. A 120-hour check on radio equipment is given at the same time engineering gives their 120-hour check; likewise, 30-hour, 60-hour, and 90-hour checks. Check sheets are signed by radio or radar personnel and are given to engineering.

Examined by the recorder:

11. Q. Can you produce these check sheets?
A. I can. Here they are.

The radio-radar check sheets were offered in evidence by the recorder and submitted to the board for their examination. There being no objection, they were so received, examined by the board, and found correct.

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12. Q. Are there standing instructions for pilots to check their radios with the tower before take-off?
A. Yes sir.

13. Q. Can you state whether or not these five aircraft checked their radios before take-off?
A. No sir.

14. Q. Were there any discrepancies reported on the radio equipment on any previous flights?
A. On 5 December, T-3 ATC transmitter was reported out. The transmitter was replaced and checked with the tower. T-36 on 29 November RL inter-phone equipment was reported out. The unit was replaced. T-28 on 3 December, the ARB receiver was reported weak and out. This equipment was checked by competent personnel and found to be all right. Also T-28 on 5 December, it was reported that there was no coffee grinder ARB tuning dial. The handle was replaced. T-81, after 29 November, ARB receiver was reported out. It ground checked okay. This plane was flown since then, so it was evidently pilot error. No discrepancies were reported on T-117.

15. Q. What type of radar equipment was installed in each of the missing aircraft?
A. T-3 was equipped with ASB-6 radar. T-81 and T-117 were equipped with ASB-7 radar. T-36 was equipped with APS-4 radar. T-28 was not radar equipped.

16. Q. Was it in satisfactory operating condition?
A. The equipment was in working condition at the last check which was given at the time the radios were checked. There have been no subsequent discrepancies reported on the radar since the last check.

17. Q. Why was FT-28 not equipped with radar on the subject flight?
A. When T-28 was received at NAS, Fort Lauderdale, it was equipped with APS-3 radar. Such type gear is being removed for eventual replacement with APS-4 radar.

Examined by the board:

18. Q. What instructions are in effect at Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, regarding daily or flight check of radar on TBM aircraft?
A. I do not know of any instructions. The following procedure has been used: upon return from a torpedo training flight, the flight leader should call the radar shop and a man will be sent to the ready room to collect discrepancy sheets on the radar. On any flight, if radar is used and discrepancies found, it should be reported on the daily flight inspection form.

Examined by the recorder:

19. Q. What type of IFF equipment was installed in each of the missing aircraft?
A. T-3, Bureau Number 45714, was equipped with ABK-1; T-28, Bureau Number 23307, with APX-2A; T-81, Bureau Number 46325, with APX-1A; T-117, Bureau Number 73209, with APX-2; T-26, Bureau Number 46330, with no IFF.

20. Q. When was the IFF equipment in each of the missing aircraft last checked?
A. At the same time the radios were checked.

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21. Q. Why was T-36, Bureau Number 46330, not equipped with IFF equipment?
A. That is the way the plane was received at the base on 8 November 1945.

Examined by the board:

22. Q. Is properly functioning IFF equipment mandatory?
A. I do not consider it mandatory.

23. Q. How long have you held your present duties at Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale?
A. I reported for duty July 29 of this year for this assignment.

24. Q. Do your duties include instructing pilots or aircrewmen in the use of emergency repairs to aircraft radio or radar equipment?
A. To a certain extent in radar equipment. One of my duties is giving instruction hops to pilots and aircrewmen. It is a point during my instructions to give a number of things which can be easily repaired while the aircraft is in flight, on radar alone.

25. Q. Are pilots and aircrewmen instructed in the use of the ASB radar as a homing device in use with ground racon?
A. Yes sir.

26. Q. Do you know if any racon beacons were in operations in this area on the afternoon of 5 December 1945?
A. No, I'm not positive.

Examined by the recorder:

27. Q. What additional electronic equipment was installed in the missing TBM aircraft?
A. In all the missing aircraft, except T-36, there was a radio altimeter, APN-1, all of which were checked at the same time the radios were checked.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness made the following statement:

All of these aircraft were set up only on NAS, Fort Lauderdale, frequency for the ZBX, which is 600 kilocycles. I have no information on setting it up on the other five channels.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

The board then, at 11:30 a.m., recessed until 1:00 p.m., at which time it reconvened.

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Present: All members, the recorder, and the reporter.

No witnesses not otherwise connected with the investigation were present.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Arthur A. Curtis, Lieutenant, U.S. Naval Reserve, U.S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida.

2. Q. What are your particular duties?
A. I am permanent Aviation Training Duty Officer from 0700 to 1500 every day.

3. Q. What is the scope of your duties as Aviation Training Duty Officer?
A. My duties consist of dispatching of flights and of mustering the students.

4. Q. Did the flight of missing TBM aircraft take off on scheduled time?
A. No sir.

5. Q. Why was the flight delayed?
A. Lieutenant Taylor, the pilot, was late in briefing the students.

6. Q. As Aviation Training Duty Officer, can you state whether the planes were ready at the prescribed time of take-off for flight?
A. Yes sir, they were.

7. Q. Were the weather conditions favorable when they took off?
A. The weather conditions were favorable. The aerologist sends us a report in the morning. If weather conditions are unfavorable, they will inform us and tell us about the conditions. In the absence of any further information, I considered the weather favorable.

8. Q. Were you on duty when the first report came in that the missing TBM's were in trouble?
A. No, Lieutenant (junior grade) Conklin was on duty at that time.

Examined by the board:

9. Q. Did you notice anything unusual about the behavior of the pilots in this flight?
A. Yes, Lieutenant Taylor did ask me to find another instructor to take his place, giving me no particular reason except that he did not want to take the hop.

10. Q. At what time did Lieutenant Taylor make this request?
A. To the best of my knowledge, it was about 1315.

11. Q. What was your action on this request of Lieutenant Taylor?
A. I said I would not be able to get him a relief.

12. Q. Do you know Lieutenant Taylor's movements from that time until the flight was dispatched?
A. I do not know, sir.

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13. Q. Did you observe any unusual behavior of Lieutenant Taylor?
A. No sir.

14. Q. Did he seem normal in all respects?
A. Yes sir.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Lee T. Conklin, Lieutenant (junior grade), U.S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida.

2. Q. What are your particular duties?
A. My particular duties are assistant instructor, but on 5 December 1945 I was senior Aviation Training Duty Officer. I relieved Lieutenant Curtis at 1500 on 5 December 1945 and secured at 0800 on 6 December 1945.

3. Q. When did you first become aware of the subject flight being in difficulty and what did you do?
A. The first report I got was from the tower at 1610 stating that FT-28, Bureau Number 23307, was lost on a navigational hop. I informed Lieutenant Commander Poole, the Senior Flight Officer, and immediately had a ready pilot man the ready plane and await further instructions from Lieutenant Commander Poole. After that, I called the tower every fifteen minutes to see if they had any more word on the planes. I asked if I should have any ready pilots man planes for a search and was told that they had no definite word and they couldn't send out a search yet. At 1730, I got word from the Operations Officer that the planes were considered lost, that they had been due to land at 1723, and that every effort was being made to keep contact with them. They still had radio contact at that time. Later, I secured all the pilots that were standing by on the line and told them to stand by in their BOQ. This was at approximately 1800. I kept checking with the tower on any radio contact or any further information or whether or not they wanted a search plane to go out. The next word I received was at 1930 from Operations saying that the said five planes were still lost and their last fix that they thought they had on them was 79 degrees west and 29 degrees north. Lieutenant Commander Poole told us he was making up a search party to muster at 0600 the following morning and that we should stand by until this flight schedule was made up. I secured my duties at 2230, and retired to my BOQ. At 0500 the next morning, I went down and

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resumed my duties. I mustered aircrewmen and pilots for the search party and okayed the search party to take off at approximately 0700. The search party consisted of thirty planes and took off at 0700. I was relieved of my duties at 0800 by Lieutenant Curtis.

4. Q. You made the statement that they still had radio communications at approximately 1730. Would you clarify that?
A. I cannot clarify it. The only word that I received was from Operations that they still had radio communication with the planes at that time.

5. Q. Did you, at any time, alert or notify the Air Sea Rescue units?
A. No sir.

Examined by the board:

6. Q. Did you personally know Lieutenant Taylor and did you see him prior to his departure on the flight in question?
A. Yes, I did know Lieutenant Taylor, but I did not see him before the flight.

7. Q. What do you know of Lieutenant Taylor's ability as a flight instructor of TBM aircraft?
A. I had had one hop with him as an assistant instructor. It was a navigation hop out of NAS, Miami. We rendezvoused at our said point and came back home and he took us right to the station. I had Captain Powers and Captain Stivers with me at the time too.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Samuel M. Hines, Lieutenant, U.S. Naval Reserve, U.S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida.

2. Q. What are your particular duties?
A. I am the Operations and Tower Duty Officer in the operations department at NAS, Fort Lauderdale.

3. Q. What is the scope of your duties as Operations and Tower Duty Officer?
A. As Tower Duty Officer, I am in the tower to observe all take-offs

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and landings and give out any orders in case of any trouble that might come up. I stand both of these duties together. I go out and investigate any crashes and stand by on call for any emergency that might come up.

4. Q. What were the hours of your duty on 5 December 1945?
A. The hours of my duty on 5 December 1945 were from 1500 until night flying secured.

5. Q. When did you first become aware that the TBM aircraft on the subject flight were in difficulty, and what did you do?
A. At 1606, the Operations radio called down on the "squawk box" to the Duty Officer's desk and said "Lieutenant Hines, please come up to Operations radio. We believe we have some planes lost". I ran up to Operations radio and asked for the story so far from the radiomen. As soon as I learned the situation, I attempted, at about 1610, to call the boat facility. The line was busy so I went back downstairs and Lieutenant Commander Kenyon, the Operations Officer, had the boat facility on the phone and told me he was advising them. So I immediately went back to Operations radio at which time a message was coming over, "Does Lauderdale have any radar equipment that could pick us up?" I immediately called the radar shack and asked if they had any equipment that could pick up emergency signals from a plane. The answer was negative and this was transmitted to the planes in distress. All messages coming from the planes were on 4805 kilocycles. After finding out that we had no equipment, I first called the Boca Raton Army Air Base on the ATC drop and told them we had planes lost and asked if they had any equipment with which they could get a fix, giving them 4805 kilocycles as the frequency the planes were operating on. Their reply was that they would try to get in touch with their radar shop and help us out. My next thought was to call NAS, Miami, Operations. I talked with Lieutenant Commander Crandall. I told him our problem and asked him if he would turn on all of his field lights and leave them on until further advised. I asked him if NAS, Miami, had any radar equipment which would help us to locate these planes. He answered yes. This was at approximately 1700. I also asked him if he could suggest anything else and he said he could think of nothing except the Miami beam. Somebody in the flight could pick up the Miami beam and come in on that. The last call that I made in connection with the radar was at approximately 1720 when I called Morrison Army Airways Communication System and asked if they would try to get a DF fix on these planes which were using a frequency of 4805 kilocycles. During the time that I was making these calls, I had Sp(I)lc R. J. Koch in the tower call Miami Air Sea Rescue and give them the story on the planes. This was between 1700 and 1720 that he made the call. He called the controller and the Coast Guard Evaluation Unit. He put them to work doing what they could. From approximately 1730 on, the control in Miami took over. I received orders from Air Sea Rescue from then on. At 1751 I called the controller in Miami and requested him to alert all air fields from Miami to Banana River and have them turn on all lights.

Examined by the board:

6. Q. Did you have receiver and transmitter watch on 3000 kilocycles?
A. We turned our receiver on at approximately 1615. NHA-3, the boat facility, did most of the transmitting to the planes on 4805 kilocycles. They attempted several times to have the planes change to 3000 kilocycles, but were unsuccessful.

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Examined by the recorder:

7. Q. Did you intercept any transmissions from the boat facility?
A. Yes, we remained on 4805 kilocycles throughout the evening of 5 December.

Examined by the board:

8. Q. What instructions exist at Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, for the guidance of the Operations Duty Officer in the case of lost planes?
A. In case of lost planes, the Operations Duty Officer has written instructions to alert the Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 at Port Everglades, Florida, which, in turn, alerts the Miami controller.

Examined by the recorder:

9. Q. Are you the legal custodian of the Operations Communication Log of Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, for the date of 5 December 1945? If so, produce it.

A. I am. Here it is.

The Operations Communication Log of Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, for 5 December 1945 was submitted to the board by the recorder as evidence. There being no objection, it was so received and is appended marked "Exhibit 7".

Examined by the board:

10. Q. Does this log constitute the best available record of receptions and transmissions copied by Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Operations radio between the hours of 1500 and 1900 on 5 December 1945?
A. Yes, that is the best available log. However, there were several transmissions which were not recorded. This log was authentically written as events occurred and it is accurate as far as it goes.

11. Q. Do you have available in Operations radio a recorder, either the disc type or magnetic wire type, which is capable of recording voice transmissions?
A. No sir.

12. Q. Do you know of existing radar facilities that are readily available for use in locating lost planes off shore?
A. I know of no existing radar facilities. I know of the high frequency direction finders at Air Sea Rescue Controllers in Miami and also the Morrison Army Airway Communication system.

13. Q. What information was given to Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 and to the other activities who were alerted when the missing planes were first reported in difficulty?
A. The number of planes was given, the type of planes, the type of flight, their frequency of 4805 kilocycles, the time of departure and estimated time of return. Within thirty minutes, aircraft radio calls for each plane were given and the estimated length of time this type aircraft could stay in the air before running out of gas.

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14. Q. Was there any noticeable interference reported to you on 4805 kilocycles that seriously interfered with communications between the lost planes and the base?

A. There was very much static on 4805 kilocycles from 1610 until 1730 at which time, in addition to the static, music from Cuban broadcasting stations interfered with reception. The lost planes from 1610 until 1904 alternately came in loud and clear and faded beyond audibility. The receiver at Fort Everglades was able to receive transmissions which Operations Radio did not hear and vice versa.

Examined by the recorder:

15. Q. Were you ever in two-way communication with the missing planes after 1605?

A. Operations radio was unable to get a Roger on any message sent to the planes. However, it is reported that the Air Sea Rescue unit at Fort Everglades did get Roger on some messages to FT-28.

Examined by the board:

16. Q. Prior to 1605, do you know of any communications with this flight?
A. No sir, I do not.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Robert F. Cox, Lieutenant, U. S. Navy, permanently attached to Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida.

2. Q. What are your particular duties?
A. I am a senior flight instructor at NAS, Fort Lauderdale, in TBM aircraft.

3. Q. Were you on duty on the afternoon of 5 December 1945?
A. Yes sir.

4. Q. What were your specific duties on the afternoon of 5 December 1945?
A. I was scheduled to take a division flight of TBF's, division tactics, on their first flight. This was scheduled to depart at 1515 for the duration of one hour.

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5. Q. When you were on this flight did you become aware of anything unusual?
A. Yes sir.

6. Q. Tell the board what you heard or did.
A. I was flying around the field at approximately 1540. I was joining my squadron up around the field. I heard some planes or boats. One man was transmitting on 4805 to "Powers". That is the word he used and he didn't give any recognition. The party calling asked "Powers" what his compass read a number of times and finally said, "I don't know where we are. We must have got lost after that last turn". During this time, at approximately 1545, I called NHA-1, Operation radio, NAS, Fort Lauderdale, and notified them that either a boat or some planes were lost. They Rogered my message. Also, I called, "This is PT-74, plane or boat calling "Powers", please identify yourself so someone can help you". I received no answer. Later he called and asked if anyone had any suggestions. I called again, giving my identification as PT-74, and he answered giving his as MT-28. I said, "MT-28 this is PT-74, what is your trouble?" MT-28 came back, "Both my compasses are out and I am trying to find Fort Lauderdale, Florida. I am over land, but it's broken. I'm sure I'm in the Keys, but I don't know how far down and I don't know how to get to Fort Lauderdale". I said, "MT-28 this is PT-74, put the sun on your port wing if you are in the Keys and fly up the coast until you get to Miami, then Fort Lauderdale is 20 miles further, your first port after Miami. The air station is directly on your left from the port. What is your present altitude? I will fly south and meet you". MT-28 replied, "I know where I am now. I'm at 2300 feet. Don't come after me". I called, "MT-28, Roger, you're at 2300. I'm coming to meet you anyhow". I then received a call from NHA-1 asking if it was PT-28 or MT-28, and after calling MT-28 again I learned that it was PT-28 and relayed this message to NHA-1. I then received a message from PT-28, "Can you have Miami or someone turn on their radar gear and pick us up? We don't seem to be getting far. We were out on a navigation hop and on the second leg I thought they were going wrong so I took over and was flying them back to the right position, but I'm sure now that neither one of my compasses are working". I called PT-28, "You can't expect to get here in ten minutes. You have a 30 to 35 knot head or cross wind. Turn on your emergency IFF gear, or do you have it?" He replied that he didn't. I then told him to turn on his IBX gear, but received no comment. I repeated and still received no answer. NHA-1 and NHA-3 also tried to get him to turn it on. I don't know whether they got an answer or not. NHA-1 suggested I tell PT-28 to have one of his wingmen take over the lead and I did this. I received no direct answer, but heard some transmission about radar or something. I then called PT-28, "Your transmissions are fading. Something is wrong. What is your altitude?" He replied, "I'm at 4500 feet." At this point my VHF (ATC transmitter) went out and I had no power for transmission on that frequency. The frequency we had been using was 4805 kilocycles, so I tried to contact him on all nine channels of VHF and finally got Navy Lauderdale on No. 7. As his transmissions were fading he must have been going north. I believe at the time of his first transmissions he was either over the Biminies or the Bahamas. I was about forty miles below Fort Lauderdale and couldn't hear him any longer. At about 1600 I heard PT-28 report that he had a visibility of ten to twelve miles. At about 1640 I intercepted a message from PT-28 to the effect that he had flown out on a course of 120 degrees and on the second leg he had taken over the flight because he thought that they were going wrong, but later found out that he had been wrong. After that I came in and landed with the intention

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of getting the ready plane and trying to go out and find the missing planes. I thought I would fly up in the northeast section and see if I could pick up the transmissions. After I got down, I went to Operations and told the Operations Duty Officer as much as I could about it at the time and I also asked him for permission to take the ready plane out. I didn't get any definite answer so I went up to the tower and Lieutenant Commander Poole, the Flight Officer, was up there. I asked him about taking the ready plane out and he very definitely said no, that he didn't think there was any use in sending it out then. I stayed around until approximately 1800 and then went home.

Examined by the board:

7. Q. Were you personally familiar with Lieutenant Taylor, the leader of the flight of missing planes?
A. No sir.

8. Q. In what direction were you flying during the period when FT-28 transmissions became progressively weaker?
A. South and slightly southwest.

9. Q. What was your approximate geographical position when the signals from FT-28 faded out altogether?
A. I was approximately twenty-five miles south of Miami.

Examined by the recorder:

10. Q. Did you, at any time on your flight, check your ZBX equipment?
A. Yes sir. I checked it just slightly south of Miami and it was very loud and clear on channel 1 from Fort Lauderdale. I was at approximately 2400 feet and it was about 1635.

11. Q. Are you familiar with shifting to Air Sea Rescue frequencies in the case of difficulties while off shore?
A. Yes sir.

12. Q. When you were flying off shore, did you observe the surface winds?
A. Yes sir. The approximate surface winds were westerly, about 21 or 22 knots.

13. Q. Did you observe the state of the sea?
A. Yes sir. The sea was very rough. It was covered with white caps and long white streamers. The visibility was very good in all directions, except directly west.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

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A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Steven B. Smith, Lieutenant, U.S. Navy, Officer-in-Charge, Air Plot, U.S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida.

2. Q. What are your particular duties?
A. As officer in charge of Air Plot, I supervise all the flying operations, including assignment of planes for flights and personnel involved. All plane captains and line personnel are directly under me.

3. Q. Were you on duty on the afternoon of 5 December 1945?
A. Yes, I was.

4. Q. Are you the officer responsible for the handling of the Daily Flight Inspection Forms, NavAer Form 3119, the yellow sheets?
A. Yes sir.

5. Q. How are the Daily Inspection Sheets handled at Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale?
A. I assumed my duties about three months ago and the same set-up has been used for the last year and a half that we are using now. Due to the personnel involved on these planes, temporary aircrewmen and short-time personnel in the unit, none of them are very capable of being very good plane captains. We have responsible petty officers acting as crew leaders assigned to each twelve spots on the line, depending upon the number of planes available. There will be from eight to twelve planes to each crew. Before the warmup in the morning, the plane captain inspects his plane, supervised by the crew leader and as soon as the plane has been inspected and turned up, the crew leader gives us thumbs up and then goes up and signs all yellow sheets for his crew. That has been the set-up for a year and a half.

6. Q. I show you five NavAer Forms 3119 which have been received as exhibits by this board. Are these the forms which apply to the flight of missing TBM aircraft being investigated by this board?
A. Yes sir.

7. Q. Will you explain to the board why these forms are not completely filled out and the quantity of gas and oil indicated?
A. The crew petty officer gets a form on planes in the morning on the turnup and signs the yellow sheets for his crew and it has not been the practice at NAS, Fort Lauderdale, to check the whole yellow sheet out. This system was in effect when I relieved the previous officer in charge of Air Plot about the 5th of September this year. The reason was that time was needed to get the flights out, to get the yellow sheets signed, and planes assigned to gunnery for loading as soon as possible. On securing a plane for the evening, the plane captain reports to Air Plot and signs a slip stating the plane has a minimum of twenty-one gallons of oil, or a maximum of twenty-five, all gas tanks topped off, and hydraulic reservoir full, and the controls and the plane properly secured for the night, this being done before the evening muster and the men excused from duty. The chief petty officer checks these sheets against the number of planes on the line

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and by individual numbers to see that all planes are secured before the squadron is secured for the night.

Examined by the board:

8. Q. How do your line crew petty officers verify the inspection of the various components and groups listed on the inspection form for each plane?

A. By personal inspection of the aircraft throughout the day.

9. Q. Have you any record that would indicate a test and condition of the items listed on the Daily Flight Inspection Form between the scheduled 30, 60, 90, and 120-hour checks?

A. No sir.

Examined by the recorder:

10. Q. Do you have some procedure by which the plane captains know which items to check on their daily inspections?

A. Yes, by having a copy of the yellow sheet in their possession with items not necessary crossed off.

11. Q. Do you know of any discrepancy on the missing planes for 5 December 1945?

A. I know of no discrepancy.

Examined by the board:

12. Q. Can you state that these airplanes were fully gassed and oiled?

A. I can. I contacted the crew petty officers and plane captains and definitely ascertained that they were gassed, oiled, and properly serviced.

Examined by the recorder:

13. Q. Do you hold any other type of aircraft line inspections?

A. Yes. Every Friday we have a plane inspection of all planes on the line. One of the items we have the plane captains check is safety equipment, such as life rafts, whether they are easy to remove from the compartment. The hatch to the life raft compartments have been modified by Bureau order to a quick detachable type. These are also inspected for operation.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

The board then, at 4:20 p.m., adjourned until 9:30 a.m., Wednesday.

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NOTE - - Page 26 is blank and is inserted herewith to reconcile the error in numbering of pages.

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THIRD DAY

U. S. Naval Air Station
Miami, Florida
Wednesday, 12 December 1945

The board met at 9:40 a.m.

Present:
Captain Albert K. Morehouse, U. S. Navy, senior member;
Commander Joseph T. Yaverasky, U. S. Navy, member;
Commander Howard S. Roberts, U. S. Navy, member; and
Lieutenant Commander Richard S. Roberts, U. S. Navy, recorder.
Margaret L. Anderson, yeoman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, reporter.

The record of proceedings of the second day of the investigation was read and approved.

No witnesses not otherwise connected with the investigation were present.

A witness called by the recorder, entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Ernest D. Hadsell, Lieutenant (junior grade), U. S. Naval Reserve, stationed at U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, permanently assigned.

2. Q. What are your specific duties at the Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida?
A. I am the safety, survival, and the parachute officer.

3. Q. What is the required emergency equipment in TBM aircraft?
A. One Mark Four life raft. Depending on the size of the crew, one seat service parachute and QAC parachutes for personnel. A "Mae West" for each member of the crew. This equipment is provided in accordance with CNATra letter Serial No. 28731 of 18 October 1945.

4. Q. Was all of this equipment installed in each of the five missing aircraft?
A. Yes it was.

5. Q. Do you have periodic checks on all emergency equipment installed?
A. Yes sir, we do in accordance with existing instructions from CNATra.

6. Q. What inspections do those instructions specify?
A. Life rafts call for a six months or semi-annual check. Parachutes are repacked and inspected every thirty days. All Mark Four life rafts were inspected in accordance with latest directive I have on hand. Life jackets are visually inspected and inflation tests made every six months.

7. Q. When was this equipment in the missing TBM aircraft last sighted?
A. I do not know.

8. Q. Were all the personnel of Flight 19 of 5 December 1945 checked out in the correct use of emergency equipment?
A. I do not know.

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9. Q. Who is responsible for checking personnel in the use of survival equipment?

A. The ground school survival officer and the athletic officer. All instructions for use of survival gear is given by the survival officer in ground school. Actual demonstration and check out procedure and use of the gear is given by the athletic officer in the pool or on the base. To the best of my knowledge this flight has been checked out in swimming tests and all survival tests in ground school, which course they have completed.

10. Q. Were the aircraft concerned equipped with shoulder harnesses and safety belts?

A. Yes sir, all safety belts and shoulder harnesses were inspected and comply with Technical Order 3-45 dated 3 January 1945.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness was called by the recorder, entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.

A. Malvin L. Hansen, Lieutenant, U. S. Naval Reserve, U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida.

2. Q. What are your specific duties at the Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale?

A. My duties at the Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, are to carry out communication training for pilots and aircrewmen in the ground school.

Examined by the board:

3. Q. Are the pilots and aircrewmen checked out in the use of radio equipment in the TBM aircraft?

A. Yes, the pilots and aircrewmen are checked out in the use of radio equipment in the aircraft.

4. Q. Are the pilots and aircrewmen after the check out given in ground training capable of operating the aircraft radio in this type aircraft?

A. I do know that the pilots and aircrewmen who have gone through our ground school are capable of operating the radio equipment in the TBM.

5. Q. What instructions are given to student pilots concerning lost plane procedure?

A. The syllabus under communication at NAS, Fort Lauderdale, and ground school does not cover lost plane procedure as a separate subject, but pilots and aircrewmen are given a thorough check out in the use of YG/ZBX equipment.

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They are informed about the frequencies used for emergency procedure and they are told what signals may be used to get responses on those frequencies. The pilots and airerewmen are given "Q" signal practice. We follow CNATra instructions No. 11.4-13 of 29 October 1945.

6. Q. Are all pilots and airerewmen instructed in the proper procedure for obtaining radio direction finder fix of their position?
A. They are taught the communication procedure involved.

7. Q. What is the standard radio procedure for navigation flights?
A. The standard radio procedure on the first two navigation flights the syllabus indicates we will give messages to each crew which they will transmit back to NAN HOW ABLE ONE. The pilot will send a message back by voice using a shackle code from Pac Six. The radioman on the same flight will send back the same type of message in shackle code by key.

8. Q. Was this done of this particular hop?
A. This was not done of this particular flight, because it was reported to me that the flight involved had already received two navigation hops and our syllabus calls for such training on the first two hops.

9. Q. Can you state the proficiency or qualifications of any of the radiomen flying in the missing TBM's?
A. Yes, I can say that W. R. Parpart, aviation radioman third class, flying in T-28, BuNo. 23307, completed the ground school course at NAS, Fort Lauderdale and was proficient as an aircraft radioman. I have no knowledge of the other radiomen or pilot personnel regarding their records in ground school training as they completed ground school training prior to coming to NAS, Fort Lauderdale.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness was called by the recorder, entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. James Roy Jackson, Junior, Lieutenant, U. S. Naval Reserve, stationed at U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, temporarily assigned.

2. Q. What are your specific duties at NAS, Fort Lauderdale?
A. I am the carrier qualifications, communication, and navigational phase officer in aviation training.

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3. Q. What navigational instructions did you give to the five missing TBM pilots on 5 December 1945?

A. I gave the students no instructions prior to the flight but had previously briefed the instructor, Lieutenant Taylor, on his duties and in the conduct of his flight.

4. Q. How far had the student pilots progressed in the navigation syllabus?

A. This was their third and last flight. They had had two in Miami before reporting to Fort Lauderdale.

5. Q. What briefing is given to the student pilots prior to departure on over-water navigational flights?

A. The instructor of the squadron gives all briefing to the students. The problems designate the speed and altitude which they fly, and it is up to the instructor himself to fly the problem the way he wishes. For example, he may fly one leg, have the students track him and then turn the lead over to the students on the other legs, that is his choice.

Examined by the board:

6. Q. Are any instructions during briefing given to pilots concerning their actions in case of difficulty?

A. Yes sir, they are told that the standard procedure if a plane is lost would be to turn on their emergency IFF gear. They climb to altitude to see if they can contact the YG from the home station on which all planes are set. It has been the procedure at Fort Lauderdale that, if you are over water, you are to fly toward the west; if you are over land, fly east. If a plane is forced down, at least one plane turns on his emergency IFF, two planes of the flight will circle the position climbing for altitude, and the other two planes return to base to give any information as to the whereabouts of the plane in trouble. The planes which circle the downed plane orbit until relieved either by voice or by another plane or until fuel or approaching darkness necessitates return to base.

7. Q. Do any of the instructions to student pilots or instructors include the employment of shore based radio direction finders for determining the position of planes or flight in difficulty?

A. Only the YBX.

Examined by the recorder:

8. Q. Had Lieutenant Taylor, the leader of the missing TBM flight, been checked out in the navigational procedure?

A. Yes sir. I personally checked him out on or about 27 November 1945.

9. Q. Were all compasses in the missing TBM's calibrated? If so, approximately when?

A. Four of these planes were scheduled to go aboard the carrier on December 3, and the compasses were calibrated on the compass rose on either November 28 or 29, in preparation for flying out to the carrier for qualifications. T-28, Lieutenant Taylor's plane, was not checked at this time; however, it was one of our new planes which had just come out of MAR and it was checked at that time.

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10. Q. Have you the records for the calibration of the compasses in the missing TBM's?
A. No sir, we have no written record.

11. Q. What provisions are made in the training TBM aircraft assigned to U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, for determining the strength and direction of the wind while in flight?
A. There are charts in all plotting boards which give the Beaufort scale for estimating wind velocity and observation of the state of the sea. The planes are all equipped with smoke lights for the purpose of determining wind direction.

12. Q. In ground training instruction in navigation are student pilots instructed in the method of estimating wind direction and velocity?
A. I do not know. Such instructions would come under ground school.

13. Q. Can the YG be heard throughout the track of the navigation problem in question?
A. No sir, it cannot. The farthest point of the track of the navigation problem involved in 123 miles from base and we have no record that local YG gear can be heard at more than 84 miles at 6000 feet, or about 35 miles at navigational altitude of 1000 feet.

14. Q. How was the 84 miles maximum range at 6000 feet of the Fort Lauderdale YG determined?
A. It was determined by a test flight conducted for that purpose using one of the TBM training planes within the last six weeks.

15. Q. Do you know of any obstructions of the YG transmitter that would prevent signals reaching out from the direction in which this flight had proceeded?
A. I do not.

16. Q. How do pilots on navigation flights determine or check the accuracy of their navigation while flying the problem assigned?
A. With one exception the termination of all legs touch a point of land and that one exception is within sight of a large island.

17. Q. What instructions are given the students conducting navigation flights in regard to failure to successfully complete the leg due to errors in navigation?
A. I do not know in regard to students. The responsibility of procedure rests with the instructor.

18. Q. Does navigation instruction for student pilots point out the value of frequent comparison between mechanical and remote reading compasses?
A. In ground school when flying the link trainers and in the problems they work in ground school, it is brought out in each period the value of comparing their compasses at all times.

19. Q. What instructions did you give to the flight instructors concerning the availability of the ZBX grid cards?
A. I informed the instructors that they could get the ZBX grids in the Operations Office before each flight.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

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The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness was called by the recorder, entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Jerome A. Rapp, Junior, Lieutenant Commander, U. S. Naval Reserve, U. S. Naval Air Station, Miami, Florida.

2. Q. Were you personally acquainted with Lieutenant Charles Carroll Taylor, the leader of Flight No. 19?
A. Yes sir. I was acquainted with Lieutenant Taylor from January 1, 1944 to the present date during which period we were in Torpedo Squadron Seven, Pacific Fleet, and were VTB instructors at NAS Miami.

3. Q. From your observations of Lieutenant Charles Taylor describe his flying ability and aptitude.
A. He was an above average pilot in the Fleet. He performed all his duties very well and was trusted and respected for the way in which he performed his duties.

Examined by the board:

4. Q. Do you know of any circumstances that might have contributed towards producing a recent mental strain or affected the physical well-being of Lieutenant Taylor?
A. I do not.

5. Q. Do you know of any recent change in Lieutenant Taylor's attitude toward flying?
A. I do not. Lieutenant Taylor like his flying very well. He was very happy doing it.

6. Q. When did you last see Lieutenant Taylor?
A. I last saw Lieutenant Taylor on November 11, 1945 at 0800.

7. Q. What was Lieutenant Taylor's marital status?
A. He was unmarried.

8. Q. During the period you served with Lieutenant Taylor in the Fleet did you have occasion to become familiar with the use of various homing devices as currently installed in TBM aircraft?
A. Yes sir.

9. Q. Can you state whether Lieutenant Taylor was familiar with these devices?
A. Yes he was. We used these aids in all combat missions and routine patrols.

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None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

The board then, at 12:30 p.m., adjourned until 9:30 a.m., Thursday.

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NARA 345

FOURTH DAY

U. S. Naval Air Station
Miami, Florida
Thursday, December 13, 1945.

The board met at 9:40 a.m.

Present:
Captain Albert K. Morehouse, U. S. Navy, senior member;
Commander Joseph T. Yavorsky, U. S. Navy, member;
Commander Howard S. Roberts, U. S. Navy, member; and
Lieutenant Commander Richard S. Roberts, U. S. Navy, Recorder.
Elvera M. Erquist, yeoman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, reporter.

The record of proceedings of the third day of the investigation was read and approved.

No witnesses not otherwise connected with the investigation were present.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Marion C. Hanna, Lieutenant, U.S. Naval Reserve, Navigation Instructor at U.S. Naval Air Station, Miami, Florida.

2. Q. What are your duties at the Naval Air Station, Miami, Florida?
A. I am an instructor in ground school and a custodian of ground school records.

3. Q. How long have you been an instructor at Naval Air Station, Miami?
A. I have been an instructor since 28 March 1944.

4. Q. From the ground school records of the following personnel, can you state that they completed the ground school syllabus and were qualified aircrewmen: Walter R. Parpart, ARM3c, USNR, Robert F. Harmon, AOM3c, USNR, Howell O. Thompson, S/Sgt., USMCR, George R. Paonessa, S/Sgt., USMC, Robert P. Gruebel, Pvt., USMCR, Robert F. Gallivan, Sgt., USMC, William E. Lightfoot, Pfc., USMCR, Herman A. Thelander, S1c, USNR, and Burt E. Baluk, Jr., S1c, USNR.
A. I have examined the records and these aircrewmen, with the exception of Walter R. Parpart, ARM3c, USNR, and Robert F. Harmon, AOM3c, USNR, were qualified and have completed the ground school syllabus.

5. Q. What subjects does the ground school syllabus cover for combat aircrewmen?
A. The following subjects are covered in ground school for combat aircrewmen: communications, radio-radar, gunnery, recognition, survival, and ACI lectures.

6. Q. From the ground school records at Naval Air Station, Miami, can you state that Captain Edward J. Powers, Jr., USMC, Captain George W. Stivers, USMC, 2nd Lieutenant Forrest J. Gerber, USMCR, and Ensign Joseph T. Bossi, USNR, completed the required ground school syllabus in navigation, radio, radio communication, lost plane procedure?
A. Yes sir, they have all completed the ground school syllabus.

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7. Q. Are the subject combat aircrewmen still attached to Naval Air Station, Miami?
A. No sir, they were transferred several weeks ago to Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness made the following statement:

I can state that the pilots were thoroughly qualified in navigation insofar as ground school instruction goes.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. William L. Stoll, Lieutenant (junior grade), U.S. Naval Reserve, VTB Assistant Instructor at U.S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida.

2. Q. What are your specific duties at the Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale?
A. I am an assistant instructor in VTB type aircraft at NAS, Fort Lauderdale.

3. Q. On the afternoon of 5 December 1945 what duties did you perform at Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale?
A. I was acting as instructor for a navigation flight for problem number 1 from NAS, Fort Lauderdale. We had Flight No. 18 and we took off at 1345, due to return at 1600, 5 December 1945. We flew at 1000 feet so as to use surface winds.

4. Q. What were the flying conditions encountered by you on this flight?
A. Flying conditions were about average. The wind was a little high, broken clouds were between 3000 and 4000 feet, visibility was 8-10 miles, wind was over the water 35-40 knots, and the water was rather rough.

Examined by the board:

5. Q. What wind did you use in your navigation?
A. I used a wind from 240 degrees at 35 knots.

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6. Q. Was this wind verified by the result of your navigation on the training flight?
A. Yes sir.

Examined by the recorder:

7. Q. Did you hear Lieutenant Taylor, the flight leader of the missing TBM's, brief his students prior to departure on 5 December 1945?
A. I heard him briefing them, but I did not attend his briefing; we had our own briefing.

8. Q. Did you see any of the material used by Lieutenant Taylor in briefing his students prior to his takeoff on Flight No. 19?
A. Yes sir. I saw Lieutenant Taylor's true headings for all legs and distances which coincided with navigation problem No. 1, Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale. I saw this information on the blackboard opposite the names from his flight. The winds used by Lieutenant Taylor's flight were the same winds given from Aerology and used by my flight, No. 18.

9. Q. During your flight did anything unusual occur?
A. During my flight nothing unusual occurred until, upon entering the traffic circle, I heard FT-28 report that he was over a group of small islands believed to be the Florida Keys. This is all I heard and I landed immediately afterwards at Fort Lauderdale.

Examined by the board:

10. Q. Prior to Lieutenant Taylor's takeoff, did you notice anything unusual about his actions?
A. No sir, he seemed all right when I greeted him at the ready room.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness called by the recorder, entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Harold Burke, Commander, U. S. Navy (Medical Corps), stationed at U.S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale.

2. Q. What are your specific duties at Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale?
A. I am senior medical officer and flight surgeon at the air station dispensary.

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3. Q. From the records in your department, can you state to the board the dates the following pilots completed their last flight physical examinations: Lieutenant Charles C. Taylor, Captain Edward J. Powers, Jr., Captain George W. Stivers, 2nd Lieutenant Forrest J. Gerber, and Ensign Joseph T. Bossi.

A. Yes, I can. From the records, Lieutenant Taylor passed his flight physical examination on 28 March 1945; Captain C. J. Powers on 22 August 1945; Ensign J. T. Bossi on 22 August 1945; 2nd Lieutenant Forrest J. Gerber on 15 August 1945; and Captain George W. Stivers on 22 August 1945.

4. Q. Since the dates of these flight physicals, have any of these officers been on the sick list for any serious illness?

A. No, they have not.

5. Q. Do you know of any physical or mental handicaps of any of the above officers that might impair their judgment or flying ability?

A. I do not.

6. Q. Were the following aircrewmen, W. R. Parpart, ARM3c, R. F. Harmon, AOM3c, H. O. Thompson, S/Sgt., G. R. Paonessa, S/Sgt., R. P. Gruebel, Pvt., R. F. Gallivan, Sgt., W. E. Lightfoot, Pfc., H. A. Thelander, S1c, and Burt E. Baluk, Jr., S1c, physically qualified to be aircrewmen?

A. They were, according to the records at my disposal, all qualified to be aircrewmen.

7. Q. Have you any information regarding any physical or mental handicaps that might impair the judgment or performance of duty of the subject aircrewmen?

A. From the records available, I do not know of any.

Examined by the board:

8. Q. Were you personally acquainted with any of the pilots or aircrewmen under discussion?

A. No, I was not.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness called by the recorder, entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rate, and present station.

A. Rolland John Koch, Specialist (Y) first class, U.S. Naval Reserve, stationed at the U.S. Naval Air Station Control Tower, Fort Lauderdale.

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2. Q. What are your specific duties at Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale?

A. I'm the petty officer in charge of the control tower under the direction of the Operations Duty Officer.

3. Q. On the afternoon of 5 December 1945, to what duties were you detailed?

A. I was in charge of the control tower under the direction of the Operations Duty Officer.

4. Q. Did any of the pilots of the missing TBM's on 5 December 1945 test their radios with the tower prior to takeoff?

A. Yes sir. The flight leader called for taxi instructions before he left the field and FT-28 and two others of this flight, the numbers of which I do not remember, checked Operations radio prior to calling the tower for taxi instructions.

5. Q. Did you receive any reports of aircraft in difficulty on the afternoon of 5 December 1945?

A. Yes sir. At approximately 1605 we received a call from Operations radio on the squawk box to the effect that FT-74 had intercepted a message from an unidentified station to the effect that he was lost. I asked Operations radio to get an identification of this station which was lost. Operations radio again contacted FT-74 and received information that it was MT-28 who was in difficulty. FT-74 questioned the MT part of the identification and established the fact that it was FT-28. I then alerted the Operations Duty Officer and requested that he report to Operations radio and also to inform the Boat Facility. This was acknowledged by the Operations Duty Officer. At approximately 1612 I alerted the ready plane crew and at approximately 1615 I called the Air Sea Rescue controller in the DuPont Building at Miami and gave him what facts we had at the time and then asked that the call be switched to Coast Guard Evaluation, also in the DuPont Building, giving them the frequency which FT-28 was transmitting on, the number of planes, the plane numbers of that flight, and also asked them to attempt to get a fix on their position.

6. Q. Does Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, maintain any communications with over-water navigational flights from the tower?

A. No sir, not from the tower.

7. Q. On 5 December 1945 did you receive any communications from Flight 19?

A. No sir.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

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A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Donald J. Poole, Lieutenant Commander, U.S. Naval Reserve, permanently attached to Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, in the capacity of Flight Officer.

2. Q. What are your specific duties at Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale?
A. I am the Flight Officer at Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, and have been for the past two months. My duties include the authorization and supervision of all training flight schedules. I determine the competency of senior instructors, assistant instructors, and student pilots to perform their flight duties in a satisfactory manner. I also make certain that student pilots meet definite prescribed standards in all ground school courses, and that all phase officers and ground school instructors are fully qualified to properly instruct students in their particular assignment. This is all done under the supervision of the Aviation Training Officer, Commander Jenkins.

3. Q. Did you authorize Flight No. 19 led by Lieutenant C. C. Taylor on 5 December 1945?
A. I did authorize Flight 19 led by Lieutenant C. C. Taylor. They took off from Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, at 1410 5 December 1945. From our records, I considered all personnel fully qualified and competent to perform their third and last navigation flight in a satisfactory manner. Navigation flights 1 and 2 were similar in nature and covered the same general over-water territory.

4. Q. Where were you on the afternoon of 5 December 1945?
A. On the afternoon of 5 December 1945 I was in the Aviation Training Department Office on duty.

5. Q. Did anything unusual happen on the afternoon of 5 December 1945?
A. Yes sir, definitely. At 1630 I was notified that a flight was in difficulty.

6. Q. What did you do?
A. I was notified by the Operations Duty Officer at 1630 that Lieutenant Taylor seemed to be lost. I immediately went into Operations and learned that Lieutenant Taylor thought he was along the Florida Keys. I then learned that his first transmission revealing that he was lost had occurred at 1600. I knew by this that Lieutenant Taylor could not possibly have gone on more than one leg of his navigation problem and still get back to the Keys by 1600. Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 had contact with FT-28, Lieutenant Taylor, at this time, 1645, so I immediately notified them to instruct FT-28 to fly 270 degrees, also to fly toward the sun. I know this was transmitted because I listened over Operations radio. I do not know that it was ever acknowledged. Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 also instructed FT-28 to change to 3000 kilocycles, Channel 1, but this was never done by FT-28. I had a pilot in the ready plane warming it up, but was hesitant about sending it out until I had some information as to where to send it. I was about to send it out on a direct easterly course at 1700, however,

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when Lieutenant Hines rushed in and said, "Hold it, Commander Baxter says they will have a radio fix for us". We did not receive this fix of 29 degrees north, 79 degrees west until 1815. I also reasoned that the ready plane would only have a tendency to complicate and might even destroy what communication we did have with FT-28. At 1736 I received a special weather report from Aerology advising me that Palm Beach was having foul weather and that it might move on to Fort Lauderdale and close in. I then definitely decided that the ready plane would not go out. At 1751 I instructed the Operations Duty Officer to check and be sure that Air Sea Rescue had alerted all stations from Key West to Melbourne and to have them turn on all field lights, beacons, and search lights. I was still confident and certain that they would hit the coast before their gas supply ran out. I was especially confident after the radio transmission by Lieutenant Taylor in which he stated that they would fly due west until their gas supply ran out. I was also hopeful that Boca Raton would be able to pick up the flight's emergency IFF, as it is possible to pick it up as far as 150 miles, but upon calling them they reported negative. Lieutenant Taylor and students had been instructed that if lost they were to (a) climb 1000 feet for every 10 miles distance estimated from station and turn on emergency IFF, (b) head due west at any time they were out at sea in our operating area, including navigation hops, (c) change to 3000 kilocycles, Channel 1, (d), to climb 1000 feet for every 10 miles they estimate they are from station and tune in on ZBX, Channel 1, using standard grid. At 2305 Commander Baxter informed us we would have search area 25 degrees north, 78 degrees west to the beach. I worked out details and had previously dispatched the duty officer to have all pilots report to ready room at 0600, 6 December 1945. I secured at 0130, 6 December 1945.

7. Q. I give you the Operations Communication log of Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, for 5 December 1945. Do you know of any communications that you heard pertaining to the missing TBM's that are not included in this log?

A. Yes, I do. At approximately 1700 I heard two different students, unidentified as to plane or person, make the following statements: "If we would just fly west we would get home". The other transmission that I heard was, "Dammit, if we would just fly west we would get home".

8. Q. Do you have any way of knowing what preflight information Lieutenant Taylor gave to Flight 19 on 5 December 1945?

A. Yes, I do. We combed the ready room in which Lieutenant Taylor briefed his squadron previous to his flight 19. This search revealed the following information on the blackboard: his true heading and distances were correct and coincided with problem No. 1.

Examined by the board:

9. Q. In what portion of the navigation problem should the missing planes have been when their difficulty was first reported over the radio?

A. According to navigational data available, it was found, allowing twenty minutes for bombing over Hens and Chickens Islands, that Flight 19 should have been over landmark "Great Sail Key" at the time of first reported difficulty.

10. Q. Can you state whether Flight 19 actually carried out scheduled bombing training over Hens and Chicken Islands while on the subject navigation problem.

A. No sir, but I assume that they would as it is a part of the scheduled navigation problem.

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Examined by the recorder:

11. Q. I will read you the list of aircrewmen comprising Flight 19. Can you identify those who are aircrew radiomen and those who are aircrew gunners? Walter Reed Parpart, ARM3c; Robert Francis Harmon, AOM3c; Howell Orrin Thompson, S/Sgt.; George Richard Paonessa, S/Sgt.; Robert Peter Gruebel, Pvt.; Robert Francis Gallivan, Sgt.; William Earl Lightfoot, Pfc.; Herman Arthur Thelander, S1c; and Burt Edward Baluk, Jr., S1c.

A. Your list is correct. I will differentiate between radiomen and gunners as they participated in Flight 19. W. F. Parpart, ARM3c, radioman, and R. F. Harmon, AOM3c, gunner, in T-28; H. O. Thompson, S/Sgt., gunner, and G. R. Paonessa, S/Sgt., radioman, in T-36; R. P. Gruebel, Pvt., radioman, and R. F. Gallivan, Sgt., gunner, in T-117; W. E. Lightfoot, Pfc., gunner in T-81; and H. A. Thelander, S1c, gunner, and B. E. Baluk, Jr., S1c, radioman, in T-3.

Examined by the board:

12. Q. Why were two aircrewmen assigned for navigation training flights?

A. They are a permanently assigned flight crew and fly on all training flights with their respective pilots. This is standard procedure and prescribed by the VTB syllabus.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, and which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness made the following statement:

No sir, I have no definite facts, but I would like to convey the following information. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale's last pilot fatality in VTB training occurred 9 December 1944, all with a total of VTB flight training hours of 78,627.6. This is up to and including 4 December 1945.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

The board then, at 12:30 p.m., recessed until 1:30 p.m., at which time it reconvened.

Present: All members, the recorder, and the reporter.

No witnesses not otherwise connected with the investigation were present.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.

A. Claude Charles Newman, Commander (DM), U.S. Naval Reserve, Officer in Charge, Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4, Port Everglades.

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2. Q. What are your specific duties at Port Everglades?
A. I am officer in charge of Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4. I have collateral duties of student crash boat instruction, torpedo retrieving, and salvage operations in connection with crashed planes. As officer in charge of Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4, I am in charge of keeping my boats and other equipment in a constant state of readiness for air-sea rescue missions. I also maintain liaison and communication with other task units, and cooperate with other task units, and initiate action involving any situation for air-sea rescue missions.

3. Q. On the afternoon of 5 December 1945 did your activity intercept any unusual transmissions from aircraft?
A. Yes sir. I personally received the first information of the missing flight at 1623 Roger on 5 December. However, our radiomen intercepted the first message in connection with this flight at 1620 Roger. "Air Sea Rescue 4, FT-74 via radio on 4805 kilocycles. FT-28 is calling you". "Roger. Go ahead FT-28".

4. Q. Are you the legal custodian of the Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 communications log for 5 December 1945? If so, produce it.
A. I am. Here it is.

The communications log of Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 was submitted by the recorder as evidence to the board. There being no objection, it was so received and marked "Exhibit 8".

5. Q. Will you state to the board what your activity did upon learning of the planes' difficulty?
A. At 1627 we advised Operations, Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, via telephone of a message received from FT-28 at 1626 Roger in which he mentioned, "I am angles 3.5 x-ray Have on emergency IFF x-ray Does anyone in the area have a radar screen that could pick us up? (Roger. Stand by)". At this time, Operations, Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, advised that they would notify Naval Air Station, Miami, and other stations to attempt to pick up FT-28 on radar or HFDF. The further activities as participated in by Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 are in accordance with Exhibit 8.

6. Q. At Port Everglades do you have any direction finding equipment?
A. No sir, we do not.

Examined by the board:

7. Q. Were all communication facilities operating satisfactorily on the afternoon of 5 December 1945?
A. Affirmitive, with the exception of our teletype system which was out of commission from 1527 to 2108.

8. Q. Did you receive any direction finder fix from Air Sea Rescue, Miami, on the missing aircraft?
A. According to our log, that message was intercepted from Miami to Banana River at 1821 Roger. It was 29 degrees north, 79 degrees west.

9. Q. When did your facility first contact Banana River and Miami Air Sea Rescue headquarters?
A. A DF position on the missing planes was requested from Dinner Key at 1643. Banana River was advised at 1738.

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10. Q. Did any transmissions originate from Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 to the missing planes regarding the fix obtained by Air Sea Rescue, Miami?
A. No sir.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness made the following statement:

The master of the British tanker, "Viscount Empire" reported to me that, on the night of 5 December 1945, he passed through that area northeast of the Bahamas on a voyage from the United Kingdom to Fort Lauderdale. While in this area, he further advised, he encountered tremendous seas and winds of high velocity.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Ray E. Crandell, Lieutenant Commander, U.S. Naval Reserve, U.S. Naval Air Station, Miami, Florida.

2. Q. State your specific duties at Naval Air Station, Miami.
A. Assistant Operations Officer.

3. Q. Were you on duty on the afternoon of 5 December 1945 after 1600?
A. I was on duty at the Operations office.

4. Q. Did anything unusual occur concerning aircraft in trouble on the afternoon of 5 December 1945?
A. Yes.

5. Q. Will you explain.
A. At 1735 the Air Sea Rescue command line telephone rang and I answered the same. I was advised by Fort Lauderdale that five TBM type aircraft avengers were overdue on a navigational hop and was requested that we alert ourselves and render such assistance as might be possible.

6. Q. Will you state to this board exactly what assistance you rendered.
A. I immediately ordered all field lighting turned on, ordered the control tower to set up a receiver on 4805 kilocycles, which was the transmitting frequency of the missing planes. This was done at 1740. The field lights were on and the receiver was set up on 4805 kilocycles and tested

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for accuracy with the frequency meter. The Operations Duty Officer, Lieutenant (junior grade) Hanass, was instructed to locate the Ground Training Officer, Lieutenant Commander Thrash, and request Ground Training radar be immediately put into operation. The Operations Duty Officer was also instructed to endeavor to find the VF-6 radar group and do whatever possible to put their equipment into operation. I further checked and found that the Ground Training Officer had been located and that his radar was put into operation. The VF-6 group was located, but they were unable to put their radar into operation inasmuch as it had just been sent to this station. The radar equipment set up by Ground Training is for training use only and is limited in its range to the immediate vicinity and is of no value for off-shore search operations. A twin engine ready plane was standing by with crew and all hands on duty in Operations remained at their assigned posts and were aware of the emergency and were completely alert and ready to render any assistance for which they were trained or equipped.

7. Q. At any time did you set up any receivers or transmitters on 3000 kilocycles or 140.58 megacycles?

A. We didn't set up a transmitter or receiver on 3000 kilocycles, but we do have 140.58 megacycles operating as one of our channels we use.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

The board then, at 3:15 p.m., adjourned until 9:30 a.m., Friday.

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FIFTH DAY

U. S. Naval Air Station
Miami, Florida
Friday, 14 December 1945

The board met at 9:30 a.m.

Present:
Captain Albert K. Morehouse, U. S. Navy, senior member;
Commander Joseph T. Yavorsky, U. S. Navy, member;
Commander Howard S. Roberts, U. S. Navy, member; and
Lieutenant Commander Richard S. Roberts, U. S. Navy, recorder.
Margaret L. Anderson, yeoman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, reporter.

The record of proceedings of the fourth day of the investigation was read and approved.

No witnesses not otherwise connected with the investigation were present.

Donald J. Poole, Lieutenant Commander, U. S. Naval Reserve, permanently attached to U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, in the capacity of Flight Officer, a witness for the board, was recalled and warned that the oath previously taken by him was still binding.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. Did the pilots of Flight 19 on 5 December 1945 have ZBX sector code cards?
A. I do not know that they did definitely have ZBX grids.

Examined by the board:

2. Q. Whose responsibility is it to obtain these ZBX grid cards?
A. The responsibility rests with each flight leader of any navigation hop to see that all pilots have obtained standard discs. Lieutenant Taylor was informed by the Navigation Officer, Lieutenant Jackson, that ZBX grids were available and were to be picked up in Operations previous to any navigational flight.

3. Q. Where do flight leaders obtain the subject grids or code cards for navigation flights and is there a record kept when they are withdrawn for use?
A. Standard ZBX grids are obtainable from the Operations Office. There is no record kept of pilots who obtain these grids. Many students and instructors have copied the standard ZBX code on their plotting board blank grid. It is entirely possible that someone in Flight 19 had one of the boards.

Examined by the recorder:

4. Q. Do you know if any of the pilots in Flight 19 had received any special instructions in the use of YG/ZBX equipment?
A. I do not know. I interviewed the remaining five pilots in Squadron 79M to which the four missing students were attached. They stated that they had all received one link trainer hop using ZBX standard grids. They also stated that they had received two link trainer navigation hops using orientation without grid. Upon questioning these pilots as to their ability to orient themselves under actual circumstances if lost, they were confident they could orient themselves properly and return to station.

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Examined by the board:

5. Q. What officer at U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale was actually in charge on the afternoon and evening of 5 December 1945 of coordinating all search and rescue activities on that station when it was learned that the five TBM's under investigation were in difficulty?
A. I was in charge.

6. Q. Did you receive a telephone call from Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 at about 1639 to the effect that the missing flight was believed lost over the Bahamas and suggesting that the ready plane be dispatched to the east to establish communications with FT-28?
A. I did not receive this message direct nor was I informed that it came from Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4; however, Lieutenant Commander Kenyon did offer this suggestion to me.

7. Q. Tell the board what your decision was with regard to this suggestion.
A. Primarily, I held the ready plane in hopes that a little more definite location of Flight 19 could be obtained. Secondly, NAN HOW ABLE THREE was in communication with FT-28. I reasoned that one more radio trying to establish communication with FT-28 would only add to the existing confusion and might even destroy what communication already existed.

8. Q. Did you know that Lieutenant Cox in FT-74 had been in radio contact with FT-28 at about 1600 and that FT-28 signals had faded out when FT-28 flew south?
A. I did not know this until the following day.

9. Q. You have stated in your testimony that at 1815 you received a fix at 29 degrees north, 79 degrees west. What use was made of this information?
A. I immediately plotted this fix on a chart. This fix tended to confirm my beliefs that they were east of the Florida mainland. I had previously ordered NAN HOW ABLE THREE to tell FT-28 to fly 270 degrees, and this would still hold true after receiving this fix at 1815.

10. Q. Was U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale in communication with the TBM's when they received the position obtained by the fix?
A. No sir.

11. Q. Did you request NAN HOW ABLE THREE, Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4, to transmit the position obtained by the fix to the TBM's?
A. No sir, I did not.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness made the following statement:
On 13 December 1945 Lieutenant Jackson flew navigation problem No. 1 that was flown by Flight 19 on 5 December 1945. This flight was flown at approximately the same time of day that Flight 19 was flown on 5 December 1945.

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Visibility and winds were average. Lieutenant Jackson observed that his course to NAS, Fort Lauderdale coincided with a direct course into the sun. Lieutenant Jackson also states that three beams were intercepted during this navigation flight. They were Miami, Florida; West Palm Beach, Florida; and Richmond, Florida beams and he intercepted two of these beams on the cross-leg. Further information I would like to give to the board is that Ensign Harris flew FT-28 on the morning of 5 December 1945 previous to the time Lieutenant Taylor used FT-28. Ensign Harris states that he definitely checked the remote compass before take off and it coincided with his runway heading.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. William T. Murphy, Lieutenant Commander, U. S. Coast Guard, stationed as Assistant to Assistant Operations Officer, District Coast Guard Headquarters, Seventh Naval District, DuPont Building, Miami, Florida.

2. Q. What are your specific duties?
A. I am assistant to Commander Baxter in Coast Guard Operations and Air Sea Rescue Operations, DuPont Building, Miami, Florida. This is the Operations Office for Gulf Sea Frontier, Air Sea Rescue, and Operations.

3. Q. Were you on duty on the afternoon of 5 December 1945 after 1600?
A. Yes sir, I was on duty at the Coast Guard Operations Office on the bridge in the DuPont Building, Miami, Florida.

4. Q. From your records, when was your activity first notified that U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale aircraft were in difficulty?
A. At approximately 1640R the Navy Controller, Lieutenant Howell, received a telephone call from Fort Lauderdale asking about an alert on the net. This call was shifted by Lieutenant Howell to Lieutenant (junior grade) Sorensen, U. S. Coast Guard (WR) in the Gulf Sea Evaluation Center (HF/DF). She took this phone call which lasted approximately two or three minutes and at 1645 she put on the net to LM (Jupiter, Florida), LO(Pensacola, Florida), and LP (Houma, Louisiana) that went out as from ZE (Gulf Sea Frontier), to monitor on 4805 kilocycles for plane FT-28, AS (Voice transmission): "Plane was lost on the east coast of Florida". At 1645 she put out on the net, "If you hear him or FT-74 alert the net". At 1647 Houma alerted the net, their seventh alert for that day. The minute we put that out we called the Army Evaluation Center and they alerted the Army East Coast net. We then notified NFF, San Juan, Puerto Rico, to alert the Caribbean net.

5. Q. Can you produce the Air Sea Rescue instructions for Gulf Sea Frontier for examination by this board?
A. Yes sir, here it is.

The copy of Air Sea Rescue Instructions for Gulf Sea Frontier produced by the witness was submitted to the board and offered in evidence by the recorder. There being no objections it was so received and marked "Exhibit 9".

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6. Q. At what time did your activity take over control of the Air Sea Rescue operations for the missing TBM's from U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale?

A. At 1640 we received the message from Fort Lauderdale. We alerted the Eastern Sea Net and the Gulf Net, then we stood by waiting to get bearings on the nets. At this time we thought it was like any of the common occurrences that we have quite frequently on planes lost or overdue and did not consider it an actual distress until approximately 1900. We were advised around 1750 by Fort Lauderdale that the planes had fuel for another hour and fifteen minutes, and if they were only working off Bimini, which we were told over the phone, they should reach the mainland.

Examined by the board:

7. Q. When did District Air Sea Rescue Headquarters receive its first fix of the missing planes on the DF nets that had been alerted?

A. The first fix we were able to establish was sent out on the net at 2334Z (1834R), and it gave an approximate fix of 29 degrees 15 minutes north, and 79 degrees 00 minutes west, a radius of 100 miles, by averaging all bearings and times, that would be his position at 2250Z (1750R).

8. Q. What use was made of the position established by this fix?

A. It was immediately telephoned by Lieutenant (junior grade) Sorensen to NAS, Fort Lauderdale who were in communication with the planes. That went right out on the Eastern Sea Frontier net (teletype net) which Banana River and WAX (which is at Hialeah) received. It was also sent out on the Gulf Sea Frontier HF/DF net which includes Dinner Key.

The board then, at 12:30 p.m., recessed until 1:30 p.m., at which time it reconvened.

Present: All the members and the reporter.

No witnesses not otherwise connected with the investigation were present.

Lieutenant Commander William T. Murphy, U. S. Coast Guard, District Coast Guard Headquarters, Seventh Naval District, Miami, Florida, a witness for the board was recalled and warned that the oath previously taken by him was still binding.

Examined by the board:

9. Q. Who was in actual control of Air Sea Rescue operation at Joint Operations Center in the DuPont Building, Miami, when word was first received of the five TBM's being in difficulty?

A. I was, sir.

10. Q. How long did you continue in that capacity?

A. I was in charge of Operations until the arrival of Commander Baxter at approximately 1830R. Commodore Benson, Chief of Staff to ComSeven, and Comgulf, was present on the bridge throughout this period.

11. Q. Did you continue to assist Commander Baxter as officer in charge of actual operations after you were relieved?

A. Yes sir.

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12. Q. State the facilities available to the Gulf Sea Frontier Air Sea Rescue organization that were called in to assist in locating the five missing TBM aircraft.

A. The Eastern Sea Frontier HF/DF net, the Gulf Sea Frontier HF/DF net, the Caribbean HF/DF net, the Army HF/DF net, the Jacksonville Naval Air Station, the Banana River Naval Air Station, Coast Guard Air Station at Dinner Key, Army Transport Commands at Morrison Field and Miami, Third Air Force, MacDill Field, Coast Guard groups at Fort Pierce, Miami, and Key West, the Boat Facility at Port Everglades, the Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, and the various Army fields, the CVE USS SOLOMONS and USS BARNES, and through CNAAdvTra, Jacksonville, USS MISSION BAY. In addition to these facilities, BAMS were broadcast to all merchant vessels regarding the missing aircraft. At 1830R we alerted the USCG Pandora and CG 83504 at Miami to stand by, and be ready for sea pending further orders.

13. Q. What is the procedure in the Air Sea Rescue organization for transmitting positions obtained by radio direction finders to vessels or aircraft in difficulty?

A. The fix is telephoned or transmitted to the station that is in contact with the planes or vessels and he, in turn, tries to get it out to them.

14. Q. What station did you consider in contact with the aircraft and did you transmit the fix to that station?

A. Lieutenant (junior grade) Sorensen transmitted the fix via telephone to NAS, Fort Lauderdale.

15. Q. Does Air Sea Rescue Headquarters have any special radio transmitting apparatus available to them for transmitting direction finder positions to ships or aircraft?

A. Yes sir. They can go out through WAX at Hialeah or through JUPITER.

16. Q. Were either of these stations just mentioned directed to transmit the radio direction finder fix to the missing planes?

A. Not to my knowledge, sir.

17. Q. Are you the legal custodian of the Coast Guard Air Sea Rescue Log from 1718R, 5 December 1945 to and including the date of termination of search for the five missing TBM aircraft?

A. I am, here it is.

The Coast Guard Air Sea Rescue Log was produced by the witness, submitted to the board, and offered in evidence by the recorder. There being no objection it was so received and marked "Exhibit 10".

18. Q. What further steps were taken by Air Sea Rescue Headquarters, DuPont Building, Miami, to locate the missing planes before 2000, 5 December 1945?

A. After all HF/DF nets were alerted, we passed information to Civil Aeronautics Authority and asked them to alert and set up in this area. At 1800R ordered all stations south of Banana River to light up their fields and stations to the greatest extent. At 1820R the Miami Dumbo PBY was airborne and directed to fly over NAS, Fort Lauderdale, and then to fly on course of 45 degrees true for 150 miles and endeavor to raise a flight of planes on 4305 kilocycles. At 1821R the evaluator gave the fix to the controller of the flight of planes as 29-15 north, 79 west, radius 100 miles as of 1750R. At 1830R alerted the USCG Pandora and the CG 83504 at Miami to be

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ready to proceed to sea on very short notice. At 1840R alerted the Florida east coast south of Jacksonville to light up to all possible extents. At 1855, we sent out a "BAMS" to all "MERVES" along east coast of Florida to 74 degrees west, "All ships in the area east coast Florida to 74 degrees west, be on alert for five planes lost and short of fuel". At 1941R we sent to the Coast Guard VIGILANT, "Five TBM's lost at sea. Believe your area and fuel about exhausted. Have VIGILANT ready to proceed on very short notice." These messages went to all our ships all along the east coast of Florida. At 1951R we started orders out to all the facilities to proceed to sea on a course due east from their stations and orders would follow. At 1950R we received the USS SOLOMONS dispatch 06/0006, operational priority to ComGulf, "Four or six planes, no IFF, at 1900 latitude, 2935 on longitude, 8128 degrees west, Course 176. Speed 120. Estimated altitude 4000 feet. At 1939 Steamship DELAWARE dispatched, "We saw five planes at 2200Z flying in formation going seaward from Hillsboro Light". At 2037R we amended the original "BAMS" we sent out to read, "All ships area east coast of Florida, east to 74 degrees west, be on alert for five planes to be considered down."

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Ellen M. Sorenson, Lieutenant (junior grade), U. S. Coast Guard Reserve, ComGulf Sea Frontier Evaluation Center, Miami, Florida.

2. Q. What are your specific duties?
A. I have control of the net which connects all the high frequency direction finders and as they transmit their bearings; that is, the various high frequency direction finder stations, we plot them on the chart or charts and after we have sufficient bearings and confirming bearings it is our duty to give a fix if it is possible to do so.

3. Q. Were you on duty on the afternoon of 5 December 1945 after 1600?
A. Yes sir. I was on duty at the Evaluation Center in the DuPont Building, Miami.

4. Q. When were you first informed that several aircraft from Fort Lauderdale were in difficulty on the afternoon of 5 December 1945?
A. The first word we received was at approximately 1630 or thereabouts via phone from NAS, Fort Lauderdale.

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5. Q. What did you do?
A. We immediately put three stations on to monitor the frequency that the planes were on and told the first one hearing anything to alert the net immediately, which they did. These stations were Houma, Louisiana; Pensacola, Florida; and Jupiter, Florida.

6. Q. Did you receive any direction finder bearings?
A. We received bearings from four stations between 1647R and 1712R. Two of those stations submitted one bearing each and two of them submitted two each. That was the extent of our bearings.

Examined by the board:

7. Q. Will you evaluate these bearings received?
A. The bearings that were received up until 2212Z by no means justified a fix or even an approximate location.

Examined by the recorder:

8. Q. Are you the legal custodian of the high frequency direction finder bearings taken by Air Sea Rescue networks on the afternoon of 5 December 1945 in attempting to locate the five missing TBM's? If so, produce them.
A. I am, here they are.

The charts of the high frequency direction finder bearings produced by the witness were submitted to the board and offered in evidence by the recorder. There being no objection, they were so received and marked "Exhibit 11".

Examined by the board:

9. Q. State to the board your experience and background as an evaluator of high frequency direction finder bearings.
A. I received six weeks intensified training in high frequency direction finder evaluation in Atlantic City. Following this I was transferred to Miami to the Evaluation Center where I have been stationed for three months. During this time I have had daily experience in evaluation, both with planes and with ships.

10. Q. When did you receive bearings that resulted in an acceptable fix?
A. The bearings that were transmitted from 2210Z to 2305Z confirmed one another sufficiently to warrant an approximate fix. We received several confirming bearings from Cape May and Houma. Then we also received a number of bearings from Green Cove, Georgia, which showed a variation of 17 degrees but were constant in their variation. At approximately 2250Z or a few minutes before, we received quite a number of confirmed bearings from Houston, one from Poyner's Hill and one bearing from Brigantine, New Jersey. Pensacola transmitted bearings the entire time, but they varied from 034 degrees to 216 degrees so could not be used with any degree of certainty. However, I used two bearings from Pensacola that were specified as being taken on Flight FT-28. Since a number of confirming bearings had been received by 2300Z, we felt that an approximate location could be given. The bearings were still not sharp enough to warrant an exact fix without a large radius, but it did give the general location in which to search.

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11. Q. What position was obtained as a result of these bearings?
A. The approximate position given was within a radius of 100 miles of 2915 north, 79 west.

12. Q. Can you state whether there were any conditions or disturbances that delayed or adversely affected obtaining of good high frequency direction finder bearings of the missing aircraft on the afternoon of 5 December 1945?
A. This was a poor time of the day to get high frequency direction finder bearings due to atmospheric conditions. Too, there was heavy interference by Cuban broadcasting stations and there was a steady carrier note on that particular frequency from 1600 to 2400R.

13. Q. When you first obtained what you considered an approximate position of the missing aircraft through evaluation of high frequency direction finder bearings, whom did you notify?
A. At approximately 1810R we notified the tower, NAS, Fort Lauderdale. We notified Commodore Benson, and we called the Army. After we had gotten all of these people taken care of, we put it on the east coast net and the Gulf net and also had it relayed to the Caribbean net.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that she was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which she thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness made the following statement:

A lot of the information that was received and given was done via telephone because both teletypes were going the whole time and it was quicker to get some of them by telephone. Too, the Commodore and one or two Captains and several Commanders were in the Evaluation Center the entire time and were cognizant of everything that was going on and saw the plotting of all the bearings. When we decided on this approximate fix, they were given that position immediately and took action accordingly. We relayed the fix by telephone as soon as it was determined. Knowing that [redacted] WAX nor NMU could transmit on 4805 kilocycles, we delayed the transmission on the teletypes until any who might be in contact with the planes were notified.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

Lieutenant Commander William T. Murphy, U. S. Coast Guard, District Coast Guard Headquarters, Seventh Naval District, Miami, Florida, a witness for the board was recalled and warned that the oath previously taken by him was still binding.

Examined by the board:

1. Q. What activity controlled all search operations for the five missing TBM aircraft under investigation?
A. Gulf Sea Frontier Air Sea Rescue Headquarters, Miami, Florida.

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None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

The board then, at 4:45 p.m., adjourned until 9:30 a.m., Monday.

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SIXTH DAY

U. S. Naval Air Station
Miami, Florida
Monday, 17 December 1945

The board met at 9:30 a.m.

Present:
Captain Albert K. Morehouse, U. S. Navy, senior member;
Commander Joseph T. Yavorsky, U. S. Navy, member;
Commander Howard S. Roberts, U. S. Navy, member; and
Lieutenant Commander Richard S. Roberts, U. S. Navy, recorder.
Margaret L. Anderson, yeoman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, reporter.

The record of proceedings of the fifth day of the investigation was read, and approved.

No witnesses not otherwise connected with the investigation were present.

A witness called by the recorder, entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Robert D. Cox, Commander, U. S. Navy, permanently attached to U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida as Officer-in-Charge of VB2 ATU-3.

2. Q. What are your specific duties?
A. As Officer-in-Charge of VB2 ATU-3 under the Superintendent of Aviation Training and the Commanding Officer, NAS, Banana River, I'm charged with the training of combat aircrews including officers and enlisted men in advanced training in Mariner type aircraft and with the custody and maintenance of aircraft and equipment employed in this training and with the administrative duties connected therewith.

3. Q. Where were you on the afternoon of 5 December 1945, after 1600?
A. I was at my home in Eau Gallie, Florida which is about fifteen miles from NAS, Banana River. I was notified by my duty officer at approximately 2340R that one of our aircraft was overdue on their early plane reports and that Air Sea Rescue at NAS, Banana River had informed him that an explosion observed earlier in the evening could be our overdue aircraft. I dressed immediately and reported aboard NAS, Banana River at approximately 0130R, 6 December 1945.

4. Q. Was PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, launched from NAS, Banana River on 5 December 1945?
A. It was. This aircraft was put over the side about 1915R, was airborne at 1927R and sent its out report at 1930R. The following names comprised all the personnel who were aboard this aircraft: Senior pilot, Lieutenant (junior grade) Walter G. Jeffrey, U. S. Navy, File No. 329291; Co-pilots, Lieutenant (junior grade) Harry O. Cone, (Al), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 378634; Ensign Robert M. Allen, (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 466015, Ensign Lloyd A. Eliason, (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 465964; Student Radar Officer, Ensign Charles D. Arceneaux, A(L)T, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 409770; and the following named enlisted men who were assigned to NAS, Banana River Combat Crew 880: Donald E. Peterson, aviation machinists mate first class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 382 88 99; plane captain; Wiley D. Cargill, seaman first class (AMM), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 995 90 12; James F. Jordan, aviation radioman third class, U. S.

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Naval Reserve, Service No. 367 76 04; Robert C. Cameron, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 574 04 17; Philip B. Neeman, seaman first class (AGM), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 247 11 21; James R. Osterheld, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 378 96 75; Alfred J. Zywicki, seaman first class (AGM), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 727 69 79; John T. Menendez, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 268 84 98.

5. Q. Did this airplane ever return from its mission or is there any record of it or its crew being subsequently located?

A. No. This aircraft and its crew have not returned to NAS, Banana River or any other known station and no communications have been established with the aircraft or the crew and neither have been seen or heard from since their 1930 out report.

6. Q. Who was the patrol plane commander of PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, on 5 December 1945?

A. The senior pilot or patrol plane commander was Lieutenant (junior grade) Walter C. Jeffrey, U. S. Navy, File No. 329291.

7. Q. Was Lieutenant (junior grade) Walter C. Jeffrey, U. S. Navy, fully qualified to be a patrol plane commander in PBM type aircraft?

A. Lieutenant (junior grade) Jeffrey was not a Fleet designated patrol plane commander, but was a patrol plane commander and flight instructor in accordance with NAS, Banana River standards for patrol plane commander in PBM type aircraft. He performed his first flight as such May 11, 1945. His total flight time was 1917.8 hours; his total PBM time was 426.4 hours; his PBM night time was 53.8 hours. He had not been involved in any aircraft accident at NAS, Banana River up to the time of the flight in question.

8. Q. Was there any other Naval Aviator aboard PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, on 5 December 1945?

A. There were the following pilots aboard who served as co-pilots under Lieutenant (junior grade) Jeffrey during this flight: Lieutenant (junior grade) Harry C. Cone, (Al), U. S. Naval Reserve, 378634; Ensign Roger M. Allen, (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, 466015, and Ensign Lloyd A. Eliason, (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, 465964.

9. Q. What are the qualifications for co-pilot duty in PBM type aircraft?

A. These Naval Aviators were assigned to temporary duty under instruction involving flying in Mariner type aircraft in advanced training at NAS, Banana River, Florida. According to the records, Lieutenant (junior grade), Harry C. Cone was a student patrol plane commander assigned to NAS, Banana River Combat Aircrew 880. His total flight time was 1142.7 hours; his total PBM time was 850.2 hours, his total PBM night time was 214.4 hours. According to the records Ensign Roger M. Allen, was a student co-pilot assigned to NAS, Banana River Combat Aircrew 880. His total flight time was 497.7 hours, his total PBM time was 163.1 hours, his total night PBM time was 44.2 hours. According to the records, Ensign Lloyd A. Eliason, was a student co-pilot assigned to NAS, Banana River, Combat Aircrew 880. His total flight time was 491.4 hours, his total PBM time was 155.9 hours, his night PBM time was 44.2 hours. According to the records, NAS, Banana River Combat Aircrew 880 was an organized standard combat aircrew and had flown 160.1 hours as such, while in training in PBM type aircraft and VB2 ATU-3, Banana River, Florida, and had completed all of the ground training syllabus and all of the flight training syllabus except one night patrol flight of seven hours duration.

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10. Q. What was Ensign C. D. Arceneaux's specific duties in the flight crew?
A. Ensign C. D. Arceneaux was a student radar operator.

Examined by the board:

11. Q. What is the normal complement of PBM crews at U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River while in training flights?
A. The normal size of a combat aircrew undergoing training in PBM type aircraft at NAS, Banana River is three pilots and nine enlisted men. On the flight in question Combat Aircrew 88G was originally scheduled for a night navigation training flight. Also assigned to this flight was Ensign Charles D. Arceneaux, a radar technical observer, who was undergoing instruction and familiarization in PBM type aircraft. This flight was scheduled to depart at about 1900 but prior to the departure of the flight word was received by the ATU Operations Duty Officer from the NAS, Banana River Air Sea Rescue Duty Officer that five TBM's from Fort Lauderdale were lost and that ATU would be required to dispatch available aircraft to search for them. The Air Sea Rescue Duty Officer also informed the ATU Operations Duty Officer that it would be necessary for a fully qualified ATU instructor to go along as a patrol plane commander in charge of all flights. Lieutenant (junior grade) Walter G. Jeffrey had been scheduled for a local night flight that night and volunteered to take out PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, Squadron No. 49, with Combat Aircrew 88G on the Air Sea Rescue mission.

Examined by the recorder:

12. Q. Was D. E. Peterson, aviation machinist mate first class, U. S. Navy, qualified to be a plane captain in PBM-5, BuNo. 59225?
A. According to the records D. E. Peterson, aviation machinist mate first class, combat aircrew student plane captain of combat Aircrew 88G was checked and found qualified to solo as plane captain in PBM type aircraft on 22 October 1945 in accordance with the qualifications for solo plane captains at NAS, Banana River.

13. Q. What were the qualifications of Combat Aircrew 88G as the combat aircrew of a PBM type aircraft?
A. Combat Aircrew 88G had completed the ground training syllabus for combat aircrew and had completed all of the flight training syllabus except one night patrol flight of seven hours duration and was familiar with their respective duties performed in flight in PBM type aircraft.

14. Q. Who scheduled that flight with Combat Aircrew 88G in PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, on 5 December 1945?
A. The original flight was scheduled by the ATU Schedules Officer, Lieutenant Commander Brule, as a night navigation training flight. However, before the aircraft and crew had gone over the side the scheduled navigation training flight was diverted to an Air Sea Rescue mission and an ATU flight instructor, Lieutenant (junior grade) Jeffrey put in charge of the plane and crew by the ATU Operations Duty Officer, Lieutenant C. W. Johnson, when directed by the Air Sea Rescue Duty Officer to furnish aircraft for the Air Sea Rescue mission.

15. Q. When was the flight of PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, considered missing?
A. Since the yellow sheet shows that PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, Squadron No. 49 had 1855 gallons of fuel aboard which allows from 12-15 hours of flight, I assumed the crew and aircraft were missing on the Air Sea Rescue mission at

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about 1030, December 6, 1945, because by this time their fuel supply would have been exhausted and no communication had been established with aircraft or crew and neither had been seen since the 1930 out report of the previous evening.

16. Q. Were all personnel of PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, on a flight duty status on 5 December 1945?
A. They were.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness made the following statement:

The policy of VB2 ATU-3 is to assign the newest and best aircraft available to extended training flights and these aircraft, of which PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, Squadron No. 49, is one, is not used for other training flights. Also special attention is given to aviation equipment and emergency equipment aboard these planes. We have only a few Gibson Girls and they are assigned to the aircraft used on extended flights. All of this equipment is sighted and visually inspected before each flight.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness called by the recorder, entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Norman E. Brule, Lieutenant Commander, U. S. Naval Reserve, attached to NAS, Banana River, Florida on permanent duty.

2. Q. What are your specific duties at U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River?
A. I am the Flight Schedules Officer of VB2 ATU-3. I schedule combat aircrews and instructors and planes for training flights as outlined in the flight training syllabus for our station.

3. Q. Where were you on the afternoon of 5 December 1945 after 1600?
A. On the afternoon and evening of 5 December 1945 I was aboard the station and on duty as the senior duty officer until 1200, 6 December 1945.

4. Q. Did you schedule Combat Aircrew 886 for a night navigation flight in PBM-5, BuNo. 59225?
A. I did.

5. Q. Was this a regularly scheduled training flight?

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A. Yes, it was a regularly scheduled night navigation training flight which is a solo night radar coastal patrol and radar scope interpretation, and navigation flight.

6. Q. Was this flight launched as scheduled on 5 December 1945?
A. No sir.

7. Q. Explain this to the board.
A. The Operations Duty Officer for ATU upon hearing of an emergency rescheduled the flight from what it was to a searching hop.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness called by the recorder, entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Duane E. Walker, Lieutenant (junior grade), U. S. Naval Reserve, temporarily assigned to duty at Operations, U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida.

2. Q. What are your specific duties at NAS, Banana River?
A. My duties in Operations are Operations Watch Officer and Utility Pilot. The Operations Watch Officer handles all flight plans, is in charge of the aircraft coming and going from the field, is responsible for notifying all parties concerned of officials departing and arriving, keeps a log of all flights, is responsible for any emergency that comes up in the way of flying.

3. Q. Where were you on the afternoon of 5 December 1945 after 1600?
A. After 1600 of that date I was on duty as duty officer in the Operations Office at NAS, Banana River.

4. Q. On the afternoon of 5 December 1945 did you receive any information concerning aircraft in difficulty?
A. Yes I did.

5. Q. Tell the board exactly what happened.
A. At 1610 on 5 December 1945 the Boat Facility Office at Port Everglades called me on the long distance telephone and advised me that five TBM's in a flight out of Fort Lauderdale were reported missing and last heard from at 1610R, also stating that the radio voice call was FT-28 transmitting on 4805 kilocycles. When the flight was last according to the Port Everglades Office the approximate position of the flight was 045 degrees

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bearing, 150 miles from Bahamas Banks. The office at Port Everglades asked that we notify Vero Dumbo, Daytona Beach Dumbo, and all stations on the teletype circuit, and to send planes from NAS, Banana River to aid in the search. I was asked by the officer calling to advise him as soon as we were able to notify all stations and Dumbos. As soon as I had finished the telephone conversation with the Port Everglades Boat Facility Officer I advised Lieutenant (junior grade) Parmenter of the Air Sea Rescue Duty Office of the message received and gave him the information I received. I then called Lieutenant Johnson, the ATU Duty Officer, and gave him all of the information received and suggested that we send out as many planes as possible on the search. Lieutenant Johnson advised me that he would call back immediately and let me know how many planes we could send out. After a few minutes he called and asked me if students could be sent out. I advised him that no flight could be cleared unless an ATU instructor was aboard the plane. Lieutenant Johnson advised me that he could send three planes on the search. I relayed the message to the Air Sea Rescue Duty Office that Lieutenant Johnson would be able to send three aircraft to assist in the search. At about 1845R Lieutenant Parmenter advised me that all stations on the circuit had been notified and he had received "rogers" from all stations; also the Dumbos had been notified. I then called the Boat Facility Office at Port Everglades and notified them that all stations and Dumbos had been notified. He then told me that the high frequency direction finder net had established a fix on the TBM's as 29 degrees north and 79 degrees west, and asked that we notify all stations and Dumbos and I stated that I would. I then advised the Air Sea Rescue Duty Officer and the ATU Duty Officer directing the leader to send his planes to the position given; also to have the planes call on NAN PETER BAKER which is the voice call on 3000 for NAS, Banana River, as soon as they were airborne for a voice check.

Examined by the board:

6. Q. Was the telephone call from the Port Everglades Boat Facility at 1810 the first word you had of the missing flight of five TBM's?
A. Yes it was.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness called by the recorder, entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Charles W. Johnson, Lieutenant, U. S. Navy, permanently attached to NAS, Banana River, Florida. I'm assigned to VB2 ATU-3 as a flight instructor. I was the Operations Duty Officer at 1600, 5 December 1945 to 0600, 6 December 1945 during which time I was on duty at the ATU Duty Office in Hangar 510 NAS, Banana River.

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2. Q. Did you launch any aircraft on the night of 5 December 1945?
A. As Operations Duty Officer for ATU, I sent planes PBM-5, BuNo. 59173, Squadron Training No. 32, and PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, Squadron Training No. 49 on the assigned search. I also launched, about two and a half hours later, PBM-5, BuNo. 59160, Squadron Training No. 60.

3. Q. Why were these aircraft launched?
A. About 1810, station Operations notified me that a flight of TBM's was lost and was believed to be in the area just north of the Grand Bahama Islands. Operations then directed an ATU ready plane for immediate search of that area. I then decided that planes PBM-5, BuNo. 59173, Squadron Training No. 32; PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, Squadron Training No. 49; and PBM-5, BuNo. 59160, Squadron Training No. 60, would be diverted to search for the TBM's. About this time Lieutenant Bammerlin and Lieutenant (junior grade) Cone returned to the ATU Duty Office from station Operations. I then notified station Operations that ATU would send out planes PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, Squadron Training No. 49, and PBM-5, BuNo. 59173, Squadron Training No. 32, with the assigned crews on the search. The station Operations officer advised me that a qualified patrol plane commander ATU flight instructor be assigned in charge of Combat Aircrew 88G in plane PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, Squadron Training No. 49. This message and all my communications were over the "squawk box". Lieutenant (junior grade) Jeffrey, a qualified patrol plane commander and an ATU flight instructor, was in the duty office at the time and he heard the conversation between the station Operations officer and myself and Lieutenant (junior grade) Jeffrey then volunteered to fly with Combat Aircrew 88G.

4. Q. What further information were you given by the Operations Duty Officer or the Air Sea Rescue Duty Officer that concerned the missing TBM's?
A. I received no further information on the lost TBM's other than the position of the missing TBM's at 1810, until 1820 when I received a new possible position on the missing planes which was 29 degrees north, 79 degrees west. I then was directed to send search planes out immediately.

5. Q. What instructions did you give the pilots of the PBM's designated for this search?
A. I then briefed Lieutenant (junior grade) Bammerlin and Lieutenant (junior grade) Jeffrey as follows: Lieutenant (junior grade) Bammerlin was to take off and fly direct to 29 degrees north, 79 degrees west, and then conduct an expanding square search. Lieutenant (junior grade) Jeffrey was to take off and fly up the coast to latitude 29 degrees north and then east to longitude 79 degrees west, where he would contact Lieutenant (junior grade) Bammerlin and then would also conduct an expanding square search. Both planes were to use radar and keep lookouts posted throughout the plane. They were to send CW plane reports every hour using 4385 kilocycles. They were also to guard 4805 kilocycles which was the voice frequency of the TBM's. They were to contact Banana River tower on 3065 for any additional search information. Both Lieutenant (junior grade) Bammerlin and Lieutenant (junior grade) Jeffrey read the weather forecast and contacted Aerology for the latest weather. Both of the above pilots checked out a patrol plane commander book and then left the duty office for their assigned planes on the ramp. This was about 1850.

6. Q. Did you notice anything unusual about Lieutenant (junior grade) Jeffrey before he left operations to man his aircraft?
A. Lieutenant (junior grade) Jeffrey appeared normal in every respect.

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Examined by the board:

7. Q. What other personnel of the planes that you launched were present at the briefing?
A. Lieutenant (junior grade) Cone and all the junior pilots scheduled in the two planes were present during the briefing.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

The board then, at 12:45 p.m., recessed until 1:30 p.m., at which time it reconvened.

Present: All members, the recorder, and the reporter.

No witnesses not otherwise connected with the investigation were present.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rate, and present station.
A. Vernon D. Clary, radioman second class, U.S. Navy, permanently assigned to Communications Department, Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida.

2. Q. What are your specific duties?
A. Supervisor of communications watch and in control of the communications office in the absence of the chief at NAS radio, Banana River.

3. Q. Were you on duty on 5 December 1945?
A. I was on duty from 1700 until 2400.

4. Q. To what duties were you assigned?
A. Supervisor of watch, NAS communications.

5. Q. Are you the custodian of the communications log of NAS, Banana River, for 5 December 1945? If so, produce it.
A. I am. Here it is.

The communications log of Naval Air Station, Banana River, for 5 December 1945, was submitted to the board by the recorder and offered in evidence. It was examined by the board and, there being no objection, the communications log of Naval Air Station, Banana River, for 5 December 1945, was appended marked Exhibit "12".

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6. Q. Referring to the official communication log for Naval Air Station, Banana River, read such portions thereof as pertain to the facts concerning communications with PBM-5, BuNo. 59225.

A. Between 1900 Roger and 1905 Roger, 1883T training plane No. 49 called radio, NAS, Banana River, and requested them to send "V's" on 4385 kilocycles. Radio, NAS, Banana River, complied with this request and told the plane to go ahead. Training 49 then asked Radio, NAS, Banana River, if he should send "V's" and there was no answer to this request. Training 49 then requested signal strength from Radio, NAS, Banana River. Radio, NAS, Banana River, then answered with a "QSA 5", which means signal strength five. Training 49 then Rogered to the message. Between 1925 Roger and 1930 Roger, Training 49 requested permission from Radio, NAS, Banana River, to send a message. Radio, NAS, Banana River, gave this permission. Just prior to 1930 Roger, Training 49 sent his departure report. The message was "Rogered by Radio NAS, Banana River, at 1930". This last transmission was the departure report of Training 49, BuNo. 59225.

7. Q. Did you receive any hourly position reports from PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, on 5 December 1945?

A. No sir, I didn't.

8. Q. When you did not receive the hourly position reports from PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, what action did you take?

A. The Training 49's first position report was due at 2030 Roger. When he failed to call base at 2035 Roger, the operator attempted to contact him. The operator called him continually for an hour and still failed to get an answer. At approximately 2140 Roger, I informed Air Sea Rescue duty officer, Lieutenant Parmenter, personally of the fact that Training 49 was one hour overdue on his position report.

9. Q. Did you know of any unusual interference with radio transmission experienced during this period?

A. There was no unusual interference at all on 4385 kilocycles. Communications were good with other planes in the air.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness made the following statement:

I have no further statement except that operators were still trying to contact the missing PBM when I was relieved at midnight.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

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A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Robert H. Dinegar, Lieutenant, U.S. Naval Reserve, permanently attached to duty in connection with aerology at NAS, Banana River, Florida.

2. Q. What are your specific duties?
A. I am the Aerological Officer and Aerological Duty Officer at NAS, Banana River.

3. Q. Were you on duty 5 December 1945?
A. I was.

4. Q. Are you the legal custodian of the weather log of NAS, Banana River, for 5 December 1945? If so, produce it.
A. I am. Here it is.

The weather log of Naval Air Station, Banana River, produced by the witness, was submitted to the board and offered in evidence. There being no objection, it was so received and marked "Exhibit 13".

5. Q. Referring to the weather log of NAS, Banana River, for 5 December 1945, were weather conditions satisfactory for a search mission at 1900 over adjacent ocean areas?
A. They were permissible for an emergency search mission, but were undesirable for an ordinary training flight.

Examined by the board:

6. Q. Do the weather records available to you indicate that severe turbulence was probable over the local sea areas?
A. Yes sir, they do indicate that.

Examined by the recorder:

7. Q. What were the average winds in the area of Naval Air Station, Banana River, from 1900 on 5 December 1945?
A. Referring to my record, at surface they were 270 degrees at 11 miles per hour. At 1,000 feet, they were 270 degrees at 17 miles per hour. At 2,000 feet they were 270 degrees at 20 miles per hour, and at 3,000 feet, 250 degrees at 25 miles per hour. At 4,000 feet they were 240 degrees at 31 miles per hour, and at 5,000 feet they were 240 degrees at 31 miles per hour.

8. Q. What was the state of the sea in the area of NAS, Banana River, on the night of 5 December 1945?
A. I personally observed the state of the sea in the immediate area of Banana River that evening to be moderate. I later found out, on actual reports from the pilots that were in the search, that the state of the sea was rough.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

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The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rate, and present station.
A. Clarence R. Urgin, aviation machinist's mate third class, U.S. Navy, attached to Maintenance Division, ATU, Naval Air Station, Banana River.

2. Q. What are your specific duties?
A. I am assigned to one aircraft in our squadron. I take care of one engine, that is, maintenance on that engine and make sure all equipment is in the aircraft at all times. I fly any hops when the crew is not qualified, as instructor mechanic.

3. Q. Were you on duty on 5 December 1945?
A. Yes sir. My section had duty that day.

4. Q. To what duties were you assigned on 5 December 1945?
A. I was assigned to a night flight which was a D-6 patrol. On night flying you draw any plane in the squadron. I was assigned to airplane squadron No. 49.

5. Q. Did you inspect PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, Squadron No. 49, on 5 December 1945?
A. Yes sir.

6. Q. Tell the board in what condition you found PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, on 5 December 1945.
A. I found it to be A-1. I spent about an hour in the aircraft due to the change from D-6 to search flying and there was no indication of any gas fume. There was no discrepancy in any of the equipment and when we started up the engines they operated normally.

7. Q. Did you observe any irregularities whatsoever in this plane?
A. Nothing at all, sir.

8. Q. Did the plane captain check his airplane in accordance with existing instructions at Naval Air Station, Banana River, before the flight on 5 December 1945?
A. As near as I could observe, he carried out the standard procedure on the pre-flight inspection.

9. Q. How long before the PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, was launched, did you leave this airplane?
A. I would say approximately fifteen minutes.

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Examined by the board:

10. Q. How long have you been serving in your present capacity as plane captain instructor?
A. I would say approximately six and one-half or seven months.

11. Q. Prior to this time, had you served in PBM type aircraft?
A. I worked for about three and one-half months in PBM type aircraft before checking out as a mechanic instructor at Banana River.

Examined by the recorder:

12. Q. What safety and survival equipment did you sight at the time you were inspecting the aircraft for flight?
A. Three rafts, five emergency kits, semi-phore flags, parachutes and parachute harnesses, life preservers, Very pistol ammunition, and parachute flares.

Examined by the board:

13. Q. Do your duties require that you check all items in your assigned aircraft previous to flight?
A. No sir.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. John Douglas Mastaglio, Lieutenant Commander, U.S. Naval Reserve, permanently attached to ATU, Naval Air Station, Banana River, as maintenance officer.

2. Q. What are your specific duties?
A. Maintenance Officer, ATU, which is a PBM aircraft training squadron.

3. Q. What do your duties as Maintenance Officer consist of?
A. I supervise the upkeep and maintenance of all the aircraft attached to the squadron; see that the logs and all of the records are properly kept; see that checks are conducted and do the usual routine maintenance that is followed in connection with the upkeep of planes in a training squadron.

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4. Q. Are you the legal custodian of the Daily Flight Inspection Form for PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, dated 5 December 1945? If so, produce it.
A. I am. Here it is.

The Daily Flight Inspection Form was submitted to the board by the recorder and offered in evidence. It was examined by the board and, there being no objection, was so received and appended marked "Exhibit 14".

5. Q. Referring to the Daily Flight Inspection Form for PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, for 5 December 1945, has it been completed properly?
A. Yes sir, it has.

6. Q. Does the pre-flight inspection sheet show the quantity of gas and oil aboard before the takeoff on 5 December 1945?
A. Yes sir, it does. It indicates 220 gallons, right wing tank, 200 gallons, left wing tank, 270 gallons center, and 1165 gallons aft, making a total of 1855 gallons.

7. Q. I show you a group of papers. Do you recognize them? If so, as what?
A. These papers represent a check sheet covering a 60-hour check pulled on 20 November 1945 on PBM-5 airplane, squadron No. 49, BuNo. 59225, and a 90-hour check on the same plane which was pulled under date of 3 December 1945.

8. Q. Have these check sheets been fully completed and do they indicate that the checks were completed and signed as completed?
A. Yes sir, they do.

9. Q. By whom were they signed?
A. Both check sheets were signed by R. M. Shaw, ACMM(PA), Division Chief Petty Officer.

10. Q. Is there anything in either of the check sheets to indicate any outstanding or unusual mechanical difficulty of the airplane?
A. No sir, there is not.

11. Q. I show you a group of books. Do you recognize them and if so, as what?
A. The group consists of three books, one of which is the aviation engine log book covering a starboard engine on PBM-5 aircraft, squadron 49, BuNo. 59225, Pratt and Whitney engine BuNo. P-54213. Another book is the aviation engine log book covering the port engine on the same plane which is a Pratt and Whitney engine BuNo. 52187. The third book is the aircraft log book on the same plane.

12. Q. Do these logs contain a record of all checks that have been performed on this airplane while in the custody of the ATU-3?
A. Yes sir, they do.

13. Q. Referring to these logs, how many hours were put on the airplane between the last check performed and the next to last check?
A. 28.2 hours.

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14. Q. From your logs, how many hours flight time had the aircraft flown since the last check?
A. The first flight after the last check, which was a 90-hour one, was the flight on the evening of 5 December 1945.

15. Q. Were there any uncompleted "mandatory changes to be accomplished immediately" on this aircraft?
A. No sir.

16. Q. I show you another group of papers. Do you recognize them and, if so, as what?
A. They are two discrepancy sheets on PBM-5 aircraft, squadron 49, BuNo. 59225, one of which is dated 4 December and the other 5 December 1945.

17. Q. Referring to these discrepancy sheets, do they show any chronic or major discrepancy?
A. No sir, they do not.

18. Q. To the best of your knowledge, were there any uncorrected discrepancies on this aircraft when it departed on the flight in question?
A. There were no discrepancies.

19. Q. Referring to these discrepancy sheets, were there any discrepancies reported on this aircraft between the time of completion of the last check and the time of this flight?
A. Yes sir, there were. The discrepancy sheet bearing the date 4 December 1945 indicates that the left mag on the starboard engine dropped off and also that the hull should be inspected as the plane went aground. The discrepancy on the mag was corrected on the morning of 5 December 1945 and, at the same time, the hull was inspected and no damage was found to it or any of the structural members. There were no discrepancies reported on the sheet submitted for the morning of 5 December 1945.

20. Q. Have you had any reports of gasoline fumes in PBM-5, BuNo. 59225?
A. No sir.

21. Q. I show you this inventory list. Do you recognize it? If so, what is it?
A. Yes sir. It is a standard Bu&Aero inventory list for PBM-5 aircraft, NavAer Form 0135 GF27, covering plane BuNo. 59225, squadron 49.

22. Q. From this inventory list, were all instruments required for flight installed in this aircraft?
A. Yes sir.

23. Q. From the engine and aircraft log books of PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, give a concise history of the aircraft and engines.
A. Before the last flight, the port engine had 15.4 hours test time, plus 86.6 hours flight time, totalling 102.0 hours, and the starboard engine had 15.7 hours test time, plus 86.6 hours flight time, totalling 102.3 hours. The total time of the plane to 5 December 1945 was 959.4 hours. This plane was accepted by ATU on 28 February 1945. It was brand new and ferried to Banana River from Baltimore, Maryland. There were, naturally, no major overhauls involved. Both the port and starboard engines were installed on 23 October 1945.

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24. Q. Are you cognizant, as Maintenance Officer, of smoking regulations in aircraft?
A. Yes sir.

25. Q. What are they?
A. They are covered in Maintenance Department Order 6-45 dated 1 February 1945, a copy of which I hand you herewith.

Maintenance Department Order 6-45, produced by the witness, was submitted to the board and offered in evidence. It was examined by the board and, there being no objection, it was so received and appended marked "Exhibit 15".

26. Q. Do you know if a copy of the smoking regulations was posted in subject aircraft?
A. Yes sir. A copy of the regulations was posted on the bulkhead forward of the bunk room and no smoking signs were stenciled in various places throughout the ship and a copy of the smoking regulations was in the plane captain's log. The foregoing was personally observed by me on about 4 November 1945.

27. Q. What member of your maintenance crew is familiar with the details of the most recent checks conducted on PBM-5, BuNo. 59225?
A. Shaw, ACMM(PA), is the division chief petty officer in charge of the 4th Division to which plane 49 was attached.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness made the following statement:

I would like to advise the board that PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, was used solely for extended patrol flights and was never used for any other type of flight such as bounce drill, instrument flights, gunnery or bombing, in order to insure that it was in the best of airworthy condition.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rate, and present station.
A. Richard M. Shaw, aviation chief machinist's mate, U.S. Navy, permanently attached to Maintenance Division, ATU, Naval Air Station, Banana River.

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2. Q. What are your specific duties?
A. I am chief in charge of the 4th Division in Engineering. I have ten planes in my division and I supervise all the work that is done on the planes and see that the plane captains are on hand for all hops.

3. Q. Was PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, Squadron 49, assigned as one of the planes in your division?
A. Yes sir.

4. Q. I show you a paper. Do you recognize it and, if so, what is it?
A. It is a discrepancy sheet on PBM-5 aircraft, squadron No. 49, BuNo. 59225, for 4 December 1945.

5. Q. Are there any discrepancies on this discrepancy sheet?
A. Yes sir. The left mag on the starboard engine was dropping off 125 rpm or more, and the port engine was idling too low so that it cut out. The plane captain on this plane checked the discrepancy and couldn't find anything wrong with it, so I went out and personally checked the discrepancy myself and, after a good warmup period, both engines checked out okay.

6. Q. How do you explain the mag checking out okay when tested after they failed to check out when tested by the pilot on the previous evening?
A. Evidently the engines were loaded up from idling too long a period and when turned up the next morning warmed up and checked out okay.

7. Q. Did you inspect this PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, when it was undergoing a 90-hour check on 3 December 1945?
A. I supervised the check and there were no major discrepancies found on the plane at that time.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness made the following statement:

I have nothing further to state except that it was one of our best planes with new engines with about 86 hours flight time.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

The board then, at 4:50 p.m., adjourned until 9:00 a.m., Tuesday.

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SEVENTH DAY

U. S. Naval Air Station
Miami, Florida
Tuesday, December 18, 1945

The board met at 9:40 a.m.

Present:
Captain Albert K. Morehouse, U. S. Navy, senior member;
Commander Joseph T. Yavorsky, U. S. Navy, member;
Commander Howard S. Roberts, U. S. Navy, member; and
Lieutenant Commander Richard S. Roberts, U. S. Navy, recorder.
Elvera M. Erquist, yeoman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, reporter.

The record of proceedings of the sixth day of the investigation was read and approved.

No witnesses not otherwise connected with the investigation were present.

A witness called by the recorder, entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Lester R. Hussey, Lieutenant, S(A)T, U.S. Naval Reserve, assigned to permanent duty at Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida.

2. Q. What are your specific duties?
A. I am the ATU Radio-Radar Officer. As Radio-Radar Officer I am in charge of radio and radar maintenance in aircraft assigned to ATU, in charge of the ARM's and ART's who fly as instructors in radio communications, in charge of radio and radar materiel, in charge of radar officers assigned to ATU under instruction.

3. Q. State what you know regarding the condition of radio and radar equipment of PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, on 5 December 1945.
A. To the best of my knowledge, PBM-5, Squadron No. 49, BuNo. 59225, had no discrepancies in the radio and radar gear on that date with the exception of the APX-6 interrogation device which is without antenna due to lack of availability.

Examined by the board:

4. Q. How do you arrive at this conclusion?
A. I have a check sheet before me which is signed by an aviation radar technician, the heading of which states: "I have checked all electronic gear on the plane indicated before my signature and find all equipment except that listed in the exception column to be in proper operating condition".

Examined by the recorder:

5. Q. What do you mean by electronic equipment?
A. The use of the term electronic equipment has been to designate all radio and radar gear.

6. Q. What is the date on this last electronic check sheet?
A. 4 December 1945.

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7. Q. Was all the electronic equipment as required for PBM type aircraft installed aboard the PBM-5, BuNo. 59225?
A. Yes, sir.

Examined by the board:

8. Q. Do you have the electronic inventory sheet that would prove this point?
A. No I don't.

9. Q. How do you arrive at the conclusion that all radio and radar equipment required in this type aircraft was actually installed?
A. By questioning the ART's who were last aboard this plane, I arrived at that conclusion.

10. Q. What do you know from your own experience?
A. From my own experience, I checked the plane when it arrived and it had a complete complement of gear.

11. Q. Why do you not have records which would indicate that this gear was aboard PBM-5, BuNo. 59225?
A. When this plane was delivered I had a complete inventory made. I saw the sheets, but they are now missing; however, there is a check inventory available through the Supply Officer at Banana River.

12. Q. Would you, as radio-radar officer, know if any piece of radio and radar equipment had been removed from PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, for overhaul or repairs?
A. Yes sir, I would. None had been removed as of 4 December 1945.

Examined by the recorder:

13. Q. Was the radio altimeter installed in PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, in proper working condition and calibrated?
A. Yes it was, as of 4 December 1945.

14. Q. Is there any piece of radio-radar equipment installed in PBM type aircraft that is subject to chronic or periodic arcing failures?
A. The radar transmitter is subject to arcing failures, although it seldom happens.

Examined by the board:

15. Q. Where would such arcing of the radar transmitter discharge?
A. The arcing failure would occur inside the pressurized hat of the radar transmitter which is located in the radome above the plane.

Examined by the recorder:

16. Q. What personnel of the crew of the missing PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, were assigned by you to radio or radar duties on the flight under investigation?
A. Ensign Charles D. Arceneaux, A(L)T, U.S. Naval Reserve, File No. 409770, was assigned to ATU radio-radar for temporary duty under instruction involving flying and was aboard PBM-5, Squadron No. 49, BuNo 59225, 5 December 1945. The combat aircrew radiomen in the flight do not come under my cognizance.

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Examined by the board:

17. Q. Has Ensign Charles D. Arceneaux been seen subsequent to the night of 5 December 1945?
A. No, he has not reported for any musters which were made of his class.

18. Q. What training or experience did Ensign Charles D. Arceneaux have in the operation of radio and radar equipment?
A. Ensign Charles D. Arceneaux had the regular eight-month Navy course given to radar officers and was in the last week of his eight-week operational training course in this command.

Examined by the recorder:

19. Q. Do you consider Ensign Arceneaux qualified to perform the duties of radar operator on PBM-type aircraft?
A. Yes, Ensign Arceneaux was very well qualified.

None of the parties desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Louis (n) Peters, Chief Carpenter, U.S. Navy, permanently assigned to the maintenance division of ATU-3 at Naval Air Station, Banana River.

2. Q. What are your specific duties?
A. I am the Maintenance Division Structural Officer in charge of the shop in which emergency gear is checked and tested.

3. Q. I show you a paper. Do you recognize it and, if so, as what?
A. That is the chart of emergency gear required in the aircraft of the Naval Aviation Operational Training Command.

4. Q. Referring to this chart, state whether all required emergency equipment was aboard PBM-5, BuNo. 59225.
A. All items were aboard with the following exceptions: No large emergency ration container, instead, there were five small Mark 4 emergency ration containers; life raft equipment was short one hammock bed, one flashlight, and two batteries, and one corner reflector target; Mark 4 equipment container was short four water storage bags and also two distress smoke signals Mark 1 MD-0.

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5. Q. When had the survival equipment in the subject airplane been last inspected?

A. On 3 December 1945 during the routine 90-hour check all items were visually inspected. At that time, all the equipment, with the noted exceptions, was aboard PBM-5, Squadron No. 49, BuNo. 59225, and had no visible defects.

Examined by the board:

6. Q. Explain why there were exceptions to the required survival equipment in PBM-5, BuNo. 59225.

A. None of the missing items were considered essential in the type of operation conducted in ATU squadrons. Although there is a shortage of flashlights and smoke signals in the life rafts, they are available in the aircraft. There was one case of distress smoke signals in the aft station and flashlights available on the flight engineer's panel and auxiliary power plant. The other items were not available at NAS, Banana River.

Examined by the recorder:

7. Q. How often are life rafts, life vests, emergency rations, parachutes, and parachute harnesses tested and inspected at NAS, Banana River?

A. They are given daily visual inspection by the plane captain. Life rafts are inflation tested every three months. Life vests are tested every six months. Emergency rations are inspected at every inflation period of life rafts. Parachutes are replaced every thirty days, the harnesses are tested every six months.

8. Q. What was the condition of the safety belts and shoulder straps in PBM-5, BuNo. 59225?

A. There were only two shoulder harnesses installed, one on the pilot's seat and one on the co-pilot's seat. They were in a new condition. The shoulder harnesses were tested on or about 1 June 1945 in accordance with Bureau change and the safety belts were last tested on or about 1 May 1945. Testing equipment was not available for a recent drop check.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.

A. Robert G. Courter, Lieutenant, (A1), U.S. Naval Reserve, stationed at Naval Air Station, Banana River.

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2. Q. What are your specific duties?
A. I am the weight and balance officer at ATU-3, Naval Air Station, Banana River.

3. Q. What was the gross weight of PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, at the time of takeoff on the night search mission on 5 December 1945?
A. The gross weight at the time of takeoff from the calculations I can make was 49,485 pounds.

4. Q. From what source did you arrive at this figure?
A. The basic weight of the PBM aircraft is 35,190 pounds, from the Weight and Balance Handbook. The yellow sheet states 1855 gallons of gas at six pounds per gallon, 110 gallons of oil, a crew of thirteen. That would give a gross weight of 49,485 pounds.

5. Q. What is included in the term basic weight?
A. The basic weight is the empty airplane with all its fixed and operational equipment.

6. Q. What is the maximum allowable gross weight for PBM-type aircraft?
A. It is 60,000 pounds.

7. Q. Referring to the load adjusted for PBM aircraft, was the center of gravity in relation to the MAC of PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, as loaded for the night search mission on 5 December 1945, within the allowed limits?
A. According to my calculations, yes, it was, and the center of gravity would be at 31.3 per cent of the MAC.

8. Q. What are the allowable limits?
A. With 30 degrees of flap, between 28 per cent and 38 per cent of the MAC for takeoff.

9. Q. What loading instructions are in effect for PBM-type aircraft?
A. We require the student pilots to file a Form F clearance with the Operations Weight and Balance Office for each loading problem as encountered in the various phases. In this case, the loading problem had been encountered and a Form F filed for a similar load on a previous flight. All training loads are made conforming to a Flight Department Memo requiring that no plane shall carry more than 25 people and the maximum authorized gas load for regular training flights is 1950 gallons. Any load would, therefore, be under 52,000 pounds.

Examined by the board:

10. Q. Were these instructions complied with on the flight under investigation?
A. Yes sir.

11. Q. Under what conditions could PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, have become unstable on the night of 5 December 1945 due to a sudden shift in weights in the hull?
A. If three men in the forward bunk room had suddenly moved as far forward in the galley compartment as they could get, the plane would have been loaded beyond its stable limits.

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12. Q. Are pilots and combat aircrewmen in training in PBM-5-type aircraft at Naval Air Station, Banana River, acquainted or instructed in the dangers of sudden shift of load while in flight?

A. Yes sir, they are. The enlisted men are given one lecture on loading in which they are told of the dangers of shifting loads and especially of the importance of adhering to the load manifest which is established by the pilot. The pilots have a ground school course consisting of six lectures in loading, one lecture of which is devoted to loading theory and weight and balance rules, the remaining five lectures being devoted to load problems, working with the load adjuster, and Form F.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness made the following statement:

Lieutenant (junior grade) Jeffrey was fully qualified in the loading of PBM-5 type aircraft and, as an additional duty, was a lecturer on loading problems in the Ground Training Department. In flight, if all men had been at their normal stations for a search, the gross weight would be 49,035. Assuming that the aircraft burned approximately 450 pounds of fuel in thirty minutes, then the center of gravity would have been located at 27-1/2 per cent of the MAC. The loading range in flight is from 26 per cent to 41 per cent, the optimum location of the center of gravity for cruising is at 26 per cent of the MAC.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

The board then, at 12:30 p.m., recessed until 1:30 p.m., at which time it reconvened.

Present: All the members, the recorder, and the reporter.

No witnesses not otherwise connected with the investigation were present.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. James Flander, Jr., Lieutenant (Medical Corps), U.S. Navy, U.S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida.

2. Q. What are your specific duties?
A. The duties of a Flight Surgeon attached to NAS, Banana River.

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3. Q. Referring to the health records of Lieutenant (junior grade) W. G. Jeffrey, U.S. Navy, Lieutenant (junior grade) H. G. Cone, U.S. Naval Reserve, Ensign R. M. Allen, U.S. Naval Reserve, and Ensign L. A. Eliason, U.S. Naval Reserve, when did the above pilots last take a flight physical?

A. Ensign Eliason last took a flight physical 6 September 1945; Ensign Allen last took a flight physical 24 October 1945; Lieutenant (junior grade) Jeffrey last took a flight physical 4 September 1945; and Lieutenant (junior grade) Cone last took a flight physical 5 November 1945.

4. Q. Did any of the subject pilots have any physical or mental handicaps that would impair their proper performance of duty involving flying?

A. There is nothing in the record to indicate that any of the subject officers were not physically qualified for the actual control of aircraft in flight.

5. Q. Have you any record or information that any of the subject pilots have been under medical treatment since their last flight physical?

A. No sir.

6. Q. Referring to the health records, were Ensign C. D. Arceneaux, U.S. Naval Reserve, D. E. Peterson, AMM1c, U.S. Navy, W. D. Cargill, S1c, U.S. Naval Reserve, R. C. Cameron, ARM3c, U.S. Naval Reserve, J. F. Jordan, ARM3c, U.S. Naval Reserve, P. B. Neeman, S1c, U.S. Naval Reserve, J. T. Menendez, AOM3c, U.S. Navy, J. F. Osterheld, AOM3c, U.S. Naval Reserve, and A. J. Zywicki, S1c, U.S. Naval Reserve, physically qualified to be naval air technical observer or combat aircrewmen?

A. Yes sir.

7. Q. Did Ensign C. D. Arceneaux or any of the subject aircrewmen have any physical or mental defects that would hinder their proper performance of duty as flight aircrew personnel?

A. No sir.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.

A. Gerald Edward Bammerlin, Lieutenant (junior grade), U.S. Naval Reserve, Flight Instructor, ATU, U.S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida.

2. Q. What are your specific duties?

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A. My specific duties at ATU are Flight Instructor and, in addition, I have administrative duties in the navigation department.

3. Q. To what duties were you assigned on the night of 5 December 1945?
A. I was scheduled for a night solo check, which was later changed to a night navigational flight, but when information on the TBM's came in I was assigned to a search mission in a PBM-5 type aircraft.

4. Q. What orders and instructions did you receive concerning the night search mission?
A. About 1830 Operations called the Operations Duty Officer at ATU in regard to the five TBM's whose last position was reported as approximately 130 miles east of New Smyrna with about 20 minutes fuel remaining. We received this information on this position and were told to conduct a square search. We were instructed to conduct radar and visual search and to stand by on 4805 kilocycles, the reported frequency on which the TBM's were operating.

5. Q. What other planes were included in this search mission?
A. At the time we were briefed, Lieutenant (junior grade) Jeffrey in Training 49 was to make the second plane in the search and no other planes were included at that time.

6. Q. Did you and Lieutenant (junior grade) Jeffrey make any plans for your joint conduct of this search mission?
A. Yes, I was to proceed to the last reported position of the TBM's and conduct a square search. Lieutenant Jeffrey was to proceed to New Smyrna and track eastward to intercept the presumed track of the TBM's, and then was to conduct an expanding square search at the last reported position of the TBM's.

7. Q. At what time did you take off on this mission?
A. I took off in Training 32 at 1904.

Examined by the board:

8. Q. What personnel comprised the crew of your PBM-5?
A. Aboard Training 32 we had a total of 15 men, including four naval aviators, one officer navigational instructor, and ten enlisted aircrew ratings.

9. Q. After you were airborne, did you intercept any radio transmissions from Training 49, PBM-5, BuNo. 59225?
A. No sir.

10. Q. Did you intercept any transmissions on 4805 kilocycles?
A. No sir. We did not set up on 4805 kilocycles because the tower instructed us to set up on 3000 kilocycles before we had set up on 4805 kilocycles. These radio instructions superseded the instructions to guard 4805 kilocycles.

11. Q. Narate the factual sequence of events as concerned your mission on the night of 5 December 1945.
A. After takeoff we proceeded to 29 degrees north, 79 degrees west, and commenced an expanding square search for the five TBM's reported lost. This

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expanding square search was modified by investigations of radar targets and visually sighted lights, all of which were determined to be negative. About 2145 we were instructed to proceed to a position about 25 miles east of New Smyrna to investigate an explosion reported by a tanker. With the strong headwinds, it required about an hour to arrive on that scene. Arriving at the position of the reported explosion, we commenced an expanding square search at the position of the reported explosion, investigating numerous radar targets and visually observed lights, all of which were proved negative, until about 0300. We paralleled the assumed track of the TBM's out and back to the scene of the explosion and commenced an expanding square search, returning to the base at 0615.

12. Q. Did you use radar throughout the flight in question?
A. Yes sir.

13. Q. What were the weather and sea conditions in the vicinity of 29 degrees north, 79 degrees west, when you first arrived in that area?
A. When we first arrived in the area of 29 degrees north, 79 degrees west, at about 2015, the ceiling was approximately eight to twelve hundred feet overcast, occasional showers, estimated wind, west, southwest, 25 to 30 knots, and the air was very turbulent. The sea was very rough.

14. Q. Did you resort to instrument flying or use of the automatic pilot during your search in the vicinity of 29 degrees north, 79 degrees west?
A. We flew manually on instruments throughout the night, though whitecaps were visible below.

Examined by the recorder:

15. Q. What were the weather and sea conditions when you arrived 25 miles east of New Smyrna?
A. The weather and sea conditions 25 miles east of New Smyrna upon our arrival were ceiling estimated 1,000-1,200 feet, wind estimated west, southwest, about 25-30 knots, air very turbulent but, as I recall, we encountered no rain showers. The sea was very rough.

16. Q. Did you sight any ships in this area?
A. During the expanding square search in the area of the explosion we picked up a number of ships and fishing boats and we located what we believed to be the Smyrna crash boat that was standing by at the scene of the explosion and was searching the sea in that area.

17. Q. Did you sight a large tanker in this area?
A. I did not identify any ship as a tanker.

18. Q. Did you encounter any lightening during your search flight on the night of 5-6 December 1945?
A. Not to my recollection.

19. Q. At what altitude did you fly during your search mission on the night of 5-6 December 1945?
A. I flew at an altitude of between 400 and 800 feet, remaining below the overcast.

Examined by the board:

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20. Q. Did you experience any unusual difficulty in manual flying during the turbulence encountered on the night of 5-6 December 1945?
A. I found no abnormal difficulty in flying that would not be accounted for by the turbulent air.

Examined by the recorder:

21. Q. State your total flying hours.
A. My total flying time is slightly over 1,800 hours.

22. Q. How many hours have you logged in PBM-type aircraft?
A. I have logged approximately 1,400 hours in PBM-type aircraft.

23. Q. Approximately how much of this PBM time was night flying?
A. Approximately 300 hours.

24. Q. Are you a qualified fleet patrol plane commander?
A. Yes sir.

25. Q. Did you observe anything unusual about Lieutenant (junior grade) Jeffrey's actions prior to takeoff?
A. No sir, I observed nothing unusual about Lieutenant Jeffrey's actions prior to takeoff.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Floyd R. Parmenter, Jr., Lieutenant (junior grade), U.S. Naval Reserve, present station, Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida.

2. Q. What are your specific duties?
A. I am Air Sea Rescue Assistant Operations Officer at U.S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida.

3. Q. Were you on duty on 5 December 1945?
A. I was on duty at the Air Sea Rescue office from 1600 to 2400 on 5 December 1945.

The board then, at 4:30 p.m., adjourned until 9:30 a.m., Wednesday.

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EIGHTH DAY

U. S. Naval Air Station
Miami, Florida
Wednesday, December 19, 1945

The board met at 10:45 a.m.

Present:
Captain Albert K. Morehouse, U. S. Navy, senior member;
Commander Joseph T. Yavorsky, U. S. Navy, member;
Commander Howard S. Roberts, U. S. Navy, member; and
Lieutenant Commander Richard S. Roberts, U. S. Navy, recorder.
Elvera M. Erquist, yeoman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, reporter.

The record of proceedings of the seventh day of the investigation was read and approved.

No witnesses not otherwise connected with the investigation were present.

Floyd R. Parmenter, Jr., Lieutenant (junior grade), Assistant Air Sea Rescue Operations Officer, U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida, a witness for the board, was recalled and warned that the oath previously taken by him was still binding.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. Did you maintain a log or record of Air Sea Rescue operations and activities at Naval Air Station, Banana River, on 5 December 1945?
A. I maintained a record, but I have no log.

2. Q. How was this record compiled?
A. This record was compiled from memoranda and notes taken down by myself and assistant officers while I was on watch.

3. Q. Can you authenticate the entries made while you were on watch?
A. Yes sir.

4. Q. Do you have this record?
A. Yes, Here it is.

The Naval Air Station, Banana River, Air Sea Rescue operations record was introduced to the court in evidence for the purpose of reading into the record such extracts therefrom as required. There being no objection, the witness was permitted, during interrogation, to refer to this record to refresh his memory of events that transpired.

5. Q. When did you first learn that a flight of aircraft was in difficulty on 5 December 1945?
A. At 1700 I received information from Coast Guard, Dinner Key, that a flight of planes was lost near the Florida Keys and that Coast Guard, Dinner Key, was standing by.

6. Q. Through what means did you obtain this information?
A. Over the Air Sea Rescue teletype circuit.

7. Q. When were you told that a flight of five TBM's from Fort Lauderdale were lost?
A. At 1810.

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8. Q. By whom were you notified?
A. I was notified by Lieutenant (junior grade) Walker, who was in Operations at that time.

9. Q. What was the substance of the report you received from Lieutenant (junior grade) Walker?
A. That five planes were approximately 150 miles northeast of the Bahama banks with 30 to 60 minutes of fuel left and that the Miami dumbo was airborne and proceeding to that position. The lost planes were transmitting on 4805 kilocycles.

10. Q. What action did you take?
A. At 1812 I alerted the Vero Beach dumbo. At 1815 I tried to contact Miami JOC on the Air Sea Rescue teletype and request that they alert the net on 4805 kilocycles, but I was unable to reach them after trying for a few minutes. At 1817 I called Canova Beach radar station and informed them of the emergency. At approximately 1820 I alerted NGW-16, which is the 104-foot crash boat stationed off Naval Air Station, Banana River. At that time I alerted Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 3, Fort Pierce. At 1830 I called the tower and requested that they guard 4805 kilocycles and report any messages overheard on that frequency. At 1836 the Operations Duty Officer informed me that Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 at Port Everglades had called long distance and said that the new position of the lost planes was 29 degrees, 00 minutes, north, 79 degrees, 00 minutes, west. At 1837 I alerted Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 1, NAAS, Mayport, on the Air Sea Rescue teletype circuit and instructed them to dispatch the Mayport dumbo. At 1840 I contacted Naval Air Station, Daytona, and told them to dispatch the Daytona dumbo. At 1844 Lieutenant (junior grade) Walker said that he was requesting planes from ATU. He asked me if it was necessary to have flight instructors on the planes and also asked me if I wanted him to call Commander Lawrence and inform him of the emergency. I answered affirmative to both questions. At 1845 I alerted the Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 2 at New Smyrna and told them to have all available boats stand by in readiness. At 1850 I discovered that I could not transmit on 3000 kilocycles. At 1851 I told Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 1 at Mayport all the information I had at that time and requested that they relay all messages to NPB, Naval Air Station, Banana River, on 3000 kilocycles, as I could not transmit on that frequency. I informed them also that the Air Sea Rescue teletype was out from Banana River south. At 1905 the tower informed me that Training 32 was airborne. At that time I requested Lieutenant (junior grade) Walker to take care of all Banana River planes and, in turn, he informed me that Training 32 was proceeding to 29 degrees, 00 minutes, north, 79 degrees, 00 minutes, west. At 1920 the Operations Duty Officer informed me that he had received a telephone call from Miami and that they reported that they had lost all contact with the missing planes. At 1927 the tower informed me that Training 49 was airborne. At 2010 I called Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 at Port Everglades to try and get more information on the emergency.

11. Q. Who is the officer in charge of Air Sea Rescue operations at Naval Air Station, Banana River?
A. Commander W. J. Lawrence, U. S. Coast Guard.

12. Q. When did you notify him of the emergency?
A. At 1844 I instructed Lieutenant (junior grade) Walker to notify Commander Lawrence of the emergency.

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Examined by the board:

13. Q. Why did you instruct Lieutenant (junior grade) Walker to inform Commander Lawrence?

A. At the time I was very busy doing other things and it takes some time to get connections on telephone with Commander Lawrence.

14. Q. How many officers and men comprise the Air Sea Rescue watch detail at Air Sea Rescue Headquarters, Naval Air Station, Banana River?

A. At the time I was on duty I was the only man on watch.

15. Q. Did you, at any time during this emergency, direct radio, Naval Air Station, Banana River, or any other communication activities to try to contact the missing TBM planes on 4805 kilocycles?

A. At approximately 1830 I told the Banana River tower to try and contact the missing TBM's on 4805 kilocycles. They informed me that they did not guard this frequency and it would take some time to be able to transmit on that frequency. I told them to do the best they could and report any messages received. Nothing more was heard from the Banana River tower and they never transmitted on 4805 kilocycles.

16. Q. When did you determine or learn that Air Sea Rescue teletype circuit was out of commission from Banana River south?

A. At 1815, after I was unable to contact Miami JOC after several attempts, I came to the assumption that the teletype circuit was out from Banana River south.

17. Q. Did you, at any time during the emergency, direct Naval Air Station, Banana River, or any other radio activity to try to contact the missing planes on 3000 kilocycles Air Sea Rescue frequency?

A. No, I did not.

18. Q. What action did you take when you determined that the Air Sea Rescue circuit on 3000 kilocycles was not in operation?

A. I informed the transmitter building at Naval Air Station, Banana River, that I could not transmit on 3000 kilocycles. I also told Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 1 at Mayport that I could not transmit on 3000 kilocycles and asked if they would relay any messages to me by teletype. At the time, my receiver was very noisy and I doubt very much if anyone called me on that frequency, that I could hear them.

19. Q. What steps did you take to obtain assistance of additional personnel in Air Sea Rescue Operations during the course of this emergency?

A. Shortly after the emergency I requested that one or both of the officers in Operations that had the duty at the time come in and help me. Lieutenant (junior grade) Walker was the only man that was familiar with the Air Sea Rescue office and it was necessary for him to remain in the Operations office to answer the long distance telephone calls. At 1844 I requested Lieutenant (junior grade) Walker to notify Commander Lawrence. At approximately 2030 Ensign J. J. O'Neal, another Air Sea Rescue duty officer, arrived in the office.

20. Q. Did you make any further effort to notify Commander Lawrence of the emergency after 1844?

A. I made no further effort, but at approximately 2015 I inquired and

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Lieutenant (junior grade) Walker told me that Commander Lawrence was on his way out.

Examined by the recorder:

21. Q. When were you notified on 5 December 1945 that PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, had not been heard from since the "out" report?
A. At approximately 2140 the radio supervisor, Naval Air Station, Banana River, informed me that Training 49 had not sent in his 2030 position report.

22. Q. What action did you take when so informed?
A. I instructed the radio supervisor to keep trying to raise Training 49. I also informed Commander Lawrence, who previously had arrived at the Air Sea Rescue office.

23. Q. Did you receive any further information concerning PBM-5, BuNo. 59225?
A. No, but previously, at 2112, I received the following message from Miami JOC, "Position 28 degrees, 59 minutes, north, 80 degrees, 25 minutes, west, explosion just observed. Following is whole message, 'At 1950R 100 foot burst of flame lasting several minutes seen by circling ship'". When I heard that Training 49 had not sent in his position, in my mind I thought that this explosion could be Training 49 as we had no other planes besides the five TBM's reported missing and the five TBM's were reported to be out of fuel.

Examined by the board:

24. Q. At what time was the Air Sea Rescue voice transmitter on 3000 kilocycles back in operation?
A. I do not know, but it was later in the evening, approximately 2145.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

The board then, at 12:45 p.m., recessed until 1:30 p.m., at which time it reconvened.

Present: All members of the board, the recorder, and the reporter.

No witnesses not otherwise connected with the investigation were present.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

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Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Russell R. Barrett, Jr., Lieutenant Commander, U.S. Naval Reserve, Administrative Assistant to the Officer in Charge of ATU-3, U.S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida.

2. Q. What are your specific duties?
A. My specific duties are to muster the permanently assigned ATU officers daily and to report unauthorized absentees to the Officer in Charge.

3. Q. Are any of the following names officers on your muster roll: Lieutenant (junior grade) Walter G. Jeffrey, Lieutenant (junior grade) Harry G. Cone, Ensign Robert M. Allen, Ensign Lloyd A. Eliason.
A. Lieutenant (junior grade) Jeffrey is the only one on my muster roll for permanent ATU officers.

4. Q. Was he present for muster on 5 December 1945?
A. Lieutenant (junior grade) Jeffrey was present for muster on 5 December 1945.

5. Q. Was he present at any subsequent muster since 5 December 1945?
A. No sir, he was not.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Donald N. Brown, Lieutenant Commander, U.S. Naval Reserve, U.S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida.

2. Q. What are your specific duties?
A. I am the Combat Aircrew Administrative Officer; that entails forming of crews, the reports of the progress of training of these crews, mustering of the crews, and all the administrative jobs that are contained therein.

3. Q. Are any of the following naval officers on your muster roll? Lieutenant (junior grade) Harry G. Cone, Ensign Robert M. Allen, Ensign Lloyd A. Eliason.
A. Yes sir, they are all on my rolls.

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4. Q. Were they present for muster on 5 December 1945?
A. Yes, they were present for muster on 5 December 1945.

5. Q. Were they present for any subsequent muster since 5 December 1945?
A. No sir.

Examined by the board:

6. Q. To what PBM training crew were these officers assigned?
A. They were assigned to crew 88G.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rate, and present station.
A. John E. Bowman, Aviation Chief Machinist's Mate, U. S. Navy, U.S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida.

2. Q. What are your specific duties?
A. I'm the Combat Aircrew leading chief.

3. Q. Are you charged with the muster and accountability of the combat aircrewmen assigned to the PBM advanced training unit at Naval Air Station, Banana River?
A. Yes, I am.

4. Q. Are any of the following naval personnel on your muster roll? Donald E. Peterson, AMM1c, U.S. Navy; Wiley D. Cargill, S1c, U.S. Naval Reserve; Robert C. Cameron, ARM3c, U.S. Navy; James F. Jordan, ARM3c, U.S. Naval Reserve; Phillip V. Neeman, S1c, (ARM), U.S. Naval Reserve; John T. Menendez, AOM3c, U.S. Navy; James R. Osterheld, AOM3c, U.S. Naval Reserve; Alfred J. Zywicki, S1c (AOM), U.S. Naval Reserve.
A. Yes sir, they are all on my muster roll.

5. Q. Were they present for muster on 5 December 1945?
A. Yes, they were.

6. Q. Were they present for any subsequent muster since 5 December 1945?
A. No sir.

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7. Q. To what crew were these men assigned?
A. They were assigned to Crew 88G.

8. Q. Are any other combat aircrewmen carried on your muster roll unaccounted for?
A. No sir.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness states that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. William J. Lawrence, Commander, U.S. Coast Guard, U.S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida.

2. Q. What are your specific duties?
A. I'm the Air Sea Rescue Operations Officer and Air Operations Officer, at Naval Air Station, Banana River.

3. Q. Where were you on the evening of 5 December 1945?
A. I left the station between 1615 and 1630 and went directly to my home in Eau Gallie.

4. Q. At what time on 5 December 1945 were you notified that a flight of TBM's was missing?
A. At 2010R I received the call at my home from the Operations Duty Officer to the effect that five TBM's were missing from Fort Lauderdale.

5. Q. What did you do?
A. At 2105, 5 December 1945, I arrived at the Air Sea Rescue Operations Office, NAS, Banana River, and took charge of all operations for this Air Sea Rescue task group as Operations Officer and Air Sea Rescue Officer for this command. The summary of the situation as I found it is as follows: The Vero Beach Dumbo was proceeding to a position 150 miles east of Vero Beach, then searching north with instructions to report to Banana River for further instructions. The Daytona Beach Dumbo was airborne and had been directed to proceed to position 29 degrees, north, 79 degrees west, and conduct an expanding square search. PBM Training No. 32 and PBM Training No. 49 were out and directed to proceed to the same position and conduct a search. Mayport, New Smyrna, Fort Pierce, and Port Everglades Boat Facilities were alerted and standing by. Canova Beach radar station was in operation and the entire Air Sea Rescue net of this sector was alerted, including

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air traffic control. Communications were as follows: Air Sea Rescue Operations guarding 3000 kilocycles, 140.58 megacycles, 4790 kilocycles; Radio Control guarding 4385 kilocycles; Air Sea Rescue Annex guarding 8280 kilocycles; and Control Tower guarding 4805 kilocycles.

Examined by the board:

6. Q. What office of the Air Sea Rescue organization of the Gulf Sea Frontier was in charge of all search operations for the missing aircraft when you arrived in the Air Sea Rescue Operations office, Naval Air Station, Banana River?

A. The Air Sea Rescue Officer, Seventh Naval District, was controlling search operations. This was later verified by the following dispatch: "At 2224, Air Sea Rescue Officer, Miami, advised that Miami was controlling the search".

7. Q. Was central control of all Gulf Sea Frontier Air Sea Rescue Operations for the five missing TBM aircraft being effected when you arrived at your office on the night of 5 December 1945?

A. To the best of my knowledge, Miami had control of the search. At 2240 the Air Sea Rescue Officer, Miami, stated definitely that they were controlling search operations.

8. Q. When were you first informed that a PBM had not been heard from since sending his "out" report?

A. I was officially notified at approximately 2140.

9. Q. When you received this information, what action did you take?

A. I knew prior to that time that PBM Training No. 49 could not be contacted on 3000 kilocycles voice nor 4385 kilocycles on CW. I did attempt myself to establish communications with it on 3000 kilocycles up until that time. At 2112 I received information from the Joint Operations Center, Miami, that an explosion was observed by the SS GAINES MILLS at a position 28 degrees, 59 minutes north, 80 degrees, 25 minutes, west, at 1950R. At 2122, after being unable to contact the Daytona Beach dumbo, they were directed to proceed to the position of the explosion. This message was sent blind. At 2125 New Smyrna surface craft were dispatched to the position of the explosion. At 2135 PBM Training No. 60 was dispatched to the position of the explosion with instructions to guard 3000 kilocycles by radio. At 2147 PBM Training No. 32 and Training No. 60 were directed to conduct an expanding square search beginning at 28 degrees, 50 minutes, north, 80 degrees, 25 minutes, west. Each plane was to conduct a search individually with instructions to communicate by voice on 3000 kilocycles. The explosion had been reported as serious and the burst of flames had lasted for several minutes. It was assumed then that it could possibly be PBM Training No. 49 with which we were attempting to establish communication on 3000 kilocycles, but had not been able to do so. The explosion was reported to have been observed at 1950R, exactly 23 minutes after PBM Training No. 49 had taken off. The position of the explosion given was 45 nautical miles from Banana River seaplane area and north of a line from Banana River to the area assigned to the search. It is logical to assume that the plane was cruising between 120-140 knots.

Examined by the board:

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10. Q. What were the results of the searches you ordered in the vicinity of the recorded explosion?

A. The results of the searches by aircraft were negative; however, the SS GAINES MILLS was requested to stand by the scene of the explosion until relieved by another surface craft at 2315. New Smyrna Surface Craft No. 2 arrived on the scene. The officer in charge of the New Smyrna Surface Craft No. 2 reported that the master of the SS GAINES MILLS stated that a plane appeared to catch on fire in the air and quickly hit the water and explode and that an oil slick and debris had been seen by members of the ship's crew. The officer in charge of the New Smyrna surface craft reported later that he did not see any of the debris and that if any had been located the sea was too rough to permit picking it up. The boat maintained this position until relieved by another surface craft at daylight. Neither this craft or its relief salvaged any debris or wreckage from the explosion.

11. Q. Do you have any knowledge of any wreckage or oil samples being picked up by any of the surface vessels that searched the vicinity of the reported explosion?

A. Yes sir. The New Smyrna surface craft that had maintained a position in the area on 6 December 1945 took a sample of an oily substance from that locality. The samples were delivered to me, but there was no indication of any oil being present in the buckets. The samples were set aside to permit them to settle and, after approximately five days, an oily film appeared on the surface of the samples. It was then turned over to the Dispensary, NAS, Banana River, to submit for analysis. No wreckage was seen other than that reported by the master of the SS GAINES MILLS who failed to pick it up because of rough seas.

12. Q. How long was the search conducted in the vicinity of the reported explosion?

A. It was conducted throughout the night and begun again at daybreak on 6 December 1945 and continued until 1800, 10 December 1945.

13. Q. Was the scene of the explosion marked with buoys by any of the search activities?

A. To my knowledge, the position was not buoyed at that time because of exceedingly rough seas and undetermined depth of the water.

14. Q. What was the depth of the water in the vicinity of the reported explosion?

A. According to the pilot's chart, 78 feet.

15. Q. Were any diving or salvage operations conducted in attempting to identify the victim of the explosion?

A. Not to my knowledge.

Examined by the recorder:

16. Q. Have you radar equipment at Naval Air Station, Banana River?

A. Not on the station proper; however, Canova Beach Ground Control Intercepter located nine miles south of the station is a unit of the Operations Department. This equipment is used primarily for training and may be manned on call in emergency.

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17. Q. Was this equipment operating during the emergency on 5 December 1945?
A. Yes it was. It was conducting problems for Vero Beach aircraft.

18. Q. Was this radar equipment ever alerted?
A. The radar was alerted at 1817, 5 December 1945.

19. Q. What were the results?
A. The results were negative.

20. Q. Have you racon equipment at NAS, Banana River?
A. Yes sir, we have a racon unit located on the south side of the field.

21. Q. Was this racon equipment operating on 5 December 1945 during the emergency?
A. To the best of my knowledge, it was.

Examined by the board:

22. Q. Explain your words, "to the best of my knowledge".
A. When this equipment is out of operation the fact is reported to me by the watch immediately. Since such report had not been received, I assume that it was in operation.

23. Q. Could the racon equipment at Naval Air Station, Banana River, be used in conjunction with APS-4 type radar or ASB-7 type radar equipment?
A. That I can't answer.

Examined by the recorder:

24. Q. Have you YG equipment at Naval Air Station, Banana River?
A. We do have the equipment installed on the station; however, it was not in operation. The YJ, YK, and YM beacons were in operation.

Examined by the board:

25. Q. What further search operations for the missing TBM's and PBM aircraft were conducted under your cognizance?
A. The search operations were conducted by aircraft and surface craft as directed by the Air Sea Rescue Officer, Miami, from the evening of 5 December 1945 to 1800, 10 December 1945. The results and areas searched have been submitted to the Air Sea Rescue Officer, Miami. The total flight time of our planes from 5 December to 1700, 13 December 1945, was 690 hours, 44 minutes. In addition to these planes, we utilized surface craft of Mayport, New Smyrna, Fort Pierce, and Port Everglades boat facilities.

26. Q. What were the results of the conducted search activities under your cognizance that terminated on the evening of 13 December 1945?
A. The results of all searches conducted under my cognizance during that time were negative.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further

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statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

The board then, at 4:30 p.m., adjourned until 9:30 a.m., Friday.

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NARA 405

NINTH DAY

U. S. Naval Air Station
Miami, Florida
Friday, December 21, 1945

The board met at 9:30 a.m.

Present:
Captain Albert K. Morehouse, U. S. Navy, senior member;
Commander Joseph T. Yavorsky, U. S. Navy, member;
Commander Howard S. Roberts, U. S. Navy, member; and
Lieutenant Commander Richard S. Roberts, U. S. Navy, recorder.
Alvera M. Erquist, yeoman third class, U.S. Naval Reserve, reporter.

The record of proceedings of the eighth day of the investigation was read and approved.

No witnesses not otherwise connected with the investigation were present.

Robert D. Cox, Commander, U.S. Navy, Officer-in-Charge of VB2, ATU-3, Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida, a witness for the board, was recalled and warned that the oath previously taken by him was still binding.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. Are you in possession of Lieutenant (junior grade) Walter G. Jeffrey's qualification jacket?
A. I am. Here it is.

The qualification jacket of Lieutenant (junior grade) Walter G. Jeffrey was submitted to the board by the recorder for examination. There being no objection, it was so received.

2. Q. Referring to this jacket, give the board a brief history of Lieutenant (junior grade) Jeffrey's naval background.
A. According to the Officers' Qualification Questionnaire, NavPers 309, which I have before me, Lieutenant (junior grade) Walter G. Jeffrey completed flight training at NAS, Pensacola, in July 1942. Previous to this time he had served since 1937 in various naval aviation activities as an enlisted man. From 1942 until December, 1945, he had served in patrol and photographic squadrons prior to being ordered to NAS, Banana River, in January, 1945, to act as an instructor in the ATU. He had a total enlisted service of seven years and his highest enlisted rating was Chief Aviation Pilot (Permanent Appointment). The record further indicates that he was commissioned an Ensign (T), U.S. Navy, on 18 November 1943.

3. Q. Are you in possession of Lieutenant (junior grade) Walter G. Jeffrey's flight log?
A. I am. Here it is.

The flight log of Lieutenant (junior grade) Walter G. Jeffrey was submitted to the board by the recorder for examination. There being no objection, it was so received.

4. Q. Referring to this flight log, give the board a brief history of his flying experience.
A. Lieutenant (junior grade) Jeffrey's log indicates that he has a total of 1917.8 hours of flight time. Of this flight time, approximately 543.7 hours is in PBY type aircraft, 54 hours in PB4Y type aircraft, 180.7 hours in PBJ type aircraft, 488 hours in PB2Y type aircraft, and 426.4 hours in PBM type aircraft.

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5. Q. In previous testimony you have stated that Lieutenant (junior grade) Walter G. Jeffrey was a patrol plane commander and flight instructor in accordance with Naval Air Station, Banana River, standards for patrol plane commanders in PBM type aircraft. State to the board what these standards are.

A. The standards that must be met by ATU instructors before they are considered fully qualified are that they pass successfully a day flight check, a night flight check, and an instrument flight check under the supervision of a senior and experienced ATU instructor. Previous to these checks, pilots are interviewed by flight officers regarding their total flight time, past experience in type plane, and flight experience, and their suitability for instructor duty is determined.

Examined by the board:

6. Q. What are the standards established at Naval Air Station, Banana River, for student patrol plane commanders?

A. Students are checked as student patrol plane commanders for each major phase of their training; that is, they are given a day flight check after which they are permitted to solo in the local area in daytime; upon completion of the day familiarization phase, the student enters the instrument phase and upon completion of this phase is given an instrument check which he is required to pass; upon completion of the instrument phase, the student enters the night familiarization phase where he is given a night flight check and upon satisfactorily passing this check is permitted to solo the aircraft on any training flight.

Examined by the recorder:

7. Q. I show you here the pre-flight inspection form for PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, of 5 December 1945, which has previously been introduced in evidence to this board, on which form it is noted that the name of Vicent J. Zappolo appears as a crew member for this flight. Explain to the board why this name appears on this inspection form when it is not included in your testimony which stated the names of all personnel aboard the missing PBM?

A. Vicent J. Zappolo was assigned as the third radioman of NAS, Banana River, Combat Aircrew 880. His name was not given in my previous testimony as Zappolo was not aboard the aircraft although his name appears on the sheet.

None of the parties to the investigation desired to further examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

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1. Q. State your name, rate, and present station.
A. Vicent J. Zappolo, aviation radioman third class, U.S. Naval Reserve, temporarily assigned to NAS, Banana River, for operational training as a combat aircrewman.

2. Q. What are your specific duties?
A. My specific duties on the PBM is third radioman and port waist gunner in Crew 88G.

Examined by the board:

3. Q. Your name appears on the pre-flight inspection form for flight of PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, on the night of 5 December 1945. Did you make this flight?
A. No sir, I didn't.

Examined by the recorder:

4. Q. Tell the board why you did not make this flight.
A. At approximately 1500 of 5 December 1945 I called up the patrol plane commander, Mr. Cone, and asked if I might be excused from the flight that night and he said it would be all right.

Examined by the board:

5. Q. Did you notify the plane captain, Peterson, of this fact?
A. Yes sir, I did. I saw him at approximately 1530 in the Pelican Room and told him that I had gotten permission from Mr. Cone not to take the flight.

Examined by the recorder:

6. Q. Did you see the other members of Combat Aircrew 88G man their plane?
A. No sir.

Examined by the board:

7. Q. As a member of Combat Aircrew 88G, can you give any information regarding the competency of the officers or men in that crew that might shed light on the subject matter of this investigation?
A. To the best of my knowledge, all the men aboard the plane with the exception of the ATU man, whom I don't know, were responsible and competent persons.

8. Q. In your experience as a combat aircrewman in training in PBM type aircraft, have you any particular concern regarding the material condition or characteristics of PBM type aircraft in flight?
A. No sir, I don't.

9. Q. As a radio combat aircrewman in training for duty in PBM type aircraft, do you consider the syllabus adequate?
A. I do consider the syllabus adequate.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

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The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

The board then, at 12:15 p.m., recessed until 1:30 p.m., at which time it reconvened.

Present: All the members, the recorder, and the reporter.

William T. Murphy, Lieutenant Commander, U.S. Coast Guard, District Coast Guard Headquarters, Seventh Naval District, Miami, Florida, a witness for the board, was recalled and warned that the oath previously taken by him was still binding.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. What radar facilities are available to Air Sea Rescue Operations on the Florida peninsula?
A. I do not know, sir.

2. Q. Are there any racon stations available for Air Sea Rescue Operations on the Florida peninsula?
A. There are racon stations at Green Cove Springs, Banana River, Boca Raton, Miami, Key West, and San Julian.

3. Q. From the information you received, were these racon stations in operation during the emergency?
A. I do not know, sir.

4. Q. From information available to you, did Boca Raton report that their radar equipment was in operation?
A. From information I received, it was not available.

5. Q. Identify radio station WAX for the board insofar as its setup in Air Sea Rescue operations is concerned.
A. WAX is a leased radio station at Hialeah, Florida. WAX is on a teletype drop from HFDF, Gulf Sea Frontier net.

6. Q. Can radio station WAX operate on 4805 kilocycles?
A. They could, but to shift over it would take an engineer to go in there and shift over from the working frequency to 4805 kilocycles.

7. Q. Identify radio station JUPITER for the board insofar as its setup in Air Sea Rescue operations is concerned.
A. JUPITER is a Coast Guard radio station. It also provides HFDF bearings on the Gulf Sea Frontier net.

8. Q. Can radio station JUPITER transmit on 4805 kilocycles?
A. Not to my knowledge. It is on its own working frequency.

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9. Q. When you sent your evaluated fix out over the Air Sea Rescue and HF/DF nets, was anyone instructed to broadcast this fix to the aircraft in distress?
A. I do not know.

Examined by the board:

10. Q. Is it necessary for the Air Sea Rescue HF/DF net obtaining a fix to depend upon a source outside the net to transmit the evaluated fix to the vessel or aircraft requesting it?
A. No sir.

Examined by the recorder:

11. Q. What instructions did Air Sea Rescue headquarters give to the Dinner Key dumbo on the night of 5 December 1945?
A. Dinner Key was in communication via command line with Fort Everglades and Fort Lauderdale. Dinner Key advised us around 1800 by phone that they were having a PBY take off to endeavor raising the flight of lost planes. At 1820 Dinner Key called us via telephone and said the Miami dumbo was airborne to fly to Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, and then to fly course of 045 degrees true for 150 miles, endeavoring to raise the flight of planes on 4305 kilocycles.

12. Q. From information available to you, did the Dinner Key dumbo contact the five TBM's in difficulty?
A. No sir, not to my knowledge.

13. Q. Have you any information that any of the dumbos dispatched on the night of 5 December 1945 contacted or intercepted any message from the TBM's in difficulty?
A. No reports came in to our office on that sir.

14. Q. Did the Air Sea Rescue controller at headquarters, Gulf Sea Frontier, estimate the hourly and daily drift of the missing TBM's crews?
A. Yes sir.

15. Q. Explain how the Air Sea Rescue controller at Headquarters, Gulf Sea Frontier, calculated the probable drift of the missing TBM crews.
A. The calculated drift for rubber boats was worked out daily using hydro charts, ocean current tables, weather bureau information on the weather and reports from the ships in that locality on the weather, the state of the sea, and the direction and strength of the wind.

16. Q. How was this calculated drift used in conducting the search?
A. It was used to determine the search areas for the planes and vessels.

17. Q. Evaluate the 06006 dispatch received from the USS SOLOMONS which said that from four to six planes with no IFF were at 29-35 north, 81-28 west, course 170 degrees, speed 120 knots, estimated altitude 4000 feet, at 1900.
A. It was evaluated as negative.

Examined by the board:

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18. Q. Was the identity of these planes ever established?
A. No sir.

Examined by the recorder:

19. Q. Did Air Sea Rescue Operations receive any similar reports during the evening of 5 December 1945?
A. We had another report from the USS FORT WILLIAM. They reported five planes flying seaward from Hillsboro Light at 1500R. No one else sighted those planes and the evaluation of this report was negative.

20. Q. Are you familiar with deep-sea salvage operations?
A. Yes sir. I have commanded a submarine cable vessel for approximately four and one-half years.

21. Q. Would salvage operations be practicable in the area of the explosion reported to Gulf Sea Frontier headquarters by the steamship USS GAINES MILLS on the night of 5 December 1945?
A. I think it would be impracticable to attempt salvage operations for the aircraft.

22. Q. Are you the legal custodian of the Air Sea Rescue search charts for the missing aircraft? If so, produce them.
A. I am. Here they are.

The Air Sea Rescue charts were submitted to the board by the recorder and offered in evidence. There being no objection, they were so received and marked "Exhibits 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, and 21".

Examined by the board:

23. Q. From what sources of information are the search charts offered to the board drawn up?
A. From the daily reports of each activity concerned, describing the area searched, the type of planes, and the number of hours searched.

24. Q. Were the total instruments of search available to the Air Sea Rescue organization sufficient to search all probable sea area thoroughly and completely?
A. Yes sir.

25. Q. Did the Air Sea Rescue organization, Gulf Sea Frontier, employ all available rescue facilities?
A. Yes sir, all that were considered necessary and appropriate for this search.

Examined by the recorder:

26. Q. Who ordered the search for the missing aircraft to be terminated?
A. The main search terminated on the evening of 10 December by orders of ComSeven.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investiga-

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tion which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

The board then, at 4:50 p.m., adjourned until 9:30 a.m., Saturday.

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TENTH DAY

U. S. Naval Air Station
Miami, Florida
Saturday, 22 December 1945

The board met at 9:30 a.m.

Present:
Captain Albert K. Morehouse, U. S. Navy, senior member;
Commander Joseph T. Yavorsky, U. S. Navy, member;
Commander Howard S. Roberts, U. S. Navy, member; and
Lieutenant Commander Richard S. Roberts, U. S. Navy, recorder.
Margaret L. Anderson, yeoman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, reporter.

The record of proceedings of the ninth day of the investigation was read and approved.

No witnesses not connected with the investigation were present.

Commander Thomas H. Jenkins, U. S. Naval Reserve, Aviation Training Officer, U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, a witness for the board was recalled and warned that the oath previously taken by him was still binding.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. When it appeared that the five TBM's were in difficulty what officer took control of NAS, Fort Lauderdale's efforts to assist them?
A. Lieutenant Commander Poole, the Flight Officer.

2. Q. Did you at any time assume control of the operations on the evening of 5 December 1945?
A. I at no time assumed actual control of the operations. Lieutenant Commander Poole had been in charge since the difficulty was first known and had all of the pertinent information at hand, I, therefore, let him continue the active control.

3. Q. What instructions exist at U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, regarding the handling of a situation of this kind?
A. The procedure to be followed in case of any planes in difficulty is laid down in the Station Operations Manual. This procedure covers any general situation and in any unusual circumstances one of the senior aviators, either the Training Officer or the Flight Officer, takes over.

4. Q. Is radar required equipment in TBM's for over water navigational flights?
A. It is not.

5. Q. Did you receive any evaluated HF/DF positions on the five TBM's in difficulty?
A. I was informed that a fix had been obtained on the planes.

6. Q. What action was taken upon the receipt of the evaluated HF/DF position?
A. I do not know.

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7. Q. Why are the ZBX receivers in the U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale aircraft set to receive only on the home station frequency of 600 kilocycles?
A. I was unaware that they could receive on only the local station.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness called by the recorder, entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Meredith H. Griffith, Lieutenant Commander, U. S. Coast Guard, Gulf Sea Frontier, Miami, Florida.

2. Q. What are your duties?
A. Air Sea Rescue Communications.

3. Q. What search radar facilities are available for Air Sea Rescue Operations on the Florida Peninsula?
A. I do not know.

4. Q. I show you here Gulf Sea Frontier Air Sea Rescue Plan No. 1, dated 1 January 1945, referring to Part 4, Paragraph 4-2(e), does the cognizance of the operating status of all Navy radar and Naval aids within Naval districts come within the duties of your office?
A. Yes, all are within the Gulf Sea Frontier.

5. Q. Is station WAX, a radio facility, available to the Air Sea Rescue organization of Gulf Sea Frontier?
A. Yes, it is.

6. Q. Can the equipment installed at WAX, Hialeah, be set up to transmit on 4805 kilocycles?
A. The transmitter can transmit on 4805 kilocycles; however, presently the equipment is limited to certain fixed frequencies as set up for use by WAX. No arrangements are possible with the station WAX for rapid shifting of frequencies at the remote point of the transmitters other than those now in effect.

7. Q. What frequencies are regularly manned by station WAX?
A. 500 kilocycles, 8280 kilocycles, 482 kilocycles, and 8490 kilocycles.

8. Q. What is the situation regarding frequencies at radio station Jupiter?
A. The transmitter at Jupiter is essentially for operation with the net control station of the Caribbean net at San Juan.

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Examined by the board:

9. Q. What transmitting stations are available to the Air Sea Rescue of the Gulf Sea Frontier for transmitting vital information such as direction finder position to ships or aircraft in distress?
A. For surface craft in distress, the leased radio stations WAX, Miami, and WNU, New Orleans, are communicated with on 500 and 8280 kilocycles, unless aircraft are equipped to utilize these frequencies communications with them by other than their base station cannot be accomplished. However, the task units and other craft at the scene of a crash are all equipped to operate on 3000 kilocycles.

10. Q. Is the Air Sea Rescue organization self-sufficient as regards communications with vessels or aircraft in distress?
A. The HF/DF net was not originally set up to communicate directly with aircraft. It was the intent that a plane in distress would contact its base and they in turn would notify the Joint Operations Center which in turn alerts the net.

11. Q. What facilities for transmitting information would be used when the aircraft do not have a base in this area?
A. The HF/DF net has no means of communicating with the planes on long distance flights other than on 500 and 8280 kilocycles. Heretofore, due to low priority it has not been possible to obtain transmitter equipment for each direction finder station.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness called by the recorder, entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Donald W. Harris, Ensign, U. S. Naval Reserve, U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale.

2. Q. What are your duties?
A. I'm a student officer at NAS, Fort Lauderdale.

3. Q. When did you last fly TBM-3, BuNo. 23307, Squadron No. FT-28?
A. Wednesday morning, 5 December 1945.

4. Q. Did you observe anything unusual in the performance of this aircraft?
A. No sir.

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5. Q. Did you have occasion to observe the performance of the compasses on FT-28?

A. Yes sir. When I take off I always set my remote compass indicator in the direction of the runway. I check my remote compass on take off and in the area during every flight. It is part of my check off list. I set the remote compass indicator in the direction of the runway, then if the other needle coincides with the indicator which I set in the direction of the runway, I know the compass is operating satisfactorily.

6. Q. Did you at any time check the magnetic compass in FT-28?

A. No sir.

7. Q. During this flight did you at any time subject the aircraft to any unusual strains?

A. No sir.

Examined by the board:

8. Q. Did you at any time during flight notice any unusual behavior of the remote reading compass?

A. No sir.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

The board, then, at 1:15 p.m., adjourned until 9:30 a.m., Monday.

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NARA #13

ELEVENTH DAY

U. S. Naval Air Station
Miami, Florida
Monday, December 24, 1945

The board met at 9:30 a.m.

Present:
Captain Albert K. Morehouse, U. S. Navy, senior member;
Commander Joseph T. Yavorsky, U. S. Navy, member;
Commander Howard S. Roberts, U. S. Navy, member;
Lieutenant Commander Richard S. Roberts, U. S. Navy, recorder.
Margaret L. Anderson, yeoman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, reporter.

The record of proceedings of the tenth day of the investigation was read and approved.

No witnesses not otherwise connected with the investigation were present.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. John Andrew Sweezey, Ensign, U. S. Naval Reserve, U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, on temporary duty undergoing VTB training.

2. Q. What are your specific duties?
A. I am a student pilot in VTB instruction at Fort Lauderdale. My squadron number is 79-M.

3. Q. Have you participated in an off-shore navigational flight in TBM aircraft while undergoing advanced training?
A. Yes, I had one off-shore navigational flight which was conducted at night.

4. Q. What other flights did you have that prepared you for this night navigational flight?
A. I had no actual navigational flights over water, but gunnery and that didn't involve any navigation at all. In the hurricane that hit Florida on 13 September our flight took planes to Arkansas, and that involved radio navigation, but it didn't involve any use of the plotting board. It was all contact flying. Also, we have had navigation hops in the link trainer and classroom navigation.

5. Q. What instructions have you received regarding your actions in the event you became lost or uncertain of your position during off-shore navigation?
A. We were instructed that as soon as we learned that we were lost to pick up a heading of 270° and in that way we would eventually hit the coast of Florida. In the event we didn't hit the coast of Florida at the end of a reasonable length of time, we should turn on our emergency IFF, get on 3000 kilocycles, and do everything in our power to get in contact with the Air Sea Rescue organization located in Miami. In the meantime, we were to try to keep in contact with the base by radio on the working frequency and, in the event that we couldn't establish contact with the working frequency, we were to use any other training frequency that the tower could receive that we had knowledge of.

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6. Q. What instructions have you received regarding employment of YG/ZBX homing equipment?

A. In ground school we were given a class on the operation and principles of ZB homing gear, but we never had an actual checkout in the plane to show us how to set it up. We had three link hops involving ZB. The first one was done with the grid and the second one was done without the grid, using the 90 degree ZB orientation method. The third and final hop was a choice. We could use either the ZB or radio beam.

7. Q. What instructions have you received regarding the employment of racon beacons in conjunction with radio?

A. All we have had is one period in ground school training involving the principles of racon and how it operates.

Examined by the board:

8. Q. Are you familiar with the location of any racon beacons on the east coast of Florida?

A. No sir, I am not.

9. Q. If you had reason to believe that your instructor was in serious doubt as to his position on an off-shore navigational flight, what course of action would you follow?

A. In the event that I, myself, had no idea as to our position, I would follow the instructor, but in the event that I felt sure in my own mind that I had the position, then I would question the instructor's navigation over the radio or by visual means, whichever was at our command, and try to work out something with him. We have always been taught to remain with the formation unless actual failure of our own aircraft caused us to leave the formation.

10. Q. Would you continue to follow the instructor on a heading that you thought was getting you into serious difficulty?

A. I cannot answer that question without having full knowledge of the circumstances.

Examined by the recorder:

11. Q. If you found yourself in doubt regarding your position on a standard navigational flight as flown in this area, how would you orientate yourself?

A. The first thing I believe I would do would be to check my navigation on the plotting board and find out if I had made any errors in my tracking or my navigation and try to determine my position in the cockpit by my plotting board. If that failed, I would take up the heading of 270° and fly it for a reasonable length of time, depending on how far I believed myself out from shore. If, at the end of a reasonable length of time, I still hadn't reached shore, I would turn on my ZB and try to home in on that and also try to contact the Air Sea Rescue station here in Miami. All this time I would have kept in contact with the home field if it was possible.

Examined by the board:

12. Q. Do you know the designating letters for any of the local radio beam stations?

A. No sir, I don't.

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Examined by the recorder:

13. Q. Have you had available to you for use in off-shore navigational flights a ZBX homing grid?
A. Yes sir. There was a copy of the grid on the plotting board when I took the night flight from Miami and it had a grid for the Miami area.

14. Q. Were you acquainted with Ensign Bossi, Lieutenant Gerber, Captain Stivers, and Captain Powers who were the pilots in the missing TBM aircraft?
A. Yes sir, I knew them very well.

15. Q. Were these officers in your training squadron?
A. Yes sir, they were.

16. Q. Do you know if these officers received the same training as you received?
A. Yes sir. They received almost identically the same training as I received.

Examined by the board:

17. Q. If you had an occasion to need a HF/DF position, would you know how to obtain such a position while in flight.
A. No sir, I am not positive, but under the circumstances I would call Air Sea Rescue on 3000 kilocycles and ask them for a fix to locate my position.

18. Q. Do you feel that the instruction you have received is adequate for the type of flying required in advance training VTB type aircraft?
A. Yes sir, I do. Very adequate.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

The board then, at 11:00 a.m., adjourned, until 9:30 a.m., Thursday.

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TWELFTH DAY

U. S. Naval Air Station
Miami, Florida
Thursday, December 27, 1945

The board met at 9:30 a.m.

Present:
Captain Albert K. Morehouse, U. S. Navy, senior member;
Commander Joseph T. Yavorsky, U. S. Navy, member;
Commander Howard S. Roberts, U. S. Navy, member;
Lieutenant Commander Richard S. Roberts, U. S. Navy, recorder.
Margaret L. Anderson, yeoman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, reporter.

The record of proceedings of the eleventh day of the investigation was read and approved.

No witnesses not otherwise connected with the investigation were present.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station
A. Captain William O. Burch, Jr., U. S. Navy, Commanding Officer, Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida.

2. Q. What are your specific duties?
A. Commanding Officer of Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida.

3. Q. Do you exercise operational control of the Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 at Port Everglades during the progress of an emergency.
A. No.

4. Q. Explain your relation with Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 at Port Everglades.
A. In an emergency when a plane or boat is lost, the Air Sea Rescue is charged with the operation of locating or safety of life, and I am, at that time, only in administrative command of the unit. The Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 comes under the Air Sea Rescue Group Commander at Banana River during an emergency operation. I do have operational control of the unit when it is concerned with retrieving of torpedoes and things concerned with training.

5. Q. What officers in the operational chain of command at your station are qualified and authorized to take actual control of emergencies involving aircraft in flight from your station?
A. Myself, the Executive Officer, the Training Officer, Flight Officer, and, in the absence of any of those four, the duty officers of the training unit who are so designated. I do not have a list of them.

6. Q. Where were you at 1600, 5 December 1945?
A. On authorized leave.

7. Q. When did you learn of the TBM's being in difficulty?
A. About 1100 on 6 December.

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8. Q. At what time did you arrive at Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale?
A. About 1600 on 6 December.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

Commander Claude C. Newman, (DM), U. S. Naval Reserve, Officer in Charge, Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4, Port Everglades, Florida, a witness for the board, was recalled and warned that the oath previously taken by him was still binding.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. Was Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 in communication with any of the lost TBM's when you intercepted the coordinates of the high frequency direction finder fix at 1821R?
A. No sir. We had been out of two-way communication for approximately one hour.

2. Q. What station was responsible for transmitting the position obtained by the HF/DF fix to the lost TBM aircraft?
A. According to the interception of the teletype, Miami was passing that message on to Banana River for action. However, I would have taken any initiative if I thought there was any way of reaching them. We just intercepted that message on teletype and sent it up by landline.

3. Q. As the Officer in Charge of Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4, was it your responsibility to transmit the position obtained by HF/DF fix to the lost TBM's?
A. Yes, if I had been instructed by Miami. However, if I could have gotten it to them, I would have used my own initiative because there was life at stake.

4. Q. Did your radio equipment overhear any transmissions from the lost TBM's after you intercepted the HF/DF fix?
A. Yes. According to our log entry at 1844, we heard the following: "On 4805 kilocycles. Conversation garbled. Could hear FT-3 giving his call".

5. Q. Did you consider the fix as vital information for the recovery of the airborne TBM's at 1821 on 5 December 1945?
A. Very much so.

6. Q. What established procedure exists for determining the station that will broadcast such fix information to aircraft in distress?
A. Because of the short time I have been on this assignment, I do not feel qualified to give that answer.

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7. Q. What is the power rating in watts on your MHF transmitters?
A. Our antenna is set up for 3000 kilocycles. On that we have an output of 75 watts. However, using 4803 kilocycles, our output is limited to about 40 or 45 watts.

Examined by the Board:

8. Q. Lacking two-way communication, was there any attempt made to transmit the HF/DF fix to the aircraft in difficulty by means of so-called "blind" transmission?
A. No sir.

9. Q. Who exercises operational control of Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 during an emergency involving lost aircraft?
A. We act under the Task Group Commander at Banana River or Joint Operations Center, Miami, which is the headquarters of Air Sea Rescue.

Examined by the recorder:

10. Q. Did you guard 140.58 megacycles on 5 December 1945?
A. Yes sir. We had 24-hour operation on that frequency. We attempted to communicate with FT-28 on that frequency with negative results.

11. Q. What frequencies are guarded by Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4?
A. 2916 kilocycles, 4805 kilocycles, 5785 kilocycles, 6465 kilocycles, and 6620 kilocycles. These frequencies are guarded during flying hours. The following frequencies are guarded 24 hours a day: 3000 kilocycles and 140.58 kilocycles.

12. Q. Was any attempt made to contact the TBM's on 3000 kilocycles?
A. I do not know, but numerous attempts were made on 4805 kilocycles to get the aircraft to switch over to 3000 kilocycles.

13. Q. I read you an entry from the Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 Communication Log: "1824 ASRTU #4 to Banana River via phone, Relayed TWPL message from Miami. Also advised them to please have all stations in his area to attempt to contact FT-28 (Leader of Flight of TBF's) on 4805 Kc and advise him to maintain course of 270°." Can you authenticate this telephone message?
A. I cannot authenticate that message.

14. Q. Who can authenticate this message?
A. Lieutenant Thompson, Operations Officer, Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which has not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

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A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Azariah G. Thompson, Jr., Lieutenant, U. S. Naval Reserve, Operations Officer, Port Everglades Boat Facility.

2. Q. What are your specific duties?
A. I am in charge of operations of Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 under Commander Newman.

3. Q. Were you on duty on the afternoon of 5 December 1945?
A. I was.

4. Q. We have testimony that NAN HOW ABLE THREE was directed by Lieutenant Commander Poole, Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, to direct the lost aircraft to fly west into the sun. This transmission was heard by the Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale radio, but does not appear in NAN HOW ABLE THREE Log. Can you confirm this transmission?
A. Yes, I can as follows: At 1715R the following transmission was received from FT-28, "I am flying 270 degrees. Will fly that until we hit the beach or run out of gas." We gave them a "Roger" to continue to fly that course.

5. Q. I show you Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 Communication Log previously submitted in evidence. Do you know of any intercepted messages received or transmissions made that do not appear in this log?
A. I do, but I am not sure of actual times. After they changed course to 030 degrees, one plane, I do not know the number, gave his call and asked FT-28 if he should drop the last of his bombs. He said, "By all means". About 1715 FT-28 told all the planes to join up and continue in formation, and if any one plane had to ditch, they would all ditch together. There may be others that I do not recall at this time. Several times we attempted to contact FT-28 and each plane in the flight on VHF, the Air Sea Rescue frequency, 140.58 megacycles, and 3000 kilocycles and CW on 4805 kilocycles. There was no response at all. This was done between approximately 1710 and 1830.

6. Q. At 1824 the Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 Communications Log indicates that a message from Joint Operations Center, Miami, was intercepted by Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 and forwarded by landline to Operations, Naval Air Station, Banana River. This message was to advise them to have all stations in the area to attempt to contact the flight leader, FT-28, on 4805 kilocycles and advise him to maintain a course of 270 degrees. Can you verify that this was accomplished?
A. I can. I made the call myself by landline at about 1824. In that conversation I told them to tell the planes to steer 270 degrees.

7. Q. Did NAN HOW ABLE THREE attempt to contact the missing TBM aircraft on 3000 kilocycles?
A. We did with negative results.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

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The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. John Harding, Commander, U. S. Coast Guard, Headquarters, Gulf Sea Frontier.

2. Q. What are your specific duties?
A. I am an Assistant Operations Officer in the Gulf Sea Frontier, being a specialist assistant for Air Sea Rescue.

3. Q. Are there available to the Air Sea Rescue organization of the Gulf Sea Frontier, radio transmitters with sufficient power to insure covering all areas of the Gulf Sea Frontier's responsibility with aircraft and vessels in distress?
A. There are.

4. Q. Where are these radio transmitters located?
A. There are leased radio stations at Miami and New Orleans which are, in themselves, sufficient to cover the entire Sea Frontier; in addition, any Navy, Coast Guard, Army, CAA, or commercial station can be acquired for an emergency.

5. Q. What communication procedure has been established by the Air Sea Rescue organization of the Gulf Sea Frontier for transmitting information to airborne planes in distress?
A. The procedures established for use in the Gulf Sea Frontier and published in their Air Sea Rescue plan are taken practically verbatim from the emergency procedures established and published by the Joint Communication Board, Washington. These procedures are given in pamphlets titled JANP 107 and 108.

6. Q. Are you in possession of pamphlets JANP 107 and 108? If so, produce them.
A. I am. Here they are.

The Joint Emergency Rescue Communication Procedure pamphlets, JANP 107 and 108, were submitted to the board by the recorder for examination. There being no objection, they were so received, and examined by the board.

Examined by the board:

7. Q. Is the Air Sea Rescue organization capable of communicating with aircraft on the normal MHF bands?
A. Yes sir, they are.

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8. Q. What is the estimated time required to set up on a transmitting and receiving frequency not normally guarded by Air Sea Rescue facilities?

A. Using the Navy radio in Miami, the receivers could be set up practically instantaneously and the transmitter within fifteen minutes. Using CAA facilities at the Everglades radio station, approximately thirty minutes would be required to set up the transmitter. Radio, Miami, I know has a transmitter of 400 watts output for the 3 to 6 megacycle band and the CAA facilities includes a 3 kilowatt transmitter.

Examined by the recorder:

9. Q. Can you state what officer in the Air Sea Rescue organization of the Gulf Sea Frontier is responsible for evaluating and disseminating distress information during the progress of an alert or an emergency?

A. The controller on watch acting, of course, for his superior in the organization.

10. Q. Can you state what officer in the Air Sea Rescue organization of the Gulf Sea Frontier is responsible for being cognizant of the operating status of all radio/radar navigational aids within the Seventh Naval District.

A. The controller on watch has this responsibility and he acquires his information from various people in the organization. The Frontier no longer has a radar officer and that function is handled by the communication department.

11. Q. How does Air Sea Rescue employ shore-based radars in the Florida peninsula to assist in locating aircraft in distress?

A. There are no continuously operating shore radars maintained for locating aircraft in distress. The available radar activities are in two groups, one in the Vero Beach area and one at Key West. These are used by the commands concerned only when they have training in progress requiring their use. Other times they are available to the Air Sea Rescue organization in a standby status. That is, they cannot be expected to function without the usual warmup period.

12. Q. What is their standby status?

A. It is my understanding that, in their standby status, personnel are immediately available for their operation.

13. Q. Does the controller in the Air Sea Rescue Headquarters, DuPont Building, Miami, keep advised of their ready status?

A. No arrangements have been made to keep the controller informed of the temporary closing down of a radar station for maintenance purposes. However, when a station is dismantled and placed in inoperative status, that information is available to all concerned.

14. Q. How does the controller in Air Sea Rescue Headquarters receive radar positions on aircraft obtained by these radar stations?

A. By means of leased telephone circuit to the Key West area and by means of leased telephone and leased teletype from the Vero Beach control center. In the latter case, it is by telephone from Vero Beach to Banana River and by teletype from Banana River to Miami.

15. Q. Does the controller in Air Sea Rescue Headquarters receive regular reports from these stations during the progress of an alert to indicate that they are searching with their gear?

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A. Not unless he specifically requests such reports. However, it is certainly safe to assume that results if positive would be transmitted to the Controller.

16. Q. Who exercises operational control of Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 during the progress of an emergency for which the Gulf Sea Frontier Air Sea Rescue Organization has been alerted?

A. Task Unit No. 4 is under the group headquarters at Banana River. However, this would not prevent the controller at Miami giving an order to Task Unit No. 4 and notifying Banana River if the situation warranted such emergency action.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which has not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

Lieutenant Commander William T. Murphy, U. S. Coast Guard, District Coast Guard Headquarters, Seventh Naval District, Miami, Florida, a witness for the board was recalled and warned that the oath previously taken by him was still binding.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. Have you received any further information from the Master of the SS GAINES MILLS amplifying the report of the explosion which he witnessed on the night of 5 December 1945?

A. No sir.

2. Q. Did you have any other reports concerning this explosion?

A. Planes and surface craft searched that area. The SS GAINES MILLS searched the area and all results were negative. We received a dispatch from the USS SOLOMONS, CVE 67, 061627: "Our air search radar showed plane after take-off from Banana River last night joining with another plane, then separation and proceeding on course 045 degrees at exact time SS GAINES MILLS cited flames and in exact spot the above plane disappeared from the radar screen and never reappeared."

3. Q. Do any of your records show that any of the Air Sea Rescue activities attempted to contact the TBM's in difficulty on 4805 kilocycles on 5 December 1945?

A. The Dinner Key Dumbo took off at 1820 on 5 December and was told to try to contact them on 4805 kilocycles, but his antennae iced up later and he couldn't contact his own base or receive anything from his home base. Also, as indicated by the log, NAN ROW ABLE THREE had contact with the planes during the early evening of 5 December.

4. Q. Did any Air Sea Rescue activity try to contact the TBM aircraft on 3000 kilocycles?

A. The Vero Dumbo and the Daytona Dumbo were instructed when they took

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off on the evening of 5 December to try and contact the lost flight on 3000 kilocycles. I do not know what the results were.

5. Q. Can you state what was the temperature of the water in the area northeast of the Little Bahama Banks?

A. Referring to Chart No. 126, Atlas of Climatic Charts of the Oceans, U. S. Department of Agriculture, Weather Bureau, dated 1938, it shows for the month of December that the average ocean temperature over a period of years at 30 degrees north, latitude, in the area searched, was from 69.9 degrees Fahrenheit to 72.8 degrees Fahrenheit and as you come down to the southern area, it is an average of 73.6 degrees Fahrenheit to 75.9 degrees Fahrenheit.

6. Q. From your records, evaluate the SS THOMAS PAINE 06/1035 dispatch which stated that a watch officer reported two parachute flares 55 miles, bearing 074 degrees, from Cape Canaveral at 0135Z.

A. That area was searched by planes and surface craft and the results were negative.

7. Q. From your records, evaluate the SS PRESIDENT TYLER report of 0018R which stated that apparent white parachute flares bearing 100 true from position 29 degrees, 30 minutes, north; 79 degrees, 40 minutes west, which were sighted at 0043Z.

A. That area was also searched by surface vessels and planes for approximately one day and the results were negative.

8. Q. From your records, what were the results of your investigation concerning the body sighted in a life jacket by an SNJ pilot at Matanzas Inlet on 6 December 1945?

A. That area was searched by surface craft and planes and the evaluation was negative.

9. Q. From your records, what were the results of your investigation concerning a life jacket sighted at 26 degrees, 37 minutes north; 79 degrees, 44 minutes, west, by a Norwegian freighter?

A. A thorough search gave negative results.

10. Q. Do you know of any order or orders given by any personnel at Air Sea Rescue Operations to transmit the evaluated fix to the TBM aircraft either from Miami or from any radio stations available.

A. To my knowledge, no orders were given to blind broadcast, but the approximate fix was telephone to Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, to the Army Air Field, Miami 36th Street Airport, to the Civil Aeronautics Authority, and also put on the Air Sea Rescue teletype to all the Air Sea Rescue organizations, and also on the HF/DF nets. It was also given over the squawk box to NSO, Miami radio station. Miami radio station set up on 4805 kilocycles and tried to contact the planes. They couldn't contact them, and, to my knowledge, they did not broadcast that blind. We tried to relay the same message to the Dinner Key Dumbo which was airborne and enroute to the vicinity of the fix and could not contact the plane. Later, we were advised that his antennae iced up and he was unable to maintain contact with any of the shore units.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investiga-

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tion which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

Lieutenant Commander Donald J. Poole, U.S. Naval Reserve, Flight Officer, U.S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, a witness for the board, was recalled and warned that the oath previously taken by him was still binding.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. Are you in possession of Lieutenant Taylor's qualification jacket?
A. Yes, I am. Here it is.

Lieutenant Taylor's qualification jacket was submitted to the board by the recorder for examination. There being no objection, it was so received, and examined by the board.

2. Q. Referring to this jacket, give the board a brief history of Lieutenant Taylor's naval background.
A. Lieutenant Taylor received his flight training as an aviation cadet at Naval Air Station, Corpus Christi, Texas. This was from June 1941 to February 1942. From February 1942 to October 1942 Lieutenant Taylor remained at Corpus Christi as a flight instructor in a basic training squadron. During the period November 1942 to November 1943, Lieutenant Taylor was attached to VS-62, Naval Air Station, Key West, Florida, as a scouting pilot. During the period February 1943 to February 1945, Lieutenant Taylor was attached to VT-7 as a torpedo plane pilot. VT-7 trained at Naval Air Station, Quonset Point, Rhode Island, from November 1943 to April 1944. Then the squadron was aboard the USS HANCOCK from April 1944 to February 1945. Lieutenant Taylot reported to Naval Air Station, Miami, Florida, in April 1945 and was assigned duty as a flight instructor in VTB operational training. In November 1945 Lieutenant Taylor was transferred from Naval Air Station, Miami, to Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, and was also assigned duty as a flight instructor in VTB Advanced Training Unit No. 1.

3. Q. Are you in possession of Lieutenant Taylor's current flight log? If so, produce it.
A. I am. Here it is.

Lieutenant Taylor's current flight log was submitted to the board by the recorder for examination. There being no objection, it was so received and examined by the board.

4. Q. Referring to this flight log, give the board a brief history of Lieutenant Taylor's flying experience.
A. Lieutenant Taylor's second flight book begins as of 5 September 1943 while he was attached to VS-62 based at Key West. Practically all of the time logged while attached to VS-62 from 5 September 1943 to December 1943 was in OS2U-3's. This totaled 138 hours. From 17 December 1943 to 5 December 1945, practically all of Lieutenant Taylor's solo flight time was in TBF's and TBM's. This totaled 616 hours. Of this 616 TBF and TBM flight hours, 273 were flown while VT-7 was aboard the USS HANCOCK and approximately 61 of the 273

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hours involved actual strikes against the enemy or anti-snooper missions. Approximately 165 TBF-TBM hours were flown by Lieutenant Taylor as a VTB flight instructor while at Naval Air Station, Miami. Lieutenant Taylor's flight log shows a total of 2509.3 flight hours. This includes both passenger and pilot time.

5. Q. Have you ever directed that a test flight be conducted to determine the range of the Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, YG homing transmitter when used in conjunction with the standard ZBX receiver as installed in the TBM training planes?
A. Yes sir, I have.

6. Q. What were the results?
A. The result of the test conducted by Lieutenant Jackson as of 14 December 1945 are as follows: At 1000 feet, YG transmitter signals were received for a distance of 42 miles. At 2300 feet, signals were received 56 miles. At 5000 feet, signals were received 80 miles. At 7100 feet, signals were received 100 miles. At 8200 feet, signals were received 115 miles. At 10,000 feet, signals were received 123 miles.

Examined by the board:

7. Q. On what bearing from Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, were these tests conducted?
A. On a bearing of 091 degrees true.

Examined by the recorder:

8. Q. Do you know what type VHF radio equipment was installed in FT-74 when flown by Lieutenant Cox on 5 December 1945?
A. Yes. It has VHF AN/ARC-1 type gear.

9. Q. Do you know what frequency was set on channel 7 on FT-74?
A. Yes sir. This frequency is 142.74 megacycles. This is the Navy's cross-country VHF frequency and is guarded by Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, tower.

10. Q. What frequencies are guarded by Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale?
A. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, tower guard the following frequencies: 3105 kilocycles, 4495 kilocycles, 142.74 megacycles, 6225 kilocycles, and 3475 kilocycles. Operation radio guards the following frequencies: 4805 kilocycles, 6620 kilocycles, 3475 kilocycles, and 140.22 megacycles. That is all that is guarded without special request for turning the others on.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which has not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

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Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Marshall Bernard Goodwin, Lieutenant, U. S. Naval Reserve, Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale.

2. Q. What are your specific duties?
A. I am personnel officer at Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale.

3. Q. I read you a list of names of the combat aircrewmen passengers in the missing TBM's. Can you verify these names? Walter Reed Parpart, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve; Robert Francis Harmon, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Howell Orrin Thompson, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve; George Richard Paonessa, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps; Robert Peter Gruebel, private, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve; Robert Francis Gallivan, sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps; William Earl Lightfoot, private first class, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve; Herman Arthur Thelander, seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve; Burt Edward Haluk, Jr., seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve.
A. The list of names is correct in all respects with the exception of Robert Francis Harmon who enlisted fradulently under this name. His correct name is George Francis Devlin, which name was established by his own admission and affidavits from his parents and a certified copy of his birth certificate which were submitted to the Bureau of Naval Personnel on 25 November 1945.

4. Q. Have any of the aircrewmen just previously mentioned been sighted at any subsequent musters since 5 December 1945?
A. They have not.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which has not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

The board then, at 1:00 p.m., adjourned until 9:30 a.m., Friday.

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THIRTEENTH DAY

U. S. Naval Air Station
Miami, Florida
Monday, December 31, 1945

The board met at 9:30 a.m.

Present:
Captain Albert K. Morehouse, U. S. Navy, senior member;
Commander Joseph T. Yavorsky, U. S. Navy, member;
Commander Howard S. Roberts, U. S. Navy, member;
Lieutenant Commander Richard S. Roberts, U. S. Navy, recorder.
Margaret L. Anderson, yeoman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, reporter.

The record of proceedings of the twelfth day of the investigation was read and approved.

No witnesses not otherwise connected with the investigation were present.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Richard Baxter, Commander, U. S. Coast Guard, District Coast Guard Office, Seventh Naval District, Miami, Florida.

2. Q. What are your duties?
A. My specific duty is Assistant Operations Officer, District Coast Guard Office, Seventh Naval District, Miami.

3. Q. To what specific duties in the Air Sea Rescue organization of the Gulf Sea Frontier are you assigned?
A. I'm the Assistant to the Assistant District Coast Guard Officer. The District Coast Guard Officer, having been delegated the authority to handle Air Sea Rescue so far as practicable for the Seventh Naval District under the Commandant, Gulf Sea Frontier, who is charged with Air Sea Rescue by CNO. Coast Guard regulations of January 1944, now current, provide that the Assistant Coast Guard Officer is the Operations Officer of a Coast Guard District in addition to his other duties. My job is primarily that of Air Sea Rescue Operations for the Coast Guard District.

4. Q. Can you state to whom within the Gulf Sea Frontier Air Sea Rescue organization is delegated the responsibility for establishing and maintaining positive and rapid Air Sea Rescue communication facilities within the Air Sea Rescue organization?
A. I do not know that any responsibility has been delegated to one person for establishing positive and rapid communication facilities, but Lieutenant Commander Griffith is the communications representative established under Gulf Sea Frontier to do what he is able in maintaining proper facilities.

5. Q. Can you state to whom within the Gulf Sea Frontier Air Sea Rescue organization is delegated the responsibility of being cognizant of the operating status of all radio, radar, and navigational aids within the Seventh Naval District?

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A. I believe Mr. Griffith is charged with the cognisance of Navy and Coast Guard gear attached to the Seventh Naval District; that is, gear which is directly belonging to Seventh Naval District, and I know that he also tries to include other Navy gear belonging to various other commands as the NAAdvTra, and ComAirLant stations.

Examined by the board:

6. Q. Do you know of any officer in the Air Sea Rescue organization of Gulf Sea Frontier who is cognizant of the location and operating status of Army radar and radio facilities in the Seventh Naval District that are considered available to the Air Sea Rescue organization in emergencies.
A. No sir.

Examined by the recorder:

7. Q. Can you state to whom within the Gulf Sea Frontier Air Sea Rescue organization is delegated the responsibility for assuming emergency control of any aircraft when necessary in Air Sea Rescue operations?
A. The senior Air Sea Rescue Watch Officer may assume that responsibility under the existing Gulf Sea Frontier plan.

8. Q. Is adequate and suitable radio transmitting equipment available to the Air Sea Rescue organization of the Gulf Sea Frontier for communicating with aircraft in distress?
A. My duties cover only a part of Gulf Sea Frontier in the Seventh Naval District area. In my opinion there is not suitable radio equipment for transmitting to aircraft in distress in the vicinity of this area.

9. Q. At what time did your activity take over control of the Air Sea Rescue operations for the TBM's from U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale on 5 December 1945?
A. My activity being the Coast Guard never fully took over control due to the presence of Commodore Benson representing the Navy (Seventh Naval District), but we assumed control to an extent by issuing orders to Navy and Coast Guard units and making requests to merchant vessels. By requesting the HF/DF net to take bearing at approximately 1643, that date, the assumption of control was started. The issuance of "BAMS" to merchant shipping and the issuance of general alerts to Navy vessels and other service vessels was exercised by Seventh Naval District. Requests were made of the Army for participating help and directives issued to Navy and Coast Guard units which would indicate control having been taken over by Seventh Naval District.

10. Q. At what time did you report to Joint Operations Center, Miami, on the afternoon of 5 December 1945?
A. In the neighborhood of 1900, exact time I do not know.

11. Q. What duties did you assume when you arrived?
A. Upon arriving I assumed no duties, but immediately went to Evaluation Plot to check on reported 1750 plot of the planes, then returned to my office immediately adjoining the bridge and made a short study of the available, pertinent data at that time. Then I made suggestions to Commodore Benson, to both the Navy and Coast Guard Controllers on watch and to the Gulf Sea Frontier senior Operations Duty Officer. I took over controller's duties shortly after studying current data available.

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Examined by the board:

12. Q. Were the controllers on watch at Joint Operations Center, Miami, representatives of the Commandant, Seventh Naval District, and Commandant, Gulf Sea Frontier?

A. There are two controllers on watch, one a Coast Guard officer who represents Coast Guard Operations and Air Sea Rescue in general, Seventh Naval District. There is a Navy officer as Controller who represents Operations, Seventh Naval District, and Gulf Sea Frontier. Both of these officers sit at the same desk and are there on watch every bit of the time. There is a senior Operations Duty Officer representing Gulf Sea Frontier who is immediately available, but does not actually stand the watch on the bridge. The Controller being the man who answers the phones and actually operates. He may be relieved by the senior Operations Duty Officer in cases of necessity, but ordinarily the senior Duty Officer acts through the Controller. Air Sea Rescue has recently been delegated to the District Coast Guard Officer, insofar as practicable, at the suggestion of Commandant, Gulf Sea Frontier, with the concurrence of ComSeven - at that time ComSeven and ComGulf were one and the same person. On the 24th of October, ComGulf duties were absorbed by ComEast in New York. This echelon makes ComGulf separate from ComEast in area only, the actual head being one officer. At the time of this emergency, Seventh Naval District assumed control to the extent that Commodore Benson, Assistant Commandant, Seventh Naval District, issued orders, made suggestions through both myself, the Coast Guard Controller on watch, and the Navy Controller on watch, as well as the Gulf Sea Frontier senior Operations Officer on duty. He was present at the time I reported aboard that evening and was on the bridge a great deal of the time throughout the operations and personally checked the plane searches made by me, made suggestions as he deemed necessary, and operated as a head representing Seventh Naval District.

13. Q. Joint Operations Center is an organization charged with several functions and responsibilities, one of which is Air Sea Rescue of the Gulf Sea Frontier. On the evening of 5 December 1945 to what officer attached to the Joint Operations Center fell the responsibility of actually controlling the emergency concerning the five TBM's.

A. Myself, after my arrival.

Examined by the recorder:

14. Q. What was the situation when you arrived at Joint Operations Center on the evening of 5 December 1945?

A. The Commodore was on or near the bridge, Lieutenant Commander Murphy, U.S. Coast Guard, Lieutenant (junior grade) Perret, U. S. Coast Guard, both Coast Guard and Navy Controllers and the Gulf Sea Frontier Duty Officer were present, the Evaluators of the HF/DF net were in an adjoining room with their watch standers, the teletype Air Sea Rescue operators were working. Attempts were being made to pass information to Jacksonville and Banana River to get action from them and the teletypes were out of commission from south of Banana River up through Jacksonville, and phone calls were pending. An approximate position by HF/DF cuts was available as of 1750R. Boat Facility, Fort Lauderdale, was attempting transmission with the missing aircraft, Miami dumbo was airborne, Banana River had planes standing by, and Jacksonville had a plane airborne. Daytona Beach and Vero Beach dumbos were

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in the process of taking off or one had already been airborne. Although all the radar information was not fully available at the time I arrived on the bridge due to communication difficulties on the teletype net; that is the Air Sea Rescue net, priority phone calls were attempted, but an error had been made by not giving them a Class 1 priority which is allowed by ComGulf. I quickly informed the switch board operator, Dupont Building, to make all calls pertaining to this case Priority 1 and passed that information on to the Commodore and representative watch officers in order to get immediate action by phone as fast as possible. Two "BAMS" messages were being initiated, messages to surface ships of the Navy and the Coast Guard were being made up, directives were being made up to the USS SOLOMONS, to various Coast Guard Group Headquarters having surface ships available, and informative messages were being given to Charleston Air Sea Rescue, CAA, Army, and RAF units. As soon as possible by phone, Banana River and Jacksonville were given the latest information possible and as soon as teletypes went back in commission, everyone on the Air Sea Rescue circuit was advised, which includes such units as the Third Air Force on the west coast of Florida, Coast Guard Air Station, St. Petersburg, in addition to the east coast stations Army, Navy, and Coast Guard. NSO was advised of the frequency the planes were using and directed to communicate with them if possible. A suggestion had been made to broadcast to them "blind", if they were not heard, although I do not believe the planes position was broadcast "blind" by NSO because that suggestion was not concurred in by the senior officer present at that time -- the reason at the time being the high power would blank out the HF/DF people who were trying to obtain bearings on voice frequency at a great distance and were trying to get every particle of any of the lost plane transmissions.

15. Q. Was a record of all pertinent radio transmission concerning the TBM aircraft available to you when you took over control at Joint Operations Center?

A. No sir.

16. Q. What method has been established at Joint Operations Center to keep the Controller advised of all current communications information during an emergency?

A. The Air Sea Rescue teletype net has been established to be able to receive information from the units on that net as soon as possible. The teletype connected with the HF/DF units also is immediately available and there is one receiver in the Evaluator's Office which is available for close by accidents. NSO is available for listening watches in short order but it is the custom to operate with lost planes through their base radio, if the planes are considered to be anywhere near their home base. For planes of the Advanced Training Command it is generally left to the Banana River Task Unit which is their direct representative to handle communications with their aircraft.

17. Q. What was your estimate of the situation when you took over control at Joint Operations Center?

A. That five planes were definitely overdue and from my past experience in the Air Sea Rescue organization when I was the first Coast Guard Air Sea Rescue Operations Officer when it was originated at San Diego in 1943, I considered it an emergency and took immediate steps to make all possible alerts to try and establish contact with the planes themselves, to check in with known available IFF interrogator stations. Known radar stations were alerted. Most of this was done by phone, Priority 1. It was determined that no one had picked up the IFF, including Boca Raton and Key West, Boca Chica

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that is; that the mobile plane in the area, Dinner Key Dumbo, had suitable radar, APX-6, and attempts were made to be sure that all the northern stations had been fully advised. A check was made and it was determined that all the coastal fields had been requested to put on maximum lights, weather conditions were checked. It was very definite in my mind that these planes were approximately 100-150 miles off Cape Canaveral at approximately 1800. We did not know actually in which direction they were headed at that time. A DR position at the time of that fix, giving a fair approximation, put them in that area. This DR was based on the fact that we knew their original course, approximate speed, approximate wind, and their intentions (based on information we had received by interception from HF stations and Boat Facility, Fort Lauderdale), of the courses and times in flight. That would have given them, in my estimation, a position near Walker Cay at the time they thought they were over the Keys. An interception from flight leader to planes directing them to proceed for 45 minutes, I believe it was, on course 030 degrees, then steer due west would give them a 1800R DR of about 29-00 north and 79-00 west.

18. Q. What radar facilities were available to the Air Sea Rescue organization for obtaining fixes on aircraft?
A. The only radar that is fully active that we can call on that I am aware of is Boca Chica. There are other temporary radar units in the area that change regularly and I am unable to keep up on such Army units and training Navy units throughout the area.

19. Q. Do you know what radar stations were used to attempt to locate the TBM's in difficulty on 5 December 1945?
A. I know that Boca Chica was requested, and reported negative results of air radar search. I have only hearsay information regarding use of other stations.

20. Q. Were any orders given by Joint Operations Center to transmit the evaluated fix to the TBM aircraft?
A. The position was given to the home base to give to the aircraft which was Boat Facility, Fort Lauderdale. Other attempts by other units were made to contact the aircraft with the direct intention of giving their position to the aircraft if contact could be made.

21. Q. Did NSO (Radio Miami) attempt to transmit the fix to the aircraft in distress?
A. NSO attempted to contact the planes with the intention of transmitting the fix, if the planes had been contacted.

22. Q. Can you state at what time NSO set up on 4805 kilocycles?
A. I understand that it was 1954 or thereabouts.

23. Q. What means were available to Air Sea Rescue Headquarters to transmit to aircraft in distress on 5 December 1945?
A. Boat Facility, Fort Lauderdale radio, NSO, Coast Guard communication system including our air station, Jupiter, Jacksonville radio, Key West, and surface craft.

Examined by the board:

24. Q. Which of these stations were available and suitable for transmitting the evaluated fix to the TBM's on 5 December 1945?

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A. In my opinion, none of those stations were satisfactory at that time of day on 4805 kilocycles.

Examined by the recorder:

25. Q. Were any of these radio stations used to contact the TBM's in difficulty?
A. Yes, Fort Lauderdale Boat Facility and NSO were used.

26. Q. According to your log, at 1718 the evaluator advised that the flight of five TBM's from U.S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, was lost and unable to determine their position and that the flight leader's compass failed at 1552R when the flight was over Hens and Chickens Shoals. Can you advise the origin of this information?
A. I believe that this information actually came from Fort Lauderdale and/or Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4, on the phone calls in and out of the evaluation office, where the Controller and the Evaluator were both on the line at frequent intervals. It was probably a summation of data gathered while in the evaluation office.

27. Q. The Eastern Sea Frontier communication log entry at 1807R shows an intercepted message from Taylor suggesting that the planes in distress fly east until they ran out of gas. Did you know of this intercepted message when you took over the duties of Controller?
A. No, that information came to me a short time later.

Examined by the board:

28. Q. According to information available to you, what actual emergency control of the TBM aircraft in distress on the afternoon of 5 December 1945 was exercised from Joint Operations Center in Miami?
A. No actual control of these aircraft was undertaken insofar as I know, except that information was given to Boat Facility, Fort Lauderdale, to give them if contacted.

Examined by the recorder:

29. Q. According to information available to you, did any activity of the Air Sea Rescue organization transmit instructions to the planes in distress to fly west?
A. Not that I'm aware of.

30. Q. Did Air Sea Rescue issue any special instructions to the Air Sea Rescue Group Headquarters at Banana River concerning establishing communication with the TBM's?
A. No special instructions were given to my knowledge, but it was ascertained directly from Boat Facility, Fort Lauderdale, that they had called and given instructions to Banana River.

31. Q. Can you state to whom was assigned the responsibility of determining the daily search areas for the various ships and aircraft utilized during 6-10 December 1945?
A. No one was assigned that responsibility, but I assumed it, and such areas were checked by Commodore Benson.

32. Q. What considerations were used in assigning search areas to aircraft and surface vessels on 6 December 1945?

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A. First consideration, the maximum distance offshore the airplanes could have been when they had reached the estimated fuel range; secondly, the area in which flares were seen by at least two different merchant ships; thirdly, wind and current sets. In summation, I used the 1750 approximate fix with the addition of using the outer perimeter of search to include the area the planes could have continued in, if going east until gas gave out; based on information I have of TBM's as to fuel range, their probable speed, and wind conditions.

33. Q. On what consideration were the successive days searches established?

A. The conditions of wind effect, using HO 235 current Pilot Charts of the North Atlantic, availability of aircraft, previously searched areas, were basis of handling the search on successive days. One important point that had to be considered throughout these days, was the recurrence of sightings of odds and ends which may have been at the time of sighting of value to the search and considered at the time urgent reasons for modifying a search then out, and another important point was the fact that special dumbos, as B-29's, special dumbo B-17's, specially equipped PBM's and PBY's attached to Air Sea Rescue proper be properly interspersed in other groups of planes to take care of any possibility of other losses. It can be seen from the exhibited charts that as a search moves farther east that inshore areas were only moderately covered the latter days, but inboard areas not definitely designated were flown over by planes departing and returning from offshore areas.

34. Q. How were the Controllers, Joint Operations Center Headquarters kept advised of the thoroughness of the daily searches assigned to various search activities?

A. The Controllers were kept briefed throughout the search on the results and weather in the areas searched by the various units. Explanations were given the Controllers as to why certain areas were covered and recovered to keep them advised of the reasons for search. The searching units kept Joint Operations Center advised of the search at the end of each day and I interrogated most of the units myself as to the conduct of their individual searches.

35. Q. I show you a copy of the Coast Guard Operations Log which has been introduced in evidence marked "Exhibit 10". Do you recognize same?

A. I recognize it as an incomplete record of events. If I may, I will add a few entries that should show on this record. For instance, a notation was made that at 1643 the evaluator took over the call from NAS, Fort Lauderdale, concerning their announcement to the Controller that a flight of planes was overdue. The evaluator accepted the call and put the information given on the HF/DF net teletype to get bearings and consequently a position, if possible, on the missing aircraft. Entries should also show the HF/DF net's actions and results prior to the 1718 entry.

36. Q. What does the marginal date and time groups indicate?

A. "Roger" times, local date, and they indicate the time that data was received in the Control Center.

Examined by the board:

37. Q. Is this Air Sea Rescue log that has been offered in evidence a complete record of Air Sea Rescue activities during the emergency in question from 1718R, 5 December 1945 on?

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A. No sir. It was a physical impossibility to log all the phone call data and it is quite possible some messages may not have been entered.

38. Q. Can you state when Air Sea Rescue at Banana River was fully advised of the details of the emergencies?

A. I cannot, but shortly after 1900 via the telephone I ascertained that they had been given necessary details by Lauderdale or Boat Facility. I brought them up-to-date at the time of my phone call and they advised me of the time of take off and the status of the ready planes.

39. Q. Discuss briefly the searches conducted, results of each search, the evaluation of pertinent sightings reported during the period of the search.

A. All searches proved negative as to the finding of anything considered pertinent to the five TBM's. Under searches we included the sightings and searches by surface vessels which includes the sighting of the explosion and the oil slick. That search is the only search in my opinion that uncovered anything in the loss of the six aircraft. Flares were seen twice on the first night, white in color. The Operations Officer at Banana River stated to me that his planes dropped flares in those areas at those times. Further searches indicated data as to the life raft sighted with two occupants, sighted by a merchant vessel and a plane searching with the vessel, but it turned out there were no occupants, no life raft. Other sightings consisted of a flashing light one night by a passing airplane who did not investigate but continued on and it was found upon investigation that this was a flashing light buoy at the given position on that night. An Eastern Airlines pilot saw what he considered to be a red rocket in the vicinity of Melbourne one night, and a careful search was made of that area with the Eastern Airlines pilot accompanying part of the mission and a helicopter was used carrying the Eastern Airlines pilot and was set down in various positions but no trace was found of anyone in distress. Flares were seen late one night in the vicinity of Fort Myers, green by one bus driver, white by a hunter. They were investigated promptly the next morning from daylight on, results negative. Balsa rafts were sighted by pilots and at least one picked up by a vessel. The pilot stated it was a dark orange one, but at the time the vessel picked it up at that position, the only one picked up by a vessel apparently, was dark gray in color. This pilot was the same pilot who later sighted what he thought were three rafts, plane type, one with two occupants, but it turned out to be packing boxes or crates. One white object seen in the water considered to be possibly a parachute canopy, upon further identification proved to be nothing from a parachute, just debris. The sighting of life jackets in the water and a possible float from a plane or cylindrical object seemed to be a large can, and a shipborne kapok jacket. Nothing on any search proved any debris from aircraft other than the oil slick, which in my mind was the FBM crash point. The searches were conducted along the lines of fully covering the areas and expanding the areas with concentrated searches of the component parts and researching of areas. Searches included the west coast of Florida and a few miles to sea in that area on the off chance, something may have been found in that area. The searches included the State of Florida, extending up into Georgia, covered south through the Keys and the Atlantic Ocean area to the latitude and longitude points given on the submitted and accepted charts. It is noticed that during the course of the searches standby planes were sent out and vessels moved as necessary when anything in the way of a sighting was made. It is to be noted that the surface crafts were put at strategic points in order that each area would have a surface craft available in case of plane sightings and that each surface vessel was making an ex-

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panded square search around his reference point. Dumbos were placed to be of aid to any of the searching aircraft because in a search of that kind, as was quite evident in this one, engine failures occur, planes reached their gas limit before reaching their home base, etc.

40. Q. On what considerations was the decision to discontinue the search for the six missing aircraft made on 10 December 1945?

A. Consultation with Commander Loveland, the weather officer of this locality, indicated that the reports from the planes were correct and that the weather was becoming very bad in off shore areas, that no sightings of any object of value had been made, that practically all the large planes were late over check time, and replacements were not readily available, and that the search had adequately covered the area in so far as possible. The final decision to discontinue the search was made by Com7 in concurrence with ComGulf.

Examined by the board:

41. Q. What activities other than those regularly assigned to the Gulf Sea Frontier for Air Sea Rescue purposes were called upon to participate in the search for the missing aircraft?

A. The Third Air Force was called upon to participate. Army Air Force Units at Boca Raton, Orlando, and Air Transport Command, and the RAF, Nassau, volunteered.

42. Q. Did these activities called upon to participate provide the required search craft that you desired?

A. No. The Third Air Force stated that they could not provide aircraft for off shore search, but they did provide aircraft for land search in Florida.

43. Q. Do you know what type aircraft the Third Air Force has available in Florida?

A. Yes. The Third Air Force has a number of B-29's and several other long range airplanes.

44. Q. Did the failure of the Third Air Force to provide aircraft for extended over water search reduce the thoroughness of the searches conducted during the period 6-10 December 1945?

A. Yes, because long range planes were vitally needed well offshore.

45. Q. From a review of the circumstances and actions surrounding the attempts to recover five TBM's on 5 December 1945 what recommendations can you make to better handle a situation of this nature?

A. I would recommend a staff to suitably investigate and perform liaison with all communication set ups in this area and the dissemination of all data found to every flying organization in this area, to include such people as CAA, the Army, the Navy, and civilian organizations. I would recommend that the present radio equipment in training units be improved so that proper communications may be maintained with their aircraft under all conditions.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investiga-

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tion which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

The board then, at 2:30 p.m., adjourned, until 1:00 p.m., Thursday.

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FOURTEENTH DAY

U. S. Naval Air Station
Miami, Florida
Thursday, January 3, 1945

The board met at 1:00 p.m.

Present:
Captain Albert K. Morehouse, U.S. Navy, senior member;
Commander Joseph T. Yavorsky, U.S. Navy, member;
Commander Howard S. Roberts, U.S. Navy, member;
Lieutenant Commander Richard S. Roberts, U.S. Navy, recorder;
Elvera M. Erquist, yeoman third class, U.S. Naval Reserve, reporter.

The record of proceedings of the thirteenth day of the investigation was read and approved.

No witnesses not otherwise connected with the investigation were present.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. William James Slattery, Captain, U.S. Navy, Commanding Officer, U.S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida.

2. Q. Did you exercise operational control of the Air Sea Rescue task group based at Naval Air Station, Banana River?
A. Yes.

3. Q. Are the facilities available to the Air Sea Rescue task group at Naval Air Station, Banana River, adequate for its assigned duties?
A. Yes.

4. Q. Are sufficient personnel assigned to the Air Sea Rescue task group at Naval Air Station, Banana River, to perform its assigned functions?
A. I consider the six officers assigned to Air Sea Rescue duties at Banana River to be adequate.

5. Q. When were you informed that an emergency existed on the evening of 5 December 1945?
A. Upon my return to the station at 2105 at which time I immediately proceeded to the Air Sea Rescue office where I remained until the following morning.

6. Q. What control does Air Sea Rescue Task Group Headquarters, Banana River, exercise over Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 at Port Everglades?
A. I cannot answer this briefly without discussing the structure of the Command relationships of the Air Sea Rescue Organization of the Seventh Naval District.

7. Q. Explain such command relationship as it affects your command.
A. Prior to mid-November, 1945, Banana River conducted air sea rescue in accordance with Naval Air Operational Training Command Administrative Order No. 5-45, dated 21 November 1945. In mid-November, 1945, Headquarters, District Coast Guard Officer, Seventh Naval District Rescue Plan DCGO-7,

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No. 1-45, was received. This order will hereinafter be referred to as Rescue Plan No. 1-45. Upon receipt of Rescue Plan No. 1-45, Commander W. J. Lawrence, U.S. Coast Guard, the Air Sea Rescue Officer at Banana River, was sent by me to Headquarters, Seventh Naval District, to request clarification of this order, particularly as to whether it abrogated Administrative Order No. 5-45, dated 21 February 1945. Commander Lawrence reported to me upon his return that he had gone into this matter thoroughly and in detail with Commander Harding, U.S. Coast Guard, of the Staff of ComSeven, who informed Commander Lawrence that Headquarters, Seventh Naval District, would hereinafter coordinate all air sea rescue operations within the Seventh Naval District, that Banana River was, of course, to continue operations as a task unit, but not as a task group as it had previously functioned under Administrative Order No. 5-45. Its operations would, as a task unit, embrace the mission set forth in Rescue Plan No. 1-45. We do not control the Port Everglades Air Sea Rescue Facility, and, further, there are no rescue aircraft based at Port Everglades.

8. Q. Are you the legal custodian of a copy of Seventh Naval District Rescue Plan DCGO-7, No. 1-45? If so, produce it.
A. I am. Here it is.

The Rescue Plan No. 1-45 was submitted to the board by the recorder as evidence. There being no objection, it was so received and appended marked "Exhibit 22".

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rate, and present station.
A. Thomas W. Tramburg, seaman first class, (Sp(Y), U.S. Naval Reserve, U.S. Naval Air Station, Banana River.

2. Q. What are your specific duties?
A. I'm a control tower operator at NAS, Banana River.

3. Q. When did radio, Naval Air Station, Banana River, set a receiver watch on 4805 kilocycles on the evening of 5 December 1945?
A. Radio, Banana River, I do not know about. The tower set up a guard at 1830. We have two auxiliary receivers in the tower just for that purpose and we set up a guard on 4805 kilocycles on the evening of 5 December 1945.

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4. Q. Did you receive any transmissions on 4805 kilocycles on 5 December 1945?
A. No sir, we did not.

5. Q. In previous testimony, Lieutenant (junior grade) Parmenter, Air Sea Rescue Duty Officer, stated he called Banana River tower and told them to contact the five TBM's on 4805 kilocycles. What action was taken on this?
A. Mr. Parmenter didn't tell us to contact the missing TBM's, to my knowledge. I was there. He told us what information he had on the missing TBM's, their last known position, and asked if we could set up a listening guard on the frequency of 4805 kilocycles, and that is all we did.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Julian C. Parker, Lieutenant, U. S. Navy, Communication Officer, U.S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida.

2. Q. What is the estimated time required to shift a transmitter to 4805 kilocycles from another aircraft operating frequency in an emergency?
A. Approximately twenty minutes; however we can shift to any of ten previously pre-set frequencies in a matter of seconds. 4805 kilocycles was not one of these pre-set frequencies.

3. Q. Did Naval Air Station, Banana River, ever set a transmitter on 4805 kilocycles on the evening of 5 December 1945?
A. No sir.

4. Q. Was the HF/DF net teletype working on the evening of 5 December 1945?
A. Yes sir.

5. Q. Was this teletype manned?
A. It was not independently manned, but personnel were in the vicinity of it.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further

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statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

Lieutenant (junior grade) Duane E. Walker, U.S. Naval Reserve, Operations Watch Officer, U.S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida, a witness for the board, was recalled and warned that the oath previously taken by him was still binding.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. Previous testimony states that the Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 informed Naval Air Station, Banana River, by phone to contact all stations in the area to work FT-28 on 4805 kilocycles and to advise him to maintain a course of 270 degrees. Did you receive this message?
A. No sir.

2. Q. Referring to the Communication Log of Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 for 5 December 1945, which has been introduced in evidence to the board, at 1824 Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 relayed teletype message from Miami to Banana River concerning the fix of 29 degrees north, 79 degrees west, and also advised Banana River to please have all stations in this area attempt to contact FT-28 on 4805 kilocycles and advise him to maintain a course of 270 degrees. Did you receive this message?
A. No sir, I did not.

3. Q. Do you know of any message of a similar nature that was received about that time?
A. Yes sir, I do.

4. Q. What was the substance of the message that you did receive?
A. The message I received was at 1810R from the Boat Facility Officer at Port Everglades, and he advised me at that time that there were five TBF's on a navigation flight out of Fort Lauderdale who, at 1621R, had reported their position as in doubt, and they were relaying the message from Miami due to teletype trouble and they asked that we alert the stations in our area and dispatch the Daytona Beach dumbo and the Vero Beach dumbo and put a guard on 4805 kilocycles which the planes in the flight were on.

5. Q. Were you cognizant of all telephone calls received by Air Sea Rescue, Banana River, concerning the emergency on 5 December 1945?
A. Yes, I was cognizant of these calls. The long distance telephone calls that came in with reference to the missing aircraft were at 1810 from Port Everglades and approximately 2030 from Miami, and that is all.

6. Q. You have previously testified that the Boat Facility at Port Everglades advised you by telephone that a high frequency direction finder fix had established an approximate position on the TBM's of 29 degrees north, 79 degrees west. When did you first receive information regarding the HF/DF fix on the missing planes?
A. I received that information at the time I phoned by long distance the Boat Facility Officer at Port Everglades at about 1836.

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7. Q. Did you receive any other information from Port Everglades concerning the emergency at that time?
A. No sir, I did not.

8. Q. Was the HF/DF teletype utilized on the evening of 5 December 1945?
A. I do not know.

Examined by the board:

9. Q. Is the Operations Duty Officer charged with assisting the Air Sea Rescue Duty Officer during an emergency at Naval Air Station, Banana River?
A. The Operations Duty Officer assists the Air Sea Rescue Duty Officer in any way he requests or needs. We work together in assisting each other in aircraft overdue, and when things are too busy for Air Sea Rescue and they need an extra man he can call upon the Operations Duty Officer to assist him.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

Commander William J. Lawrence, U.S. Coast Guard, Air Sea Rescue Operations Officer, U.S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida, a witness for the board, was recalled and warned that the oath previously taken by him was still binding.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. Was the HF/DF net teletype working on the evening of 5 December 1945?
A. Yes it was.

Examined by the board:

2. Q. Was the information coming in on this HF/DF net teletype evaluated and used between 1600 and 2000 on 5 December 1945?
A. No sir.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness stated that he had nothing further to say.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

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A witness called by the recorder entered, was duly sworn, and was informed of the subject matter of the investigation.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.
A. Howard H. J. Benson, Commodore, U. S. Navy, Chief of Staff and Aide, Commandant, Gulf Sea Frontier and Commandant, Seventh Naval District.

2. Q. Explain to the board how the Joint Operations Center, Miami, is organized to insure coordination and positive control of Air Sea Rescue activities under its cognizance.
A. The Air Sea Rescue activities , the responsibility for them, is vested in Commandant, Gulf Sea Frontier, who delegated the Air Sea Rescue activities to the Commandant, Seventh Naval District, who is directed to delegate them to District Coast Guard Office and the operation of the Air Sea Rescue activities is to be carried on by the District Coast Guard Officer. The organization of the District is set up in Air Sea Rescue under the Commandant. There is a task unit under the Chief, Naval Air Operational Training Command, Task Unit 03-7-61, with a control station at Banana River under him, with Mayport, New Smyrna, Fort Pierce, Port Everglades, and dumbos at Daytona Beach and Vero Beach. There is the Coast Guard Air Station in Miami, Task Unit 03.7.62, control station at Dinner Key, and other stations at Boca Chica, dumbos at Boca Chica and Dinner Key, and two crash boats at each station. Similarly, at St. Petersburg for the western part of Florida, they have a dumbo, two ready planes, a helicopter, and two crash boats. Communications from the headquarters to each of those task unit commanders is through the Air Sea Rescue teletype and through the HF/DF net teletype, and they also have commercial phone communication which can be used as an emergency measure. The organization is set up in the Headquarters under the Commandant, Gulf Sea Frontier, and Commandant of the District, and the District Coast Guard Officer. On watch all the time is an Operations Duty Officer. He is an officer of Lieutenant Commander or Commander rank. They have two controllers, the Navy Controller, and the Coast Guard controller. In the Evaluation Center, which is in a room right adjacent to the Coast Guard Operations people, are two officers, maybe a Lieutenant (junior grade) and a Warrant, and maybe two commissioned officers, but always two officers who operate the Evaluation Center. The teletypes are installed in the Office of the Evaluation Center or one of the adjacent offices. The Controllers have telephones at their desks and the Coast Guard Assistant Operations Officer is in an office right next to the Controllers.

3. Q. Who was controlling Operations in the Joint Operations Center, Miami, on 5 December 1945 when the evaluated fix on the five TBM's was received?
A. I was present at the time, but Lieutenant Commander Murphy was controlling.

4. Q. What disposition was made of the 1750R evaluated fix?
A. At 1812 it was given to the tower at Fort Lauderdale, at 1821 it was sent to Banana River, at 1834 it was put on all nets.

5. Q. Were any orders issued by the Joint Operations Center, Miami, to transmit the evaluated fix to the aircraft in difficulty?
A. I do not remember any orders being issued to transmit it. The standard procedure was that the ground station in contact with the planes should

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transmit position, and the fix was given to the Fort Lauderdale station. Efforts were made to call the plane from Radio Station, Miami, but no acknowledgement was received and the fix was not broadcast from Radio, Miami. I had in mind trying to keep from interfering with the stations who had been in touch with the planes in their efforts to regain communication.

6. Q. On what considerations was the decision to discontinue the search for the six missing aircraft made on 10 December 1945?

A. The considerations were: the large area already covered, the thoroughness of the search, the approach of bad weather forecast for the next day, hard usage of planes as evidenced by break-downs, and the very bad sea conditions at the presumed area of ditching after dark. Failure to find any trace of planes during the five days' search led to the belief that they had broken up and all hands lost during the landing during high sea conditions that prevailed on 5 December 1945. The search was repeatedly moved to the eastward and planes going and returning thereto searched areas near the coast so that it seemed improbable that the survivors were in the coastal areas. For the survivors to still have been up, they would have had to be afloat for five days. Admiral Shafroth conferred by phone with Captain Burch and Admiral Davidson, and both concurred in their belief that it was advisable to discontinue the search.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The board informed the witness that he was privileged to make any further statement covering anything relating to the subject matter of the investigation which he thought should be a matter of record in connection therewith, which had not been fully brought out by the previous questioning.

The witness made the following statement:

We are making efforts to get a teletype installed at Boca Chica and Key West. We are going to have Air Sea Rescue Controllers aviators. That probably had no bearing on this particular incident. There are three Air Sea Rescue Controllers who will be down here after January 15th who are all aviators. We are going to have better recording arrangements in connection with the telephones so that we can keep a log of conversations as they come in without depending on written notes. Messages came in so fast, people couldn't write them down. It would appear from that that better indoctrination of students for procedure when lost would be of value. With an earlier broadcast of distress information, it would have been a better thing to do, now looking back at it.

None of the parties to the investigation desired further to examine this witness.

The witness was duly warned and withdrew.

The recorder was called as a witness by the recorder, and was duly sworn.

Examined by the recorder:

1. Q. State your name, rank, and present station.

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A. Richard S. Roberts, Lieutenant Commander, U. S. Navy, attached to the U. S. Naval Air Station, Miami, Florida, and recorder of this board.

2. Q. Did you communicate with Houma, Louisiana, HF/DF station, and Pensacola, Florida, HF/DF station and request these stations to forward their communication logs via mail for the evening of 5 December 1945?

A. Yes. In accordance with the suggestion of the board, I did so and here they are. They were received by registered mail. I offer these logs to the board for the purpose of being appended to the record, these communications having a bearing on the subject of this investigation.

There being no objection, the Houma, Louisiana, HF/DF Communication Log, and the Pensacola, Florida, HF/DF Communication Log were examined by the board and so received, appended marked "Exhibits 23 and 24".

Neither the board nor the recorder desired to call any more witnesses.

The investigation was finished, all parties thereto withdrawing.

After full and mature deliberation, the board finds as follows:

FINDING OF FACTS

1. That TBM-3, BuNo. 23307, Squadron No. FT-28, Engine No. 124575; TBM-1E, BuNo. 46094, Squadron No. FT-36, Engine No. 66287; TBM-1C, BuNo. 73209, Squadron No. FT-117, Engine No. 34191; TBM-1C, BuNo. 46325, Squadron No. FT-81, Engine No. 63027; and TBM-1C, BuNo. 45714, Squadron No. FT-3, Engine No. 34619, departed at approximately 1410R, 5 December 1945, as Flight 19 on an authorized overwater navigation training flight from U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida.

2. That the authorized overwater navigation training flight assigned to Flight 19 on 5 December 1945 was Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, navigation problem No. 1 which is as follows: (1) depart 26 degrees 03 minutes north and 80 degrees 07 minutes west and fly 091 degrees (T) distance 56 miles to Hen and Chickens Sheals to conduct low level bombing, after bombing continue on course 091 degrees (T) for 67 miles, (2) fly course 346 degrees (T) distance 73 miles and (3) fly course 241 degrees (T) distance 120 miles, then returning to U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida.

3. That Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685, was the authorized pilot who signed for and accepted for flight TBM-3, BuNo. 23307, for Flight 19 on the afternoon of 5 December 1945.

4. That Edward Joseph Powers, Jr., Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 09789, was the authorized pilot who signed for and accepted for flight TBM-1E, BuNo. 46094, for Flight 19 on the afternoon of 5 December 1945.

5. That George William Stivers, Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 010959, was the authorized pilot who signed for and accepted for flight TBM-1E, BuNo. 73209, for Flight 19 on the afternoon of 5 December 1945.

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6. That Forrest James Gerber, Second Lieutenant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, File No. 047223, was the authorized pilot who signed for and accepted for flight TBM-1C, BuNo. 46325, for Flight 19 on the afternoon of 5 December 1945.

7. That Joseph Tipton Bossi, Ensign (A1)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 470677, was the authorized pilot who signed for and accepted for flight TBM-1C, BuNo. 45714, for Flight 19 on the afternoon of 5 December 1945.

8. That Walter Reed Parpart, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 19 16, and Robert Francis Harmon, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 711 02 11, were the authorized aircrew passengers on TBM-3, BuNo. 23307 (pilot Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685) on 5 December 1945.

9. That Howell Orrin Thompson, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 499181, and George Richard Paonessa, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 805639, were the authorized aircrew passengers on TBM-1E, BuNo. 46094 (pilot Edward Joseph Powers, Jr., Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 09789) on 5 December 1945.

10. That Robert Peter Gruebel, private, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 563782, and Robert Francis Gallivan, sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 359343, were the authorized aircrew passengers on TBM-1C, BuNo. 73209 (pilot George William Stivers, Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 010959) on 5 December 1945.

11. That William Earl Lightfoot, private first class, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 519803, was the authorized aircrew passenger on TBM-1C, BuNo. 46325 (pilot Forrest James Gerber, Second Lieutenant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, File No. 047223) on 5 December 1945.

12. That Herman Arthur Thelander, seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 758 44 37, and Burt Edward Baluk, Jr., seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 91 50, were the authorized aircrew passengers on TBM-1C, BuNo. 45714 (pilot Joseph Tipton Bossi, Ensign (A1)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 470677) on 5 December 1945.

13. That TBM-3, BuNo. 23307, Squadron No. FT-28; TBM-1E, BuNo. 46094, Squadron No. FT-36; TBM-1C, BuNo. 73209, Squadron No. FT-117; TBM-1C, BuNo. 46325, Squadron No. FT-81; and TBM-1C, BuNo. 45714, Squadron No. FT-3, and the personnel assigned to these aircraft for Flight 19 that departed from U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, at 1410R, 5 December 1945, are unaccounted for since about 1900R, 5 December 1945.

14. That Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685; Edward Joseph Powers, Jr., Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 09789; George William Stivers, Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 010959; Forrest James Gerber, Second Lieutenant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, File No. 047223; and Joseph Tipton Bossi, Ensign (A1)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 470677, were qualified naval aviators on 5 December 1945.

15. That Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685; Edward Joseph Powers, Jr., Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File

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No. 09789; George William Stivers, Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 010959; Forrest James Gerber, Second Lieutenant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, File No. 047223; Joseph Tipton Bossi, Ensign (A1)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 470677; Walter Reed Parpart, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 19 16; Robert Francis Harmon, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 711 02 11; Howell Orrin Thompson, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 499181; George Richard Paonessa, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 805639; Robert Peter Gruebel, private, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 563782; Robert Francis Gallivan, sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 359343; William Earl Lightfoot, private first class, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 519803; Herman Arthur Thelander, seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 758 44 37; and Burt Edward Baluk, Jr., seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 91 50, were attached to and serving on active duty in flight status at the U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, on 5 December 1945.

16. That Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685, was the authorized and assigned instructor in charge of Flight 19 which departed from the U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, at 1410 on 5 December 1945.

17. That Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685, was a naval aviator whose flight log indicates a total of 2509.3 hours flying time, and his officer's qualification jacket indicates that he served approximately one year with VS-62 as a scout pilot based at Key West, Florida, and had completed a recent combat tour as a carrier-based torpedo plane pilot attached to the USS HANCOCK.

18. That Edward Joseph Powers, Jr., Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 09789; George William Stivers, Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 010959; Forrest James Gerber, Second Lieutenant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, File No. 047223; and Joseph Tipton Bossi, Ensign (A1)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 470677, were naval aviators undergoing instruction in VTB Type Advanced Training at U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, on 5 December 1945.

19. That Walter Reed Parpart, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 1916; Howell Orrin Thompson, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 499181; George Richard Paonessa, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 805639; Robert Peter Gruebel, private, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 563782; Robert Francis Gallivan, sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 359343; William Earl Lightfoot, private first class, U. S. Marine Corps reserve, Service No. 519803; Herman Arthur Thelander, seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 758 44 37; Burt Edward Baluk, Jr., seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 91 50, were undergoing Advanced Combat Aircrew Training in VTB type aircraft on 5 December 1945.

20. That Robert Francis Harmon, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 711 02 11, was in a flight duty status, assigned to the Gunnery Department at the U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, on 5 December 1945.

21. That Edward Joseph Powers, Jr., Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 09789; George William Stivers, Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 010959;

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Forrest James Gerber, Second Lieutenant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, File No. 047233; and Joseph Tipton Bossi, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 470677, completed, prior to 5 December 1945, the required ground training syllabus for VTB Type Advanced Training.

22. That Walter Reed Parpart, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 19 16; Howell Orrin Thompson, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 499181; George Richard Paonessa, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 805639; Robert Peter Gruebel, private, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 563782; Robert Francis Gallivan, sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 359343; William Earl Lightfoot, private first class, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 519803; Herman Arthur Thelander, seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 758 44 37; and Burt Edward Baluk, Jr., seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 91 50, completed the ground training syllabus for aircrewmen in VTB Type Aircraft Advanced Training prior to 5 December 1945.

23. That Lieutenant Robert F. Cox, U. S. Navy, at approximately 1600R, on 5 December 1945, while piloting FT-74 in the vicinity of the U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, established communication with FT-28 leading Flight 19 and he, while flying toward the reported position of FT-28, which was the Florida Keys, experienced a fading radio signal from FT-28.

24. That U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, learned at 1611R, 5 December 1945, that FT-28 was uncertain as to his position.

25. That Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 at Fort Everglades, Florida, was aware of the difficulty of FT-28 at approximately 1620R, on 5 December 1945.

26. That the Joint Operations Center of the Gulf Sea Frontier Air Sea Rescue organization was aware of the difficulty of FT-28 at approximately 1630R on 5 December 1945.

27. That at 1647R, 5 December 1945, the Gulf Sea Frontier and Eastern Sea Frontier HF/DF nets were alerted to obtain all possible bearings on transmissions from FT-28, who was transmitting on 4805 kilocycles.

28. That at approximately 1800R, 5 December 1945, an approximate HF/DF fix was obtained on FT-28 placing FT-28 within a one hundred mile radius of 29 degrees, 15 minutes, north, 79 degrees, 00 minutes, west at 1750R.

29. That the 1750 HF/DF evaluated position was telephoned to the tower at U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, at about 1810R, 5 December 1945.

30. That the 1750R HF/DF evaluated position was transmitted on the Gulf Sea Frontier and Eastern Sea Frontier HF/DF teletype nets and Air Sea Rescue teletype net of the Gulf Sea Frontier at approximately 1836R, 5 December 1945.

31. That at 1820R an Air Sea Rescue dumbo was airborne from Coast Guard Air Station, Dinner Key, Florida, to attempt to regain communications with the planes of Flight 19 on 4805 kilocycles.

32. That the Air Sea Rescue dumbo from Dinner Key Coast Guard Air Station was unsuccessful in its endeavors to contact Flight 19.

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33. That the YG homing device at U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, was functioning properly at approximately 1625R on 5 December 1945.

34. That extensive search operations by surface craft and aircraft from 6 December to 10 December, inclusive, conducted over land and sea areas adjacent to the Florida peninsula failed to discover any wreckage or locate any survivors of the five TBM's comprising Flight 19 on 5 December 1945.

35. That PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, Squadron Training No. 49, Engines No. P-54213 and 52187, departed at approximately 1927R, 5 December 1945, on an authorized Air Sea Rescue search mission from U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida.

36. That an "out" report sent by radio was received by the U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida, from PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, Squadron Training No. 49, at about 1930R, 5 December 1945, and no further communications were received from said airplane after that time.

37. That the authorized Air Sea Rescue mission assigned to PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, on 5 December 1945, was as follows: Depart U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, and proceed to 29 degrees north and the east coast of Florida, thence fly east to 29 degrees north, 79 degrees west, there to conduct an expanding square search.

38. That Walter G. Jeffrey, Lieutenant (junior grade), U. S. Navy, File No. 329291, was the authorized patrol plane commander who signed for and accepted for flight PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, on 5 December 1945.

39. That Harry G. Cone, Lieutenant (junior grade) (Al), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 378634; Roger M. Allen, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 466015; and Lloyd A. Eliason, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 465964, were the authorized and assigned co-pilots of PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, Squadron No. 49, for the search mission launched from U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida, at 1927R on 5 December 1945.

40. That Charles D. Arceneaux, Ensign (Al)T, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 409770, was the authorized and assigned radar officer of PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, for the search mission launched from U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida, at 1927R on 5 December 1945.

41. That Alfred J. Zywicki, seaman first class (aviation ordnanceman), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 727 69 79; James F. Osterheld, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 378 95 75; John T. Menendez, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 268 84 98; Philip B. Neeman, seaman first class (aviation radioman), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 247 11 21; James F. Jordon, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 887 76 08; Robert C. Cameron, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 574 04 17; Wiley D. Cargill, seaman first class (aviation machinist's mate), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 975 90 12; and Donald E. Peterson, aviation machinist's mate first class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 382 88 99, were the authorized and assigned crew members of PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, Squadron No. 49, for the search mission launched from U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, at 1927R, on 5 December 1945.

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42. That Walter G. Jeffrey, Lieutenant (junior grade), U. S. Navy, File No. 329291; Harry G. Cone, Lieutenant (junior grade)(Al), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 378634; Roger M. Allen, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 466015; and Lloyd A. Eliason, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 465964, were qualified naval aviators on 5 December 1945.

43. That Walter G. Jeffrey, Lieutenant (junior grade), U. S. Navy, File No. 329291; Harry G. Cone, Lieutenant (junior grade)(Al), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 378634; Roger M. Allen, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 466015; Lloyd A. Eliason, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 465964; Charles D. Arceneaux, Ensign (Al)T, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 409770; Alfred J. Zywicki, seaman first class (aviation ordnanceman), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 727, 69 79; James F. Osterheld, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 378 95 75; John T. Menendez, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 268 84 98; Philip B. Neeman, seaman first class (aviation radioman), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 247 11 21; Robert C. Cameron, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 574 04 17; James F. Jordon, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 887 76 08; Wiley D. Cargill, seaman first class (aviation machinist's mate), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 975 90 12; Donald E. Peterson, aviation machinist's mate first class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 382 88 99, were attached to and serving on active duty in a flight status at the U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida, on 5 December 1945.

44. That Walter G. Jeffrey, Lieutenant (junior grade), U. S. Navy, File No. 329291, was an ATU, U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida, instructor and patrol plane commander whose flight log indicates a total of 1917.8 hours flying time.

45. That Harry G. Cone, Lieutenant (junior grade)(Al), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 378634; Roger M. Allen, Ensign (Al); U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 466015; and Lloyd A. Eliason, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 465964, were naval aviators undergoing instruction in VPB type Advanced Training at U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida, and were members of Combat Aircrew 880 on 5 December 1945.

46. That Charles D. Arceneaux, Ensign (Al)T, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 409770, was a student radar officer on temporary duty involving flying under instruction at the U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida, on 5 December 1945.

47. That Donald E. Peterson, aviation machinist's mate first class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 382 88 99; Wiley D. Cargill, seaman first class (aviation machinist's mate), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 975 90 12; Robert C. Cameron, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 574 04 17; James F. Jordon, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 887 76 08; Philip B. Neeman, seaman first class (aviation radioman), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 247 11 21; John T. Menendez, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 268 84 98; James F. Osterheld, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 378 95 75; and Alfred J. Zywicki, seaman first class (aviation ordnanceman), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 727 69 79, were undergoing Advanced Combat Aircrew Training in VPB type aircraft and were members of Combat Aircrew 880 at U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida, on 5 December 1945.

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48. That the officers and men comprising Combat Aircrew 88G were undergoing training at the U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida, and had obtained approximately 160.1 hours flight time as an operating crew in PBM type aircraft.

49. That Harry G. Gene, Lieutenant (junior grade) (Al), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 378634; Roger M. Allen, Ensign (Al)I, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 466015; Lloyd A. Eliason, Ensign (Al)I, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 465964, completed, prior to 5 December 1945, the required ground training syllaus for Advanced Training in VPB type aircraft.

50. That Donald E. Peterson, aviation machinist's mate first class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 382 88 99; Wiley D. Cargill, seaman first class, (aviation machinist's mate), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 975 90 12; Robert C. Cameron, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 574 04 17; James F. Jordon, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 887 76 08; Philip B. Meeman, seaman first class (aviation radioman), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 247 11 21; John T. Menendez, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 268 84 98; James F. Osterhold, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 378 95 75; and Alfred J. Zywicki, seaman first class (aviation ordnanceman), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 727 69 79, completed, prior to 5 December 1945, the ground training syllabus for aircrewmen in Advanced Training in VPB type aircraft.

51. That Donald E. Peterson, aviation machinist's mate first class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 382 88 99, was the authorized and assigned plane captain of Combat Aircrew 88G, who was checked and certified as qualified to solo as plane captain in PBM type aircraft on 22 October 1945.

52. That PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, Squadron No. 49, and the assigned personnel aboard are unaccounted for since about 1930R, 5 December 1945.

53. That the hourly position report due at 2030R from PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, was not received at U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida, on 5 December 1945.

54. That at 2115R on 5 December 1945 the SS GAINES MILLS reported as follows: "At 0050 G.M.T. observed burst of flames, apparently explosion, leaping flames 100 feet high burning ten minutes. Position 28 degrees, 59 minutes north, 80 degrees, 25 minutes west. At present, passing through big pool oil at 0119 G.M.T. Stopped, circled area using search lights, looking for survivors. None found."

55. That USS SOLOMONS CVE67 dispatch 06127 reported as follows: "Our air search radar showed plane after takeoff from Banana River last night joining with another plane, then separation and proceeding on course 045 degrees at exact time SS GAINES MILLS sighted flames and in exact spot the above plane disappeared from the radar screen and never reappeared".

56. That concentrated search operations from 6 December to 10 December 1945, inclusive, by surface and aircraft in the area of the reported explosion failed to reveal any debris of the missing PBM or evidence of its crew.

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OPINION

The board, from all evidence before it, is of the opinion:

1. That Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U.S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685; Walter Reed Parpart, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 19 16, and Robert Francis Harmon, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 711 02 11, are missing as a result of the disappearance of TBM-3, BuNo. 23307, Squadron No. FT-28, on 5 December 1945.

2. That Robert Francis Harmon, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 711 02 11, who is missing as a result of the disappearance of TBM-3, BuNo. 23307, Squadron No. FT-28, enlisted fraudulently under this assumed name and that his legal name is George Francis Devlin.

3. That George William Stivers, Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 010959; Robert Peter Gruebel, Private, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 563782; and Robert Francis Gallivan, sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 359343, are missing as a result of the disappearance of TBM-1C, BuNo. 73209, Squadron No. FT-117, on 5 December 1945.

4. That Edward Joseph Powers, Jr., Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 09789; Howell Orrin Thompson, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 499181; and George Richard Paonessa, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 805639, are missing as a result of the disappearance of TBM-1E, BuNo. 46094, Squadron No. FT-36, on 5 December 1945.

5. That Forrest James Gerber, Second Lieutenant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, File No. 047223; and William Earl Lightfoot, private first class, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 519803, are missing as a result of the disappearance of TBM-1E, BuNo. 46325, Squadron No. FT-81, on 5 December 1945.

6. That Joseph Tipton Bossi, Ensign (A1)L, U.S. Naval Reserve, File No. 470677; Herman Arthur Thelander, seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 758 44 37; and Burt Edward Baluk, Jr., seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 91 50, are missing as a result of the disappearance of TBM-1C, BuNo. 45714, Squadron No. FT-3, on 5 December 1945.

7. That Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685; Walter Reed Parpart, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 19 16; Robert Francis Harmon, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 711 02 11; Edward Joseph Powers, Jr., Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 09789; Howell Orrin Thompson, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 499181; George Richard Paonessa, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 805639; George William Stivers, Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 010959; Robert Peter Gruebel, private, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 563782; Robert Francis Gallivan, sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 359343; Forrest James Gerber, Second Lieutenant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, File No. 047223; William Earl Lightfoot, private first class, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 519803; Joseph Tipton Bossi, Ensign (A1)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 470677; Herman Arthur Thelander, seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 758 44 37; and Burt Edward Baluk, Jr., seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 91 50, are missing in line of duty and not as a result of their own misconduct.

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8. That Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685, instructor in charge of Flight 19 and pilot of FT-28, had sufficient experience, training, and aviation background to be a qualified VTB senior instructor capable of leading an overwater navigation training flight such as was assigned to Flight 19 on the afternoon of 5 December 1945.

9. That all personnel of Flight 19 had received ample instruction for proper and safe conduct of flight in TBM aircraft engaged in overwater navigational training.

10. That Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685; Edward Joseph Powers, Jr., Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 09789; George William Stivers, Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 010959; Forrest James Gerber, Second Lieutenant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, File No. 047223; and Joseph Tipton Bossi, Ensign (A1)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 470677, were physically qualified and temperamentally adapted for actual control of aircraft on 5 December 1945.

11. That Walter Reed Parpart, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 19 16; Robert Francis Harmon, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 711 02 11; Howell Orrin Thompson, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 499181; George Richard Paonessa, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 805639; Robert Peter Gruebel, private, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 563782; Robert Francis Gallivan, sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 359343; William Earl Lightfoot, private first class, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 519803; Herman Arthur Thelander, seaman first class, U.S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 758 44 37; and Burt Edward Baluk, Jr., seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 91 50, were physically qualified and temperamentally adapted for flight in aircraft on 5 December 1945.

12. That the weather over the area covered by the track of the navigation problem assigned to Flight 19 on 5 December 1945 was average, to below average, for a training flight of this nature.

13. That TBM-3, BuNo. 23307, Squadron No. FT-28; TBM-1E, BuNo. 46094, Squadron No. FT-36; TBM-1C, BuNo. 73209, Squadron No. FT-117; TBM-1C, BuNo. 46325, Squadron No. FT-81; TBM-1C, BuNo. 45714, Squadron No. FT-3, were in satisfactory operating condition and properly equipped for an overwater navigation training flight on 5 December 1945.

14. That an intercepted radio transmission between the pilots of Flight 19 at approximately 1545R, 5 December 1945, was the first indication that the instructor of Flight 19 in FT-28 was uncertain of his position.

15. That intermittent and unsatisfactory radio communications on 4805 kilocycles was carried out between Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4 at Port Everglades, Florida, and FT-28, leader of Flight 19, from 1620R to 1755R, 5 December 1945.

16. That unsatisfactory radio communication on 4805 kilocycles was due to interference from Cuban broadcasting stations, static, the presence of a steady carrier note, and atmospheric conditions during this time.

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17. That the leader of Flight 19 in FT-28 was uncertain as to in what direction lay the peninsula of Florida and this uncertainty influenced his later decisions.

18. That the Air Sea Rescue frequency of 3000 kilocycles was not utilized in accordance with existing instructions by any of the aircraft of Flight 19 on 5 December 1945.

19. That shore-based radars provided no effective assistance in locating any of the aircraft of Flight 19 on 5 December 1945.

20. That difficulty was experienced in obtaining the HF/DF bearings on the aircraft of Flight 19 after the Gulf Sea Frontier/Eastern Sea Frontier nets were alerted because of interference on 4805 kilocycles.

21. That the Air Sea Rescue Gulf Sea Frontier teletype was out of commission south of Banana River during the critical period on the evening of 5 December 1945.

22. That no Air Sea Rescue activities engaged in assisting Flight 19 were in successful communication with that flight after the receipt of the evaluated fix.

23. That no activity associated with assisting Flight 19 made blind transmissions or radio broadcasts of the 1750R evaluated position to any aircraft of that flight.

24. That the YG homing device at the U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, was functioning properly on the evening of 5 December 1945.

25. That the 1750R, 5 December 1945, evaluated position obtained by HF/DF bearings represents the highly probable location of Flight 19 at that time.

26. That the nature of the navigation problem assigned to Flight 19 on 5 December 1945 and the force and direction of the surface wind and winds aloft would preclude the probability of Flight 19 at any time reaching a position south or west of the peninsula of Florida.

27. That Flight 19 departed on the first leg of its assigned navigation training flight on 5 December 1945 led by an unknown student member of that flight.

28. That Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685, the instructor in charge of Flight 19, flew in a tracking position for an undetermined period after the start of the navigation flight to a point somewhere along the second leg.

29. That Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685, instructor in charge of the flight, believed that Flight 19 was not on the prescribed track of the assigned navigational problem at some time prior to 1545R, and, therefore, assumed the lead of the flight with the intention of correcting his position.

30. That Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685, after assuming lead of Flight 19 in FT-28, concluded that

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his compasses were not working and at approximately 1545R was undecided as to his position.

31. That Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685, in FT-28, at approximately 1545R was over broken land which he believed to be in the Florida Keys.

32. That Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685, led Flight 19 on undetermined courses for undetermined lengths of time when, at some time prior to 1645R, he turned to 030 degrees intending to fly for a period of forty-five minutes, thence to fly north in order to assure himself that he was not in the Gulf of Mexico.

33. That prior to 1715R Flight 19 assumed a course of 270 degrees with the intention expressed by Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685, of flying until he reached mainland or exhausted his fuel supply.

34. That at some undetermined time prior to 1850R Edward Joseph Powers, Jr., Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 09789, in TBM-1E, BuNo. 46094, Squadron No. FT-36, assumed the lead of Flight 19 and maintained a course of 270 degrees.

35. That at 1806R Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685, suggested to Edward Joseph Powers, Jr., Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 09789, to change course to the east again, assuming that the flight was still over the Gulf of Mexico.

36. That the courses flown by Flight 19 subsequent to 1807R are undetermined.

37. That the aircraft of Flight 19 made forced landings in darkness at sea east of the peninsula of Florida sometime after 1904R on 5 December 1945.

38. That the state of the sea in the area in which Flight 19 was presumed to have landed was rough and unfavorable for a water landing.

39. That the fuel supply of the aircraft in Flight 19 on 5 December 1945 should have permitted them to remain airborne until approximately 2000R.

40. That the Air Sea Rescue efforts to assist the return of Flight 19 on the evening of 5 December 1945 were ineffective.

41. That the following factors contributed to the ineffectiveness of the over-all Air Sea Rescue effort in the attempt to locate and recover the aircraft of Flight 19 before they were presumed to have been forced down by fuel exhaustion:

(a) Excessive interference on the training frequency, 4805 kilocycles, in use by Flight 19.

(b) Failure of the aircraft concerned to shift to the Air Sea Rescue frequency of 3000 kilocycles which was guarded by all the Air Sea Rescue activities.

(c) The failure of Air Sea Rescue Gulf Sea Frontier teletype during the critical period.

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(d) The inability of the HF/DF nets to obtain early and reliable bearings on 4805 kilocycles due to interference.

(e) Lack of complete coordination, understanding, indoctrination, and training in Air Sea Rescue procedures on the part of principal participating units, both within themselves and in combined effort.

42. That the principal participating units in the Air Sea Rescue efforts on the evening of 5 December 1945 were:

(a) U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida.

(b) U. S. Naval Air Station, Banana River, Florida, and attached Air Sea Rescue activity.

(c) Air Sea Rescue Task Unit No. 4, Port Everglades, Florida.

(d) Joint Operations Center, Gulf Sea Frontier, Miami, Florida.

43. That the coordinated search operations conducted under the direction of Joint Operations Center, Gulf Sea Frontier, Miami, Florida, from 6 December to 10 December 1945, inclusive, utilized sufficiently large numbers of surface vessels and aircraft in those areas in which survivors of Flight 19 were presumed to have been located to satisfactorily cover those areas.

44. That the disappearance of TBM-3, BuNo. 23307, Squadron No. FT-28; TBM-1E, BuNo. 46094, Squadron No. FT-36; TBM-1C, BuNo. 73209, Squadron No. FT-117; TBM-1C, BuNo. 46325, Squadron No. FT-81; and TBM-1C, BuNo. 45714, Squadron No. FT-3, resulting in the missing status of Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685; Walter Reed Parpart, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 19 16; Robert Francis Harmon, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 711 02 11; Edward Joseph Powers, Jr., Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 09789; Howell Orrin Thompson, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 499181; George Richard Paonessa, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 805639; George William Stivers, Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 010959; Robert Peter Gruebel, private, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 563782; Robert Francis Gallivan, sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 359343; Forrest James Gerber, Second Lieutenant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, File No. 047223; William Earl Lightfoot, private first class, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 519803; Joseph Tipton Bossi, Ensign (A1)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 470677; Herman Arthur Thelander, seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 758 44 37; and Burt Edward Baluk, Jr., seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 91 50, was caused by a temporary mental confusion resulting in faulty judgment on the part of the flight leader and instructor of Flight 19, Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685, in permitting himself to lose knowledge of his general position relative to the peninsula of Florida, and failure on his part to utilize the facilities available to him in his flight for orientating himself.

45. That no offenses are known to have been committed, nor serious blame incurred by any known person or persons other than that which may be assigned to Lieutenant Charles Carroll Taylor, (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685, the flight instructor in charge of Flight 19 for his faulty judgment that contributed to the disappearance of TBM-3, BuNo. 23307, Squadron No. FT-28; TBM-1E, BuNo. 46094, Squadron No. FT-36; TBM-1C, BuNo. 73209, Squadron No. FT-117; TBM-1C, BuNo. 46325, Squadron No. FT-81; and TBM-1C, BuNo. 45714, Squadron No. FT-3, resulting in the missing status of Charles Carroll Taylor, Lieutenant (A1), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 114685; Walter Reed Parpart, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 19 16; Robert Francis Harmon, aviation ordnanceman third class, Service No. 711 02 11; Edward Joseph Powers, Jr., Captain

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U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 09789; Howell Orrin Thompson, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 499181; George Richard Paonessa, staff sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 805639; George William Stivers, Captain, U. S. Marine Corps, File No. 010959; Robert Peter Gruebel, private, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 563782; Robert Francis Gallivan, sergeant, U. S. Marine Corps, Service No. 359343; Forrest James Gerber, Second Lieutenant, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, File No. 047223; William Earl Lightfoot, private first class, U. S. Marine Corps Reserve, Service No. 519803; Joseph Tipton Bossi, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 470677; Herman Arthur Thelander, seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 758 44 37; and Burt Edward Baluk, Jr., seaman first class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 714 91 50.

46. That Walter G. Jeffrey, Lieutenant (junior grade), U. S. Navy, File No. 329291; Harry G. Cone, Lieutenant (junior grade)(Al), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 378634; Roger M. Allen, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 466015; Lloyd A. Eliason, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 465964; Charles D. Arceneaux, Ensign (Al)T, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 409770; Alfred J. Zywicki, seaman first class (aviation ordnanceman), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 727 69 79; James F. Osterheld, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 378 95 75; John T. Menendez, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 268 84 98; Philip B. Neeman, seaman first class (aviation radioman), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 247 11 21; James F. Jordon, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 887 76 08; Robert C. Cameron, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 574 04 17; Wiley D. Cargill, seaman first class (aviation machinist's mate), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 975 90 12; and Donald E. Peterson, aviation machinist's mate first class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 382 88 99, are missing as the result of the disappearance of PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, Squadron No. 49.

47. That Walter G. Jeffrey, Lieutenant (junior grade), U. S. Navy, File No. 329291; Harry G. Cone, Lieutenant (junior grade) (Al), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 378634; Roger M. Allen, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 466015; Lloyd A. Eliason, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 465964; Charles D. Arceneaux, Ensign (Al)T, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 409770; Alfred J. Zywicki, seaman first class (aviation ordnanceman), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 727 69 79; James F. Osterheld, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 378 95 75; John T. Menendez, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 268 84 98; Philip B. Neeman, seaman first class (aviation radioman), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 247 11 21; James F. Jordon, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 887 76 08; Robert C. Cameron, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 574 04 17; Wiley D. Cargill, seaman first class (aviation machinist's mate), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 975 90 12; and Donald E. Peterson, aviation machinist's mate first class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 382 88 99, are missing in the line of duty and not as the result of their own misconduct.

48. That the disappearance of PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, Squadron Training No. 49, resulting in the missing status of Walter G. Jeffrey, Lieutenant (junior grade), U. S. Navy, File No. 329291; Harry G. Cone, Lieutenant (junior grade) (Al), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 378634; Roger M. Allen, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 466015; Lloyd A. Eliason, Ensign (Al)L, U. S.

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Naval Reserve, File No. 465964; Charles D. Arceneaux, Ensign (Al)T, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 409770; Alfred J. Zywicki, Seaman first class, (aviation ordnanceman), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 727 69 79; James F. Osterheld, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 378 95 75; John T. Menendez, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 268 84 98; Philip B. Neeman, seaman first class (aviation radioman), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 247 11 21; James F. Jordon, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 887 76 08; Robert C. Cameron, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 574 04 17; Wiley D. Cargill, seaman first class (aviation machinist's mate), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 975 90 12; and Donald E. Petersen, aviation machinist's mate first class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 382 88 99, was not caused in any manner by the intent, fault, negligence, or inefficiency of any known person or persons in the naval service or connected therewith.

49. That PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, Squadron Training No. 49, was in satisfactory operating condition and properly equipped for a search mission at the time it was launched at 1927R on 5 December 1945.

50. That the crew assigned to PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, Squadron Training No. 49, on the evening of 5 December 1945, was competent and fully qualified to perform the duties essential to the mission assigned.

51. That Walter G. Jeffrey, Lieutenant (junior grade), U. S. Navy, File No. 329291, volunteered to act as patrol plane commander of PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, Squadron Training No. 49, for the night search mission on 5 December 1945, and in doing so displayed a keen sense of duty and commendable spirit.

52. That the weather conditions over the area assigned to PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, Squadron Training No. 49, on the night of 5 December 1945 were undesirable, but not unduly hazardous for the mission assigned.

53. That PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, exploded in the sea for reason or reasons unknown in the approximate position of 28 degrees, 59 minutes north, 80 degrees, 25 minutes west.

54. That thorough and extensive searches of the sea areas in and adjacent to 28 degrees, 59 minutes north, 80 degrees, 25 minutes west, were conducted during the period 5-10 December 1945, inclusive, for possible survivors of PBM-5, BuNo. 59225.

55. That no offenses are known to have been committed or serious blame incurred by any known person in connection with the disappearance of PBM-5, BuNo. 59225, resulting in the missing status of Walter G. Jeffrey, Lieutenant (junior grade), U. S. Navy, File No. 329291; Harry G. Cone, Lieutenant (junior grade)(Al), U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 378634; Roger M. Allen, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 466015; Lloyd A. Eliason, Ensign (Al)L, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 465964; Charles D. Arceneaux, Ensign (Al)T, U. S. Naval Reserve, File No. 409770; Alfred J. Zywicki, seaman first class (aviation ordnanceman), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 727 69 79; James F. Osterheld, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 378 95 75; John T. Menendez, aviation ordnanceman third class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 268 84 98; Philip B. Neeman, seaman first class (aviation radioman), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 247 11 21; James F. Jordon, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 887 76 08; Robert C.

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Cameron, aviation radioman third class, U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 574 04 17; Wiley D. Cargill, seaman first class (aviation machinist's mate), U. S. Naval Reserve, Service No. 975 90 12; Donald E. Peterson, aviation machinist's mate first class, U. S. Navy, Service No. 382 88 99.

56. That the various logs and records as submitted in evidence by all the participating activities are incomplete, compiled from direct logged communications, memory, notes, and memoranda, and are difficult to reconcile one with the other and with the testimony in some cases, but do represent the best records available.

ALBERT K. MOREHOUSE,
Captain, U. S. Navy,
Senior Member.

JOSEPH T. YAVORSKY,
Commander, U. S. Navy,
Member.

HOWARD S. ROBERTS,
Commander, U. S. Navy,
Member.

The record of proceedings of the fourteenth day of the investigation was read and approved and the board, having finished the investigation, then at 4:30 p.m., adjourned to await the action of the convening authority.

ALBERT K. MOREHOUSE,
Captain, U. S. Navy,
Senior Member.

RICHARD S. ROBERTS,
Lieutenant Commander, U. S. Navy,
Recorder.

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

COPY

FM CNAADTRA JKVL FLA 061615
TO CAPT ALBERT K MOREHOUSE USN NAS MIAMI
INFO NAS MIAMI
NAS BANANARIVER
NAS FTLAUDERDALE
CNAT PNCLA COM7

BD OF INVESTIGATION CONSISTING YOURSELF AS SENIOR AND OF COMDR JOSEPH T YAVORSKY USN AND COMDR HOWARD S ROBERTS USNR AS ADDITIONAL MEMBERS AND OF LT COMDR RICHARD S ROBERTS USN AS RECORDER CONVENE EARLIEST OPPORTUNITY AT NAS MIAMI FLO TO INQUIRE INTO AND REPORT UPON CIRCUMSTANCES ATTENDING DISAPPEARANCE OF FIVE TBM TYPE AIRCRAFT AND ONE PBM TYPE AIRCRAFT APPROX 1900 5 DEC RESULTING IN MISSING STATUS OF NAVAL PERSONNEL X

BD WILL MAKE THOROUGH INVESTIGATION AND INCLUDE IN FINDINGS FULL STATEMENT FACTS DEEMED ESTABLISHED X

BD DIRECTED TAKE TESTIMONY OF WITNESSES UNDER OATH X CONDUCT PROCEEDINGS ACCORDANCE CHAPTER TEN NAVAL COURTS AND BOARDS X GIVE OPINIONS CALLED FOR BY SEC 723 THEREOF ALSO WHETHER ANY OFFENSES COMMITED OR SERIOUS BLAME INCURRED X ATTENTION INVITED SEC 734 THEREOF X

CO NAS MIAMI FLO DIRECTED FURNISH CLERICAL ASSISTANCE X

SIGNED CONFIRMATION AND ADDITIONAL AIRCRAFT IDENTIFICATION FOLLOWS

1735/06 DEC TM

ORIG: LT.RYAN
REL BY: DAVISON

DEC 6/45 #103

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

NARA 463

Green File Copy

Ft Lauderdale

NAVAL AIR ADVANCED TRAINING COMMAND
NH23-11/07-3/A17(2) HEADQUARTERS
UNITED STATES NAVAL AIR STATION
JACKSONVILLE, FLORIDA

7 DEC 1945

Serial No. 33436

From: Chief of Naval Air Advanced Training.
To : Captain Albert K. Morehouse, U. S. Navy, U. S. Naval Air Station, Miami, Florida.

Subj: Board of investigation to inquire into and report upon the circumstances attending the disappearance of five TBM type aircraft, bureau numbers 23307, 46325, 46330, 45714 and 73309, and one PBM aircraft, bureau number 59225, which occurred at approximately 1900, 5 December 1945, resulting in the missing status of naval personnel.

Ref: (a) CNAAdTra dispatch 061615 dtd 6 Dec. 1945

1. A Board of investigation consisting of yourself as senior member and of Commander Joseph T. Yavorsky, U. S. Navy, and Commander Howard S. Roberts, U. S. Navy ~~Reserve~~, as additional members, and of Lieutenant Commander Richard S. Roberts, U. S. Navy, as recorder, will convene at the earliest opportunity at the U.S. Naval Air Station, Miami, Florida, for the purpose of inquiring into and reporting upon the circumstances attending the disappearance of five TBM type aircraft, bureau numbers 23307, 46325, 46330, 45714 and 73309, and one PBM aircraft, bureau number 59225, which occurred at approximately 1900, 5 December 1945, resulting in the missing status of naval personnel.

2. The board will make a thorough investigation into the matter hereby submitted to it, and will include in its findings a full statement of the facts it may deem to be established. The board will further give its opinion as to whether any offenses have been committed or serious blame incurred.

3. The board is hereby empowered and directed to administer an oath to each witness attending to testify or depose during the course of the proceedings of the board of investigation. Hearings may be held at such places as the board may deem appropriate.

4. The proceedings of the board will be conducted in accordance with the provisions of chapter X, Naval Courts and Boards, and the board will give the opinions called for by section 725.

5. The attention of the board is particularly invited to section 734, Naval Courts and Boards.

6. The Commanding Officer, U. S. Naval Air Station, Miami, Florida, is hereby directed to furnish the necessary clerical assistance. In addition to the record of proceedings and copies required by Naval Courts and Boards, you are directed to make four copies for the convening authority.

RALPH DAVISON,
Rear Admiral, U. S. Navy,
Chief of Naval Air Advanced Training.

CC: CO, NAS, Banana River, Fla; CO, NAS, Ft. Lauderdale, Fla; CO, NAS, Miami, Fla; CNATra; COM7

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Authority NND 868189

By 07-3

A17(2) Ft. Lauderdale 5 TBM crash 5 Dec 45

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Authority NND 868189

NATIONAL ARCHIVES AND RECORDS ADMINISTRATION
MICROFILM PUBLICATIONS

Target 2

Folder A17 (1)
Administrative Reports–Fort Lauderdale – 1944–45
Entry 16 (Box 89)

Information concerning the disappearance of naval aircraft on December 5, 1945, during routine navigation flight.

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

Route Slip No. 54949
Date EO 31 Dec 45

Headquarters
Naval Air Operational Training Command

Our File A17(1)
Cross File
No. Copies 1
Enclosures
Taken Up By

Subject: Disappearance of naval aircraft on 5 Dec during routine over water navigation flight; information concerning.

From: CNO
Date: 28 Dec 45

File Reference: Op-514-H/rrp Ser 591P514
Finished File: 5 JAN 1946

Corres. Symbol	Title	Routing Order	Routing Act. Symb.	Initials Noted	Date In	Date Out
OT-1	ADMIRAL	4	3	Seen		
OT-2	CHIEF OF STAFF	3	3	Seen		
OT-3	Legal	2	7	CPO	1/3	
OT-4	Domestic Transportation					
OT-5	Public Relations					
OTA-1	ADMINISTRATION					
OTA-2	Operations; IATCB					
OTA-21	Oper. Fac.-Plng.					
OTA-23	Aerology					
OTA-25	Boat Facilities					
OTA-3	Welfare, Physical Trng.					
OTA-32	Ship's Service; BOQ					
OTA-34	War Bonds					
OTA-35	Insurance					
OTA-36	Civil Readjustment					
OTA-4	Personnel					
OTA-41	Personnel (Officer)					
OTA-42	Personnel (Enlisted)					
OTA-43	Education—Enlisted Trng.					
OTA-44	Classification Control					
OTA-45	Civil Pers. Relations					
OTA-46	Hdqtrs. Flag Unit					
OTA-5	Public Works; OinCC					
OTA-6	Security; Intel.					
OTA-61	Safety; Fire Fighting					
OTA-7	Communications (Adm.)					
OTA-73	Postal					
OTA-74	Registered Publications					
OTA-75	Publications					
OTA-8	Medical (Adm.)					
OTA-9	Supply					
OTA-17	Director of WAVES					
OTA-18	Central Office					

Corres. Symbol	Title	Routing Order	Routing Act. Symb.	Initials Noted	Date In	Date Out
OTT-1	TRAINING	1	2	9	1/2	
OTT-2	Planning					
OTT-21	Pilot Allocation					
OTT-22	Marine Liaison					
OTT-3	Pilot Trng. (Flight)					
OTT-31	VF Combat Trng.					
OTT-32	VT-VB Combat Trng.					
OTT-33	Multi-Engine Cmbt Trng.					
OTT-34	Instrument Trng.					
OTT-35	LSO; Carrier Qual.					
OTT-36	Instructor Trng.					
OTT-37	Accident Prevention					
OTT-4	Aircrewman Trng.					
OTT-46	OinCC, AGTSU					
OTT-5	Pilot Trng. (Ground)					
OTT-51	Multi-Engine Type					
OTT-52	CV Type					
OTT-53	Survival Trng. & Eqpt.					
OTT-54	Navigation Trng.					
OTT-55	Synthetic Devices					
OTT-56	ACI					
OTT-57	Recognition Trg.; Film Util.					
OTT-58	Trng. Film Distr.					
OTT-6	Aircraft Materiel					
OTT-61	Maintenance & Eng.					
OTT-62	Procurmnt & Allocation					
OTT-63	AGR Work Distb.					
OTT-64	Ordnance Material					
OTT-7	Electronics; VF(N) Trng.					
OTT-71	Communication Trng.					
OTT-72	Radar Trng.					
OTT-73	Fighter Dir. & VF(N) Trg.					
OTT-74	Electronic Materiel					

J.NAS 69691 J-4826 6-45 75M

Definition of Symbols

1. Take necessary action.
2. Comment.
3. For information.
4. FILE—no action required.
5. Retain enclosure(s). Return Routing Slip to Central Files.

TO ACTION OFFICER
REPLY TO BE MAILED BY 1/7/46

REMARKS:

5 JAN 1946
204

Forwarded to C.O. FF Lauderdale and Bar. Pier for reply via CNAADTRA. Action on Bd of Invest. Report.

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

FOLLOW-UP MEMORANDUM

URGENT

_____
(date)

To: _____ (action officer)

1. Records indicate that reply to the correspondence covered by this route slip has not been made.

2. Comment is requested in the space below as to:

   (1) Reason for delay in completing action.

   (2) Date on which action is expected to be completed.

_____
(Folllow-up Clerk)

_____
(date)

From: Action Officer

To: Department Head

1.

2. Action is expected to be completed by _____.

_____
(Action Officer)

_____
(date)

To: Follow-Up Clerk, Central Office

1. Action date extended to _____.

_____
Department Head

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

In reply refer to Initials and No.

Op-514-H/rrp
Serial 591P514

NAVY DEPARTMENT
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF OF NAVAL OPERATIONS
WASHINGTON 25, D. C.

A17(1)

54949

28 DEC 1945

From: Chief of Naval Operations
To: Chief of Naval Air Advanced Training, Jacksonville, Florida.

Subject: Disappearance of naval aircraft on 5 Dec. during routine over water navigation flight; information concerning.

Ref: (a) NAS Ft. Lauderdale dispatch 062125 of Dec.
(b) NAS Banana River dispatch 062015.

1. In order that appropriate reply may be made to Congressional inquiries, it is requested that complete information concerning these accidents, including information as to the nature and extent of search operations conducted, be forwarded to the Chief of Naval Operations (attn. Op-514-H). In addition, it is requested if practicable that a copy of the Boards of Investigation or Administrative Reports be forwarded this office when the original is forwarded to the JAG.

R. E. JENNINGS
Acting Deputy Chief of Naval Operations (Air)

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Authority NND 868189

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Authority NND 868189

N829-11/AT-3/A17(1)

5 JAN 1946

Serial No. 204

To: Commanding Officer, NAS, Ft. Lauderdale, Fla.
Commanding Officer, NAS, Banana River, Fla.

Subj: Disappearance of naval aircraft on 5 Dec. during routine over water navigation flight - Information concerning.

Ref: (a) CNO ltr Op-514-H/rrp serial 591P514 dtd 28 December 1945.

1. Enclosure 1 is forwarded for information and compliance.

2. By copy of this letter, the Chief of Naval Operations (Op-514-H) is informed that a board of investigation concerning subject matter was convened by CNAAdTra on 7 December 1945 and that a copy of the proceedings of subject investigation will be forwarded upon completion of same.

RALPH DAVISON
Rear Admiral, USN
CNAAdTra

CC: CNO (Op-514-H)

Encl. (HW)
1 - Copy of reference (a)

DATE

ADMIRAL
CHIEF OF STAFF
Legal
Dom. Transp.
Pub Rel.

ADMINISTRATION
Oper. Fac. Plng. IATCB
Aerology
Boat Facilities
Wel.; Phys. Trng.
Ships Serv.; BOQ
War Bonds
Insurance
Personnel
Pers. (Off.)
Pers. (Enl.)
Ed.-Enl. Trng.
Class. Control
Civil Pers. Rel.
PW & OinCC
Security; Intel. Safety; Fire Fightg.
Comm. (Adm.)
Postal
Medical (Adm.)
Supply
Dir. of WAVES
Public Affairs Office

TRAINING
Planning
Officer Detail
Pilot Allocations
Marine Liaison
Pilot Trng.(Flight)
VF Combat Trng.
VT-VB C'mbat Trng.
Multi-Engine
Combat Trng.
Instrument Trng.
LSO; Carrier Qual.
Accident Prevention
Aircr.; Grdcr. Trng.; ABTU
Pilot Trng. (Grnd.)
CV Type
ME Type
Survival Trng.
Navig. Trng.
Synthetic Devices
ACI
Recognition Trng.
Aircraft Mat'l
Ordnance Mat'l
Electronics; F. D. & VF(N) Trng.

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

A 17(1) ADMIN REPORTS FT. LAUDERDALE 1944-45

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

NATIONAL ARCHIVES AND RECORDS ADMINISTRATION
MICROFILM PUBLICATIONS

Target 3

Folder A17 (1)
1946
Entry 16 (Box 92)

Report of informal board to study reference.

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

NARA 473

A9-11/LJK/AT-1
A17-25

Serial No: 14134

19 JUL 1946

Subj: Report of Informal Board to Study Reference (a).

3. The comments of the Board are attached herewith as Enclosure (1).

RALPH DAVISON
Rear Admiral, USN
CNAAdTra

Enclosure:

1 - (HW) Informal Report on Reference (a).

ORGINAL HANDLED BY AT-1

ADMIRAL
CHIEF OF STAFF
Legal
Dom. Transp.
Pub Rel.
ADMINISTRATION
Oper. Fac. Plng. IATCB
Aerology
Boat Facilities
Wel.; Phys. Trng.
Ships Serv.; BOQ
War Bonds
Insurance
Personnel
Pers. (Off.)
Pers. (Enl.)
Ed.-Enl. Trng.
Class. Control
Civil Pers. Rel.
PW & OinCC
Security; Intel. Safety; Fire Fightg.
Comm. (Adm.)
Postal
Medical (Adm.)
Supply
Dir. of WAVES
Central Office
TRAINING
Planning
Officer Detail
Pilot Allocations
Marine Liaison
Pilot Trng.(Flight)
VF Combat Trng.
VT-VB C'mbat Trng.
Multi-Engine
Combat Trng.
Instrument Trng.
LSO; Carrier Qual.
Accident Prevention
Aircr.; Grdcr. Trng.; ABTU
Pilot Trng. (Grnd.)
CV Type
ME Type
Survival Trng.
Navig. Trng.
Synthetic Devices
ACI
Recognition Trng.
Aircraft Mat'l
Ordnance Mat'l
Electronics; F. D. & VF(N) Trng.

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Authority NND 868189

NM29-11/LJK
A17-25

19 JUL 1946

14134

From: Chief of Naval Air Advanced Training.
To: Chief of Naval Air Training.

Subj: Report of Informal Board to Study Reference (a).

Ref: (a) Ltr from RADM JENNINGS to RADM WAGNER, dated 7/11/46, with ltr from Mrs. K. C. TAYLOR attached.
(b) CNAT ltr Serial 3659, dated 15 July 1946.

1. In accordance with reference (b), an informal board consisting of the below named officers met on 16, 17, and 18 July for the purpose of discussing, reviewing, and commenting on the contents of reference (a).

COMDR. L. J. KIRN, USN - STAFF, CNAT
LT. C. A. WHARTON, USN - STAFF, CNAT
COMDR. D. F. SMITH, USN - STAFF, CNAADTRA
LT. COMDR. R. S. OSTERHOUDT, USN- STAFF, CNAADTRA
MAJOR A. W. BLACKMUN, USMC - STAFF, CNAADTRA

2. The Board visited the Naval Air Stations at Banana River, Fort Lauderdale, and Miami and held informal discussions with the following:

NAS BANANA RIVER

CAPTAIN W. J. SLATTERY, USN
LT. COMDR. W. J. LAWRENCE, USCG
LT (JG) H. A. WILLIAMS, USN(T)

NAS FORT LAUDERDALE

CAPTAIN W. O. BURCH, USN
LT. COMDR. DONALD POOLE, USNR
LT. CLARK MILLER, USNR

NAS MIAMI

CAPTAIN A. MOREHOUSE, USN
COMDR. R. SWANSON, USN
COMDR. J. YAVORSKY, USN

	DATE
ADMIRAL	
CHIEF OF STAFF	
Legal	
Dom. Transp.	
Pub Rel.	
ADMINISTRATION	
Oper. Fac. Plng. IATCB	
Aerology	
Boat Facilities	
Wel.; Phys. Trng.	
Ships Serv.; BOQ	
War Bonds	
Insurance	
Personnel	
Pers. (Off.)	
Pers. (Enl.)	
Ed.-Enl. Trng.	
Class. Control	
Civil Pers. Rel.	
PW & OinCC	
Security; Intel. Safety; Fire Fightg.	
Comm. (Adm.)	
Postal	
Medical (Adm.)	
Supply	
Dir. of WAVES	
Central Office	
TRAINING	
Planning	
Officer Detail	
Pilot Allocations	
Marine Liaison	
Pilot Trng.(Flight)	
VF Combat Trng.	
VT-VB C'mbat Trng.	
Multi-Engine	
Combat Trng.	
Instrument Trng.	
LSO; Carrier Qual.	
Accident Prevention	
Aircr.; Grdcr. Trng.; ABTU	
Pilot Trng. (Grnd.)	
CV Type	
ME Type	
Survival Trng.	
Navig. Trng.	
Synthetic Devices	
ACI	
Recognition Trng.	
Aircraft Mat'l	
Ordnance Mat'l	
Electronics; F. D. & VF(N) Trng.	

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Comments in Connection with Remarks contained in letter by Mrs. Tayler to Rear Admiral Jennings, dated 22 June 1945.

Each statement of the letter is quoted and then discussed.

1. "The only mention of blame made in this Record is that which is that which is placed on my son."

Mrs. Tayler is totally unaware of the nature of the findings and opinions of a Board of Investigation. It is convened to study the cause of an occurence, to determine what could be done in the future to prevent a like occurence, and whether there has been any culpable negligence or inefficiency on the part of persons involved. It is noted that the Board in the instant case considered the primary cause of the disappearance to be the confusion of Lt. Tayler as to his position and his failure to consider the prevailing strong winds of that date. Mrs. Tayler does not realize that an assessment of pilot error in the loss of an aircraft does not carry with it the stigma of culpable negligence or incompetence. Nowhere in the Record of the Board has Lt. Tayler been accused of anything other than exercising poor judgment, which, in itself is not derogatory to the memory of the late Lt. Tayler. However, the record clearly shows that the primary reason for the loss of the flight was the judgment exercised by him. He, as instructor, was responsible for the flight. His experience and past duty indicated that he was capable of exercising this responsibility, yet he allowed himself to be led to believe he was in a position in which he could not possibly have been. This is made more difficult to understand in view of the fact that Lt. Tayler had served in the Key West area with VS-62 for about a year. Through this confusion, broadcast to Lt. Cox, the planes were assumed to be over the Keys until 1510 at which time a fix was obtained indicating he had been mistaken.

Despite the fact that responsibility for the loss was placed on Lt. Tayler, he was judged to have lost his life in line of duty and not as a result of misconduct and no culpable blame was ever laid against him by the Navy. There has been no attempt to assess "blame" for the disappearance, merely the "causes" which resulted in the disappearance.

2. Accusations against Lt. Comdr. Poole.

(a) "He was in charge of coordinating all search and rescue activities at the station."

This is true insofar as it applies to the activities of the NAS Fort Lauderdale. Lt. Comdr. Poole adequately fulfilled his duties in this respect. He received and evaluated material coming in, made

ENCL. 1

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attempts to get word to the planes, and, did, in fact, coordinate the search activities by laying out sectors and arranging search planes and crews subject to call by Joint Operations Center, Miami, which had assumed charge of all ASR operations. His duties were at a station level and he had no responsibility under the Air Sea Rescue Organization except insofar as it applied to his station. These duties he appears to have performed competently and with good judgment.

(b) "The difficulty arose at 1545 and he knew nothing about it until 1630."

This accusation is completely frivolous. It is true that Lt. Comdr. Poole did not know of the emergency until 1630, but, up to that time there was no emergency. Lt. Cox has testified that at 1600 he received word from Lt. Taylor that he was over the Keys, that he knew where he was, and that Lt. Cox should not come after him. In the face of such transmission, all hands were justified in not notifying the Flight Officer. The planes were not overdue and from all indications, until 1630 and, in fact, even until later, no emergency existed.

(c) "He refused to let the ready plane go to the rescue of the flight."

This refusal was justified. The records shows that, at the time Lt. Comdr. Poole is accused of not sending the ready plane, the position of the flight was completely unknown, and was, as a matter of fact, supposedly over the Keys, in which case the ready plane would not be necessary. When a fix was obtained showing the best position obtainable, a dumbo plane, fully equipped and capable was dispatched immediately to try to contact the flight on 4503 Kcs. Lt. Comdr. Poole has testified that he did not send the ready plane because of the uncertainty of the position of the flight, the fear of jamming the only communication they had with the flight, and the fact that the weather was getting worse. In this he appears to be completely sincere and justified. Further investigation indicates that the ready plane referred to was a single engine land plane which further justifies his refusal to send it out over open water in bad weather without certain knowledge that such action would save the flight.

(d) "He denied knowing, until the next day that Lt. Cox had been in radio contact with my son between 1600 and 1620, when Lt. Cox heard my son say he was lost."

(e) "Lt. Cox talked with him in the tower immediately upon coming in from his flight at 1645."

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Accusations 4 and 5 are answered together. Lt. Cox's testimony, question 6, page 23 clearly supports Lt. Comdr. Poole's denial of knowing that Lt. Cox had been in communication with the planes. He states that he told the Operations Duty Officer all he knew of the facts, but testifies as regards Lt. Comdr. Poole, that he went up to the tower and asked Poole about the ready plane, giving no indication that he told him any of the other facts of the case. This is borne out by Poole on further informal questioning and he remembers talking to Cox about the ready plane but did so while talking to other officers and trying to locate the missing planes. He states that all Cox talked to him about, so far as he remembers, was the ready plane.

(f) "Lt. Cox requested that he be let take the ready plane out, and he waited until 1800 before going home."

This is completely irrelevant and immaterial. Lt. Comdr. Poole testified on page 39 of the Record that he had a pilot in the ready plane warming it up. Therefore, whatever Lt. Cox wanted to do has no bearing on the case. The plane was manned adequately and Lt. Cox's offer of service, while commendable, was unnecessary.

(g) "Donald Poole told Lt. Cox definitely that the ready plane would not go out."

Lt. Cox testified that Lt. Comdr. Poole "definitely said no" to his own request to take out the ready plane and that he didn't think it would do any good to send it out then. This cannot be construed as meaning that the ready plane would definitely not go out at all.

(h) "Donald Poole denied knowing that Task Unit No. 4, Fort Everglades, had advised him at 1639 to send out the Ready Plane to establish communication with the flight, as it was becoming increasingly difficult to pick up FT-25."

Nowhere in the Record is it apparent that Donald Poole was personally advised by ASR TU4 to take such action. Lt. Comdr. Kenyon, the Operations Officer, testified that he discussed the situation with ASR TU#4 and they had agreed that such dispatching of the ready plane might help, and this is borne out by the ASR TU#4 communications log. All this information was passed to the Operations Officer and not to Lt. Comdr. Poole, who admits Lt. Comdr. Kenyon did make such a suggestion to him but did not to his knowledge notify him that it was an idea of ASR TU#4, and that he still considered it unwise to dispatch the ready plane.

Mrs. Taylor further states that no one was reprimanded for failing to deliver this message to Poole. Poole admits getting the message as a suggestion and giving it consideration. Also, it is apparent that ASR TU#4 and NAS Fort Lauderdale were in constant communication with one

ENCL. 1

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Authority NND 868189

another.

(i) "Donald Poole knew that Lt. Taylor could not possibly be in the Keys, according to his own testimony, yet he would not send out the Ready Plane."

Mrs. Taylor is confusing certain knowledge with reasonable assumption in the instant accusation. Even though Poole knew almost certainly that the flight could not be over the Keys, he still had no knowledge of the actual position thereof. Coupled with the remarks under accusation 3, is the testimony of Poole that at 1700 he was about to let the ready plane go when it was learned that a fix might soon be obtained. Also, at 1645 Poole requested ASR TU94 to relay to FT-28 to fly 270° which appears to have been the best action the flight could have taken.

(j) "He would not send out the ready plane until he had more definite information."

By this statement, Mrs. Taylor shows her complete lack of understanding and logic. What could be more reasonable and justified than holding the ready plane until more definite information was received? Why risk a single engine land plane with its crew by sending it on a blind mission in bad weather?

(k) "Donald Poole would not send out the ready plane because Lt. Hines rushed in at 1700 to advise that Commander Baxter would have a fix."

This is not the only reason Poole did not dispatch the ready plane, but is an excellent argument for holding the plane until such a fix was obtained. Further, the single engine land plane designated a ready plane would not have been sent to the area of the fix obtained at 1810; Dumbo's from other stations were the only suitable type.

"Hines, according to his own testimony, did not advise the Evacuation Center at Miami until between 1700 and 1720."

While Hines himself may not have called JOC, Miami until 1700, Lt. Comdr. Murphy testified on page 47 that the HF/DF net was alerted at 1643 in response to a call from Fort Lauderdale.

(l) "Donald Poole did not send out the ready plane because the weather had fouled up at West Palm Beach and he was afraid it might pass on to Fort Lauderdale."

(m) "He did not send out the ready plane because he felt sure that Boca Raton could pick up their emergency IFF."

ENCL. 1

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

These two accusations support the good judgment of Lt. Comdr. Poole and further justify not sending a single-engine land plane on such a search.

(a) "At 1704 Donald Poole advised Task Unit No. 4 that the Ready Plane would not go out. The flight was due back at 1723."

Again, here is evidence that Poole was justified in not sending the ready plane since the flight was not yet overdue.

It is the opinion of the officers seeking new evidence that the above accusations are unfounded in fact and are repetitious to the point of being almost incoherent. In view of the type of ready plane available, the uncertainty of the position of the last flight, the fact that a fix was expected, and in view of the fact that the weather was worsening, it is considered that Lt. Comdr. Poole showed good judgment and sound common sense in refusing to send out the ready plane. His action is further justified in that he felt that another plane in the air would unnecessarily complicate the communication circuit in its attempt to maintain contact with the last planes. The evidence clearly shows that a dumbo was dispatched from Dinner Key as soon as the position of the flight was known with any degree of certainty. The dumbo was airborne at 1620 and instructed to proceed to Fort Lauderdale then on course 045° for 150 miles in an effort to contact the flight.

The record does not show any denials or falsification on the part of Lt. Comdr. Poole. In a number of places Mrs. Taylor has charged him with having been told certain items when the evidence clearly shows that such items were given to the Operations Officer of the Operations Duty Officer. It is considered that he at all times has acted in accordance with his ideas of responsibility as a Naval Officer and that he has, in fact upheld the Navy's tradition of truthfulness and uprightness, and that his testimony, to the best of his knowledge and belief, given under oath, was true and correct. He has admitted the fact that he was responsible for the ready plane and has given strong and reasonable facts to support his action in not dispatching it. In addition, his appraisal of the situation appeared correct when he requested the flight to fly on 270°. This course it is felt would have brought the flight over land.

3. Accusations against Lt. Comdr. Murphy.

(a) "He did not consider the situation an actual distress until 1900."

Lt. Comdr. Murphy's testimony on pages 47 and 48 bear out the above statement, but, unfortunately Mrs. Taylor has failed to include more pertinent data which clarifies it. He testifies that at 1640 Miami ASR received a message from Fort Lauderdale and alerted the Eastern Sea Net and the Gulf Net. At that time it was considered a routine, common occurence since the planes were in no immediate danger. However, the nets were alerted and search and rescue activities alerted. It was not com-

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sidered a true distress until 1900 when it was assumed the planes would not be able to stay airborne much longer and no recent communication had been established with them. The fact that it was not considered a distress did not operate to lessen their attempts to locate the missing planes.

(b) "At 1730 he was told by Fort Lauderdale that the flight was working off Bimini."

This particular accusation is nothing more than a statement of fact and the investigating officers fail to see wherein it was considered pertinent by Mrs. Taylor. Even if such information were relayed to Murphy, it would be an assumption on the part of Fort Lauderdale informant and, until the fix was obtained at 1810 and the Dumbo dispatched from Dinner Key such information could not be of material help to Lt. Comdr. Murphy. Nor can it be seen wherein Mrs. Taylor considers this a point against Lt. Comdr. Murphy.

(c) "He did not advise Commander Baxter, who did not arrive until 1900, then time had to be wasted giving him details so he could take over."

Lt. Comdr. Murphy was the officer under Comdr. Baxter and was qualified to act in the emergency. Commodore Benson was on the bridge throughout the emergency and nowhere in the testimony does it appear that Comdr. Baxter's absence affected the quality of operations. As to the charge that time was lost by passing the word to Comdr. Baxter, it is pointed out that Baxter, in his testimony states that he brought himself up to date on the emergency before taking over on the bridge, and no operations were interrupted to give him information. There were qualified officers on duty at all times, and Comdr. Baxter had no more expert knowledge than did these officers.

(d) "William Murphy gave no directions to transmit the fix obtained at 1800 to the missing planes."

The evidence shows that Lt. Comdr. Murphy passed on the information about the fix to Fort Everglades ASR TU#4 which was the only station which had been in contact with the flight. However, prior to this time communication had been lost as proved by the numerous transmissions and test calls from ASR TU#4 which were never "Rogered" for, although they could still intercept transmissions from FT-28. Nor is it considered that a fix would have been any more beneficial than the blind transmissions which had already been made telling FT-28 to fly 270° into the sun. The latter information is, under the circumstances less confusing, less time consuming and more useful to the pilot of a lost small plane than is a fix which must be plotted in and assessed.

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4. Accusations against Comdr. Claude Newman.

(a) "His station was the only one in two way contact with the planes. He failed to transmit to the missing planes the fix obtained at 1810."

The record refutes this statement. The evidence shows that two way contact with the flight was lost some time prior to 1807 at which time a final attempt to contact the flight was made with no success. Prior to this time they had intercepted message at 1715 which advised ASR TU#4 that the flight was flying 270° and would do so until they hit the beach. Therefore, ASR TU#4 and Fort Lauderdale were sure that their directions were being carried out. At 1804, ASR TU#4 heard FT-28 tell the planes he was holding 270° but thought they might as well fly East again. Immediately ASR TU#4 tried to contact them, apparently to tell them to hold 270° as directed by Fort Lauderdale but there was no answer. From 1720 on, ASR TU#4 had been out of two way communication with the flight.

(b) "He failed to give Banana River any of the details in connection with the missing planes until 1810."

Prior to 1810, there was no reason for assuming the planes were anywhere in the area of Banana River. Therefore, until definite knowledge of the reported position was had, there was no more reason for alerting Banana River than there was for alerting Jacksonville or stations further up the coast. Until the fix established the position, the planes were, according to Lt. Tayler over the Keys on Gulf and, even according to the reasoning of Lt. Comdr. Poole, should not have been as far north as Banana River.

(c) "He did not advise Banana River to contact all stations in the area and tell them to contact my son and advise him to maintain a course of 270 degrees."

This is disproved by the record. The communications log of ASR TU#4, which was introduced and accepted, shows that at 1824 a teletype message was received by ASR TU#4 and relayed by phone to Banana River, at which time Banana River was advised to have all stations in the area contact the flight on 4605 kcs. Question 18, page 82 indicates that action was taken to have Banana River tower to try to contact the missing planes on 4805 kcs. If Walker did not receive the message, it was taken by someone else who acted on it. Banana River's transmitters were not calibrated for 4805 kcs since this training frequency was assigned to Fort Lauderdale. A shift under these conditions would have been of doubtful value.

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(d) "When they did receive these details at 1510, they were completely unorganized, and they consumed nearly one hour in making ready to send out their planes."

This accusation illustrates the incoherence with which Mrs. Taylor approaches the problem. In no way can Commander Newman be charged with responsibility for the operation of NAS Banana River and the organization or disorganization of the station has no connection with him whatsoever. He was in charge of ASR TU#4 at Port Everglades and had absolutely no responsibility for the operation of NAS Banana River. Furthermore, it is considered that Banana River acted with unusual dispatch in sending out search PBM, since no Dumbo's were located at that station.

5. Accusations against Captain William Slattery.

(a) "He did not have a sufficient number of officers assigned to Air Sea Rescue work at Banana River."

Captain Slattery has testified in answer to question 4, page 126 of the record that he had six officers assigned to ASR work aboard Banana River. This is considered sufficient for the type of work done.

(b) "The teletype was not independently manned."

This is true, but it is pointed out that a teletype need not be independently manned. The machine is completely automatic in its receipt of messages and, in its operation attracts the attention of anyone in the room with it. As a matter of fact, except in large communications offices, a teletype is rarely independently manned. Information was evaluated and acted upon as received without delay.

(c) "Captain Burch, of Fort Lauderdale, had not been advised by Captain Slattery that Task Unit No. 4, Port Everglades, was no longer under the group commander at Banana River."

This accusation has no bearing whatsoever on the matter. There is no evidence to show that anything different would have been done if such notification had been given. It is submitted that the lack of notification, if, in fact, there was a lack, is immaterial and irrelevant, and does not reflect upon the ability of either Captain Slattery or Captain Burch.

(d) "The information coming in on the teletype under his Command was not evaluated and used between 1600 and 2000."

The evidence clearly indicated that during this period the ASR teletype at Banana River was inoperative to the south. Therefore, it is

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assumed that Mrs. Tayler had reference to the main teletype in the communications office which served the entire East Coast. The messages received on this net were examined some time after 2000 and it was determined that although the actual teletype messages had not been received on the ASR installation, all the information in the messages had been received by telephone or radio and had been completely evaluated and acted upon.

(e) "Lt. Parmenter was the only man on watch detail at the Air Sea Rescue Headquarters, Banana River, during the emergency. There was no other officer on whom he could call for assistance at that time."

Lt. (jg) Parmenter was the Assistant Operations Officer for ASR at Banana River and was on watch at the time of the disappearance. A check of the record fails to show any material thing left undone by Lt. (jg) Parmenter by reason of lack of assistance. He was operating in conjunction with the NAS Operations Department and there is nothing to indicate that he would have acted differently if he had had more assistance. The record shows that he alerted nearby stations and dispatched dumbos as necessary and did an excellent job prior to the time Commander Lawrence arrived.

(f) "The Air Sea Rescue circuit on 3000 was not working during the emergency."

This is true but is considered immaterial in the light of the rest of the record. The Communications Officer at Banana River advised that the reason for the failure of the 3000 kcs transmitter was operator trouble and that, in switching frequencies, plugs were crossed. The main transmitter was operative but the tower facilities were crossed up by the operator for a short time, estimated to be less than an hour. However, in light of the fact that there is no evidence that the missing flight ever shifted to 3000 kcs. the operation of the communication circuit at Banana River was not a contributing factor to the loss of the planes.

(g) "They made no effort to transmit the fix to the planes in distress."

The fix was not transmitted because NAS Banana River was unable to shift frequency to 4805 kcs in time to aid the flight. It is affirmatively shown in the record and confirmed by the investigating officers that NAS Banana River was never in contact with the planes on any frequency, and therefore could not reasonably have transmitted the fix.

(h) "When they received the details of the difficulty at 1510, they were completely unorganized and they consumed nearly one hour making ready to send out their planes.

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There is no foundation for such an accusation. NAS Banana River is a training station and not a rescue station. Prior to 1810 there was no indication that they would be called upon to participate in the immediate search. Therefore, when such action became apparent, it was necessary to divert scheduled training planes for the flights and to secure qualified Patrol Plane Commanders to take over the student crews. Considering the above, and the complexity of launching PBM type aircraft, it is considered that NAS Banana River is to be commended for having planes in the air fifty-five minutes after the emergency was announced. There is no evidence to support a charge of disorganization or confusion and such accusation is obviously made by some one who is totally unfamiliar with the operation of a training activity and large seaplanes.

The above specific charges and answers are further amplified by answering general charges made in the body of Mrs. Taylor's letter.

Mrs. Taylor dwells upon the request of her son that he not take the flight out. Extensive additional investigation fails to uncover any valid reason for his making such a request. The record shows that he asked the Operations Duty Officer if he could get out of the flight, and, when told no other instructors were available, he dropped the matter. Lt. Taylor had had experience enough in the Navy to know that there are procedures to be followed in being excused from flights. If there is a physical, mental, or personal reason for such excuse, he may go to the flight surgeon or Chief Flight Instructor and present his excuse. Lt. Taylor's action in dropping the matter after talking to the Duty Officer clearly indicates that he had no strong reason for not taking the flight out. His roommate could give no reason for his not wanting to fly, but was inclined to believe it was for Taylor's personal convenience. According to him Lt. Taylor was normal physically and mentally prior to the flight.

Mrs. Taylor's reasoning that the pilots would have to bail out over the Everglades after reaching land further shows her unfamiliarity and lack of understanding of aircraft operation. The weather along the coast that night was such that, had they reached land anywhere they probably could have gotten in to an airfield.

Her request that four officers be discharged from the service to atone for the lives of the last pilots is coupled with the words "horrifying incompetence and neglect". It is submitted that in making such an indictment Mrs. Taylor completely overlooks the fact that the Naval Service was represented by her son, a Naval Aviator, with 2500 hours and four years and more of experience. As such he was placed in a position of responsibility and trust and the lives of a class of students with little experience were placed in his hands.

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He allowed himself to become lost, which, in itself is not a matter for blame since it is recognized that even the most experienced person can become temporarily confused. However, his subsequent actions and his failure to take any coherent steps to remedy his position are not compatible with the actions expected from an officer of his experience and training. The charge of incompetence and neglect could better be laid to Lt. Taylor than to the officers who tried by every method available to extricate Lt. Taylor from his precarious position. Lt. Taylor apparently did not cooperate, nor did he show good judgment in any of his actions subsequent to becoming lost.

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GENERAL COMMENTS

The informal discussions held with officers named in the letter of transmittal brought to light the following additional information.

(a) Mrs. Taylor has written numerous letters to individuals requesting information of the disaster. In all cases she received complete, honest, clear and sympathetic replies. Captain BURKE stated that he spent a day and a half with her explaining everything in detail. Her son-in-law Lt. Whitney Lowe, a naval aviator, visited Ft. Lauderdale and was flown over the track the navigation problem assigned Lt. Taylor's flight. He was also given a thorough explanation of the flight, action taken, etc. and stated he was satisfied everything was done that could be done; but when asked if he could convince Mrs. Taylor he expressed doubt.

(b) Lt. Clark Miller, who roomed with Lt. Taylor furnished information concerning the latters' personality, character, attitude, etc. He stated that Taylor was a very likable person but quite lazy, that his attitude toward flying was somewhat perfunctory. On a previous occasion it is known that Taylor took out a navigation flight without his ear phones. On the day of the ill-fated flight Taylor was observed to be without his plotting board when he entered the plane. This, however, cannot be taken as conclusive because it is possible the board was already in the plane.

Miller stated he liked Taylor very much, personally, but that he considered him to be "haphazard and lazy". This apparently accounts for Taylors request not to take the flight that day. He had previously made requests for others to take his flights, just for the sake of getting out of them. His request not to fly, therefore, cannot be given any serious consideration. Taylor was well aware of proper procedure to be followed in legitimate requests not to fly. The fact that he did not pursue the matter classifies his request as a whim.

(c) Mrs. Taylor apparently gives no credit to the Navy for the extensive search efforts made to locate the missing flight, nor does she mention the loss of the PBM with its entire crew of 13 while participating in this search.

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OPINIONS

Review of the Record of Proceedings of the Board of Investigation, numerous letters written by and to Mrs. Taylor, and of reference (a) to basic letter prompt the board to make the following opinions.

(a) Mrs. Taylor is laboring under an obsession which it is doubtful can be eliminated except by time or complete mental derangement. She has been treated with utmost sympathy and courtesy, but this sentiment is slowly, on the part of various officers concerned, turning to apathy. She appears to be incapable of accepting a rational, reasonable explanation of Lt. Taylor's responsibility as senior officer of the flight and as an experienced pilot, for the safety of the flight.

(b) Mrs. Taylor, unless told with finality that the Record of Proceedings as a legal document is unbiased and impartial, and has been thoroughly examined by experts who have found it to be legally and technically in order, will continue to write letters and demand the time of officers who cannot possibly offer the satisfaction she seeks.

(c) It is believed that Mrs. Taylor is emotionally unstable as a result of this disaster, and cannot be expected to react in a normal manner until she becomes emotionally stable.

RECOMMENDATIONS

(a) That a firm letter be written Mrs. Taylor advising her that the Record of Proceedings have been reviewed, interested parties consulted, and that nothing can be done which will improve the memory of her son. In fact, if the case were reopened there is every indication that Lt. Taylors responsibility for the safety of the flight might be more firmly established and stated.

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NATIONAL ARCHIVES AND RECORDS ADMINISTRATION
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Target 4

Folder A17 (1)
Administrative Report–Fort Lauderdale–1946
Entry 16 (Box 92)

Information concerning the disappearance of naval aircraft on December 5, 1945, during routine navigation flight.

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Routing Slip No. 01644
Date as 18 jan 46

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Headquarters
Naval Air Operational Training Command

Subject:

Disapprearance of naval aircraft on 5 dec 45 during routine over water navigation flight -information concerning

From: NAS Ft. Lauderdale **Date:** 15 jan 46

File Reference: NM29-4/L11-1(1) 60242 **Finished File:** JAN 24 1946

Corres. Symbol	Title	Routing Order	Routing Act. Symb.	Initials Noted	Date In	Date Out
OT-1	**ADMIRAL**	4	3		1- 22	
OT-2	**CHIEF OF STAFF**	3	3		1- 23	
OT-3	Legal	2	1		1-21	1-22
OT-4	Domestic Transportation					
OT-5	Public Relations					
OTA-1	**ADMINISTRATION**					
OTA-2	Operations; IATCB					
OTA-21	Oper. Fac.-Plng.					
OTA-23	Aerology					
OTA-25	Boat Facilities					
OTA-3	Welfare, Physical Trng.					
OTA-32	Ship's Service; BOQ					
OTA-34	War Bonds					
OTA-35	Insurance					
OTA-36	Civil Readjustment					
OTA-4	Personnel					
OTA-41	Personnel (Officer)					
OTA-42	Personnel (Enlisted)					
OTA-43	Education—Enlisted Trng.					
OTA-44	Classification Control					
OTA-45	Civil Pers. Relations					
OTA-46	Hdqtrs. Flag Unit					
OTA-5	Public Works; OinCC					
OTA-6	Security; Intel.					
OTA-61	Safety; Fire Fighting					
OTA-7	Communications (Adm.)					
OTA-73	Postal					
OTA-74	Registered Publications					
OTA-75	Publications					
OTA-8	Medical (Adm.)					
OTA-9	Supply					
OTA-17	Director of WAVES					
OTA-18	Central Office					

Corres. Symbol	Title	Routing Order	Routing Act. Symb.	Initials Noted	Date In	Date Out
OTT-1	**TRAINING**	1	2		1/19	
OTT-2	Planning					
OTT-21	Pilot Allocation					
OTT-22	Marine Liaison					
OTT-3	Pilot Trng. (Flight)	5	3		1/24	
OTT-31	VF Combat Trng.					
OTT-32	VT-VB Combat Trng.					
OTT-33	Multi-Engine Cmbt Trng.					
OTT-34	Instrument Trng.					
OTT-35	LSO; Carrier Qual.					
OTT-36	Instructor Trng.					
OTT-37	Accident Prevention					
OTT-4	Aircrewman Trng.					
OTT-46	OinCC, AGTSU					
OTT-5	Pilot Trng. (Ground)					
OTT-51	Multi-Engine Type					
OTT-52	CV Type					
OTT-53	Survival Trng. & Eqpt.					
OTT-54	Navigation Trng.					
OTT-55	Synthetic Devices					
OTT-56	ACI					
OTT-57	Recognition Trg.; Film Util.					
OTT-58	Trng. Film Distr.					
OTT-6	Aircraft Materiel					
OTT-61	Maintenance & Eng.					
OTT-62	Procurmnt & Allocation					
OTT-63	A&R Work Distb.					
OTT-64	Ordnance Material					
OTT-7	Electronics; VF(N) Trng.					
OTT-71	Communication Trng.					
OTT-72	Radar Trng.					
OTT-73	Fighter Dir. & VF(N) Trg.					
OTT-74	Electronic Materiel					

J.NAS 69691 J-4826 6-45 75M

Definition of Symbols

1. **Take necessary action.**
2. **Comment.**
3. **For information.**
4. **FILE—no action required.**
5. **Retain enclosure(s). Return Routing Slip to Central Files.**

REMARKS:

Good summary
No action required - T-3 (R)

TO ACTION OFFICER

REPLY TO BE MAILED BY

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IN REPLY REFER TO NM29-4/L11-1(1)

Address:
Commanding Officer
Naval Air Station

Reg 2617

UNITED STATES NAVAL AIR STATION
FT. LAUDERDALE, FLORIDA

A17(1)

60242

01644

15 January 1946

To: Chief of Naval Operations (Attn: Op-514-H)

Subj: Disappearance of naval aircraft on 5 December 1945 during routine over water navigation flight - Information concerning.

Refs: (a) CNO ltr. Op-514-H/rrp serial 591P514 dtd 28 Dec. 1945.
(b) CNAAdTra ltr. NM29-11/AT-3/A17(1) serial 204 dtd 5 Jan. 1946.

1. The following report is submitted in accordance with references (a) and (b).

2. Narrative of the facts:

(a) Composition of the flight crews:

TBM-3, BuNo. 23307:

Pilot: Lieutenant Charles Carroll TAYLOR, (A1), USNR, File No. 114085. Lieutenant TAYLOR was permanently attached to the U.S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, as a senior qualified VTB flight instructor.

Radioman: Walter Reed PARPART, Jr., ARM3/c, USNR, Ser. No. 7141916. PARPART was temporarily attached to the U.S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, undergoing training as an aircrewman.

Turret Gunner: George F. DEVLIN, AOM3/c, USNR, Ser. No. 7110221. DEVLIN was permanently attached to the U.S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida.

TBM-1E, BuNo. 46094:

Pilot: Captain Edward Joseph POWERS, Jr., USMC, File No. 09789. Captain POWERS was temporarily attached to the U.S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida.

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Radioman: George Richard PACHESSA, Staff Sergeant, USMC, Ser. No. 805639. PACHESSA was temporarily attached to the U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, undergoing training as an aircrewman.

Turret Gunner: Howell Orrin THOMPSON, Staff Sergeant, USMCR, Ser. No. 499181. THOMPSON was temporarily attached to the U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, undergoing training as an aircrewman.

TBM-1C, BuNo. 73209:

Pilot: Captain George William STIVERS, USMC, File No. 010959. Captain STIVERS was temporarily attached to the U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, undergoing flight training in VTB ATU #1.

Radioman: Robert Peter GRUBBEL, Private, USMCR, Ser. No. 563782. GRUBBEL was temporarily attached to the U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, undergoing training as an aircrewman.

Turret Gunner: Robert Francis GALLIVAN, Sergeant, USMC, Ser. No. 359343. GALLIVAN was temporarily attached to the U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, undergoing training as an aircrewman.

TBM-1C, BuNo. 46325:

Pilot: 2nd Lieutenant Forrest James GERBER, USMCR MAVC, File No. 047223. 2nd Lieutenant GERBER was temporarily attached to the U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, undergoing flight training in VTB ATU #1.

Turret Gunner: William Earl LIGHTFOOT, Private First Class, USMCR, Ser. No. 519803. LIGHTFOOT was temporarily attached to the U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, undergoing training as an aircrewman.

TBM-1C, BuNo. 45714:

Pilot: Ensign Joseph Tipton BOSSI, (Al)L, USNR, File No. 470677. Ensign BOSSI was temporarily attached to

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the U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, undergoing flight training in VTB ATU #1.

Radioman: Burt Edward BALUK, Jr., S1/c, USNR, Ser. No. 7149150. BALUK was temporarily attached to the U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, undergoing training as an aircrewman.

Turret Gunner: Herman Arthur THELANDER, S1/c, USNR, Ser. No. 7584437. THELANDER was temporarily attached to the U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, undergoing training as an aircrewman.

(b) Aircraft involved:

TBM-3, BuNo. 23307, Engine Mfg. No. 124575;
TBM-1E, BuNo. 46094, Engine BuNo. 66287;
TBM-1C, BuNo. 73200, Engine BuNo. 54191;
TBM-1C, BuNo. 46325, Engine BuNo. 63027; and
TBM-1C, BuNo. 45714, Engine BuNo. 34619.

(c) Origin and authorization of flight:

The five (5) aircraft involved comprised Flight #19, and took off from the main station field, U. S. Naval Air Station, Fort Lauderdale, Florida, at 1410, 5 December 1945. This flight was due to return at 1723, 5 December 1945. Flight #19 was a regularly authorized and scheduled operational training over water navigational flight.

(d) Composition of the flight:

The flight was composed of five (5) aircraft. It cannot be determined who was leading the flight at the time it became lost as each student pilot leads one leg of the navigation problem as assigned in the pre-flight briefing, and the other student pilots track while the instructor chases the flight.

(e) Training area assigned:

Flight #19 was flying over water day navigation problem #1. Navigation problem #1 consists of four (4) legs with glide bombing exercises on Hen and Chickens Islands between legs #1 and #2.

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True courses and distances for navigation problem #1 are:

Leg #1: Course 091° Distance 58 miles.
Note: Leg #1 leads to the Great Isaac Light where glide bombing exercises are conducted on the Hen and Chickens Islands, 5 miles south of the light.

Leg #2: Course 091° Distance 67 miles.

Leg #3: Course 346° Distance 73 miles.

Leg #4: Course 241° Distance 120 miles.
Note: Leg #4 returns to NAS, Fort Lauderdale.

See Enclosure 1 - area chart showing over water day navigation problems used by this station. Navigation problem #1 is outlined in red.

(f) Pertinent facts preceding flight:

It has been ascertained that Lieutenant TAYLOR prior to the flight briefed his students in preparation for the navigation problem and that he did require each of his students to work navigation problem #1 prior to take-off. The flight manned their planes at approximately 1400 and took off at 1410.

(g) Emergency action taken:

At 1805 on 5 December 1945 Lieutenant R. F. COX, pilot of FT-74, a NAS, Fort Lauderdale based TBM, called NAS, Fort Lauderdale operations radio on 4805 Kc with the information that a ship or plane seemed to be lost and was attempting to contact NAS, Fort Lauderdale Tower. At 1811 FT-74 again called and identified the lost plane to be FT-28, piloted by Lieutenant Charles Carroll TAYLOR, leader of a flight of five torpedo planes on a routine over water day navigation flight. NHA #3 and NHA #8, armored target boats from the Port Everglades Boat Facility stationed at sea approximately five miles east of NAS, Fort Lauderdale, confirmed the fact that the lost plane was FT-28 and that they could hear FT-28's transmissions faintly but that FT-28 could not receive NHA #3 or NHA #8.

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Immediately upon identification of the lost flight, the Chief Flight Instructor, NAS, Fort Lauderdale, ordered Operations, NAS, Fort Lauderdale, to request ASRTU #4 to contact FT-28 or any other member of the lost flight on 4805 Kc, transmitting to them instructions to change frequency to lost plane emergency 3000 Kc and to fly west or into the sun. No answer was received from FT-28 or any member of the flight to radio's attempt to contact them and both messages were transmitted "blind" several times at short intervals. No evidence is available that FT-28 or any member of the flight received either message.

The Operations Officer, NAS, Fort Lauderdale, alerted Air Sea Rescue 7th Naval District, Miami, at 1620. Requests were also made to all directional finder radio stations for DF fixes. At 1720 NHA #3 again notified NAS, Fort Lauderdale, that transmissions from FT-28 were still readable but that he had not been able to get any messages through to FT-28.

At 1751 NAS, Fort Lauderdale, requested that the Air Sea Rescue Controller in Miami alert all fields from NAS, Banana River, to NAS, Miami, and have them turn on all lights. ASR Controller informed NAS, Fort Lauderdale, that all fields south of Jacksonville were alerted and that Banana River and Dinner Key Dumbos were airborne.

ASR Controller reported that the last transmission heard from the flight was at 1904 when FT-3, piloted by Captain Edward Joseph POWERS, USMC, a member of the navigation flight, attempted to call the flight leader in FT-28. There was no acknowledgement by FT-28.

NAS, Fort Lauderdale, informed ASR Controller that 36 TBM aircraft with experienced crews were available for dawn take-off for 6 December searches.

Extensive searches were carried out by all available military aircraft through 11 December 1945 under the direction of the Air Sea Rescue Controller, 7th Naval District, Miami. Charts prepared by the ASR Controller, showing areas searched, are enclosed as Enclosure 2.

On 8 December 1945 the escort carrier, USS SOLOMONS, CVE-67, was made available to NAS, Fort Lauderdale, for search opera-

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tions at the request of the Commanding Officer, NAS, Fort Lauderdale. Eleven TBM's, led by Lieutenant Commander Don J. POOLE, Chief Flight Officer, NAS, Fort Lauderdale, landed aboard the SOLOMONS at 1122, 8 December 1945 and carried out extensive search operations on 8, 9, and 10 December 1945. All searches were negative and the planes returned to NAS, Fort Lauderdale, on 11 December 1945.

Active search was discontinued by this station on 10 December 1945 after all areas within the operating range of the TBM type aircraft were throughly covered. ASR Controller continued searches with longer range aircraft.

A report by an Eastern Airlines pilot that a plane was seen in the swamp area immediately south of Melbourne, Florida, on the night of 7 December 1945 was investigated thoroughly by aircraft from this station and an Army helicopter. No evidence of any of the missing aircraft or personnel were found.

Investigation and search of the swamp area immediately west of the city of Miami, Florida, was instigated after a report by an Indian guide that he had discovered signs of personnel movement in the uninhabited area. Results were again negative.

All debris of any type picked up by ships at sea or washed ashore anywhere along the east coast of Florida is currently being either returned to this station for inspection or a representative of this command is being sent to examine the articles for possible connection with the missing aircraft and personnel.

To date no positive evidence has come to light indicating the whereabouts of the missing aircraft and personnel.

(h) Weather conditions:

Observation by station aerology officer for period 1200-1800, 5 December 1945:

"Scattered altocumulus clouds. Lower scattered stratocumulus and cumulus at 1500 to 2500 feet, becoming broken in moderate showers. Visibility 8 miles, lowered to 2 miles in showers.

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Subj: Disappearance of naval aircraft on 5 December 1945 during routine over water navigation flight - Information concerning.

Surface winds southwesterly to westerly, 10 to 28 knots. Winds aloft 230° to 240°, 16 to 48 knots. Flying undesirable in showers to average between showers."

Winds aloft were reported as:

Surface	220°	20 knots
1000'	240°	31 knots
2000'	240°	32 knots
3000'	240°	37 knots
4000'	250°	33 knots
5000'	245°	35 knots
6000'	245°	50 knots

(1) Pilot data:

Lieutenant Charles Carroll TAYLOR had compiled a total flight time of 2509.3 hours of which 616 hours was in the TBF type aircraft. Lieutenant TAYLOR, previous to take-off, had signed for and accepted the aircraft, and he appeared normal in all respects.

Lieutenant TAYLOR received his flight training as an aviation cadet at NAS, Corpus Christi, Texas, receiving his commission in February 1942. From that date until November 1942 he remained at Corpus Christi as an instructor in a basic training squadron. From November 1942 until November 1943 Lieutenant TAYLOR was attached to VS-62, NAS, Key West, Florida, as a scouting pilot. From November 1943 until February 1945 Lieutenant TAYLOR was attached to VT-7 as a torpedo plane pilot. VT-7 trained at NAS, Quonset Point, R. I., from November 1943 until April 1944 when they went aboard the USS HANCOCK. Lieutenant TAYLOR remained with VT-7 aboard the USS HANCOCK until February 1945 when he was ordered to NAS, Miami, where he was assigned duty as a flight instructor in Operational Training Unit #2. In November 1945 he was transferred to NAS, Fort Lauderdale, and assigned duty as a flight instructor in Advanced Training Unit #1.

Of Lieutenant TAYLOR's flight time in the TBF type aircraft 273 hours were flown while VT-7 was actually aboard the USS HANCOCK and 61 of these hours involved actual strikes against the enemy or anti-snooper missions. Lieutenant TAYLOR flew 165 hours as a VTB instructor at NAS, Miami.

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Subj: Disappearance of Naval aircraft on 5 December 1945 during routine over water navigation flight - Information concerning.

Captain Edward Joseph POWERS, Jr., had compiled a total flight time of 344.9, of which 62.2 hours was in the TBF type aircraft. Captain POWERS, previous to the take-off, signed for and accepted the aircraft, and he appeared normal in all respects prior to the flight. He was considered to be an average-to-above pilot.

Captain George William STIVERS had compiled a total flight time of 374.7 hours, of which 57.9 hours was in the TBF type aircraft. Captain STIVERS, previous to the take-off, signed for and accepted the aircraft, and he appeared normal in all respects prior to the flight. He was considered to be an average-to-above pilot.

2nd Lieutenant Forrest James GERBER had compiled a total flight time of 360.6 hours of which 61.8 hours was in TBF type aircraft. 2nd Lieutenant GERBER had signed for and accepted the aircraft previous to the take-off, and appeared normal in all respects. He was considered to be an average-to-above pilot.

Ensign Joseph Tipton BOSSI had compiled a total flight time of 373.4 hours, of which 65.9 hours were in the TBF type aircraft. Ensign BOSSI, previous to the take-off, signed for and accepted the aircraft, and appeared normal in all respects. He was considered to be an average-to-above pilot.

(j) Aircraft data:

TBM-3, BuNo. 23307, had a total operating time of 320.2 hours with one overhaul, 30.4 hours since overhaul. Engine, Mfg. No. 124575, had a total operating time of 30.4 hours with no overhaul.

TBM-1E, BuNo. 46094, had a total operating time of 1374.9 hours with one overhaul, 15.3 hours since overhaul. Engine, BuNo. 66287, had an unknown total of operating time with 20.6 hours since the last overhaul.

TBM-1C, BuNo. 73209, had a total operating time of 386 hours with one overhaul, 140.1 hours since overhaul. Engine, BuNo. 34191, had a total operating time of 484 hours with two overhauls, 142 hours since last overhaul.

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Subj: Disappearance of Naval aircraft on 5 December 1945 during routine over water navigation flight - Information concerning.

TBM-1C, BuNo. 46324, had a total operating time of 612 hours with one overhaul, 156.7 hours since overhaul. Engine, BuNo. 63027, had an unknown total of operating time with 155.6 hours since the last overhaul.

TBM-1C, BuNo. 45714, had a total operating time of 725.7 hours with one overhaul, 263.3 hours since overhaul. Engine, BuNo. 34619, had a total operating time of 1048.9 hours with two overhauls, 267.4 hours since last overhaul.

3. The following action was taken by this station in an effort to determine cause:

(a) A test flight was flown to determine the extent that the local ZB homing beacon could be utilized by a lost plane in the area used by the five missing TBM's. The following results were noted:

Altitude of plane	Distance from station that signal could be distinguished
1000'	42 miles
2300'	56 miles
5000'	80 miles
7100'	100 miles
8200'	115 miles
10,000'	123 miles

(b) It has been ascertained that Lieutenant TAYLOR and the four student pilots had been thoroughly briefed on lost plane procedure in the area by the station Operations Officer and again by the Squadron Navigation Officer. Any plane lost in the squadron operating area at sea is instructed in all cases to fly west until the east coast of Florida is intercepted where orientation can be made. Lieutenant TAYLOR and all student pilots had been instructed to draw ZBX standard grid charts from Operations prior to any navigation flight. It is assumed this flight followed standard procedure and drew the customary grids; it is hard to believe any experienced instructor would depart on such a flight without requiring all members of the flight to have these grids in their possession. No record is kept of grids issued, therefore it is impossible to definitely state that this flight did have them. Each of the pilots had also been instructed in ZB homing beacon orientation without a code chart and had spent two periods under instruction in a Link Trainer.

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Subj: Disappearance of Naval aircraft on 5 December 1945 during routine over water navigation flight - Information concerning.

(c) Flight number 18, led by Lt(jg) Willard Lewis STOLL, was identical in all respects to flight 19, led by Lt. TAYLOR. Both flights were assigned Problem #1; flight 18 preceding flight 19 by 15 minutes from take-off time. Lt.(jg) STOLL reported that his flight was conducted without incident, and no unusual obstacles were encountered. The flight returned to the station on time.

(d) The Squadron Navigation Officer briefed all instructors, including Lt. TAYLOR, on the standard procedure for flying Navigation problems. All Navigation flights are to be flown at approximately 700 feet and never more than 1000 feet in any event. They are instructed that wind changes and estimations taken from the water cannot be made at any higher altitude. Also, direct visual contact will be kept with the water at all times.

(e) It has been ascertained that each plane carried a MK IV emergency life raft with standard equipment and that the rafts had been checked recently and were in good condition.

(f) Pilots who flew TBM-3, BuNo. 23307, the aircraft flown by Lieutenant TAYLOR, were questioned and it was determined that the aircraft was equipped with both a magnetic and remote compass and both were in working order prior to the flight.

W.O. BURCH, Jr.,
Captain, USN,
Commanding Officer.

Encl.
1 - (HW) Area chart showing over water day navigation problems.
2 - (HW) Charts showing areas searched prepared by ASR Controller.

Copy to:
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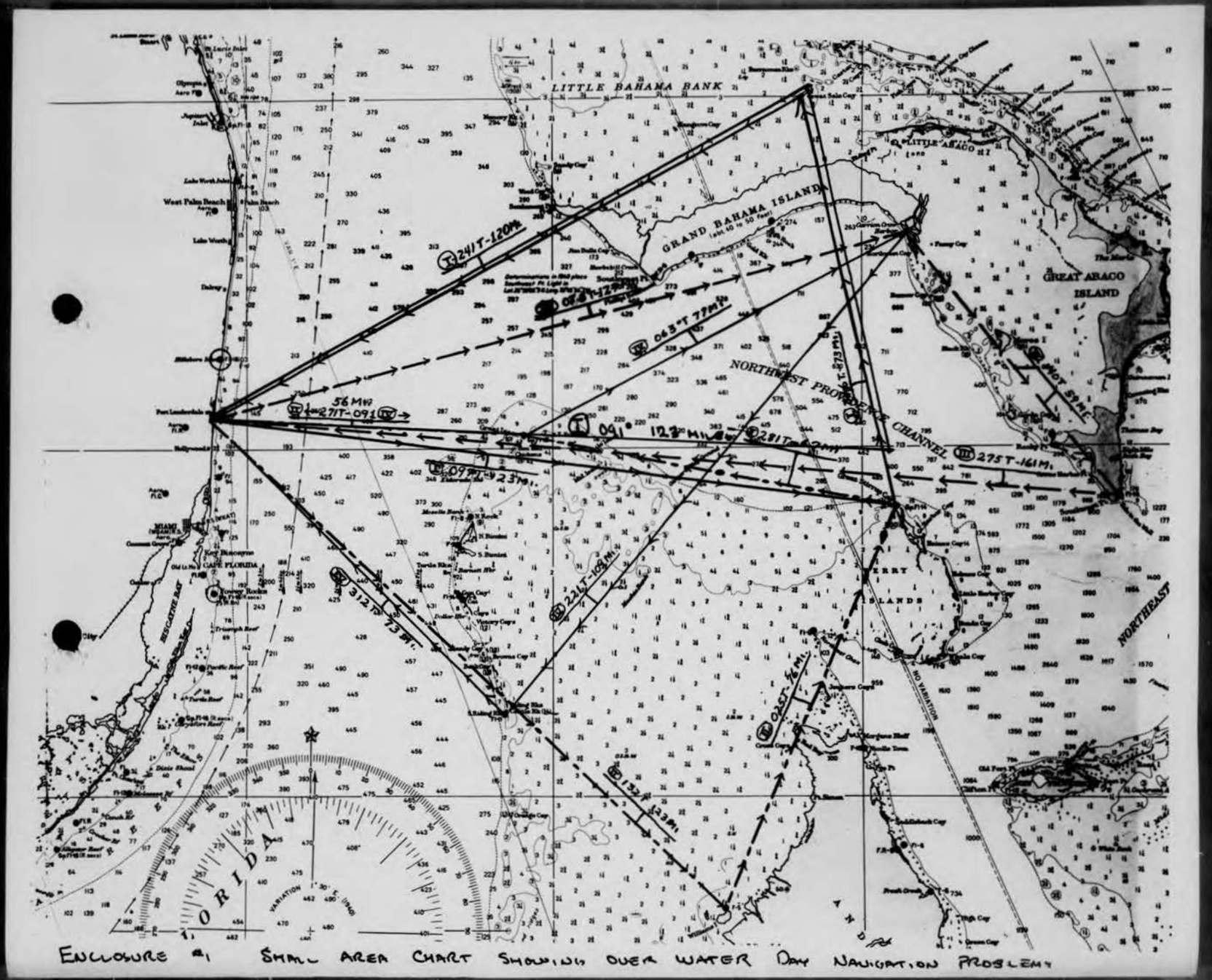
NARA 501



ENCLOSURE #1 SMALL AREA CHART SHOWING OVER WATER DAY NAVIGATION PROBLEMS

DECLASSIFIED

Encl. 2
12-5-45

NARA 383

84° 82° 80° 78°

CHARLESTON

5 DECEMBER 1945

JACKSONVILLE

2100 R. MAYPORT
DUMBO ON POOR VIS

ST. AUGUSTINE

DAYTONA DUMBO UP 1921
ON 2400.7.1 HOURS

DAYTONA BEACH

PONCE DE LEON INLET

HEADED FOR NEW SMYRNA

1821 R. LAST NF/OF FIX
79°00 - 29°15'

TR. 32 SA. SCH.
DAYTONA DUMBO

TR. 32 UP 1920
TR. 49 UP 1927
TR. 60 UP 2235

TR. 60

TR 32 - 7.1 HRS.

CAPE CANAVERAL

4 BAN. R PLANES
SEARCHED 28.1 HRS

INVESTIGATE FLARES

150 M. NORTH

TAMPA

1 PLANE UP 1845

VERA BEACH

VERO DUMBO 6.1 HRS.

150 M. EAST

CONTACT 4805 KCS.

NOTES ON 5 TBM's

DECLASSIFIED

NARA 304

78° 76° 74° 72° 70° 34° 32° 30° 28°

5 DECEMBER 1945

OF FIX

RES

150 M. NORTH

M. EAST

NARA 383

TR. 32 3A. SCH.
DAYTONA DUMBO

TR. 32 UP 1920
TR. 49 UP 1927
TR. 60 UP 2235

TR 32-7-1 HRS.

4 BAN. R PLANES
SEARCHED 28.1 HRS

INVESTIGATE FLARES

150 M. NORTH

TAMPA

1PLANE UP 1845

VERA BEACH

VERO DUMBO 6.1 HRS.

150 M. EAST

NOTES ON 5 TBM'S
LOST 5 DECEMBER 1945
SHEET 1, 5, DECEMBER 1945

JUPITER

WEST PALM BEACH

1820 D.K. PLANE TO EST. RDO CONTACT 4805 KCS
150 MILES 045 DT

FT. LAUDERDALE

1645 C.G.A.J. D.K.
ALERTED. 2 PLANES
11.4 HRS.

MIAMI

KEY WEST

BOCA CHICA

DECLASSIFIED

NARA 302

150 M. NORTH

M. EAST

25°

26°

24°

5-DECEMBER-1945.

DECLASSIFIED

Encl. 2
12-6-45

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

NARA 508

84° 82° 80° 78° 76°

CHARLESTON

6 DECEMBER 1945

31°00'N

3RD AAF & ORLANDO S. TO 27°00'N.

3RD AAF SEARCH

N.A.S. JAX
126 PLANES OUT 349.7 HRS

JACKSONVILLE

N.A.S. JAX PBY'S
+ AUX 70 PLANES IN AREA
MORNING AND AFTERNOON.

EXTENSION SOLOMON'S AREA

3RD AAF SEARCH
10 PLANES SARASOTA
6 MCDILL 5.5 HRS AV.

ST. AUGUSTINE

JAX
3 SNJ's 4 SNB's
CECIL FLD.
20.05 B2 C's.

MAYPORT
DUMBO

N.A.S. JAX
8 SNJ's

N.A.S. JAX.
20 F4U's
5 SNJ's

SOLOMONS
+ ESCORTS
NO PLANES

MCDILL 4 L 5's
2 N11 25.3 HRS.

DAYTONA BEACH

PONCE DE LEON INLET

7.8 HRS
DAYTONA DUMBO
MORRISON FIELD
2 PLANES
C47-PBY-16.3 HRS

C.G.A.S. ST. PETE
2 PBM - 10 HRS.

CAPE CANAVERAL

BANANA RIVER
11 PLANES 86.3 HRS.

TAMPA

VERO BEACH

VERO
DUMBO
2 PLANE 8.1 HRS

MORRISON
A.T.G.
1 C47 1 - PBY
16 HRS. 15 MINS.

56.8 HRS.
3RD AAF & ORLANDO
N TO 31°00'N 30 PLANES
B17, B26, P51, P38

DECLASSIFIED

NARA 303

76° 74° 72° 70°

33°

32°

6 DECEMBER 1945

OMON'S AREA

OMONS
ESCORTS
PLANES

RIVER
86.3 HRS.

MORRISON
A.T.C.

1-C47 1-PBY
16 HRS - 15 MINS.

30°

28°

DECLASSIFIED

NARA 519

PONCE DE LEON INLET

C.G.A.S. ST. PETE
2 PBM - 10 HRS.

CAPE CANAVERAL

7.8 HRS
DAYTONA DUMBO
MORRISON FIELD
2 PLANES
CA7 - PBY - 16.3 HRS

BANANA RIVER
11 PLANES 86.3 HRS.

TAMPA

VERO BEACH

VERO
DUMBO
2 PLANE 8.1 HRS

MORRISON
A.T.C.
1 C 47 1 - PBY
16 HRS - 15 MINS.

56.8 HRS.
3D AAF + ORLANDO
N TO 31°00'N 60 PLANES
B17's, A26's, P51's. P47's

JUPITER

WEST PALM BEACH

BOCA RATON
4 - B 17's
20 HRS

FT. LAUD. MORNING SEARCH

OPA - LOCK
5 PBY's

FT. LAUDERDALE

MIAMI

MIAMI ATC
B17 - 5.3 HRS

C.G.A.S.
DINNER KEY
2 PLANES
13.7 HRS.

74 PLANES
221.5 HRS,

BOCA CHICA

KEY WEST

FT. LAUDERDALE
AFTERNOON SEARCH

OAK FIELD R.A.F.
6 HRS. 30 MINS. BY SKY TRAIN.

DECLASSIFIED

RIVER
86.3 HRS.

MORRISON
A.T.C.

1-C 47 1-PBY
16 HRS - 15 MINS.

OPA - LOCKA
5 PBY's 50 HRS.

C.G.A.S.
DINNER KEY
2 PLANES
13.7 HRS.

OAK FIELD R.A.F.
6 HRS - 30 MINS. BY SKY TRAIN.

28°

26°

24°

6 DECEMBER 1945 L.D.M.

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

NARA 312

Encl. 2
12-7-45

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

NARA 313

84° 82° 80° 78°

CHARLESTON

N.A.S. MAYPORT 9 PLANES TOT. 49.1 HRS

N.A.S. JAX. + AUX. FIELDS
TOT. 54 PLANES AM + PM.
309.75 HRS.

N.A.S. JAX - UP0155 54.1 HRS.
10 S.N.J.-6

N.A.S. JAX 15 F4U's UP 0755 R 75.9 HRS.

BANANA RIVER
9 PBM - 3 PBY 114.6 HR.

SOLOMONS PLANES
9 FLIGHTS 18.1 HRS.

JAX PBY
5 PBY 42.5 HRS.

JACKSONVILLE

CECIL FLD. 35 SB2C's UP0705 92 HRS

SOLOMONS + ESCORTS
8 M. INTERVAL

St Augustine

ORLANDO AAF

BOCA RATON B 17's
5 PLANES 36.7 HOURS

N.A.S. MIAMI
8 PBY's USED 50 HRS.

DAYTONA
DUMBO
9 HRS 32 MIN

Daytona Beach

Ponce de Leon Inlet

ATC MORRISON
2 PBY
19.5 HOURS

MIAMI
PBM

3rd AAF

BANANA RIVER
14 PLANES
130.1 HOURS

TAMPA

Vero Beach

6 PLANES
SEARCHING 18 HRS.

N.A.S. FT. LAUD
46 PLANES 164 HRS 58 MINS.

VERO BEACH
DUMBO
1 PLANE 6.5 HRS.

C.G.A.S. MIAMI
2 PLANES 17.4 HRS.

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868188

NARA 314

76° 74° 73°

33°

32°

30°

28°

7 DECEMBER 1945

RIVER
114.6 HR.

NS PLANES
18.1 HRS.

JAX PBY
5 PBY 42.5 HRS.

Y ESCORTS
ERVAL

MIAMI
50 HRS.

DAYTONA
DUMBO
9 HRS 32 MIN

MIAMI
PBM

BAN. R.
3 PBM
1 PBY

BAN R.
3 to 4 PBY's

VERO BEACH
DUMBO
1 PLANE 6.5 HRS.

C.G.A.S. MIAMI
2 PLANES 17.4 HRS.

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

NARA JIJ

3d AAF

TAMPA

BANANA RIVER
14 PLANES
130.1 HOURS

ATC MORRISON
2 PBY
19.5 HOURS

MIAMI
PBM

Vero Beach

6 PLANES
SEARCHING 18 HRS.

N.A.S. FT. LAUD
46 PLANES 164 HRS 58 MINS.

VERO BEACH
DUMBO
1 PLANE 6.5 HRS.

C.G.A.S. MIAMI
2 PLANES 17.4 HRS.

Jupiter

West Palm Beach

C.G.A.S. ST. PETE
2 P.B.M. 14.8 HRS.

BAHAMA ISLAND

GREAT ABACO ISLAND

MIAMI ATC
B 17

McDILL CENTERED SEARCH
4 L-5s 2 AT-11s 1 B-17.
25.1 HRS.

Ft Lauderdale

Miami

N.A.S. KEY WEST
2 FGF, 2 SNB'S

BOCA CHICA DUMBO
6.9 HRS.

R.A.F. NASAU 7.5 HRS BY
SKYTRAIN.

BOCA CHICA 15 TBM's (7.2 HRS. EA)
KEY WEST DUMBO

ANDROS ISLAND

KEY WEST

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

AAAA 316

MIAMI
PBM

VERO BEACH
DUMBO
1 PLANE 6.5 HRS.

C.G.A.S. MIAMI
2 PLANES 17.4 HRS.

MIAMI ATC
B 17

28°

26°

24°

GREAT ABACO ISLAND

R.A.F. NASAU 7.5 HRS BY
SKYTRAIN.

7 DECEMBER 1945 C.C.C.

DECLASSIFIED

Encl. 2
12-8-45

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

84° 83° 82° 81° 80° 79° 78° 77° 76°

33°

32°

30°

28°

CHARLESTON

CHARLESTON DUMBO

8 DECEMBER 1945

MAYPORT 12 SNB'S
2 J2F'S 6 SNJ'S
52 HRS.

OGIB BIR 2 PBM
SQ SCH. 10 HRS.

JACKSONVILLE
NAS - JAX. 104 PLANES
293.5 HOURS.

18 SNJ'S

SOLOMONS
PLANES
8 FLIGHTS
39 HRS.

ST. AUGUSTINE

NAS JAX LAND PLANES
30 PLANES F4U'S 177.8 HRS.

DAYTONA BEACH

PONCE DE LEON INLET

DAYTONA DUMBO
14.1 HRS

BANANA RIVER
15 PLANES
118 HRS.

CECIL FIELD
30 SB2C'S
64 HOURS

CAPE CANAVERAL

BANANA R.
4 SNB'S
9 HRS. 0 M.

C.G.A.S. ST PETE
3 PLANES 24.8 HRS

BANANA RIVER
1 HNS
2 HR 48 M.

TAMPA

TAMPA 2 PLANES
5.5 HOURS.

VERO DUMBO 6.5 HRS.

VERO BEACH
2 PLANES 14.5 HRS.

MORRISON
PBY- B17
18 HRS.

DECLASSIFIED

8° 77° 76 75 74 73 72 71 70

33 33

32° 32

8 DECEMBER 1945

SOLOMONS

30° 30

JAX NAS
6 PBY'S
APPROX. 60 HRS.

C.G.A.S.
INNER KEY
2 PBM.
23.1 HOURS

BANANA R.
6 PBM'S
63.6 HRS.

ATC
MORRISTOWN
B 17
BOAT CARRYING
2 PLANES
17.7 HRS

OPA LAKA
5 PLANES
50 HRS.

28° 28

MORRISON
PBY- B17
18. HRS.

BOCA RATON
5 - B-17's
2 - B-24's
46 HRS. 15 MIN.

ORLANDO
3 - B 29's
2 - B 17's
31.9 HOURS

DECLASSIFIED

DAYTONA BEACH

PONCE DE LEON INLET

DAYTONA DUMBO
14.1 HRS

BANANA RIVER.
15 PLANES
118 HRS.

CECIL FIELD
30 SB2 C's
64 HOURS

CAPE CANAVERAL

C.G.A.S. ST. PETE
3 PLANES 29.8 HRS

BANANA RIVER
1-HNS
2 HR 48 M.

BANANA R
4 SNB's
9 HR 0 M.

28°

TAMPA

TAMPA 2 PLANES
5.5 HOURS.

VERO DUMBO 6.5 HRS.

MORRISON
PBY- B17
18. HRS.

VERO BEACH
2 PLANES 14.5 HRS.

C.G.A.S. ST. PETE
2 PLANES 16.9 HRS.

JUPITER

LOCAL AREA SEARCH
15 PLANES 59.8 HRS

FT. LAUDERDALE

26°

MIAMI

KEY WEST

BOCA CHICA

24°

DECLASSIFIED

AAAA 321

ATC
MORRISTOWN
B 17
BOAT CARRYING
2 PLANES
17.7 HRS

OPA-LAKA
5 PLANES
50 HRS.

MORRISON
PBY- B17
18. HRS.

BOCA RATON
5 - B-17's
2 - B-24's
46 HRS. 15 MIN.

ORLANDO
3 - B 29's
2 - B 17's
31.9 HOURS

R.A.F.
SKYTRAIN
3 HRS.
IN
AREA

28°

26°

24°

28

26

24

8th of December '45

DECLASSIFIED

NARA 322

Encl. 2
12-9-45

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

84° 83° 82° 81° 80° 79° 78° 77°

CHARLESTON

CECIL FD.
30 - SB 20's
60 HRS.

NAS JAX
30 FAU's

NAS JAX
30 PLANES
178.1 HRS.

MAYPORT
12 SNB's
33.2 HRS

BANANA R.
2 PBM's SQ. SCH.
22.1 HRS.

9 DECEMBER 1945

NAS JAX & AUX
90 PLANES
271 HRS 15 MIN.

JACKSONVILLE

ST. AUGUSTINE

DAYTONA DUMBO
4 PLANE 10.1 HRS

DAYTONA BEACH

PONCE DE LEON INLET

VERO DUMBO
8.6 HRS.

BANANA R. TOTALS
17 PLANES
143 HRS. 25 MINS.

CAPE CANAVERAL

MS DILL
11 PLANES
44 HOURS

TAMPA

BANANA R.
PLANES 7
HRS 3.6 HR

SNO's
26.8
HRS.

FT. LAUD
2 - SNB's

VERO BEACH

C. G. A. S
ST. PET
1 PLAN
13.6 HR

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

NARA 524

78° 77° 76° 75° 74° 73° 72° 71° 70°

33

32

9 DECEMBER 1945

SOLOMONS
8 PLANES, 20 FLIGHTS
46.3 HOURS

N.A.S. JAX 6 PLANES.

NA DUMBO
NE 10.1 HRS

BANANA RIVER
9 PLANES
120.9 HRS.

OPA - LOCKA
8 PLANES - PBAY'S
80 HRS.

30

28

C.G.A.S.
ST. PETE
1 PLANE
13.6 HRS

ORLANDO SUPERDUMBO
2-B17's & 2 B 29's
41 HRS 10 MIN

BOCA RATON

DECLASSIFIED

DAYTONA BEACH

PONCE DE LEON INLET

BANANA R. TOTALS
17 PLANES
143 HRS. 25 MINS.

CAPE CANAVERAL

MS DILL
11 PLANES
44 HOURS

TAMPA

BANANA R.
PLANES 7
HRS 3.6 HR

SNOW
24.8
HRS.

FT. LAUD
2 - SNBs

VERO BEACH

VERO DUMBO
8.6 HRS.

C. V. A. S
ST. PETE
1 PLANE
3 F HR

MS DILL
2 AT 11
6.6 HRS.

JUPITER

FT. LAUD. NAS 24 PLANES 64 HRS.

FT. LAUDERDALE

MIAMI

KEY WEST

BOCA CHICA

NARA 326

BANANA RIVER
3 PLANES
120.9 HRS.

OPA - LOCKA
8 PLANES - PBAY'S
80 HRS.

28

C.G.A.S.
ST. PETE
1 PLANE
12.5 HRS

BOCA RATON
5 PLANES B17'S
55 HOURS

ORLANDO SUPERDUMBO
2 - B17'S + 2 B 29'S
41 HRS 10 MIN

MIAMI ATC
7.2 HRS.

MORRISON ATC
1 PLANE
8.4 HRS.

HRS.

26

9 DECEMBER 1945

DECLASSIFIED

Encl. 2

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189
12-10-45

84°

82°

80°

78°

CHARLESTON

10 DECEMBER 1945

JACKSONVILLE

BAN. R. 2 PBM'S SEARCHED
EXPANDING SR. 17 HRS. 50 MIN.

ST. AUGUSTINE

DAYTON BEACH

PONCE DE LEON

N.A.S. JAX.
20 PLANES
124 HRS. 40 MIN

2 B 29'S
1 B 17'S
1 B 25
ORLANDO
20 HRS. 35 MINS.

CAPE CANAVERAL

BAN. R. DAYS
TOTAL 16 PLANES
121 HRS. 47 MINS.
BAN. R. SNB. NNS. 4.5 HRS.

BOCA

TAMPA

VERA BEACH

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

NARA 329

8°

76°

74°

72°

70°

35°

32°

30°

32°

31°

16 TBM'S SEARCHED
48.5 HOURS.

2 B 29'S
2 B 17'S
1 B 25
ORLANDO
20 HRS. 35 MINS.

BAN. R. 4 PBY'S
33 HRS. 16 MINS.

N.A.S. JAX.
20 PLANES
124 HRS. 40 MIN

BOCA

MASTER FIELD

BAN. R. 8 PBM'S
66 HRS. 11 MINS.

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Authority NND 868189

MAR 1938

CAPE CANAVERAL

BAN. R. DAYS
TOTAL 16 PLANES
121 HRS. 47 MINS.
BAN. R. SNB. HNS. 4.5 HRS.

TAMPA

VERA BEACH

JUPITER

WEST PALM BEACH

FT. LAUDERDALE

MIAMI

KEY WEST

BOCA CHICA

N.A.S. O.R.
20 PLANES
124 HRS. 40 MIN

BOCA

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

NARA 531

124 HRS. 40 MIN

BOCA

MASTER FIELD

BAN. R. & P.B.M.'S
66 HRS. 11 MINS.

26°

24°

10 DECEMBER 1945.

W.T.P.

A 17(1) ADM. REPORT - FT. LAUDERDALE 1946

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

NATIONAL ARCHIVES AND RECORDS ADMINISTRATION
MICROFILM PUBLICATIONS

Target 5

Folder A17 (2)
Miami – 1944–45
Entry 16 (Box 96)

Board of Investigation inquiring into the loss of certain naval aircraft on December 5, 1945.

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

Route Slip No. 54978
Date EO 31 Dec 45

Headquarters
Naval Air Operational Training Command

Our File A17(2)
Cross File
No. Copies 2
Enclosures
Taken Up By ma

Subject: Board of Investigation Inquiring into Lo s of Certain Naval Aircraft on 5 Dec 45.

From: 7ND Miami
Date: 26 Dec 45

File Reference: ND7(76) A4-3(1) JFS:JFH:jm
Finished File: 5 JAN 1946

Corres. Symbol	Title	Routing Order	Routing Act. Symb.	Initials Noted	Date In	Date Out
OT-1	ADMIRAL					
OT-2	CHIEF OF STAFF					
OT-3	Legal	1	1	R	1-2	1-3
OT-4	Domestic Transportation					
OT-5	Public Relations					
OTA-1	ADMINISTRATION					
OTA-2	Operations; IATCB					
OTA-21	Oper. Fac.-Plng.					
OTA-23	Aerology					
OTA-25	Boat Facilities					
OTA-3	Welfare, Physical Trng.					
OTA-32	Ship's Service; BOQ					
OTA-34	War Bonds					
OTA-35	Insurance					
OTA-36	Civil Readjustment					
OTA-4	Personnel					
OTA-41	Personnel (Officer)					
OTA-42	Personnel (Enlisted)					
OTA-43	Education—Enlisted Trng.					
OTA-44	Classification Control					
OTA-45	Civil Pers. Relations					
OTA-46	Hdqtrs. Flag Unit					
OTA-5	Public Works; OinCC					
OTA-6	Security; Intel.					
OTA-61	Safety; Fire Fighting					
OTA-7	Communications (Adm.)					
OTA-73	Postal					
OTA-74	Registered Publications					
OTA-75	Publications					
OTA-8	Medical (Adm.)					
OTA-9	Supply					
OTA-17	Director of WAVES					
OTA-18	Central Office					

Corres. Symbol	Title	Routing Order	Routing Act. Symb.	Initials Noted	Date In	Date Out
OTT-1	TRAINING					
OTT-2	Planning					
OTT-21	Pilot Allocation					
OTT-22	Marine Liaison					
OTT-3	Pilot Trng. (Flight)					
OTT-31	VF Combat Trng.					
OTT-32	VT-VB Combat Trng.					
OTT-33	Multi-Engine Cmbt Trng.					
OTT-34	Instrument Trng.					
OTT-35	LSO; Carrier Qual.					
OTT-36	Instructor Trng.					
OTT-37	Accident Prevention					
OTT-4	Aircrewman Trng.					
OTT-46	OinCC, AGTSU					
OTT-5	Pilot Trng. (Ground)					
OTT-51	Multi-Engine Type					
OTT-52	CV Type					
OTT-53	Survival Trng. & Eqpt.					
OTT-54	Navigation Trng.					
OTT-55	Synthetic Devices					
OTT-56	ACI					
OTT-57	Recognition Trg.; Film Util.					
OTT-58	Trng. Film Distr.					
OTT-6	Aircraft Materiel					
OTT-61	Maintenance & Eng.					
OTT-62	Procurmnt & Allocation					
OTT-63	AGR Work Distb.					
OTT-64	Ordnance Material					
OTT-7	Electronics; VF(N) Trng.					
OTT-71	Communication Trng.					
OTT-72	Radar Trng.					
OTT-73	Fighter Dir. & VF(N) Trg.					
OTT-74	Electronic Materiel					

J.NAS 69691 J-4826 6-45 75M

Definition of Symbols

1. Take necessary action.
2. Comment.
3. For information.
4. FILE—no action required.
5. Retain enclosure(s). Return Routing Slip to Central Files.

REMARKS: Copy retained by #1-3

5 JAN 1946
206

TO ACTION OFFICER
REPLY TO BE MAILED BY 1/4/46

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

NM29-11/AT-3/A17(2)

Serial No. 206 5 JAN 1946

To: Commandant, SEVENTH Naval District.

Subj: Board of investigation inquiring into loss of certain naval aircraft on 5 December 1945.

Ref: (a) Your ltr MD7(76) A4-3(1) JPS:JPH:jn dtd 26 Dec. 1945.

1. In accordance with reference (a), a copy of the record of proceedings of the board of investigation regarding subject matter will be furnished upon completion of the investigation.

RALPH DAVISON
Rear Admiral, USN
CNAAdTra

DATE	
ADMIRAL	Glenn
CHIEF OF STAFF	
Legal	1-3
Dom. Transp.	
Pub Rel.	
ADMINISTRATION	
Oper. Fac. Plng. IATCB	
Aerology	
Boat Facilities	
Wel.; Phys. Trng.	
Ships Serv.; BOQ	
War Bonds	
Insurance	
Personnel	
Pers. (Off.)	
Pers. (Enl.)	
Ed.-Enl. Trng.	
Class. Control	
Civil Pers. Rel.	
PW & OinCC	
Security; Intel. Safety; Fire Fightg.	
Comm. (Adm.)	
Postal	
(Adm.)	
Dir. of WAVES	
Central Office	
TRAINING	
Planning	
Officer Detail	
Pilot Allocations	
Marine Liaison	
Pilot Trng. (Flight)	
VF Combat Trng.	
VT-VB C'mbat Trng.	
Multi-Engine	
Combat Trng.	
Instrument Trng.	
LSO; Carrier Qual.	
Accident Prevention	
Aircr.; Grdcr. Trng.; ABTU	
Pilot Trng. (Grnd.)	
CV Type	
ME Type	
Survival Trng.	
Navig. Trng.	
Synthetic Devices	
ACI	
Recognition Trng.	
Aircraft Mat'l	
Ordnance Mat'l	
Electronics; F. D. & VF(N) Trng.	

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A(17)(2) MIAMI 1944-45

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NATIONAL ARCHIVES AND RECORDS ADMINISTRATION
MICROFILM PUBLICATIONS

Target 6

Folder A17 (2)
PBM–1946
Entry 16 (Box 97)

Outcome of the Board of Investigation query upon the circumstances attending the disappearance of five TBM-type aircraft.

DECLASSIFIED
Authority NND 868189

Route Slip No. 384
Date dt. 21 Feb 46

Headquarters
Naval Air Advanced Training Command

Our File A17(2)
Cross File
No. Copies 1
Enclosures 0

Taken Up By ma

Subject: Outcome of Board of Investigation query upon the circumstances attending the disappearance of five TBM-type aircraft.

From: NATC, Pensacola
Date: 15 Feb 1946

File Reference: 520
Finished File 25 FEB 1946

Corres. Symbol	Title	Routing Order	Routing Act. Symb.	Initials Noted	Date In	Date Out
AT-1	ADMIRAL	4	3			
AT-2	CHIEF OF STAFF	3	3			
AT-3	Legal	2	1			
AT-4	Domestic Transportation					
AT-5	Public Information					
ATA-1	ADMINISTRATION					
ATA-2	Operations; IATCB: ASR					
ATA-21	Operations Facilities; Planning					
ATA-23	Aerology					
ATA-24	Command Motor Transport					
ATA-25	Boat Facilities					
ATA-3	Welfare; Physical Training					
ATA-32	Ship Service; BOQ					
ATA-34	War Bonds					
ATA-4	Personnel					
ATA-41	Personnel (Officer)					
ATA-42	Personnel (Enlisted)					
ATA-43	Education; Enlisted Training					
ATA-45	Civil Personnel Relations					
ATA-46	Flag Unit					
ATA-5	Public Works					
ATA-7	Communications; Postal					
ATA-75	Publications					
ATA-8	Medical					
ATA-9	Supply					
ATA-17	Director of Waves					
ATA-18	Central Office					

Corres. Symbol	Title	Routing Order	Routing Act. Symb.	Initials Noted	Date In	Date Out
ATT-1	TRAINING	1	3			
ATT-2	Planning					
ATT-21	Pilot Allocations					
ATT-22	Marine Liaison					
ATT-23	Aircrewman Allocation					
ATT-3	Single Engine Training					
ATT-31-34	VF; VTB; VSB; VO-VCS					
ATT-35	LSO					
ATT-36	CV(N)					
ATT-37	Ground Training					
ATT-4	Multi-Engine Training					
ATT-41-44	VB2; VPB; VB4; ABTU					
ATT-45	Ground Training					
ATT-5	Training Support					
ATT-51	Ground Support					
ATT-52	Training Aids					
ATT-53	Electronics					
ATT-54	Ordnance					
ATT-6	Aircraft Material					
ATT-61	Maintenance - Engineering					
ATT-62	Procurement - Allocation					
ATT-63	AGR					
ATT-7	Flight Safety					
	BAMR					

J.NAS 1/46-J5547-100M

Definition of Symbols

1. Take necessary action.
2. Comment.
3. For information.
4. File—no action required.
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REMARKS: No action required. JSB

TO ACTION OFFICER

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Authority NND 868189

NAVAL AIR TRAINING COMMAND
PENSACOLA, FLORIDA

A17-2
4884

320

FEB 15 1946

The record of proceedings of the board of investigation in the instant case discloses several discrepancies in the execution of the training program which, in themselves, were of no vital import, but the sum total of which contributed to the loss of the TBM's.

The convening authority's comment is concurred with that, in essence, the leader of the flight became so hopelessly confused as to have suffered something akin to a mental aberration.

Being done //

In overwater navigational flights within the Naval Air Training Command, lost plane procedure will be given greater emphasis than in the past.

Subject to the foregoing remarks, the proceedings, findings and opinion of the board of investigation in the attached case, and the action of the convening authority thereon, are approved.

/s/ F. D. WAGNER

F. D. WAGNER,
Rear Admiral, U.S. Navy,
Chief of Naval Air Training

To: JAG

cc: CNAAdTra
CO, NAS, Banana River
CO, NAS, Ft. Lauderdale
ComSeven
CNO
ComEastSeaFron

Re: Board of Investigation convened by CNAAdTra to inquire into and report upon the circumstances attending the disappearance of five TBM-type aircraft, Bureau Numbers 23307, 46094, 73209, 46325, and 45714, and one PBM aircraft, Bureau Number 59225, which occurred at approximately 1900, 5 December 1945, resulting in the missing status of Naval personnel.

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A 17(2) PBM 1946

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M1657
Roll 1
of 1

END

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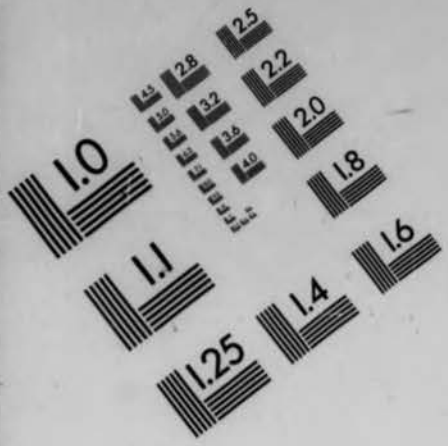
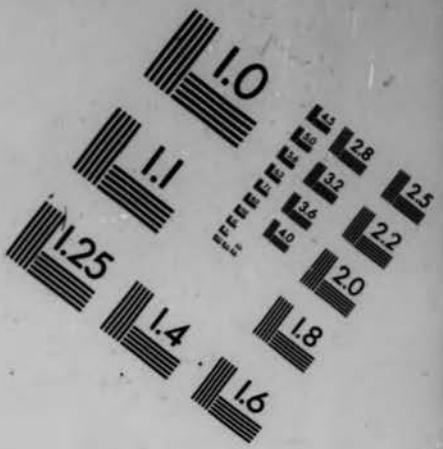
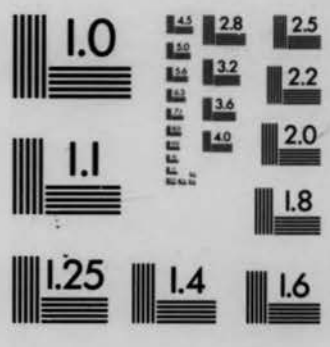
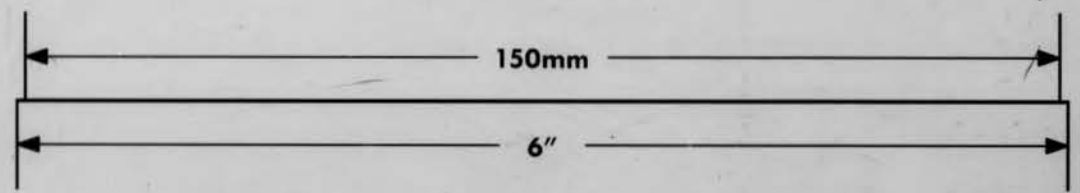
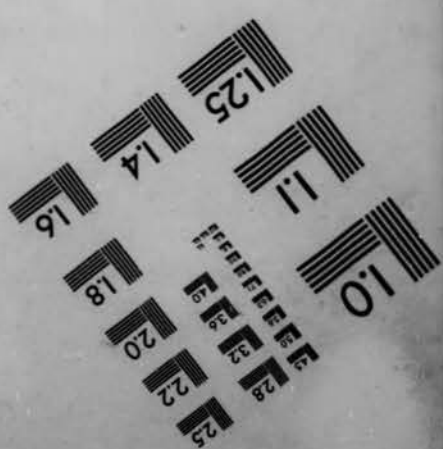
IMAGE EVALUATION
TEST TARGET (QA-3)











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THE END

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